

In the name of God most Gracious, ever Merciful!

The Beloved and I

Volume 9: The Holy Qur'an

Thomas McElwain

New Jubilees Version of Sacred Scripture in
Verse
With Verse Commentaries
Revised Edition

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The Holy Qur'an

Disclaimer: The holy Qur'an is impossible to translate. This is not a translation. It is merely a contemplation of the holy Qur'an.

The Author's Apology

A simple Baptist preacher turns his pen
To hymn the message of Qur'an again
In lays to sing in Long Meter and find
The Word of God beyond the fed and
wined.

I beg forgiveness from all men for this:
It is offensive to all men I kiss
The sweetness of the Arabic and pray
Bowed down in the Islamic sort of way.
The Muslim does not accept me among
His crew, and Christians also bite my
tongue.

The Jew cares not whether a Gentile goes
About in dervish woollen sort of clothes.
The ten commandments are God's word,
and they

Are ratified in the Qur'anic lay.
Muhammad came to preach in Araby
Against falsehood in the sixth century,
The great monophysitic heresy,
Most radical faith in the Trinity.
He called men back into the faith once set
To Abraham, and not to new faith met.
He did not come to invent one more creed,
But to unite Jew and Christian in need.
That's why I must remain a Baptist here,
The ancient faith of those that God held
dear

Outside the fold of Israel and clear.
The first Baptist known in the Scriptures
came

To the prophet Elisha with the claim
That he could heal him of his leprosy.
Baptised in Jordan, he rose up to see
The Baptist church his house of prayer to
be.

I take the ancient faith in David's Son,
And sink beneath the Jordan's waves that
run,

And rise into the congregation still
Keeping the faith of Naaman with a will.

I see the rise of empires and of churches,
The rage of armies and saints on their
perches,
And after all, like phoenix come to life,
I rise above all doctrinal in strife,
And take the Word of God the Prophet
preached

And submit to the living faith he reached.
What is the faith that dear Muhammad
taught?

It is the Bible still stands in its lot
And that the Lord Jesus is Christ for all
Who live and move upon the earthly ball.
Oh yes, and keep the Sabbath not to be
A monkey throughout all eternity.
That is the creed that Francis Bampffield set
Upon the church he gathered from the wet
To sing their Psalms and never to forget.
I take the Bible, yet I turn away
From Roman and the Protestant in sway.
I take the Qur'an, yet I turn my back
Upon Sunnite and Shi'ite in their slack.
I enter in the simple way restored,
The way of grace and the way of my Lord.

How many of my forebears anciently
Like Edward Elwall cried out silently
And from the heart "Ali, Ali, Ali"?
Like Moses before Pharaoh's throne who
stayed

To watch the waters of the Nile arrayed,
(Exodus 8:9)

Like Israel upon the desert sand
Depending on a springing well to stand,
They lifted heart and hope as well as hand.
(Numbers 21:17; 24:6)

Beloved, I too lift voice and beat my breast,
And find within that name a place of rest,
As I recite the sparkling words with zest
That from the first are last if not the best.
Let the Qur'an join with the Bible word
To sing with me along with winged and
furred.

Surah 1 Al-Fatihah or the Opening

1 In the name of God most gracious,
merciful,
2 All praise is God's, Lord of the Universe,

3 Most gracious Lord and Lord most
merciful,
4 King of the Day of judgement, 5 we
rehearse
To You alone our worship and petition.
6 Guide us, O Lord, in Your right
admonition,
7 In ways of peace in Your bounties'
fruition,
Not in their path who know Your wrath
Nor in their way whose steps go to
perdition.

Beloved, I take Your name alone to start,
All other names express but empty art,
All other names refer to You alone,
Or else refer to disappearing stone.
Beloved, You are alone in what You seem,
All other is illusive, changing dream.
I take Your name, Most Gracious,
Merciful,
And so begin, that I, dressed in mere wool,
May speak and act eternal words and
deeds.
Take me beneath the reed bed and its reeds,
Take me, Beloved, as far as earth may go,
And teach me what mercy and grace can
show.
I take Your name, Beloved, that there may
be
No name but Yours in all Reality.

Lord of the Universe, Beloved, I raise
To You the slender melody of praise.
You do not need my praise, worship or
thanks.
You have the songs of angels in their ranks.
But I it is who needs to give to You
Acknowledgement of what You are and
who.
All praise is Yours, because there is no
other,
You are not son, father, daughter or
mother.
You cherish all, and all things You sustain
Without fatigue, nor any care or pain.
Do not sustain, but cherish also me
Till otherness is gone and I am free,
Beloved, cherish also me until
There is no I but You to do Your will.

The Name of Allah in the Hebrew Bible

The name of Allah does not always shine
From Bible pages like the new-made wine,
Except of course in Arabic translation,
Where Alohim is Allah for sensation.
The Bible much prefers the cognate to
Allahumma, that's Alohim, and YHWH.
The Hebrew aleph-lamedh-he appears
As name for God in Bibles without tears,
And that's not to mention the Chaldee rate
Of calling God in Scripture Allah great.
The Torah in just one passage relates
That lovely name of God within its gates.
(Deuteronomy 32:15,17).
But Nehemiah also shows the light
Of Allah streaming in the people's sight
After captivity in Babylon,
When Allah's faith once more came in to
dawn. (Nehemiah 9:17).
In the same verse the prophet shows the
word
Of grace and mercy, rahuum, to be stirred.
Three times the Psalmist mentions Allah
too
And shows the name a valid one in view.
The first thing David says, a warning sound
To both the Jew and Christian come
around,
That Allah will destroy both root and
ground
Of those who forget Allah and none can
Deliver them, not even Christ the son
Of David once their ranting has begun.
(Psalm 50:22)
Let Protestant and Catholic beware
Of setting aside Allah from the fair,
For such a way leads straight to hell-fire's
lair.
The second thing that David would
command
Is that the very God of Jacob's stand
Is called Allah. So Allah's no name grand
Of heathen idol, as sweet Christians claim
To their wickedness and eternal shame.
(Psalm 114:7)
David's third word is that Allah will slay
The wicked, and so He goes from their
way. (Psalm 139:19)
Allah rejects the bloodthirsty man here,

And so I know that Muslims who appear
In violence are not Allah's in kind,
But are the wicked, hopelessly born blind.
If David's witness does not suffice here,
Then I take Solomon speaking in ear.

(Proverbs 30:5)

“Every word of Allah is pure, and He
Is a shield for the ones whose trust” to be
In Him is sure and faithful in decree.
I pray my trust in God remain before
The weight of heresy I find in store
In every faith established upon gore.
Instead I come to Allah's sure word now
And find a purer voice here where I bow.
Above all other passages I find
Isaiah's hopeful proclamation signed
With Allah's oneness is the greater word,
Despite its abuse by the Christian herd.

(Isaiah 44:6)

In this verse YHWH's called king,
redeemer too.

I here report the story of false Jew
I met in a church called with infame's hue
A messianic congregation's crew.
He claimed that since YHWH was both
Israel's king

And his redeemer, that shows a clear thing,
That YHWH is not one being here but two,
The one who died upon a cross to save
The world from sin and an eternal grave,
The other the sweet Father up above
Who looked down on His son in helpless
love.

How can the eye and heart be ever blind?
The very text itself gainsays the kind.
God says that He is first and last and so
There is no god but He, none fast or slow.
So few times do the Hebrew Scriptures call
God Allah in the vasty Scriptures' hall,
Except for Job, who likes that word more
than

Any other name under the sky's span.
As soon as he begins to speak, he tells
The world the name of Allah without
spells. (Job 3:4)

He knows Allah is sovereign in all things,
And so he praises Allah in his stings. (Job
3:23)

Eliphaz Temanite regards the name
Of Allah as the one of greatest fame. (Job
4:9)

He rightly points out that a man cannot
Be more just than Allah in human plot.
So when a man complains his fate is rot,
He is rebelling against divine spot. (Job
4:17)

He also shows that blessings fall upon
The one that Allah smites from dawn to
dawn
Correcting him from sinful ways outdrawn.
(Job 5:17)

Job speaks again of Allah who strikes him
With terrors in array against him grim. (Job
6:4)

He begs Allah to let him die in grief,
Since Allah does not bring him to relief.
(Job 6:8,9)

The Arab Bildad does not choose the word
That Christians now attribute to that herd,
But Job goes on to wish that he had heard
The reason for the things that had occurred
From Allah's own lips told to his belief.
(Job 9:13; 10:2)

Unlike Bildad, Zohar takes on his lips
The name of Allah to defend his slips
In accusation against a just man,
A perfect one according to God's plan. (Job
11:5,6,7)

Job mocks the wisdom of Zohar who shows
God cannot be searched out for human
woes,

To say Allah is abused by such rows. (Job
12:4)

Job points out that the ones who will
blaspheme

Allah's name sometimes prosper with the
cream. (Job 12:6)

Indeed that's true today, where Muslim's
take

The name of Allah for violent stake,
And Christians despise Allah as a god
Drawn out of a more pagan sort of clod.
It's true in five or six passages here
That word, like Alohim, comes to appear
In reference to false gods and such undear.
(Daniel 11:37-39; Habbakuk 1:11)

And yet Habbakuk knows Allah, it's clear.
(Habbakuk 3:3)

Eliphaz throws the accusation back
On Job, as though his knowledge too were
slack. (Job 15:8)

Job only answers with his tears to say

To Allah that he hoped to plead his way.
(Job 16:20,21)

Though Allah has brought down on Job
such pain,

Job places confidence through sun and rain
On Allah and the resurrection's gain,
The day when all creation shall return
Before Allah's face for the things they earn.
(Job 19:6,22,26)

Job's friends who do not know these things
rely

On supposition under a clear sky,
While Allah's rod does not come down to
fly

Upon them, but Allah lays up the book
Of their iniquity, and then shall look
On them for their reward with fire and
hook. (Job 21:9,19)

Eliphaz once more begs Job to repent
So he can stand before Allah unrent. (Job
22:12,26)

But Job knows that the evil plague is not
The proof of wickedness that he had
wrought.

The plague is proof that Allah's sovereign
still,

And Job gives no doubt to the neighbour's
will. (Job 24:12)

Job holds his righteousness fast in the way
While Allah's spirit is his breath in sway
That he might call on Allah's name each
day. (Job 27:3,5,8,10)

And yet a suffering man reserves the right
To weep upon his grief from night to night,
Though Allah's hand is always free of spite.
(Job 29:2,4)

The plaint is justified, since Allah knows
All things the universe presents in rows,
And whether righteousness of a man grows.
(Job 31:2,6)

Elihu disagrees, hopes Allah's great
Beyond the reach of human thought and
state.

Man need not understand but only pray,
And Allah will bring down the better day.
(Job 33:12,26)

Elihu's wrath falls down on other three
As well as on Job when he will make free
To justify the sovereignty of God
By claiming Job is wrong upon the sod.
He says "None says 'Where's Allah my

Maker, who gives night songs to fly.'" (Job
35:10)

So the brave young man comes to speak
For Allah's sake, as though He's weak. (Job
36:2; 37:15,22)

Though Allah sets Job up to answer Him,
He does not condemn what he said in trim,
But rather condemns those accusing him.
Though Allah's great and sovereign, evil
times

Are not results of suffering men for crimes.
(Job 39:17)

Allah Himself uses the name Allah
To speak to Job and bow him down in awe.
(Job 40:2,9,19)

That's only the Hebrew, the Chaldee tongue
When used in Scriptures Nehemiah's sung
And Daniel too when he was old and young
Refer to Allah more times on the rung,
And more than three-score ten times show
Him fair

Who is YHWH, Alohim and Allah there.
In ignorance men say that God is not
Allah, in wisdom every Christian sought
Who speaks the Arabic tongue knows it's
true

That God's name is Allah in the church too.
Within the Hebrew portion and the brew
Twelve verses outside Job call God Allah,
And that's an end to rule of human claw.

"In the Name of the Lord" in the Bible

Holy Qur'an begins in name of God
And so makes paradise upon the sod.
It is no new thing to write so and speak,
For God's name's been the refuge of the
weak

And terror of the strong since God took
rod.

There are twelve means and ways in the
Good Book,

The Bible, for the name of God they took.
The first way is the priestly service done
To minister to all beneath the sun.
(Deuteronomy 18:5,7; 21:5)

So Ali's word is priestly ministry
Upon the soil and ever faithfully.
The second way the name of God appears
Is in the speaking without false and fears

In name of God His word in prophecy.
 (Deuteronomy 18:22; 1Kings 22:16;
 1Chronicles 21:19; 2Chronicles
 18:15; 33:18; Jeremiah 11.21;
 26:9,16,20; 44:16; Zechariah 13:3;
 James 5:10)

So Hasan's message is the one that tells
 The prophecy aloud in songs and bells.
 The third way is to come in the Lord's
 name,

And that is spoken only for the fame
 Of David in his saving of the claim
 (1Samuel 17:45; Psalm 118:26)
 And of the Christ who was without a blame
 The son of David shining like a flame.
 (Matthew 21:9; 23:9; Mark 11:9,10;
 Luke 13:35; 19:38; John 12:13)

So the first phrase of the holy Qur'an
 Implies the memory of David drawn
 And recognizes the Messiah's dawn.
 The message of Hussain, my fair Hussain,
 Reveals the coming of the Christ in pain
 And sacrifice upon the river plain.
 The fourth way in the name of God is met
 In swearing in the pact of David set
 And Jonathan, the law of love to let. (1
 Samuel 20:42)

So love sworn in peace is the way Ali
 Also sang his Psalms to God faithfully.
 The fifth way in the name of God I find
 In blessing, which is also of the kind
 King David made when others were
 resigned. (1 Samuel 6:18; 1
 Chronicles 16:2; Psalm 129:8)

So Muhammad al-Baqir takes the cake
 Of blessing everyone for Allah's sake.
 The sixth way in the name of God reveals
 The altar that Elijah built for peals
 Of thunder and for rain in name of God
 To water and refresh the parching sod. (1
 Kings 18:32)

So Ja'fer as-Sadiq's alchemic wake
 Revealed the law refreshing for men's sake.
 The seventh way in name of God is curse
 Brought on by prophet Elisha, no nurse
 To forty young men who reviled his head
 And so brought disgrace to God's name
 instead. (2 Kings 2:24)

Al-Kadhim's message goes beyond the gap
 Of David's blessing to cursing's mishap.
 The eighth way of God's name is ever near:

Destruction of the wicked who appear.
 All nations fall destroyed in David's fear,
 Before the glory of his son and dear,
 In name of God struck down with gain and
 gear. (Psalm 118:10,11,12)
 So Ali ar-Riddha destroys in fact
 The Abbasid empire's lying pact.
 The ninth way in God's name is divine aid
 Which comes in the power of the One who
 made

Both heaven and earth and set them on
 parade. (Psalm 124:8)

So Imam Taqi is the one who stayed
 Within the help of Allah when waylaid.
 The tenth way in God's name is simply
 trust

Within the human heart upon the dust
 For those who fear the Lord, obey the voice
 Of the Lord's servant sent to give a choice,
 Who leads through vales of darkness to
 rejoice. (Isaiah 50:10)

So too afflicted and poor ones prevail
 In trusting in God's name on hill and dale.
 (Zephaniah 3:12)

So Imam Naqi, without greed or lust,
 Teaches the soul in God to place her trust.
 Eleventh way in God's name is to walk
 No matter what the heathen do or talk.
 And so God will forever be our God
 And guide in love and light beneath His
 rod. (Micah 4:5)

Imam al-Askeri is Ali's sword
 Set out to walk the way and at last scored.
 The twelfth way in Allah's name is to take
 The oil of the anointing for the sake
 Of those who suffer illness in the wake
 Of trouble in the world of hope and rake.
 (James 5:14)

So the Imam Mahdi, one led and kept
 In secret for the pure who prayed and wept,
 Is balm of healing in the day and night
 Until the raising of the judgement's light.
 The twelve activities done in God's name
 Throughout the Bible prophesy the fame
 Of twelve Imams and thus establish fast
 The first words of Qur'an against the blast
 Of faiths established to oppress the soul.
 I pray God lead me to the faithful goal.

“Gracious and Merciful” in the Bible

The words of grace and mercy that appear
 At the beginning of Qur'anic seer
 Are quoted from the Lord in Exodus
 Who came to show grace and mercy to us.
 Ar-rahmaan ar-rahiim in Hebrew form
 Is rahuum wehannuun and as the norm.
 (Exodus 34:6)

These words appear together in the rate
 Of twelve times in the Biblical estate,
 And thus show hidden incommensurate
 The Twelve Imams that make the heart
 elate.

The grace and mercy of Allah shines out
 When the captives returned and turned
 about,

And left the faith of Babylon and doubt. (2
 Chronicles 30:9)

Repentance in the turning is the word
 That has my heart for graciousness
 bestirred.

This grace is given by the promise made
 Despite the shrewish hardened neck that
 stayed

In their rebellion's bondage and waylaid.
 But this is joy to me, though none deserved
 Salvation, the divine One never swerved
 From promise of His mercy by grace paid.
 (Nehemiah 9:17)

God might have forsaken and sent the lot
 Consumed by fire and fate and heathen
 plot,

But did not, for He's ever gracious still
 And merciful to foot the steepest bill.
 (Nehemiah 9:31)

Good David shows that way that grace
 comes down

In mercy to fill up the fallen town:
 Those who call on the name of God's
 renown,

On the great gracious and merciful's crown,
 Find that He grants the both in shining
 gown. (Psalm 86:15)

For the Lord's merciful and gracious too,
 And slow to wrath and full of mercy's view.
 (Psalm 103:8)

The seventh word of grace and mercy show
 That God's works were made with the holy
 glow

To make remembrance. So the dhikr set
 Upon the Sabbath day is one that's met

In grace and mercy, which is why the
 tongue

Proclaims them both on every Sabbath's
 rung. (Psalm 111:4)

The upright finds truth in a darkened place
 And rises in that mercy and that grace.
 (Psalm 112:4)

So righteousness is the product that's found
 Wherever grace and mercy touch the
 ground. (Psalm 116:5)

In sum the words of David and all six
 Reveal that God is hiding no new tricks,
 But slow to wrath comes in the gracious
 way

To bring to humankind merciful day.
 (Psalm 145:8)

The grace and mercy of our God creates
 Repentance in the called, elected mates.
 Repentance gained by that grace in the
 heart

Remains until salvation fills its part. (Joel
 2:13)

Poor Jonah uses God's grace as excuse
 For fleeing from the programme of abuse
 In warning Nineveh of coming flame
 And its destruction for a life in blame.

(Jonah 4:2)

Complaint that God is gracious every day
 And shows His mercy to such as still stray
 Is surely evidence that no man may
 By mere obedience and works in pay
 Enter the Paradise of God to stay.

What does not come by grace created fair
 Comes by the mercy that God's power will
 share

With the called and the chosen on the stair.

Hamd in the Bible

The word for praise in Arabic is fine,
 But hamd in Hebrew's a desire like wine
 To burn with longing for the Lord above,
 Desired and pleasant, and the Lord of love.
 Isaiah so laments for those near tents
 Where the Beloved returns among the
 rents,

And longs for the desired fields where the
 breeze

Blows in the breath of God from the far
 seas (Isaiah 32:12)

The soul seeks the Beloved as the wife
 strains
 In sighing for desired young man in pains.
 (Ezekiel 23:6,12,23)
 She languishes beneath the desert sun,
 And dreams of vineyards well desired and
 won. (Amos 5:11)
 Beneath the praise the Qur'an stands to
 raise
 There is a hidden hopelessness in maze
 Until the desired and Belovèd come
 To quench desire with praise, sighing with
 hum.

Rabbil-'aalamiin (YHWH le'olam) in the Bible

What's Lord of worlds or all the universe
 In Arabic is something not the worse
 In Hebrew for exchanging space for time,
 And saying Lord forever is the rhyme.
 The first to call upon the lovely name
 Of Lord of universe, Arabic claim
 Rabbil-'aalamiin, was good Abraham.
 I so called at sacrifice of the lamb. (Genesis
 21:33)
 On crossing the Red Sea then Miriam
 Along with the folk also sang aloud
 To the Lord of the worlds before the crowd.
 Exodus 15:18)
 Through Moses God declares the
 congregation
 To belong to Rabbil-'aalamiin's nation.
 (Deuteronomy 23:3)
 David speaks of his innocence before
 The Lord Olam to praise Him evermore. (2
 Samuel 3:28)
 The throne of David was established then
 Before Lord aalamiin and before men. (1
 Kings 2:45)
 So Israel's God is blessed and come to be
 Lord of Olam and so eternally. (1
 Chronicles 16:36)
 The Lord's blessed to Olam again by that
 Greater restorer in the burning fat,
 Good Nehemiah, when at last he came
 Back to Jerusalem for lasting fame.
 Nehemiah 9:5; 13:1)
 But David the king knows better than all
 Before him upon whom as Lord to call,

Lord of Eternity before the fall
 Of gods and powers that be out of the stall.
 (Psalms 9:7; 10:16; 29:10; 41:13;
 48:14; 89:52; 90:2; 92:8; 102:12;
 103:17; 106:48)
 Isaiah knew the Lord indeed
 Was everlasting above need. (Isaiah 40:28)
 When Jeremiah said the word,
 He knew the Lord was undeterred
 From being King eternally
 On sky and earth and on the sea. (Jeremiah
 10:10)
 He did not forget that when he
 Wrote his laments sorrowfully.
 (Lamentations 5:19)
 Ten witnesses from Israel's ancient days
 Come to give the Lord their eternal praise.

Siraatul-mustaqim (the straight path) in the Bible

The straight path is mentioned just five
 times in
 The Bible to keep people from their sin.
 The servant of Abraham found his way
 To the land and the family the day
 He sought a wife for Isaac, because God
 Had led him on the right path by His rod
 (Genesis 24:48)
 When Israel begged a king against the
 Lord,
 Rejecting Him to lead them without sword,
 And angering Him for their sin's reward,
 Then Samuel came to pray they be restored
 To the right way, and so he prayed again
 And ever for Israel's women and men. (1
 Samuel 12:23)
 Though they preferred an earthly king, this
 man,
 A prophet of the very best in span,
 Kept teaching the right way and path to
 them
 Though many came rejecting to contemn.
 In after years when Babylon had come
 To take the people of Jerusalem
 To a far land to languish and abide,
 Ezra proclaimed the right path on his side.
 Affliction of our souls and fasting might
 With seeking bring the right path into light,

When God's grace fell upon the folk with
might. (Ezra 8:21)

The fasting seems to have been without
harm,

For the Lord is presented with strong arm
To lead the people in the right way when
David sang to inspire the folk again.
(Psalms 107:7)

By contrast, there's a way that is not right,
The way that Balaam offered in the night
Of greed and envy to lead into plight.
So Peter warns a thousand years and more
Not to follow in Balaam's doctrine's score.
(2 Peter 2:15)

May my prayer and my fasting on this day
See me return and follow the right way.

2 Baqara, or the Heifer

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
1 Alif Lam Mim.

The letters that face many chapters here
In the Qur'an are cryptic and appear
To make men wonder what and how and
fear.

Their meaning is great and secret, though
clear

To You, Beloved, and to the prophet's
cheer,

And to the people of the house held dear.
While other men may speculate and find
Some meanings from their own depraved in
mind,

I stand aloof from all who think they know
The meanings of the letters that You show,
Relying on the ones who know the truth
About Your grace and mercy on both youth
And aged people who answer the call
Of cryptic letters shining on the wall.

2 That is the book, no doubt in it,

A guidance to those who are fit,

3 Believing in the hidden thing,

Establishing prayer and spending
From what We gave them in provision,

4 Believing in the present vision
Sent down upon you and the books
Sent down before you, and who looks
With certainty for the hereafter.

5 Such ones indeed, they follow after
The guidance from their Lord and they

Are most successful every way.

Islamic scholars always try to say
That when the Qur'an says "that book", this
way

It means the Qur'an itself, and translate
"This" instead of "that" to their doom in
fate.

The word "that" means "that" in both
English and

In Arabic. And so I come to stand
Upon the truth that that book that is meant
Is the book that was once already sent,
The Holy Bible, book in which You came
To show Your ten commandment law of
flame

And glorify eternally Your name.

Beloved, I take this book and that and
know

That You are far above sectarian show
And sit sovereign over the earth below.

6 But those who disbelieve, you might
As well not warn them as give light,
For faith is something they reject.

They do not stop, do not reflect.

7 Allah has set a seal upon

Their hearts and hearing and has drawn
A veil upon their sight, and great
Shall be their torment and their fate.

Ah Bismillaahi in the name of Him
Ar-Rahmaanir Rahiim, along the rim
Of grace and mercy I step out to sing
Your glories, O Beloved and my king.
Ah Bismillaahi in Your name I pray,
Ar-Rahmaanir Rahiim, I dare to say
Again and once more what Your grace
reveals

And what Your mercy cleanses, binds and
heals.

Ah Bismillaahi, name where bounties live,
Where meet the Gracious Merciful to give
The world and universe a revelation
In Scriptures taught in every tongue and
nation.

Ar-Rahmaanir Rahiim, mercy and grace,
I find in You, Beloved, the only place.

Beloved, four books in one You sent to us

Sure guidance without doubt and without
fuss.

I take hold of the firm unseen, I bow
In prayer, in charity fulfil my vow.
I have faith in the book sent down before
Your final prophet, read each day its store,
And in the book sent down at last to last,
And in Your guiding judgement from the
past

To future. So this day let me press on
In guidance from Your never failing dawn.
Remove the veils on heart and eye and
hearing

That I may sound Your lovely voice none
fearing,
And see beyond the past and coming light
Into the now and present work of night.

8 And of the people there are those
Who say "In God we do believe
And in the day when time will close"
But truly they do not believe.

9 Instead they will try to deceive
Those who believe in God in fact.
But God and all see through their act.
They fool themselves and do not know it.

10 In their hearts is disease to show it,
And God increases their disease.
They have been saying what they please:
A painful torment for their lying.

11 And when you tell them "Stop defying
And causing mischief in the land"
They only say on every hand

"We just make peace." 12 But they're the
ones

Who cause the trouble, and their sons,
But they don't seem to realize it.

13 But when you tell them "Don't despise
it,

Believe as others have believed"
They say "Shall we like fools deceived
Believe in nonsense?" Truly they
Are fools and don't know what they say.

With Abdullah ibn Olai the beginning
Of missionary work through friendship
winning

Appeared, and since that day upon the
street

Of fair Madina, all who come to greet

With two-faced cunning show the Christian
way

To share a faith or not upon the day.
Beloved, my faith is simple and direct:
I take Jesus Christ as Lord and select
Lawgiver to my soul and conscience
wrecked,

And the sweet Bible as my only rule
Of faith and worship and life in this school.
Since the Qur'an affirms these two, I know
Your sovereignty and Sabbath come to
show

Salvation and the heavenly goal in row.

It's heart disease and cancer we most fear,
Beloved, these days of greater wealth and
gear.

And though cholesterol is in control,
And blood pressure within the better scroll,
The heart disease that makes pretence of
good

When evil lurks in word and deed that
should

Be subject to Sinai's last message roll
Is still as common on the western shore
As it was in Muhammad's desert core.
Beloved, though I'm a fool, no doubt it's
true,

Keep me from mischief in the things I do,
While claiming to be just in my own pew.
Perhaps I'll realize the truth at last
And turn my actions from the wicked cast.

14 And when they meet believers, say
"We too believe," but on the day
They're with their satans, then they say
"We were just joking all the way."

15 So Allah makes of them a joke
And lets them wander like blind folk
In their wrong-doing. 16 These are they
Who bought instead of guidance error,
Such purchase profits not but terror,
And so such ones have lost the way.

17 They're like the man who kindled fire,
And when it lighted all around him
Then God deprived them of desire,
Left in the dark so no one found him,
And so they could not see at all.

18 Both deaf and blind, they will not come
Back to the path, for they are dumb.

19 Or like a rain cloud from the sky,

In it are darkness, lightning, thunder:
With fingers in their ears they try
To keep away the stunning thunder
For fear of death in terror, wonder.
But God surrounds those who deny.
20 The lightning nearly takes their sight,
And every time they see some light
They walk, but when they're in the dark
They find all they can do is park.
But if God wished He could deprive
Them of their hearing, *sakes alive*,
Of sight too, for in everything
God's power always has the sting.

Beloved, Your power is over all things
here,
You give capacity to eye and ear
Or not. Through veiling cloud and rain I
run
Who knows how far since thunder has
begun.
I take my fingers from my ears and stand
To find Your speeches rolling off the land.
Yet even know, within the hearing plot,
The gallows of remembrance, I have
sought,
Or thought I sought, faith in You and the
last
Day, culmination of all days gone past.
But true it is this is the final day,
And still I strain my ears for what You say.
Deceive me not, Beloved, though I'm a
fool
Who will not leave for earth or peace the
pool.

21 O people! Serve your Lord, the one
Who has created you, the one
Who has created those before,
And so keep evil from your door.
22 He made for you the earth a place
Of rest, the skies above your face
A canopy, and sent down rain
Out of the cloud and not in vain,
That brings forth from it your provision
Of fruits on earth, a lovely vision,
So set no rivals up with God
If what you know is worth a pod.
23 And if you doubt what We have sent
From time to time to our servant,
Then make a chapter just like it,

And call your witnesses to it
Besides God, if you're true and fit.
24 But if you do not, and it's sure
You never can produce it pure,
Beware then of the fire prepared,
Its fuel both stones and men ensnared,
For unbelievers fire prepared.
25 But give good news to those who do
Right actions and believe what's true,
That their reward is gardens where
Streams underground flow on and bear
Fruit for their portions while they say
These gifts we have received today
Are what we had before, they're just
Like what we had and thought we must
All lose, and pure mates shall be given
In those fair gardens there to live in.
26 Allah is not ashamed to make
Use of the smallest for Truth's sake,
A gnat or anything above it
Is good enough for God to love it,
Those who believe are in the know
How God's truth is revealed below.
Those who reject faith only say
What does God mean here anyway?
By parables He leads astray
Those who will not walk the right way.
But those who do not want to go
Away from the right path below,
He leads and causes not to stray.

While You, Beloved, are entranced by the
gnat,
I think my choice is better where I'm at.
You have not noticed how mosquitoes fly,
Since You are never bitten to the wry.
If You, Beloved, had swatted them, You'd
know
They have a way of getting on the go.
Just think what kind of brain that is not
slow
Allows their quick retreat before my blow.
I must admit that I'm inferior
To Your mosquito in my speed and chore,
And so I stay admiring and in wonder
That any man could make so great a
blunder
As thinking himself better than the least
Of Your creatures out flying and increased.

27 But those who break God's covenant

And after it was ratified
 They sunder what God was content
 They joined, they are the ones that tried
 To fill the earth with mischief, they
 It is who bear the loss today.
 28 How can you disbelieve in God?
 You know that you were just a clod
 Without life, and He gave you life,
 And He will cut it like a knife
 And then give you the resurrection
 Till you return to His protection.
 29 He that created for you what
 Is in the earth and all it's got,
 Then He ascended to the sky
 To fashion it in seven by
 His own design and will, for He
 Is knower of all things that be.

It is not language, style nor rhyme that
 makes
 The surah more than man, but what it
 wakes.
 Some poet there may be whose lines are
 bright
 And clear, whose lays inspire to love and
 fight.
 And rhetoric abounds to change men's
 minds
 And advertising products always finds
 The buyer for the needless, yes, the word
 Of many men has kindled hearts and
 stirred.
 The word of man can only cause to stray,
 And sunder covenants, make mischief's
 way.
 You only with a word can create life,
 Bring back from death and pacify the strife.
 Your word alone can penetrate the veils
 Of seven skies, perfect knowledge from
 tales.

30 And when your Lord said to the angels,
 The fiery and majestic angels,
 "I shall create upon the earth
 A representative *of worth*,"
 They said, "Will You appoint therein
 A man of mischief and of sin
 Who will shed blood, whilst we Your
 praise
 Do celebrate throughout our days?"
 Said He "In truth I know a thing

Of which the angels never sing."
 31 And so he taught Adam the name
 And nature of all things that claim
 A place He set before the host
 Of angels in angelic boast,
 And said "Tell me, if you are true,
 The names of these and what they do."
 32 They said "Alone to You be glory,
 We have no knowledge, end of story,
 We only know what You have taught,
 Such perfect wisdom can't be bought
 As You have, nor Your knowledge either,
 Your wisdom nor Your knowledge either."
 33 He said "O Adam! Tell them truly
 Their natures." So he not unduly
 Told everything, and Allah said
 "Did I not tell you without dread
 That I know secrets heavenly
 And earthly too, that I can see
 What things it is that you reveal
 And also what you would conceal?"
 34 Look at the angels what We told them:
 "Bow down to Adam." None could hold
 them,
 And they bowed down, except Iblis:
 But he refused and would not cease
 His proud behaviour, he was one
 Who had no faith once he was done.

Make me, Beloved, like that unfaithful one
 Who bowed not to a single man, to none
 Though he heard even some divine
 command.
 While all the others bow, let me just stand
 Alone and upright as the idol crumbles.
 Let me stand straight when every man here
 stumbles
 That gives his fealty to artifice
 And policy. Yes, my Beloved, let this
 Be my last prayer before I enter flame
 Of Hell. While others followed in the game
 Of universal love and secret blast
 Upon the poor to make a buck, I fast
 Even from what You seem to grant in
 grace,
 And like Iblis bow only towards Your face.

35 We said "O Adam! You may live
 Here in the garden that I give
 And your wife too, and eat what's there
 Whatever you find fresh and fair,

But do not come near this one tree
Or you'll find harm transgressing free."

36 Then Satan made both of them slip
From where they were, he gave them lip.
We said "Get down, and everyone
Have enmity for what you've done.
On earth you shall live for a time
And work and sweat to earn a dime."

37 Then Adam learnt from his Lord word
Of inspiration like none heard,
And his Lord turned towards him too,
For He returns whate'er you do,
Most Merciful, forgiving too.

38 We said "All of you, down from here,
I'll send you guidance, never fear,
And if you follow what I send
You'll have no fear or grief to tend."

39 "But those of you who will deny,
Who reject faith, Our signs belie,
They will be dwellers in the fire,
And there they'll stay and go no higher."

The Biblical account gives just a hint
Of how and why the fall came in to dint.
You spoke, Beloved, to Adam on the score
And not to Eve about which to deplore
Among the garden trees on glassy floor.
The tempter knew a better way than You:
He spoke instead to Eve, not Adam's due.
If You want something done, learn Your
approach:

Don't ask the man, but rather more
encroach

Upon the wife. She's far more likely to
Accomplish any task a man should do.
It's only children who know that dad lets
Them do what mum holds them to make
regrets.

The sale's always made to the mistress
crew.

40 O Israel's sons, remember what
I have bestowed and what you've got
Of bounties from Me, just fulfil
Your covenant with Me, and still
I shall fulfil My covenant
With you by My gracious consent,
So fear no one but Me. 41 Believe
In what I have sent down, receive
Its confirmation in the book,
(Torah and Psalms, just take a look),

Which is with you, and do not be
First to reject faith in it, see
You do not sell for a small price
My signs, for what you think is nice,
But fear to disobey My word
And Me alone. 42 Do not hide Truth
With falsehood or find out in ruth
You have concealed Truth that you know
Is written in the Torah. 43 So
Establish prayer, give to the poor
Their alms in charity and more,
And bow down with those who prostrate
Themselves in worship. 44 Don't be late,
You who teach others what is right,
To follow it yourselves, the light
You find in study of the Book.
Do you not see although you look?
45 Seek help with patience and with prayer,
Hard task to do for proud and fair,
Save humble ones, 46 always aware
That surely they will meet their Lord,
Return to Him with one accord.

A special favour, my Beloved, You gave
To Israël in revelation's wave
That says to fear You, aye, to fear alone
The One True God made not by hands in
stone,

Establish prayer in earth prostration and
Give charity while bowing on the sand.
I too take deep droughts of that blessed
word

From Israel's well-kept table overheard,
And in its cantillation fine-perfumed
With ecstasies of Sinai late exhumed,
I meet my Lord in sound and divine speech
Soft-splendoured and in spirals beyond
reach

Of hand for disappearing melody,
So I return to You and You to me.

47 O Sons of Israel! Do remember
My bounties poured like burning ember
Upon you all, how I preferred
You to the whole world in a word.

48 Then guard yourselves against the day
When one soul shall not have the say
To compensate another or
Have any intercession for
Another, or give ransom to
Their God by anything they do.

49 Remember We delivered you
From Pharaoh's folk afflicting you
With grievous torment, killing sons
And saving women in their tons,
In that there was a great temptation
And testing from God on their nation.
50 Remember when We taught the sea
To run dry for you and to be
A road of rescue while they drowned
Whom Pharaoh sent, and you looked
round.

51 Remember We appointed then
For Moses forty nights and men
Took for their worship golden calf
When he had left you not to laugh
In your transgression. 52 Even then
We forgave you to teach you when
You ought to give thanks, 53 and when We
Gave Moses Scripture and the great
Criterion (of love and hate
And right and wrong, the bright Furqan)
So you might be led to the dawn.

By the Criterion that You gave Moses I
Continue to be guided to know why
One claimant to the prophethood is true,
Another false and pale. If I should do
As others do and take the one I feel
As right or else again, tradition's meal,
Consider all the views of humankind
Direct reflection of Your divine mind,
I should need no Criterion, no table
Of law, but I should my own self be able
To know both right and wrong. That fallacy
Is root of perennial philosophy.
If natural faith alone sufficed You would
Not give the Decalogue to say what should.

54 And remember when Moses said
To them, "O people I have led!
You have indeed made yourselves dark
By taking calf as your prayers' mark.
So turn repenting to your Maker
And find wrong-doer now and take her
Out for slaughter, that were the best
In view of your Creator's test."
So He turned towards you in forgiving,
The oft-returning, mercy-giving.
55 Remember when you said "O Moses!
We'll not believe unless God chose us
To hear outright that you're His sent,"

And thunder seized you where you went
While you looked on what you had spent.
56 Then We raised up after your death
Your bodies and filled you with breath
So that you might be grateful then.
57 And We gave you the shade of cloud
And sent down manna food for men
And quails for food, saying aloud,
"Eat of the good things We give you,"
While to Us they did no great harm,
But their own souls put in alarm.
58 And then remember when We said
"Enter this town, and eat its bread
As you like, there is plenty there
Within the market, on the stair,
But enter the gate falling down
And crying pardon in the town,
And We shall forgive you your sin
And multiply the good within."
59 But the transgressors changed the word
From what they had before that heard,
And so We sent a plague on them
From heaven above and to condemn
Transgressors for what they had done
Perverting the word as they run.

The Masoretic Bible is perverted
By leaving out passages controverted,
The Jubilees and Enoch and some others
That right or wrong offended Jewish
brothers.

I beg You now, Beloved, to stay the plague
And forgive their descendants for the vague
That still remains in Scripture all the while.
I put the books together with a smile
And find them all consistent with Your
Word

Once spoken on Mount Sinai and that
stirred
The hearts of all to faith and to be doing.
There is no more a reason to be stewing.
We all know by the Scripture You are One,
And with that truth all faith's begun and
done.

60 And when Moses sought water for
His people and your ancestor
We said to him "Smite rock with staff"
Then gushed forth twelve springs with a
laugh.

Each group knew its own place to drink.

So eat and drink now at the brink
 Of that divine provision there,
 And do no mischief for your share
 Of evil on an earth not bare.
 61 And then remember when you said
 "O Moses! We cannot be fed
 Always with the same kind of bread,
 So ask your Lord for us and see
 If He will produce the earthly
 In herbs and cucumbers, for taste
 The garlic and lentils, no waste
 If we have onions too in haste."
 He said "Will you exchange for worse
 The better, and incur a curse?
 Go down to any town and find
 The things you want to make you blind."
 Humiliation, misery
 They drew upon themselves to see
 The wrath of Allah truthfully.
 This was because they kept rejecting
 The signs of Allah and electing
 To kill unjustly His sent ones.
 This was because they disobeyed,
 Forgetting divine benisons,
 They transgressed everywhere they strayed.

I love my garlic and my pots of herbs,
 But let me not therefore reject the curbs
 Laid down by Your good self and by the
 prophets,
 Let me not sell Your signs for loss or
 profits.
 But rather let the words of prophet strike
 My heart like staff of Moses also like
 The lightning of Elijah. Let gush forth
 From me the living waters that henceforth
 Shall satisfy my thirst for You. Let me
 Slay every witness in my heart to free
 Both soul and mind from false apostles
 here.
 Teach me and mine to love as well as fear.
 Strike on my stony heart, Beloved, and
 make
 A river cool and clear before daybreak.

62 Those who believe, and those who are
 Jews, Christians, Sabians, by far,
 The ones who fail not to believe
 In God, and the Last Day, and grieve
 For any sin, but do good deeds,
 Shall have fulfilled all of their needs,

And shall not fear the punishment,
 And shall not grieve, but be content.
 63 And then remember also when
 We took Your Covenant, in book,
 And raised above you towering height
 Of Sinai's mountain, said with might
 "Hold firmly what We give you and
 Always remember, understand
 What is in it that you may fear
 Allah as long as you are here."
 64 But you turned back there after that,
 And would have been lost where you're at
 Had not the grace and mercy of
 Allah been showered down in love.
 65 And well you knew those among you
 Who broke the Sabbath, as such do,
 We said to them, "Turn into apes,
 Despised, rejected, no escapes."
 66 We made example to their time
 And to those in each land and clime
 That come here after them to fear
 The lesson of Allah when near.

Though I come after age of ape let me
 Take warning from the sign of evil time.
 Let me not lay my nets into the sea
 Upon the Sabbath day, let me not climb
 From bark to shore to find what savoury
 fish
 On Sabbath morn awaits the breakfast dish.
 To fail to pause, Beloved, in rendez-vous
 Set ages since for me to meet with You
 Results not only that I miss Your blessing.
 It dims the heart and robs the soul of
 power,
 It shuts light from the eye and leaves one
 guessing,
 It breaks infinity into an hour.
 Let me not transgress on the Sabbath day,
 But keep within the golden, sparkling way.

I am not any Muslim convert here,
 Despite the fact I've kept the practice dear,
 Denying no Islamic tenet's gear.
 I've kept to each belief and practice near.
 And yet the Muslim denies I am true,
 A Muslim by what I believe and do,
 Simply because in addition to all
 Of what they harp upon and keep in stall
 I keep Your Sabbath day writ on the wall
 Of both the Bible and Qur'anic pall.

Such is the nature of mankind and such,
Beloved, I ask that You judge with Your
touch
Of mercy and of justice: I'm forsaken
Simply for what Your Sabbath would
awaken.

67 Remember when Moses said to
His people, "Allah says to do
A sacrifice, a heifer." They
Said "Are you joking with us, say?"
"I take refuge in God" he said
"From being ignorantly led
In folly." 68 They said "Truly pray
On our behalf your Lord will say
In plain speech which heifer to slay."
He said "He says: The cow should be
Not too old nor too young for me,
But of a middling age: now do
The thing I have commanded you."
69 They said "On our behalf again
Pray your Lord plainly show to men
Her colour" He said "Truly God
Reveals dun coloured like the sod,
A heifer pure and rich in hue,
Delightful to the sight and view."
70 They said "Beseech on our behalf
Your Lord make plain and do not laugh
But tell us which one we should strike.
To us all heifers are alike.
We hope for guidance in His will,
If Allah deigns to guide us still."
71 He said "He says: A heifer not
Trained to the plough or watering field,
Sound and without a blemish spot."
They said "Now have You not concealed
The truth." They offered her up then
In sacrifice though they were men
Who had no wish at all to yield.

The ashes of the red heifer were needed
For purifying things when they had heeded.
The rules of purity become each day
More complicated as I ask the way.
No doubt Your good intention was that I
Learn to make differences between the sky
And earth. But doubt indeed for focusing
Upon Your patient answers to the thing
That I myself enquired led me to go
In many ways that You thought not to
show.

Blind, deaf and dumb at last I stand before
The judgement throne in moral poverty
But with clean face and hands and feet and
more.
Beloved, from my own questions set me
free.

72 Remember when you killed a man,
Fell in dispute with countryman,
But Allah would make clear, revealed
The thing that you hid and concealed.
73 So We said "Strike the body now
With a piece of the slaughtered cow."
Thus Allah brings the dead to life
And shows you His signs without strife
So you may understand your deeds,
And where your disobedience leads.
74 Henceforth your hearts were hardened
as

The stones or harder still, for some
Rock gushes rivers forth and has
Life in it, while some others split
And send out water where they sit,
While others prostrate in their fear,
For Allah knows what all do here.
75 Do you, O men of faith, hope that
They will believe in you? While at
Their ear some used to hear the Word
Of Allah, yet perverted what
They understood and what they heard.
76 Indeed it is when they have got
With the believers then they say
"We do believe." But then when they
Meet each in private, then they say:
"Tell them what Allah has revealed
To you in Scriptures unrepealed
So they can argue about it
With you before your Lord, with wit?"
Do you not understand their aim?
77 Do they not know that just the same
Allah knows what they will proclaim?

I've seen the thing come up always and
soon.
When I remark on what You give in boon
And what You still prohibit at the noon,
The hearer always has a point of law,
Obscure and sweetly shredded by his claw,
To argue about to distraction till
He need not thank You for the paunch to
fill

Nor yet consider prohibition's will.
Beloved, though I am interested to know
The secrets of both law and fashion's glow,
Keep me here focused on the way to go,
Submitted to Your commands and Your
row.

I drop harangue of Scriptures and address
The actions that You require in the mess.

78 There are among them ignorant
Who do not know the Scriptures' bent,
But see in it their own desires
From hearsay or from biased liars'
Translation, such can only guess.

79 Then woe to those who write the Book
With their own hands, and then say "Look
This is from Allah," they sell it
For price unworthy and unfit.

Then woe to them for what their hands
Have written, editing commands,
And for what they take in ill gain.

80 And they say "Fire come down in rain
Shall not touch us but for a while."
Say in your answer to their guile

"Has Allah given you His word
To act by nothing undeterred,
Or do you say of Allah what
You do not know and cannot cut?"

81 Indeed, who earn an evil thing
With their sin round them in a ring,
They are companions of the fire
And there they shall stay in their pyre.

82 But those who do believe and do
Good deeds, they are among the few
Companions of the Garden, they
Shall stay there through eternal day.

I do not say the English words I write
Convey the burden of Your speech and
sight.

I make admission of their poverty,
But hope they are a dim reflection, free
As far as possible of error. Now
Let me make not the false mistakes of cow
And heifer folk, who find their vain desires
In Scripture, and not what for flaming fires
You give in warning, and who write the
words

In error, and who follow beasts and birds
Imagining a part to serve as well
As all. I will subtract no dot nor spell,

Nor add a jot. Let me earn not a deed
Of evil. O Beloved, let me take heed.

83 Remember when We made a pact
With the children of Israel
To worship in both word and act
None but Allah alone, repel
Not parents, orphans, those in need
But do them well in word and deed,
Speak kindly to all people and
Establish prayer and give your alms.
But you turned back, except whose palms
Refused backsliding in the land.

84 Remember when We made a pact
Do not commit the bloody act,
And turn your people from your home.
And this you solemnly agreed,
You can bear witness to the deed.

85 And after this you kill among
Yourselves, and banish some from home,
Assist against them in sin's rung
And in transgression, if they come
To you as captives, ransom some,
Though it was not lawful for you
To banish them the way you do.
So do you only believe some
Of the Book and reject the rest?
What's the reward for you at best
Who deal like this in this life but
Disgrace, and in the Judgement what
But a most grievous penalty?

Unmindful Allah cannot be
Of what you do disgracefully.

86 These are the people who buy life
Of this world at the price of strife
For themselves in the Hereafter:
Their penalty's not light to bear,
Nor shall they be helped anywhere.

The mystic life arises only when
The basic laws of justice among men
Are carried out. The first is to take no
God but the One, the second is to show
Good actions to one's parents. The best
way

Of serving You is to do honour day
By day to mother and to father. If
They do not so deserve, then staying stiff
To honour them gives all the greater good.
Then follow aid to orphans, kindness

And prayer and alms, not killing when one
should
Protect the life and home, not curse but
bless.
These are the highest secret exercises
The true and mystic way of life comprises.

87 We gave to Moses the book and
We caused his following to be manned
With a succession of apostles,
And evidence that surely jostles
We gave to Jesus, son of Mary,
And strengthened with the holy spirit.
Is it not so you're proud and very
Swelled up as though you truly fear it
When such apostles come to you,
And with what you do not pursue,
Impostor you call some of them
And others kill when you condemn.

88 They say "Our hearts enclose God's
Word."

No, Allah's curse is rather stirred
On them for what they have blasphemed,
And little they believed, it seemed.

89 And when there comes to them a book
From Allah, that confirms the book
That is with them, the Bible, though
They had prayed for the victory
Against the disbelievers, so
When there comes what they ought to
know

And recognize, they will not see,
So let the curse of Allah be
On those who disbelieve. 90 The price
Is paltry for which they have sold
Their souls, and for what a device
To deny what Allah had told
And what message Allah had sent.
Their envy is most insolent
That Allah of His grace should send
It to the one He might intend
Among His servants freely chosen.
By this they are all caught and frozen
In wrath on wrath, for disbelievers
The most disgracing punishment.

91 When it is said to such deceivers
"Believe in what Allah has sent,"
They say "We do believe in what
Was sent to us, the Bible," but
They have rejected all besides,
Even if its Truth coincides,

Confirming what is with them. Say
"Why then have you killed in your day
The prophets of Allah in times
Gone by, if you believe their rhymes?"

How few I find, Beloved, who will accept
All of the revelations that the ept
Of prophets bring into the world to show
Your Decalogue is the line we should toe.
Some take the Torah and some rather take
The Gospel and reject the Hebrew stake.
And others take the Qur'an and no other
Except perhaps hadith or marja brother.
Beloved, let me rest in simplicity,
And make no fond excuse, but faithfully
Accept the holy words, Torah and all
Down to the Qur'an at last in the stall.
Then I shall submit human will to You
And find grace shining ever in my view.

92 Then Moses came to you with clear
Evidence, yet you did not fear
To worship the calf after that,
Behaving wrongfully in that.

93 Remember when We took your pact
And raised high over you in fact
Mount Sinai, saying "Hold firm what
We've given you, and what you've got
In hearing of the Law." They said
"We hear, and disobey." We fed
Them ground up golden calf mixed in
Their drink to punish them for sin.
Say "Vile indeed is that which your
Faith makes you do, if you've in store
A bit of faith at all!" 94 Say "If
The final home in hieroglyph
With Allah, is for you for sure
And not for others who're impure,
Then seek death, if you are sincere."

95 But they will never, do not fear,
Seek death, because of what their hands
Have sent before them in demands.
And Allah is acquainted with
The wrongdoers, 96 you'll see forthwith,
Of all folk most greedy of life,
More than idolaters are rife.
Each one of them hopes God will give
A thousand years for him to live.
But even length of life will not
Save from the punishment he's got.
For Allah sees well all they've wrought.

O my Beloved, I pray that I may follow
 In faithfulness Your message and not
 wallow
 In blind illusion, taking one and leaving
 Another of Your messengers, not cleaving
 To all alike. I stand today and hear
 Your voice on Sinai, take as they appear
 Both Moses and Messiah, keep their word
 In thought and deed, until my heart is
 stirred
 By prophets all from first to faithful last.
 Let me not cease to be true Jew when I
 Accept the blessed Messiah, let me die
 A Christian still and faithful as I lay
 Full faith in pure Muhammad's word and
 say
 There is no god but You, and so hold fast.

97 Say "Whoever's an enemy
 To Gabriel, for he brings freely
 The revelation to your heart
 By Allah's will, to do its part
 In confirmation of what went
 Before, the holy Bible sent,
 And guidance and glad tidings for
 Those who believe the treasured store,
 98 Whoever is an enemy
 To Allah and His angels, see,
 And the apostles, Gabriel
 And Michael also archangel,
 Indeed, Allah's an enemy
 To those who reject Faith wrongly."

Did I say let me be true Jew or Christian?
 What egotism in my gross ambition!
 I'll next in hybris claim Islam my own,
 Despite my fast unworthiness by throne.
 No human sacrifice here can atone.
 I am no Jew at all, nor Christlike either,
 Nor do I submit always like a tither.
 When I go to the mosque to pray men
 shake
 Their heads and say inshallah in my wake.
 A doubting Thomas here, I ask not much,
 Not to be one of the saints at a touch,
 But if I am no foe, I'll take the crutch
 And be a baptist in the ghosl's clutch,
 One wet and gleaming from the stream or
 lake.

99 We have sent down to you clear signs,
 And none reject them but who pines
 For perverse ways. 100 Is it not fact
 That every time they make a pact
 Some of them throw it all aside?
 No, most do not believe, but slide.
 101 And when there came to them one sent
 From Allah, to confirm what went
 To them, the Bible, then some folk
 Of that book treated as a joke
 The book and threw behind their backs
 The book of Allah in attacks
 As if it had since long ago
 Been something that they did not know.
 102 They followed what the evil ones
 Gave out *falsely* like simpletons
 Against the power of Solomon:
 The blasphemers were evil ones,
 Not Solomon, to teach men magic,
 And such things as came down, and tragic,
 At Babylon by Harut and
 Companion Marut, angels, and
 Neither of these taught anyone
Such things unless they had begun
 By saying "We are just a trial,
 So do not blaspheme all the while."
 They learned from them the means to sow
 Discord between man and wife. So
 They could not harm anyone but
 By God's permission. And clear-cut
 They learned what harmed them, and not
 what
 Was profit to them. And they knew
 That the buyers of that had no share
 In happiness hereafter. There
 Was paltry price for which they sold
 Their souls, they knew and had been told.
 103 If they had just believed and guarded
 Themselves from evil, not discarded
 The better reward from their Lord,
 If they had known that good reward.
 Give me, Beloved, the magic of the king,
 King Solomon, who did not rub a ring
 Or blow on knots, but in all matters sought
 Your guidance from the wisdom he was
 taught
 In answer to his prayers. You promised him
 That You would give his own desires, both
 dim
 And glorious, he only had to ask.

Beloved, You set me no such sought for task.

And still like him I come with my petition,
Not seeking gold or fame, but in contrition,
Ask for the gold and fame of wisdom from
The divine heart. I see that wisdom come.
There is no wisdom other than to know
That You are one and to You all things go.

104 O you believers! Do not say
Words in an ambiguous way,
But speak respectfully and hear,
Awesome correction you may fear.
105 Those without faith, both pagan and
Those of the Book, do understand,
Will never hope that something good
Should come down to you from your Lord.
But Allah chooses whom He will
For mercy, Allah is Lord still
With grace abounding. 106 None of Our
Messages do We disempower
Or cause to be forgotten, but
We give instead better or what
Is similar. Do you not know
That Allah's powers on all things go?

107 Do you not know that Allah has
Dominion of heavens as well as
The earth? Then besides Him there's not
For you patron or helper's plot.
108 Would you question your messenger
As Moses was of old? Aver
Whoever changes faith to doubt
Has left straight way and wandered out.

The change of faith, the innovation made
In practice or in liturgy's parade
Or in the concepts that faith has waylaid,
Is one small step towards hell, no matter
what

Sweet comes of it to polish off the gut.
My own poor life and brief's been spent to
shut

Out innovations and return for power
To revelation of the trysting hour.

Beloved, I take the faith of Adam found
In Genesis and fostered on the ground
In every book of revelation since.
I take the faith most primitive and wince
At innovations loved by priest and prince.
Let others be for hell or heaven bound.

109 The people of the book are many
Who wish they could with just a penny
Turn you to infidelity
Since your belief, from pure envy,
After the truth was clear to them.
Then overlook, do not condemn,
Forgive, till Allah finishes,
Whose power is over all that is.

110 In prayer be steadfast, and be quick
To charity, and what you pick
Of good to send forth for your souls
Before you, you shall find its tolls
With Allah safe, for Allah sees
Well all you do and what you please.

111 And they say "None shall enter in
The paradise, though libertine,
Unless he's Jew or a Christian."
Those are their vain desires. So say
"Produce your proof if, as you may,
Be truthful." 112 No, who will submit
His whole self to Allah is fit
And is a doer of the good,
And he'll get the reward he should
With his Lord, as he does believe,
On such they certainly shall grieve.

Produce your proof! All men may say to
me,
Beloved, as I sit beneath my birch tree.
The proof of what? I maintain that there's
not

Anything true but You upon the spot.
I flee to You, Beloved, from paradise,
As well as from the hell of human vice
And conflict in the blindness of the eye
That must intend to rise up to the sky
As god among men or at least to try.
Produce Your proof! Beloved, I know the
word

Of holy Qur'an in the things I've heard,
And find in my own breath reciting here
That proof of You in all things that appear.
I flee to You from justice and reward.

113 The Jews say "Christians have no place
To stand," and Christians to their face
Say "Jews have nothing to stand on."
Yet both profess to study, dawn
To eve the same book. Their word's spoken
In ignorance, in judgement broken.
But Allah will judge them one day

For all mistaken things they say.
114 And who is more unjust then he
Who forbids in places for free
Worship of Allah, His name be
Proclaimed and honoured, and whose zeal
Is only meant to set off keel?
It was not fitting that such should
Themselves go in except in fear.
For such ones there is nothing good
But disgrace in this world and here,
And in the future world to come,
Exceeding torment for their sum.

Of those who bow in reverence to You
Some say that I should not do what I do
In keeping day by day Your name before
I seek my needed food and drink and store.
Some would stop every mouth that says
Your name,
Some out of reverence and some out of
shame.
I pray Your name might greater celebration
Find in each place and in each sovereign
nation,
In church and mosque and synagogue
upheld,
Recited for Your glory, writ and spelled.
Disgrace upon such ones both here and
now
And in the day to come make them to bow
If need be through torment, before Your
throne.
I glorify Your name, Beloved, alone.

115 To Allah are the east and west:
Wherever you turn, there's the best,
The Presence of Allah, not showing.
Allah is All-Pervading, Knowing.

I whirl upon a day, upon a night,
And everywhere I whirl within my sight
The place I turn to is a place where You
Are present in all things within my view.
I turn to east, I turn also to west,
And everywhere I turn, I see the best
Of all creation holding up Your name
And glorifying day to day Your fame.
You live in every breath that creatures
raise,
And every sound of things made is Your
praise.

You whisper in the rustling of the cloak,
You patter on the floor of polished oak.
The universe is full of light and power,
Illumine my darkness, touch my weakened
hour.

116 They say "Allah has sired a son."
Glory to Him. Such is not done.
No, His are all in heaven and earth,
All worship Him, alone of worth.
117 To Him is due the origin
Of heaven and earth, and all within.
When He decrees a thing, He says
"Be," and it is. 118 Those without *fez*
Or knowledge, tell them, "Why does not
Allah speak to us, we'd be taught?
Or why does there not come to us
A sign?" So the people made fuss
Before them with words of like sort.
Their hearts alike are in consort.
We have indeed made clear the signs
Unto any people where shines
The faith held firmly in their hearts.
119 Truly We've sent you as the bearer
Of glad tidings, a warner fairer:
But they shall pose to you no question,
Companions of the fire's combustion.
120 Never will Jews or Christians be
Satisfied with you till you be
A follower of their religion.
Say "Guidance from Allah's no pigeon,
But that's the only guidance true."
Were you to follow their desires
After knowledge has come to you,
Then would you find against the fires
Of Allah no help nor protection.
121 Those to whom We have sent selection
Of the book study it as it
Should be studied: they are the fit
Believing in it, but who lacks
Faith in it, loss on their own backs.

Let me, Beloved, follow not my desires
For paradise or even for the fires,
But let me follow in the gracious way
That You set out for my path on this day.
I lay hold on the book, though faith is
weak,
And find behind the seeing what I seek,
The face I cannot see, though I can hear
The beauties of the voice upon my ear

That speaks in word creating on the sea
 Both earth and animal and flower and tree,
 That speaks from Tur to show the right and true,
 That speaks in Makkah's terraces where
 grew
 The knowledge in the heart and mind of
 few,
 The Prophet and his house, where I find
 You.

122 O Sons of Israel! Call to mind
 The special favour which I bind
 On you, bestowing preference
 To you above others' expense.
 123 Then guard yourselves against a Day
 When one soul shall not hold the sway
 In avail for another, nor
 Shall compensation be accepted
 From her, nor shall she have therefore
 Gain of intercession selected,
 Nor shall any find help confiding.
 124 Remember that Abraham bidding
 Was tried by his Lord with commands,
 Which he fulfilled beyond demands
 He said "I'll make of you a leader
 To all the nations." He pleaded,
 "And also from my offspring led!"
 He answered, "But I'm not conceder
 Within the reach of evil pleader."

You made, Beloved, of Abraham a guide,
 Imam to all the nations that confide
 Affirming that You are the One alone.
 His prayer was that You always would
 condone
 His progeny as long as time should last.
 But You refused to promise by contrast
 That evildoers should enjoy Your meat.
 Thus those who run to wash the stranger's
 feet,
 Fulfilling Your divine will as they go,
 Alone receive the promises below.
 Impostors there are many who pretend
 To represent the divine guides You send.
 From Persia as far as to the fourth Rome
 They raise their heads, but You send them
 all home.

125 Remember how We made the House
 A place to gather men, not grouse,

A place of safety, so then take
 Station of Abraham for sake
 Of prayer, and We covenanted
 With Abraham and Ismail, bid
 That they should sanctify My place
 For those who compass it My face
 Seeking, or use it as retreat,
 Or bow, prostrating hand and feet.
 126 Remember Abraham said "My
 Lord, make this a city of peace,
 And feed its people with Islam
 The fruits of peace, such as draw nigh
 Belief in Allah and release
 On the last day and in its balm."
 He said: "Yea, and such as reject
 Faith, for a while I shall neglect
 To punish them in their pleasure,
 But I shall soon drive them for sure
 To the torment of grace and fire,
 An evil ending for desire!"

The curious and idle stander-by
 Enjoys the sun and drinks the simple rain,
 And shares alike the singing and the pain,
 And like the wise man also wonders why.
 The answer to my questions comes at last,
 A day I have had banqueting and wine
 And filled my head and stomach to the
 spine,
 And suddenly I notice time has passed.
 Equality, the gist of my demand,
 Raised questions that I'll never need to hear
 When brotherhood and peace both
 disappear,
 Instead come Paradise and fire-brand,
 And some enjoy the sun and simple rain,
 And some the endless howling and the
 pain.

127 Remember Abraham, Ismail
 Raised the house foundations a while:
 "Our Lord! Accept this thing from us,
 For You're the All-Hearing, All-Knowing
 Of everything that's said and showing."
 128 "Our Lord, submit us to Your will,
 And from our children fit the bill
 Of a nation submitted still
 To You, reveal to us the way
 Of worship, return on us, stay.
 129 "Our Lord, raise up from among them
 One sent among them with the gem

Reciting to them signs of worth
In witness and teach them on earth
The book and wisdom and come to
Cleanse them also before Your view.”

There’s too much teaching all around the
world

In every sort of faith that’s come uncurled,
And far too little reading of the word
In tones of awe, in tones that has hearts
stirred.

Send down on me, Beloved, a voice
reciting

The holy Qur’an and by that igniting
The Torah, Psalms, and Gospel, what is
true:

Send not instruction but the Word from
You.

Beloved, I then submit first to Your will,
The gold and silver tones that still fulfil
The recitation of the sacred bill.
Beloved, I now submit to You alone,
Forgetting what the preachers here intone,
And bowing prostrate now before Your
throne.

130 Who gives up Abraham’s belief
Except the one in foolish fief?
We chose him truly in this age
And in the hereafter to page
Among the righteous with courage.

131 When his Lord said to him, “Submit
In peace to Islam as is fit,”
He said “I submit to the Lord
Of all the worlds, the One adored.”

132 Abraham passed this to his own
Children, and Jacob, without groan,
“My children, Allah has indeed
Chosen this faith before your need,
So never die outside this creed.”

While the Qur’an like Christ sends hearer
back

To faith of Adam and Noah for track,
It’s faith of Abraham that foots the mill.
I see the same progression on the hill
When Christ spoke of the start in divorce
bill,

And the apostles wanted Noahide
Laws in the Gentile church once to abide.
It’s just one step more in Genesis to

Reach up to circumcision’s bloody hue.
The question was passé. Apropos now
Would be the proclamation to allow
No longer and forever what they do
To little girls. My God, if only You
Were leader of the faith instead of crew.

133 Did you testify of the scene
When death came toward Jacob in screen,
When he said to his offspring, “Now
After me to what will you bow?”
They replied, “We’ll worship your God,
And the God of your fathers’ prod,
Abraham’s, Ishmael’s, Isaac’s who
Is the One God we submit to.”

The blessing on the bed of Jacob runs
Across the fates of his twelve comely sons.
The many verses and their obscure funs
Are summarized in this last call to be
The worshippers of You eternally.
While Genesis gives Jacob’s blessing word,
The Qur’an gives the sons’ reply he heard,
And so rounds out the revelation stirred.
Beloved, I am no son of Jacob here,
Despite the fact I have an ear and tear.
Bring me to worship God of Abraham,
And God of Jacob, though a poor black
lamb.

I see the twelve file out in wealth and
room,
While I stay at the bedside for my doom.

134 That was a nation now passed by,
For it what it earned on the try,
And for you what you shall have earned,
You’re not questioned for what they
learned.

135 They say “Be Jews or Christian men,
So you may be guided again.”
Rather the faith of Abraham,
And he was not one like a ram
Of idol worshippers to damn.

136 Say “We believe in Allah and
What’s sent down to us here to stand,
And what was sent to Abraham,
Ishmael, Isaac *in cryptogram*,
And Jacob and the tribes of folk,
And what was given at a stroke
To Moses and Jesus, and yet
What prophets were given to get

From their Lord, we make no distinctions
Between any of their extinctions,
And we submit unto His yoke.”

The Bible shows a line from Abraham
And Isaac down to Jacob's twelve in cam,
But often forgets Ishmael in the wheel.
The Qur'an brings that sentence back to
heel.

There is no faith so lovely as that set
On Ishmael's brow, who was Abraham's
pet,

And Isaac's elder brother he adored.
I too make Ishmael out to be my lord.
Beloved, I make no fond distinctions here
Among the prophets that I've come to fear,
And give them equal respect, equal faith
And fealty above satyr and wraith.
But Ishmael has my heart's love above all,
Affection's not commanded in the stall.

137 If they believe in what you do,
Then they are truly guided too,
And if they turn aside, then they
Are just rebellious in their way,
Allah is up to fighting them,
All-hearing and All-knowing stem.

138 The baptism of Allah's great,
And who baptises in estate
Better than Allah does in rate?

There's none who's better baptizer than
You,
Beloved, for the lone dervish come in view.
When Francis Bampffield met the English
stream,

There was no one officiating dream
But You when he plunged down beneath
the wave
And joined his master in the lowly grave,
And resurrected without spot, a slave
And son reborn in new-dyed clothing won.
Beloved, baptise me dressed in woollen
dun,
And bring me up dyed white and shining
bright
In dress and gulbent, after weary night.
Let no one witness me sink in the mire,
Let no one see me rise to join the quire,
And further disappear as spark from fire.

139 “Do you quibble about Allah
With us, while He's our Lord in awe
And your Lord too, and so our deeds
Belong to us, and while your deeds
Belong to you, and we bow down
In worship to Him without frown?
140 Do you say that Abraham and
Ishmael, Isaac, Jacob and band
Of Tribes were Jews or Christians canned?
“Do you know better or Allah?”
And who is more wicked than he
Who hides a faith testimony
That is with him from Allah's fee?
And Allah is not unmindful
Of all the things you try to pull.”
141 That was a people passed away.
They'll reap the fruit when gone astray,
And of what you do in their way!
No question of merits that day.

Beloved, let me not look back on them
Who went before, I seek the seamless hem
Of Your appointed guidance in the land,
Though he be unseen, still I rise and stand
To taste the here and now. I do not seek
The origins of earth in its first week,
Nor do I look with fear or faith to what
The future has laid up, I've only got
The present moment clasped in fervid time
And crystallized in sacred whirl and rhyme.
I do not ask for their reward who passed
The gates of Abraham as Jew or cast
Their lot with Christ, this moment here
with You
Be my reward abundantly and true.

142 But the fools among men say “What
Has turned them from their Qibla shut,
Towards which they were at before?”
Say “God's is east and western door,
He guides whomever He desires
To the right path of faith and fires.”

The fools no matter what their creed had
left
Off turning in prayer toward Your house
bereft
And turn themselves still toward the rising
east
As though they worshipped sun or bird and
beast.

But You, Beloved, are not found in the
 wind
 Of any one direction, such have sinned.
 I turn both east and west and north and
 south
 And in my whirling still find in my mouth
 Remembrance of Your lovely, gracious
 name:
 There is no one direction for Your fame,
 And yet there is one place, the place of
 prayer
 Where I find You upon the everywhere,
 And turning toward that place I testify
 That You are one above the earth and sky.

143 And so We've made of you a group
 To stand between as witness stoop
 Above mankind and over you
 The Prophet be a witness too;
 We did not fix the Qibla [direction of
 prayer and pilgrimage] toward
 Which you were at in peace or sword
 Except to make distinguishing
 Between whom heard the Prophet's thing
 And whom turned back upon his heels,
 And this was surely a hard thing
 For any except those by ring
 Whom God has guided, and God would
 Not make futile your faith for good,
 Truly God's unto humankind
 Affectionate in mercy's mind.
 144 Truly We see the turning of
 Your face in heaven so We in love
 Shall turn you towards a Qibla you
 Shall be pleased with, turn then on cue
 Towards place of holy prostration,
 Wherever you are let be done
 Your prayer with faces towards it, for
 Indeed those who've received the door
 Of the book know it's a true thing
 From their Lord, and God's not going
 To be heedless of their doing.
 145 And even if you were to bring
 To those who have been receiving
 The Scripture, every sign, yet they
 Would not follow your Qibla's way,
 Neither are you the follower
 Of their Qibla, nor will bestir
 Some of them to follow Qibla
 Of others, and if you in awe
 Followed their desires having had

Guidance come on you, you'd be bad.

Indeed who know the Gospel's humble
 story
 Of Jesus speaking at the well in glory
 Know that the Qibla to which turned in
 prayer
 The folk rightly guided's not everywhere
 But in Jerusalem. And yet Your sent
 One told the lady what your Qibla meant,
 How neither Jerusalem, Gerizim
 Would one day be acceptable to him,
 But that beyond the desert sands each soul
 In spirit and in truth should seek the goal,
 While yet the house that Abraham once
 built
 Should save divided humankind from guilt
 Of dividing sects also divides You.
 Yes, people of the book should know
 what's true.

146 Those unto whom We've given the
 book
 Know him as they know when they look
 Their own offspring, but truly some
 Of them conceal the truth's kingdom,
 Although they know it from the book.
 147 It is the truth from your Lord, so
 Be not of those who wavering show.

The truth is from You only, why then must
 The many faiths at every hand cast dust
 Into the eyes of those already blind?
 Some will have one faith only come to
 mind
 As being true, and some with have them all
 Be equally straight paths without pitfall.
 In fact all faiths are wrong and lead
 nowhere
 But to illusion or the county fair.
 I turn from all religions to look on
 Your face invisible though veils are gone.
 I shed the vain desires of priest and book,
 And join the joyous crowd at feast and look
 Upon the slight souls of my congregation,
 Both beast and bird that make up righteous
 nation.

Who read the Book as it was spoken fast
 In Hebrew tongue know not only the past
 Prophecies of Muhammad's acts and words

But also very name itself by birds
Warbled in air and on the parchment bare
Written by many early prophets there.
Indeed who read the book have no excuse
To fail to find Your prophet for abuse.
More clearly is He known than son or
daughter
Reflected in a mirror or clear water,
More sweetly is he borne upon the sound
Of Scripture than the sprouting, budding
ground.

Indeed, Beloved, the book reports his face
Before the man is born in time and place.

148 And for each one's a direction
To which he turns when prayer is done,
Make haste therefore to be the first
In every good thing, not the worst,
Wherever you are, God will bring
You to Him together to sing,
For God has power on everything.

149 And from wherever you go out
Turn your face in prayer without doubt
Toward place of holy prostration
Indeed that's truth of your Lord's ration
And God's not heedless of your station.
150 So from wherever you go out
Turn your face towards and turn about
To place of holy prostration
Wherever you are prayers are done,
So none have claim against you but
Those who are unjust with hearts shut,
So do not fear them, but fear Me,
That I may perfect My bounty
On you, and you guided rightly.

151 Even as We have sent among
You a prophet and from among
Yourselves one who has read and sung
Our signs and purifies you and
Teaches you the book in your hand
And wisdom and teaches you what
You did not know and had not got.

The reason You sent one more prophet here
Was first to bring Qur'an and make appear
The signs You meant for humans to be
clear,

And next to purify us, and then third
To teach what's in the hand, the Bible word
That was corrupted by each faith injured,
And fourth to teach the wisdom we had not.

Ah, my Beloved, let me take what You've
taught!

How few accept the Prophet's vital gifts,
The four bright ones beneath the star that
lifts

The heart to You. Some take one or another
And leave the fairest to an unknown
brother.

Beloved, I lay hands on the sparkling four
And find more jewels scattered at my door.

152 Therefore remember Me and I
Shall remember You on the sly,
And be thankful to Me and so
Not any ingratitude show.

I have my words of remembering Your
name,
Beloved, and celebrating Your great fame.
I come reciting all Your names to whirl
Before the sapphire sky with gates of pearl.
I enter in the dance of universe,
Pronouncing every blessing, every curse,
And rising in a spark of love on high
Until the self and human will shall die.
You too, Beloved, have names to recite,
Remembrance that lifts You too in the
light,
Invisibly in joy You too speak out
In words that sing creation all about.
Your name is my remembrance and my
song,
My name is Your reciting my lifelong.

My breath, Beloved, recites Your lovely
name
And repeats Huu no matter what the claim
Of veils and visions that conceal from sight
The glories of Your being and Your might.
So I can choose no other thing but You
No matter what my wayward will would do
That is without substance and without
shame.

But You, Beloved, at any moment can
Obliterate the memory of a man.
If You remember me, it is because
You choose to love, and not for any laws.
And yet perhaps in that We are yet one
Since there's no I but You when all is done.
The wind blew on the sand and the tide ran.

153 O you who believe, patiently
 And with prayer seek help, verily
 God is with the patient ones here,
 As guidance will last make appear.
 154 And say not of those who are slain
 In God's path that they're dead and vain,
 No, they are living, but you do
 Not perceive the thing that is true.
 We'll surely test you with some fear
 And hunger and loss of wealth dear
 And lives and fruit, and give glad tidings
 To patient ones in their abidings,
 156 Who when misfortunes come their way
 Say "Truly we are in God's way,
 And unto Him we shall return."
 157 Those are they who the blessings earn
 From their Lord and His mercy, and
 They're the ones guided by His hand.
 158 Truly Safa and Marwa are
 Among the signs of God like star,
 Whoever makes the pilgrimage
 To the house or who does engage
 In Umra, therefore it shall be
 No blame on him to go freely
 Around them both, and who conspires
 To a good thing, then God's desires
 Are grateful and all-knowingly.
 159 Indeed those who conceal what We
 Have sent down and manifestly
 In guidance after what clearly
 We've shown to mankind in the book:
 Those are the ones whom God will curse,
 Cursing curse cursers for the worse,
 And ferret out from every nook.

Beloved, I too decry concealment of Your
 Word.

Who claim to be the faithful are deterred
 From reading Scripture confident it still
 Reveals Your will, because the cry is shrill
 The Bible is corrupt. If that be so,
 We still possess the manuscripts that glow
 With years before the Qur'an's aayaat
 show
 Them to be confirmed truth. Corrupt they
 are
 By those criteria set up by star
 Pupil and scholar, not by what You claim
 Is necessary to keep Scripture's fame.
 A foolishness it is to set aside
 Corrupted Scripture and then flee and hide

Behind what has no claim to Scripture's
 name.

160 Except those who turn and amend
 Themselves and make clear what I send,
 These are the ones to whom I turn,
 In mercy I shall oft return.

My motive, O Beloved, in writing here
 Has been to make plain what You made
 appear

In Bible and Qur'an, Apocrypha,
 In Book of Enoch, Jubilees for law.
 And yet words fail, though I have purified
 My life from institutions that confide
 Their biases to all translations met.
 Words fail to speak your words again well
 set.

Because each syllable of Hebrew, Greek
 And Arabic turns into jewel I seek
 To utter, yet before the sense is said
 A hundred other facets flash their red
 And green and purple lights upon my head.
 Your words make gabbling me wordlessly
 meek.

161 Verily those who disbelieve,
 And who die while they disbelieve,
 On them shall be the curse of God,
 Of angels and men on the sod.

162 Abiding in it, the torment
 Shall not abate beneath the rod
 For them upon whom it was sent.
 163 And your God is one God alone!
 There is no god but He alone!
 The Gracious, Merciful alone!

My God, Beloved, is One, One and not
 three,

Who says that one is three and three is one
 Has simply not got all his homework done,
 And failed the course in plain geometry.
 My God is One and there shall never be
 Another above or below the sun.
 To claim that one is three may seem like
 fun,

But is a sinister idolatry.
 The mind that accepts facile contradiction
 Returns in slavish flattery to all
 Attempts to rule and even to oppress.
 Irrationality bears all affliction

As claim to beauty and the mystical.
Beloved, You only are what I confess.

Your Word, Beloved, is made of dot and
slash,

The scintillating markings of the gash
Of revelation on the veiling sash
Of the screen of empty infinity
To fill it with the myriad forms I see,
The melodies I hear, the lights I fear,
And all the shouting atoms that appear
Before the leaf in bud, cacophony
Of strident voices clambering to be
The first to proclaim divine unity.
The complex dimensions and multiplied
Of meagre thought and slight nature to hide
Behind corners of moments of surprise,
Your oneness newly rising to my eyes.

164 Indeed in the creation of
The heavens and the earth in God's love,
And in the alternation of
The day and night, and in the ships
That sail in the sea with what slips
Of profit for mankind, and in
The water which God sends to spin
From the skies and enlivening
The earth therewith after its death
To scatter therein beast with breath,
And in the changing of the wind
And clouds set between and unpinned
To serve between the heavens and earth,
Surely there are great signs of worth
To guide the folk who understand.

165 And yet of men on every hand
Are some who take unto themselves
Equals to God besides Him, elves,
And love them as the love for God;
But the believers' stronger rod
Is love for God: if the unjust
Could see when they behold the dust
Of torment, unto God belong
All powers, God punishes all wrong.

I followed sheikh and guru, pope and priest
Who taught me faith and law and so
increased

The worship not their due, until I saw
That no one can avail by scent or claw,
But all who come to You must turn away
From every spectre in religion's pay

And seek Your face alone and without veil,
That only prophet and guide raise a sail,
But even their footprints glow with the fire
That spurs my lusty heart's punished desire
For You alone, Beloved, I see the ties
Like sand crumble and scatter in the skies.
The dust turns air and water into pyre
Of torment while all things to You aspire.

167 And those who followed would say
"Oh,

If there were an escape to show,
Then we'd renounce them as they did
To us," so God will show what hid
Of their deed to their great regret,
And out of hell fire they'll not get.

There is no pir but You, Beloved. I take
Your lovely teaching on my tongue and
make

It all my memory both day and night,
As I move here beneath Your royal sight,
A round on round, one spark of sacrifice.
Indeed, Beloved, Your teaching must
suffice.

Who takes a teacher, leader, king or state
Relying on such human hands for fate
Must suffer now illusion and the while
Go through the fire before the final mile.
I clear myself of any human face
That I might look to for good in Your
place,

And turn all such as seek my guidance here
To You alone, Beloved, and to Your fear.

168 O humankind, eat from what's in
The earth and lawful without sin,
And good, and follow not the lead
Of Satan, for truly with speed
He is your enemy indeed.

169 For truly he commands to you
What's evil and shameful to do,
And say against God that which you
Know not at all that it is true.

170 And when it is said to them "Now
Follow what God's sent anyhow,"
They say "No, we follow that which
We found our fathers in the ditch."
What? Even though their fathers had
No sense at all with guidance bad?

The holy Qur'an does not give a list
Of what should be eaten and what be
missed.

(Indeed somewhere the camel as a grace
Is added to permitted food and place,
No doubt because when Torah was
revealed

Arabia was wooded plain and field.)
Yet many now turn from the holy word
Vouchsafed to Moses to eat bat and bird
Pronounced unclean, and do so with excuse
That some tradition was once put to use.
When Qur'an does not give the right detail,
I turn to Moses and take up his tale
While in rebellion others break the sod
For this companion or that, and not God.

171 The likeness of whom disbelieve
Is like one shouting for reprieve
To one who hears but call and cry,
Deaf, dumb, and blind they are, that's why
They do not understand the cry.
172 O you who believe, eat the good
Things We've provided that you should,
And thank God, if you worship Him,
For His providing good and trim.

Some eat the wrong because they do not
read
Your counsels in the past in Torah's feed.
Some eat the right, but do so since the plot
Of some traditions tell what they forgot.
To eat wrong or right or clean or unclean
On basis of traditions one has seen
Is just another rash idolatry.
I eat by Torah's word and so I flee
To holy Qur'an's light to set me free
Depending on men righteous not in wrong.
Me eating, drinking, breathing's but a song
That proclaim You are one, and yet the
blind
And deaf and dumb turn toward the grind
And do not understand the cry of gong.

173 Truly He has prohibited
That which dies of itself amid,
And blood and swine flesh and the thing
Upon which other name they sing
But God's, except eaten in need,
Not lusting for it nor indeed
To transgress, then it is no sin,

Surely God's forgiving within
And merciful to whom He lead.

There is in fact a list of what to eat
And what things to avoid more than the
meat
Of swine. You make the point in Bible and
A later sign than this, I understand.
Perhaps swine is the worst or then perhaps
You take swine for a symbol of the gaps,
The dog, the bat, the vulture and the others
Not slaughtered properly, as heathen
smothers.
Let it not happen in my case that I
Am forced by some necessity or die,
Despite the dispensation to eat pork.
I don't think I could get beyond the fork.
Preserve me from such swine idolatry
And I shall know You only and be free.

174 Who conceal what God has sent down
Of the Book, and trade for mere down
What's in it for a lowly price,
Shall fire consuming in a trice
Into their bellies, and God will
Not speak to them for good or ill
The day of resurrection, nor
Will purify them on that score
And for them grievous punishment.

Some do not taste the swine because Your
book
The holy Qur'an's nothing they mistook,
And yet they'll eat the rabbit and hare
Because they do not understand their share
And do not read the Torah's warning there.
Instead they conceal what You once sent
down
And march the Torah out of stock and
town,
And for a paltry price instead devour
Traditions once invented for an hour
And call their rebellion Islam or yet
Freedom in Christ, I'll leave them no
regret.

I fill, Beloved, my belly with Your Word,
And following its precepts undeterred,
I do all things to know Your oneness set.

175 These are they who purchased for cent
Error in exchange for the right

Guidance, and torment in the night
In exchange for forgiveness, oh
How shall they endure fire's glow?
176 That's because God sent down the book
By truthfulness, and those who look
Upon the book to differ on,
Into the broad way they've been drawn.

The book in which they seek cause for
dispute
Is that book Jew and Christian of repute
Forsook concealing what You say therein.
To them be woe or pardon for their sin,
May You, Beloved, decide the fate of all.
But now the Muslim joins the precious ball
And dances to find fault with that same
book,
Despite the fact that everywhere you look
In all the revelation messages
Are just the same. There is not one but is
A proclamation that You are alone,
Beloved, the only Deity that's known.
I take the books from Torah to Qur'an
To hear You speaking divine benison.

Beloved, my soul in burning punishment
Writhes in desire for You and what You've
sent,
And in that burning sweet desire for You
Let me remain, although forgiven and true.
Even before Your face, returned, united
Let me still feel this loving longing sighted.
And so my soul shall through eternity
Both burn in hell of desiring to see
Your glory and be quenched as I abide
In heavenly glories I find at Your side.
All reconciled in You, I find the book
Of revelation my delight to look,
And differ never in Your word and law
In what I do with head or foot or paw.

177 It is not righteousness that you
Turn your faces toward the due
East or west, but the righteousness
Of one's belief in God, confess
The last day and angels, the Book,
Apostles and one who forsook
Not giving wealth from love to Him
Supporting the poor and the grim
Wayfarer and needy and those
In bondage, and establishing

Prayer and alms for the poor paying,
And those who keep promises made,
And the patient ones who are weighed
With distress, affliction, and war,
These are the truly righteous or
The ones who seek a pious store.
178 O you who believe, vengeance sought
Is prescribed in case murder's wrought,
The freeman for the freeman and
The bondman at the bondman's hand,
The woman for the woman, but
If any remission's uncut
To any by brother aggrieved,
Then recognized course be received
And payment made to him in full.
This is reprieve and merciful
Of your Lord, and who shall transgress
The limit after this redress
Shall have a painful punishment
Upon him and his actions sent.
179 And for you there's security
Of life here in the vengeance fee,
O you who understandingly
Guard yourselves with impunity.

The Bible folk seem to have needed life
For life and eye for eye in case of strife.
I thank You, my Beloved, for this
concession
That's closer to the Decalogue's
expression.
To compensate with gratitude is better
Than killing others to stick to the letter.
I pray that You will kill the self in me
That murders every other it can see,
And let reign only Self of You, that I
May always taste the sweeter alibi,
Restrain myself until there's but what
You'd
Have done in me, a gift my gratitude
Shall never fail for such a compensation.
So murder me not only but the nation.

Blood vengeance is exception to command
Of Decalogue to take no life in hand
And shed no blood. In Noah's day it came
To remedy the violence and shame
That nearly emptied earth of population.
Today it would be no exaggeration
To say blood vengeance is prohibited
By nations to suppress ego and id

And foster stable and contained assent
To violence by which is fondly meant
Civilization. O Beloved, I see
No end to sinister iniquity
Until awareness of Your unity
Implies the oneness of humanity.

180 It is prescribed for you when death
Approaches any of your breath,
If he leaves any goods, to make
A bequest for his parents' sake
And near of kin in goodness met,
A duty on the pious set.

181 And anyone to change bequest,
After he has heard it for best,
Shall be guilty who altered it,
Truly Allah in hearing's fit
And knows all things that others wrest.
182 But he who fears from testator
Injustice or a sin before,
And so establishes agreement
Between them, there's no sin in fee meant
For him, surely God is forgiving
And merciful to all those living.

O my Beloved, here You command to
make
Last will and testament for parents' sake
And near of kin, but if Islamic law
Set out in all detail is without flaw,
Such testament's truly redundant thing,
Which only shows that it's better to sing
Your names in whirling dance than ask
what's right
After the revelation's come in sight.
Let me not be a man to seek details
Of right and wrong because willingness
fails,
Nor with motive to find the blameless way
As near as possible to sinful pay.
Rather, Beloved, I flee to You to stay
In glories beyond all the beaming veils.

183 O you who believe, fasting's been
Ordained to you as it was seen
By those before you that you may
Keep out of evil and harm's way.
184 For a set number of days, but
Anyone among you who's shut
Up sick or on a journey, then
With those exceptions among men

The fasting's that number of days,
And who can hardly make the stays
May make atonement by feeding
A poor one, for who's performing
A good deed of his own accord
Better for him before his Lord,
And fasting's better for you too
If you are knowing what to do.

When many die of hunger, more this day
Than when You sent this loving word, do
say
If fasting is the best approach, would it
Not be the better part to benefit
The starving poor with bread and beans and
rice
And meat and for dessert something that's
nice?
As life draws to its close, my fasting days
Recede to memory, yet among the maze
Of living there is time and place for giving
And fasting becomes more a time of
sieving
Of who's deserving poor, why there's not
more
To give to those in need. None's at the door
To ask. I turn to You, Beloved, who do
Not eat or fast, and beg an alms of You.

The best fast, O Beloved, that You
command
Is seeking out the hungry in the land
And putting bread and pickles in his mouth.
There may be hungry on the pigeoned
street
Set out with cup and placards north to
south,
But as I empty my portion of meat,
Or as it were, of oatmeal, I retreat
From offering the dispossessed what I
Prefer to put in belly on the sly.
The taste for fish and chips and burger,
coke
Has made my alms redundant at a stroke,
Who eat the coarse and homely Scottish
fare.
Beloved, I give my fasting alms to You
Who share with me the dervish taste of
few.

185 The month of Ramadhan in which

Was sent down the Qur'an as pitch
 To guidance for humankind and
 Clear evidence of guidance and
 Discrimination of the right
 And wrong, so who shall take in sight
 The month shall fast in it, and who
 Is ill or on a journey too
 Shall fast the number other days,
 For God desires ease in your ways,
 No hardship desires for His praise,
 For you to finish the days' number
 To glorify God, and not slumber,
 For His guiding you that you may
 Be grateful to Him every day.

Islamic calendar's a thing of late,
 Established by the caliphs in their state
 Years after Your prophet had met his due
 And in his spirit had returned to You.
 So who's to say that Ramadhan each year
 Comes at the time when it used to appear?
 I put the word of prophet far above
 The word of caliph who may or not love.
 Though every man not yet bereft of sight
 May find the lunar month on cloudless
 night,

The year is lost unless tied to the sun.
 I only ask what Abu Bakr's done.
 I flee to You, Beloved, from time and space
 And find my month of fasting in Your
 grace.

Like Torah's Passover the Ramadhan
 Of Your twice-blessed, holy, glorious
 Qur'an
 For journey or for illness is replaced
 By later days privately interstaced.
 The festivals changed and revealed to flow
 From the authorities that come and go
 With prophets any day at all will do.
 The only time that's eternally true
 Is sixth day, day of gathering to find
 Your blessing ever coming on mankind,
 And seventh day eternally so blessed
 As symbol of Your mounting throne to rest
 In divine state and power, Creator of
 All things in the universe that You love.

186 When My servants ask you about
 Me, tell them truly without doubt
 I am near, and I answer prayer

Of supplicant beseeching there,
 So let them hearken to My say,
 Believing in me so that they
 May be led into the right way.
 187 You may in the nights of your fast
 Go in into your wives at last,
 They are an apparel for you
 And you for them in what you do,
 God knows you yourselves held it wrong
 So He has turned toward you in song
 With His forgiveness, therefore go
 In unto them and seek to show
 What God has prescribed for your living
 And eat and drink what He is giving
 Until the dawn's white streak appears
 To you from out the black night's fears,
 And after that complete the fast
 And have no intercourse at last
 While confined to the mosques. These

bounds
 Were prescribed for you on God's grounds,
 So do not approach to your wives,
 And so God makes clear in your lives
 His signs to humankind so they
 May guard themselves from evil way.
 188 And do not swallow up your wealth
 Among yourselves by wrong, in stealth
 Seek to gain access thereby to
 Authorities in order to
 Swallow up a portion of wealth
 Of other men, wrongly, in stealth,
 While you indeed know what to do.

Let the white thread of dawn prevent my
 drink
 And bread, let me in everything I think
 And do and say feed on the bread of day
 That comes from You. I wait the silver ray
 To taste the blessings of the month once set
 For fasting from both food and water met
 In body now grown past the hunger time.
 My body's fasting at this age of mime
 Is only memory of that sweet fruit
 Once held on tongue when youth was in the
 root.

My fast is now in You alone as I
 Draw nearer to the throne of merging sky.
 I wait the silver ray to meet You there
 Where You and I shall breakfast on the air.

189 They ask concerning ahilla,

Say they are just the algebra
Of times fixed for humankind and
For pilgrimage in sacred band;
It is not righteous that you stand
To enter your houses behind,
But the righteous of humankind
Guards himself against evil's bind,
So enter houses by their doors
And take shelter in Allah's stores
Of mercy, so you may succeed.

Straight is the way and narrow is the gate
That enters into life. I choose my fate.
I do not gaze in fascination at
The empty air where butterfly and bat
Dream they are free. Unfettered, slaves are
still

Slaves to unholy delusional will.
I seek not merely to be left unchained,
But to come in the house that I've attained.
I leave the rabble scratching at the back,
Imagining the short cut will keep track.
I go directly to the regal throne
Of Your reality, Beloved, from first.
The proper gate is to fear You alone,
Prosperity to fear no other cursed.

The threshold is the Kaaba, and for that
I bow to kiss the place where Ali sat.
Though sand and sun remark to make the
place
Holy where guide and prophet seek Your
face,
Still in the poverty that lifts the mace
I find the Kaaba spread beneath Your
grace,
The threshold of the humblest cottage door
That looks toward the river valley's floor
And glints beneath the morning sun aloof
To find the beds spread out upon the roof.
The threshold is the Kaaba, so with hand
Upon the threshold I refuse to stand,
But kiss my hands spread palm down on
the cool
And raised stones before drinking of the
pool.

190 And fight in the cause of God's need
Those who fight you, but have no speed
Towards aggression, for truly
God loves no aggressive party.

191 And slay them wherever you find
Them having driven you behind,
For more grievous is mischief than
Even the slaughter of a man,
But fight not with them near the place
Of sacred prostration on face,
Until they fight with you therein,
But if they fight you, without sin
Slay them for such is the reward
Of disbelievers lifting sword.
192 But if they desist, then truly
God is forgiving in mercy.
193 And fight them until there is no
Mischief and faith's only God's show,
But if they desist, let them be
Against no man hostility
Except against aggressor's fee.
194 A sacred month in reprisal
For sacred month and reprisal
Is lawful in things sacred, who
Then inflicts aggression on you,
Inflict the like aggression too
As was afflicted by him on
You, and fear God from dusk to dawn,
And know that God's with pious, true.

The law is simply that one must not kill.
Does this conflict with that divine law still?
I think not, my Beloved, reality
Is that one must save life as far as free.
Prophet and guide must show the better
way,
When killing one will save the ten and day.
Kill in me, my Beloved, the enemy
That thinks another self than You is true.
Kill in me too the love of Trinity
And love of every goddess here but You.
And with that killing save my darling life
In divine unity instead of strife.
Restrain not Self and I shall strive my best
Once to restrain the self within my breast.

195 And expend in the path of God
And cast not yourselves on the sod
With your own hands into perdition,
And do good instead of sedition,
For truly God loves right petition.
196 Complete the pilgrimage and make
Also the Umra for God's sake,
But if you be prevented, then
Send what offering's easy for men,

And shave your heads, but not before
 Your sacrifice has reached the door,
 But of you who is sick and has
 An ailment in his head whereas,
 Then let him make a compensation
 By fasting or alms or a ration
 Of sacrifice, but when you are
 Secure from the hindrance or bar,
 Then who enjoys Umra to Hajj,
 Let him offer what he may judge
 Available to him with ease,
 But one who's not able to please
 With sacrifice should fast three days
 During the pilgrimage displays
 And seven days upon return,
 This makes up ten days of concern,
 This is for him whose people dwell
 Not near the place of sacred bowing,
 And fear you God and know you well
 God's harshly evil not allowing.

There is no sacrifice that cannot be
 Done in its compensation wonderfully
 By merely fasting truly certain days.
 And yet as faster grows old in his ways
 There is no fast but charity cannot
 Come as a substitute. When all is fought
 The bottom duty that remains is this.
 Both sacrifice and fasting I may miss,
 But not the feeding of the poor. But yet,
 Who does not fast and does not sacrifice
 May be too poor to feed the poor ones met.
 The poor one feeds may well be to suffice
 By feeding one's own self. Let reason lead
 And there's no duty left to kill or feed.

197 Hajj [Pilgrimage] is in months well
 known, who then
 Starts out in pilgrimage of men,
 Let there be no intercourse then,
 Nor bad language nor quarrelling
 During the pilgrimage to bring,
 And whatever of good you do,
 God knows it, so make ready due,
 And truly the best readiness
 Is piety, and fear confess
 Of Me, folk of a wise address.
 198 It shall be no guilt on your part
 If you seek bounty at the start
 From your Lord, then when you march
 from

Arafat remember God come
 Near to the holy monument,
 And remember Him as He sent
 You guidance, though before this you
 Were surely in unguided cue.

Each year that passes since the night that I
 Slept by the mount of Arafat where sky
 Turned blue and purple and I saw the way
 Three white-clad figures stood apart to
 pray,
 Strikes my heart with a deeper sense to be
 Far from my true home set between the sea
 Of Reeds and Aqaba. Lord, set me free
 Or not of longing coming restlessly.
 I am Your guest, Beloved, on all the earth,
 And every place is made a place of worth
 By Your footprints upon the sandy waste.
 And yet I yearn and burn for one more taste
 Of Arafat. My heart was torn and bled
 When I left Arafat as though I fled.

199 Then march on from where people
 march
 And so seek pardon at the arch
 Of God, and verily God is
 Forgiving, and mercy is His.
 200 And when you have performed your
 rites,
 Remember God as in your nights
 You remember your fathers' fame,
 But more intensely of God's name
 Remembering, for of men there are
 Who say "Our Lord, make us the star
 In this world" and for such there'll be
 No portion in eternity.

Give me no bounties other than these three:
 The knowing that You're one, no Trinity,
 The gift of prophets throughout history,
 And guidance for the task and mastery.
 I do not ask for what is thought the best
 In every state and palace in the West,
 Nor do I ask for oriental gold,
 Nor anything that can be bought and sold.
 For food and drink I merely press my
 thanks
 That You provide a richness outside banks.
 I beg no treasure in the afterlife,
 No honours to the sound of drum and fife.
 From portions coveted let me be free.

Give me no bounties other than these three.

201 And among them there are some who
Say "Our Lord, give us good that's due
In this world and good in the one
In the hereafter, save when done
From what torments of fire ensue."

202 These shall have a portion of what
They've earned, for truly God is not
Slow in the reckoning to do.

203 And remember God on the days
Appointed, and who's quick in ways
To his departure in two days
It will be no sin on him, and
Who tarries there, is no command
Unheeded, and this is for him
Who guards against the evil grim,
So take shelter in God and know
Unto His gathering you will go.

The service of remembrance of Your name,
Beloved, is one that I would take in flame
On heart and tongue to recite day by day,
On the days appointed Your sacred way.
I do not tarry, I do not stand here
Unheeding princely sounds upon my ear,
But hasten to recite the sacred sound
That falls upon the frozen, silent ground,
And rises with the prayer and hope to find
That You, Beloved, are never deaf and
blind.

Beloved, give me the good that's due me in
This world of hopelessness and world of
sin,

And I shall live a moment with a grin
To praise Your name to all the great and
kind.

204 And among men there are those whose
Talk of life here leaves naught to choose
But marvel, and he takes God as
Witness to what in heart he has,
Yet he is the most violent
Of adversaries in earth sent.

205 And when he turns his back he strives
On earth that he may wreck our lives
Destroying tilth and stock, but God
Does not love mischief on the sod.

206 And when it's said to him, "Fear God,"
Pride drives him on to sin, rebel,
And sufficient for him is hell,

Indeed an evil place to dwell.

207 And among men, there's one to sell
Himself seeking pleasure of God,
And truly God's affectionate
Unto His servants in their state.

208 O you who believe, enter all
Into submission of God's call,
And follow not where Satan stepped,
For he's your enemy adept.

209 But if you slip after that which
Has come unto You in the pitch
Of the clear signs, then know that God
Is mighty, wise above the sod.

210 Do they have anything in store
For them but that God at the door
Come to them under canopies
Of bright cloud and above the trees'
Angels? And the matter's decreed
To God all things return indeed.

Bright clouds they may be from the other
side,

But they are grey, grey here where I abide,
And looking up from forests where I stride,
I see the greyness lower and collide
With lighter and with darker greys that ride
The wind above the frozen countryside.
Bright clouds they may be where the sun
comes down

To strike them with a gold and silver
crown,

But where I look I see no angel's frown
Nor even angels coming into town.
My life is cloud and angels, it is true,
But beyond what I see and hear, it's You
Who makes Reality come into view
Of the soul's waking up to sing anew.

211 Ask Israel's folk how many clear
Verses We've given them to hear,
And who changes God's bounty dear
After it's come to him in truth,
Then surely God requites in ruth.

212 The life of this world has been made
Alluring to the ones who've strayed
In unbelief and they scoff at
Those who believe, but those who've sat
In guard against evil will be
Above them on the day in fee,
And surely God provides sustaining
For whom He will, no measure reigning.

213 Once humankind was but one folk,
 And God sent Apostles who spoke
 Good tidings and warners and sent
 Down with them the book with truth meant
 To judge between men in that where
 They differed and none differed there
 Except the very ones to whom
 It was given, clear signs in doom,
 By revolting among themselves,
 And so God guided, not those elves,
 But those who believed by His will,
 Regarding that which people will
 Differ about the truth, and God
 Will surely guide with staff and rod
 Whom He wills right path where they trod.
 214 Or do you think that you will go
 Into the garden while yet show
 Upon you none of that which passed
 On those before you? On the last
 Came distress and affliction, so
 They were shaken, so on the go
 Exclaimed the Prophet and those who
 With him believed, "When will God's true
 Help come?" Oh truly and indeed
 God's help is near to those in need.

I cry beneath the darkness of the night
 Because You seem to be outside my sight.
 Yet when I cry for help, I know You're
 near,

Nearer, Belovèd, nearer than my fear.
 When I feel pain it seems to be within
 The marrow and beneath the tortured skin.
 Yet You are closer far to me than that.
 When I am in adversity it seems
 My troubles are more pressing than my
 dreams.

Yet You are closer far to me than that.
 When I am shaken in my spirit then
 I feel that I am poor beneath all men.
 But You are closer far than poverty
 Of spirit, You are closer than my me.

215 They ask you what they ought to
 spend.
 Say "Whatever of good you lend,
 Let it be given to parents, near
 Of kin, and orphans that appear,
 The poor, the traveller, and what good
 You do, God knows it as you should."
 216 Fighting is ordained unto you,

And it is hateful to you too,
 And maybe you hate what is good
 For you and love a thing which should
 Be bad for you, and truly God
 Knows what is unknown where you plod.
 217 The sacred month they ask about,
 And whether one should fight and shout,
 Say "Fighting therein's a grave sin,
 And to hinder people and kin
 From God's way, and to deny Him,
 And prevent access to the rim
 Of the holy mosque, and to drive
 Its people away from it live,
 Is graver still with God." And such
 Evil is a more grievous touch
 Than carnage, and they will not cease
 To fight you till you should release
 Your faith, if they only prevail,
 And whoever of you turns sail
 Away from faith, and as such dies
 An infidel, are all such guys
 Whose actions shall be done in vain
 In this world and the coming reign,
 And they're the inmates of the fire
 Wherein they shall abide the ire.
 218 Truly those who believe and those
 Who have migrated in the close
 Way of God, these are they whose hope
 Is in the mercy of God's scope
 And God's forgiving, merciful.

The question of the months is not quite
 clear,
 Although since Umar all Muslims revere
 The lunar month and follow peace and war
 By the one lunar calendar in store.
 I turn from adding the thirteenth month and
 Lay on the Jubilees obedient hand,
 And recognize Islamic months to stand,
 Since priestly courses in the days of old
 Followed the lunar months in cycles bold.
 Belovèd, let me not fight today nor when
 Rebellions rise against good and true men,
 But follow every week till Friday's path
 Lead me away from quarrelling and wrath,
 Lead me toward the Sabbath day again.

219 They ask you concerning the pull
 Of wine and gambling games of chance,
 Say "In both these great evils dance,
 As well as benefits for men,

But the evil they cause again
 Is greater than their benefit.”
 And they will ask you what is fit
 To spend, say “Whatever you can.”
 Thus God makes clear to every man,
 To you each sign to ponder it,
 220 Concerning this world and the next.
 They’ll ask about orphans perplexed.
 Say “To set right for them is best.”
 But if you act at their behest,
 Remember they’re your brothers’ test,
 And God distinguishes between
 The corrupt and the righteous scene,
 And if God willed, He could have made
 Things hard for you in higher grade,
 God’s surely mighty, wise displayed.

Both wine and games of chance seduce the
 soul,
 They are addiction that take a great toll.
 That’s why they are forbidden in the train.
 They run the risk of idol worship vain.
 And yet as I recite Qur’anic Word
 And stand upon the night for what I heard,
 I find I am addicted to the sound
 Of sweetness in divine cast to the ground.
 And so, Beloved, though wine touch not
 my lip,
 Though game of risk and chance spring not
 my ship,
 I still find that my eyes are darkened by
 Idolatry as I spin round for why.
 I take Your Word for idol to my shame
 When I forget the wine and idle game.

221 Do not marry women who fail
 To acknowledge the holy grail
 Of the divine oneness until
 They come to cup of faith to fill.
 Believing servant-woman bride
 Is better far than to confide
 In idol-worshipping trollop
 Though she allure with simpering sop,
 And give not in marriage to such
 Idolater men who have much
 Until they believe, since it’s true
 Believing servant-man and shrew
 Is better than the wealthy clutch
 That worships images and such,
 Even though he may put on charm
 Alluring you into the harm

Of fire, and truly God allures
 You to the garden and ensures
 Forgiveness by His leave, and makes
 His signs clear for men and their sakes
 In remembrance services’ stakes.

The institution of marriage is sure
 And given for the sake of having pure
 Pairs to make remembrance service to Your
 Name. The service of remembrance when
 done

By single soul witnesses You are one
 In every word of faith and revelation.
 But musahiblik, whirling of the pair
 Without a word bears witness to the air
 That all creation is a manied thing,
 A paired, a multiplicity, a wing
 Full feathered with the iridescent close
 Of myriad colours, more I might suppose.
 I glory in creations pairing and
 So know that You, Beloved, are one to
 stand.

Just one more word to make me enemies
 Of the good Muslims I should try to please,
 And that’s the Qur’an here says straight
 away

Not to marry a woman for a day
 Who has not confessed Your oneness, but
 still

Worships the many idols on the hill,
 Or takes the One for three in creedal bill.
 I don’t say those who call themselves the
 name

Refrain from taking trinitarian shame
 For wives and hussies on the sexy train.
 It’s just my narrow-minded view that those
 Men who do so are not Muslims in rows.
 What’s good for goose is grander on its
 toes,
 And men will do as they like for their gain.

222 And they’ll ask you concerning state
 Of menstruation and the mate,
 Say “It’s discomfort therefore keep
 Away from women when they weep
 In menstruation, go not near
 Them until their cleansing appear,
 And when they’re cleansed go in to them
 As God’s ordained the stratagem,
 Truly God loves those who turn to

Him constantly and loves those who
 Cleanse themselves in the things they do.
 223 Your women are your tilth, wherefore
 Enter your tillage on that score
 According to desire and yet
 Provide for yourselves in advance
 A righteousness and firmly set,
 Take shelter without defiance
 In God, knowing that you shall meet
 Him in judgement. Without retreat,
 O Muhammad, bear the glad news
 Unto the faithful whom I choose.
 224 O who believe, make not the name
 Of God in your oaths hindrance shame
 Against your doing good, and be
 Pious and do well among men,
 Because that God is verily
 All-hearing and knows all again.
 225 God will call you not to account
 For a thoughtless oath in amount,
 For what your hearts have earned and God
 Forgives, forbearing on the sod.
 226 For those who swear to abstain from
 Their wives, is ordained waiting sum
 Of four months and if then they go
 Back, then truly God is not slow
 To forgive in His mercy's *drum*.
 227 And if they resolve on divorce,
 Then truly God hears all perforce,
 And He knows all things too, of course.
 228 The divorced woman shall await
 Until three monthly courses' rate,
 And it shall not be lawful then
 To conceal what God has by men
 Created in their wombs, if they
 Believe in God and the Last Day,
 And their husbands shall have the right
 In greater due to cancel spite
 To reconciliation's tune,
 While for women it is their boon
 To have equal rights on their men,
 And for men also on women,
 Doubly duty must not despise,
 And God is mighty, He is wise.

Beloved, do not divorce me from Your
 love,
 Do not divorce me from the bringing of
 Your memento on my heart and ear to
 row
 In recitation of the names I know

Of Your beneficence above the show
 Of market and of tinsel with their glow
 Of fading light before the ragged glove.
 Beloved, divorce me not, but keep me near
 The sighing of Your breath upon my ear
 From pine and fir, from birch and aspen
 while
 The evening rushing towards me without
 guile.
 Beloved, the days pass swiftly on the toe
 Of love in this kiss of the wind and snow,
 Divorce me not from Your winters last
 smile.

229 Divorce is only taken twice:
 After that, parties should be nice,
 Either stay together on terms,
 Or separate and without squirms
 In kindness. It's not lawful that
 You men take back from any wife
 Your gifts, except that where they sat
 You'd be unable in your life
 To keep God's ordained bounds from strife.
 If you indeed fear they would be
 Unable to keep the bounds free
 Ordained by God, there is no blame
 On either of them to their shame
 If she give something to be free.
 These are God's bounds, do not transgress.
 If any do transgress excess
 The limits ordained by God, such
 Persons wrong themselves just as much.
 230 So if a husband divorce wife
 For good, he cannot, in his life
 After that, remarry her till
 After she's had another bill
 Of marriage and divorce to fill.
 In that case there will be no blame
 On either of them if the same
 Couple will reunite, if they
 Think they can keep to Allah's way.
 Such are limits ordained by God,
 Which He makes plain upon the sod
 To those who understand His rod.

There are some details of the Torah law
 That are the opposite when found in star
 Of the Qur'an. Whether that shows the
 latter
 To be a forgery for getting fatter,
 I shall not say. The Torah does allow

Remarriage of the divorced couple's prow
 If no one has been interloper in
 The marriage heart and bed as well as bin.
 The Qur'an makes the once prohibited
 A necessary requisite and bid.
 I have been told it is a punishment
 For quarrelling up to the divorcement.
 As Jesus said once, hardness of the heart
 Is spring of the whole thing, both horse and
 cart.

231 When you divorce women, and they
 Fulfil the term of waiting's way,
 Either take them back on fair terms,
 Or set them free as faith affirms,
 But do not take them back to be
 Injurious to them, or see
 Undue advantage, if one does
 That, he wrongs his own soul that was.
 Do not treat God's signs as a jest,
 But solemnly rehearse the best
 Of Allah's favours on you, and
 The fact that He sent down command
 To you in the Book and Wisdom,
 For your instruction. Fear in sum
 Allah, and know that God is well
 Acquainted with all things you spell.

When a man will divorce the thing is like
 He cut off his right hand and with a spike
 Thrust through his foot. The divorce is a
 spell
 That throws the wife into a living hell.
 And yet the Christian view that no law
 makes
 The divorce legal in the human stakes
 Is simply wrong. No man, not even Christ,
 Has right to say that Moses' law's untriced.
 The Gospel rather condemns the false way
 That Middle Easterners make divorce pay
 But marrying intending to divorce
 After lying with the wife caught by force
 Of gold, to cover prostitution's bill
 Divorce is law divine and valid still.

232 When you divorce women, and they
 Fulfil the term of waiting's way,
 Do not prevent them from their seeking
 Marriage with former husbands peeking,
 If they both agree on fair terms.
 This instruction for all confirms

Amongst you, who believe in God
 And the Last Day upon the sod.
 That is the way of most virtue
 And purity here amongst you.
 And Allah knows, and you do not.
 233 The mothers shall give suck to sot
 Their offspring for all of two years,
 If the father desires arrears
 To complete the term. But he'll bear
 The cost of their food and what's fair
 Clothing on terms that are right there.
 No soul shall have a burden laid
 On it greater than can be paid.
 No mother shall be treated wrong
 On account of her child for long,
 Nor father on account of child,
 An heir shall be charged unbeguiled.
 If they both decide on the weaning,
 By mutual consent and screening,
 And after due consulting, there
 Is no blame on them anywhere
 If you decide on foster nurse
 For your offspring, there is no worse
 Blame on you, provided you pay
 Her what you offered fair by day.
 But fear Allah and know that God
 Sees well what you do on the sod.

Only Islam makes dads bear up the cost
 Of breast-feeding their children in the frost
 Or heat. But every woman in the way
 Of northern snows thinks that too is the
 sway
 Of patriarchal control without pay.
 If one by some great miracle may read
 Your Word and by a greater be agreed,
 There's always the onlooker in her need
 To deny and to scoff about the freed.
 Beloved, feed me with breasts divine if
 You
 Have breasts, and if not, pay the divine
 crew
 To nourish me in a cold world and pew,
 And I shall find or not the justice set
 In word and deed of Your own message
 met.

234 If any of you die and leave
 Widows behind, they in reprieve
 Shall wait concerning themselves four
 Months and ten days, and not before

They have fulfilled their term, there's no
Blame on you if they come to show
Just and reasoned behaviour's go.
And Allah well knows what you do.
235 But there shall be no blame on you
In indirect proposing to
Marriage you make to women due
Concealed within yourselves, but true,
God knows that you will mention them,
But make no secret promise gem
Unless you speak in fairness, and
Resolve on no wedlock at hand
Until the prescribed term is done,
And know that God knows everyone
And what is in yourselves begun,
Therefore be careful of His gun,
And know that God's forgiving One,
Forbearing too when all is done.

How many Christian preachers ought to
know

The rule of marriage after the death show!
As soon as they are free, they take a wench
Still hot from her deceased husband's work-
bench.

The Christian sort of worship is the kind
Inspiring everyone to turn his mind
To sensual extravagance and blind.
The plot is to put women in a bind.
Beloved, I am a widow of the day,
Forsaken by the night I took for pay,
But do not wait to take me for Your own
Before the four months and ten days have
flown.

If Christian ministers can take a wife,
Then You can snatch me too out of the
strife.

236 There is no blame on you if you
Divorce women before the due
Consummation nor having made
Fixation of their dower paid,
But provide them according to
Each his means, and the wealthy do
What he is able, and the poor
Provision with fairness procure,
Duty of good-doers insure.
237 And if you divorce them before
You have touched them, and yet the store
Of dowry for them handed over,
Then half the dowry of the trover

Shall still be given unless they
Themselves remit what's in their pay,
Or he in whose hands is the knot
Of marriage shall remit the lot,
And that you yourselves remit all
Is closer to a righteous call,
Forget not generosity
Among yourselves, for verily,
Whatever you do God will see.

The recompense is in the choice of maid,
And so negotiated when once paid.
Though grace alone is source of all life
stayed,
And nothing I can do changes parade,
Still I find choices everywhere I turn
Within the holy book in things to learn,
Within the legislation things to earn.
The recompense is choice of what's outlaid.
Beloved, though I've been bought and sold
as wife

To every soldier wrenching in the strife,
Take back Your recompense, I give it all.
But keep me safe a day within Your stall,
Beloved of You by day and night to find
That I'm a soul Your own and so resigned.

238 Be strict in observance of prayer,
Especially the midmost there,
And stand attent in praying to
God who'll surely hear the true.

239 If you fear, then on foot, or riding,
But when you're safe, in God confiding
Remember God as He has taught
You of the things which you knew not.

240 And those of you who die and leave
Widows shall bequeath for reprieve
Of their wives a year's maintenance
Without causing to quit their tents,
But if they of their own accord
Quit their homes, there shall be no scored
Blame on you for what they might do
With themselves, lawfully and true,
And God is mighty, wise, it's true.

241 And for the divorced women be
Provision in its equity,

A duty on those who guard from
Themselves the evil things to come.

242 Thus God makes clear to you His signs
So you may understand confines.

Some count the day from evening, so they
take

The dawn prayer for the middle one at
stake.

But others think the day begins at dawn,
And so the middle prayer is that in spawn
Of later afternoon. Five prayers in all
Must always have a middle one in stall.
I beg, Beloved, that You excuse my prayer:
I leave so many bowings on the air,
Mind wandering about the mosque or
room,

No hope of paradise nor fear of doom.
And so like atheist I hope not nor
Fear anything that's lurking at the door,
But only whirl in walking on the floor
Where You dispel the shadow and the
gloom.

243 Did You not see those who went out
From their homes, and they were no doubt
In thousands, and in fear of death,
Then God said to them in one breath
'Die then!' and after that He brought
Them back to life, and to the lot
Truly God is gracious to them,
But most men to not thank His hem.

244 Then struggle in the path of God,
And know God hears and knows the prod.

245 Who is he that will lend to God
A fair loan, truly, on the sod
He'll multiply it many-fold,
For God's is to extend and hold,
To His return you shall be bold.

246 Have You not seen the heads of state
Of Israel's folk after the mate
Moses, when they spoke to one sent
As prophet to them when they meant
"Raise up for us a king, that we
May fight in God's path gratefully,"
He said "It may be that not such
Fighting were ordained for your touch,
Then would you not fight at the clutch?"
They said "What ails us that we should
Not fight in the path of God's good,
When we have truly been sent out
From home and children by the clout?"
But when fighting was ordained to
Them they turned back save but a few,
Truly God knows the unjust, too.

The people clamour for a king today
And every day on earth. It is their way.
They may call him a president or pope,
But a king is always the only hope.
Beloved, I have no hand to fight in claw,
I have no will to keep the divine law,
So hardly can I keep the bill of fare
That humans have invented to beware.
Beloved, let me want never king or crown
Or any other ruler of the town
But You alone, and I shall see come down
Invisibly in hand the blessing taught
By every whirling hopeful on the spot,
By every howling dervish in the plot.

247 Their prophet said to them "Indeed
God has appointed Saul to lead."
They said "How can the kingdom be
His, over us, since we are free
And more rightful for it than he,
While he's not gifted with great wealth?"
He said "Truly God's come by stealth
To choose him over you and made
Him wealthy in knowledge and stayed
In strength, and truly God has granted
His kingdom to whomso He planted,
God is extended over all,
Knower of everything and call.
248 And said their prophet to them still,
"A sign of his monarchal will
Is that to you shall come the ark
Of covenant, in which shall park
The shekinah from your Lord and
The relics of what did command
The family of Moses and
The family of Aaron's band,
The angels shall bear it and stand,
Truly therein shall be a sign
For you if you believe the shine.

The angels were but men or in one case
But kine and not of the celestial race.
It matters not. It's no conflict of face.
What matters is the sign shekinah made
To prove that Saul was king among the
paid.

He was the king the people did demand,
And had some chafed and taxed beneath his
hand.

Such is the character of man and place.
Beloved, I take no king but him You send

Upon the harbour to which I would wend
My flattered way. I seek the best to spend.
If Saul is king or David or another,
I take them all and love them like a brother,
Though all may have a different sort of
mother.

249 When Saul set forth with his armies,
He said "Truly Allah will please
To try you at the stream and who
Drinks from it then he is not true
To me and who does not taste it,
Then verily he is well fit
To be mine, save who drinks a draught
In hollow of his hand up caught."
All but a few of them went down
To drink of it with bent down crown,
And when he'd crossed it, then he said
And those believing with him led,
We have no strength this day to win
Against Goliath and his kin,"
But those who thought they should meet
God,
Spoke saying, "How oft on the sod
By God's permission a small band
Did vanquish a big host's command?
Truly God's with the patient band."

Beloved, You seem to confuse here two
men:
Saul and the earlier named Gideon.
Of course You might retort that the event
Happened twice, and the one time that was
meant
In Judges of the Bible is not spent
In the Qur'an, which takes the other way,
And tells about the second one and day.
There's always an honest and sacred means
Of getting around conflicts on the scenes.
There's always room to doubt the sacred
word,
And find a reason to think it's absurd.
Beloved, the wise among men in Your eyes
Are more absurd than any who despise
The revelation and its human guise.

250 Against Goliath and his hosts
They set forth saying in their boasts
"O our Lord, shower on us strength
And set our feet firm and at length
Help us against infidel folk,"

And so God-fearing people spoke.
251 By Allah's will they routed all,
And David made Goliath fall,
And God gave him kingdom and sage
Wisdom and taught him the page
He willed, and were it not that God
Repelled some men with the harsh rod
Of others, then the earth had been
Full of mischief and mischief's sin,
But God's gracious to universe.
252 These are God's signs that we rehearse
To you in truth: indeed you are
One of the apostles and star.

Beloved, I do not understand Your signs!
You seem to say that David's arm inclines,
By killing one, to prove the worth of him
Whom You sent last. The argument is dim.
I cannot fathom how Goliath's death
Proves that Muhammad's Master of the
breath.
But then reciting all these signs brings me
Into al-Haqq, from word and thought set
free.
The longing that is mine through love and
knowing
Is quenched, Beloved, at last in Your true
showing.
The heads of giants cast aside are worth
Their weight in arms abandoned on the
earth.
The battle's gore and glory disappear
As You alone in quietness are here.

253 These apostles we have exalted
Some above others (*but none faulted*),
Of them are some to whom God spoke,
And some whom He has raised a stroke,
To Jesus son of Mary we
Gave clear signs *and abundantly*
And strengthened with the holy spirit,
As God so willed he *would be near it*.
The generations that came after
Quarrelled among themselves *with laughter*
After clear evidence had come,
But chose dissension *for their sum*,
With some believing, others not.
If God so willed, they had not fought,
But God does as His will *has taught*.
254 O you who believe! Spend in *alms*
Of what We have provided *balms*

For you before the day arrives
When there's no bargaining contrives,
Nor friendship nor to intercede,
Who disbelieve unjust indeed.

255 God! There's no god but He, the
Living,
The Self-subsisting, all life-giving,
No slumber seizes Him nor sleep.
In heaven and earth all's His to keep.
Who is there who can intercede
In His presence, except He lead?
He knows what is before, to come,
None compasses His knowledge sum,
But as He wills. His throne extends
On heaven and earth and He transcends
Fatigue in guarding, keeping all.
He is Most High, Supreme of all.

O my Beloved, no verse in time or place
Reveals so fully as this divine grace.
There is no god but You, and none indeed
To come fulfilling every human need.
Yet You have need of nothing for Your
share,

For You're Creator of the everywhere
And every time. I turn from all to bear
Creation to find Your throne on the stair.
I turn from evil and the fainting spark
And find You even after light in dark.
I turn from good in men to find alone
You still seated for good upon the throne.
I turn from my own self and flee to You,
Alone my heart's desire, alone the True.

256 Religion must have no compulsion,
Indeed there is a clear convulsion
Between truth and error distinct,
Therefore the one who has not blinked
To favour rebels but believes
Fast in God, indeed such one cleaves
To strongest handle without break,
Truly God hears, knows for his sake.
257 God is the guardian of those who
Believe, He takes them out of *true*
Darkness into the light, and those
Who disbelieve, rebels arose
As their guardians, they take them out
From light into darkness and doubt,
They are companions of the fire
Where they shall dwell *for their desire*.

You, my Beloved, are One alone, while I
Stand here surrounded by a cloudy sky
Of witnesses, some true and prophetly,
And others who would dream to coerce me.
I take You only for my guardian
And give no homage to the form of man
Who would take me into darkness from
light.

I stand alone here and beneath Your sight.
I dip my toe into the blazing fire
To taste a sample of flaming desire,
And turn again and flee once more to You:
My doubt is but my hurrying to do
Your will alone. Exalt apostle signs,
Beloved, but confer upon me Your wines.

258 Did you not see him who disputed
With Abraham about his Lord,
Because his Lord had constituted
A kingdom for him *without sword*,
When Abraham said "My Lord's He
Who gives life and makes death to be,"
He said "I give life and cause death,"
Said Abraham *then in one breath*
"Indeed God brings the sun from east,
So bring it from the west at least."

At that who disbelieved was made
Confounded, for God has not stayed
To guide unjust people *unpaid*.
259 Or like him who passed by a town
In which the roofs had fallen down,
And he exclaimed "How can God bring
To life after death anything,"
So God caused him to die a spell
Of one hundred years then make well
And raised to life, He asked me "Tell,
How long were you thus?" So he said
"Perhaps a day or one day's part."
He said "No, You've stayed one hundred
Years so, but look at your food *cart*
And your drink, for their signs of age,
Look at your donkey: We engage
To make of you a sign unto
The people, look further *and true*
At the bones, how We bring them *due*
Together and clothe them with flesh."
When this was shown clearly *and fresh*
To him, he said "I know Allah
Has power over all things *for awe*."
260 Behold! Abraham said "My Lord!
Show me how You give life *once sword*

Has taken from the dead their life."
 He said "Don't you believe then *rife?*"
 He said "Indeed, but satisfy
 My understanding *by the by.*"
 He said "Take four birds, tame them to
 Turn to you. Put a portion due
 Of them on every hill, and call
 To them. They'll come to you *though small*
And speedily. Then know that God
 Is great in power, with wisdom *shod.*"

Your power, Beloved, is seen in sovereign
 choice
 By which You resurrect, by which rejoice.
 The breath of man is in Your hand today,
 Each breath is gift directly from Your
 sway.
 The body fails and goes down to the dust,
 The delicate cake turns to crumb and crust,
 The ass expires and leaves bones bleached
 and white,
 And silence reigns upon unconscious night.
 In death no dream or memory appears,
 All is forgotten of both love and fears.
 And then at one word the soul rises up
 In breath and body before silver cup
 Of life again. Beloved, Your single word
 Suffices that inanimate be stirred.

261 The parable of those who spend
 Their substance in the way to lend
 To Allah is a grain of corn:
 It grows seven ears, and *not forlorn*
 Every ear has a hundred grains.
 Allah gives manifold in gains
 To whom He pleases: Allah cares
 For all and He knows all their shares.
 262 Those who spend their substance in
 cause
 Of Allah, and not for applause
 Give gifts with reminders of their
 Generous character to share
 Or with injury, their reward
 Is certainly there with their Lord.
 On them shall be no fear nor grief.
 263 Kind word and pardon's better than
 An act of charity to ban
 With obligation's injury,
 And truly Allah's All-sufficing,
 And most forbearing in devicing.
 264 O you believers, do not make

Your acts of charity mistake
 By your reproaching injury
 Like one who spends his wealth so see
 Men and believe not in Allah
 And in the Last Day *as in awe.*
 They are like a soil-covered rock,
 Heavy rain falls upon the stock
 And leaves it just bare stone. They'll not
 Receive of anything they've earned,
 And truly it is not God's plot
 To guide the unbelievers *spurned.*

No matter what my charity in deed,
 Beloved, my action is but Yours decreed.
 I have no merit that I bring to You,
 No not in any good thing that I do.
 Yet You've decreed all good works of all
 men,
 And by Your hand they are all done again.
 If from my hand good comes, I do rejoice
 And render praise to You with my full
 voice.
 The rain falls on bare stone, the corn grows
 up,
 But neither stone nor stalk bring to the cup
 The virtue of their produce. So am I
 The passive clay beneath the gracious sky,
 And rain in grace and sun may fall on me
 To bring to pass Your will and Your
 decree.

265 The likeness of who spend their wealth
 Seeking Allah's pleasure, in stealth
 Of devotion is like
 A garden on a hillside, strike
 The rains and it springs out
 Its fruit two-fold, and if it's not
 A heavy rain on it then be
 A gentle shower, Verily
 Allah beholds your best in fee.
 266 Does any one of you wish that
 He had a garden where dates sat,
 And grapevines and underground streams,
 All kinds of fruit, and when it seems
 He's gone decrepit and offspring
 Not yet capable of living,
 And all be caught up in whirlwind
 With fire unleashed and fire unbinned
 To burn it all up? So Allah
 Makes clear to you His signs in awe.

When Allah first gave the dream to the
king
Of Egypt for dear Joseph's explaining,
He left the Pharaoh without sleep awhile
And had him tossing on his flaxen pile.
If Allah gives the increase in the day
Of famine to the one He wills in sway,
And takes the robin for a swimming stay
On lawns where the abundance grows and
flows,
Then I take trust in Him for life and death
And praise Him in this momentary breath.
I spend my substance on the one who asks,
Full realizing that the getter basks
In wine and song and feasting while I break
The hard crust in my mountain fastness'
wake.

267 O you then who believe! Give well
Of the good things you've earned *in spell*,
And of the good fruits of the earth
That We've produced for you *of worth*,
And do not try to get the bad
To give away from such you *had*,
When you yourselves would not accept
Such things which your eyes shut *and kept*.
And know Allah is rich beyond
All praises *of both free and bond*.
268 Satan it is who makes you fear
That poverty has touched you near
And orders you to behave wrong.
Allah promises all along
Forgiveness and bountiful gifts.
And Allah cares for all He lifts,
And knows all *in the world that drifts*.
269 He makes wise whom He will,
And such receive abundance spill,
But none will understand the word
But men of understanding heard.
270 And what you spend in charity
Or in devotion faithfully,
Be certain that Allah knows all.
But wicked men have no help's call.
271 If you show charity in view,
It is a good thing in the pew,
But if you hide the act and make
It go in the true needy's wake,
That is the best for you to take:
That will remove from you the bad.
And Allah's well aware and glad
Of what you do in hidden pad.

272 There's no requirement on your part
To set them in the right path's cart,
But Allah sets on the right way
The ones that He's pleased will not stray.
Whatever good you come to give
Will benefit the way you live,
And you'll only do that as you
Look for Allah's face come in view.
What you give will come back to you,
And you'll have no unjust for rue.
273 For those in need in Allah's way
Restricted from movement in sway
Upon the land seeking the pay:
Unknowing ones think because they
Are modest, they need nought in lay.
You'll recognize them by the way
They do not beg in cries of grief
From everyone for their relief.
And what of good you give to them,
Be certain Allah knows the gem.

Satan prevents the giving of the good
To those who need their drink as well as
food.
But he also wields a good tool to show
That poverty is yawning in the glow
Of Sabbath-keeping to prevent the way
Allah has given to absent the flay
Of those in power. So many fail to keep
The Sabbath and remain at last to weep.
Beloved, let me give with a grateful claw
To those who need my bread and stand in
awe
Of You alone as He who deals the raw
And cooked both from the pot and
cupboard's share.
It's You alone who keep all in Your care,
The man, the child, the sparrow and the
hare.

274 Those who spend of their goods by
night
And by day, in secret and sight,
Have their reward with their Lord come:
On them shall be no fear, nor hum
Of grief, *but they shall stand in light*.
275 Those who eat interest will not stand
Except as one by evil hand
Touched with such madness *on the land*.
That's because they say "Interest is
The ground of capitalist bizz."

But Allah's granted business, but
 Forbidden interest and shut.
 Those who receive their Lord's advice
 Shall be forgiven in a trice
 For what's in the past when they stop.
 Their case is for Allah to pop.
 But those who keep it up shall be
 Companions of the fire and see
 They will abide there *lastingly*.
 276 Allah will take His blessing from
 The interest, but increase in sum
 The deeds of charity, for He
 Does not love infidelity.

The word goes up today as well to say
 That business needs the interest to pay.
 Fact is the interest is the cause of
 Failing economy and failing love.
 The way to keep economy robust
 Is freely giving charity in trust.
 That seems a wild tale to the greedy man,
 And so he cannot conform to the plan.
 Beloved, I have but little in my store,
 And yet it's great compared to failing score
 Of many starving on this earth near me.
 The famine spreads around in sprawling
 spree
 Since interest eats the profits in fat glee.
 I turn and turn again from what I see.

282 O you who believe! When you deal
 With one another, in appeal
 Of future obligations' heel,
 Let it be written in contract
 By a scribe faithfully intact
 Between both parties, but let not
 The scribe refuse to write what's taught
 By Allah, let him write the lot.
 Let the one who's incurred the debt
 Dictate, but let him in fear set
 Before his Lord Allah and not
 Diminish what he owes in plot.
 If that one is mentally naught,
 Or weak or cannot dictate wrought,
 Then let his guardian do so
 In good faith, and get two to go
 As witnesses from your own men,
 And if there are not two men, then
 A man and two women among
 The ones you choose, *the old or young*,
 So if one errs, the other can

Remind her *of the written plan*.
 Witnesses should not refuse when
 They're called upon to state again.
 Don't put off writing to a time
 In future, small or bigger rhyme:
 It's juster in the sight of God,
 A better witness and a prod,
 And more convenient to prevent
 Doubts by you, but as the things went
 It is a thing you carry out
 Immediately among yourselves,
 There is no blame to leave *like elves*
 The matter unwritten. But take
 A witness whenever you make
 Commercial contract; and let not
 The scribe nor witness suffer sot.
 If you make trouble, it would be
 A wicked thing for you to see.
 So fear Allah. For Allah's who
 Instructs you. And Allah knows too
 About all the things that you do.
 283 If you're travelling and cannot find
 A scribe, then take a pledge to bind.
 And if one of you gives a thing
 On trust to another in ring,
 Let the trusted one keep his trust,
 And let him fear his Lord as must.
 Don't hide the evidence, for such
 Who hides it, his heart it will touch
 With sin. And Allah knows all you
 Do *and will bring the thing to view*.

The spells of sweet Muhammad on the
 sight
 Of many folk who can and cannot write
 Minds me that many in my world around
 Pretend to be more literate than found.
 In older days it was expected that
 A good man may not read or write, but sat
 Upon his laurels bought and earned and
 ground.
 Today the lack is secret to the bound.
 Beloved, I know that You are literate
 From the way that You spoke the law in
 state,
 Which now remains correctly but for one
 Or two misspellings that no one should
 shun.
 So write on my heart now with loving pen
 The billet-doux of Decalogue again.

284 To Allah is all that is in
 The heavens and on earth in bin.
 Whether you show what's in your mind
 Or hide the thing from the refined,
 Allah will call you to account.
 He forgives whom he will amount
 And punishes the one He pleases,
 For Allah's power never ceases.

The message of Your sovereign grace I see
 More clearly in Qur'an than in the fee
 Of Christian books and Jewish lights and
 rights,
 And so I take Qur'an in my delights.
 You save the one You choose and leave the
 rest,
 Even if by Your calling all the best
 Should go down in perdition for their rest.
 There is no taint of bias in the way
 You save a brand out of the burning day.
 Beloved, I come to You and so I pray:
 Give me the grace to accept what You say
 And never murmur that my justice sense
 Requires an explanation for Your tents.
 So my reaction is a divine test.

285 The messenger believes in what
 Has been revealed to him in glut
 From his Lord, as do faithful men.
 Each of them believes once again
 In Allah, His angels, His books,
 His messengers in all their nooks.
 "We do not make a difference
 Between one and another's pence
 Among His messengers of sense."
 They say "We hear and we obey.
 Forgiveness from our Lord we pray,
 And to You is the end of all
 The journeyings of *mankind's thrall*.

I do believe, Beloved, in what You sent:
 In You, in angels, in the books You lent
 And in Your messengers and where they
 went.

I make no difference among the true,
 And so cannot be loyal to the crew
 Of any faith established, for they do.
 One takes of Moses and another rates
 That Jesus Christ is better than ingrates,
 While some pretend that blessed
 Muhammad stands

Above all other prophets on the sands.
 I take them all in love and equal share
 And meet them all and kiss upon the stair.
 And will each one I join in fervent prayer
 For Your forgiveness. So I am obeyer.

286 On no one does Allah set down
 A weight more than the fervent crown
 Can bear. But each gets benefit
 Of the good that he earns by wit,
 And suffers every wicked thing
 That he deserves by his doing.
 "Our Lord! Do not condemn us when
 We forget or return again
 To error. Our Lord! Do not lay
 On us a burden as in sway
 You put on those before our time.
 Our Lord! Do not set to our crime
 A weight beyond our strength to climb.
 Blot out our sins, and do forgive.
 Have mercy so that we may live.
 You are our shield and so give aid
 Against those standing in parade
 Against the faith, *lest we're waylaid.*"

Beloved, let me not carry in my tune
 More than You would propose to lay in
 rune.

Let me not go beyond Your word to do
 Some task so futile that I join the crew
 Of busy-bodied business men in pew
 And priestly failures in their habits' hue.
 Beloved, keep me exactly in the path
 Of Your commandments to avoid Your
 wrath,
 And as I walk the straight and narrow way,
 I shall not demand You another's pay.
 Let mercy be my watchword and my shield
 From every sort of lust my heart would
 yield

To pass beyond the mark You set for me.
 Beloved, this is my prayer. So hear and see.

Surah 3 Al-i-Imran, or The Family of Imran

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 Alif. Lam. Mim.

Ah Bismillaahi "in the name of God"
 Ar-Rahmaanir Ra'hiim, I seek to trod,
 "Most Gracious, ever Merciful," the halls

And corridors where Your love always
calls.

Ah Bismillaahi in Your name I seek,
Ar-Rahmaanir Rahiim, I dare to speak
In shadow of Your mercy and Your grace,
Beloved, I bow once more before Your
face.

Ah Bismillaahi, name of joy and bliss
Where meet the Gracious Merciful to kiss
The world and universe with loves
abounding

In every syllable of glory sounding.
Ar-Rahmaanir Rahiim, begin and end,
I find in You, Beloved, the only Friend.

2 Allah! There is no god but He,
The Living, *One* Sustaining me,
3 He's sent down the Book with the truth
Confirming the revealed *in youth*,
And He sent down the Torah and
The Gospel as guidance to stand
4 Before for humankind, He sent
Also Criterion *He meant*.

Surely those who defy the signs
Or verses of Allah's *designs*,
There's a strict punishment for them,
Allah's mighty, vengeance *in hem*.
5 From Allah there is nothing hidden
In the earth or the heavens unbidden.
6 It's He who forms you in the wombs
In whatever way His will dooms.
There is no god but He *indeed*,
Almighty, the All-wise *decreed*.
7 It is He who sent down the book.

Some parts are definite in look,
They are the mother of the book,
While others are in metaphor.
As for those in whose hearts is store
Of deviance, they grasp the husk
Of metaphor and give the tusk
To temptation and its false meaning.
But no one knows its sense *for gleaning*
Except Allah and those well set
In knowledge, they say "We believe,
All of it from our Lord receive."
And none takes admonition but
Those who have mind filled and not shut.
8 "Our Lord, do not let our hearts swerve
After You have guided our *nerve*,
But bestow Your mercy on us,
None but You gives so bounteous.

Ah my Beloved, let me take on my ear
The sounds of Torah, Psalms, and in the
fear

Of fire the Gospel and the Qur'an dear!
What in the sacred books is loud and clear
Let me follow with a pure heart and steer
Away from the unrighteous way, unjust,
Or plough my life down in the mangled
dust.

Let me not give the darker word the sound
Of falsity brought from a dark heart's
ground.

But take the understood as well as closed
And bring faith and doubt under power
posed.

As I recite the warbled words with joy,
Or with the tears' repentance You employ,
To waken me to hope, let grace abound.

9 "Our Lord, You'll surely bring mankind
Together on a day to find
There is no doubt." Indeed Allah
Does not break His promise of *law*.

10 As for the faithless, neither their
Wealth nor their children shall prepare
Them anything against Allah,
But they shall be in fire like straw.

11 Just like Pharaoh's folk, those before
Who denied Our signs evermore,
And Allah called them to account
For their sins. For Allah's amount
Of punishment is in strict score.

The Exodus is paradigm of fate
Of humankind before the earthly gate.
The hardened hearts, the dead in sins await
The punishment that's sudden to be great.
Denial of Your signs, Beloved, I see
In my own round of living wrathlessly,
Inspired by what is trivial and bound,
Ephemeral and scattered on the ground.
Beloved, I look toward the grace bestowed
On those who fled from Pharaoh when he
crowed.

I glimpse the fire and straw once more and
sink

Again into the slumber on the brink,
Awaiting the awakening of Your hand
To praise or burning of the broken brand.

12 Say to unfaithful ones, relay:
 "Soon you'll be conquered and to pay
 Summoned to Hell, an evil bed
 For you to lie on there instead.
 13 "There has already been for you
 A miracle in armies two
 That came together in the view,
 One struggling in God's cause and crew,
 And on resisting Allah's due;
 They saw before their own eyes there
 Two times more than their number's share.
 But Allah helps the ones He will.
 In this remains a warning still
 To those who have eyes seeing fill."
 14 Pleasant to men is how they love
 What they will covet hand in glove,
 Both wives and children, piles of gold
 And silver, horses with brands told,
 And cattle and good fields unsold.
 These are held in this world's life's way,
 But in the nearness to the sway
 Of Allah is the best in pay.
 15 Say shall I give you the good news
 Of things far better than you choose?
 For righteous ones are gardens near
 Their Lord, with rivers flowing sere
 Beneath them: there's their bidding home,
 With their mates pure, and in God's loam.
 For in God's sight are His slaves true,
 16 Those who say "Our Lord, here we do
 Believe. Forgive us of our sins,
 And keep us from the fiery bins,"
 17 Those who are patient, firm and strong,
 The true, who worship not the wrong,
 Who give in charity, and who
 Pray for forgiveness at morn's dew.
 18 There is no god but He: That stays
 Allah's witness, His angels' praise,
 That of those having knowledge too,
 Who stand firm on His justice too.
 There is no god but He, the One
 Exalted in Power, the Wise One.

In justice You proclaim that You are one,
 And so impartiality is done.
 If You were as a judge made up of three,
 You would have parts and limits mightily.
 The blessed trinity is not divine,
 But rather witness of the greater sign.
 It is not Father, Son and Holy Ghost
 As ignorantly heathen often boast,

But Allah and Your angels and the ones
 Endued with knowledge and their blessed
 sons.

A thing in Scripture is confirmed by three,
 So let this be the blessed Trinity.

I hear Your witness, my Beloved, and
 theirs.

Hear You then Dervish Ali Haydar's
 prayers.

19 The faith before Allah's submission,
 Nor did the Book's folk make sedition
 From it except through envy's cause,
 After they knew it's lightened laws.
 But if some deny Allah's signs,
 Allah's quick to show their designs.

20 If they debate with you, then say
 "I have put myself under sway
 Of Allah and whom follow me."
 And tell the people of the Book
 And those who all knowledge forsook,
 "Do you submit yourselves?" If they
 Do so, they're in the guided way,
 But if they turn aside, you must
 Give out the message, you can say
 In Allah's sight His servants trust.

Explain the sects and the departure from
 The pure faith once vouchsafed to king and
 bum:

Envy's the key word to explain in sum.
 Envy brought in the holy trinity,
 Envy brought in baptisms in a spree
 Of sprinkling and of pouring on in glee.
 Envy brought in the Sundays and their rate
 Of clinging to the seasons soon or late.
 Envy brought in the quarrels of the name
 Of god and goddess spoken of for shame.
 Beloved, I envy too, I envy too,
 And rush back to the faith You brought in
 view

From the beginning of the false and true.
 It is still written in Your signs for rue.

21 The ones who deny Allah's signs
 Arising against just designs,
 Kill prophets and kill those who teach
 Justice in humankind to reach,
 Proclaim on them, harsh judgement preach.
 22 Those are men whose acts will not bear
 Fruit in this world and in the share

To come will they have help or care.
 23 Did you not turn your sights on those
 Who have receive part in the rows
 Of the Book? They have been called to
 The Book of Allah in the view
 Of mediating disputations,
 But some of them the arbitrations
 Refuse to accept in their rations.
 24 That is because they say "The fire
 Will not touch us but for the trier
 Of a few days." Their falsities
 Keep them in the dark of decrees.

Those who are bundled in their heresy,
 And claim their faith is better than you see
 In the lines of the signs controversy
 In sacred book makes clear for all to be
 In the agreement of Your favour free,
 Shall fall in fire of hell eternally.
 It matters not that blindness caused to fall,
 It matters not on what false gods they call,
 The burning of Your love will eat them all
 And spit their bones out over heaven's wall.
 Beloved, devour me too in divine love
 Despite my heresies in hand and glove
 With morning and with evening to debate
 The light and dark above the love and hate.

25 But what about the time when We
 Gather them together to see
 A day of which there is no doubt,
 And each one will be paid in stout
 What he has earned and nothing out?
 26 Say "O Allah! Ruler of strength,
 You grant power to whom You at length
 Desire, and You take power away
 From those You will, and You raise up
 To honour those You take in cup,
 And You abase them at Your pleasure:
 In Your hand is all good in treasure.
 Surely over all things You wield
 The power *to do and power to yield*.
 27 "You bring the night fast on the day,
 And cause the day to break night's sway;
 You bring up living from the dead,
 You send to death the living spread,
 And You give nourishment to those
 You please in their abundant rows."

The dawn is gauge and guarantee that You
 Bring up the dead into eternal view

Of judgement just as sure as the world
 turns
 And day follows the night, and the night
 learns
 That light eternal must burst on the grave
 And bring to life both master and the slave.
 Though evening draws on my small circle
 here,
 And work is done, and I am left to fear
 And hope, the morning always comes to
 make
 Me know the treasure-houses that You
 take.
 Beloved, the dews that quietly march in
 My garden paths after my sorrows, win.
 The sparkle of their diamonds casts out
 night
 And magnifies a thousand times the light.

28 Believers should not take as friends
 Or helpers unbelieving fiends
 Instead of the ones who believe.
 If any do so, there will be
 No help from Allah in the spree;
 Except they take such friends in case
 Of danger to protect the face.
 But Allah warns you of His awe,
 The final goal is to Allah.
 29 Say "It does not matter at all
 Whether you hide your hearts' *recall*
 Or show it *to the world to fall*,
 Allah knows it and everything.
 He knows what's under the sky's *wing*,
 And what is on the earth *to ring*.
 Allah's power's over everything.
 30 "On the day when each soul will be
 Faced with all the good done *in spree*
 And all the wickedness *in tale*,
 Then she'll wish there were a great vale
 Between her and her wickedness.
 But Allah warns you of His own.
 Allah's kind to His servants *known*."

Beloved, I am a hermit on the hill
 That overlooks the lake as to fulfil
 The prophecy that St. Bean in his stride
 Along the sands and pebbles had implied.
 I have no friends or enemies of late,
 So very few to love and none to hate,
 That I look on this sign that I should not
 Take friends among the unbelieving lot

As something vaguely ludicrous in slot.
Beloved, my hermitage is on the road,
And many pass it with or without load,
And some stop to remark the dog is there
To bark a greeting with his measured care,
But none are friends or enemies, I swear.

31 Say "If you love Allah, then follow.
Allah will love you and will swallow
Your sins. For Allah's quick to give
Forgiveness and kind *to let live*.

32 Say "Obey Allah and the one
That He has sent with message done."
But if they turn back as from wraith,
Allah loves no rejecting faith.

33 Allah chose Adam, Noah too,
The family of Abraham's crew,
And 'Imran's family over all,
34 Descendants each of other's stall.
Allah hears and knows every *call*.

35 See a woman of 'Imran said
"O my Lord! I give to You *spread*
What's in my belly to be led
In Your own service, so receive
This from me, since You *in reprieve*
Hear and know all things *in the sleeve*.

36 When she had given birth, she said
"O my Lord! See, a girl child bred!"
And Allah knew best what she bore.
No way is a boy good in store
As is a girl. I name her Mary,
And I set her and her child chary
Under Your care from wicked one,
The one rejected when he's done."

37 In grace her Lord accepted her.
He made her increase in the stir
Of purity and beauty sure;

To care for Zakariah's cure
She was appointed. Every time
He came to her room where resigned
He found her nourished. So he said
"O Mary! How is this you're fed?
She said "From Allah, Allah gives
The nourishment to him who lives
Beneath His pleasure vastly spread."

Immaculate conception's not perhaps
Meant in so early a text for a lapse,
But consecration at least appears here
To keep both Mary and her mother clear.
I do not see the reason on this earth

For arguing about the virgin's birth,
But if we must know every detail now,
Let this be set down on my doubting brow.
Beloved, I do believe good Mary pure
Upon the day of birth if not more sure
From her conception till the day when she
Be raised up from the dead eternally
To reign beside Your throne, and cast a
prayer
For all her children's children everywhere.

38 So Zakariah prayed his Lord
And said "O my Lord! Grant restored
To me from You a progeny
That's pure, for You hear every plea."

39 While he was standing there in prayer

Within the room, the angels' bear
Him their message, "Allah will give
You good news of John, who will live
To bear the testimony true
Of a Word from Allah and who
Is noble, pure, a prophet too,
From the good and the righteous crew."

40 He said "O my Lord! How shall I
Have son, seeing I'm not spry,
And my wife is a barren sigh?"

"So" was the answer and reply,
"God brings about His will thereby."

41 He said "My Lord! Give me a sign!"
"Your sign," was the reply's design,
"Will be that you will fail to speak
To anyone for three days' peak
Except by hand signals and weak.
So raise your Lord's praises again,
And glorify Him *among men*
When evening comes and morn in glen."

Beloved, let me not ask You for a sign.
It would be to cruel to make me resign
To silence for a day. I raise a voice
In constant complaint as well as rejoice
In these ghazal sonnets uttered for choice.
Do not give me, Beloved a sign in fine.
Let me rather still live in silence met
Since the last time You spoke to chosen set
When Jesus was still living on the earth.
Let me keep living in Your voice's dearth.
It was enough You spoke on Sinai then,
It did suffice You sent the dove and wren
On Jesus Christ and thundered before men.
Beloved, be silent. Do not speak again.

42 See how the angels said "O Mary!
Allah has chosen you like cherry
And cleansed you and elected you
Above all nations' women too.

43 "So Mary, worship piously
Your Lord, prostrating, bowing see
With those who bow down prayerfully."

44 This is part of the good news brought
Of unseen things revealed and taught
To you by inspiration got.

You were not of the ones who made
With arrows divination stayed,
To find out who in the parade
Should be responsible and staid
To take care of Mary unpaid,
Nor were you there debating grade.

45 See how the angels said "O Mary,
Allah gives you good news to pary,
A Word from Him, his name will be
Christ Jesus, the son of Mary,
Renowned in this earth and to see
In the hereafter with those near
To Allah *and with righteous fear*.

46 He'll address his people as child
And as a man *not over wild*.
And he shall be among the throng
Of those who sing a righteous song."

Some find a contradiction written here
That the name Jesus or Yeshua dear
Was given to the Virgin Mary when
The Gospel says that Joseph heard it then.
Some find a straw that the Qur'an relates
A miracle of the Christ Child's estates
In talking from the cradle to improve
His mother's reputation they would move.
Beloved, I do not grasp at flaws to find
A reason to live on the earth unkind,
But in my heart submit my will to You,
And leave the rest to sing in their own pew.
I do not care if Torah or the Psalms
Or Gospel or Qur'an bring me Your calms.

47 She said "My Lord! Shall such a wrong
Come on me I should have a child,
When no man has touch me in mild?"
He said "Just so. Allah creates
What He desires. And when He states
His plan He only says the word
"Be" and see how it has occurred.

I do not doubt Creator of all things
Is able to create a child with wings
And in the womb without a male who
flings

His seed about society for stings.
It's foolish men who doubt what You can
do,

And doubt again what they have here in
view.

It is no care for truth that makes them rush
To ridicule the virgin birth in crush.
What I doubt, my Beloved, is why in world
You'd put a prophet's mother through such
swirled

Accusing and a whispering that she
Was a woman of low morality.
This is no sign. It's rather a poor stroke
To lay upon a mother and a bloke.

48 "And Allah will teach him the book
And wisdom, and Torah and hook
Of the Gospel, 49 "and so make him
A messenger to the not dim
Children of Israel: 'I come
To you with a sign from the thumb
Of your Lord, as I make for you
Out of the clay a bird in view
And breathe upon it, and by leave
Of Allah the sands do receive
Bird's life. And I heal those born blind,
And lepers, and raise the dead lined,
By God's permission, and proclaim
To you what you will eat by name,
And what to store in your household.
Truly there's a sign for you when
You will believe *the word again*.

50 'So I affirm the Torah which
Came before me, and to raise pitch
To make it legal for you what
In part was forbidden and shut;
I've brought you a sign from your Lord.
So fear Allah, obey my word.

51 Allah's my Lord and your Lord too,
So worship Him. This is the due
And straight pathway of what to do."

Some take the story of the sandy bird
That came alive when Jesus spoke the word
As proof the Qur'an is a book absurd,
For quoting of apocryphal unheard.

Some take the confirmation of Torah
To show that the Qur'an's come from Allah,
And hold it in faith before other awe
Despite the sand-build bird and the bird's
claw.

Beloved, make me a man of faith to know
That Your word comes in Arabic not slow
As well as in the Hebrew and the Greek
And Aramaic Jesus came to speak.
To quote the right from the wrong Gospel
makes
No difference at all, it makes no shakes.

52 When Jesus saw their unbelief,
He said "Who'll come to my relief
For Allah's aid?" Disciples said
"We're Allah's helpers, we've been led
To believe in Allah, and you
May testify we're Muslims too.
53 "Our Lord, we believe what You've
shown,

We follow the messenger *flown*,
And so inscribe us among those
Who testify *in rhyme and prose*."
54 Connivingly they laid their plans,
And Allah also set His scans,
And the best plotter *of them all*
Is Allah, *who will never fall*.
55 See Allah said "Now Jesus, I
Will take you and raise to the sky
To Myself and then justify
You from those who come to blaspheme:
I'll make your followers supreme
Above those who reject belief,
To Resurrection Day's relief;
Then you will all come back to Me,
And I will judge of your decree
In issues where you disagree.
56 "As for those who will disbelieve,
I'll punish them without reprieve
In this world and that one to come,
And they'll be without help *in sum*.
57 "As for those who believe and do
Right acts, Allah will give in due
Of their reward; but Allah will
Not love those who do wicked still.
58 "This is what We repeat to you
Of verses, wisdom's message true."
59 The likeness of Jesus before
Allah is like in Adam's score,
He created him from the dust

Then said to him: "Be" So he must.

Beloved, You utter but one word to me
That echoes through the universe "Let be!"
The breath of that one glowing word I find
Upon my lips, Your divine kiss designed
To waken me from death from breath to
breath,
The word of life from You outreaching
death.
I take its sweetness on my tongue, its glow
Enlightens the dark cave of stone below
My heart, impregnates my gaunt soul and
last
Breaks out in birth to leave my hopes
aghast,
And sets the gallows for my quivering heap
Of flesh content to be and being keep
The miracle of guidance and creation,
Who bear one man, like Hagar, and a
nation.

60 The truth from your Lord: do not be
Among those who live doubtfully.
61 If anyone comes to debate
Of this with you, now that not late
The knowledge has filled you, then say
"Hear, let's come together a day,
Our sons and your sons and our wives
And your wives too, all for our lives,
And let's pray fervently and call
The curse of Allah on the stall
Of those who lying would appal."
62 This is the right report: There's no
God except Allah in the show,
And Allah, He's truly the high
In strength and wisdom to come nigh.
63 If they turn back, then Allah knows
The mischief done by all of those.

Why do I disremember these fine words
When people come presenting me with
turds
Of doctrines false and fabulous in herds?
Please, my Beloved, remind me of this act
Of sacrifice before the divine pact,
And I shall not respond with rank and rail,
But calmly challenge all who would assail
To pray for lightning to strike them if they
Are preaching the false thing upon a day.
The truth is all men fail at some point here,

And give up breath and lie upon the bier,
While those who still believe in them shed
tear.

This test in time will prove all human
speech

Was the wrong thing for unsent men to
preach.

64 Say "O you people of the Book!

Let's come to an agreement, look,
Between us and you, that we do

Not worship anyone as due

But Allah." If then they turn back,

Say "Testify we have no slack
In being Muslims on the track."

65 You people of the Book, why do

You argue about Abraham,

When Torah and Gospel in cam

Were not revealed till after him?

Has your understanding turned dim?

66 Well you're the ones who argued here

Of issues even that were clear.

So why argue now about things

Of which you have no slight inklings?

Allah's the one who knows, but you

Have nothing at all in your view.

67 Abraham was neither a Jew

Nor Christian, but he was one true

In faith, not joining gods in crew

As equal with Allah in due.

68 There is no doubt the people who

Are nearest in relation true

To Abraham are those who take

Him for example as in stake

Do this Prophet and those who make

Profession of their faith. Allah

Protects those who hold Him in awe.

69 Some of the people of the Book

Want to lead you out of your nook.

But they cause only themselves to

Stray and don't notice what they do.

Instead of arguing of Trinity,

Let me propose a pact among the free

Who come to tell me my salvation's fee

Is paid in part when I accept the three,

Otherwise I am bound for the degree

Of lowest hell. I shall say to such men,

Let's come together and so once agree

To worship none but the one God again.

Beloved, it is no matter of debate,

Or how to get a better answer's rate

In argument. No logic can relate

To true love. So humanity for me

Brooks no advance beyond that charity.

I find myself still hanging round the gate.

70 You people of the book, why do

You deny Allah's signs in pew

Of which you witness in your view?

71 You people of the book, why make

The truth appear as falsehood's wake

And hide the truth knowing the stake?

72 Some of the people of the book

Say "Believe at dawn what it shook

To the believers, but deny

It as the day ends *in the sky*,"

Maybe they will turn back *and die*.

73 "But do not believe anyone

Unless he's in your faith as one."

Say "Real guidance is Allah's,

And lest a revelation's laws

Come to another like the one

That was sent to you, have you done?

Or that such people who receive

It should argue without reprieve

Before your Lord?" Say "All things lie

In Allah's hand, who grants on high

To those He wills, and Allah cares

For all and knows all things in shares."

I have not heard the Christians who live
near

Say to believe at dawn and then appear

At dusk in doubt and in disbelief's leer,

But give and earn may well show me one
day

A greater knowledge of the world for pay.

I also doubt the way, Beloved, You make

Adherents of my own sect only take

The witness stand for truth. My days have
shown

But few men anywhere can give a loan

Of truth at all, no matter to which church

Or synagogues they belong to for perch.

The mosque is no improvement nor the line

Of temple song and dance with, without
wine.

Send me a sect that's true or let me pine.

74 In His own mercy He elects

The ones He will, and so selects

Allah from the bounties His own
Unbounded from before His throne.
75 Some of the people of the book
Entrusted with gold treasure's brook
Would pay it back, but other who
Were just one silver coin and new
Entrusted, would not pay it back
Though you stood claiming it, because
They say "There's nothing in the laws
To hold us to ignorant paws."
But they lie about Allah then
And know they lie *before all men*.

76 No. Those who keep their contracts
made

And act in honesty portrayed,
Truly Allah loves their parade.
77 As for those who barter away
The faith they owe to Allah's sway
And their own promised contracts' pay
For a small recompense, they'll get
No part in the hereafter met.
Allah will not speak to them nor
Give them a glance come to the door
Of Judgement, nor will purify
Them: they'll be punished then to die.

The issue rises often, if the pay
Of interest is immoral all the way
Or can be taken from the heathen bay.
Much like it is the thought that honesty
Is owed only to those who faithfully
Belong to the same loving sect as I.
Excuse for usury can just rely
Upon the Bible, but the scope to steal
Is not so easy before such appeal.
It's genocide, not theft, that's justified
By Scriptures lying with a beef to bide.
Beloved, give me no faith at all, I pray,
So that I can get up at dawn and stay
Both moral and alive before the grey.

78 Some of them corrupt what the book
Says by the tongues they cannot brook,
As they recite what you would think
Is part of the book, but is stink,
And say "This is from Allah's brink"
While it is not by any link,
But they tell lies about Allah
And know it too, *though without awe*.
79 No man who's given book, insight,
And the prophetic office right,

Should tell the people "Worship me
Rather that Allah in decree,"
But rather "Worship only him
Who is the true Lord of all grim,
For you have taught the Book and know
To study it with fervent glow."

80 Such a one would not teach to take
Angels and prophets by mistake
For lords and masters. Now would he
Turn you to unbelief's degree
When you'd submit to God's decree?

81 See, Allah made the prophets swear,
Saying "I give you a book rare
And wisdom, and then comes to you
A messenger saying what's true
That's with you in the book in pew,
And so believe and help his due."

Allah said "Do you acquiesce
And take My pact in your address?"
They said "We do so and confess."
He said "Then testify that I
Am with you and to testify."

82 So those who turn back after this
Are the transgressors *and they miss*.

83 Do they look for some other thing
Than the faith of Allah *to ring*,
When to Him do submit all those
In the heavens and *in their rows*
On earth, whether they will or not,
And to Him they'll return *from plot*.

The thing some claim is in the Bible word
That the Qur'an condemns when it is heard
Is the claim that You are a single God
In three divided on the earthly sod.
The texts shown by researchers to have
been,

If true, are often those that fit the sin,
Support, if they support, in some small way
The doctrine of the Trinity in sway.
Beloved, I take the Scriptures as they stand,
And follow Bible at Qur'an's command,
And find consistency upon the land.
My light and life depart from what men
think
Is written in the course of pen and ink,
To stand on windswept peaks and on the
brink.

84 Say "We have faith here in Allah,
And in what's come to us in awe,

And what was revealed Abraham,
 Ishmael, Isaac, Jacob *with dam*,
 And the tribes, and in what was sent
 To Moses, Jesus, and was lent
 The prophets from their Lord: we make
 No distinction between the one
 And other among them when done,
 And to Allah submit when run.
 85 Whoever seeks religion met
 Other than submission as let
 To Allah never shall receive
 His approbation or reprieve,
 And in the next world he will be
 Among the losers' company.
 86 How shall Allah guide those who come
 To deny the faith like a bum
 After they had accepted it
 And bore witness as true *and fit*
 Was the Apostle, and denied
 The clear signs coming to their side?
 But Allah does not guide at all
 An unjust people *who appal*.

There is no difference that I can make
 Between the prophets sent for human sake.
 For all alike preach of Your unity,
 Teach to submit to You in charity.
 The labels that men give hide just one
 thing,
 Refusal to submit to divine King.
 A Christian, Muslim, Jew is just a name
 Expressing deviation into shame.
 The difference in practice prophets give
 Is just local response to how men live.
 O my Beloved, I lay hold on Your Self
 And leave the man-made bargains on the
 shelf.
 I do not slice the world in portions, but
 Submit to guidance from Your hand
 unshut.

87 These have as their return to find
 Laid on them the curse and the bind
 Of Allah, angels, and mankind.
 88 That's why they shall remain in their
 Torment without abate in share.
 89 Except for those who after this
 Repent and change the ways they kiss,
 For truly Allah does not miss
 In mercy and forgiveness' bliss.
 90 Truly unfaithful who believe

And after their belief receive
 Increase of infidelity,
 Shall never have any reprieve
 For their repentance in degree,
 And these have gone astray *and leave*.
 91 As to those who reject faith, and
 Die rejecting, will never stand
 Accepted though in ransom they
 Should offer all the gold in pay
 That earth contains. For such men there
 Awaits a penalty and rare,
 And they'll find none to help their share.

No ransom is enough, Beloved, to stay
 The loving heart. You stroke both night and
 day
 The soul's damp cheeks, refusing to give
 up
 The chosen one, but share her crust and
 cup.
 She sees no shadow of Your coming,
 knows
 No sound of footstep at the evening's close,
 She shuffles through her fasting and her
 prayers
 Beneath Your soft caresses unawares.
 But fast on fast and prayer on prayer she
 gives
 In hopes a world of gold, so long she lives,
 Might touch Your heart with mercy for her
 sins.
 She does not realize what offering wins.
 What sacrifices cannot buy is free:
 The loving heart tuned to reality.

92 You'll never attain righteousness
 Until you give away the fuss
 Of what you love, and what you give
 Allah knows all *of it to live*.
 93 All food was allowed to the folk
 Of Israel except what he spoke
 Before the Torah was sent down.
 Say "Then bring here the Torah's crown
 And read if you're of truth's renown."
 94 Whoever will invent a lie
 About Allah after this try
 Is among the unjust, oh my.

The Qur'an here states that the diet spoken
 Of in the Torah was not just a token

For time and place, but ought to be read
now
To find out what to eat and when and how.
That flies in the face of Islamic code
Based on traditions and where ijma rode,
And sends me back to Torah with its sound
Of lovely Hebrew words upon the ground.
Beloved, I follow the holy Qur'an
Back to the Torah's statutes read in plan,
And find Your footprints everywhere I scan
The squared, once modern letters that
reveal

The trumpetings and twitterings that steel
My soul for life and love down to the heel.

95 Say "Allah's spoken truth, and so
Follow creed of Abraham's row,
The upright in faith on the go,
Who fled idolatrous in show.
96 Truly the first house made mankind
Is the one at Makkah to find,
Blessed and guidance for the world's mind.
97 In it are clear signs: there where stood
Abraham, who enters for good
Is safe; and for Allah: all must
Make pilgrimage to the house trust,
For those who have the means to go.
And whoever denies the show,
Truly God is not bound to what
The world has or has never cut.
98 Say "O you people of the book,
Why do you deny signs and look
Not to Allah? Truly Allah
Is witness of your nail and claw."
99 Say "O you people of the book,
Why do you prevent those who look
To believe in path of Allah,
And try to make it lose in awe
As crooked? You bear witness that
God does not ignore what you're at."
100 O you who believe, if you stay
Obedient to a group in sway
Among those who have once received
The book, they will turn you deceived
Back into infidels once you
Have believed *in the great and true*.
101 How can you disbelieve while signs
Of Allah are recited lines
To you, and His messenger too
Is among you? The ones who hold
Fast to Allah are guided bold

Already to the right path's fold.
101 O you who believe, fear Allah,
As you should do, and keep in awe
But to die as submitted *there*
As Muslims beneath Allah's care.
103 And so hold fast by Allah's cord
Together and do not be scored
In sects, but remember restored
The bounty of Allah bestowed
On you; when you were enemies
He bound your hearts in love's decrees,
And so by His grace you've become
Brothers snatched from the brink of hell
From which He has saved you in spell.
So Allah makes clear His signs too
So you might be guided in view.

O my Beloved! The Gospel of grace I
Have loved much, sovereign grace whereby
You save the souls of the elect appears
Within this miracle of mighty seers.
While Christian, Muslim, humanist and
crew
Of every pagan shape and pagan crew
Work out their own salvation as their due,
I cast away all hopes but those in You.
The Bible and Qur'an join in one faith
Of a true living God and not a wraith,
Of sovereign God whose will is ever shown
From the eternity of divine throne.
O my Beloved, spend power and grace on
me
That I too enter in eternity.

104 And let there be among you too
A group who invite to virtue,
Enjoining good, forbidding wrong,
And these are ones who get along.
105 Do not be like the ones who got
Divided in sects for the plot
Of disagreeing with the light
Of evidence there in their sight,
For whom a great torment is right.
106 The day some faces will be bright
And some will be dark in their sight,
To the dark ones turned will be told,
"What! Did you disbelieve at last
After having heard the truth cast?
Then taste the punishment you gain
For what you disbelieved in vain."
107 And to those whose faces are bright

Shall come Allah's mercy in sight,
There they'll abide *both day and night*.

108 These are Allah's signs we recite
To you in truth, and Allah plans
No injustice on human bans.

109 To Allah's what's in heaven above,
To Him what's on the earth *for love*,
To Allah return all *for shove*.

110 We are the best of folk who rose
For humankind, exhorting those
To right, and forbidding the wrong,
Believing in Allah along.

If only people of the book
Had faith, it would be better look,
Among them some have faith, but most
Of them are wicked sinners' *toast*.

Enjoining what is right, forbidding wrong,
What courage is required to sing that song!
The human heart will always take a part
Of right and reject much of wrong to start,
But when a matter rises in the flesh
Discernment of what's just lies in the mesh.
Divine proof and its guidance only can
Free human hearts and wills, enlighten man
And woman, point in the right way for
good.

Beloved, give me the knowledge of the
right
And let me not depart from what I should,
And I shall strive to stand tall in Your
sight,
Maintaining right, forbidding wrong and
going
With courage from Your heart and from
Your knowing.

111 They'll never harm you, but in slight,
They'll turn and run who come to fight,
They'll have no help in their place tight.
112 They're cast low everywhere they're
found,

Except under a pact when bound
To Allah and humans renowned.
They've brought down Allah's wrath, and
shame

Is seared on them, and all for blame
They used to deny Allah's laws
And killed His prophets without cause,
All this because they disobeyed
And used to wander as they strayed.

113 They're not alike, folk of the book,
Some come recite Allah's signs, look,
All through the night, and bowing down
In adoration to the crown.

114 They believe in Allah and in
The final day, praise good and sin
Forbid, and hurry to do right:
These are the righteous ones in sight.

115 And whatsoever good they do
They shall not be denied in pew,
God keeps the pious ones in view.

116 But as for those who disbelieve,
No wealth nor children give reprieve
Against God's judgements, they receive
Abode in hell always to grieve.

117 What they've spent in this worldly life
Is like a freezing wind of strife,
Which breaks upon a people's field
You have done wrong, so it will yield
A bare destruction. Allah did
Them no injustice, but they hid
Themselves in unjust acts to bid.

Double predestination in the church
Of Calvin has left many in the lurch,
But the Qur'an shows clearly that those
who

Go down to their destruction in a crew
Reap but reward of the things that they do.
God perpetrates no injustice to man,
But only mercy destined from His plan.
The Qur'an is a Baptist book to scan.
Beloved, I praise You for the mercy set
Upon the saints elected and well met
To do the works divine that You propose.
I praise You for the choice of rows on rows
Who go in ignorance as though they chose
The fire instead of what the saints will get.

118 You who believed, do not take friends
Except among those whose amends
Make them fellows in your belief.
They will corrupt and bring you grief.
They hope only for your distress.
They with their own mouths spite express.
But what's hidden in their breasts goes
Beyond that in evil they chose.
We've made clear signs for you if you
Come to understand what's in view.

119 See, you love them, but as for them,
They do not love you like a gem

Despite your loving the whole book.
 On meeting they say "We believe,"
 But when they're elsewhere they bite nails
 In rage against you. Tell them tales:
 "Die in your rage." Allah knows true
 What's in folk's hearts hidden from view.
 120 They're grieved for any good that
 comes

To you, and if evil thing hums
 To you, they rejoice at the sight.
 But if you're patient and keep right
 Their craft will not harm you: Allah
 Knows everything that's in their crawl.
 121 And when you set out before dawn
 From you family drawing on
 To prepare for believers then
 The camp for battle, then again
 Allah hears and knows of the drawn.
 122 When two of your grown thought
 retreat,

And Allah guarded both their feet,
 In Allah should believers meet.
 123 Truly Allah has nourished you
 At Badr when you were a crew
 Of sorry weak men, so refuge take
 In Allah for thanksgiving's sake.
 124 When you said to believers then
 "Is it not enough once again
 That your Lord help you with the band
 Of three thousand of angels' stand
 Sent down *from heaven upon the land*?
 125 If you steadfastly refuge take
 In Allah and the foe awake
 Upon you in vehement wake,
 Your Lord will aid you with a band
 Of five thousand angels to land
 All of renown *on every hand*.

126 Allah did not mean this to be
 But good news for you and so free
 Your hearts in certainty, and there
 Is no help but in Allah's share,
 The Mighty and the Wise *to care*.
 127 That He might cut off some of those
 Who do not have faith in His pose,
 Or throw them down so they retreat
 In disappointment *and defeat*.
 128 Naught of power is for you at all,
 Whether He turns in mercy's call
 Or punishes them in sin's thrall.

The Christian missionaries in old time

Took sword to sprinkle converts in their
 prime.

The Christian missionaries of this age
 Follow the businessmen to find the gauge
 Of selling points to print on heart and hand
 The impress of their violence to stand.
 But truth is that there is no power of man
 Can influence salvation by a span,
 And it is not man's business to return
 Upon the fate of those elect to burn
 And those plucked from the burning by the
 might

Of sovereign grace before Jehovah's sight.
 Beloved, punish whom You will in Your
 right,
 And show Your mercy by Your day or
 night.

129 To Allah belongs all that's in
 The heavens and on earth to spin.
 He forgives whom He pleases and
 Punishes whom He wills in hand,
 But Allah's Oft-Forgiving too,
 Most Merciful *of all who do*.

Who patiently continue in well-doing
 Shall have five thousand angels at the
 shewing
 Of battle and before the enemy.
 Rush to attack and hotly, though I see
 The enemy in violence go on,
 Yet I in peaceful prayer, and at the dawn,
 Seek patience in right-doing and not wrong.
 The arms of mass destruction for a song,
 The violence of otherness I sell,
 And buy from You the right and doing
 well.

In Your name and for peace I lay the act
 Of every good deed that I can infract.
 A multitude of small good deeds can show
 The bombs as well as bombers where to go.

130 O you of faith, do not devour
 Compounding interest by the hour,
 Seek refuge in Allah so you
 Will be just a successful crew.

131 Fear the hell fire that is prepared
 For the faithless ones *who've not cared*.

132 Obey God and the one He's sent
 As one on whom His mercy's spent.

133 Rush to forgiveness from your Lord

And to the Paradise restored
Beyond the vastness of the sky
And the earth made for the glad cry
Of righteous one *and for their hoard*.

When Torah forbade usury in time
Of Israelitic faith, it was no crime
To take it from the infidel for rhyme.
When the Qur'an in glorious array
Came down from heaven to touch the
earthly sway,
It made no difference in churchly pay,
But forbade usury to straight and gay
In every company and faith astray.
Beloved, the root of war is in the tale
Of thinking gold can reproduce like whale.
The nonsense implied in the interest fee
Is that gold multiplies grown on a tree.
Without Your sovereign grace all men
remain
Dead in their sins, hearts and minds under
stain.

134 Those who give alms no matter what
Of their prosperity in glut
Or of their poverty, and who
Restrain their anger and as due
Forgive men, for Allah is true
To love those who do well in view.

135 Those who when they do shameful
things,
Committing wrong against their springs,
Remember Allah and beg Him
Forgiveness for their sins with vim:
Who's there to pardon sins but God?
Those who do not intend to keep
On doing what they've done to weep,
And know *the sinful way is steep*.
136 For such, their reward is to get
Forgiveness from their Lord and set
In gardens under which their flow
Their rivers, and abide there so,
And fine is the reward of those
Who act *in righteousness to close*.
137 Truly there have in times past come
Examples for you in their sum,
So travel here and there and see
The end of their rejecting spree.
138 This proclamation's clear for men,
And guiding warning come again
To pious ones and faithfully.

The catch is that not all men can repent,
But only those to whom You will relent
And give the sovereign grace to know their
sins

Have risen up to indict fallen wins.
The catch is that repentance is a thing
Beyond the reach of pauper and of king,
But only You, Beloved, can touch the heart
And make repentance arise from the start.
Beloved, I seek not gardens and the streams
Of heavenly fountains beyond human
dreams,
Nor great rewards for good I may have
done,
For the grace of repentance under sun.
I follow the Qur'an to seek that way
Of living in Your shadow day by day.

139 Do not lose courage, do not grieve,
For you will gain higher reprieve,
If you're those who truly believe.
140 If you are hurt, then so are they.
In such times as the present day,
We bring things to each one in turn,
That God may know those who don't spurn,
And take witnesses among you,
God does not love the unjust crew.
141 So God may cleanse those who
believe,
Destroy faithless without reprieve.
142 Do you expect just to go in
To Paradise *with all your sin*?
For God has not yet brought to light
Those of you who struggle for right
And those who persevere despite?
143 You truly wished for death to come
Before you met its *face in sum*,
So now you truly saw it here,
While you looked on it *strong and clear*.
144 Muhammad's just a messenger,
Other such ones passed before him,
So if he dies or it occur
That he is slain, are you so dim
To retreat? Those who do retreat
Will not harm Allah or defeat,
And soon Allah will give reward
To those who're grateful to their Lord.
145 It's not for any soul to die
Except by Allah's leave *and cry*
According to the decree that

Fixes the term *that each life sat*.
 The one who in this world desires
 Reward receives from Allah's fires,
 And the one who desires reward
 In the hereafter from his Lord,
 We give him that, it's soon that We
 Shall reward acting gratefully.
 146 How many prophets came and strove
 Where thousands of just men arose,
 And did not fall discouraged by
 The things that fell on them to try
 In Allah's way, nor become weak
 Nor shame themselves in what they speak,
 And God loves perseverant guy.
 147 They only said in prayer, "O Lord,
 Forgive us of our sins and hoard
 Of going too far in our acts,
 And make our feet strong in Your pacts,
 And help against infidel horde."
 148 And Allah gave them in this world
 Reward, more excellent unfurled
 In that to come, and truly God
 Loves those who do well on the sod.

Beloved, my prayer too consists of four
 things

Spoken in air and having taken wings:
 Forgive my sin, forgive exaggeration,
 Set my feet in Your path and generation,
 And aid me by destruction of the nation
 Of wicked evil-doers that for spite
 Come up against me in this mortal fight.
 Just four things are enough for my prayer's
 stings.

For my four in petition, You descend
 To give a trinity of things to mend:
 Reward in this life fraught with cares and
 hope,
 The crown of life snatched from the hand
 of pope,
 And love for me when I do right in scope.
 Let me do right just once in what You send.

149 O you who have believed, if you
 Follow advice of faithless crew,
 They'll make you retreat from the true,
 So you will be the losers too.

150 No! Allah is your guardian here,
 The best of helpers to appear.

151 We'll cast dread into faithless hearts,
 Because they set up by their arts

Things with God that He does not say
 Are valid, and that's why they stay
 In hell-fire. How bad is the place
 Where dwell the unjust of the race!

Hell's not alone the coming fire and heat,
 But is the place to which men now retreat
 From serving You alone out on the beat.
 Hell is a place that now seems cool and
 sweet,

Where wealth is squandered, trampled
 under feet

Of the oppressor out to catch fallout
 From bombs exploded to deplete in rout
 Old stores of obsolete that cost a lot
 To keep and not use against hands
 uncaught.

Hell's not the future state, hell's with us
 now,

Despite unworry on boardroom and brow.
 Beloved, save me and mine from hell
 below

The false dawn of night city and its glow,
 From field machined and failing garden
 plot.

152 Truly Allah's fulfilled His promise
 To you, when *unlike doubting Thomas*,
 You were destroying by His will,
 Until you flinched *from off your hill*,
 Disputing the command and so
 Fell into disobeying's row,
 After which He revealed to you
 What you loved by the things you do.
 Some of you love this world, and some
 Love that to come. In your retreat
 He proved you, which of you were meet,
 And has forgiven you. Indeed,
 Allah's the Lord of grace in need
 For those who believe *without greed*.

153 Remember when you ran away
 From the hill suddenly in sway,
 Not looking back, while the Sent One
 Called you behind *in vain when done*,
 So He poured on you punishment
 Upon your anguish that was sent,
 So you might not grieve at your loss,
 Or what fell on you as a cross,
 And Allah well knows what you've lent.

154 After the pain Allah sent you
 Safety, the sleeping of a few,

While others just thinking of self,
 Thought unjustly of Allah's shelf,
 In ignorance thinking untrue.
 They say "What gain's for us in this
 Authority?" Say this they miss:
 "Authority's just God's to kiss."
 They kept secreted in themselves
 What they would not reveal for elves
 To you, and say "If we had not
 Had part in authority's plot,
 We never would have been killed there."
 Say "If you had stayed home with care,
 Those who were ordained to be slain
 Would have gone out into the plain
 Where they now lie dead, so God might
 Prove what was in hearts out of sight,
 And cleanse your hearts, for Allah knows
 All that within human breasts grows."
 155 Truly those who retreated when
 The armies met, it was the den
 Of Satan made them slip, because
 They had disobeyed of God's laws.
 And truly God has pardoned them,
 God's oft forgiving, patient gem.

Three elements appear to take the cake:
 The sins of men and what they come to
 make,
 The acts of Satan in the worldly stake,
 And power of God above all human rake.
 How this might differ from the doctrine
 found
 Among the Calvinists upon the ground
 I dare not say. Predestination's round.
 All do agree about the fiery lake.
 Beloved, I see the world of men depraved,
 And his free will bent to evil enslaved,
 But against that divine election sure
 Comes to propose the right for chosen pure.
 Your grace is irresistible to men,
 And so You keep them till Christ comes
 again.

156 You who believe, don't be like those
 Who disbelieve, who said and chose
 That their brothers who travel round
 The world and fight upon the ground,
 "If they had stayed with us, they'd not
 Have died slain in their fighting's plot."
 So God might put grief in their hearts
 Regretting their combative parts.

And it's Allah who brings both life
 And death when caught up in the strife,
 And God sees all you do *in arts*.
 157 And if you're killed in Allah's way,
 Or if you die, then pardon's sway
 Come from Allah and mercy's day
 Is better than all of their pay.
 158 For if you die or if you're killed,
 Truly in Allah you'll be filled.
 159 So it's mercy of Allah you
 Are soft with all of them in crew.
 If you'd been harsh, hard-hearted too,
 They would have scattered from your pew.
 So forgive them, for them seek grace
 Of pardon, and give them a place
 In council. But when things are set,
 Put your trust in Allah to get
 From Allah love He has for those
 Who trust Him *as He Himself chose*.
 160 If God helps you, no one can win
 Against you; but then in the din
 If He abandons you, then who
 Can ever help you in to-do
 After that? That's why on Allah
 Should the believers place their awe.

The argument stands only if we take
 A grain of Calvin for election's stake.
 We live or die by Allah's hand and will,
 In Samarcand or Rome or on the hill
 Of Ohad when the enemy came out
 To cut off those who had not heard the
 shout.
 You lead some into death and some to hell,
 You lend some men Your breath for just a
 spell,
 But in the end all come before Your face
 And all are judged as lacking without
 grace.
 Beloved, I take no word for an excuse
 To unhinge life of others in abuse,
 And so fail to move on, still a recluse,
 From what the horde reveals in fight
 defuse.

161 No prophet should defraud a man.
 Those who defraud will bring in span
 Their gain on resurrection day,
 And every soul will get the pay
 Of what he earned, and no one then
 Shall be unjustly treated men.

162 Is one who stays in God's delight
Like one who rouses God's wrath's sight
And whose abode shall be in hell,
An evil end *after a spell?*

163 They're of diverse bands with Allah,
And Allah sees what's in their claw.

164 God was with the believers when
He raised up a messenger then
From among them to recite them
His miracles and cleanse *like gem*,
And teach them the book and wisdom,
Though before in error *in sum*.

If men are of two kinds, and some are those
Who stay in Your delight, while some
arose

To stay in hell through all eternity,
Then it is sure that You have faithfully
Created the two kinds of men to be.
Those who are made in Your delight have
found

Themselves sometimes in error on the
ground,

But You are faithful then to bring the sound
Of cantillated Scripture to the ear,
And cleanse by the sound men from every
fear

And wicked way. Thus You regenerate
The chosen dead in sins to find the gate
Of paradise before the earth and sky
Fail from the age of time without reply.

165 What! When misfortune fell on you
After you had done on the crew
Two times as much damage in view,
You said "Why this?" Tell them "This
thing

Is from your own selves in failing,
Truly Allah's on all things king."

166 What happened to you on the day
That two armies engaged that way
Was by God's leave so He might know
Who are believers *in the show*.

167 And that He might find out the ones
Who are dissembling on their buns,
And it was said to them, "Now come,
And fight in Allah's way in sum,
Or in defence." They said "If we
Had known the art of armoury,
We would indeed have followed free."
Closer to infidelity

Were they that day than faith in fee,
Their lips saying what was not found
In their hearts but Allah is sound
To know all they've kept hidden ground.
168 They're such as say while sitting round,
"If they had lent to us unbound
Their ears they would not now be found
Killed." Say "Then keep death from
yourselves,
If you speak the truth *not like elves*."

All things are in Your hand, Beloved, and
when

The battle of Ohod fell among men,
You saw the matter and in sovereign will
Gave the retreat from off the fatal hill.
The rise and fall of breath in humankind
Is so dependent on Your grace to bind
That every moment and each breath is
signed
With miracles of the creation's find.
Beloved, I cannot keep my life at all
Much less can I create it in my stall.
And yet the cloud upon my mind and heart
Makes me pretend that I too have a part.
Remind me, my Beloved, though battles
rage,

That You are provident from age to age.

169 Do not consider dead the ones
Who're killed in Allah's way *in tonnes*,
No, they live nourished in the way
Of their Lord's presence *and His sway*.

170 They cantillate abundantly
In Allah's provisions' degree,
And as for those remaining there,
Who've not yet come into their share,
They bask in that they have no fear
And that no grief comes to appear.

171 They vaunt in Allah's grace and in
Abundance, and there stays in bin
By Allah their reward to win.

172 Those who came at the summons of
Allah and the Messenger's love,
Even after being struck down,
Those who do righteously for crown,
Avoiding evil have renown.

173 The ones who say to them "A large
Force gathers at your marge,"
Have frightened them, but it increased
Their faith, and they said "We're released

Enough in Allah, and He'll be
The best to take care of the free.”
174 They came back with grace and bounty
From Allah, no harm came to them,
Because they followed Allah's hem,
And Allah's Lord of bounties' gem.
175 The wicked one brings you to fear
His own, but do not let appear
Regard for them, but only fear
Me, if you have faith *to appear*.

The word of the Qur'an, like Gospel too,
Seems to affirm the Hellenistic crew,
Who have faith in the everlasting soul,
Immortal and immaterial toll.
But the word that would seem to take that
stand
Is followed by another on the land,
That You bring back the dead in flesh and
sin,
Not that they are immortal in the bin,
But that by sovereign grace creative act
May resurrect as well as make in fact.
Beloved, there is none who has life but You
And those to whom You give it, not a few.
When You withdraw Your hand, the breath
goes out,
The soul extinguishes without a doubt.

176 Don't be sad about those who go
In haste into destruction's show
Of disbelief. They cannot do
The least harm to Allah or rue.
Allah plans not to give reward
To them in the day of the Lord,
But punishment abundant stored.
177 Those who buy infidelity
At the price of their faith's decree,
They will not harm in least degree
Allah, but have great pain to see.
178 Let not the infidels presume
Our hesitation stops their doom.
We grant them space so they'll have room
To increase in iniquity.
But they'll be punished shamefully.
179 Allah will not leave faithful in
This kind of state they have in sin,
Till He divides evil from good,
Nor will He show behind the hood.
But He makes choice from messengers
Of His as His pleasure infers,

So have faith in Allah and in
His messengers. And without sin,
If you believe and do the right,
You'll have a reward beyond sight.

No human choice can take me from Your
hand,
Beloved, when You've brought me forth by
command
And shown Your providence in grace to
know
Repentance is my race, my race not slow.
No faithless act of human, not my own
Or any other man before Your throne
Can damage the divine will that is shown,
And if so, none can damage me below,
Since You are sovereign over all the show.
Beloved, I wait the cantillation wise
Of the Qur'an to sing above the rise
Of human acts and all men can devise.
The way may seem a rocky one of fear,
But all is safe because Allah is here.

180 Don't let those who in stingy trace
Keep back the gifts of Allah's grace
To them, think they will benefit.
No, they'll be in a greater fit.
Soon what they kept in stingy way
Be tied about their necks to sway
Like braided collar, on the day
Of judgement. To Allah belongs
Bounties of the sky and earth's *songs*,
And Allah knows well all your wrongs.
181 Allah hears those mocking who say
“Indeed Allah is poor, and we
Are rich!” So we shall certainly
Keep record of their words and see
Their killing prophets in their spite
Of what is right, and We'll requite
To say “Taste pains the fires ignite.
182 “This is for what your hands sent on
Before you, for Allah is drawn
Not to harm those who serve Him right.”

The poverty of Allah is the grand
And shining corridors that run and stand
Beyond the galaxies of stars above,
Within the divine heart's mercy and love.
Your poverty, Beloved, is greater than
The richest things that any human can,

And where the glories of the state fall
down,
You come in poverty to take the town.
Beloved, give me Your poverty and take
For Your own self the wealth for divine
sake,
And with Your poverty I shall be rich
To live in hovel and drink from the ditch.
Beloved, no harm can come to any man
But the illusion that You have no span.

183 They said "Allah regards how we
Swore not to believe in any
Messenger unless He shows us
An offering burned by igneous."
Say "There came to you messengers
Before me with clear signs for spurs
And even for the thing you wanted,
Why then did you kill them unavaunted,
If you tell the truth as occurs?"
184 If they reject you, so were they
Who were sent before you to stay,
Who came with clear signs and with books
Of obscure prophecies in nooks
And the illuminating books.
185 Everyone shall have taste of death.
On judgement day shall final breath
Of full reward be paid: for just
The one who's delivered from lust
Of fire and brought into the way
Of the garden will have the pay
Of attaining in the right way.
For this world's life is only wealth,
Deceiving herds come out in stealth.
186 Indeed, you'll be tried, tested too,
In your possessions, what you do,
You'll truly hear much to grieve you
From those who had the book e'er you,
And from the polytheist crew.
But if you keep on patiently,
And guard against iniquity,
Then that will be the thing to tell,
And keep you surely out of hell.

I wonder if Your patience is a grace
When I consider how oft in this place
Your wrath appears, at least before my
face,
Who read Your law each day in hurried
race.

Give me wrath or Your patience as You
will,
And I shall use the both with vigour still,
And find Your patience a rest for the hand
If wrath still makes me rush about the land.
Beloved, the patient one will escape hell,
But what about the one who's under spell
Of divine anger before proudful swell
Of man's rebellion? Open up the gate
Of paradise for both the love and hate,
And I shall enter in and not be late.

187 Mind how Allah made covenant
With the people of the book lent,
To reveal clear to humankind,
And not make it too hard to find.
But they cast it behind their backs,
And traded it for paltry lacks,
And so their trade was one maligned.
188 Do not consider those who joy
In what they've produced as a ploy,
Loving to take the credit for
What they have not done to restore,
They're not aware they won't escape
The punishment, for in their cape
Is a harsh penalty in store.
189 To Allah's rule of heaven and earth,
And Allah's on all things of worth.
190 In the creation of the sky
And of the earth, day and night's cry,
There are indeed signs for men who
Are aware of the things they do.
191 Men who raise the praise of Allah
While standing, sitting, and in awe
Lying upon their sides to see
Creation of the heavenly
And the earthly: "Our Lord, in vain
You've not created this in gain.
Glory to You! Deliver us
From punishment of igneous.
192 "Our Lord, indeed You such enclose
In the fire, such You give shame's clothes,
And never will the wicked ones
Find any helpers *among sons*.
193 "Our Lord, we've heard the call to
faith,
'Believe in the Lord *and not wraith*,'
And we've believed. Our Lord, forgive
Our sins, blot out here where we live
Iniquity, and take to Your
Own Self our souls within the store

Of the righteous ones *at Your door*.

194 "Our Lord, give us Your promise
through

Your messengers, and save in due
Time from shame on the judgement day,
For You never break promised sway."

195 Their Lord's accepted them, replied:

I'll never let be lost beside

The work of anyone of you,

Whether man or woman in crew,

You're members of each other too.

Those who've abandoned homes or been

Cast out, or suffered harm in sin

For My cause, fighting or been slain,

Truly I'll blot out from them plain

Their sins, and bring them in the place

Of gardens with rivers in trace

That flow beneath, reward and grace

From presence of Allah, His face

Gives best of rewards *from His reign*."

In what way did the Christians throw away

The covenant made in the Bible's day,

And cast behind their backs without regard

For love or law? What did they think too
hard?

At least two things come readily to mind:

The first is how Your unity's confined

In trinities and definitions blind;

The second is neglect of Sabbath nights

And mornings, leaving off Sabbath

delights.

Beloved, let me not take part in deceit

Of Christian falling from the right to bleat.

Let me know that You are One and alone

Upon the glorious and sovereign throne,

And meet with You on Sabbaths when I'm

grown.

196 Don't let the prideful walking round

Of unbelievers on the ground

Deceive you *with their certain sound*.

197 Pleasure is small, then their abode

At last is hell, and evil load.

198 But for those who fear their Lord, there

Are gardens with rivers in share

That flow beneath them, and there they

Will dwell *for ever and a day*,

A gift from God's presence in sway.

And what's in God's presence is best

For the righteous ones *and the blessed*.

199 Surely among folk of the book

There are some who believe and look

To Allah, and the revelation

To you and what's revealed in ration

To them, who bow down humbly to

Allah. They'll not sell the signs due

Of Allah for a paltry gain.

They have great reward with their Lord,

And Allah counts quickly the stored.

200 O you believers, persevere

In patience and steadfastness' fear.

Compete with each other in such

Patience, strengthen each other's touch,

And fear Allah to prosper much.

Deception of the heathen's all around:

The sweet tones of the Christian rise and
sound

In love with the disarming argument

That God is love in everything He's sent.

Few know how much love made the power
of Rome,

How civilized was Greece to those at
home.

The pagan though, pagan philosophy

Is clear and bright and wonderful to see.

But I, Beloved, long for that sovereignty

That is divine, Your own thought in redress

For all the things that I want to confess.

Beloved, I patiently or not receive

The heavenly melodies beyond reprieve,

The words of life sent down from Your
address.

Surah 4 Al-Nisaa, or The Woman.

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 O humankind! Reverence your Lord,

Who made you from a single cord,

Created of nature the same,

His mate and from them both in fame

Scattered unnumbered people both

Women and men; so worship just

Allah, through whom you crave as must

Your mutual duties and rights

To reverence wombs that gave to sights,

For Allah watches over you

In everything you come to do.

Ah Bismillaahi loveliest of names

Ar-Rahmaanir Ra'hiim, where nothing
shames,

"Most Gracious, ever Merciful," the one
 Who follows Your law until he is done.
 Ah Bismillaahi in Your name I walk,
 Ar-rahmaanir RaHiim, in grace I talk
 Of Your creation, how You made all things
 In pairs to glorify Your destinings
 And chant Your mercies to both male and
 her
 Of whom You are the source and
 comforter.
 Ah Bismillaahi, name in which I find
 The secrets of creation, though I'm blind
 Without the grace of R-rahmaanir RaHiim,
 Beloved, above created things that seem.

2 Give back to orphans what's their own,
 Don't substitute your worthless bone
 For their good things, and don't consume
 Their property kept in your room.
 This is truly great sin *for doom*.
 3 If you're afraid that you cannot
 Deal justly with the orphans' lot,
 Marry the women that you choose,
 Two or three or four (not to lose),
 But if you're afraid not to be
 Just in your dealing honestly,
 Then only one, or one that your
 Right hand possesses, that is more
 Appropriate and will prevent
 You from doing injustice meant.

This verse in revelation is a glass
 Where every man's reflected in his crass,
 And subject to so many understandings
 It can be useful for nothing but landings.
 Since no man can be just to two or four,
 Then it stands for one wife and never more.
 Since it's in context of the orphan's score,
 Then it's no limit on the wives in store.
 It says the default way is more than one,
 And one is the exceptional for fun.
 Tradition claims that up to four is fine.
 See here are four interpretations' wine.
 Beloved, keep me from understanding what
 Your revelation says about hearts shut.

4 Give women their dower as free gift,
 But if they of their own will lift
 A part to you, take and enjoy
 It cheerfully and to employ.
 5 Don't turn your wealth over to those

Weak in understanding's forclose,
 What Allah's made means of support
 For you, but give them food and clothes
 And speak kindly and in just rows.
 6 Keep orphans on probation till
 They reach age of the marriage bill.
 If you find that they can fulfil,
 Give over their wealth to their fill,
 But don't consume it wastefully,
 Or quickly before they are free.
 If the guardian has what he needs,
 Let him take no pay for his deeds,
 But if he's poor, let him receive
 For himself just and right reprieve.
 When you give over to them their
 Wealth, take a witness of their share
 Before them, but Allah knows well
 The full account and the full spell.

The care of orphans must be at expense
 Of the care-giver, not the orphan's cents,
 Unless the patron is too poor to take
 Care of the waif in his poverty's stake.
 Who in this day and rage takes orphans in
 Who is too poor to put a pound in bin?
 Some other way to gain the legacy
 Must be found by the rich in their debris.
 Beloved, I am an orphan, an outcast,
 And never loved by any in this world.
 But what is that to me, when You at last
 Take me up in Your wealth and yet leave
 furled
 And waiting in its store my little bit
 That I may or may not come inherit?

7 From what is left by parents and
 The near relations share in hand
 There is some for men and some for
 Women, whether the wealth in store
 Is small or great, determined floor.
 8 But if at the time of division
 Other relatives, or provision
 Of orphans or poor come along,
 Feed them from the wealth with a song
 Of kindness and justice, *not wrong*.
 9 Let them have the same fear in mind
 As they would have for their own kind
 If they had left folk dispossessed
 Behind at their death come ungussed.
 Let them fear Allah and in word
 Give the right comfort to be heard.

10 Those who unjustly consume wealth
 Of orphans, consume fire in stealth
 In their own bodies. They'll soon be
 Caught in a fire most blazingly!

11 So Allah guides you in the way
 Of your children: to the male pay
 A portion equal to what get
 Two females. If just daughters set,
 Two or more, their share is two-thirds
 Of the inheritance in words.
 If only one, her share is half.
 For parents, a sixth share to each,
 If the dead left children in reach.
 If there are no children left, then
 The parents are the ones again
 To be heirs, the mother gets third.
 If the dead left siblings unstirred,
 The mother has a sixth. In all,
 The distribution's after call
 Of payment in legacies and
 Debts. You don't know if parents stand
 Closer to you in payment's hand.
 These are determined share ordained
 By Allah. And Allah's unfeigned
 To know all in all wisdom reigned.

12 Of what your wives leave, you get half
 If they leave no child, but in gaff
 If they leave a child, your share may
 Be one fourth after you shall pay
 Legacies and debts in their way.
 Of what you leave, their share will be
 One fourth, if you leave childlessly.
 But if you leave a child, they'll get
 One eighth after the payment met
 Of any legacies or debt.
 If the man or woman of whose
 Inheritance we take in view
 Has left neither ancestors nor
 Spawn, but has a brother in door
 And sister, each one of the two
 Will get a sixth, but if the crew
 Is more than two, they'll share a third
 After paid legacies and word
 Of debt. So no loss has incurred.
 So it's ordained by Allah, and
 Allah knows all, patient in hand.

There are few things that differ in Qur'an
 From Bible law, and some of these are
 drawn
 From laws of the inheritance of spawn.

The Bible only lets a daughter win
 Inheritance if there are in the bin
 No brothers to take all the wealth and grin.
 And even that concession came about
 Because some disinherited girls shout.
 Beloved, the holy Qur'an would correct
 Abuses in society's elect,
 And give more justice in a world of crime
 Against the poor, oppressed, and other
 grime.

I praise You for release and mercy found
 In the last word You gave upon the ground.

13 Those are limits set by Allah.
 Those who obey Allah and His
 Messenger will gain entrance whiz
 To gardens under which still flow
 Rivers, to dwell in that glow
 Will be their great achievement's row.

14 But those who disobey Allah
 And His apostle and then draw
 Beyond His limits will be brought
 Into a fire to stay there caught,
 And they shall have a shameful plot.

15 If any of your women fall
 Into the guilt of shameful call,
 Take evidence from four in stall
 To witness against them, and if
 They testify, make them stay stiff
 In their houses till death lay claim
 Or Allah decide other game.

I've heard of punishment set onto wives
 Thought caught in sin while man forever
 thrives,

But never have I heard it followed fast
 On four to witness of the sinful blast.
 Islam has a bad name because so many
 Men who are called by the name for a
 penny

Are braver for their pride than for the right
 And for the justice of Qur'anic light.
 Beloved, I hear and see around me still
 The actions of humankind on the hill
 Where injustice is likely to fulfil,
 And helplessly remain beside the kill.
 When all is done, the world's a worse place
 for

The multiplying of innocent gore.

16 If two of your men fall in shame

Of act, punish them both. If they
 Repent and change their sinful way,
 Leave them alone. For Allah's quick
 Forgiving, most merciful pick.
 17 Allah has regard for repentance
 Of those who do the wicked sentence
 In ignorance and then repent
 Soon after that. To them Allah
 Will turn in mercy. For Allah
 Knows well and wisdom's in His claw.
 18 There's no effect when they repent
 Who keep on doing wicked bent,
 Until they're faced by death, he'll say
 "I truly repent of my way,"
 Nor of those who die in the sin
 Of faith's rejection. *They'll not win,*
 For them We've prepared punishment
 Both harsh and constant which We've sent.

I reckon this refers to sex between
 Two men upon the gloried, earthly scene.
 They tell me some are born to that fond act,
 And cannot change themselves even though
 smacked.

I wonder why the human animal
 Is fascinated and disgusted pal
 When faced by any kind of way to be
 That's different from his own in gloomy
 spree.

Beloved, I take no comfort for myself
 In thinking about others' private shelf,
 Considering such thoughts themselves
 depraved,
 Invading privacy with customs waved.
 Judge humankind with what judgement
 You will.

I have enough in my own self to kill.

19 O you believers, you must not
 Inherit women in your lot
 Against their will. Nor may you treat
 Them harshly, so that in your heat
 You take part of the dowry meet
 That you gave them, except when they
 Have been guilty of a lewd play.
 Rather live with them in the way
 Of kindness and justice in fee.
 If you take some aversion to
 Them, maybe you dislike it too,
 But Allah will bring about through
 It an abundant good *for you*.

20 If you decide to take one wife
 Instead of another in life,
 Even if you had given her
 That you divorce a whole treasure
 For dowry, don't take any back.
 Do you want to gain by the crack
 Of slander and wrong in your slack?
 21 How could you take it back when you
 Have slept with each other in view
 And they have taken from you then
 A solemn covenant again?
 22 Do not marry a woman that
 Has been the wife where your dad sat,
 Except for what's already done,
 It was a shame and horrid fun,
 A custom odious to run.
 23 Prohibited to you to marry
 Are mothers, daughters, sisters wary,
 Your father's sisters, mother's too,
 Brother's daughters, sister's in crew,
 Foster mothers who gave you suck,
 Foster sisters, your wives' mum's truck,
 The stepdaughters under your care,
 Born of your wives with whom you share,
 There no prohibiting if you
 Have had no relations in stew,
 Wives of sons coming from your loins,
 Two sisters in one time and coins,
 Except for what is past, it's true
 Allah is Oft-Forgiving too,
 Most Merciful of *all who do*.

Beloved! You make exception for the past!
 What's done is done, and let its doing last!
 You do not separate the union made
 In ignorance, but let stand as obeyed.
 You are forgiving, merciful is why
 Your way of doing passes humans by.
 Your law cannot be broken but it must
 Be under love or else turn into dust.
 The dust is what these courts around us
 give
 For bread and wine and then expect we
 live.
 Ah! Who can state Your law but one
 appointed,
 Not the reproachful, but the one anointed.
 Beloved, there's no impartiality
 But in the One that You are and must be.

24 Protected ones of women's crew

All of them are forbidden you

Except ones your right hand possesses,
Allah's written statute confesses,
Permitted for you besides these
You may get by the wealth you please,
By matrimony and not sleaze,
And such as by contract to please,
Give them their dowries as set price,
So no sin comes by what you slice
Agreed by both, by fixed reward.
Truly Allah knows all the hoard,
And in all wisdom does suffice.

25 And those who don't have means to take
Protected believing wives' stake,
Then from among those your right hand
Possesses, of believer's stand,
Indeed God knows better your brand,
You're from one another's remand,
So marry them with master's leave,
And give them fair dowry's reprieve,
Their getting protection in view
Of not committing lewdness' rue
Or taking secret paramours,
Then on them be half of the course
Of punishment for free wives' source.
This is for him among you who
Fears falling into evil view,
And self-restraint's better to do,
Indeed Allah's forgiving and
All merciful on every hand.

The holy Qur'an seems to take a note
From St. Paul that restraint is better vote
Than marriage, but it's better far to take
Even a wife of poverty in stake
Than fall into adultery and sin.
The many who take this ayat to win
A harem full of wives and then on top
Of that some temporary ones in crop
Should take the time to think a bit and stop.
That's only for the ones who have a reason
To think they'd do adultery in season.
Otherwise it is not a thing in token
Of any good ideal that's been spoken.
Too many souls and marriages go broken.

26 Allah desires to show His laws
And guide you in the paths and clause
Of those before you and to turn
To you in mercy and not spurn,
For Allah is all-knowing and

All wise indeed on every hand.

27 Indeed Allah desires to turn
To you, but those desire who earn
In their own lusts that you should go
Astray and in great measure *flow*.
28 Allah wants to lighten your weight,
Man is created in weak state.
29 O you who believe, don't devour
Each other's property in hour
Unlawful, but trade by consent.
Do not kill your own selves, indeed
Allah is merciful in need.

30 And the one who does this for shame
In violent injustice' name,
Soon We shall cast in fire for blame,
For Allah this is easy game.

31 If you avoid the great sins which
Are prohibited you in hitch,
We'll expiate your small misdeeds,
And let you come in honour's leads.

32 Don't covet what Allah may give
To raise up some higher to live,
For all men shall have what they earn,
And women also take their turn,
And ask Allah for grace indeed,
Allah truly knows what you need.
33 And to each one We've set up heirs
Of what their parents and in shares
Near relatives have left behind,
And those which whom you've been so
kind

To hand in promise, give their share,
Indeed Allah sees fair and square.

Beloved, I love You that the burden You
Would place upon weak shoulders of the
crew

Of humankind You've lightened like a
feather,

So greater praise in every sort of weather
Might rise to You instead of dread and rue.
Your law is for the happiness of men,
And for the joy of women in their den,
And that the children might have time to
grow

In loveliness instead of being slow.
The share of wealth the world provides for
all

Meets every need in tent, palace and hall.
The burden's not too great for us to bear,
Who walk the paths of desert and the fair

Green lanes of forest and in city air.

34 Men have authority above
Women because Allah in love
Cause one to be the stronger mate,
And because they have spent the rate
Of property to give them share;
So righteous women will obey
Keeping unseen in Allah's sway;
And as for those whose perverse way
You fear, admonish them, and then
Avoid their beds, then beat again,
And if they then obey you, then
Don't try to find a way again
Against them. Truly Allah's high
And greater than the earth and sky.

A woman must obey her man indeed
When he gives here some money without
greed
And tells her how to spend it in her need.
If she once disobeys and drops his dollar
In waste, then he may rise up then and
holler.

The second time he may refuse to go
To bed with her and by that come to show
His disapproval for the way she spends.
If the third time she wastes money in ends
That belongs to her husband, then he may
Beat her for what she did with his last pay.
But some say even then he must not take
A strap but only beat with feather's wake.
This law's what men abuse in every way.

35 If any couple starts to fight,
Send arbitration for the right,
One from his kin, another from
Her kin, and if the both of them
Are willing to find stratagem,
Then Allah will set them in hem.
Allah truly knows all and stands
Aware of *what's in human hands*.
36 Serve Allah and don't set with Him
Any other, do good with vim
To parents, and to kin, and to
The orphan *that has come in view*,
And to the needy, and those close,
And to the stranger *a large dose*,
And to the friend who's at your side,
And to the traveller *without guide*,
And to the one right hands possess,

Allah truly loves not address

Of pride or boasting *in regress*.

37 Those who are stingy and teach such
And hide away what Allah's much
Bestowed on them in bounty's touch;
We have prepared for disbelievers
Strict punishment without relievers.

38 And those who pay alms just for show
Before the people, and don't know
Allah and the last day; and such
Hold Satan as friend, evil touch.

39 What harm would they have come to
suffer

If they'd believed in Allah gruffer
And in the last day, and had paid
Alms of what Allah in parade
Had granted them? Allah indeed
Is aware of all *of their greed*.

40 Truly Allah is not unjust
In what He does an atom's dust,
And if there's a good deed He brings
Manifold from it and He sings
Of His own will reward in springs.

41 How will it be when We shall take
From every folk a witness stake,
And when We bring you for your sake
In witness over what they take?

42 On that day those who reject faith
And disobey Apostle wraith
Will wish the earth joined to them fast,
But never will they come to cast
A single thing from Allah's blast.

I've heard the argument before, and find
It's not a bad one to take of it's kind.
What harm would come from the belief in
You,

And from belief that on the day of rue
You hold accountable for what men do?
What harm would come from that? No,
none at all.

But if it is true in the other stall,
What great harm comes from the denial of
You and Your judgement of the hand in
glove!

If rational we be, though none can know
With certainty, until the judgement's glow,
The better choice in valour is the show
Of faith in You and in Your judgement's
go.

How ignorant is humankind at shove!

43 O you who believe! Do not come
 To prayers with wine in cranium,
 Until you know all that you say,
 Nor in state of impurity
 Until you've washed your whole body.
 If you are ill, or on a trip,
 Or one of you comes from the slip,
 Or you've been in contact with sex,
 And find no water *to perplex*,
 Then take for yourselves clean sand or
 Earth, and then just rub therewith your
 Faces and hands. For Allah blots
 Out sins and forgives lots and lots.
 44 Have You not turned your vision to
 Those who were given *not a few*
 Portions of the book? They traffic
 In error, wish you not to pick
 The right path. 45 But Allah has full
 Knowledge of your enemies' *pull*:
 Allah's enough for Protector,
 Allah's enough for a Helper.

Baptism is established for the men
 And women who come out to bow again
 To You alone, Beloved, and that we know
 By Naaman's actions in the long ago.
 Baptism is the sign that You blot out
 The sins of those that You forgive a lot.
 But in the desert places where we find
 No water for ablutions of the kind,
 You leave us to take sand in its
 replacement.
 And so baptisms get their last effacement.
 Beloved, You are indeed enough to make
 Baptisms valid for You own dear sake,
 And not the water nor the sand at stake
 Cleanse me, but only Your grace to a rake.

46 There are some Jews who displace
 words
 From their *right* places *by their herds*,
 And say "We hear and disobey",
 And "Hear what is not heard" today,
 And "Raina", with a twist of tongue
 And a slander to faith *unsung*.
 If only they had said "We hear
 And we obey", and then "Do hear",
 And "Do look at us", it could be
 Better for them *infinitely*,
 And more proper, but Allah's cursed

Them for their unbelief *at worst*,
 And only few of them believe.

I've heard the plays on words around me
 too,
 And know that those who play that way in
 view
 Think they are very clever when they do.
 Am I one innocent of such guile when
 I make a trick of speech in the vile den
 Of my prayers couched in ghazel sonnet's
 fen?
 I doubt not. But Beloved, remember I
 Am well provoked by both the earth and
 sky.
 What human language is not fraught with
 guile?
 What human speech does not raise up to
 smile
 At the discomfort of the lank and file?
 I cover both my lips and eyes for shame
 At the way words and emotions lay claim
 On human faith, as though none were to
 blame.

47 O People of the book! Believe
 In what We have *now* revealed *steady*,
 Confirming what's with you *already*,
 Before We change the face and fame
 Of some beyond all recognition,
No matter what's their hope's petition,
 And turn them backwards, curse their *name*
 As We once cursed the Sabbath breaker,
 For Allah's decision's at stake here.
 48 God does not forgive those who set
 Up partners with Him, but He's let
 Forgiveness for anything else,
 To whom He pleases, *Turks or Celts*,
 To set up partners with Allah
 Is to devise a sin *for awe*
 Most heinous indeed *against law*.
 49 Have you not turned your sight on those
 Who claim sanctity that they choose?
 No, but Allah sanctifies whom
 He pleases. But their final doom
 In justice is certain in least
 Of things. 50 Behold! How they've
 increased
 A lie against Allah! But that
 By itself's a clear sin *and pat!*

The Sabbath names You as Creator so
 No one can fail to understand and know
 Which God You are. To neglect Sabbath
 done
 Is thus to set up partners such as sun
 With You as God, and that's a heinous
 crime
 Greater than merely sins of counting time.
 You sanctify those whom You will through
 that
 Great medium, the test that shows where
 sat
 Obedient and rebellious by the day
 They regard in submission to Your way.
 The fact the Sabbath's arbitrary shows
 Obedience to be to Your command's throes
 Instead of to my own intent and reason.
 Beloved, I stand in prayer, await Your
 season.

They lie who say the Sabbath is for Jews
 Alone, they lie who say that the good news
 Is that the day's been abrogated, now
 Sunday's for Christians, Friday anyhow
 For Muslims. Friday and Sabbath are well
 Accounted in all Scripture with a spell
 For all. They lie who say they're sanctified
 By this or that, or faith, or great works
 tried.

You sanctify each one who comes in pause
 At Sabbath's coming to renew You laws
 In heart and mind and hand remembering
 The sacred invocation, Your names sing.
 Beloved, on Sabbath and each day make
 me
 Holy to You alone, not Trinity.

51 Have you noticed those who've received
 The Scriptures and yet they've believed
 In Jibt and Taghut and say they
 About the infidels in sway:

"These are better guided in way
 Than those who believe *in God's day*."

52 Those are the ones whom Allah's
 cursed,

And whomsoever Allah's cursed,
 You'll find for him no help *for worst*.

53 Or do they have part in the reign?
 But then they would not give a grain
 To the folk in a date stone's stain.

54 Or do they envy the folk for

What Allah's given them in store
 Of His grace? But truly We grant
 To Abraham's children in plant
 The book and wisdom and We gave
 To them a great kingdom *and brave*.
 55 So of them are those who believe
 In him and of them who deceive
 Obstructing him, and it's enough,
 The burning fire *of Hell is rough*.
 56 Truly those who do not believe
 Our signs, soon We shall take by sleeve
 And throw them in the fire: as soon
 As their skin's burnt away, in boon
 We'll make another skin again,
 So they can taste torment like men.
 Truly Allah's mighty and wise.
 57 And those who believe otherwise,
 And do good deeds, We shall devise
 For them gardens beneath which flow
 Rivers, and there they'll always show,
 And for them there will be pure mates,
 And We'll set them blissful estates.
 58 Truly Allah commands that you
 Return your trusts to owners due,
 And when you judge between men, then
 To render justice once again,
 How fine is what God commands you!
 Indeed Allah hears and sees too.
 59 O you who believe, obey God
 And obey the apostle's nod,
 And those who have power among you,
 And then if you might disagree,
 Refer the case to Allah's fee
 And the apostle, if you do
 Believe in Allah and the true
 Last day. This is the fairest way
 And best for ending dispute's sway.

The millions today who claim they believe
 The Scriptures have idols to which they
 cleave:

Not only wealth and stealth in gaining
 power,

But also ancient idols of the hour,
 The trinities that sanction human flesh
 In sacrifice upon the altar's mesh.
 The worship regulated by the Word
 Is rare in every Christian sort of herd.
 The Torah's chanted by the faithful Jew,
 The Qur'an's recited by Muslim too,
 But even these, the bastions of true faith

Are easily dismayed by cunning wraith.
Beloved, take me and mine from every fear
Of idol and keep us in Your heart near.

60 Have you not noticed those who think
They believe what's sent down on brink
To you and what was sent before?
They intend to consult the store
Of Taghut, though they have command
To turn from him. Satan has planned
To lead them astray *from the core*.

61 And when it's said to them, "come in
What Allah's sent down and the bin
Of the apostle", then you see
The hypocrites turn back freely
From you and so despicably.

62 Yet how when some calamity
Comes on them for what their own hands
Have sent before, then in their bands
They come to you, swear by Allah,
"We only want good peace for a'."

63 These are those Allah knows what's in
Their hearts, so turn back from their bin,
Rebuke them and speak words that will
Be more effective *on their sill*.

64 We did not send a messenger
But to be obeyed and concur
With Allah's will, and then if they,
When they'd been unjust in their way,
Had come to you for pardon's sway
From Allah, and the messenger
Had begged forgiveness for each fer,
Indeed they would have found Allah
To be oft turning and in awe
Stand in His mercy come on a'.

65 No, by your Lord! They don't believe
Until they make you their reprieve
To judge in all their own disputes,
And after that no one refutes
Decisions you hand down and they
Submit with full submission's sway.

66 And if We'd commanded them saying
"Kill yourselves or go out betraying
From your houses," they would have not,
Except a few of them in plot.

And if they'd done what they were told,
It would have been better to hold,
And more effective for strength's *gold*.

67 And then We'd certainly have granted
Of Our own will great reward *planted*.

68 And certainly We would have guided

Them on the straight path *and decided*.

69 Whoever obeys Allah and
The messenger, they're of the band
On whom Allah's bestowed with favours,
Of the prophets and truthful savours,
And witnesses and righteous ones,
And excellent companions.

70 This is grace from Allah, and it
Suffices for Allah knows fit.

When right is without power, but only
right,

The people turn away from righteous sight.
But when right had a dollar and a sword,
Men flocked to it, fell down there and
adored.

Right is for the advantage of men's greed,
And never for obedience in seed.
How many keep the Sabbath by command?
How many would keep it, if the demand
Of market gave them profit in the hand?
Beloved, I feed upon the Torah word
Each day and love the many things I've
heard,

And that is why I find Qur'an too brings
The same sweet waters where the Torah
sings.

For some the Word is sweet, for some it
stings.

71 Oh you who believe, rise in arms,
Go out in companies' alarms,
Or all together before harms!

72 Truly among you are those who
Hold back. And when harm falls on you,
He says "Allah's gracious to me,
I was not present in their spree."

73 And if comes to you grace from God,
He's say as though upon the sod
There'd been to tie twixt you and him,
"Oh, if only I'd been with them,
I'd have achieved great stratagem."

74 Let those then struggle in the way
Of Allah who sell this world's sway
For life hereafter. To the one
Who struggles in Allah's way spun,
Whether he dies, whether he's won,
We'll grant him great reward when done.

75 What's happened to you, so you do
Not come to God's defence in view
Of the weak men, women, and crew

Of children who say "O our Lord,
 Removed us from this town abhorred,
 Whose dwellers are tyrants, and grant
 For us from You a guardian and
 Appoint for us a helping hand!"
 76 Those who believe struggle along
 The way of Allah *with a song*,
 And those who disbelieve too fight
 In Satan's way. And so do right
 To struggle against Satan's friends,
 Truly Satan's art has weak ends.

The choice is not between the struggle and
 The sitting back to enjoy sun and strand.
 The latter is illusion in the pay
 Of Satan who has found a way to sway.
 The choice is for the struggle of the right
 Of widow and of orphan and the might
 Of poverty around the people's night,
 Or struggle for the wicked way and spite.
 Beloved, life is a battle any way,
 You grant the grace to enter in the fray
 Upon the side of good or on the wrong.
 Beloved, give me a better sort of song,
 And may I find my hand lifted for good
 By the strength You provide for what I
 should.

77 Have you not seen those to whom it
 Was said "hold back from using arms,
 Establish prayer and pay the fit
 Rate of alms," but when the alarms
 Of struggle became duty, see,
 Some of them fear the progeny
 Of men as they fear Allah or
 Maybe they even fear them more,
 And say "O our Lord, why did You
 Ordain us fighting, why did You
 Not grant us respite near in view?"
 Say this world's provisions are small,
 And the hereafter's better call
 To those who guard against the fall,
 And you'll not be wronged in the debt
 Of a husk of a date stone set.
 78 Wherever you are, death with take you,
 Despite the towers high you make you,
 If good comes to them, then they say
 "It's from Allah's providence sway."
 But if an ill falls on their way,
 They say "It's your fault, *you must pay*."
 Say "All is from Allah." What bind

Has hit this folk to make them blind
 To understanding what We say?
 79 Whatever good comes to you falls
 From Allah, but whatever stalls
 Of evil comes from you yourself.
 We have sent you, and not an elf,
 To humankind as messenger.
 Allah's enough in witness sure.
 80 The one who obeys messenger
 Also obeys Allah for sure.
 And those who turn away, We've not
 Sent you to watch over their plot.

Obedience to the man You have sent
 With messages of love, warning, and bent
 To our salvation, is obedience
 To You as well as to the man of sense.
 Those who are dead in sins and turn away
 From messages You sent Muhammad's
 way,
 Are simply not the chosen and elect,
 And hell-fire is just all they can expect.
 Beloved, I take the message of Qur'an
 In its affirming of the Bible drawn,
 And love the words that in my flesh as
 pawn
 I fail to do in praise of You from dawn
 Till night, and if I live to burn in hell,
 I pray my life there also serve You well.

81 And they speak of obedience,
 But when they go from your presence,
 Some of them spend time in the night
 To contemplate what's not in sight
 From what you've said. Allah will write
 Down what they contemplate at night,
 So turn away from them and trust
 In Allah and Allah too must
 Be guardian upon *the dust*.
 82 Don't they regard in the Qur'an?
 If it had been from any spawn
 Except from God, they would have found
 Much disagreement in the ground.
 83 And when there comes to them the news
 Of safety or alarm's abuse,
 They spread it all around *the pews*.
 And if they had taken the matter
 To the apostle or the fatter
 Authorities among them who
 Can draw conclusions on the view,
 They would have known it to be true.

If Allah's grace were not on you,
And mercy, you'd have been the crew
Of the devil, except a few.

The tendency among sectarian
To contemplate the prophecies and scan
The news for their fulfilment as in plan
Divine is more that I hope to or can.
Instead of asking prophets or at least
The experts in the Scriptures or the priest,
The would-be Gnostic jumps upon the
beast,

Declaring such fulfilments news increased.
Beloved, the only prophecy I take
To heart is that You are one for my sake.
Your sovereignty is prophecy enough
To get me past the news when it is rough.
So prophesy by any in the store
That You are still upon Your throne in
score.

84 Then struggle in cause of Allah,
You're accountable in His awe
For yourself only, and wake up
Believers *to the bread and cup*.
It may be Allah will hold back
The wrath of unbelievers' track,
For Allah's the strongest in power,
And bring punishment in its hour.
85 The ones who recommend and aid
A good cause are partners unpaid,
Whoever recommends and takes
Part in an evil cause, then makes
A share in its weight. Allah shakes
Power over all things in their wakes.
86 When a greeting is offered you,
Return it with a greeting too,
Still finer than that or at least
Of equal sweetness unincreased.
Allah keeps careful record and account
Of all such things in their amount.
87 Allah! There is no god but He,
Surely He'll gather your degree
Together against Judgement Day,
About which there's no doubt in sway.
And whose word can be truer than
Allah's word *and Allah's good plan?*

The greeting that the Gospel brings to view
Is the same that the Qur'an has to shew.
That is to greet and answer peace to you.

They both got that from innovating Jew.
The greeting that was first allowed to be
By revelation to the proud and free
Was Y'howah 'imachem to which they
Replied Y'varecha Y'howah hey!
Peace is the innovation of the crowd
Who doted on warfare as though allowed.
Beloved, I do prefer Your blessing here
Above the hypocritic call and fear,
The peaces and salaams by those who mean
Nothing but form to hide violent scheme.

88 Why should you separate in two
Groups in front of hypocrite crew?
Allah's overturned them for deeds.
Would you guide those cast out in weeds?
For those Allah has thrown away,
You'll never find a path and stay.
89 They only want your faith to fail
As does their own, to seek one sail,
But do not take friends from their crew
Until they take refuge as due
In Allah's path. But if they turn
Back in apostasy, take them
And kill them where you find their gem;
And take no friends or helpers from
The company of such to come.
90 Exception is those who are part
Of a group with whom you have from start
A pact, or those who approach you
With hearts that keep them in their due
From fighting you and their own folk.
If Allah had so pleased their yoke
Might have been on you, and they'd fight.
So if they retreat from your right
And sue for peace, the Allah's not
Made the way for a war unsought.
91 You'll find some others who would gain
Your trust as well as their own skein.
Each time the come back to the test
They fail. If such do not address
To withdraw from you and make peace
Restraining their hands then to cease,
Grab them and kill them where you can,
In their case We provide a plan,
Clear argument against their scan.

The oneness of God implies very well
The oneness of all humankind in spell.
And yet of humans there are two groups
here:

The ones that You have chosen in Your
sphere,
And those who without grace go on in fear,
Or steadily unknowing of their sin,
Sure that their hand is pure as fish's fin.
All are potential receivers of grace,
So all must be treated as of Your face.
You Yourself may cast down to hell those
who
Revere no name nor repent in the pew.
Beloved, I make no pact with anyone.
I see them all drawn dry beneath the sun,
All broken and torn when the turn is done.

92 Never should a believer kill
One who believes, but if by spill
Of accident, if one so kill
Believers, it's ordained to free
A slave believer, and freely
Pay compensation to family
Of the deceased, unless they do
Remit it too. If the deceased
Is part of a folk at war creased
With you and he believed, the freeing
Of a believing slave is being.
If he was part of a folk who
Had a treaty of peace with you,
Compensation to family's due,
And a believing slave freed too.
For those who have no means to do
This, be a fast of two months going,
Repentance to Allah so showing:
For Allah knows all things and all
Wisdom is at His beck and call.

93 If purposely a man may kill
Believer, his reward is hell
To stay there forever to tell.
And anger and curse of Allah
Remains upon him and in awe
A dreadful penalty prepared
For him *because he has not spared*.
94 O you who believe, when you march
Out in Allah's way stiff and starch,
Watch carefully that you do not
Answer a greeting with the snout
Reply you're no believer caught,
Striving for goods of worldly life,
While Allah has abundance rife.
You were that very kind before,
But Allah laid grace on your store,
So look and know and don't eschew,

Allah's aware of all you do.
95 They're not the same who sit down safe
Receiving no hurt, and who strafe
And struggle in Allah's cause by
Their goods and bodies. Allah'll give
A higher grade to those who live
To strive and struggle with both goods
And bodies for Allah than hoods
Who stay. To all God's promised well,
But those who strive and fight at spell
He does distinguish above those
Who sit by fine rewards in rows,
Degrees just bestowed by Him, and
Forgiveness and mercy in hand,
For Allah's oft-forgiving and
Most merciful on every hand.

The laws for killing folk by accident,
By treaty, and by hope do not prevent
My wonder that reality is such.
I reach toward néant and try to touch.
The accidental death is often rate
Of the disdain piled on the human pate.
I too have heard the greeting often spoken,
You're not of faith at all or of faith broken.
Beloved, the only joy in senseless death
Is that between each fading, fragile breath
You are returning oft in mercy and
Forgiveness on a gently savage land.
Even You have Your finely graded
distinctions
Between those who fight or sit in
extinctions.

97 Truly those whom the angels take
Away while they're unjust for sake
Of themselves, they'll ask in what state
Were you, and they'll answer in rate
As weakened in the earthly land.
Then they shall say was not the land
Of Allah big enough for you?
So these are those whose flight is to
Hell, and what an unhealthy crew!
98 Except for those who're truly weak
And the oppressed men, women, speak
Also for children without means
In their way to guide in their scenes.
99 These maybe Allah will forgive,
For Allah blots out to forgive.
100 Whoever migrates for the cause
Of Allah finds in the earth pause

Of refuge abundant and wide.
Whoever goes out from his place
For God and His messenger's grace,
And death should overtake his face,
Then Allah's become duty bound
To give him reward on the ground,
And Allah's oft-forgiving and
One merciful upon the land.

For what cause You have led me far afield
From the place I was born into the yield
Of the unwanted, more always the same,
I do not know, I do not stop to blame.
And yet this miracle of the Qur'an
That poses blessings on the one that's
drawn

Beyond the soft horizons to the edge
Of market, sea, and river and the sedge,
Is music of a sort, if I construe
My journeyings to be coming to You.
Beloved, be duty-bound to me and see
What great rewards You have for my
degree,
And I shall be glad to turn face and die
Between Your offer and Your empty sky.

101 When you are travelling on the earth,
There's no blame if you shorten worth
Of your prayers, if you are afraid
The unbelievers in parade
Will come to trouble you, indeed,
Infidels are your foes in greed.
102 When you're with them and stand to
lead

The prayers, then let a band there freed
To stand with you with arms in hand,
Then when they've prostrated in band,
Let them take the rearguard and those
Come up who've not yet prayed in rows
To pray with you, but let them take
Care with their arms, and for the sake
Of infidels, if you do not
Take care of arms and baggage lot,
They'll turn and attack you right quick.
But there is no blame on you thick
In case of rain or illness that
You leave your arms upon the mat.
But do be careful. Allah's true
To prepare for infidel crew
Disgrace and torment in their view.

103 And when you've finished prayer, then
mind
God standing, sitting and reclined,
And when you're safe, stand up for prayer,
Indeed prayer on believers stands
One of *Allah's own* timed commands.
104 Don't be slack in pursuit of folk,
What's hard for you, for them's a stroke.
But you hope from Allah, but they
Have no such hope upon their way.
Allah's all-knowing, wise *to stay*.

The half-prayer of the traveller has become
A duty in itself for every bum,
And it's forbidden by the ones who know
To pray four instead of two in a row.
And yet You say to do so if you fear
The sword of a sweet Christian coming
near,
And otherwise presumably to pray
In full and in the daily sort of way.
I'm neither theologian nor a scribe,
I'm just a man who comes to offer bribe
Of love in fainter sparks than holy tribe.
Beloved, I stay to pray or not or go
Beyond the limits of the prayerbeads' show,
I do not see, but You are here to know.

105 Truly We've sent you down the book
With truth so you man take a look
And judge between the folk by what
Allah shows you, but then keep shut
Your mouth from pleading for the folk
Who are treacherous ones *that spoke*.
106 And pray forgiveness from Allah,
Sure Allah's oft-forgiving, law
Of mercy's in His judgement's stroke.
107 And don't plead on behalf of those
Who deceive their own selves as chose,
Indeed God does not love the one
Who's treacherous, sinful, undone.
108 They hide from people but they hide
Not from Allah and He is wide
With them when they keep night by night
Their conferences that in His sight
Are not pleasing. And Allah here
Compasses round what they hold dear.
109 See, you pled for them in the life
Of worldly things, but who in strife
Shall plead with Allah for them when
The day of Resurrection's then?

Who'll come to defend then such men?

110 Whoever does evil or wrongs
His own self and after that longs
For pardon of Allah, shall find
Allah's oft-forgiving and kind.

111 Whoever commits sin, truly
He commits it against his tree,
Allah's knowing, of wise degree.

112 Whoever commits fault or sin
And casts it on innocent's bin,
He burdens himself with his guilt
And manifest sin, *may he wilt.*

Your sent one pleads only for those You
wish:

So You in fine choose who will lick the
dish

Of the rewards instead of serpent fish.

The prayer of righteous men indeed takes
hold

And is effective for both sky and bold.

But righteous men are led to pray alone

By the decree descended from Your throne.

Beloved, I seek the shelter of the prayer

Of saints that trod the earth before my dare,

And yet I know that Jesus and Ahmed,

And Enoch and Elijah who was fed

By ravens from Your hand, are only led

To pray for those Your grace has chosen
fast

And never in this world can be outcast.

113 Had it not been God's grace on you,

And His mercy, from them a crew

Had surely resolved to lead wrong,

But they'll not bring you into wrong,

But their own selves, and they'll not harm

You in anything; and God's sent

Down to you the book and has lent

Wisdom, and taught you what you lacked

In knowledge and God's grace not slackd

Is very great on you and spent.

114 There's nothing good in whispered
word

They cherish except what is heard

In charity or goodness spurred

Or peace fostered among the herd;

And whoever does so to seek

The pleasure of Allah to speak,

Soon We'll give him reward in peek.

115 And whoever comes to oppose

The messenger after arose

That guidance manifest to him,

And followed a way other dim

Than that of the believers trim,

We'll turn him to that which he turned

And cast him into Hell that burned,

And what a bad end he'll have earned!

Had it not been but for Your sovereign
grace

I never should have known the sinful trace

That brings the sorrow to my heart and
pain,

I never should have known the sound of
rain.

Had it not been but for Your grace above,

I never could have known Your saving
love,

But should have squandered life and will to
see

Deceptions blinding and destroying me.

Beloved, I cling to the grace of Your
power,

And like the moth burn in the candle's hour,

If that be my fate as a sacrifice,

Or yet I cantillate Your Word for vice,

With steps turned to eternity awhile,

With steps gone on a weary sort of mile.

116 Indeed Allah does not forgive

That anything is sought to live

Associated with Him, but

He does forgive whatever glut

He pleases; but the one who takes

Another to join in His stakes

Has truly gone far off astray.

117 They do invoke besides Him such

Female deities that they clutch.

It's really Satan that they touch,

Persistent rebel, *nothing much.*

118 God cursed him and he said indeed:

I'll surely steal away in greed

Your servants for my due in need.

119 I'll certainly lead them astray,

And surely stir desires away,

Command them to slit cattle's ears,

Command them to change what appears

Of God's creation. The one who

Takes Satan as a guardian too

Besides Allah, truly will find

A loss apparent *to the blind.*

120 He gives them promises and stirs
 Desires in them, but what occurs
 Is Satan's deceptions in blurs.
 121 These shall have their abode in hell,
 And find no escape from the well.
 122 But those who believe and do deeds
 Of righteousness, sure it concedes
 We'll bring them into gardens where
 Flow rivers beneath them in share,
 Forever shall they abide there;
 It's promised by Allah in share;
 True is the promise: who can be
 More truthful than Allah in fee?
 123 Not by your desires nor desires
 Of the folk of the book requires,
 Whoever does evil shall be
 Recompensed for it, nor will he
 Find for himself besides Allah
 Any guardian or help in awe.
 124 And the one who does righteous deeds,
 Whether man or woman in creeds,
 And is a believer, then these
 Shall enter heaven and they'll not
 Be wronged to a date stone's husk bought.
 125 And who's better in faith than he
 Who resigns himself entirely
 To Allah? And he's righteous and
 Follows the creed of Abram's stand,
 The upright one, and Allah took
 Abraham for a friend, *just look*.
 126 To Allah belongs what is found
 In the heavens and on the ground,
 Allah encompasses all round.

Let me, Beloved, not make associate
 With You of any idol, any state,
 Or any hope that lingers in my heart
 To give me honoured share, unhumbled
 part.

Let me, Beloved, seek only You above,
 And only You be the mark of my love,
 Until the world is empty of the share
 Of every idol that has risen there.
 Beloved, my prayer at last as at the first
 Is against every member that's accursed,
 And every glance toward enticement's
 glare.

Beloved, find me unbowed to idols there.
 If Abraham was Your friend long ago,
 Let Abraham's faith be my faith in glow.

127 They ask for a decision made
 About the women on parade,
 Say: Allah decides about them
 For you, and what's recited gem
 In the book about orphan girls,
 To whom you do not give, like churls,
 What is their own, and want to take
 Them as wives, and also the weak
 Among the children, that you speak
 Firmly in favour orphans seek,
 With justice and whatever of
 Good you do with or without love,
 Truly Allah knows hand in glove.
 128 And if a woman fearing ill
 Treatment from abandoning swill
 Of a husband, there is no blame
 On either of them if their game
 Is compromise between the two
 To separate in friendship due,
 For compromise is good; and greed
 Is made to be present in seed
 In people's minds, and if you do
 Good and guard yourselves, then God true
 Is all-aware of what you do.

129 You'll never be able to do
 Justice between wives, even though
 You may desire it, and so show
 No inclination totally
 To leave her in suspense to be;
 And if you make peace and guard you
 Against the evil, truly too
 Allah is oft-forgiving and
 A merciful one in the land.

130 And if they separate Allah
 Will make each free from want in straw
 Out of His abundance in claw,
 And Allah's all-knowing in awe
 And wise *before men's algebra*.

You Yourself promise that no man can be
 Just to two wives or more to right degree,
 And that means by the very word You
 spoke
 By which men justify to place in yoke
 Two, three or four of women that they
 stoke,
 That taking more than one wife is a joke,
 Prohibited by Qur'anic decree.
 Only those who follow the Bible's law
 Have justification to put a claw
 In more than one wife at a time in paw.

All human faith's irrational to me:
All human wisdom's inconsistency.
Beloved, let me bow down to idols free
Instead of following religion's spree.

131 And Allah's is whatever's in
The heavens and in the earth's bin;
And indeed We enjoined those given
The book before you and to live in,
And to you too that you should take
Refuge in Allah for your sake;
And if you disbelieve, that true,
Allah's is what's in heaven's due,
And what's in the earth: Allah be
Self-sufficient and praiseworthy!
132 And Allah's is what's in the skies
And what's in the earth in disguise,
And God's enough protection-wise.
133 If He but please, He can cause you
To pass away, O folk in view,
And bring others instead of you,
And for this God has power true.
134 Whoever wants this world's reward,
Then with Allah is reward stored
Of this world and after adored,
And Allah hears, sees all the hoard.

Eternally it seems that men's eyes take
Into consideration money's sake
As well as the well-turned heel in its wake,
And hope to gain the both when at the
stake.

You say a man cannot be just to wives,
And so it's better not increase the hives.
Indeed, Beloved, I trow that few can be
Just to the one wife let alone the three.
If a man can be just to take one God,
It follows in that reason in the pod,
That he can never be just taking more
Than one God and one wife within his
store.

Beloved, Your love in estimate makes sure
That love of one wife only remains pure.

135 O you who believe, stand firmly
With justice, witnesses in fee
For Allah's sake, though it may be
Against your own selves or decree
Of your parents or kindred free,
Be he rich or poor, God is closer
To both of them, than you a poser,

So follow not your inclination,
Lest you go astray and serve ration
Or turn aside, then God indeed
Is aware of all that you heed.

136 O you who believe, so believe
In Allah, His apostle's sleeve,
The book that He's sent down unto
His messenger and the book too
Which He's sent down before and who
Denies Allah, His angels too,
And His books, His apostles' crew
And the last day, has indeed strayed
Far off the right way *in parade*.

137 Truly those who believed and then
Afterward disbelieved again,
Believed and again disbelieved,
Afterward increased and so grieved
In disbelief. It's not for God
To pardon them, nor will He prod
Them to the right way on the sod.

138 Proclaim to the hypocrites that
For them there shall be painful vat.

139 Those who take disbeliever friends
Instead of the believers' ends,
Do they seek honour from them too?
Then truly all honour is due
To Allah only *in men's view*.

140 And indeed has He sent down to
You in the book whenever you
Hear the signs of Allah, did not
Believe them, but made fun a lot,
Then don't sit with them till they start
To talk about some other part,
Otherwise, you'll become like them;
Indeed Allah will take in hem
The hypocrite and infidel
And cast the both of them in hell.

141 Those who keep watch on you, then if
There is for you a triumph stiff
From Allah, they say "Are we not
With you?" But if infidel plot
Take share, they say "Did we not show
Our mastery over your row,
Defend you from believers' show?"
So Allah shall judge between you
On day of resurrection's view,
And never will Allah make clear
For infidels a way and spear
Against the believers held dear.

Beloved, tell me whom I may take as
 friend,
 Since everyone denies some part in end
 Of revelation and the book You sent.
 Some say the Torah is evil and bent,
 Corrupted by the hand and mind You lent.
 Some say the Gospel is a pagan train
 Of histories and myths counted in vain.
 Some say the Qur'an was inspired of late
 By Satan who came to negotiate.
 Though none may deny Psalms in word, in
 deed
 The world turns from them to hymns in
 their creed.
 Beloved, since all think they may pick and
 choose
 And cast away a part of what You use,
 Tell me who is a friend to me in need?

142 Truly the hypocrites strive to
 Deceive Allah while He comes to
 Deceive them, and when they stand up
 For prayer, they stand unlike a tup
 Without earnestness, and they just
 Do so to be seen of the crust,
 And they do not remember God,
 Except a little *on the sod*.

The service of remembrance, Sabbath day,
 Includes the one or two who come to stay.
 The others finger beads quickly and stray
 After the bowing postulation's sway.
 My meagre mind, my vain prejudice calls
 All hypocrites who enter in the walls
 Of church and synagogue and mosque to
 bind
 A moment of formality refined.
 Beloved, I tire and yawn above the Word,
 My cantillation slumbers and unstirred
 I linger in my sleep, am I too then
 A hypocrite among such other men?
 No doubt You lay Your grace on one of
 choice
 In disregard of every human voice.

143 So wavering between the two,
 Neither inclined to one side's view,
 Nor to the other, and whom God
 Leaves to go astray on the sod,
 You'll never find him a way trod.
 144 O you who believe, do not take

The disbelievers for friends' sake
 Instead of the believers' wake.
 Do you wish to get for Allah
 Authority against your pod?
 145 Truly the hypocrites shall be
 In the lowest stage of fire's spree,
 And you'll never find help's degree
 For them *at all eternally*.
 146 Except those who repent and right,
 And hold fast to Allah with might,
 And purify their faith for God,
 These then shall be with the true pod
 Of the believers, and soon God
 Will give the believers a great
 Reward and not punishment's rate.
 147 What can Allah gain by your end
 In punishment, if you're a friend
 In gratitude and you believe?
 No, it's Allah who notices
 And knows all things *and in a whiz*.

What separates my human soul from You,
 Beloved, what difference between the true
 And vanity? One word alone suffice
 To tell the gulf, one word, but uttered
 twice.

My human heart is grateful, Divine Soul
 Just recognizes good, thanks are the goal
 Of You and me. There is the point where
 we
 Are one. I rush forth in fidelity
 And faith, while You are the All-knowing
 One.
 And where we meet fidelity is done,
 Faith disappears, for I shall know at last,
 And in that knowing faithfulness is past.
 My shadow of a timid will declines
 Until there is no face but from You shines.

148 Allah does not love that evil
 Should be noised in public speech ill,
 Except where injustice was done,
 For Allah's He who hears *what's spun*
 And knows all things. 149 Whether you
 show

A good deed or conceal, besnow
 Evil with pardon, verily
 Allah blots out and mightily.
 150 Those who deny God and His sent,
 And wish to cause a gulf or rent
 Between Allah and His ones sent,

Saying "We believe in some but
 Reject the others *for their glut*";
 And wish to take a course midway,
 151 They're right in disbelievers' sway,
 And We've made for the infidels
 Humbling reward *in lowest hells*.
 152 To whom believe in Allah and
 His sent ones and let no strain stand
 Between any of the apostles,
 We'll soon give their rewards *in wassails*:
 For Allah's Oft-Forgiving, Most
 Merciful of the heavenly host.

153 The People of the Book ask you
 To cause a book to come down to
 Them from the sky; indeed they asked
 Moses for even greater tasked,
 For they said "Show Allah to bare
 Eye," but they were dazed for their share,
 With thunder and lightning. Yet they
 Worshipped the calf even *a day*
 After clear signs had come their way,
 Even so We forgave them, and
 Gave Moses proofs of power that stand.
 154 And for their covenant We raised
 Over them the mountain *once praised*,
 And *once* said to them "Enter in
 The gate prostrating *without sin*",
 And *once* We commanded them: "Do
 Not transgress in the Sabbath view."
 And We took from them solemn pact.
 155 Wrath on them when they broke their
 pact,
 Rejecting Allah's signs by act
 Of slaying messengers, defying
 The right, that they said, "Our hearts vying
 Contain *Allah's Word*," no, Allah
 Has set the seal on their hearts' *claw*
 For their blasphemy, little they
 Believe, 156 that they rejected the way
 Of faith, that they speak against Mary
 A grave false charge, 157 They were not
 wary
 To say *in boast*, "We killed Christ Jesus
 The son of Mary, *one who frees us*,
 Apostle of Allah", but they
 Did not kill him, nor crucify,
 But so it's made to seem *that day*,
 And those who differ therein lie
 In doubts, with no *true* knowledge, but
 Only conjecture *in minds shut*,

To follow, for surely they did
 Not kill him *who were not yet born*:
 158 No, Allah raised him up and hid
 Him for Himself, and Allah's *worn*
 Exalted power, *He is the Wise*,
 159 And there's no one *who may despise*
 Of the book's folk but must believe
 In him before his death *reprieve*,
 And on the day of judgement he
 Will be a witness, they will see.
 160 And for the Jews' iniquity
 We made unlawful for their tea
 Certain things good and wholesome which
 Had been lawful for them *to pitch*,
 In that they hindered from the way
 Of God many, *made go astray*,
 161 That they took usury, though they
 Were forbidden, and that they ate
 Men's substance wrongfully *to sate*,
 We have prepared for those among
 Them who reject faith awful stung.
 162 But those among them who are well
 Grounded in knowledge, and the *spell*
 Of believers, believe in what
 Has been revealed before your *gut*:
 And who establish daily prayer
 And often give charity's share
 And believe in Allah and in
 The last day *which will condemn sin*:
 To them shall We soon give a great
 Reward *and an eternal state*.

Ah my Beloved, those who were killed by
 sight
 Of Your glory in the eternal light,
 And raised to life again, lived but a day
 To permit idol worship in the way.
 The highest vision does not proof from
 wrong
 But may be prelude to a hellish song.
 I too have seen Your glories shown in
 dawn
 And in the high noon, sunset coming on,
 And in the flash of blackbird's wing and
 beak.
 I too a vision of Your glories seek.
 But now, Beloved, let me not live to find
 Myself bowed down before the idol's kind,
 No, not in graven image nor in spark
 Of concepts bred and held upon the dark.

The Sabbath, O Beloved, You once
 commanded
 To observe in the gate, prostrating landed,
 With towering mountain overhead and peal
 On peal of thunder there to set the deal,
 And lightning to make strong the strongest
 word.
 Who heard it lived to hold it but a turd.
 Rare is the one in silence here today
 Who keeps the solemn Sabbath in the way
 You command to the world, few hearts are
 stirred.
 If You would then relieve man of the
 blessing
 Of the Sabbath as so many're confessing,
 You ought, I think, to do it publicly
 With thunder and lightning for all to see.
 The abrogation's too secret a dressing.

 Some Mary every day lives on to hear
 The same false charge they made from ear
 to ear
 Of Jesus' mom, that she'd been in the barn
 To tumble in the hay instead of yarn.
 Islamic law that lets a girl be driven,
 Accused and stoned when she alone had
 striven
 Against the ones who forced her while at
 prayer
 And cancelled out their sins with Mecca's
 air,
 Is law demonic, diabolical
 That makes prophet apologetical,
 Who's weeping in his tomb, crying in
 sleep.
 Beloved, let those who make false charges
 keep
 Their guilt until the judgement rises up
 To give to each his own deservin cup.

 The church and synagogue have always
 vied
 About the doctrine of the riven side.
 The mosque would also enter in the fray
 With proclamation of events that day,
 And certainty of this or that to say.
 This miracle of saying in the Book
 Says that they're all in doubt for what they
 took
 To be the truth of Jesus' life and death.

So You condemn them all in just one
 breath.
 Let me, Beloved, not make my faith stand
 on
 Conjectures of what happened to the pawn.
 Let my faith rise to the one lifted up
 To Your bosom to drink a better cup.
 Some matters of contention serve a pup.

 For usury the Jewish folk were stricken.
 The thing's an evil that makes the world
 sicken.
 The wily and false way to read Your word
 Was that the thing's forbidden when it's
 stirred
 Among the brothers of the faith inured,
 But quite all right when taken from the
 heathen,
 And so to make some bankers with wealth
 wreathen.
 It's cause of war, it's cause of strife, it's
 cause
 Of every excuse to debate Your laws.
 Beloved, Beloved, what You once made a
 duty
 For Israel was not merely done for beauty,
 But that the world might live in peace and
 right,
 With food and clothing for each one in
 plight.
 Let me live in the day, not tread the night.

 163 Indeed We have revealed to you
 As We revealed to Noah too
 And the apostles after him,
 To Abraham and Ishmael prim,
 And Isaac and Jacob and those
 Tribes, Jesus, Job, and Jonah and
 Aaron, and Solomon in rows,
 And gave to David the Psalms grand.

 I take the Psalms, the loved Psalms and I
 make
 Of them a prayer and song to take the cake.
 And in my baking I make enemies
 Of all the folks who have invented sleaze
 To sing in church instead of the Psalms
 which
 For centuries were held up high in pitch
 By Jew and Muslim, Christian lay and
 monk.

But now the church folk rage and rave like
drunk
And swing their genitals to the drums' funk.
If any asks why I prefer the mosque
To Sunday din the other side of kioskue,
Let this be my retort, at least they pray
Instead of jiggling breasts and pintle's
sway,
Not my cup of wee for worship to stay.

164 There are apostles We have noted,
And others not explicit quoted,
And Allah spoke to Moses *quoted*
Directly talking *and promoted*.
165 Apostles gave good news and warning
So there might not remain till morning
An argument for folk to bear
Against Allah after the share
Of these apostles. Allah's mighty
And wise *against a people flighty*.
166 But Allah bears witness that what
He sent down to you He sent glut
Full of His knowledge, and bear too
The angels witness, though in view
Allah's sufficient witness too.
167 Indeed the ones who disbelieve
And impede people to receive
Allah's way, such have strayed away
Far from the right path and right sway.
168 Indeed the ones who disbelieve
And act unjustly, they'll receive
No pardon from Allah nor guide
Them in the right path *not to hide*.
169 Except He'll guide them into hell,
Therein forever they may dwell,
For God this is easy and swell.
170 O humankind, apostle's come
To you with truth from your Lord's sum,
Believe, it's good for you, and if
You disbelieve with a neck stiff,
Then Allah's is what's in the skies
And on the earth: Allah in guise
Is all-knowing, and is all-wise.
171 O people of the book, do not
Go beyond your religion's knot,
And don't say of Allah except
The truth. Indeed Messiah kept,
Jesus, the son of Mary's just
A messenger of Allah's trust,
And His word brought to Mary's womb,
And a spirit from Him in room.

Believe then in Allah and in
His messengers, and don't be gin
To say Trinity. Stop that din!
For that is good for you in bin.
Indeed, truly Allah alone,
One God, far be it from His throne
Of purity to bear a son.
His is what's in the skies when done
And what's in the earth. Allah's run
To be protector *without gun*.

The Trinity and Arian conflict
Are typical of judgement by the slicked.
Imperial loves force in everything,
The Roman way goes down to choose a
king,
Though once begun in a republic's wing.
But Jesus is a Christ and a Word come
From You, Beloved, a Spirit and not dumb,
A messenger of light and power and truth.
I worship You, Beloved, and fail to take
The argument for theology's sake,
And love instead of knowing to define
Humanity as well as the divine.
Do not reveal to me, Beloved, Your being,
For it must differ from all dogmas seeing.

172 Christ never was too proud to be
A servant of God, angels see
Their way near Him to serve that way.
Those too proud to serve Him, but scorn,
He'll gather to Himself to warn.
173 But as for those who believe and
Do righteous deed, to them He'll hand
The wages increased unto them
Out of His bounty. But those who
Are proud and arrogant, He'll brew
In punishment grievous to view.
Nor will they find besides Allah
Protectors or aid *without awe*.
174 O humankind, indeed there's come
To you convincing proof in sum
From your Lord, and We've sent down too
You a clear lightenment in view.
175 Those who believe in God and hold
Tight to Him, soon will they be told
From Him admittance to mercy
And grace from Him, and He will guide
Them straight to Himself to abide.
176 They ask you for pronouncement fast.
Say "Allah makes a statute last

About those who leave none as heirs
 Among descendants or forebears.
 If it's a man who dies but leaves
 A sister but no spawn that grieves,
 She'll have half the inheritance.
 If it's a woman dies without
 A child, her brother takes the bout.
 If there are two sisters they'll get
 Two thirds of the amount as set.
 If there are brothers, sisters too,
 The male shall have twice the share due
 As the female's share in the crew.
 So Allah makes it clear to you,
 So you need not err in your rue.
 And Allah knows of all things true.

I ask no great inheritance beside
 The revelation come once to abide
 And be a light clear to my feet and eye
 To lead me to the truth of earth and sky,
 The knowledge of the Oneness that You
 are,
 The love of You beyond both moon and
 star.

I ask no legacy beyond the Word,
 The cantillation that rose and then stirred
 My heart with melodies as yet unheard.
 So error need not plague my feet in all
 The ways I go as I follow Your call,
 Or keep me in another master's stall.
 Beloved, You surely know all things in
 true,
 Let me rely then only upon You.

Surah 5 Al-Maida, or the Table Spread

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 You who believe! Fulfil your duty.
 Lawful for you are all four-footy
 Animals but the ones We've named
In the Torah. But be it blamed
 To take beasts by the hunt while you
 Are in the sacred precincts, you
 Are wearing pilgrim dress, Allah
 Commands according to His will
 And plan. 2 You who believe *in awe!*
 Don't violate, but all fulfil,
 The sanctity of symbols of
 Allah, *that He reveals in love*,
 Nor of the sacred month, nor of
 The animals for sacrifice,
 Nor the garlands that mark *them nice*

As such beasts, nor the people who
 Resort to the sacred house, who
 Seek of the bounty and good pleasure
 Of their Lord *sent down without measure*.
 But when you are clear of the place,
 The sacred precincts, *without lace*
 The pilgrim dress, then you may hunt
 And do not let the hatred *stunt*
Your minds because some people shut
 You out of the sacred mosque's *rut*
 And lead you to transgression *killing*
 Help one another thus fulfilling
 Righteousness and true piety,
 But do not help the other be
 In sin and rancour: Fear Allah:
 For Allah's strict in penalty.

I have no doubt, Beloved, that many here
 Upon the earthly dust and clay like bier
 Would shut me from the sacred house to
 fear,
 Would shut me from the synagogue and
 church,
 A dervish dog left on a lonely perch.
 But You in mercy once arranged that I
 Be taken to the Kaaba on the sly,
 Where I performed in faith the sacred rites,
 And left with tears of longing in my sights.
 Beloved, it is too late to shut me out.
 I have already scaled walls of redoubt,
 And rushed into Your court and with a
 shout
 Gain victory for my soul in the rout.
 I've walked the sea of glass, sipped
 heaven's wine's lights.

3 To you forbidden *for food* are:
 Flesh having died, blood, flesh of swine,
 And that on which was said in sign
 The name of other than Allah,
 That which has been killed by strangling,
 Or by a violent blow's *sting*,
 Or by a headlong fall, or by
 Being gored to death *on the sly*,
 That which has been *partly* eaten
 By a wild beast, unless *unbeaten*
 You're able to slaughter it meeten,
 That which is sacrificed on stone,
 Its dividing by arrows thrown,
 That's impiety too. This day
 Have those who reject faith in sway

Given up all hope of your faith's way.
 Yet do not be afraid of them
 But fear Me. This day's stratagem
 Is I've completed you your way
 Of faith, made full My favour's stay
 On you, and chose for you Islam
 As your religion *and your balm*.
 But if anyone in the pang
 Of hunger, with no will that sang
 To sin, Allah is truly Oft-Forgiving,
 Most Merciful with those who's living.

The Holy Qur'an here proclaims to be
 The affirmation of the council wee
 Spoke of in Acts fifteen and verse twenty
 That takes the covenant of Noah set
 For Gentiles faithful to You when they've
 met.
 This miracle set down in black and white
 With pen and ink shows that the Qur'an's
 right
 To bind the faith from Adam to the sight
 Of good Muhammad in a line for spite.
 There is no difference in faith and crew
 From the beginning to the last in brew.
 I do rejoice to know, Beloved, that You
 Bind all Your own in Your heart's savoured
 view,
 To walk and sing together in Your light.

The Holy Qur'an here proclaims to be
 The affirmation of the council wee
 Spoke of in Acts fifteen and verse twenty
 That takes the covenant of Noah set
 For Gentiles faithful to You when they've
 met.
 This miracle set down in black and white
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 Of good Muhammad in a line for spite.
 There is no difference in faith and crew
 From the beginning to the last in brew.
 I do rejoice to know, Beloved, that You
 Bind all Your own in Your heart's savoured
 view,
 To walk and sing together in Your light.

4 They ask you what's lawful to eat.
 Say "Lawful to you for a great
 Are the good and the pure and such

As you've taught hunting dogs to touch
 In the ways Allah's given you.
 Eat what they catch for you, but say
 The name of Allah in the way.
 And fear Allah, for Allah's quick
 To take account of every trick.

Ah Bismillaahi name that I repeat
 Upon the things You sanctify to eat.
 Of R-rahmaanir Rahiim I taste in grace
 The bounties that fill platter and the vase.
 Ah Bismillaahi in Your name I take
 To lip the bread and sema' that You make
 A banquet for my body and my soul
 Where every morsel blessed tastes of the
 Whole.

Of R-rahmaanir Rahiim I drink my share
 And find the taste each sip more and more
 rare.

Ah Bismillaahi, name upon my tongue
 Is sweeter than is honey to the young.
 Of R-rahmaanir Rahiim I taste again
 And find the pleasures that have slain some
 men.

5 This day are *all* things good and pure
 Made lawful unto you *for sure*.
 The food of people of the book
 Is lawful unto you and *look*
 Yours is lawful unto them *too*.
 Chaste women who believe, but too
 Chaste woman from the bookly crew,
 Revealed before your time in pew,
 When you give them their dowries due,
 And want their chastity, and not
 Lewdness, nor any secret plot.
 If any one denies faith, then
 His work is fruitless among men,
 And in the day to come he'll be
 Among those who've lost piety.
 6 O you who believe! When you make
 Your preparation for prayer's sake,
 Wash your faces, and your hands to
 The elbows, rub your heads, and do
 Your feet to the ankles. If you
 Are in state of impurity,
 Bathe then at once your whole body.
 But if you're ill, or on a trip,
 Or one of you comes from the slip,
 Or you've been in contact with sex,
 And find no water *to perplex*,

Then take for yourselves clean sand or Earth, and then just rub therewith your Faces and hands. Allah does not Wish to place you in a hard spot, But to make you clean, and complete His favour to you, that you treat Him gratefully, *not with deceit*.

7 Call in remembrance Allah's favour To you, and His pact, *and its savour*, Which He has ratified with you, When you said, "We hear and obey." And fear Allah *in what you do*, For Allah well knows *every ray Of heart secrets and what you do*.

My service of remembrance day by day Is savour of Your favour and Your pact With humankind. Let me truly obey And not remember You in what I say Alone in recitation of Your lovely name. Hear and obey, not merely hear alone, So sema' without faithfulness is stone Idolatry. Hear and obey. For shame I see the hearing and the whirling free With heart and hand in gross idolatry. Beloved, set me free in Your will to do Nothing but what Your love compels is true, And I shall sacrifice the secrets of My heart to You alone, to You in love.

8 You who believe! Stand out firmly For Allah, as witnesses *free* To fair dealing, and do not let The hatred of the others get You to swerve to wrong and depart From justice. Be just *from the heart*: And that is next to piety: And fear Allah. For Allah knows Well all you do, *hidden, what shows*.

Beloved, how astute You are in Your Word!

You know what things in this town have me stirred.

It's not doubt that would come and make me swerve,

It's not deception of belief with verve, Those two things that arouse the rabble's curve.

Rather it is the hate of those I love

That would impel me from the road above. So let not hatred take its toll and shove. Beloved, I turn from hate to You alone, And curse as may the life in flesh and bone Of fear that makes so many hate my drone Of faith and doubt I sing before Your throne.

I turn and turn again and as I whirl The wisps of divine love my feet uncurl.

9 To those who believe and do deeds Of righteousness as Allah *leads* Has He promised forgiveness and A great reward *upon the land*.

10 Those who reject faith and deny Our signs will be, *soon by and by*, Companions of hellfire to fry.

11 O you who believe, call to mind The favour of Allah to bind On you when some men had designed To extend their hands against you, But He kept their hands back from rue. And so have regard for Allah. Let faithful trust Allah with awe.

12 Allah made a pact long ago With the children of Israel slow, And We set up among them chiefs Twelve in number *for their reliefs*. And Allah said "I am with you, If you establish prayer as due, Give out in charity, believe My messengers, and for reprieve Honour and help them, and so lend To Allah a beautiful send, Indeed I'll blot out from your souls Your wickedness, and open tolls To you of gardens where there flow Beneath rivers, but if you go After this to oppose faith, such Has truly wandered from the touch Of the right way *and heaven's glow*."

13 Because they broke their covenant, We cursed them and made their hearts hard.

They change the words from their right slant,

Neglecting what I wrote on card. You'll always find them in deceit, But overlook them in retreat, For Allah loves the mercy-seat.

14 With those too called Christians we
made
A covenant, but they have strayed
From much of the message once laid
On them, so we split them in sects
Enmity and hatred inspects
To day of judgement. And soon God
Will show them what they've done *on sod*.
15 O people of the book, there's come
To you Our messenger to hum
Much that you used to hide away
From the book, and leaving in sway
Much else. There's come to you from God
A light and book guiding like rod.
16 By it God guides all who seek out
His good pleasure to ways no doubt
Of peace. He brings them out of dark
By His will to the light to park,
Guides them to a straight path about.

The book of light that You, Beloved, sent
down
In the Qur'an, was meant to lift the frown
Of heresy that darkened earth and street
And blinded eye and mind, and stumbled
feet.
The book of light cut down blasphemous
claim
By some that Christ was just a man to
blame,
Killed on a cross, by others that he was
Allah Himself come in the flesh (hurrahs).
The book of light leads in a path that's
straight,
Where those who love the good and right,
but hate
The wicked course walk firm and sure.
This book
Is light itself, both when I hear and look.
O my Beloved, I take Your light in ear,
May I do also everything I hear.

17 In blasphemy indeed are those
Who say Allah is Christ *arose*
The son of Mary. Say "Who then
Has the least power to oppose when
Allah might, if it were His will
To destroy Christ who is son still
Of Mary, his mother, and all
Who are on the terrestrial ball?
For to Allah belongs dominion

Of heavens and earth, and every *minion*
That is between. What is His will
That He creates. For Allah still
Has power over all things *here*."
18 The Jews and Christians will appear
To say "We're sons of Allah here,
And His beloved." Say "Why then does
He punish you for your sins' *cause*?
No, you are but men, of the men
He's created. He forgives then
Whom He pleases, and He will punish
Whom He will, *and with things not funnish*.
And to Allah belongs the rule
Of heavens and earth, and all the school
Of what's between: And unto Him
Is the final goal, *stock and trim*."
19 O people of the book, Now's come
To you to make clear things in sum
Our messenger, after a break
In messengers, lest you should take
The stand to say "There did not come
To us a bringer of good news
And warner." But now in your views
Has come a bringer of good news
And warner. And Allah has power
Over all things *and every hour*.

If You, Beloved, will punish whom You
will,
And grant life everlasting on the bill
Of those You choose, then the Qur'an is
right
Affirming sovereign grace with all its
might.
If You, Beloved, send prophets to the folk
In every land and clime, and through them
spoke
The good news in each place, then You
have sent
Them everywhere that Your salvation's
meant.
Beloved, I praise Your name that things are
clear
And written in the writings of the dear
Apostles of all times that You've sent down
To bear witness of You in every town.
The warnings and the promises are great
In every palace and in every state.

20 Mind Moses said to his folk, "O
My people, call to mind the glow

Of favour Allah's given you,
When He set prophets among you,
Made you kings and gave you what He
Had not provided in degree
To any people's hostility.

21 "O my folk, enter holy land
Which God's assigned for you in band,
And do not turn back shamefully,
For then you'll lose the victory,
To your own spoiling in degree."

22 They said "O Moses, see how big
The people are who delve and dig
There, and so we shall not go in
Until they get out of that bin,
And then we shall enter therein."

23 Among God-fearing men were two
On whom Allah's bestowed in view
His grace. They said "Attack them at
The gate, and when you get in that,
The victory will then be yours.

So in Allah trust for faith's stores."

24 They said "O Moses, as long as
They stay there, we will never jazz
Ourselves inside long as times last.
So go with your Lord, you to fight,
While we sit here and watch a mite."

25 He said "Lord, I've authority
Only over brother and me.
So move us from rebellious fee."

26 Allah said "Therefore will the land
Be forbidden them by command
For forty years, and they'll go through
The wilderness bewildered too.
But don't feel sorry for this crew
Of people rebellious in hue."

The strategy of Caleb and the man
Called Joshua is missing from the plan
Of Torah, but here is clearer to scan:
Attack them at the gate and enter in,
And then the victory is there to win.
I whirl about the four gates and look on
The feast of love and delicacies drawn,
And whirl again and pass the open arch,
And then turn to the desert land to parch.
If I but dared, Beloved, I'd come into
The throne room and have lunch sat down
with you.

If I but dared, I'd enter in the land
Of Your reality and there I'd stand
No longer an outcast from Egypt's strand.

27 Recite them truly of the tale
Of Adam's two sons *to prevail*.
See, they each brought a sacrifice.

It was accepted as one nice
From one but not the other's vice.

The latter said "Be sure that I
Will kill you." But the former guy
Said "Surely Allah does receive
The offering of a righteous leave.

28 "If you stretch out your hand to grieve
Me and kill, it's not for me here
To stretch out my hand against fear
To kill you, for I really fear
Allah, the Lord of everywhere.

29 "See, I'd rather that you should bear
The punishment for the sin there
Against me and your own sin's share
And become of the fire to bear,
And that's the end of those who err."

30 His mind then justified the act
Of killing his brother, in fact
He killed him and so he became
One of the losers in his blame.

31 Then Allah sent a raven who
Scratched in the ground to show how to
Hide the shame of his brother's death.
"Woe be to me!" he said in breath.

"Am I not smart as raven's claw
To hide my brother's shame in awe?"
Then he regretted his faux pas.

32 That's why We ordained on the folk
Of Israel, if any stroke
To slay a person, unless it
Were for murder of spreading fit
Of mischief in the land, it should
Be as if he killed all the good.

And if any one saved a life,
It would be as if from the strife
He saved the life of the whole folk.
Although there came to them with signs
Of clarity messengers' lines,
Yet even after that, of them
Many continued stratagem
Of committing excess in hem.

33 The punishment of those who make
War against Allah in the wake
Of His Apostle, and strive still
With might to corrupt house and hill,
Is to be killed or crucified,
Or cutting off opposite side

The hands and feet, or exile from
The land. That is their disgrace sum
In this world and in one to come
There's heavy punishment beside.
34 Except for those who may repent
Before they fall in your hand sent,
In that case, know that God is fair
Forgiving, merciful with care.

The Qur'an makes Abel to seem at least
A pacifist if anything for beast.
He makes no defence for himself at all,
But lets his brother knock him off the wall.
And yet the punishments described upon
That wall are rather awful as they're drawn.
They mind me of the conquest for a song
Of Mexico where Indians all along
Where sliced off from their hands and feet
for wrong.

Can there not be a midway between what
Abel did before brother and the glut
Of vengeance on the wicked man and slut?
If self-defence was once forbidden then,
That law was changed by the Flood on all
men.

35 O you who believe, mind your due
To God and see the way that's true
To come to Him, and struggle more
In His way to prosper in store.

36 As for those who reject faith, if
They had all in the earth in skiff,
And twice as much, to give exchange
For penalty of judgement's range,
It would not be enough degree:
Theirs is a grievous penalty.

37 They'll want to come out of the fire,
But they can never get from ire.
Their penalty will be one that
Is everlasting *where they sat*.

38 As for the man who steals, or wife,
Cut off their hands for such in strife,
A warning punishment from God,
Allah is mighty, wise *with rod*.

39 But if the thief repents his crime,
And changes his conduct in time,
Allah turns to him to forgive,
For Allah's forgiving to live,
Most merciful *in every clime*.

I guess this last of miracles suggests

That if a thief when caught tucked in his
vests

The loot, and when the axe is raised to
strike

Of his right hand, and comes a moment like
A flash of new awareness and he cries
That he repents of what he did and why's,
Then punishment's rescinded by the guys.
That's what it seems to me. But wiser men,
More knowledgeable in Qur'anic den,
Know better. Yet by all accounts I hear
Allah knows best of all, though without
fear

Some when are brave to cut off hands of
others

Without regard to what awaits or smothers.
I'd rather not be one among their brothers.

40 Do you not know that Allah owns
Dominion of sky and earth's thrones?
He punishes the ones He please,
And He forgives the ones He please,
And Allah has power over all.

41 O messenger, don't let those grieve
You who race from what should believe,
Among those who say "we believe"
With their lips but whose hearts have none,
Or among the Jews, men when done
Who'll listen to any lie spun,
Will listen to such ones in stall
Who've never come to hear your call.
They change words from their time and
place,

And say "If you are given this trace,
Take it, but if not, then beware!"
And as for him whose trial's share
Allah desires, you can't control
Anything for him in the goal
Of Allah. Those are the ones for
Whom God does not want to restore
Their hearts. They'll have disgrace on earth,
In the hereafter pain for worth.

The Muslim is a fool who thinks Your
Word

Is not protected in the Gospel stirred,
Nor in the Torah, but proclaims confusion
Upon the Bible: that is all illusion.
The same omissions and the same lies rise
According to the Qur'an on the eyes
Of what was once recited by the Prophet

Of fair Islam, a message not to scoff at.
Beloved, let me not like the Christian fool
Deny Your message in Qur'anic pool,
And not like Muslim ignore Bible's tool.
But let me, my Beloved, obey and follow
Your truth in each of them, and so not
swallow
The punishment and loss or come to
wallow.

42 Heeders of lies, consumers of
What is forbidden *hand in glove*,
So if they come to you, then judge
Between them or turn from the budge.
And if you turn away from them,
They'll not harm you by stratagem.
But if you judge, judge righteously.
See Allah loves justice in fee.

43 Why do they come to you for right,
Since they have their Torah in sight?
The statutes of Allah are there,
Yet even after that, they dare
To turn away, because they're not
A folk within the faithful plot.

44 We revealed the Torah, in which
Was guidance and light. By its pitch
The Jews have been judged by prophets
Who bowed to Allah's will as fits,
By rabbis and doctors of law;
For they were obliged in their awe
To safeguard the book of Allah,
And there were witnesses of that.
So do not fear men, but fear flat
Out what I say, and do not sell
My signs for a paltry price fell.
The ones who do not judge by what
Allah's revealed, such are not shut
Among believers, *but are smut*.

45 We ordained for them life for life,
And eye for eye, and nose in strife
For nose, and ear for ear, and tooth
For tooth, and wound for wound forsooth.
But if any one does release
Revenge by charity's increase,
It is atonement for himself.
And if any does not judge shelf
By what Allah's revealed, they are
Wrong-doers *along with the star*.

The Torah is a light for me today
Despite the fact that centuries delay

Its coming and transmission in my way.
I take it despite age and despite greed
That may have twisted its message indeed.
I take the Torah and it satisfies
My hunger for the truth, beauty, my need.
The law in sweeter cantillation lies.
Beloved, I do not sell a single word
To be like Lutheran in a blind herd,
Or like the Jewish rabbi that is stirred
To circumvent the Torah by the curd
Of Talmud or at least it seems he tries.
Give me, Beloved, the singing of the skies.

46 We sent after in their footsteps
Jesus the son of Mary's preps,
Confirming what was before him
Of the Torah and We gave him
The Gospel in which guidance shines,
Confirming what was before it
Of Torah and a guidance fit
And admonition for those who
Guard themselves from the wicked pew.
47 Let the folk of the Gospel judge
By that which Allah without budge
Revealed in it. Who does not judge
By what Allah's revealed are just
Transgressors rebelling in dust.

Like Bampffield in his day, I come to judge
Of all my cases with a word and smudge
From Torah and the Gospel and I find
That they agree with the Qur'anic mind.
The Gospel guidance shines confirming
what

The Torah had to say to human strut.
It hits the man of God right in the gut,
And leaves him helpless before You like
slut.

Beloved, I take the Gospel and I see
That Jesus answers everyone's degree
With clear and righteous word and right
decree.

So let me judge again and judge the more
By the pure Gospel and its gleaming store
And pray my flight leave Sabbaths on the
shore.

48 To you We have revealed the book
In truth, affirming what you look
And find written that came before,
And guarding revelation's store.

So just between them by what God
 Revealed, and don't follow the prod
 Of low desires away from truth
 That has come to you and with ruth,
 For every one of you We came
 To appoint a law and a claim,
 And if Allah had so desired,
 He would have made you one folk wired,
 But so He might prove you in what
 He has revealed, strive to the gut
 With one another to be quick
 To righteous acts. To Allah slick
 Is your return and that for all,
 And He'll reveal the difference call.
 49 You ought to judge between them by
 What Allah's sent down from the sky,
 And not follow their low desires.
 Beware of them, lest by their liars
 They take you away from a part
 Of what Allah's revealed to start
 To you. But if they turn back, then
 Know that Allah wished to take men
 Into account for some fault they
 Have perpetrated on their way,
 And certainly many folk are
 Transgressors in their ways afar.

The last word is that whatever men choose
 Of wrong, and the result is that they lose,
 You are behind the track and Your will
 shows

The victory beyond both friends and foes.
 Those who apostatize from glory's state
 Are those who turn to meet merited fate,
 And every man runs with a will to take
 The divine decree of his chosen stake.
 Beloved, if any in the world below
 Remember to turn from the fate of woe,
 Your mercy is the source of memory,
 Your grace redeems the called and sets
 them free.

The heavenly crown is Your alone to give,
 Creation and redemption's Yours to live.

50 Do they then wish a judgement set
 From era of ignorance met?
 Who's better than Allah to judge
 For a sure folk who will not budge?
 51 O you who believe, do not take
 The Jews and Christians in friends' wake.
 They're friends to each other, and those

Among you, who make of such foes
 A friend, then he's surely of them.
 Surely God does not guide in hem
 The unjust people in their rows.
 52 But you will see those in whose hearts
 Is a disease rushing to parts
 For them to say "We are afraid
 Calamity falls in parade,
 But it may be Allah will bring
 The victory or then will spring
 A punishment from Himself, so
 They'll repent for what they don't show."
 53 And those who believe then will say
 "Are these the ones who by Allah
 Swore with most mighty oaths in awe
 That they were certainly with you?
 Their deeds shall count for nothing true,
 So they'll be losers with their crew."

You tell me not to take Jews for my friends
 Or Christians, unless they make some
 amends.

If You were writing now, I'll wager fast
 You'd warn me of the Muslim in the cast.
 I'm looking for a friend or two who'll take
 Both Bible and Qur'an for Your good sake,
 Admitting truth wherever it is found,
 Rejoicing in the cantillation's sound
 Of every verse and miracle that's bound
 Within the covers of the four books round.
 Beloved, I look around for friends, it's true,
 And find none in the path perhaps but You,
 And You suffice for all my needs in view,
 Creator and Redeemer, Sovereign too.

54 O you who believe, if from you
 Any turn back from faith in view,
 Soon Allah will produce a folk
 Whom He will love as by the stroke
 They too love Him, humble with those
 Who do believe, mighty in foes
 Against rejecters, they shall strive
 Greatly in Allah's way to thrive
 And shall not fear what critics say.
 This is Allah's face, He gives way
 To whom He pleases, Allah's great
 To be forgiving, knowing fate.
 55 Your friends are Allah and the one
 He's sent, and the believers' run,
 Those who establish rate of prayer,
 Give charity in what they share,

And bow down humbly and with care.

Where is the new folk You promised to send,

The ones You promised to raise up and bend

To cite the words that You revealed to those

You sent and messengers to those who chose?

They may be hidden in the Muslim rows
At prayer beneath the crescent where it grows.

They may lurk in the aisles of churchly folk,

They may be among Jewish synagogues,
But where they are, they're quiet under stroke

Of their oppression by the shrieking frogs.

The silent figures mingle with the dust,
Their Father unseen, in whom they will trust

Along the paths of Kufa and the shore
Of the Euphrates at the open door.

56 Whoever takes Allah as well
As His messenger, and the spell
Of the believers to guard him,
Then Allah's party are not dim.

57 O you believers, do not take
Friends and protectors in the wake
Of those mockers who come to make
A jest of your faith, from the ones
Who got the book before your runs
Or from the unbelievers' buns.
But carefully perform your dues
To Allah if belief you choose.

58 And when you call to prayer, they make
A mockery and joke in wake.
This is because they are a folk
Who only understand a joke.

59 Say "O you people of the book!
Do you find fault with us in stroke
For anything but our belief
In Allah and what for relief
Is shown to us and once before,
And that most of you what is more
Are transgressors in meat and store?"

60 Say "Shall I show you who is worse
Than this in retribution's curse
From Allah? One whom Allah's cursed

And cast His anger on for worst,
Whom He made apes and swine, and he
Who worships idols in his spree.
Such are in a worse plight and far
Astray from the clear path and star."

The ones You turned to apes are those who kept

No Sabbath, but caught fish in nets
unswept.

Those were Jews, but the Christians' greater blame

In matters of the Sabbath are a shame.

When Muslims follow that example, they
Join other apes in unsabbatic way.

Ignoring the sweet Sabbath turns the man
Into one without spiritual plan,

An ape that follows instinct to a tee,

And never keeps the Sabbath faithfully.

They bob and hoot when they come out to pray,

They smile and shoot the perfume on with spray,

And never know that they are apes who keep

No seventh day the Sabbath where they sweep.

61 When they come to you, they will say

"We do believe, and yet they stray
With unbelief and with it go

Out with it, but Allah does know
Completely all they fail to show.

62 And you'll see many of them strive
With one another to make thrive

In sin and go beyond the hive,

And eating what's unlawful and

Wicked indeed their deeds in hand.

63 Why don't the rabbis and the priests

Forbid their evil-speaking feasts

Consuming the unlawful beasts.

Wicked are the works of their breasts.

64 The Jews say Allah's hand is tied.

Their hands shall be fettered and fried

For saying so. No, both His hands

Are spread and He grants and commands

As He please. What has been revealed

To you from your Lord and unsealed

Will surely make many of them

Increase their unbelief, condemn

Them to exaggeration's hem.

We've put hatred and enmity
Among them till the day they see
The resurrection. When they start
A blaze of war, Allah will dart
It out. They try to do their part
Of mischief in the land: Allah
Does not love mischief-making claw.

Sectarian abuse is rampant still,
The oecumenic tries to fill the bill,
But in fact only covers all the hate
With hopeful love-ins covered up and late.
The fact is Islam also comes to be
Divided in so many sects, I see
Fulfilment of the fatal prophecy.
Religion is a form of treachery.
Beloved, I rush to You and to the way
That You reveal in the books of Your sway,
And follow the books when I bow to pray,
And follow them in everything in hand,
The actions that I must take in the land.
Beloved, keep me ever in Your command.

65 If followers of the book had
Believed and guarded 'gainst the bad,
We'd surely have redeemed them from
Their evil deeds and made them come
Into the gardens of delight,
Ever to live in divine sight.
If they'd kept Torah and the light
Of Gospel, and what came in sight
From their Lord, they would have been fed
From above, and beneath feet led
Are some that keep the righteous ground,
But most of them are evil bound.
67 O Messenger, make known the song
Revealed to you from your Lord long.
If you don't do it, you will not
Have brought the message that He taught.
God will protect you from mankind.
God does not guide those who are blind
To truth, but stagger in the plot.
68 Say "O you people of the book,
You have no ground to stand and look
Unless you stand firm in Torah,
The Gospel and all that in awe
Has come revealed to you from your
Lord." It's the revelation stored
That comes down to you from your Lord
That increased in most of them their
Stubborn rebellion to blaspheme.

But do not sorrow or show care
For faithless people as they seem.
69 Those who believe and those who're
Jews

And the Sabians, in their pews
The Christians too, all who believe
In Allah and last day's reprieve,
And do the works of righteousness,
They'll have neither fear nor distress.
70 Surely We made a covenant
With Israel's folk and made extant
Their messengers, each time there came
To them a messenger to blame
Them for what they did in desire,
Some they called impostors in mire
And some they killed in wrath and ire.
71 They thought they'd not give an account.
So they were blind and deaf to mount.
Still Allah turned to them again
And many once more of their men
Became blind and deaf, but Allah
See all they do in hand and claw.

Jesus also blames Jews that they had killed
The prophets and so doing had fulfilled
Rebellion in the way that You'd instilled.
So it is no surprise to me today
To find the Qur'an also speaks that way.
It only shows them both under Your sway.
But such complacent thoughts that some
may find
To blame the Jews for the way that they
dined
Two thousand years ago with the well-
wined,
And even three to speak beyond the rind,
Are hardly justified. Christians kill too,
And Muslims at their killing are not few.
The one who kills a man kills all the earth,
And the one who saves one saves all in
worth.

72 They surely disbelieve who say
"Indeed, Allah's the Christ in sway,
The son of Mary," But Christ said
"O sons of Israel, be led
To worship Allah, my Lord and
The Lord of your own sinful band.
Indeed, the one who joins with God
Others, then Allah's barred the clod
From garden, and his dwelling place

Will be the fire, and there's no trace
Of helpers for the unjust race.

Beloved, I stand by Torah's word today
At the command in Ahmed's hand to sway.
I stand by Gospel's sound and make my
lord

The Christ named in its word and so
adored.

The double thread throughout all canons
stored

Is that the law and the law-giver still
Hold sway on earth and on each earthly
hill.

As long as the sound of the Qur'an swells
And Torah's rippling tunes in cantibels
Arise, and Gospels flow in grace
abounding,

And David's harp in Psalterly is sounding,
I follow ear and make my heart to play
And sing the dances of that roundelay,
And walk and talk the divine narrow way.

73 They surely disbelieve who say
"See Allah is third of three's way,
When there's no god, save one, Allah.
If they don't stop telling that lie,
A heavy penalty'll come by
The disbelievers in the sty.

74 Why don't they turn to Allah and
Seek His forgiveness in their band?
For Allah's oft forgiving and
Most merciful upon the land.

The measure of God's mercy is still seen
In Israel's choice, though actions may be
keen

And bring down sorrow on the humble
head

Of children of the ones who were first lead.
The measure of divine grace is still tall
Upon the sons of Israel great and small,
And shows the power of God to reconcile
His justice with His mercy mile by mile.
Beloved, each day You turn to me and I
Turn back without an ear to Your last sigh,
You bring the brightness of new life and
spring,

You bring the bitterness of winds that ring
About my house and heart. A moment just
I look to You and crumble in the dust.

75 The Christ, the son of Mary's just
A messenger, many such must
Have passed before him. His mum came
A woman with truth and no shame.
They both had to take nourishment.
See how Allah makes clear what's sent
To them in signs. Yet see how they
Are fooled and go from truth away.

76 Say "Do you serve others but God,
Such as have for you on the sod
Neither harm nor use to the bod?
Allah hears and knows, He is God.

77 Say "O you people of the book,
Do not exceed in what faith took,
And do not follow low desires
Of people gone astray to fires,
Leading many astray and went
Astray from the right path to bent.
78 Those who do not believe among
The children of Israel by tongue
Of David and Jesus, were cursed,
By son of Mary, since they burst
The bounds transgressing with the worst.

79 They did not use to forbid each
Other the wickedness to preach,
The wicked things they do and teach.

80 You see many of them make friends
With unbelievers, and that tends
To evil which their souls have sent
Before them, so Allah is bent
To be displeased with them and in
Doom they shall stay for all their sin.

Beloved, I too exceed the bounds and take
My own intelligence and for its sake
Invent a law to self and to my stake.
My heart is certain that the thing I see
Is right and doing so unrighteously
I fall into the pit of glitter dust
Where hopefulness turns into iron rust,
And wit to brass beneath the churchly
crust.

Beloved, bring me to Your bounds here,
And let me never cast eye or lend ear
To whisperings that something is unclear
And necessary to add to the weight
Of what Your Word provides
commensurate,
Of what Your heart divine ever holds dear.

81 If they'd believe in Allah and
 The prophet, and what's in his hand
 Of revelation, they would not
 Have taken them for friends in plot.
 But many of them came to choose
 The evil conduct in their pews.
 82 Most violent of humankind
 Against those who believe you'll find
 Are Jews and pagans, and you'll see
 The nearest of men in love's glee
 To those who believe are those who
 Say "We are Christians." That is true
 Because there are among them there
 Both priests and monks who do not share
 The pride of worldliness and care.
 83 And when they hear what's been
 revealed

To the messenger, you'll see peeled
 Their eyes gushing with tears to hear
 The truth they recongize to steer.
 They say "Our Lord, we do believe,
 Inscribe us witness to receive."
 84 How should we not believe Allah,
 And in the truth that's come in awe
 To us, while we long that our Lord
 Should bring us with good folk restored?"
 85 So Allah rewards them for what
 They said by the gardens unshut
 Under which rivers flow where they
 Shall abide, and this is the stay
 Of those who do good in their way.

Beloved, I find gross enmity in all!
 There is no other but the other's gall.
 To recognize the other is to set
 Oneself against the enemy, and yet
 The face of every other shows but One,
 For You alone are He, and counting's done.
 The single self imagines enmity
 In every other face, divinity
 Is hard put, but at last must recognize
 There is no what or where but in some wise
 That You are there, and You alone are true.
 I find no friend in any face but You,
 I find no face but is that friend alone
 That is Beloved in every clime and zone.

86 But those who disbelieve, deny
 Our revelations, these rely
 On their companions of flame nigh.
 87 O you who believe, forbid not

The good things which Allah has taught
 As lawful for you, so commit
 No excess, see, Allah will sit
 Unloving to those who transgress.
 88 Eat of the lawful and address
 The good that Allah's given you and
 Beware of Allah, understand.
 89 Allah won't hold you to account
 For your oaths of lightness in mount,
 But He'll require the oaths you swear
 In earnestness. Atonement's share
 Is feeding ten of needy folk
 With the same that you feed in stoke
 Your own, or clothe them, or then give
 A slave his freedom and to live.
 If those things are beyond your means,
 Then fast for three days in routines.
 This is atonement for oaths sworn.
 So guard your oaths, for Allah'd warn
 You by His revelations so
 That you'll learn thanksgiving to show.

But Jesus said before the crew of those
 Who followed him, to keep them on their
 toes,
 That every idle word that men should speak
 Would meet them in the judgement like a
 streak.
 That is enough for someone here to say
 That the two books conflict in roundelay.
 The small mind that thinks up such petty
 things
 Should stop to consider what merry rings
 A circus follows without struggling stings.
 Beloved, no oath of mine how serious
 Is worth the time and effort of the bus.
 My life no matter what I think I choose
 Is but the product of the things You use.
 An oath is only play gone out to cruise.

90 O you who believe, strong drink and
 Games of chance, setting stones to stand,
 Divining by arrows, all these
 Are an abomination's breeze
 From Satan, so shun all of them
 So you may have success in hem.
 91 Satan just wants to bring about
 Enmity and hatred in rout
 Among you by intoxicants
 And games of chance, and make you dance
 Far from remembrance of Allah

And from prayer. So withhold your paw.

92 Obey Allah, and so obey

The messenger and take care's sway.

If you turn back, know it is due

Our Messenger proclaim to you

Clearly the right and wrong and rue.

93 On those who believe and do good

There's no blame they eat what they should,

When they beware, believe and do

Good deeds, and again mindful to

Keep from evil and believe, then

They guard themselves from wicked den

And do good. For Allah loves those

Who do the good that Allah chose.

The population's always in a mess:

On one hand ready in wings to confess

The wrongs already long ago prevented

Such as the things they ate before when
dented,

And yet forgetting what wicked store bends

Them daily from their enemies and friends,

The gambling, drinking, and guessing the
future

That distracts them from opening of suture.

Beloved, strike down my conscience
hypocritic

In pretence of repentance paralytic,

A cover to distract me from the slow

Incessant villainy my carnal mind

Would sweep behind the judgement in a
show

Of piety that makes and keeps me blind.

94 O you who believe, Allah just

Makes trial of you by what game must

Be in the reach of hand and weapon,

To see what you fear and are hep on,

Being unseen, so any who

Transgresses after that is due

A painful penalty in pew.

O you who believe, don't kill game

What in the sacred precincts' frame

Or in the pilgrim dress. If you

Does so intentionally too,

Atonement is an offering

Brought to the Kaaba, to the sting

Of a domestic animal

Equivalent in value's stall

To the one slain, as judged by two

Just men chosen from among you,

Or by way of atoning just

To feed the poor as much as must,

Or the equivalent in fast,

So he may feel the weight that casts

His action. Allah forgives what

Is past, but the one in his glut

To do so again, Allah will

Take retribution on him still.

Allah is great, able to kill.

96 Lawful to you's the game of sea

And its food provided degree

For you and travellers, and the game

Of the land's forbidden for shame

As long as you're on pilgrimage.

Fear Allah, at the end of age

To Him you'll be gathered in stage.

97 Allah has set the Kaaba here,

The sacred house to keep from fear

Mankind, the sacred months also,

The beasts for sacrifice to go,

And garlands on them for the show,

So you might know that Allah knows

What's in the heavens and what goes

On earth, Allah knows all that shows.

98 Know that Allah's severe to give

Punishment and Allah will live

To be forgiving, merciful.

99 Nothing's due on messenger's pull

But to proclaim. Allah knows what

You might reveal and might keep shut.

Beloved, in pilgrimage I waited long,

And slowly kept remembrance of the song.

So far as I know in my passing there

I did not kill an animal or share

In wickedness berating any mate.

I kept the pilgrimage in a pure state.

I only took one life in that long trip,

The sheep that died where I had come to
sip.

Beloved, they told me that it was a sign

That You accepted when I came to dine

In Your house as Your guest, that I was
stricken

With devastation and came down to sicken.

The memory of that week still remains

To glorify my joying and my pains.

100 Say "Bad and good are not the same.

Though wicked plenty to your shame

May please you, so beware Allah,

Men of insight, success in crow.
 101 O you who believe, do not ask
 About things in which you would bask
 Distressed. But if you ask of them,
 When the Qur'an's revealed in hem,
 They will be made known to you then.
 Allah will forgive many men,
 For Allah's oft forgiving and
 Forbearing in His good command.
 102 A folk before you came to ask
 Such questions and then took the mask
 Of unbelief from what was manned.
 103 Allah had not appoint such things
 As bahirah or saibah's wings,
 Or wasilah or hami, but
 The unbelievers came in rut
 Of lying against Allah shut,
 But most lack wisdom in their gut.

It's asking questions that has raised the state
 Of so much in tradition and in weight
 On humankind. You only gave us ten,
 But we have multiplied it among men,
 By our requirement that You satisfy
 Our curiosity of earth and sky.
 If men had kept their mouths shut, they had
 found
 An easy and a straight path on the ground.
 Beloved, I depart from the straight path too
 In whirling round and round and asking
 You
 To cantillate a Word so that my feet
 In whirling round may find from You a
 treat.
 Beloved, make me satisfied where I stand
 To eat what is found in Your loving hand.

104 When it's said to them, "Come to what
 Allah's revealed, come to the one
 Sent with a message," they for fun
 Say "What our ancestors would do
 Is good enough for us in crew."
 What! Even though their fathers had
 No knowledge of the good and bad?

I too look to ancestors in my way,
 Untroubled by the lightness of their day,
 Untrammelled by the lack of knowledge
 where
 They stumbled and mistakenly they share
 Idolatry of self if not of faith,

Belief in earthly help if not in wraith.
 I too look longingly upon the crowd
 And wonder why they are so long allowed.
 Beloved, turn me from every father's set,
 And every faith tradition I have met
 Among the Christian, pagan and the Jew,
 Among the Muslims for a righteous crew,
 Until I find that I'm alone with You,
 The dipper that dips me in Your own hue.

105 O you who believe, keep your souls:
 The erring one harms none in tolls
 Who are in the right guidance goals.
 To Allah you will all return.
 He'll show truth of what all you earn.
 106 O you who believe, when death comes
 Near any of you, take in sums
 Witnesses among you to make
 Bequests, two just men for your sake
 Or others from outside, if you
 Are travelling through the earthly view,
 And sudden death comes to your pew.
 If you're in doubt, choose those who come
 Direct from prayer, and make succumb
 To an oath by Allah: we do
 Not hope in this for worldly gain,
 Even though our near kin attain.
 We shall not hide the evidence
 Before Allah, and if we do,
 Then see the sin is on our crew!"
 107 But if it gets known that these two
 Were guilty of such sin in view,
 Let two others stand in their place,
 From among those who have a trace
 Against them, the two near of kin.
 So they both shall swear by Allah.
 Surely our witness is in awe
 More than the testimony's way
 Of those two, and we don't give way,
 For then indeed we'd be unjust.
 108 It's more likely that they will give
 True witness if they fear to live
 After their oaths. But fear Allah,
 And listen to His Word with awe,
 For Allah does not come to guide
 Rebellious people filled with pride.
 109 On the day when Allah will stay
 To gather the messengers, say
 "What answer were you given that day?"
 They'll say "We do not know, it's You
 Who fully know the secret due."

You are too optimistic, my Beloved,
In thinking humankind with oaths ungloved
Is likely to speak truth of simple fare,
Of wealth in goods that they have come to share.

The greed of carnal mind for greater sums
Of money and of cloth among us bums
Is something that's beyond even Your mind:

Our wickedness, Beloved, has made You blind,

Unless Your love did so before the act.
I've heard that love is blind, and that's a fact.

Beloved, an oath or two will never make
A difference among us for Your sake,
But Your regard alone, Your grace at stake
Will give the life at last that we have lacked.

110 When Allah says "O Jesus son
Of Mary! Mind My favour done
To you and to your mother won,
When I gave you strength by My power
Of holy spirit, in that hour
You spoke to the folk as a child
In the cradle, and undefiled
As a grown man, and when I taught
You the book and such wisdom got
From Torah and the Gospel too,
And when you made of clay a thing
In the form of a bird in wing
By My permission, then you breathed
Into it and it became seethed
A living bird and by My leave,
And you healed the blind and the lot
Of leprosy by My leave taught,
And when you raised the dead again
By My permission to help men,
And when I kept back Israel's folk
From you when you came then and spoke
To them with arguments' clear stroke,
But those who disbelieved among
Them said "This is just magic sung."

111 See I inspired disciples to
Have faith in Me and in My true
Messenger, and they said "We've got
Faith, so bear witness we are taught
To bow to God submission wrought."

112 When the disciples said "O man,

Jesus the son of Mary's plan,
Will your Lord come to send us down
A table set from heavenly town?"
He said "Beware of God's renown
If you believe in Allah's crown."

113 They said "We only want to eat
And satisfy our hearts with treat.
It would make us know by the sign
That you've told us the truth's design,
And so we ourselves could remain
Witness to miracles for gain."

Request seems daring to ask that You send
A pot and potage to a village kenneled
Just to provide a miracle to be
A witness in disciples' memory.
I'd rather make request today that You
Would send daily some tonnes of food in cru

To those who starve so that my lifestyle true

May be a peaceful devouring of flesh
Under a blue sky and under the mesh
Of Western greed and its prosperity.
I'd rather that You intervene to see
The empty tables filled and children set
To eat with relish what they at last met.
Beloved, send down a table on Your pet.

114 Jesus the son of Mary said
"O Allah our Lord, now be led
To send us from heaven a spread
For us a blessing in our stead,
From first to last of us, a sign
From You. Give us with which to dine,
For You're best of sustainers' line."

115 Allah replied, "I'll send it down
To you, but if after renown
Any of you deny My crown,
I'll punish him with penalty
Such as I've never in degree
Laid on any one by decree
Among all of humanity."

116 They said "We only wish to eat
Of it to satisfy hearts' treat,
And know that you've told us the truth,
So we ourselves may *without ruth*
Be witnesses to the sign's seat."

The lad with one handful of barley bread

And two small fishes for his lunch then
 said
 The sent one might have his lunch for a
 feast,
 The lad would starve a day, one of the
 least.
 But no, the master prayed to God in heaven
 And brought down on the basket seven
 times seven
 And fed the multitude from heaven's table
 Where thousands ate as long as they were
 able.
 The twelve who followed him were filled
 with awe
 That Christ could call down both the
 cooked and raw.
 Faith grew at last to greatness, although fed
 On miracles and signs from heaven spread.
 I join the twelve as witness to the life,
 The bread of life among the wars and strife.

117 "I never told them anything
 Except what You command on wing,
 That is, 'worship Allah alone,
 My Lord and your Lord to atone,'
 And so I came to testify
 Against them while I lived there nigh
 Among them, when You took me high,
 You watched over them with a sigh,
 And You're witness of all I try."

The concept that lord Jesus never died
 Is not supported by the Word though tried.
 He admits in the judgement that You took
 Him from the life on earth that he forsook,
 And through death and the resurrection
 brought
 Him to celestial lands that he had sought.
 I understand the Muslim way's concern
 That death of Christ is something
 Christians earn
 To detriment of sovereign grace and burn
 In pagan faith and trust in ash and urn.
 But that is no excuse to deny fact,
 If Jesus died and rose up from the tract.
 Exaggeration is the common veil
 Of faith traditions under every sail.

118 "If You lay punishment on them,
 They are Your servanthood and gem.
 If You forgive them, that makes You

Exalted in power and in view,
 The wise *above the earthly crew.*"
 119 Allah says "This is a day when
 Truth will profit from their truth then.
 Theirs are the gardens under which
 The rivers flow, eternal pitch.
 Allah's well-pleased with them, and they
 With Allah. That's salvation's sway."
 120 To Allah is the sovereignty
 Of heavenly and the earthly
 All things in both, and it is He
 Who has the power and decree.

The sovereign grace, Beloved, that You
 proclaim
 Divine prerogative to those in blame
 Can even justify the pagan flame,
 And save brands from the burning
 Christian shame
 And blasphemy that calls You one of three,
 And bows before a pagan trinity.
 Such grace cannot be comprehended here,
 But does explain the quandary I fear,
 How You allowed such blasphemy a room
 Without a full and immediate in doom.
 By saving some among the awful crowd
 Who blaspheme Your name by that name
 allowed
 Of Trinity, You show the height of grace,
 And demonstrate Your infinite in face.

Surah 6. An'am, or Cattle.

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 Praise be to Allah, Who has made
 The heavens and the earth, and stayed
 To make the darkness and the light.
 Yet unbelievers hold as right
 Others equal with their Lord's *might*.

Praise be to You, Beloved, who made the
 light,
 Praise be to You, Creator of the night,
 Creator of the day and dark, praised be
 The Maker of the earth and sky and sea.
 Who made all things cannot compare to
 those
 That are created, You're not one of those.
 Unique of all in that You made all things,
 You cannot be counted among the kings,
 Among their subjects, but You are of all

The Sovereign and all things obey Your call.

The cattle are Your own, and none of ours,
But kept in trust for You these fleeting hours.

You give to whom Your will and take again,

Ox, goat, ass, goose, horse, sheep and water-hen.

2 He did create you from the clay,
And made a term of life to stay.

And there's a fixed term with Him too,
And yet you keep doubt in your view.

3 He's Allah in the heavens and earth,
He knows your secrets and what worth
You show, and He knows well what you
Will come to earn by what you do.

4 No revelation comes to them

Of those Allah has sent as gem,
But they turn aside from His hem.

5 They denied the truth when it came,
So the truth they deride for shame
Will shine upon them like a flame.

6 Don't they see how many before
In generations We made gore?

Such ones We'd set up on the earth
In power beyond what you are worth,
For whom We pour rain from the skies
Abundantly, and streams to prise
Beneath them, yet because of sin
We destroyed them from out their bin
And let new generations win.

Beloved, the rise and fall of empires here
Owes all success and failure to the fear
Of Your hand intervening at the last
To show to men the power that You cast.
You have created us a strange lot who
Imagines that we have the power to do
As well and think and plan, but all in fact
Comes from You only and Your power to act.

Beloved, I see the histories go past,
I see the Greeks and Romans fading fast,
I see the Chinese fall again and more,
And yet arise upon Pacific shore
To stand through ages. Every folk abroad
Rises and falls beneath the hand of God.

7 If We'd sent them a paper note,

So they could handle it and dote,

The infidels would take a vote

To say it was a magic rote.

8 They say "Why's not an angel sent
Down to him?" If an angel went
Out from Us, the issue would be
Firm, they'd have no immunity.

9 If We had made an angel come,
We'd have made him in human sum,
And so caused more perplexity
Than what they already do see.

10 Messengers before you were mocked,
But the derision then was flocked
On those scoffers themselves when
blocked.

11 Say "Travel through the land and see
What end of the rejecters be."

12 Say "Whose are all in heaven and
earth?"

Say "Allah's. He's inscribed its worth
For Himself in His mercy's girth.
He'll bring you all together when
The day of resurrection then
Comes without doubt at all again.
Those losing their own souls will pen
Their unbelief within their den.

I've travelled here and there, Beloved, and I
Have seen the selfsame sun upon the sky
In Egypt and in Asia and have found
Its warmth upon the Puerto Rican ground.
Americas and European round
Cast me upon the billows of my life.
I've travelled in between both peace and

strife,
And carried with me book and fork and
knife.

And everywhere I go I wonder that
The houses multiplied where idols sat,
But nowhere did I find a marble dome
Where Torah and Qur'an both found a
home,

And where the Gospel rang in Psalter's
tome.

I've only found false worship of the fat.

13 To Him belongs what's in the night,
What moves upon the day in sight,
He hears and knows with all His might.
Say "Shall I choose protecting friend
Any but Allah to defend,

The maker of both heaven and earth?
He's nourisher but eats no thing."
Say "No, but I'm His commanding
To be first to bow in submission
To Allah, so do not you be
Of those who make a company
Of gods with Allah faithlessly."

15 Say "I'd fear not to obey Him
Who is my Lord, chastisement grim
Upon a grievous day and dim."
16 The one on whom that day does not
Fall such a penalty in lot,
It's due to Allah's mercy wrought:
The clear fulfilment of all sought.
17 "If Allah touches you with ill,
There's none to relieve from the spill
But He, and if He touches you
With some good fortune as in due,
He has power over all in view.
18 "He has all power upon those who
Worship Him, and He's wise to know
All things above and here below."

The sovereign grace that Moses spoke
about
And Jesus offered to the Roman rout,
And David sang, and even Augustine
Remembered in the African heat's scene
Is sung by good Muhammad to the fair
And to the unjust sitting everywhere.
You have the power and wield the weal and
woe,
And I am satisfied to have it so.
Beloved, I trust You because You know
best
The in and all of everything You've
blessed,
In heaven above and in the hometown
street,
Your grace is in all things that humans
meet.
Let me like Job rush to You to receive
The good and ill upon my human sleeve.

19 Say "What's the strongest evidence?"
Say "Allah's witness of the fence
Between me and you. This Qur'an
Has been revealed to me in dawn
Inspired, so I may warn you and
All those who hear of its command.
Can you give demonstration that

There's an Allah except who sat
As Allah on His throne for mat?"
Say "No, I cannot bear witness."
Say "Then in truth He is the one,
Allah alone, and I have done
With your joining others to stun."

The demand for proof of the fact that You,
Beloved, exist and rule the human crew
Is foolish, since as the Qur'an makes clear,
No one but You could bring evidence near.
And yet the ones who've not yet heard the
call
Are certain that their hopes will never fall,
And what they see and know is seen and
known
Forever without need of You on throne.
The ways of human wisdom are awry,
And yet You do not answer from the sky,
Nor from the inner closet where I try.
The temple of Your silence is one sweet,
But only for the elect on the street,
The yellow wren that hops about to tweet.

20 Those whom We gave the Book know
Him
As they know their own sons with vim.
Those who've lost their own souls refuse
For that to come to faithful use.

The knowledge of Your throne and power
and face
Is clear to those who've come each week to
trace
Your Word in Hebrew syllables and race,
The Torah chimes in sudden brighter grace.
The Qur'an gives a witness that the tune
Of Torah brings Your knowledge like the
noon,
The lines of Your divinity as clear
As features on the children we hold dear.
Beloved, I speak the Arabic awhile,
Qur'anic verse that makes me weep and
smile,
And turn again to Hebrew scratches where
Your muddy footprints soil the page and
dare
To bring to earth a heavenly room and
state,
The fulness of divinity and great.

21 Who's more unjust that the one who
Invents a lie against the view
Of Allah or denies the true
Of revelation, suchly such
Unjust will never success touch.

So true, Beloved, is this word that I read,
And yet it condemns most of human seed.
The one may not deny the Torah's sound,
But still curse the three other books around.
One holds to the Qur'an, but comes to hate
The Gospel caught in Greek, a poorer state.
And some without foundation for belief
Are sure that only Paul gives us relief.
Beloved, how few there be who take the
Word

Of the Four Books, all four of them as
heard,
And love them and recite them and at last
Live by the light and shadows they have
cast!

No wonder I am lonely on my hill
As I hear, dance, and by Your grace fulfil!

22 Some day We'll gather them all up
And say to those who join a tup,
"Where are the partners you invented
To take Allah's place unprevented?"

23 Their only excuse they can say
"By Allah, we were not astray
To join gods with Allah one day."

24 See how they lie against themselves.
But that will leave them on their shelves.

I've heard this lie so many times I fear
That it has become faith of far and near.
They say they do not sin to join with You
A Trinity of gods to keep in view.
They say they do not go astray to make
An idol of theology and cake.
They say and say and dance around the
ring,

Pretending You are this, that, other thing.
Beloved, I do not come to define wing
Of Your divinity. I only sing
The words of my delight as I take hold
Of revelation that You've been so bold
To cast upon the world in books divine:
The Torah's water and Qur'anic wine.

25 Some listen to you, but We've cast

Veils on their hearts, so they don't last
To understand, and deafness laid
Upon their ears, if they had stayed
To see each of the signs, they'd not
Believe them, so when in their lot
They come to you, they just dispute.
The unbelievers say "They toot
Just ancient tales of no repute."

26 They prevent some from it and go
Astray themselves, and only show
Destruction on their own souls and
They don't see what's before their hand.

How many veils on hearts I've seen about
The streets, the mart, the internet, no doubt,
In every church and mosque and synagogue
Where faith and love are painted in a fog!
The veils, Beloved, You cast on hearts in
sway

Are thicker than the dark after the day,
Are damper than the earth upon the shore,
Are fuller than the floods that beat there
more.

Let me be bold to penetrate the veils
And find the treasure where the soul
prevails,

But mind me of the storm above the way,
The hopelessness of Your eternal ray.
And I shall see the many in the crowd
Without a whimper that I've been aloud.

27 If you could just see when they're
brought

To stand before the fire unsought,
They'll say "If we could only go
Back, then we'd not reject the glow
Of our Lord, but believe the show!"

28 So, it will be clear to them too
What they hid before from the view.
But if they were returned, it's sure
They go back to their things impure,
For they are liars, that is sure.

The judgement that You propose on all
men

Awaits the time and place and then again
Condition of the heart in its deceit
So that condemned will with one voice
repeat

If only they could choose again their way,

They'd not go from the righteous path
astray.

You tell it before time, so when they do,
You can say that the answer's what You
knew.

Beloved, You choose the ones You will to
sing,

And those You will to bow before the sting
Of fire and punishment and horrid pain.
You're justified in Your election's gain
By the illusion that men always claim,
They think they make their choice of love
or flame.

29 And they say "There is nothing known
Except the temporal life shown
On this earth, and we'll never be
Raise up again for penalty."

30 If you could just see when they must
Stand before their Lord in the dust!
He'll say "Is this not the truth's crust?"
They say "Yes, by our Lord we trust."
He'll say "Then taste the penalty,
Because you disbelieve in Me."

31 They're lost who deny they shall meet
Allah, until when an hour fleet
Comes on them and they say "Alas
That we took no thought what would pass."
They bear upon their backs the weight
Of evil burdens in their state.

It is human conceit to deny what
He cannot see or hear or at least shut
In formula. My own good father told
Me not to believe half of sight or hold
A single word I hear as truth's unfold.
We were created by Your word to doubt
The true, it seems, and by the turn about
To have faith in the false in every way
We dance from morning till the close of
day.

Beloved, reverse creation in my heart,
And let me love the truth that You impart,
Despite invisibility for me,
Despite the silence on the pouring sea,
The silence of Your great divinity.

32 And this world's life is just a play
And idle sport while in its way
The life to come is better for
Those who are aware of what's more.

Do you not understand the score?

33 We surely know that what they say
Is grief to you, but surely they
Do not call you a liar, but those
Who are unjust deny revealed
Things of Allah and do not yield.
34 Messengers were denied before
You. They were patient as they bore
Rejection and wrong till Our aid
Came to them. There's none who is made
Able to change decrees of God.
You have prophets' account in rod.

Muhammad is a Calvinist, it's sure,
On every page I see the doctrine pure
That none can change decrees of God and
live

To see the ample heart's results and give
Account for having made the universe
With or without a word in saving curse.
The hopes and fears are all determined so
By the environment that is not slow
To speak to our biology and glow.
Beloved, what You decree may come to
show

What's hidden in eternal plot and plan.
But at the sight the craven heart of man
Will plagiarize Your own and fast disperse
The pages of his claims on what is worse.

35 If their disdain is hard to bear,
Then, if you can, search out to share
A way down into the earth's deep
Or yet a ladder to sky steep,
To bring them down a sign to keep.
If it were God's will He could bring
Them all together under wing
Of truly guided. So don't be
Among the ignorant degree.
36 Those chosen to accept will hear.
Those dead will God make to appear,
And then they'll turn to Him *in fear*.

Beloved, the lifting of the heart to sing
Is not a proof that You have been choosing
Me for salvation from eternal fling.
The good deeds that I lay upon the earth
As though in offering are of little worth,
And none can buy eternal life with You.
There is no proof in anything I do.
I search for satisfaction that I may

Enter the life of paradise some day.
The only proof to me and to my part
Is in the subtle reaches of my heart,
Not in it's inspiration, joy or crown,
But in awareness of my sins' renown,
And in the gift repenting You send down.

37 They say "Why has no sign been sent
Down to him from his Lord present?"
Say "God has power to send a sign,
But most of them see no design."

38 No animal on earth nor bird
That flies on wing, but comes in herd
Like you. There's nothing been left out
Of the Book, so gathered about
Shall they be to their Lord with shout.
39 Those who reject Our revelations
Are deaf and dumb in darkness' stations.
Whom God wills, He lets go astray,
Whom He wills, puts in the right way.

40 Say "Figure if God's punishment
Should come on you or the time sent,
Would you call on other than God,
If you have grain of truth in pod?
41 "No, He's the one you call upon,
And He removes what makes you drawn
To call on Him and as He's grim,
You forget what you join with Him."

I lay hold on Your revelation here,
Both on the Torah and the Psalms so dear,
And on the Gospel stories read in cheer,
And on the bold Qur'an that ties loose ends
Left in the former Scriptures by Your
friends.

I lay hold still, but my hypocrisy
Is strong enough to deceive You and me.
Require my heart, Beloved, in purity,
The gift of sovereign grace, and I shall see
The splendoured villages and awesome
spires

Of paradise beyond human desires,
The hopes and the assurances and fires.
Beloved, I have no gift to give to You:
I only wait the coming of Your dew.

42 We surely sent to nations known
Before you and by suffering grown
We struck them that they might alone
Grow humble in all that they own.

43 When pain came on them from us, why

Did they not humbly look to sky?
Instead their hearts were hardened fast,
And Satan made things seem a blast.
44 When they forgot the warning care,
We opened them all goods in share,
Till in the middle of their joy
Of Our gifts, suddenly in ploy
We brought them into judgement's game,
See they were cast in despair's shame.
45 Of the folk who did wickedly
The last left were cut off. Praise be
To Allah Lord of worlds to see.

There seems to be a new crowd since the
day
Muhammad heard that You had spun the
way
Of wickedness in loss and cast at bay
The folk of wickedness from where they
stay.

The last of evil-doers has been seen
Perhaps in every generations' green,
And in the generation that I live,
I see the wickedness of greed and sieve,
And fancy my own heart may oft applaud
The empty rather than the pea in pod.
I praise You nonetheless despite the swarm
Of evil-doers who keep the earth warm,
And know Lord of the universe is game
To put all humankind on earth to shame.

46 Say "Just think if God took away
Your hearing and your sight one day,
And sealed your hearts, what god beside
Allah could restore them to guide?"

See how We clarify the signs
In varied ways and in designs,
And yet they turn away in lines.

47 Say "Do you think God's punishment,
If it comes on you clear or bent,
Would any be destroyed but those
Who are wicked folk *in their rows*?"

48 We sent not messengers alone
To give good tidings and the drone
Of warning, so those who believe
And so repent, they shall receive
No fear, nor shall they ever grieve.
49 But those who reject revelation
From Us, chastisement is their ration
Because they transgressed *in their station*.

50 Say "I don't tell you I possess

The treasures of Allah's address,
 Nor do I know secrets from high,
 Nor do I tell you now that I
 Am an angel. I just go by
 What is revealed to me or try."
 Say "Can the blind be considered
 The same as any seeing herd?"
 Will you not consider the word?
 51 Warn thereby those who fear that they
 Be gathered to their Lord's last day,
 There is no guardian for them,
 Nor intercessor in their hem
 To guard against the coming way.
 52 Don't drive away those who do call
 On their Lord morn and eve in all
 To seek His face. You need not give
 Account for them and they don't live
 To give account for you for you
 To turn them from the way they do,
 And so be one of unjust crew.

The way of David in the fast and call
 Of Scripture in the palace and the hall
 Of heart and temple is the way that You
 Most love, and even Islam come in view
 Does not come to change any bolt or screw
 Of David's fast and David's dhikr too.
 The calling on Your name in morn and
 night
 With Psalm and Torah is a way that's right,
 And still resounds upon the heart as bright
 As in the day that You came to inspire
 The Hebrew syllables with Your desire.
 Beloved, I cantillate the ancient word
 And find it flies and darts like singing bird,
 Alive as soon as tongue will heave the
 herd.

53 So We try some by others' way
 To see if they will stay to say
 "Are these the ones that God in sway
 Has favoured among us today?"
 Does not God know best who are they
 Who are grateful *and without pay*?
 54 When those come to you who believe
 In Our revealings to relieve,
 Say "Peace on you! Your Lord does take
 Mercy upon Him for your sake.
 Truly if you in ignorance
 Do wickedly in human dance
 And then repent and mend your ways,

See He's forgiving for His praise,
 Most merciful to human lays."
 55 And so We give in revelations
 Exposing ways of sinful nations.
 56 Say "I'm forbidden to bow down
 To those you pray to in the frown
 Of Allah." Say "I shall not follow
 Your empty wishes. If I'd swallow,
 I'd stray from the path and not be
 Among the guided company."
 57 Say "I take clear sign from my Lord,
 But you reject the One Adored.
 What you want hurried's not for me.
 God's alone is command's decree.
 He states the truth, and He is best
 To judge *what may not be confessed*."
 58 Say "If I had in hand what you
 Rush to accomplish, then in view
 It would be settled between us,
 You and me, everything in fuss,
 But Allah knows best who does worse."

Some You have made to worship man and
 beast,
 The gold and silver, idols great to least,
 And ride upon the highways to a star,
 Some are made to remain there where they
 are.
 Some You have made to count the shilling's
 cost,
 And find the wages that had once been lost,
 Some You have lent the lavish love
 increased
 For reason's goddess reigning on the
 fleeced.
 But my Beloved, You made me with such
 care
 That nothing can inspire my love in share
 But You alone. The footprints that You left
 On Puijo's sides, pale violets bereft,
 Lead me no farther than Your sky for
 dome,
 Your pillars firred and pined above my
 home.

59 He has the keys of the unseen,
 The treasures none knows but His bean.
 He knows whatever's on the earth
 And in the sea. No leaf in worth
 Falls without His knowledge in berth.
 There's no grain in earth's deep nor yet

The fresh or dry but still is set
Recorded *in His book to get*.

The sparrow of the Gospel turns to leaf
In the Qur'an to affirm my belief.
His eye is on the sparrow, says the song,
And so I know He keeps me from all
wrong.

Indeed, I trust You more than I trust self,
Or any other sort of pagan elf,
And hope in You alone after the way
I've disappointed my own self in sway.
Beloved, the leaf that falls I know's unique,
And so I wonder that You take a peek
Only to let the wonder disappear,
Lost in the fatal earth with all its gear.
There's no injustice in the roll of time
In divine judgement, no, never a crime.

60 It's He who takes you in the night
And knows what you do in the light.
He raises you again by day,
To the appointed time and way,
At last to Him will you return,
And at that time you'll come to learn
The truth of everything you earn.

61 He's irresistible above
To care for worshippers in love,
He sets His guardians over you.
At last when death comes into view
Of one of you, Our angels take
His soul and never fail their stake.

62 So men are taken back to God,
Who's their protector on the sod,
Only reality in prod:
His is the judgement surely and
He's swift to reckon all in hand.

Your grace, Beloved, is never to be kept
Back from the human hearth though duly
swept.

None can resist the call of love and power
That You raise at Your own appointed
hour.

Though men may try to make a newer way,
And take control of fate and bear the sway
Of power up to the resurrection day,
You turn deflected every thrust and tower.
Beloved, see my resistance fail before
The knocking of Your hand upon the door,

And every lock and bolt placed there with
care

Melts disappearing on the thinner air.
I too return, with all the race of men,
And find Your face and grace and power
again.

63 Say "Who is it delivers you
From dangers of the land in view
And of the sea when you review
Your call to Him, humble, discreet:
'If He alone saves our retreat
From such, we'll truly be ones meet
In gratitude before His feet?'"

64 Say "It is Allah who saves you
From these and all distresses too,
And still you worship false gods' due."

Beloved, by sovereign grace You save the
ones

Whom You have chosen beforehand by
tonnes.

And yet the most of them sit in the pew
Of false religions that deny both You
And the right worship that You've set as
due.

How many gather on the Sabbath day
To sing the Scriptures sung in roundelay?
How many cast aside the trinities
Of heathen hope and come alone to please
You who are sovereign on the heavenly
throne?

Seven thousand, You said, stayed in Israel
Besides Elijah, to escape the spell
Of wickedness. In solitude they sat
Hardly remarked by even dog or cat.

65 Say "He can send you punishment
From above you or from descent
Under your feet, or cover you
With such bewilderment in view
Of the dissension in your crew
Under the tyranny you spew."
See how we show the revelations
In many ways for cogitations.

66 Your people do deny the fact,
Although it's the truth in the act.
Say "I'm not in charge of you *backed*.

67 "Each declaration has its term,
And soon you'll know of it *and squirm*."
68 When you see men meddle a might

With Our signs, turn back from the sight
Of them, unless they change their speech.
If Satan makes you not mind this,
When you remember the true reach,
Don't sit in that crowd's cowardice.

How do men meddle with the divine Word,
The verses sent by prophets that once
stirred

The hearts and minds of men and women
here?

They do so by their preaching, and I fear,
By the way that they try to show the
meaning

Of what You say by alternative screening.
The fact is human mind and language may
Pretend the opposite of what You say.
It's only grace that brings the faith that
knows

The meaning of the Scriptures in their
rows.

And so, Beloved, enlighten me today,
Preserve me from the meddling in my way,
And keep before the eye of him who reads
And at the ear of hearer Your own creeds.

69 It's not the job of righteous folk
To give account of what they poke,
But only to remind them that
They may learn to fear God out flat.

I'm not responsible to convert those
Who are dead in their sins away from woes.
I'm only here to remind them their toes
Are at the fire, so they may learn to fear
The coming conflagration and the tear.
But You, Beloved, Creator, Sovereign here,
Choose from the mass of undeserving peer
Those whom by grace You'll save from
punishment
That's waiting for the wicked where they
went.

Beloved, give me more spirit to repent,
That's all I know that shows that You relent
From casting me in hell. And I shall praise
Your worthy name throughout eternal days.
If not, then teach me now to fear Your
ways.

70 Leave those who take their faith for
play,

A mere sport, whom this world's life's way
Has blinded and remind them how
A soul runs to spoil by its acts.
Such will find no guard go-between
Except God. If one offered seen
Every ransom, none would esteem
Accepted. But such are to deem
Lost by their own fault. To all such
Is drink of boiling water's touch,
And grievous punishment to clutch,
For they kept on in unbelief,
Rejecting Allah to their grief.

In winter where I live, my daily drink
Is boiling water, but here on the brink
Of tundra none could ever come to think
Hell fire was near the brave or not in link.
Reminder of that place came once a week
As Finns gathered in past times for a peek
At sauna steaming temperatures sleek
Near boiling point before the burning leak.
Beloved, I choose the boiling water now,
And hope it may suffice on sinful brow,
So that when You gather Your own You'll
find

Me with the chosen ones and not the blind.
But if repentance flees from me today,
I'll find a warmer haven where to stay.

71 Say "Shall we call on any but
Allah, things that can do no glut
Of good or harm to us, and turn
Back from the guidance that we learn
From Allah, like the one who's made
A fool by evil ones waylaid,
And wandering through the land? He's got
His friends to call him to their plot,
To guide him to the pathway sought."
Say "Allah's leading's guidance true,
And we've been led to submit to
Lord of the universe *in view*.

72 "To keep up prayers and fear Allah:
And He's the one you'll hold in awe."

73 It's He created heavens and earth
By the command of truth in girth
The day He says "Be" and it is.
His word is truth. The reign is His
On the day when the breaths shall whiz,
The knower of unseen and seen,
He is the wise, aware and keen.

O my Beloved! How many times I turn
Back from my prayers to what the world
would learn,

And grasp the visible, the idols caught
In steel and glass, and in energy taught!
Oh let my soul depraved and lost in sin
Rise from unholy worship and its din
Into the calm and still where the small
voice

At last will make my will stand and rejoice.
O my Beloved, I rush to You alone,
And turn from every president and throne,
And my reliance on blood, flesh and bone.
Eternal glory somewhere waits to find
The bidden and the soul that once was
blind,
Recipient of Your graced and divined.

74 See, Abraham said to his father,
“Do you take idols for gods, Azar?
I see you and your folk to be
In error manifest surely.”

The father of dear Abraham I see
In Torah is Terah by the decree,
And some see in the title of Azar
An arrow shot toward a straying star,
A fatal flaw and a discrepancy.
The difference between title and name
Can be ambiguous, yet without blame.
Desire to cast fault on the Scriptures here
Is prevalent, Beloved, and so I fear
That blasphemy is greatest of all sins
Found in the human sort of garbage bins.
Beloved, let me not search for hooks to
hang
My vain doubts on, but let me with a bang
Keep doubts that provide life with zest and
tang.

75 And so we did show Abraham
The kingdom of the heavens to *cram*
The earth, so he might be of those
Who are convinced upon their toes.

76 So when night over-shadowed him
He saw a star, *a star not dim*,
And said “Is this my Lord *in trim*?”
But when it set, he said “I do
Not adore setting ones *in view*.”

77 Then when he saw the moon come up,
He said “Is this my Lord *or tup*?”

But when it set he said *in cup*,
“If my Lord had not guided me
I'd be of erring company.”
78 Then when he saw the sun arise
He said “Is this my Lord *in guise*?”
But when the sun set, he said then
“O my folk, I am free again
From giving partners among men
To Allah *whether three or ten*.”
79 I've surely turned my face to Him
In upright and whole-hearted vim,
Who started sky and earth in toll,
I'm not of polytheists' roll.

The story of Abraham's like the one
Told of Inka Pachacuti whose sun
Was god until he saw how it did run
In its obedience around the sky,
And so must follow the command on sly
Of greater and Creator to reply.
Today, Beloved, few look above to find
The clarity of truth or to unwind.
We look in books and internet to see
What other men believe and if they flee
To profits and to gains, then also we
Believe their vain conceits and false decree.
Beloved, let me look up and know each day
That You alone in royalty hold sway.

80 His people argued with him then.
He said “Do you argue like men
Against Allah? He's guided me
Surely, and I don't fear decree
Of those you set up with Him, but
As my Lord pleases so to strut.
My Lord includes in knowledge met
All things, will you not see the set?
81 “How should I fear things you have
joined

With Allah, when you've no fear coined
To give associates to God
Without good reason on the sod
Sent down by Him? Which of the two
Is surer of safety in crew?
Say if you know the truth in view.
82 “Those who believe and don't mix up
Their faith with wickedness in cup,
Those are the ones who'll have safety
And they go in the right degree.”

The natural heart of man's a heart of fear,

And I know that from self as well as peer.
 The fear of pain is not dim with the cheer
 Of grace repentant at obeying ear,
 But fear of what the neighbour has to say,
 And how the great majority will pray
 Is the fear that is lost when You descend
 To bring depravity of heart an end.
 Beloved, I fear no stone theology,
 No binding creed, no arm of human glee,
 Nor anything associate with You
 By hand and mind of heathen sort of crew.
 All glory is Your own, and all I give,
 My faith is Yours, and so I come to live.

83 And so this was our argument
 We gave to Abraham as sent
 Against his people where they went:
 We raise to dignity whom We
 Desire, and surely your Lord's free
 In wisdom and in cogency.
 84 We gave to him Isaac and Jacob,
 Each did We guide, and Noah wake up
 Before, and sent down of his spawn
 David and also Solomon,
 And Job and Joseph and Aaron,
 And so We do reward the few
 Who do good to others in crew.
 85 And Zachariah, John, Jesus,
 And Elijah and omnibus
 Who were of the good without fuss.
 86 And Ishmael and Elisha and
 Jonah and Lot, all come to stand
 We made excel in universe.
 87 And to their fathers and not worse
 Descendants and brothers. We chose
 Them and guided in the right rows.
 88 This is God's guidance, by which He
 Guides those He pleases by decree
 As His servants, and if they'd set
 Up others, they would surely get
 No success in the things they met.

The great and good, the righteous in the
 earth
 Are all such, not because of their deeds'
 worth,
 But by Your choice, Beloved, divine decree
 That they should be among the ones set
 free
 Of fallen heart and heart's depravity.

You chose them and by Your choice raised
 them all
 To hear Your voice and respond to Your
 call.
 Repentance was the watchword of their
 ball.
 Beloved, choose me too by Your word,
 And separate me from the hopeful herd
 That must seek their salvation by the way
 They earn the right to look to moon and
 bay.
 Choose me and burn my merits from the
 hand,
 The heart, the hope and from the heavenly
 land.

89 These are those whom We gave the
 book,
 And wisdom and prophetic look,
 So if these disbelieve in it,
 We surely trust it to folk fit
 Who do not disbelieve in it.
 90 These are those whom God's guided, so
 Follow their guidance. Say "I'd know
 From you no reward for the show,
 It's just a reminder to go
 To the nations not to be slow.

Across the melodies of centuries,
 Long on the air of earth and sky and seas,
 Around the world, above the course of
 men,
 How do the names of the twelve rise again!
 Man wanders in the lovely wisdom taught
 Under the mantle that the rabbis sought,
 Help comes at last from the light sent
 abroad
 Among the humble waiting on the sod.
 Miraculous the revelation found
 Attached to frozen hoof prints in the
 ground!
 Delight fills my soul as I make the round
 Across the dergah echoing with sound
 Launched by the voices true and sweet
 though faint.
 I whirl and whirl and never make
 complaint.

91 They don't give to God attributes
 Due to Him when they say *in boots*,
 God's not revealed to mortal *eyes*

And ears a message from the skies.
 Say "Who revealed the book brought by
 Moses, a light and guidance nigh
 To humankind, which you set in
 Leaves scattered showing some and yet
 Concealing much *that men should get?*
 You were taught what you did not know,
 Not you nor your ancestors' show."
 Say "Allah" then leave them to go
 In their sport of vain discourse glow.
 92 This is a book We have sent down,
 Blessed to affirm that of renown
 That you may warn the mother town,
 And those around it, and those who
 Believe in the coming in view
 And in it, and who come to pray
 Constantly and in the right way.

All that You once revealed to Moses when
 Laughter of the Egyptian left the den
 And Israel fled across the sea and sand
 Has been recorded by a faithful hand.
 Men hear and know the Torah by the sound
 Uncloaked in the synagogue's resound.
 Hacked in the tables of stone for all men
 Along eternities of earthly fen,
 Made clear in every language not come late
 And spoken in both wisdom, love and hate,
 Delivered on the fatal air, Your law
 Accumulates in human ear and awe.
 Love now or not the populace in store,
 I praise You still, Beloved, I praise You
 more.

93 And who is more unjust than he
 Who makes lies against God's *decree*,
 Or says "It's been revealed to me,"
 While nothing's been sent to his hem,
 And he who says, "By stratagem
 I can bring the like of what God
 Has sent down *on the earthly sod.*"
 If you'd seen how the wicked shall
 Writhe in the agonies of hell
 And angels spread out their hands well:
 Give yourselves up, today you'll get
 Paid with a punishment that's set
 Because you spoke against Allah
 What is not truth and without awe,
 Proudful against His revealed law.

Before the book of Joseph Smith was
 written,
 The Qur'an spit out what the man had
 bitten.
 The one great follow of that book is
 guessed
 In Sunday worship of the crowd unblessed.
 So many books are published with the seed
 Of human graft and human sound of greed!
 Some write new books, and others set the
 hand
 To the defiling of Your books that stand.
 Preserve me, my Beloved, of that great sin,
 And keep my heart and ear out of that din.
 I see the Sabbath stricken from the new
 Translations of the Bible. Qur'an's view
 Is still upstanding in translators' crew.
 Your sovereignty, Beloved, still stands to
 win.

94 Surely you've come to Us alone
 As We created you in tone
 From the beginning, and you've set
 Behind your backs the things you met
 From Us, and We don't see you get
 The mediators that you bet
 Are ones joined to God for your pet:
 Surely the bonds between you now
 Are cut and what you thought somehow
 Has fled from your *hands and your brow.*

Since Wesley in his pride came back to
 church
 In hopes the great would not leave him in
 lurch,
 The rag-assed multitudes have come to
 hear
 The lie that human choice rules men's fate
 near.
 The mediator, the blasphemed Christ stands
 And lifts before You, my Beloved, his
 hands,
 Denying that a soul stirred of the damned
 May be saved by his clamouring
 unclammed.
 The mediators that men claim to set
 Beside You in divinity unswept
 Fail all and so repudiate the claim
 That Your salvation lies in feelings' flame.
 By Your decree and not by hymn and
 prayer

Your chosen resurrect and rise in air.

95 Indeed God splits the grain and pit
To sprout, He brings forth living fit
From the dead and He brings the dead
Down from the living, Allah's spread!
How have you turned away in dread!

96 He cleaves the dawn, He's made the
night

For rest, and sun and moon aright
For reckoning, the way so set
By the Mighty, the Knowing yet.

The sun and moon are made for reckoning,
And that appears for times' fair beckoning
In days and months and years to know the
way

That You hold over all times sovereign
sway.

But smaller things in nature show the day
Of Sabbath, last of seven in array:
Blood pressure, acid content of the blood,
Red blood cells, heart beat, heat on tongue
in flood,

The urine chemistry and volume show
The way the cycles of the sevens flow.
Above all the immune system in man
Shows cycles of the seven at a scan.
I look to no moon for the Sabbath days,
They are all counted in Your heart and
praise.

97 It's He who's made the stars for you
So you might follow the way true
In darkness of the land and sea;
Surely We've made clear the decree
For a folk who know *faithfully*.

The stars have led the sailors many years,
As well as caravans in desert fears.
The blessing of the stars I see above
Is given to humankind by Your love.
There's hardly anything left in this world
Depleted by the sinful way we've swirled
But Sabbath pure returning every week
And stars above the many things men seek.
Beloved, when I've enough of chasing fires
And shadows that speckle earthly desires,
I pause and look to see the stars in sway
Around the sky and silver milky way,
And know that beyond this a better day

Retains my hope in what Your law
requires.

98 It's He who has produced you from
A single soul, a place to drum
And a depository's sum;
Surely We've made clear the decree
For a folk who know *faithfully*.

All things indeed, Beloved, appear to be
Planned, executed, and by Your decree
Fulfilled on earth and in the heavenly sea.
All things indeed, Beloved, in solace find
Their sources in the inscrutable mind
Of Your divinity and sovereignty.
The single soul indeed, the soul of man
Or woman placed upon the earth by plan
Is the vast room where Your deposits made
Appear in fleeting images displayed.

I see the rushing forms and colours glow,
I see the lives pass by me in a row,
And my own hopes and knowings come to
show

Your glories temporal in full parade.

99 It's He sends down the water from
The cloud, then We bring forth the rum
Buds of all, and at last the green
From which We bring forth grain and bean
Piled high, and the palm with its sheaths,
The ripe dates clustered in their wreaths,
And vineyards, oliveyards and hold
Of pomegranates manifold
And similar; so see the fruit
Of it when it yields fruit to boot,
And certainly in this are signs
For a folk in believing lines.

As I each day whirl round the hill above
My yellow cabin where I keep my love,
I see the water from the clouds shift leaf
And pinestraw from the pathway of their
grief,

And flow beneath the crust of rock to find
The arteries and veins of Puijo's rind.
No pomegranates grace the slopes I tread,
Nor palms lift up their green swords at my
head,

But buds remember in one day to burst
Forth in the songs of blessed and the
uncursed.

The fruit is spare: an arctic bramble rare,
A huckleberry higher on the stair,
A lily-of-the-valley too produces
A shiny poisoned speck that crows seduces.

100 And they make jinn associates
With Allah, who creates their states,
And falsely attribute to Him
Sons and daughters with knowledge dim:
Glory be to Him, let Him be
Exalted high above the spree
Of what they ascribe to His fee.
101 Beginner of the sky and earth,
How could He have a son in birth
Who has no consort, and He just
Created all *upon the dust*,
And He knows all things *in their berth*.
102 That's Allah, your Lord, there's no god
But He, Creator of all sod,
So worship Him and He holds sway
Over all things *upon the way*.
103 Eyesight can never take Him in,
He incloses the vision's bin,
And He knows all with subtlety,
He is aware of each degree.

I lie in ecstasy before the word
That from these miracles stampedes like
herd
Of broken stars, split suns, or buffalo
On dreamed of prairies of the long ago.
That You are one in absolute strikes fair
Against the human wisdom and the heir
Of thought and faith and all idolatry.
I turn from humankind in ecstasy.
Beloved, give me no eyesight that can take
The true form of Your selfhood for my
sake.
Give me no hopeful heart theology
To number such I wish to join to Thee.
Give me no more than proclamation clear
That You stand beyond all the things I fear.

104 Indeed to you's come evidence
From your Lord; whoever has sense
To see, it is for his own soul,
Whoever wants the blind one's toll,
It will be against himself and
I am no keeper of your band.
105 And so We do repeat the laws
So they may say "You in your awes

Have declared and recited them."
So We make it clear to a folk
Who know *the thing that Allah spoke*.
106 So follow what's revealed to you
From your Lord; there is no god true
But He, and separate yourselves
From polytheists *and their elves*.
107 If God had wished, they would have
not
Set others up with Him in plot,
And We've not set you to guard them,
And you're not placed in charge of them.

The faith of every man is in Your hand,
Beloved, You make the hopes of all to
stand
Beneath Your grace or in idolatry,
Whether of stone or some theology.
You say the word, You propound the
decree,
And what they've heard, each man comes
out to be.
Each follows the clear revelation set
Within the human heart where every lie is
met.
Beloved, give me the revelation bright
That glows in Abraham's good faith in
sight,
In Noah's and in Adam's, David's share,
And in the books of Moses written fair.
Give me the word revealed on Jesus' brow
And in Muhammad's book. To You I bow.

108 So don't abuse those whom they call
On besides Allah, lest in hall
They should by ignorance in thrall
Blaspheme Allah. So We have made
Their deeds seem right to all folk laid,
And to their Lord they shall return,
And He'll inform them what they earn.
109 They swear by God with their strong
oaths,
That if a sign came in their quoths
They would surely believe in it.
Say "Signs are just with Allah fit."
And what should make you know when it
Comes, they will not believe a whit?
110 We'll turn back their hearts and their
eyes,
Even as they refused in guise
To have faith in this from the start.

We'll leave them in their sinful art
To wander aimless for their part.

When I see all about me the pure signs
And miracles of witness, the designs
Of Your own image cast upon the screen
Of nothingness, the myriad shades of green
Upon the earth, the azure witness of
Creative power, Your oneness and Your
love.

If unbelief, then blindness of my heart
Makes me to pass by all Your signs of art.
Cast out that me that disbelieves and let
Me wander into blind distraction, yet
Make one with You, Beloved, that little me
Who has no will nor sight but unity
With Your will and Your sight. So dare
To step into creation's cloud and air!

111 Had We sent angels down to them,
Had even the dead spoke to them,
And made the manifold appear
Before them, still they would not fear
Believing unless Allah so
Desired *for them that way to go*.

Beloved, I seek Your will above the frost
Below the frozen sun and at the cost
Of night eternal on the birchen shore.
Beloved, I seek Your will at my own door.
I do not seek the pleasures and reward
Of Paradise, nor fear Gehenna's sword
And flame to lick about my harboured soul.
I do not fear the cradle or the goal.
Beloved, I seek Your will in truth and let
My pains and pleasures suffer what they
get,

Or tend to no service in hope or fear
But only thirst to know that You are near,
Within the silence of my heart and wood,
Above the din of city as it could.

112 We made for each prophet a foe,
The Satans from among men's row
And among the jinn, some of them
Parading to others in hem
Such varnished lies to deceive them,
And had your Lord so wished, they'd not
Have done so, therefore leave the lot,
Both them and what they've made in plot.
113 So hearts of those who don't believe

In the hereafter in reprieve
May follow after it well pleased
To earn what they wish of the sleezed.

You made a single foe for prophets sent?
Methinks I find as many where I went
In every church and every pew at least
A foe or two or even more increased.
Perhaps You limit enemies in grace
To give Your prophets some respite and
space.

A single foe, Beloved, can also make
Life misery, depending on the stake
Of insolence abounding in the wake.
The lies that enemies of truth provide
May for a moment give a place to hide,
But in the end bring with the pall the hand
Of punishment upon the weary land.
I turn from both the good and evil band.

114 Should I seek other judge than God?
And He's the one revealed the prod
Of the book made plain; and those whom
We gave the book know that it's room
Is revealed by your Lord with truth,
So don't be a disputing youth.

115 Your Lord's word was accomplished
right

And justly: there is none in sight
Who can change His words, and He be
The hearing and knowing's decree.

116 If you obey majority
Of those in the earth, they will lead
You from Allah's path as decreed;
They follow what they just suppose
And only lie *in what they chose*.

117 Indeed your Lord, He knows best who
Goes astray from His path in due,
And He knows best those who do right
In following the path of light.

Beloved, let me follow the right You
choose,

Not the might of established in their pews,
Nor the right of the Protestants who use
Their private interpretations for view.
For sixty years I've sought with mind and
main

To find the truth in philosophic vein
And see that every line of thought returns
Without a certain sort of truth it earns.

I lay my wisdom all aside and take
The hearing of Your word for my sweet
cake,
And set my tongue to melodies I find
Set in the Masoretic text to bind.
I lay my human folly in the dust
And turn to You, Beloved, my only trust.

118 So eat what's blessed in Allah's name
If you believe His statutes' claim.
119 Who keeps you from eating the thing
On which lies Allah's name's blessing,
When He's already shown you well
What He's forbidden you in spell,
But what circumstances compel,
And surely many'd lead astray
By their low lusts' unknowing way;
Indeed your Lord, He does know best
Who pass the limits *in their quest*.
120 Turn from open and secret sin;
Truly those who earn sin shall be
Paid with what they earned *in the spree*.
121 Don't eat things on which Allah's name
Has not been mentioned in acclaim,
For that's a sin by any name.
Indeed the devils tell their friends
That they should argue by your ends,
And if you follow their advice,
You'll be idolatrous, not nice.

All things blessed by Your name, Beloved,
are clean,
Last word of the apostles to the mean.
All things blessed by Your name are those I
find
However mentioned in the books You bind.
My mouth is not defiled by meat, say they
Under the Gospel word who want to stray,
Having their pork chops and their lobster
prey.
A kosher and a halal mark is found
Made by Your name incised upon the
ground
And sunk upon the flesh of goat and sheep
Done out in sacrificial way to keep.
Abounding meals run in the course I take,
Linked to the limitless sky in my wake,
I sit with Turkish shepherds by the lake.

122 Is one dead that We raised to life
And made for him a light like knife

By which he goes among the folk,
Like the one whose like under stroke
Of utter darkness from which he
Cannot get out? So their decree
Was made to appear right to those
Who did not believe in their rows.
123 So We've condemned in every town
As guilty the great of renown,
And gave them room to plan their doom,
But they do not see in the gloom.
124 When revelation comes to them,
They say "We will not trust the gem
Till we receive the very same
That Allah gave messengers game.
Allah knows best where He will set
His message. Guilty ones will get
Humiliation from Allah
And sharp chastisement for their claw.
125 So the one God intends to guide,
He expands his breast open wide
For that submission, and the one
He intends should err, He in sum
Makes his breast narrow, his breast strait
As though to go up to the gate,
And so Allah set the unclean
On those who do not believe keen.
126 And this is the part of your Lord,
The right one, surely We have scored
In revelations clear to those
Folk who are mindful, on their toes.
127 They will have dwelling place of peace
With their Lord, and He will not cease
To guard them in their ways' release.

A revelation come from You and read
Leaves nothing in the heart of the well-bred
And great or even small unless they're led.
Hearts are shut gates to all You have to say,
Mortered and sealed and turned from light
away,
Unless You open up the steel door's clasp,
Hearts heavy with depravity, with asp
Among the corridors in poisoned wake.
My own heart hears and sees no word of
Yours
Against the backdrop of the deadly spores,
Damned by birth and the choices I have
made
And kept, unless You in Your vast decree
Latch on in saving grace to set me free.
I stand before the dergah where I flee.

128 And on the day when He shall take
 Them all together at the stake.
 Then O congregation of jinn!
 You took many humans in sin.
 And their friends from among men say:
 Our Lord, some of us in that way
 Took gain by others and we came
 To our determined end in shame
 Which You appointed for our claim."
 He'll say "The fire is your abode,
 Stay in it, except overrode
 Allah by His will. Surely your
 Lord is wise and knowing in store.
 129 "So We make some wicked to be
 Friends of others and for their fee.
 130 "O gathering of jinn and men,
 Did there not come to you again
 Messengers from among you then,
 Declaring you revelations
 From Me and warning you of this
 Day of your meeting *without bliss?*"
 They shall say "We bear witness now
 Against ourselves." This world's life's brow
 Deceived them and so they must bear
 Witness against their own souls' share,
 That they were unbelievers there.
 131 This is because your Lord would not
 Destroy cities by unjust plot
 While their folk neglected their lot.
 132 All in their several degrees show
 What they have done on earthly row,
 And your Lord surely comes to know
 What they do *home or on the go*.

Against the line of modern thought and
 hope
 Lingers the name of jinns, another scope,
 Another sort of being under rope
 Heaven ties around the flesh and blood of
 pope.
 May every creature that's invisible
 Under the sky, that makes the heavens full,
 Have faith to show or not his shadow here,
 And I'll believe or not, or quake and fear.
 My days are filled with visibles enough
 And hardly any need rises so tough
 Demanding for its share belief from me.
 Although the jinns may share tranquility,
 Let them rejoice in their own sphere and
 place.

I doubt or not, but stand before Your face.

133 Your Lord's the self-sufficient One,
 The Lord of mercy, if He's done,
 He can remove you and set whom
 He wills in your place and your room,
 Just as He raised you from the seed
 Of another folk *in your need*.
 134 Surely what threatens you must be,
 And you can't escape that decree.
 135 Say "O my people, act in sway
 According to your strength and way.
 I too work. So you'll come to know
 For whom will be the end in show.
 Indeed the unjust will not glow.

All things lie here before divine decree.
 Let all things submit to their own degree.
 All things determined in eternity
 Have circled whirling in divine glory.
 My own determined hope and help and hell
 Under the heavens lies a bitter spell,
 Has wings, wheels out, and turns again to
 know
 A prayer, a song, a world turns round the
 show.
 Missed opportunity is just a veil,
 A fog upon the rotting wood and nail.
 Down with the fits in charity that sail
 About the pews. I know who shall prevail.
 Leave off the contemplation, You may say.
 I turn again, and watch Your wide world
 play.

136 They set aside a part for God
 From what He's made upon the sod
 And cattle, and say "This is for
 Allah, as they affirm in store,
 And this is for our friends' relief.
 Then what's for their friends without grief
 Does not reach to Allah in brief,
 And what's for God comes to the reach
 Of their friends, so they evil preach.
 137 So their companions make it seem
 Right to idolators on scene
 To kill their children, so they can
 Bring them into destruction's plan
 And hide from them their faith in scan.
 If God had so willed, they should not
 Have done it, so leave them in plot
 And what they invent and have wrought.

138 They say "These are kine and land that
 Are set apart, none shall eat fat
 Of them except those whom We please,
 So they affirm, and kine whose tease
 Is once forbidden, and the herds
 On which they would not mention words
 Of Allah's name, to make a lie
 Against Him, He shall soon supply
 A punishment for what they try.
 139 And they say "What is in the wombs
 Of these cattle is for the rooms
 Of our men and forbidden to
 Our wives, and if it's stillborn too,
 Then they participate in crew.
 He will reward them for the word
 Consigning to Allah absurd.
 Surely He's wise, knowing *when stirred*.

A day in every tribe will show the lint
 Left by the superstitious in their glint
 At sun of revelation perched on high.
 How many quaint folkloric things go by!
 My own round in the superstitious way
 Under the word of grandpa in his sway
 Has long since passed and been buried for
 pay.
 Among the rules and fashions of the meek,
 Mistaken science that human minds seek,
 A prize may still be found at times to peek.
 Don't let me through the babe out with the
 wrath.
 Ancient taboos still linger on the path.
 Let me whirl daily where You come to
 bring
 Initiative of the right way to wing.

140 They've lost out truly, those who kill
 Their children with a needless spill,
 Forbidding what Allah has given
 To them to take a lie to live in
 Against Allah. They have indeed
 Gone off the path, and they are not
 Followers of the right path sought.
 141 It's He brings gardens up to grow
 Both on the trellis and in row,
 And palms and seed-producing plants,
 And olives, pomegranates to dance,
 The similar and different.
 So eat the fruit when the fruit's sent,
 And pay its due when harvest's home,
 And do not act like a cock's comb,

Indeed He does not love such gnome.
 142 Of cattle beasts of burden and
 Those good to slaughter by man's hand.
 Eat what God's given you and do
 Not follow steps of Satan's crew.
 Truly he is your foe in view.

Against all human feeling is the way
 Lamented here of infants' forms to slay
 Among the sand dunes of another day.
 Human life is precarious at best.
 Much is done by the living in their quest
 Under the sun for one day's living more.
 Help never came for those buried in store.
 Among the critics now of the Qur'an
 Men say that it was not true at the dawn
 Around the desert, to smother one's spawn.
 Degrees of what we call humanity
 Abound. Yet birth control has been set free
 Less than a generation from this time
 I contemplate the human state in rhyme.

143 Eight in pairs, two of sheep and two
 Of goats. You say's forbidden you
 The two males or two females or
 What's in the wombs of the two more?
 Tell me what's information's store,
 If you are truthful at the door.
 144 And two of camels, two of cows.
 You say "As He forbidden browse
 Of the two males or female pair,
 Or that which in their wombs they bear?
 Or were you witnesses come there
 When God forbade from you this share?
 Who is more unjust than the one
 Who makes a lie against what's done
 By God to lead humans astray
 Without the knowledge of the day?
 Indeed God does not lead the way
 Of unjust people where they stray.
 145 Say "I do not find in the book
 Of revelation where I look
 Forbidden to eat anything
 Except what died upon the wing
 Of itself, or the blood poured out,
 Of flesh of pigs, that without doubt
 Is such unclean, or any sin
 Except the name of Allah win.
 But anybody who is found
 Under necessity on ground,
 Not in desire to go outside

The limit, your Lord will abide
In His forgiveness, mercy's tide.
146 To those who were Jews We forbade
Each beast with claws, what oxen had
And sheep for fat upon the back
Or in the entrails, but not slack
Mixed with the bone. This was a grief
Laid on them for rebellion's beef.
And We are truthful for relief.

Among the laws that differ in between
Love's Torah and the Qur'an I have seen
Are those of diet in regard to fat
Hung on the entrails. The Jews don't eat
that.
Moreover, grudgingly the Qur'an takes
Under the wing allowed the camel's steaks.
How close the laws are is remarkable,
And not how different to push and pull.
My diet is made up of lentil stew
And rough rye bread, and bitter herbs a
few.

David himself could find no better meal
Among the courtiers at the new moon's
peal.
Let me, Beloved, seek never more a fruit
I need not, but keep me in royal loot.

147 But if they lie to you and say
Your Lord is Lord of mercy's sway,
His punishment does not give way
From guilty people, *He will pay*.
148 Idolators will surely say
If God had wished, we'd not give way
To join with Him, nor our ancestors,
Nor would we have forbidden questors.
Just so did those before them do,
Rejecting till grief came in view.
Say "Do you have knowledge with you
So you should bring it to our view?
You only follow guesses and
You only tell lies *in your hand*."
149 Say "Allah has the final word.
If He wills, He'll guide you in herd."
150 Say "Bring your witnesses to bear
Witness that Allah's given share
Forbidding this, then if they bear
Witness, bear no witness in share
With them. Do not follow the low
Lusts of those who reject Our show,
And of those who do not believe

In the hereafter, and they leave
Associates on their Lord's sleeve.

An argument by the idolators
Left against You, Beloved, and that
restores
Against all right the claims not to be
blamed,
Having no more responsibility,
More portion in the wickedness that
shamed
Under the law, is that the divine see
Has caused and brought out their iniquity.
Against that doctrine You in the Qur'an
Made plain that You'd not be imposed upon
And not be made responsible for sin.
Double predestination's doctrine thin
And false. Beloved, You send no man to
hell,
Leaving aside his own choice of the bell.
I turn to Your grace decreed without spell.

151 Say "Come, I'll recite what your Lord
Forbids you: don't join in accord
Anything with Him and be kind
To parents, and don't kill resigned
Your children for poverty's fear,
We provide for you and send gear
For them, and do not approach near
Indecencies, those which appear
And those which are concealed, and do
Not kill one God's forbidden but
For the cause of justice as shut.
This is what He's enjoined on you
So you may comprehend the view.

Among the verse of the sweet Qur'an
Lives one that enjoins life before and
drawn
Across the lines of human hopes and
spawn.
Here lie the five commandments, the
amount
Made now incumbent from the burning
fount
Under the towering Sinai's cloud and hale.
Here are the five commandments of one
slate
Atuned on Sinai to rejoice Your state.
My heart at hearing just one table read
Arises to seek more of what You said.

Deprived of Your word, I am never fed.
All Your commandments counted on the
hand

Linger in mind and lip and ear to stand
In glory in my nights and days and land.

152 Don't come near orphan's property
But justly till maturity,
And give right measure and right weight.
We don't require of any soul
Except what he can do in toll.

And when you speak, be just though it
Be against a relative fit,
And carry out God's covenant.

This is what He commands as sent,
So you may be aware as meant.

153 This is My path, the right one, so
Follow it everywhere you go.

And do not follow paths astray,
For they will lead you from His way.
He's so commanded you today

So you may keep from evil's sway.

154 We gave the book to Moses to
Complete on him what good to do,
And make plain all things guided fair,
And be a mercy, to beware

Of meeting their Lord *everywhere*.

155 That is a book We have revealed,
Blessed, so follow it and concealed
Beware so mercy be unpeeled
For you *when forgiven and healed*.

156 So don't say the book was revealed
To just two groups before unsealed
And We were surely unaware
Of what they read *was written there*.

Again three statutes stated stand in light:
Loving the famished orphan and her right,
Allowing weight and market measure's
quite,

Having truth only in heart, on the tongue.
Much more You might have uttered there
and sung

Upon the wing of Qur'an's breath and lung.
Help with the two commandments left
unspeakable

Arises from the Torah for a token.

My love of the Qur'an is built upon

A love of Torah sung upon the dawn,

Dawn of the day and always dawn of faith

Along the narrow way I take from wraith

Left in the temples of the rich and great
I set aside to find my forest gate.

157 Or don't say "If the book had been
Sent down to us, we would have been
Better led than they *in their sin*."

So truly then has come to you
Clear proof from your Lord in your view,
And guidance and His mercy too.

Who then is more unjust than he
Who denies God's theophany

And turns away from them to be?

We'll pay those who turn from Our way
Revealed with evil punishment,
Because they all have gone astray
From revelation that We sent.

158 They only wait for angels to

Come to them, or your Lord in view,

Or for some signs from your Lord too.

The day when some signs from your Lord
Will come, its faith shall no gain stored

Profit a soul that did not come

To believe before or in sum

To earn good through her faith. Say "Wait,
We too are waiting *at the gate*."

A word of warning sweet Qur'an gives me
Left in my pride and lonely Hebrew tree
Against the thought that if You'd sent Your
Word

Hung in the Hebrew syllables that stirred
My heart from early age instead of to
Unsung slaves liberated in the crew
Hopped out of Egypt, I'd have been a man
Aware of You and better by a span,
My fair obedience more than their own
And never worshipping at idol throne.
Don't tell me how untrue such pride must
be.

All that those ancient folk did wickedly
Laughs in my heart and shows depravity
I set aside only by grace set free.

159 Indeed those who divide in parts
And make religion of sects' arts,
You have nothing to do with them.
Their matter is in Allah's hem.

He will declare to them one day

The things in which they went astray.

160 Whoever brings a good deed, he

Will have ten like it in degree.

And whoever brings evil deed,
He shall be paid like it in greed.
There's been no injustice in seed.
161 Say Truly for my part, my Lord
Has guided me to right path stored;
To the most righteous faith, the way
Of Abraham, upright to pray,
And he was not among the sheep
That follow idols *to their keep*.

Alone by guidance from Your hand I find
Love led me in act of hand, thought of
mind
And plan to follow righteousness unblind.
How many days have passed since
Abraham
Made covenant with You by goat and lamb
Under the darkness of the trance and smoke
He saw from visions that You gave and
spoke.
Alone by grace I follow in the wake
Made by that man of faith of ancient stake.
Alone by grace I know the evil deed
Does not end in the death of hopeless
greed.
Alone by grace I know the righteous act
Lives on, because it comes from You in
fact.
I rest my confidence in all I lacked.

162 Say "Truly my prayer, sacrifice,
And my life and my death in trice
Are for Allah, Lord to suffice
For all the universe *in price*.
163 "He has no partner. This am I
Commanded, and I'm first to try
Bowing to His will *under sky*."

The prayer and sacrifice, the life and death
Of blessed Muhammad, long as he had
breath,
Were all for You. Now on a day I come
And find that prayer and sacrifice make
sum
With life and death, the in and out of
breathing,
Remembrance of Your name above the
seething
The world requires to make events illusion
And plunge would-be believers in
confusion.

The church and state take sword by leave
divine
To check the work of murder and rapine,
But they too fall beneath the judgement
call.

In earth prostration I remember all
Your worthy names and bear them as I bow
In sacrifice and prayer for my life now.

164 Say What! Shall I seek other god
Than Allah? He's Lord on the sod
Of all things. No soul earns a thing
But against itself and its wing,
And no one bears a burden to
Bear the burden of other's pew.
So to your Lord is your return,
And He'll declare to you to learn
Of what you differed once to spurn.
165 It's He who set you in the land
Successors of those beforehand,
And raise some of you in degree,
So He might try you and so see
By what He's granted your decree.
Indeed your Lord's quick to repay,
He is forgiving in truth's way,
And merciful *from day to day*.

And shall I see a god other than You,
Loved for Your being and for what You do
And for the grace of love that You send
down,
However I have walked about the town.
Meekly I turn my way to You and see
Upheld each hope of glory and mercy,
However I have fled upon the sea
And hidden in the earth's security.
My eye sees how the great are placed to
stand
And how they fail to keep justice and band,
Defeated by the test You gave to them
And foiled by greed and hope in stratagem.
Left to my hopeless hand of poverty
I gaze upon the test and then go free.

Surah 7 Araf, or The Heights

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
1 Alif, Lam, Mim, Sad.
2 A book revealed to you, so do not let
Your breast cave in on that account, but set
Yourself to be warned by it and remind
Nearby believers of the things to bind.

3 Follow what's revealed from your Lord
To you, and take no guardians stored
Beside Him, how little do you
Contemplate the path that's in view.

The many books of men and nature round
Me clamour for attention by the sound
Of siren sweetness or fears that abound
Where voices charm and warn upon the
ground.

I turn from many books to find the word
That's written in the Four Books I have
heard

Are revelations sent from You above,
And these are the Four Books I've come to
love.

The Torah and the Psalms, the Gospel too,
And last Qur'an, the Four Books that are
true

Reveal the sure way that You've given men
To find the grace abounding once again.
Beloved, I follow what's revealed in those
And pray You keep me following on my
toes.

4 How many cities We've destroyed,
The punishment that We employed
Come by night or siesta time
When they slept *ignorant in crime*.

5 Their clamour under punishment
From Us was just that they resent,
Saying "We were unjust and bent."

6 We'll surely hold to an account
Those to whom Our messengers mount,
And messengers themselves *as fount*.

7 We'll deal with them by what We know,
And We were not an absent show.

8 The sentence on that day will be
A just one: for the one's degree
Of full measure, success freely;

9 And for the one with empty tale,
They've made their loss without avail,
Because they disbelieved Our sale.

Apologies today are worded so
They sound like injuries on tongues not
slow.

The art of being sorry's one soon lost,
And never missed by rulers and the bossed.
Depraved heart may think their repentance
sound

When they admit injustice in them found,
But You are satisfied only to find
The root and branch are broken with the
mind.

It's not enough admitting one was wrong:
One has to make repentance of the song
And sorrow for the wrongs done all along.
Beloved, create repentance in my heart,
And on my tongue and even in my art,
And I shall praise Your name and from the
start.

10 We've set you truly on the earth
And made it the source in its girth
Of living for you, but the toll
Of gratitude's small in your soul.

11 So We created you, and We
Formed you, and then We said freely
To angels: Prostrate to Adam.

They all fell down except the ham
Iblis. He was not one of those
Who prostrated themselves in rows.

Iblis is such a wonder when I think
How he reserved prostration on the blink
For You alone, Beloved, and made a stink
Against idolatry when on the brink.
Iblis is such a wonder in his day,
And still is famous for the gracious way
He fostered monolatry without pay
When all the others fell down no delay.
Beloved, I'm always of two minds to see
The rightness in each way that's before me,
Awakened to obeying Your decree,
Or waiting to affirm Your unity.
Let me not fail to choose the better road
Before I fall beneath my human load.

12 He said "What kept you from
prostrating

When I came commanding and stating?"

He said "I am better than he,
Of fire You once created me,
While him You made of dusty scree."

13 He said "Go out from here, it's not
Fit to behave in such proud plot.

Go out, for you are of the band
Of misery upon the land."

How many in this world of faith and gore
Spoil their monolatry by saying more

Than that You are the only to adore!
If good Iblis had thought to check his pride
And keep it to himself, the thing to hide,
And say that he prostrated just to You,
He might have fooled You into thinking
too.

Instead he answers honestly and shows
That he's depraved as much as any goes.
If I should follow suit, no doubt I'd join
The Jewish or the Muslim Iblis' coin
And be accepted by the pickle crowd,
Ready to take whomever is allowed
Assent to doctrine and practice unbowed.

14 He said "Have mercy till the day
Of resurrection of their way."

15 He said "Respite shall be your pay."

16 He said "Since You keep me in sway
Of disappointed waiting, I

Shall lie in wait for those nearby
Upon the straight path *where they fly*.

17 "I'll attack from behind, before,
And from the right and left in store,
And You'll see their ungrateful floor."

18 He said "Get out of here despised,
And driven out, those who surmised
To follow you, I'll send to hell
With all of you filled to rebel."

Reaction to grace by Iblis and men
Is all the same, returning once again.
Grace used by the depraved is there to give
The strength to lie in wait instead of live.
I too see mercy on the dawn where I
Awaken morn by morn beneath a sky
That colours lake and forest where I try
To walk on Puijo Hill before I die.
Beloved, let me see mercy not at all
If I must use it to oppose the thrall
Of sovereignty divine that is my life,
The gauge of happiness before the strife.
Beloved, let me see no grace any day,
If I just use it in a wicked way.

19 O Adam, live now with your wife
Within the garden. Without strife
Eat what you will, but do not go
Near this tree, for you'll fill the row
Of the unrighteous *if you show*.

20 But Satan whispered wicked plot
Revealing evil bent unsought,

And he said "Your Lord's not retained
This tree but to keep you well reined
From being both like angels or
To keep from an immortal store."

21 And so to both of them he swore,
"I'll advise you of the true score."

22 He caused them to fall by deceit.
So when they tasted the tree's treat,
Their evil bent began to show,
And so they covered themselves low
With leaves that in the garden grow.
Their Lord called out to them, "Did I
Not forbid you both from the tree shy
And tell you Satan's come to be
For you an open enemy?"

23 They said "Our Lord, we've been unjust
To ourselves, and if You don't trust
Forgiveness to us in mercy,
We'll be the losers certainly."

24 He said "Go out, and some of you
Will be the foes of others' crew,
And there's for you a place on earth
To live and livelihood and berth."

25 He said "That's where you'll live and
there

You'll come to die and for your share
You'll be raised up again *in heir*."

The enmity, so enigmatic, that
In Genesis fill out the promise fat
Of a Messiah in the dragon's train
To break his head, is ignored in the vein
Of the Qur'an, which places enmity
Between the sons of Eve eternally.
The both may well be right, but what I see
Is hatred and suspicion faithfully
Preserved among the human being I
Perceive in every place I come to spy.
The curse of Genesis on earth becomes
In the Qur'an the promises of sums,
The resurrection waiting for all men
Returned before Your face to know again.

26 O children of Adam, We've sent
Down to you clothing to prevent
Your shame, and for beauty and such
To guard your modesty from touch,
That is the best for you to *clutch*.
This is God's revelation so
You may remember how to go.

While Genesis may well imply that skins
As “or” instead of “or” down to the shins
Is for both modesty and for the shame
That was the lot of those come under
 blame,

The dear Qur'an remarks in added word
That clothing should be beautiful as bird,
And fill the heart with joy. So You would
 bring

Solutions to the errors that men sing
Always in something beautiful to fill
The heart with joy after the bitter pill
Of loss before the errors of the will.
Beloved, though naked I whirl on the floor
Of dergah and have nothing in my store,
I joy in being clothed by You once more.

27 O children of Adam, don't let
That Satan make you fall and get
Expelled like your parents who went
From the garden, and so unvent
Their clothing to show them the bent
Of evil. He looks out on you
Along with the host of his crew,
From where you cannot take in view.
We've made the devils to receive
Rule over those who don't believe.
28 When they do lewdness, then they say
“We found our ancestors that way,
So God's enjoined it in our pay.”
Say “Allah does not command such
Indecency, you say as much
Against Allah, but what in crutch
Of knowledge can you ever touch?”
29 Say “My Lord's enjoined justice here.
So turn your faces right for prayer
And call upon Him everywhere,
And be sincere to obey Him,
As He brought you from the start dim.
So shall you too return to Him.”

Though You have left so many of men here
To worship devils in the things they fear,
You have not determined upon their pate
The lewdness that so many make their fate.
Double predestination is the state
Of Calvin's eager friends, perhaps, and late,
But You've predestined only to the good,
Obedience and doing what we should.
Beloved, I see the idols in their room,
The glories of their making and their doom,

And find their worshippers still in their
 bloom.

Lead me in smaller paths and humble ways,
In Psalms struck up in lesser tunes and lays,
And I shall find for You alone the praise.

30 Some He's guided aright, but part
Are justly due their error's art,
They took the demons for their own
In guardianship and not alone
Allah, and they think it is they
Who follow in the righteous way.

31 O children of Adam, dress well
At time of prayer, eat and drink swell
Without extravagance, for He
Does not love extravagancy.

32 Say “Who's forbidden adornment
That God has on His servants sent
And the good things provided?” Say
“These are for the believers' pay
In this world's life and on the day
Of resurrection. We explain
The word for a folk who're not vain.”

33 Say “My Lord has prohibited
Only lewdness, both those they hid
And those apparent at the bid,
And sin and unjust rebellion,
And joining to Allah a son
Without authority sent down,
And saying against Allah's crown
What you don't know *of His renown.*”

34 For every nation there's a doom,
So when their sentence comes in room
They'll not lag nor rush in the bloom.

There are so many rules that Christians
 make

To come in place of the ten at your stake,
The rules of what to where and what to eat,
The rules of what to hear and see for treat.
There may be truth for present day in that.

The nineteenth century was straight-laced
 fat,

And none could have imagined in that day
When they were making rules to come and
 play,

What should appear a hundred years to
 come,

How everyone should deck themselves in
 sum

With the frivolity and decadence

That no longer caused anyone offence.
Beloved, let all adornments have their
place,
I only seek the crystal of Your face.

35 O children of Adam, if there
Come to you messengers to bear
Among you My revealings fair,
The ones who guard from wickedness
And act in the righteous address,
They shall have no fear to confess
Nor shall they grieve to *have the less*.
36 And those who reject what We send
And turn away in proudful bend,
These are fire's dwellers to contend.
37 Who's more unjust than one who lies
Against Allah rejecting ties
Of His revealings? The doom writ
In the book's their portion and fit
To overtake them, until when
Our messengers come once again
To see them die, then they shall say,
"Where is that which you had in sway
To call upon and not Allah?"
They'll say "They have escaped our claw.
And they'll bear witness of themselves
That they were unbelieving elves."
38 He'll say "Go in the fire among
The nations passed away unsung
Before you of both jinn and men.
Whenever a nation again
Shall enter, it shall curse the other,
Until when they've all come together,
The last shall say of early ones:
Our Lord, these led us off in tonnes,
So give them double punishment
In fire." He'll say "All double lent
Is for all, but you have not kent."
39 The first will then say to the last,
"So you're no better than us cast.
So taste the punishment that's passed."
40 Those who reject Our revelations
And turn away in proud conflations,
The gates of heaven shall remain shut
Before them, nor the garden's rut
Shall they enter until it be
A camel pass through the eye wee
Of needle, so for the guilty.

Quotation of the Gospel here is seen
By every Christian that has filled his bean

With Bible knowledge if not wisdom's cup.
But some reciting ones with mind like tup
Know nothing of the antecedent green.
Beloved, it is no wonder that You take
The same words on the lip of love and rake,
Since wisdom is perennial and found
In every nation, tongue, and kindred round.
Truth is that greed in every sort of ground
Prevents the entrance into heavenly sound.
And so the needle forms the gracious
bound
Of those small enough to enter the mound
Of heaven to dance upon the crystal lake.

41 They'll have a bed of hell-fire coals
And coverlet of the same bowls,
So We reward the unjust souls.
42 Those who believe and do good We
Do not lay on any duty
Beyond the man's ability.
They are the fair inhabitants
Of the garden. They stay to dance.
43 And We'll remove whatever ill
Is in their breasts. The rivers fill
Beneath and they shall say "All praise
To Allah who guided our ways,
And we would not have found the path
Had Allah not guided through wrath."
The messengers of our Lord brought
The truth, and it shall so be taught
To them that this is the fair plot
Of which you're made the heirs for
wrought.

You promise to remove from every breast
Of those who believe and do good with zest
The ill that may remain after the test.
Repentance brings the sorrow for the sin,
And that too is Your gift of gold and tin.
But after the repentance comes the toll
Of Your regenerating in the soul.
Creation and the recreating work
Is something You, Beloved, will never
shirk,
But like the sculptor cut the marble spare
And leave the image of beauty to wear
The sunlight and the approbation's stare.
You only have the gift to make the true,
The image of the right come into view.

44 The garden dwellers will call out

To inmates of the fire when caught:
 We've found what our Lord promised us
 To be true. Have you too gracious
 Found what your Lord promised is true?
 And they will answer yes with rue.
 Then one proclaimer will cry out
 Among them to dispel all doubt
 That the curse of Allah is on
 The unjust *from both dark and dawn*.
 45 Those who prevent from Allah's way
 And seek to make it crook and sway,
 They disbelieve in the last day.
 46 Between the two there'll be a veil,
 And on the high places to sail
 Shall be men who know by their signs
 All and they shall call out in lines
 To garden dwellers, "Peace on you."
 They'll not have yet entered the view,
 But shall have hope to join the crew.
 47 And when they turn their eyes to see
 The inmates of the fiery spree,
 They'll say "Our Lord, do not place us
 With unjust people *on the bus*."
 48 And those still standing on the hills
 Will shout to those who fit the bills
 They recognize and say "Of no
 Help was your wealth and pride to show."
 49 Are these those about whom you swore
 God would show mercy never more?
 Go in the garden. You'll receive
 No fear, and there you'll never grieve.

Three groups of people are upon the earth:
 The worthy righteous and those of no
 worth,
 And those who totter on the fatal brink,
 About to swim or yet about to sink.
 They look to left and right and make their
 choice
 According to the divine vision's voice,
 Or then according to the sight they see
 Without faith and without eternity.
 Beloved, I stand upon the hill today
 And ask a vision of hell fire in sway,
 And of the paradise that You prepare
 For those in grace who had come in to
 share.
 And with that vision sent I find the grace
 To stand in justice and mercy to trace.

50 The dwellers of the fire shall call

Out to the garden dwellers all,
 Saying "Pour on some water fall
 On us or of that which God give you."
 They'll answer, "God prohibits them
 Both to the unbelievers' hem."
 51 They take their faith for idle sport,
 Amusement, and this life's world's fort
 Deceives them. So today We set
 Them aside as they did when met
 This day and denied Our laws yet.

All who do not receive the heavenly vision
 Of the divine decree and the incision
 Of grace upon the heart in mercy's way
 Deny Your laws by night and every day.
 All who do not bow at the load of grace
 Sent from You heart of love to chosen race
 Find that their search shows another place,
 A fiendish following in the fire's sway.
 Beloved, I see the many temples' sheen,
 The glow of celebration on the scene,
 The idle sport of every faith around,
 The burdening of laughter on the ground.
 Deception calls to all to speak the word
 Of truth that his or her own heart has heard.

52 We've brought them a book We've made
 clear
 With knowledge, guidance, mercy's cheer
 For a folk who believe *and fear*.
 53 They only wait for the end near?
 On the day when the end's in gear,
 Those who ignored before will say
 "Our Lord's messengers brought true way.
 Do we have intercessors' sway
 To speak on our behalf *for pay*?
 Or could we tread again the way
 And do otherwise than we lay?"
 They've lost their souls and what they
 earned
 Has gone away from them as spurned.
 54 Your Lord is Allah who has made
 The heavens and the earth on parade
 In six days, and He's great in power.
 He cast night's veil upon day's hour,
 Which follows on it constantly.
 He made sun, moon and stars to see,
 All set under His sovereignty.
 His is creation and command.
 Blessed be God, Lord of all the land.

The mighty seventy also makes the claim
That You made the earth in six days of aim,
While Torah mentions seven in the plot.
But all agree the seventh day is sought
To finish and set aside all that's wrought.
The book is one, though oft divided in
Four or a score a plenty and in din
Of mosque and synagogue and church for
sin

Recited for the formalized in blame.
Beloved, I come to You, though in my
shame,

I find my recitation poor in sound
And weak and so sporadic on the ground
That hardly any message can be found.
Still Your creation and the revelation
Makes my heart all rejoicing in the ration.

55 Call your Lord in humility,
Remember Him too secretly.
He does not love those who exceed
The bounds that He has made their need.

To call on Your name, my Beloved, was
made

Incumbent on the early sons' parade
Who followed Adam's Seth in how they
prayed.

Remembering You was spoken at least
Upon Sinai to make the Sabbath's feast
A day rejoiced in by both man and beast.
Exceeding the bounds of that way
increased

Leads to the dungeon ways of those
waylaid.

Beloved, I've been waylaid by gun and ball
Around the dergah floor, I am so tall
And make a target for the graceless small.
Let me return today and every week
To calling on Your name in what I seek,
Remembrancing You with both tongue and
beak.

56 Do not make mischief on the earth
After reforming of its berth,
And call on Him in fear and hope.
God's mercy is near by in scope
To those who do good deeds of worth.
57 It's He who sends out winds to bear
Good tidings of His mercy's share,
Until when they bring up a cloud,

We drive it to a land full bowed,
Then We send water down on it,
And so bring forth all fruits as fit.
In the same way we'll resurrect
The dead, remembering the elect.
58 As for the good land, its green springs
Abundantly from its Lord's wings,
While the lesser sprouts in scant things.
So We repeat the revealings
For a folk who hold thanksgivings.

The promise of the resurrection's found
In the leaf gold that breaks up the ground
From the seed that died to provide the
round,

From the green things afterward to abound.
The promise of the resurrection's well
Conceived in death itself beside the dell
That blossoms with the hope that comes to
tell

The mortal soul of the celestial bell.
Beloved, I look upon the rain that seers
The patterns of my hopings and my fears,
And find the rushing greys of cloud marks
me

To linger in the refuge of the tree
That drips the hopeful waters that I see
Like sweat, like rainbow ornaments, and
tears.

59 We sent Noah to his folk so
He said "O my folk, serve God's row.
You have no god but Him, I fear
For you the pain of a day near."

60 The rulers of his people said
"We seen that you're in error led."

61 He said "O my folk, there's no wrong
In me, but I'm a witness strong
From the Lord of the universe.

62 "I proclaim to you my Lord's curse
And blessing and give good advice
To you, and I know from God's *slice*
What you do not know to *suffice*.

63 "What! Are you amazed a reminder
Comes to you from your Lord to blinder
Man among you, and so he might
Warn you to guard against the plight,
So mercy to you come to light?"

64 They called him liar, so We saved him
And those with him in the ark trim,
And We drowned those who would deny

Our revelations, blind folk sly.

Good Noah preached according to the law
A hundred twenty years Your love and
awe,

And in that time no one joined in the crowd
Of saved by his hand baptized and allowed.
Good Noah's the worst Baptist preacher
found

Anywhere on terrestrial dry ground,
And would have died discouraged by the
rate

If he'd not known that sovereign grace in
state

Determines who is saved by Your decree,
And not the hammering of the preacher's
knee.

I too have preached a lot, though not as
much,

And find my congregation void of Dutch
And French and English and all men
beside,

Though rodent and fowl sometimes take a
ride.

65 To 'Ad We sent their brother Hud.
He said "O my folk, serve God good,
You have no god other than Him.
Will you not guard *from evil grim?*"

66 The chiefs of those who disbelieved
Among his people said ungrieved,
"We see you in your foolishness,
We think you lie, *so now confess.*"

67 He said "O my folk, I'm no fool,
But I'm a messenger to rule
From the Lord of the universe.

68 "I proclaim you blessing and curse
From my Lord and I'm faithful to
Give the best of advice to you.

69 "What! Are you amazed that should
come

Reminder from your Lord through bum
Of a man among you who might
Warn you *once of your coming plight?*

Remember when He made you heirs
After Noah's people in snares,
And multiplied you wonderfully?
So mind the benefits you see
From Allah, do successfully."

70 They said "Did you come to us so
We might serve God alone and know

No more what our ancestors served?

Then bring us to what you deserved
To threaten us, if no truth swerved."

71 He said "Uncleanness and wrath from
Your Lord light on you come.

What! Do you argue about names
That you and your ancestors' games
Have given? God's not sent for them
Authority at all in hem.

So wait and I too wait the gem."

72 So We saved him and those with him
By Our mercy and cut off trim

The last of those who denied our
Revealings and denied their power.

The argument of names is here to stay
Among the foolish ones who come to pray
Without the evidence of grace in sway.
Some say that Allah's the best name to say,
And others say Alohim's here at bay,
And Yahweh turns the head of straight and
gay

Who copy heathen guards in scientistic
Report before relying on ballistic.
Beloved, Your name is sure and glorified,
But above it, Your Word's here to reside,
And if I call on the Beloved alone,
Forgetful of Your name, I might atone
By my reciting of Your Word: the stone
Of idol and of church and synagogue.

73 And to Samud their brother came
As sent and Salih was his name.
He said "O my folk, serve Allah,
You have no god but Him in awe.
Clear evidence has come to you
From your Lord: Allah's she-camel too
A sign, so let her graze upon
Allah's earth and harm her none,
Or painful punishment will dawn
On you *as well as all your crew.*

74 "Mind when He made you to be heirs
After Ad and set your affairs
In the land. You make palaces
On its plains and carve out places
In the mountains. Remember now
God's benefits and do not bow
To mischief in the land somehow."

75 The ruler of the proud among
His folk said to those who were sung
As weak, to those who had belief,

"Do you know that Salih in brief
Is sent by his Lord?" They said too,
"We are believers in him due."

76 The proud said "Truly we deny
What you believe in *or so try.*"

77 They killed the camel and rebelled
Against their Lord's commandment
swelled,

And they said "O Salih, bring down
On us your threat upon the town,
If you're messenger of renown."

78 The earthquake came upon them,
So they were corpses in their hem.

79 He turned from them and said "O my
Folk I proclaimed to you with cry
The message of my Lord, and I
Gave you advice good to comply,
But you do not love those who try
To give good advice *on the sly.*"

The sign of the flood waters came down
once,

The miracle of Your oneness to dunce,
And then the earthquake as the third sign
played

Its havoc on the unbelievers stayed.
All might have been avoided at the last,
The earthquake and the angel's warning
blast,

If men had merely pitied the beast's share
And left the camel free to live and bear
Her young upon the desert rock and stair.
Beloved, I see the little mouse run in
And out of the wood and the rock and bin
Not far from my own hopeful bed and
room.

I stifle the desire for mouse's doom,
Remembering the hearts on that far day
That cared not to take the camel and slay.

80 And Lot when he said to his folk,
"What! Do you made lewdness in stroke
Which no one before did to bloke?

81 "You come to males in lust instead
Of females. You are poorly led."

82 The answer of his folk was just
That they said "Run them just
Our of your town; they are a folk
Who try to cleanse themselves *in yoke.*"

83 So We saved him and those who came
With him except his wife to blame.

She was with those who were *inflamed*
To stay behind *among the shamed.*

84 And we poured punishment on them,
See how the guilty found end's gem.

85 To Midian came Shu'aib their brother.
He said "O the folk of my *mother,*

Serve Allah, you've no other god
But Him. Clear evidence on sod
Has come to you from your Lord's rod,

So give full measure and full weight,
Do not diminish men their rate,

And don't make mischief in the land
After it's bowed to the command,

This is the better part for you,
If you believe in what is true.

86 "Don't lie in ambush everywhere,
To threaten and turn back in share
From Allah's path the one who's there
Believing Him and seeking where

To make it crooked. Mind when you
Were few then He multiplied you,
And think about the end of crew
Of mischief-makers and their due.

87 "And if there's a party among
You who believes the Message sung
With which I have been sent *though young,*
And a party not to believe,
Hold yourselves in patient reprieve
Till Allah decides between us:
For He's the best to fix a fuss."

O my Beloved, the things we find to deal
A wall of separation and to seal
One party from another are all vain.
The sunlight even mingles with the rain.
Give me the patience, Lord, to save the
sum

Of differences of faith till that day come
When You judge all, not by the things they
think,

But by the things they say and do and
drink!

And let me not be certain that day's now,
Nor try to tell the others what and how.
That day is like a lightning and a flash,
It bursts upon the heart with thunder crash.
When everyone removes the mask and role,
Then there is nothing to divide the soul.

88 The chiefs of the proud in his folk
Said "We will turn you out by stroke,

O Shu'aib, and those who believe
With you from our town and our sleeve,
Unless you come back to reprieve
In our faith." He said "What! Though we
Dislike that *false catastrophe*?"

89 "We'll have lied against Allah if
We turn back to your old faith stiff
After Allah's delivers us
From it, and it's not fit for us
To go back to it, unless God
Our Lord wished so. Our Lord does know
All things, and we trust Allah's prod.
Our Lord, judge between us not slow
And our folk by truth on the go.
And You're the best of judges' show."

90 The rulers of those disbelieving
Among his people said *receiving*,
"Follow Shu'aib and you shall be
Among the losers in the spree."

91 The earthquake then came over them,
And they were corpses in their hem.

92 Those who called Shu'aib liar then
Were as though they'd never again
Lived there. Those who called Shu'aib liar,
They were the losers *in the fire*.

93 He turned away from them and said
"O my folk, I've proclaimed as led
To you messages from my Lord,
And gave you good advice restored.
How then shall I regret the sword
That fell on unbelieving horde?"

Shu'aib was not original, though he
Turned from his ancestor's iniquity.
The claim that a new faith caught him off
guard

Was propagandist. Argument from shard
That old is best has force only because
Truth is that truth is older than the laws
Of Hammurabi. Truth is that the both,
The wickedness in flourishing and growth
And truth go back to Eden for their share.
Though innovation's always wrong, it
follows

Not that the ancient must be right as
swallows.

Beloved, I take the old faith and the truth
That You're Creator and Sovereign forsooth
And let it be the fountain of my youth.

94 We did not send a prophet down

To any unbelieving town,
But that We overturned its folk
With pain and affliction in stroke
To make them humble under yoke.
95 Then We gave them good instead of
The evil till they came above
Others in numbers and they said
"Both pain and happiness were spread
Upon our ancestors." Then We
Came on them in an ambush spree
While they did not perceive or see.
96 And if the people of the towns
Had only believed without frowns
And taken guard, We would have broken
Open for them blessings in token
From heaven and earth, but they denied,
So We gave them what they supplied.
97 What! Do the townsfolk feel secure
From Our rewards coming and sure
To them by night from sleep to lure?
98 What! Do the townsfolk feel in peace
From Our punishment We release
Come to them in morning's increase
While they are sporting for surcease?
99 Do they feel safe from Allah's plan?
None feel so but the condemned man.

The lost of humankind, the dead in sins,
Feel safe to go along with ample grins
And front the magic of the day and night,
And never hide themselves from awful
sight

Of coming judgement. Nay, they don't
believe

In judgement's coming at all for reprieve.
The only others who feel safe are those
Blind Baptists whose securities enclose
Eternals if not vernal and in prose.
Beloved, I do not feel safe in Your world,
Not with the ragged or the gold and
pearled.

But that does not mean condemnation's fled
From the park where I've rested and I've
fed.

I hope and trust above that I've been led.

100 Is it not clear to those who come
To live on the earth after bum
Of former times, that if We wish
We could afflict them with the dish
Of their faults and seal up their hearts

So they would not hear the call's starts?
 101 These towns of which We do relate
 To you the stories and instate
 Their messengers with arguments
 Clear and concise, would not have sense
 Believing what they first denied.
 So Allah sets a seal to hide
 The hearts of unbelievers tried.
 102 We did not find in most of them
 Adherence to covenant's gem,
 But found the great majority
 Engaged in their iniquity.

You might have sealed the hearts of men to
 keep
 Them from salvation's love and law to
 weep,
 But You did not. The road to hell's the
 choice
 Of those who follow as though to rejoice
 In graft and the oppression of the poor.
 The choice is of the human, but is sure.
 The messengers are sent to call the lost
 And find themselves derided and then
 tossed
 Out of the wealthy cities to find rest
 In poverty and deserts with the best.
 You did not find the most of men who
 chose
 Chose with the song and lily and the rose,
 But with the hope of greed and evil heart.
 Man chooses when he chooses wicked part.

103 We raised up Moses after them
 With revelations from Our hem
 To Pharaoh and his ruling band,
 But they denied them at his hand.
 Consider what was then the end
 Of mischief-makers *that We send*.
 104 And Moses said "O Pharaoh, I
 Am here a messenger to spy
 From the Lord of the universe,
 105 "Not fit to say of God but truth.
 I've come to you now to disperse
 Clear proof from your own Lord and couth,
 So send out with me Israel's youth."
 106 He said "If you've come with a sign,
 Then trot it out in truth to shine."

The expectations man sets up to prove
 Your Word, Belovèd, really fail to groove.

But more than that they do contain the seed
 That grows in unbelief as well as greed.
 Responding to clear proof as said by God
 With begging for a miracle of rod
 Sets the parameters of failure fast,
 Though true doubt is preferred before the
 mast.

Beloved, I come with open heart and set
 Aside the hopes and harnesses that get
 Entangled in my mind and eye, and wait
 For Your revealing of the Word in state.
 I ask no sign beyond the cantillation
 Of the sweet sounds of divine revelation.

107 So he threw down his rod and it
 Appeared a serpent *live and fit*.
 108 He pulled out his hand there to see
 It was whitened *with leprosy*.
 109 The rulers of Pharaoh's folk said
 "This is a skilled enchanter led.
 110 "He means to drive you from your
 land.
 What counsel do you have in hand?"
 111 They said "Ignore him and his brother,
 And send out to towns to find other
 112 Enchanters with knowledge to
 smother."

The strategy is to ignore the truth
 And hide with wild alternatives in ruth.
 That is the strategy here still today
 Among the companies out to get pay.
 The world will hide the truth, the best, the
 sure
 By bringing forth the counterfeit as cure,
 And showing guiles and wiles among the
 great
 As well as for the buying folk in rate.
 Beloved, I turn from idols that prepare
 The heart to wonder about You and where
 You hide. You do not hide at all, You're
 there
 For all to see, and yet unseen in share.
 Beloved, there's none to trample down the
 veils,
 And You are motionless beneath the sails.

113 The sorcerers came to Pharaoh
 And said "We must have reward's show
 If we win in contest and glow."
 114 He said "Yes you'll be made to go

Near me and in respected row.”

The trick to know which is the counterfeit
Is whether it requires a profit knit
Or is grace free of strings in human hand
To raise an empire on the earth and sand.
I know the counterfeit in Christian clutch
By the tithes and the offerings they love
much

To take from widow and the worthy poor.
The counterfeit before my eyes is sure.
Beloved, I come to You within the church
Made of the Sabbath minutes on my perch
Without a fee or cost, and in that search
I find You never leave me in the lurch.
I stand to preach to rodent and to fowl
And take no penny from rabbit or owl.

115 They said “O Moses, will you throw
Or shall we be the first to know?”

116 He said “Throw down. So when they
cast,

They clouded people's eyes to last
And scared them by sleight of the blast.”

117 And We showed Moses what We said
“Throw down your rod, and see it bred
Consuming the lies they had led.”

118 So truth was set and what they did
Turned zero *in the place they hid*.

119 So they were conquered there and they
Went back ashamed, humbled at bay.

120 The sorcerers were thrown down there
Prostrating themselves everywhere.

121 They said “We believe in the Lord
Of the worlds, 122 whom Moses *restored*,
The one that Aaron *has adored*.

123 Pharaoh said “Do you believe Him
Before I give permission's rim?

This is treason that you've planned out
In this town secretly no doubt,
To drive away its folk, but you
Will come to know *the truth and rue*.

124 ‘I'll cut off your hands and your feet
On opposite sides to retreat,
And crucify you all as meet.”

125 They said “To our Lord's our return.

126 “You only punish us who learn
To believe revelations' turn

From our Lord when they come to us.
Our Lord, fortitude grant to us
To die submitting, not to spurn.”

Today the populace of diplomats
Needs no sign to convince them they're
cool cats.

Nor do they need a pharaoh to tell them
Not to believe in You, an awful gem.
The heart depraved's enough today to make
The clearest sign divine a whipping stake,
And an excuse to turn from right to wrong,
And sing aloud a heathen, raucous song.
Beloved, set me aside from this world's
hate

And keep me in the love of You not late,
And bring upon my days the humble rate
Of mint and meadow grasses where I find
The solace of the sweeter part in rind,
The meeting of the divine in the mind.

127 The chiefs of Pharaoh's people said
“Do you leave Moses and his led
To make mischief in the land spread
Forsaking you and your gods dread?”

He said “We'll kill their sons and keep
Alive their women. We are steep
Master above the ones *who weep*.”

128 Moses told his folk “Ask help from
Allah and be patient and rum.

The land is Allah's. He makes heirs
Of it what servants in their shares
By His will, and the goal's for those
Who guard against the evil rows.”

How many evils have I guarded my
Soul from, Beloved, by Your grace from
the sky

I cannot number nor can I reply
To the hate that I find where I may turn:
They hate of the Word written and to learn
In Torah and in Psalm that all men spurn
Who touch my life with grief and dirty
hand,

And trample Your belief by boot in sand.
The hate of Hebrew syllables I see,
And where no hate, turning iniquity
To circumvent the true and bring desire
Upon the temple altar with strange fire.
I turn the page and see Your footprints
make

A blackened path across white page in
wake.

129 They said "We've suffered from the time

Before you came to us in mime
And since you've come to us." He said
"Maybe your Lord will strike the head
Of your foe and raise you to be
Rulers in the land full and free,
And then He'll see if you can act
According to promise and pact."

For centuries the people have invoked
The Exodus before the plague-fires stoked
By pharaohs rising one to fill the place
Of the preceding in the ghastly race
Of rulers to spoil earth, both bin and grace.
For centuries the cry has been that You
Might yet strike down the spoiler come in
view.

And yet more wait in vain than miss the
rue.

Beloved, today is better than the time
When Moses first spun off the promised
rhyme.

There was no precedent to give them hope.
Now we can look back from the chain and
rope

And know that there was once You came to
save

The people from the grim plight of a slave.

130 We cast on Pharaoh's people drought
And lack of produce till they sought
Remembrance *of the divine plot*.

131 But when good came on them, they
said

"This is the product of our bread."

And when the evil fell on them,
They called it bad luck from the hem
Of Moses and those with him led.

Their evil fate just comes down from
Allah, though most don't know, *they're
dumb*.

Beloved, the veils that hide the human eye
From Your reality make our hearts cry
That what of good we find is at the hand
Of our work sweating on a weary land,
And what of evil strikes our human way
Is the bad luck that's found on earthly sway.
I train the mind to see the veils in sight
As the illusions of the darkest night,

And no the evil is the call to mind
The verses of Your Torah in the bind,
The miracles of the Qur'an and fast
The Psalms and Gospel in Your mercy
vast.

The good too is from You hand for my best
To praise You in the remembrance
confessed.

132 And they said "No matter what sign
You bring to seduce us in line,
We'll not believe in your design."

133 That's why We sent them pestilence,
And locusts and lice and frogs dense
And blood in clearest evidence,
But they were acting in pride and
They were a guilty folk in band.

The honesty of the unholy man
Is beyond that of Sabbatarian.
He states for all to hear his mind's made up
As thoroughly as that of any tup.

No matter what You say or do to show
Your power and will and love on earth
below,

He'll be ready to deny what You do.

That's because he's a little god in view
And cannot bear the competition You
Provide in being the Creator and
The Sovereign of the sky and sea and land.
Beloved, the earth's evolved in era's past
Without Your intervention before mast,
So why should You not always be outcast?

134 And when the plague fell on them, they
Said "O Moses, come, for us pray
To your Lord as He promised you,
If you take away the plague's rue
From us, we will believe in you,
And we'll send out Israel with you."

The human expectation and the word
Acknowledging faith among human herd
Is always mercenary, always made
Dependent on the benefit's parade.
Methinks I am the only one I know
Who trusts You without benefit of show,
And yet I too trust only as You give
Me breath from day to day to make me
live.

All good things are Your own and all else
steers
In the illusions of my human fears.
All else is shadow and the light reflected
Along the edge of universe confected,
And rises as a smoke to praise Your name
And show the way to the truth in its flame.

135 But when We took the plague away
From them at the time set and day,
They broke the promise *in their play*.
136 So We took vengeance on them and
We drowned them in the sea as planned,
Because they denied Our signs and
Ignored the warnings *they had scanned*.
137 We made the folk they thought were
weak

Inherit eastern lands and peek
At western ones that We had blessed.
The promise of your Lord unguessed
Was carried out on Israel's folk,
Because the bore up under stroke.
We destroyed what Pharaoh had done,
And his folks doings *under sun*.

The Red Sea drowning is a famous story,
And never lacks in shed blood and in gory.
Some say the trek to Mount Sinai
Took them under the Arabian sky.
I'd like to believe that as I turn face
Toward Makkah in prayer to ask for grace
Not to participate in what made You
Destroy the folk of Pharaoh and their crew.
Though I've no right to Canaan as Gentile,
A baptized, grace-saved heathen from
erstwhile,

Perhaps the Hijaz under Sinai's view
Will be my refuge, prayer carpet and pew.
Beloved, I trample on the chariot wheels
That clutter the seabed to catch my heels.

138 We brought the children of Israel
Through the sea. Then they came awhile
On a folk who worshipped their gods.
They said "O Moses, make of clods
A god for us like what they've got."
He said "You're acting like the sot."
139 "These ones will soon be brought to
naught,

And what they do all vainly sought."
140 He said "What! Shall I seek for you

A god other than Allah due,
While He has set you above all
Created things upon the ball?"

I guess You meant the people that You
chose

To save from Egypt in their holy rows
Were set above all things created here.
You did not mean all humankind, I fear.
I know a dog or two that's better far
Than many people on this watered star,
And have a dozen chipmunks in the leaves
Of last year's maple festival's retrieves.
So often, it would seem, the folk You
choose

Turn out to worship wrong and tap their
toes

To time of Baal and dance around and
pose.

Does such apostasy come in to make
The divine choice and the election's stake
Null and void, or was it illusion's wake?

141 When We saved you from Pharaoh's
thrall

Tormenting you, killing your sons
And saving your women in buns,
In this was great trial from your Lord.
142 We set for Moses thirty nights
In term completing for delights
Ten more, so the appointed time
Of his Lord was full forty's rhyme
Of nights and Moses said to his
Brother Aaron: Take in a whiz
My place among my folk and act
Well and do not follow the pact
Of mischief-makers *to be sacked*.

143 When Moses came at Our set time
And his Lord spoke to him in rhyme,
He said "My Lord, show me Yourself,
So I make look upon Your shelf."
He said "You cannot bear to see
Me, but look at the mountain's lea,
If it stays in its place firmly,
Then you'll be able to see me."
But when his Lord showed glory round
To the mount, He made crumble ground
And Moses fell down fainting. When
He was recovered, then he said
"Glory be to You, I am led
To turn to You, and I'm again

The first of believers *of men.*”

Beloved, I too see glory all around
The Puijo hill that steps up to my ground.
I see the firs amazed at girth and strength,
The pines and birches set in all their length,
But unlike Moses, I can bear the sight.
I look unblinking at Your glories' light.
The summer storm may crumble the road I
Mount toward the cloud, mount toward the
wondered sky,
But the show of your power I may pass by
Without a pause, without a heart contrite.
Beloved, I am amazed that where I stand
Under the bare sky nonchalance has banned
Me from the crowd of speechless, and I
bear
Infinites of glory without care.

144 He said “O Moses, I chose you
Above the people with My view
And My words, so take hold of it
As I give to you and be fit
Among the grateful ones with wit.”
145 We ordained for him tablets writ
With every kind of admonition
And clarifying words' commission,
So take hold of them and be firm,
Advise your people not to squirm
Out of the best of it. I'll show
Transgressors' dwelling *there below.*

The tablets of the ten words were enough,
According to the Qur'an in the rough,
For every kind of admonition here,
And clarifying everything with fear.
Indeed, the Decalogue reveals Your will,
Your character, and more beyond the bill
Of mere commandments that all should
fulfil.

The Decalogue's a promised thing in state,
The promises in form as well as late
In commandments come floating on the air
With the perfume of hope beyond despair.
The commands are for all, the promises
Are only for the chosen ones, that is,
The elect from the ages that You share.

146 I'll turn away for My revealings
Such as unjustly proud in dealings
Are on the earth. And if they see

Each sign they'll not believe to be.
And if they see the way of right,
They do not take it for the site,
And if they see the way of wrong,
They take it for a path and song.
This is because they did deny
Our revelations coming by
And heedlessly failed to comply.
147 As for those who reject Our words,
And then return hereafter, curds
Are all their deeds. Shall be receive
Reward for what they've failed to leave?
148 And Moses' folk make of their jewels
A calf after him (they were fools),
An image only, but which made
A mooing sound when on parade.
What! Could they not see that it did
Not speak to them nor guide in bid
Which way to go? They took it and
Where unjust *in the desert land.*

The good Qur'an explains the things that
wait
A clarification for centuries late.
How did the holy nation come to rate
A golden calf a god for church and state?
The answer's not just that Egyptian crew
Was busy with Ra held in a disc due
To a horned bull. The explanation's clear:
The golden calf could moo upon the ear.
Beloved, You are so silent when I hear
The din of my realities and cheer.
You speak no word beyond the Bible and
The Qur'an when recited on the strand.
If You would only moo, I'm sure the band
Would play a tune in jubilation true.

149 When they repented and they saw
That they had gone astray by claw,
They said “If our Lord does not show
Us mercy and forgive our blow,
We'll be the losers and not slow.”
150 When Moses came back to his folk,
Angry and violent in stroke
Of grief, he said “Wicked is what
You've done behind me, in your glut
Did you turn from your Lord's command?”
And he cast down the tablets grand
And grabbed his brother by the head,
And dragged him near him, and he said
“So on my mother, the folk thought

Me weak and nearly killed in plot,
So don't make enemies rejoice
Over me and set me by choice
Among the unjust folk in voice."

The meekness of good Moses is well
known
By both the righteous and the heart of
stone,
But nothing kept him from his violence
To grasp his brother in that great offence
By the head and drag him to the past tense.
The meekness of sweet Moses is known
sure
By every cowherd on the spring for cure,
But nothing kept him from his wrath in rate
To through down the commandments at the
gate.
Beloved, keep me in meekness and in
wrath
Against those who walk on forbidden path
To tread down innocent and push the poor
Against the corner, though I'd rather not
Take any by the head. I might get shot.

151 He said "My Lord, forgive me and
My brother and bring us in band
Into Your mercy, and You are
Most merciful in mercy's car."

152 On those who took the calf the wrath
From there Lord and disgrace on path
Of this world's life shall come, and so
We recompense the lying show.

153 And those who do wrong deeds and
then

Repent afterward and like men
Believe, your Lord will come again
Forgiving, merciful to men.

What a sweet message of forgiveness I
See in the prayer of Moses on the sly.
He may have broken tablets in his wrath
And pulled his older brother in the path
By head of hair in screeching heard in
Gath,

But still the prophet shows the divine Word
In prayer, the thing that he had ever heard
From Your heart and Your mouth that our
hearts stirred.

That message is that wrong deeds don't
condemn

The perpetrator to infernal hem,
But with repentance and belief new life
And Your forgiveness overturns the strife.
I grasp the grace of true repentance You
Pour down upon humanity undue.

154 When Moses' anger had abated,
He took the tablets he had slated
And in their writing there was guidance
And mercy for those in confidence
Of their Lord *whom they'd humbly rated.*

Some hope and claim the second writing
there

Upon the second tablets came to share
A different set of promises and laws
Than did the first the broke in Moses'
claws.

I doubt that, and I wonder with delight
At how the recitation and the site
At Sinai's revelation fits the bill.
It was indeed a great, eternal hill
Beyond the one in Athens and above
The one of seven that the Romans love.
Beloved, let my wrath decrease if You will,
And let me scratch like Moses where I spill
My Roman letters in praise of the true,
The Greek, the Arabic, and the Hebrew.

155 And Moses chose among his folk
The seventy men set to the yoke.
So when the earthquake came on them,
He said "My Lord, by stratagem,
If You had willed, You might have done
Them to destruction before run
And me as well. Will You destroy
Us for what fools in our employ
Have done? It is just how You try
Them. You make err by it and sigh
Those You will and you guide the ones
You will. You are of guardians
The only one for us, and so
Forgive us and then mercy show
And Your best to forgive *the low.*

156 "Set good for us in this world's life
And in the coming without strife,
For we turn to You." He said "My
Chastisement I will afflict by
It whom I please, and My mercy
Surrounds all things. So I will see
It on those who guard from the wrong,

And give in charity and song,
And those who believe all along
In what We have revealed *as strong*. ”
157 Those who follow the Messenger
Illiterate, found written sure
With them in the Torah and in
The Gospel, enjoins from both sin
And to good, makes lawful for them
The good things and by stratagem
Unlawful the impure and takes
From them their burdens and chains' stakes
That were upon them. So those who
Believe in him, honour and aid,
And follow the light so displayed
Sent down with him, these ones shall be
Successful *through eternity*.

The Torah and the Gospel are the ground
Of messages Muhammad gave new sound.
He did not bring a new path come around.
He preached the Torah and its law and
found
The Gospel filled with truth and no
compound.
Islam turns out to be the third of three
Ways, Jewish, Christian and last trinity
Of a new faith. But I refuse to sign
On innovation, but like him confine
My faith to that that Abraham would know.
I take the old faith and forget the show
Of what men everywhere are doing here.
Let me, Beloved, remain lone in Your
cheer
And I shall find it new and year by year.

158 Say “O folk, I'm the messenger
Of God to you, of Him to stir
The kingdom of the heavens and earth,
There is no god but He of worth.
He brings to life and makes to die.
So believe in Allah, comply
With His messenger, prophet shy
Of education, who believes
In Allah and His words receives,
And follow him so you may go
In the right path, and not be slow.”

The fact that You are one and only one
Is taken for proof here on bread and bun
That good Muhammad is Your messenger,
The one that all should follow to deter

The mischief that the earthly ones incur.
The step of logic does escape my mind,
But surely every human heart is blind,
And must rely on grace to hear the call
And enter into glory, out of thrall.
Beloved, lead me in the path that is right,
Not in the failure of the third in site,
Nor in the failure of the Christian room,
Nor in the hopelessness of Jewish doom.
Give me the simple heart where You may
bloom.

159 Of Moses' folk there was a group
Who guided people, did not stoop
Away from the truth and so they
Did justice every day that way.
160 We separated them into
Twelve tribes as nations. We gave view
To Moses when his folk begged him
For water: Strike the rock with vim
By your rod. So from it flowed out
Twelve springs. Each tribe knew without
doubt
Its drinking place. And We made clouds
To give shade over them in crowds,
And We sent to them manna and
Quails. Eat the good things from Our hand.
They did not do Us any harm,
But were unjust to their own arm.

It does not come up in the Torah word
How the twelve springs each had an
assigned herd.
But that is a great thing, one to prevent
Stampeding at the water-hole You meant.
Today perhaps humanity is caught
In different tents for peace as like as not,
And Catholic and Protestant remain
In their own camps to keep them from
profane.
Beloved, let every Israelite I know
Refresh himself in the temple and glow
That You provide, but leave me not without
A well of living water that casts doubt
Upon the breeze and sends the desert air
A cool scent of refreshment for my share.

161 When it was said to them “Stay here
In this town and eat from its gear
Whatever you wish to appear,
And say 'Take from us heavy load,

And go in the gate bowing slowed,'
We'll thus forgive you your wrongs stowed,
We'll give more to those who do good
Than to the others as they should."

162 But the unjust among them changed
It for a saying other ranged
Than that which had been spoken them.
So We sent on their stratagem
A pestilence from heaven because
They were unjust *against Our laws*.
163 Ask them about the town close by
The sea. Lo, *without alibi*
They transgressed in the Sabbath matter.
For on the Sabbath day the *fatter*
Fish came to them freely and lifting
Up their heads, but when it was shifting
To a day other than the Sabt
They did not come there *to be grabbed*.
So it was We made them a test,
For they inclined to do their best
To transgress. 164 When some of them said
"Why do you preach to a folk *led*
Whom Allah will destroy or leave
With horrid punishment *bereave*?"
The preachers said "To discharge our
Duty to your Lord, and *with power*
Perhaps they will fear Him." 165 When
they
Disregarded the warnings' way
That had been given them, We saved
Those who forbade evil *enslaved*,
But We visited the wrongdoers
With an awesome correction's *skewers*,
Since they were given to transgression.
166 When in their insolence' *oppression*
They transgressed every prohibition,
We said to them "*Be in sedition*
As apes, despised, rejected *too*."

Beloved, You gave the Sabbath to mankind
Beneath the trembling mount and thunder-
lined.

The Christian who inherited the book
Left off the Sabbath but forgiveness took
For merely confessing Messiah's name.
I'd think they'd read the book now to their
shame.

Beloved, I shall hold fast what they reject,
Because You said to hold firm and respect
The Sabbath day with the remembrance of
The holy name that's in the book for love.

And for my faint remembering and tear
Perhaps I shall re-enter in Your fear
And find that apish ways fall from my
hands

As I learn to love and keep Your
commands.

167 Behold! Your Lord published the view
That He would send against them, to
The Day of Judgement, those who would
Afflict them with harsh hardihood.
Your Lord is quick in retribution,
But He's also *in contribution*
Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.

168 We split them into *plentiful*
Sections on earth. Among them are
Some that are righteous *like a star*,
And some that are the opposite.
We've tried them *that they might be fit*
With both prosperity and *strong*
Adversity: so all along
They might repent. 169 After them came
A generation: they took *claim*
To inheritance of the book,
But they chose this world's vanities,
Saying "Forgiveness is faith's ease."
If the same vanities again
Came their way, they would *be such men*
To seize them. Was not the book's pact
Taken from them so they would act
Not to ascribe to Allah things
Besides the truth? And they *in rings*
Study what's in the book. But best
For the righteous is home of rest
In the hereafter. Will you not
Understand *what those ones forgot*?

Divisions of mankind have purpose meant,
And that's to inspire the repentance sent.
I too live in a world fragmented here,
And one not too much smarter in its gear
Than what good Gibbon describes to
appear

In Rome when kings were lost and caesars
came

To rule by buying office with a claim.
I've seen the office bought now too, but still
The world despite its gardenless and ill
Is not quite as bad as Gibbon's in bill.
But in this world fragmented I still find
The joys of Your creation and the kind

In Puijo's firs and birches and resigned
The aspens lifting nervous leaf assigned.

170 As to those who hold fast by book
And establish daily prayer's *nook*,
Never shall We suffer reward
Of the righteous to meet the sword.

171 When We shook the mount over them,
As if it were canopy's hem,
And they thought it was 'bout to fall
On them, *We said* "Hold firmly all
The things that We've given you *by call*,
And bring to remembrance what's there,
So perhaps you'll fear Allah's *share*."

Beloved, I hold fast to the book that You
Sent down to Moses, David, Jesus too,
And poor Muhammad, last if not the least
To face the world of humankind and beast.
Beloved, I hold fast to the book at last
And cantillate its words, though not full
mast,

Because the cares of life take of my time,
And also my own wonderings in rhyme.
But as I cantillate Your Word in prayer
And know that You draw near me and to
where

All who recite Your revelations dear,
I find that my heart trembling loses fear,
And rests at last in promises and cheer,
In Your remembrances made loud and
clear.

172 When your Lord brought forth from
the sons

Of Adam, from their backs and buns,
Their spawn and made them testify
Against themselves, "Say, am not I
Your Lord?" They answered, "Yes, and we
So testify." So you can't say
On Day of Judgement "Verily,
We didn't know about this way."

173 Or lest you'd say "Indeed our dads
Joined others from before our pads
And we're just their descendants here
To follow after. Will You spear
Us for what vanities they did
To lead us in the way they hid?"

174 And so We clarify the verses
In detail so you may from curses
Turn back. 175 Tell them about the news

Of the man We gave precious views,
But he set himself one apart,
Till Satan followed him with dart,
And he was one who went astray.
176 And had We wanted it that way,
We could have exalted his sway,
But he clung to earthly desires,
And followed vainly what inspires,
So he was like a dog, if you
Attack him shows his tongue at you,
Or if you leave him in peace, he
Will hang out his tongue still freely,
And such are those folk who deny
Our signs, so tell the stories' cry
To make them think of what and why.

When You sent Balaam on the awful trek
Between the gadir and the horrid wreck
He made of self and soul before the talking
donkey,
He'd made his choices in the honkey-
tonkey
Despite the knowledge of Your name
You'd given.

And so today I see many unshriven
Who go about with Yahweh on their lips
Rebellious hands and elbows at the hips.
Beloved, I have no donkey to warn me,
I have no revelation in degree,
But let me not turn to the fires to take
The golden images out for my stake.
Your verses in the Bible and Qur'an
Suffice to bring to heart and mind the
dawn.

177 How evil is the way of those
Folk who deny Our signs and chose
To be unjust to their own toes.
178 Whomever Allah guides is one
Guided aright, and so the one
He lets go astray, they've not won.

The Baptist doctrine of predestination
That contrasts with the Calvinistic ration
In being single and not double drawn
Is well expressed here in words of Qur'an.
Your guidance always leads the soul aright.
Those who have not Your guidance, it's
their plight
To go astray. You are not to blame

For the ways of mankind that lead to
shame.

Beloved, I praise the great reality
Of Your grace in Your vast eternity
That brings about the fast divine decree.
The hope of heaven is not in balance set
To bait and wonder who will and not get,
But is as certain as the grace that's met.

179 Indeed We've made many for hell
Among the jinn and human knell.
They have hearts but don't understand
With it, they have eyes that have scanned
Without sight, and they've got ears too,
But do not hear a thing to do.

They're like the cattle gone astray.
Such ones take no heed of the way.
180 To God the sweetest names of all,
So use them when on Him you call,
And separate from those who take
His names profanely: for their sake
They'll soon be recompensed in stake
For what they do *to have a ball*.

181 Among the peoples We created
Are those who guide with truth elated
And in justice they themselves keep
Adherence to it *without sleep*.

Remembrance of Your sweet and holy
names
Is the joy of my harvest and my claims.
I meet the Four Books in the Four Gates
set,

And find the four in everything I get.
The facts lie on perspective of the air,
The form outlines the way in fiery share,
The fragrance in by-product makes aware,
The function in reality leaves care.
Beloved, I separate from those who take
All four of the foundations that men make
Profanely and set chemical afire
In industry instead of in the pyre
Of wedding to the hopes of Dan and Tyre.
I look out on the glass and burning lake.

182 And those who deny our signs, We
Will step by step soon in degree
Draw them from what they do not know
Into the ruin of *their show*.

183 I give them respite and in truth
My plan is strong *though filled with ruth*.

184 What! Don't they contemplate the fact
That their companion does not act
With madness, but he is just here
A warner of what will appear?

185 Or don't they regard in the realms
Of heaven's kingdoms from earth's helms
And things created and the fact
That their time may be near exact,
So then in what warning to come
Might they believe after this sum?
186 The ones God lets astray have not
A guide and He leaves them in plot
Alone with their transgression's lot,
Blind wandering *in darkness untaught*.

What use is warning, my Beloved, when
those

Who go astray do so by what they chose
Without Your guidance to the rich and fair?
The warning is no guidance to the stair,
No help to avoid loss, grief and despair.
I look on heaven's kingdom and the earth,
But without guidance fail to find their
worth,

And in my little round of things to do,
Note not the passage of angel or You,
Nor anything beyond the physic's rue.
Beloved, though I am blind, depraved, and
sweet,

Let me not wander in paths of retreat,
But find the fresher air of heights and vales
Where knowledge of reality out-sails.

187 They ask you of the coming hour
When will be its appointed power,
Say "Knowledge of it's only by
My Lord. No one can bring it nigh
But He. Heavy in earth and sky
Shall it be, and not come but sly
And suddenly to you." They ask
You as if you took care and task
About it. Say "Its knowledge here
Is just with God. Most folk *in gear*
Do not know that *and do not fear*."

188 Say "I have for myself not good
Or any harm, except God should
Will, and had I known then unseen,
I should have had much good and keen,
And evil would not have touched me,
And I am just a warner, see,
And bearer of good news for those

Folk who believe, *keep on their toes.*

The very friends of Christ himself asked
him

About the day and year of judgement's
trim,

And when the earth should melt and heaven
come

Down on the waiting multitude to hum.

No man knows day nor hour, he said to
them,

And thus betrayed the divine stratagem
Of hiding the eternal logos where
The human limitations made him bare.

No man knows day nor hour but You above
All the sublunar realms of hate and love.

Still instead of the moment of choice here,
The human heart seeks out the coming bier,
And searches Scriptures for the end in fear
Instead of minding now's repentant tear.

189 It's He created your from just
A single self and from that dust
Did make his mate so he might live
With her, then when he comes to give
Her seed, she carries a light weight
Until it becomes heavy state,
Then they both pray to their Lord, "If
You give us a good child, it's stiff
We be both thankful for the rate."

190 But when He gives them a good child
They join to Him their partners wild
In what He's given them. But high
Is God above the things they try.

191 What! Do they join to Him what will
Not make creation, no, not swill,
While they themselves are merely just
Created beings *in the dust?*

192 They cannot help them or themselves,
And they are worth no more than elves.

193 If you invite them to be guided,
They will not follow you when chided.
It is the same to you if you
Invite them or not in the pew.

Idolators I leave to their device,
And let them think that they have had it
nice.

Why should I call down on myself more
grief

By warning the idolator and thief?

Bare Your right arm, Beloved, and strike
me down

In everything I usurp from Your crown,
And in that striking strike all others here
Who fail to live under Your eye in fear.
Beloved, I know that there's no god but

You,
Since nothing can create with derring-do
A mite to perpetrate the faith in view.
Beloved, I know creation is the sign
Of Your power above every other line,
The gauge of hope, the gold and silver
mine.

194 What you call on instead of God
Is set under His divine rod

Just as you are yourselves, so call
On them, see if they're on the ball.
195 What? Do they have feet for to walk,
And do they have hands to hold stock,
Or eyes to see, or ears to hear?
Say "Call on those you join to fear
And then plot against me and give
Me no more room on earth to live."

196 Indeed my guardian is Allah
Who sent down the book writ in awe,
And He guards righteous ones *from claw.*

197 And those you call on besides Him
Can never help you from things grim,
Nor even help themselves go trim.

198 And if you call them to be guided,
They will not hear. And when confided
You see them look toward your place,
They do not see of things a trace.

199 Keep to the middle way and praise
Virtue and turn away from ways
Of ignorant ones on the craze.

200 If Satan tries to pull you wrong,
Seek refuge in Allah along:
He hears all and knows all *the song.*

201 Those who take care when evil
thoughts

From Satan enter in their draughts,
They are aware and see the plots.

202 Their brothers draw them deeper in
The wrong, so they strive still to win.

203 When you don't bring a sign, they say
"Why don't you tinker one and play?"

Say "I just follow what my Lord
Revealed to me from what He's stored;
These are clear proofs from your Lord too,

And guidance and a mercy true
 For a folk who believe as due.”
 204 And when the Qur'an is recited,
 Then listen to it, be requited,
 So mercy to you comes unslighted.
 205 Remember your Lord in yourself,
 Humbly and in awe on your shelf,
 Not with a loud voice morn and night,
 And don't be negligent for spite.

The service of remembrance, dhikr called,
 Is here enjoined on those who are
 enthralled
 With faith at morning light and when the
 night
 Brings evening on before their faithful
 sight.
 The institutions grand, the Sufi lodge,
 Brings out the service with a hodge and
 podge
 On one night of the week, and without rest
 Cries and whirls all the night as though in
 test.
 Beloved, let Your remembrance fall on me,
 Your sovereign grace to keep me faithfully
 From breath to breath as I by Your decree
 Die daily and am resurrected free
 By exhalations and inhaling where
 You come near to the soul that bows in
 prayer.

206 Those who are with your Lord are not
 Too proud to worship Him a lot;
 They glorify Him and prostrate
 Themselves before Him *who is great*.

The child that called out to the man who
 came
 To catch him for his mischief and in blame
 This verse of the Qur'an, knew that by law
 The adult must prostrate then once in awe
 To hear the words. I once was where a man
 Recited in Islamic sort of span
 This verse and some bowed down and
 some refrained,
 I know not why. The reciter was pained,
 And chided them for failure to envoke
 Your name, Beloved, at the clear words he
 spoke.
 Beloved, I bow to read the Arabic

And bow again to hear the good words
 stick
 Like barbs within my heart. Let me remain
 Bowed ever at Your throne, though without
 gain,
 And without hope, Beloved, and without
 stain.

Surah 8 Anfal, or the Spoils of War

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 They ask you about spoils or war.
 Say “Such spoils are in Allah's store
 And for the messenger, so fear
 Allah, and behave with your gear
 Among yourselves. Obey Allah
 And His messenger, if in awe
 You do believe.” 2 Those who believe
 Are just the ones without reprieve
 Who rejoice in their hearts to hear
 The mention of Allah in gear,
 And when to them His verses are
 Recited, they add without bar
 To their faith, God's their only star.

Beloved, three indicators of faith dwell
 In heart of humankind, and so make swell
 The knowledge of who is saved here from
 hell
 And who is not, besides the sign that's
 come

In the grace of repentance to each bum.
 But these signs are not singly to be taken:
 It's possible to rejoice unforsaken
 In heart at mention of Your name and still
 Be in damnation in dell and on hill.
 But joy to hear Your name in trinity
 With cantillation of the Scriptures free
 Awakening more faith, and then to be
 Relying only on You, those things three
 Prove that You've saved one from iniquity.

3 Those who set prayer and from the
 wealth
 Allah's provided them with stealth
 They spend *in charity for health*.
 4 These are the believers in truth;
 For them are degrees *and with ruth*
 With their Lord, and forgiveness and
 A sustenance of grace to stand.

To that fair trinity in evidence

Of true belief that saves from the suspense
Are added two more proofs, and higher
ones:

That regular prayer without grief or puns
Results in care and regard for the poor
And the oppressed, and that is a sign sure
Of true faith in Your Word and help and
healing.

These are the five proofs above all man's
feeling.

Beloved, give me the faith in You today.
I covet such a faith more than my pay:
To rejoice in Your name and sing Your
Word

No matter what may say the heathen herd,
Relying on You only when I pray
To help the needy come into my sway.

5 Just as your Lord made you come out
Of your house with the truth to shout,
Though some of those who believed then
Did not approve of that again,

6 They argue with you about truth
After it's been revealed *with ruth*,
As though they were driven to death,
While watching themselves lose their
breath.

7 And when God promised you should get
One of the two parties in set,

And you preferred the one unarmed,
Intending that God give unharmed
His truth by words, and so cut off
The roots of those in doubt to scoff,

8 So He could set up truth as right
And show the wrong as wrong in spite,
No matter what the guilty plight.

9 When you begged help from your Lord,
then

He answered you *in sight of men*:

"Indeed I'll rush now to your aid
With thousand angels in parade."

10 God only did that for good news
And to convince your hearts in views.
And there's no help but comes from God.
He is triumphant, wise *in prod*.

No matter what men say in the fond grip
Of the emotions that they have let slip
Since Wesleys came to teach and preach
and drip;

No matter what men proclaim from the lip

Of what their minds enquiring at the hip
Have indicated of religion's pip;
The truth is true and found in You alone:
Yours is the truth upon which stands Your
throne.

Beloved, the help that You give humankind
Is not just what we want. We hope You're
blind.

But the illumination of the truth
Is what brings aid to all, both age and
youth.

I turn from blind emotion and the mind
Whose reasons flash again to make me
blind.

11 When He put you to slumber safe,
And send from heaven the water's strafe,
So He might purify you and
Take Satan's unclean stains from hand,
And so strengthen your hearts and set
Your feet firm on the ground *to get*.

12 When your Lord showed the angels
speech:

Indeed, I'm with you, make you each
Those who believe stand firm *to teach*.
Soon I'll put fear into the hearts
Of infidels, so strike with darts
Off their necks and fingertips' parts.

The Christian sort of critic stands aghast
Before the orders to break necks and blast
Against the infidel. But this is not
Writ against everyone in cruel plot
Who fails to believe in Word of Qur'an,
But against those who came in battle
drawn.

And yet I cry hypocrisy on them
For criticism and the stratagem.
Those who would cry against the Qur'an
fail

To see the Bible also calls the flail
Against the Canaanite, both girl and son,
And gives them all death sentence once
begun.

The violent are violent in all,
Both in the hand and arm, and in the call.

13 That's because they opposed God and
His messenger, and every band
Opposing God and messenger
Will punishment of God incur.

14 That's it, so taste it, and that is

For unbelievers torment's whiz.
 15 O you believers, when you meet
 Those who do not believe in feat
 Of battle, don't turn them your backs.
 16 And those that day who turn their backs
 Except for the plan of attacks,
 Or joining a band without slacks,
 He brings on himself wrath from God,
 And his place to dwell under rod
 Is hell; and what an evil place
 To get to is that *without grace*.
 17 You did not kill them, but God did,
 And you cast not, but God the lid,
 That He might test believers by
 The gracious testing from Him *sly*.
 God is all hearing, knowing why.
 18 That's how God diminished the plans
 Of infidels *under His scans*.
 19 If your demand was victory,
 Then victory is what you see,
 And if you stop, it's better far,
 And if you go back to the bar,
 We also shall return, and then
 Your armies will never again
 Prevail in anything, though they
 May be so numerous in sway,
 For God's with the believers' way.
 20 O you who believe, obey God,
 And His apostle at the prod,
 And do not turn away from him
 While you hear *what he says not dim*.
 21 And don't be like those who have said
 "We heard" while they don't hear instead.
 22 The worst of creatures in God's view
 Are deaf and dumb, the ones who do
 Not understand. 23 And if God found
 A good thing in them, He'd come round
 To make them listen, and if He
 Got them to listen, they'd agree
 To turn back and swerve from the free.

I live among the worst of creatures here,
 Those not aware of sovereign grace and
 fear,
 Who trample on the Sabbath day and lear
 At the baptisms of believers' cheer,
 And think that any human sort of gear
 Is good enough for ritual and dear.
 I live among those You Beloved despise,
 Since You have given hearts and ears and
 eyes.

Beloved, I find within my human heart
 No better stuff than those not set apart,
 And know my ways are wayward as a song
 Beneath my Puijo pines for right or wrong.
 I lie like all men here beneath the stroke
 Of Your Word light or heavy as You spoke.

24 O you believers, answer God
 And His messenger at the prod
 That calls to life that's given you.
 Know that God comes between the view
 Of a man and his heart, to Him
 Shall all of you be gathered trim.

25 And guard yourselves from the plight
 that

May come to smite the unjust rat
 Among you in particular,
 And know that God's strict at the bar.
 26 Remember when you were but few
 Considered weak in their earth's view,
 Afraid folk might bear you away
 By force, but He strengthened your sway
 With His help and provided you
 With good things in your grateful view.

27 O you believers, do not be
 Unfaithful to God and to see
 The messenger, and do not be
 Unfaithful to the duties' that
 You have with you known where you're at.

28 Know that your substance and your
 spawn

Are a temptation to you drawn,
 And God, with Him's great reward's dawn.

29 O you believers, if you fear
 God He will grant you a clear gear
 And take from you your evil share,
 And forgive you, and God is there
 The Lord of mighty grace *to bear*.

30 And when they planned against you,
 those

Who disbelieve, that they might close
 You up, or slay you or drive out,
 And they make plans and God is stout
 To have a plan; and God is best
 Of the planners here to invest.

31 When Our signs are recited them
 They say "Indeed we've heard in hem,
 If we just wanted to we could
 Recite the like of this as should,
 It's just tales of the ancient hood."

32 And when they say "O God, if this

Is truth from You, then please dismiss
On us stones from the sky or then
Inflict on us a painful wen."

33 And God's not here to punish them
While you are among them in hem,
Nor is God here to punish them
While they still seek by stratagem
Forgiveness *like a precious gem*.

34 What can they plead that God should
not

Chastise them while they're there to stop
Folk from the sacred mosque, and they
Are not its guardians in sway;
Its guardians are only those who
Keep themselves pure, but most folk do
Not know. 35 And their prayer near the
House

Is just a whistling *like a grouse*
And folding hands. Taste punishment
For what you've disbelieved of sent.

36 Indeed the ones who disbelieve
Spend of their wealth to hold the sleeve
To keep men from the way of God.
So they will spend it, then it will
Be against them regretful bill;
And those who disbelieve, to hell
They shall be driven, *you can tell*.

37 That God might make distinction clear
Between the impure and sincere,
And put the impure, some now here,
And pile it up together dear,
Then throw it into hell for fear;
These are the losers *of all cheer*.

38 Say to the ones who disbelieve,
If they desist they'll have reprieve
For what is past, and if they turn
Back, they will only come to earn
What came on ancient folk *to burn*.

39 And fight with them until there be
No mischief and religion be
Wholly for God; but if they're free
In their desisting, God does see
What they commit. 40 If they refuse,
Be certain that Allah will choose
To be protecting you, He's best
Protector and Helper unguessed.

In truth, Beloved, each helper that appears
In church, in mosque and synagogue, one
fears

Is but the turn of battle, one who made

Peace with his Lord because the fatal shade
Came over him, as soon as sun returns
He does turn back, his faith, dried lilies,
burns.

There is no help in anyone but You,
Not even in myself, what's there to do?
But turn from self to You and there to find
The self I cherished so was shadows blind
And my true Self was glorious and
unknown,

A towering oak above the shell outgrown
Of fading veils, illusion cast aside,
Where You are I, and I in You abide.

41 And you know that what you acquire,
A fifth is for God and desire
Of the apostle and for those
Near kin and orphans and the rows
Of needy and wayfaring men,
If you believe in Allah then
And what We sent down to Our own
Servant, and on the day when shown,
On the day when two parties meet;
And all is under Allah's feet.

42 When you were on this side and they
Were on the other side to stay,
While the caravan was below,
And if you together made show
Of an appointment, certainly
You would have broken away free
For the success, but so that God
Might bring to pass determined prod,
That the one who should perish might
Perish after a clear proof's sight,
And the one who lives may live on
After a clear evidence drawn;
Indeed God hears all, knows all *light*.

43 When God showed them to you in
dream

As few, and if He's shown to seem
Many, truly then you'd have been
Discouraged and disputed keen
About the matter, but God did
Save you; indeed nothing is hid
From Him of what's in your breasts' bid.

44 When He showed them to you when met
As few in your eyes and He set
You to appear as few to them
In their eyes for a stratagem
That God might bring to pass the thing
Determined and to God will spring

Back all things *to hide in His hem.*

45 O you believers, when you meet
A band, then be firm and replete
To mind God much that you may be
Successful *in all faithfully.*

46 Obey God and His messenger
And do not quarrel at the spur
For then you'll be weakened in heart,
And your power from you will depart,
And so be patient; truly God
Is with the patient ones *to prod.*

47 And don't be like the ones who left
Their homes in boasting as bereft
To be seen by men, but you make
Obstruction for the others' sake
From the way of Allah; indeed
God surrounds what they do *in greed.*

48 When Satan made their sinful deeds
Seem to allure them in their greeds,
He told them, "No one among men
Shall conquer you while I'm in den
Your guardian." And then so when
The two bands met, he turned around,
And said "I've changed my mind and
ground,

I see then things that you don't see,
God punishes and severely."

The enemy of souls, that grand old scratch
Who makes the evil seem for grace the
match

Of good, and so allures the hand to take
An apple or a wench for his lust's sake,
Returns when crisis hits the ban and flies,
And shows his hand and reveals all his lies.
But then it is too late and muster's down
And silence has descended on the town.
Beloved, my enemy at last I find
More in my own heart than the other kind.
And yet that heart is turned in love to You
As I resort to join the fatal crew.
All change their minds, the deil as well as I,
And only You are changeless in the sky.

49 When the hypocrites and those who
Have hearts diseased say in their rue,
"Their faith has seduced them in pew,"
Who then relies on God, then God
Is mighty and wise where they plod.
50 If you had seen when angels take
Away the souls of those who make

Their disbelief, to strike their faces
And hit them on their backs and braces,
"Taste now the torment burning traces."

The vision of the angel of death rises
Here and not only where Qur'an surprises
With word of the barzakh caught in
between

The earthly life and the things not yet seen.
The folklore multiplies from town and vale
And desert nights and lights of stars assail
The mind untortured by the peace that's
wrought

Where desert skies are darkened without
plot.

Beloved, the hypocrite in me, I've often
thought,

Has no pew among faith or faithless taught.
And yet in the fragmentation that's know
In Christendom and the Islamic show,
I find the peace of my recital go
In rippling currents as Your loved signs
flow.

51 This is for what your own hands did,
Since God's not unjust that He hid
From His servant *the things He'd bid.*

52 Like the folk of Pharaoh and those
Before them; disbelieved in rows
The signs of God, so did God seize
Them for their sins; and by degrees
God hears and sees all they disclose.
53 That's because God does not change
what

Benefits He bestows in glut
On any folk until they change;
And God sees and hears all in range.

54 Like the folk of Pharaoh and those
Before them; they denied in gross
The signs of their Lord, so did We
Destroy them for their sins and We
Did drown the people of Pharaoh;
And all were unjust *scum and low.*

55 The vilest of beasts in God's view
Are those who disbelieve for rue,
And they would not believe *the true.*

Let me be no vile thing, Beloved, as You
Look on creation from Your higher pew,
Except as vileness must ever accrue
From all the human things I like to do.

You have made nothing vile, and that I
 know,
 Your making is perfection and not slow,
 And still the guile I play with comes to
 bleat
 That something smells of spoiling in the
 heat.
 The wise, Beloved, are those who doubt
 Your word.
 The ignorant alone have their hearts stirred.
 And yet I find another truth to be
 That ignorance arises in glory
 And falls flat without any grace to see.
 See how all things on this earth have
 occurred.

56 Those with whom you made covenant,
 Then they break their pact as soon scant,
 And they don't guard themselves *but rant*.
 57 So when you take them in the fight,
 Scatter them to show in true light
 Those who come after them, so they
 May mind remembering *the right way*.
 58 And if you fear folk's treachery,
 Then throw back to them equally,
 God does not love traitors' degree.
 59 Those who do not believe need not
 Think they are better in the plot.
 They shall not weaken God *a lot*.

If not by will of man can divine plot
 Be hindered, then by the same token's lot
 The will of man can never wield a hand
 To further Your kingdom among the
 planned.
 Yet many treat me to the mill and sand
 To choose to enter in or then remand
 A missionary out to save the world
 That's heading into hell with flag unfurled.
 Beloved, You save the ones You will and
 send
 The rest to hell where they burn and
 amend.
 Belief and penance and tears may be true
 Or may reveal attempts to buy off you.
 Beneath the race of universe I ply
 My little boat beneath reflective sky.

60 Prepare against them what you can,
 War horses stabled out to scan
 With fearsome aspect foe of God,

And your foes too not known on sod,
 God knows them; and what you may spend
 In Allah's way, all that you lend
 Will be repaid you, and you'll not
 Be dealt with unjustly in lot.
 61 If they are peaceful, then be so
 And trust in God; He is not slow
 To hear all things as well as know.
 62 If they intend to deceive you,
 Then Allah is enough in view,
 He strengthens and He will imbue
 With help and with believers' crew.

The feelings that rich stories now provide,
 And the reasonings that come in to guide
 Are not enough, Beloved, to steal my soul.
 I'm not deceived by heart or mind in toll.
 The most religious people in this place
 Are out to deceive me, but give no grace,
 And so I turn from love and knowing to
 The silence and the doubting I've in You.
 Beloved, though sweet and clear have been
 around
 Since Watts and Wesley ran the ship
 aground,
 I turn on heal and grasp the Gospel sound
 And hum the Psalms while I'm to glory
 bound.
 You may love and appeal to fruitful mind,
 To everything but You I remain blind.

63 He put affection betwixt hearts,
 And had you spent all in earth's parts,
 You'd not set such love between hearts,
 But God raised affection in them,
 He's almighty, all-wise in gem.
 64 O messenger, God is enough
 For those believers who are tough
 To follow you *through ease and rough*.

You are enough, Beloved, You are enough
 When times are good and when the going's
 rough.
 You send upon the earth each prophet
 loose,
 And dangle before infidel the noose,
 And never let a ray of light fall down
 Except in grace to save those in the town.
 The love of men is fixed in hearts of stone,
 And some repent and others find alone
 The help and hope in striving to be great

And wealthy beyond others in the state.
I'm greedy, my Beloved, for far more than
The gold and silver, stocks and bonds in
span.

Only You are enough, You only can
Rejoice the heart in rough and easy rate.

65 O messenger, urge on to war
Believers, if there are a score
Of patient ones with you, they'll stay
Two hundred coming in the way.
If there are two hundred, they'll take
A thousand disbelievers' stake,
A folk not knowing what to say.

66 For now God's made your burden light,
And He knows your weakness in sight,
And if there are a hundred who
Are patient ones there among you,
They'll overcome two hundred and
If you're a thousand they'll withstand
Two thousand with God's guiding hand,
And God is with the patient band.

67 It is not fitting for apostle
To have captives unless in tossle
He's fought upon the earth. You want
The poor goods of this world and gaunt,
While God wants the hereafter's fount.
And God's too great and wise *to taunt*.

68 Had God not made decree before,
Surely great punishment in store
Would have come on you for your lore.
69 Eat what you acquired in the battle,
Of things lawful and the good cattle,
And fear God, indeed God returns
Forgiving, in mercy *one learns*.

Some contemplate the Qur'an and relate
Its wickedness because of all the hate
And violence it fosters in the state.
Such have not read the Torah and the writ
Of prophets come to Israel to sit
And call the folk to genocide and fit.
Beloved, I claim to follow Gospel word
In the pacific, non-violent herd.
And yet I trow if I were taught enough
In poverty and violence and tough
Life in this world, I'd be ready to see
A bit of revolution's liberty.
Beloved, I take no credit for the peace,
But live in gratitude of my release.

70 O messenger, say to the caught
Captives in your hands, "If God has
thought

To find any good in your hearts,
He will give you better for parts
Than what has been taken from you,
And He'll forgive you, and it's true
God's forgiving, merciful too.

I guess this verse relates to those who fell
Under Islamic onslaught and the spell
And lost their wealth and yet avoided hell
By their reversion to Abraham's well.
If so, it is a slim comfort to bear,
But may inspire to take part in the wear
Of further combat in the prophet's name.
I would not consider that thing a shame.
Beloved, I wander in the earth without
An army, band or battle where I flout
All treasures and all booty but to eat
The herbs that grow along the road for
treat.

I pray the passing of automobile
Does not empoison them or else defile.

71 If they mean to be treacherous
To you, so they've been in the fuss
Toward God unfaithful from before,
But He gave you the power in store
Over them; and God knows all things,
He is all-wise *above all springs*.

72 Those who believed and moved away,
And struggled with their means in sway
And with themselves in path of God,
And gave shelter and helped in prod,
These are the guardians of each other,
And those who believed, man and mother,
And did not move, you're not the one
To guard them till migration's done,
Then you are duty-bound to give
Them help, except in sieve
Of a folk with treaty with you,
And surely God sees all you do.

73 And those who disbelieve, some are
The guardians of each other's star.
Unless you do this, there will be
Discord and lack of harmony
On earth and great mischief in spree.

74 Those who believed and moved away
And struggled then in Allah's way,
And those who gave shelter and aid,

These are the true believers staid,
For them's forgiveness and at last
A great provision *come down fast*.
75 And those who believed later and
Moved and strove with you, they are band
With you, and the blood kin are near
To each other in God's book's fear,
God knows everything, *that is clear*.

The Hegirah was not kind to the folk
Who fled to Axum and then ran for broke
Up to Madina for a lucky stroke.
Medina is a sweet town, that is true,
But it is not the nearer place to You.
The gardens of the blessed are at its file,
And palms address the pilgrims there
awhile.
And yet the dusty way to Makkah from
Madina is a long journey to come.
It is a sacrifice to make the move,
And You and Your prophet are right to
prove
Unselfishness of those who fit the groove.
Beloved, I see the road shine in the night
And hear the pilgrims in their joyous flight.

Surah 9 Tauba (Repentance) or Baraat (Immunity)

1 Immunity from Allah and
His messenger, to those who stand
As heathen with whom you have made
Treaties. 2 So go you in the earth
For four months, and know that in worth
You are not weakening God's berth,
And that God brings shame on the head
Of unbeliever *and unled*.
3 A proclamation from God and
His messenger unto the band
Of folk on great pilgrimage day,
That Allah has no duty to
Idolators, and so His due
Apostle. So if you repent
It will be better as it went
With you, and if you turn away,
Then know you're not weakening the way
Of God. And proclaim unto those
Who disbelieve a painful close.

All things turn to the good and to the plan
That You have spread beneath eternal scan
No matter of the works of feeble man,

Nor of the vast rebellion of the host
Demonic that stands up in hell to boast.
It is illusion that the human will
Determines course of fate from plain and
hill.

The math slips through the fingers and the
rage
Of acres of frustration comes to gauge
The hopes lost in the fiery billows cast.
The adversary plies ways to the last.
Beloved, let rage rage on both on the earth
And in the hells below in fainter berth,
Your sovereign will lies unchanged in its
worth.

4 Except those with whom you've a pact,
For the idolaters who've backed
You and have not betrayed you, then
Fulfil your treaty with such men
Until the end of terms agreed.
God loves those who guard them *from
greed*.

5 So when the sacred months have passed
Then kill idolaters outcast
Wherever you find them, and seize
Them and besiege them and with ease
Set ambush for them, then if they
Repent and so begin to pray,
And give the poor-rate, then leave them
Free to their stratagem,
God is the oft-forgiving and
Most merciful *in all the land*.
6 If any from the godless band
Seeks your protection, grant to him
Until he hears Allah's word *grim*,
Then escort him to his own place
Of safety. This is for the grace
That they are ignorant of face.

The good Muhammad with blood-thirsty
thrill
Has Your heart and good David's at the kill,
And does not draw back in pity and greed
Like King Saul with his spear and with his
steed.

The book of revelation's not pacific,
And that's why it's not thought to be terrific
By those who pay their taxes to the State
To protect industries that come to rate
Poor populations exploited by fate.
Beloved, kill if You will, and bring to life

Whomever You desire to meet the strife
With sword and gore and punishment as
rife
As air and rain and sun and child and wife.
Beloved, I'm waiting here to feel Your
knife.

7 How can there be a covenant
For the idolaters who rant
With God and with His messenger
Except those with whom you incur
A pact at the sacred Mosque sure
Long as they are loyal to you,
Then be faithful to them in crew?
God loves those who guard *from the rue*.

8 How can there be as long as they
Attack you without regard's way
To kinship or to covenant?
They seduce with sweet words, while they
Plan against you in heart, in sway
Of their transgressions *in the way*.
9 They've traded off the signs of God
For a small price in empty pod,
And turn others back from His way,
Evil is what they do *and say*.

The principle is that betrayal here
Voids pact and promise over life and gear,
And justifies the wars Muhammad fought,
And justifies the revolutions sought
Throughout the century that I've just seen
Destroy its millions with its war machine.
I hear the population satisfied
Repeat that war is always justified
To keep the population down and make
There room enough for every profit's stake.
Such is stupidity around the clock,
But stupid one win at the ballot's stock,
And gyrate to their own hypnotic rock.
Beloved, let some few at least come to
dock.

10 They do not have regard at all
For kinship or their treaty's thrall
When it's a question of the folk
Who are believing *what God spoke*.

11 If they repent and learn to pray
And in charity come to pay,
Then they're your brothers in faith's way.
We make signs clear for folk who know
And understand the way to go.

12 And if they violate their oath
After their covenant in quoth,
Reviling your religion, then
Fight the leaders of such base men,
Indeed there's no oath for their way,
To make them stop going astray.
13 What! Don't you want to fight the folk
Who violate the oaths they spoke,
Tried turning out the messenger,
And they attacked you first in spur?
What! Do you fear them? But Allah
Is more deserving of such awe,
If you're believing folk *in law*.

Fear is a good foundation for the act
That human's perpetrate against the fact.
Men fight each other for the fear they bear
Against each other here as well as there.
But good Muhammad hopes that men will
fight
Because they fear You by both day and
night.
How can a man fear You, Beloved, when
You

Are so invisible to this blind crew?
Beloved, I love from the depths of my soul,
And not by sight or smell or any goal,
And fear too is spontaneous I throw,
And not product of philosophic how.
So let me love and fear and go my way
A-whirling on my hill both night and day.

14 Fight them, so Allah may chastise
Them by your hands and in such guise
Put them to shame, and help you gain
Power over them and heal the stain
In breast of believers *not vain*.

15 He takes away rage from the hearts,
And God turns mercifully in arts
To everyone He so desires,
God knows all, is wise *as inquires*.

16 Do you think you'll be left alone
As though Allah had never known
How you have struggled never taking
Another besides Him forsaking
As mediator beside God
And His apostle and the prod
Of the believers? God's aware
Of everything that you do there.

17 It's not idolaters should keep
The sacred Mosque when bearing steep

Witness against themselves that they
Follow the unbelievers' way.
Their actions are vain, and beside
It's in hellfire they will abide.
18 The only one to keep Allah's
Mosque is who believes in the claws
Of God and the last day, and still
Establishes prayer and the bill
Of the poor-rate and fears no one
Except God. So these under sun
Are rightly guided ones when done.

The Torah hardly mentions retribution,
At least not hell-fire for spinal solution.
The prophets with invectives may stand on
Their ire from noon until following dawn.
But real wrath in the fires of hell appears
First in the Gospels as though in arrears
To make up for the silence gone before.
Only the good Qur'an in praise of gore
Can reach the pinnacle. The reason why
Is simply that generations gone by
Are not as wicked as the ones who now
Inspire wrath on divine and human brow.
It's anger now, not love, that shows who
stands
Acceptable, accepted in Your hands.

19 What! Do you regard those who give
Drink to the pilgrims and so live
To keep the sacred mosque to be
Equal to those who faithfully
Believe in God and the last day,
And striving always in God's way?
God does not guide the unjust sway.
20 Those who believed in God and then
Moved away and strove among men
In God's way with their properties
And with their very selves to please
Are of the highest rank God sees.
They are achievers *and with ease*.
21 Their Lord gives good news to them of
Mercy from Him and pleasure's *love*
And gardens filled for them with sure
And lasting bounties *of the pure*.
22 There they will always live and be.
Allah, with Him's great reward free.
23 O you believers, do not take
Fathers and brothers in friends stake
If they love infidelity
Above faith. And those of you who

Make friends with them, then those it's true
Are unjust *in faith and in pew*.
24 Say "If your fathers and your sons
And brothers and your kinfolk's ones,
And properties that you've acquired,
And business of the undesired,
And houses set up for delight,
Are dearer than God in your sight,
And His apostle and the way
Of striving for God every day,
Wait then until God will fulfil
His command. God is not in yoke
Of guidance to transgressing folk.
25 God helped you in many war zones,
And on the day of Hunain's groans,
When your great numbers made you vain,
But they did not avail the pain,
And earth itself stretched against you,
And you retreated from the view.

The confidence misplaced by numbers and
The ease of battle only weakens hand.
The nine who remain after thousands flee
Are all that's left of prophet's pageantry.
Hunain's the name of every place around
Sophisticated sort of battle ground
Sustained by strategy instead of grace,
Ignoring that men stand before Your face.
Beloved, as I ride out to victory
Assured by my own luck and sorcery,
Give me repentant grace and power to see
Behind the props that seem to make me
free
And turn again, and as the others flee,
Turn round and whirl back to Your
majesty.

26 Then Allah sent His peace in view
On His apostle and the crew
Of the believers, and sent down
Hosts you could not see on the town,
And punished those who disbelieved,
That's infidel's reward received.
27 Then God will turn back merciful,
To those He wishes, God will be
Oft-forgiving, full of mercy.
28 O you believers, it is true
Idolaters are impure crew.
So they'll not enter sacred Mosque
After their year *of sale in kiosk*,
And if you fear your poverty,

Then God will soon enrich freely,
 Through His grace as He wills to see,
 God knows all and is wise to be.
 29 Fight those who don't believe in God,
 Nor in the last day at the prod,
 And fail to prohibit the thing
 That God and apostle in wing
 Prohibit, and follow not where
 The faith of truth comes in to share,
 Faith of those who've been given the book,
 Until they pay the tribute hook
 By hand submitting in their nook.
 30 The Jews say Ezra is God's son,
 The Christians Christ is God's son won,
 These are the words of their mouths done.
 They imitate what those before
 Said in their unbelieving score.
 God fights against them on their shore.
 31 They take their divines and their monks
 As lords besides God in their trunks,
 And Christ the son of Mary while
 They were not told to make such guile,
 But only worship God alone.
 There is no god but He. His throne
 Is pure and high above the thing
 They would join to Him in His wing.
 32 Do they intend to quench the light
 Of God with their mouths and despite
 God lest He come perfect the sight,
 Though infidels despise the right.
 33 It's He who's sent His messenger
 With guidance and the true faith pure,
 So He might make it to prevail
 Over all faiths that come in sail,
 Despite what polytheists wail.
 34 O you believers many such
 Divines and monks they eat up much
 Of men's properties in false touch,
 And keep some from the way of God.
 Those who hoard up silver in sod
 And gold, and spend not for relief
 In God's way, proclaim them their grief.
 35 The day it's heated in hell fire
 To brand them on their forehead's pyre,
 And on their sides and on their backs,
 This is what you gathered for lacks,
 Taste what you hoarded up in stacks.
 36 The number of months with God's here,
 Just twelve months in God's book to fear,
 Since the day He created sky
 And earth, of these months four are by

Their sacredness known, that's set law
 So do not be unjust in claw,
 And fight the polytheists all,
 Just as they answer to the call
 To fight you. And know God is near
 The pious ones to *give them cheer*.
 37 Postponing's only added to
 The infidelity in view,
 By which those who now disbelieve
 Have gone astray without reprieve.
 They take postponement in one year
 And then forbid them loud and clear
 Another year, so that they may
 Adjust number of months in sway
 That God's forbidden, so they let
 A matter go allowed and set
 That God's forbidden. Wickedness
 Of their deed seems fair as they guess.
 God does not guide infidels' mess.

Beloved, You did not set in Torah and
 The Psalms and Prophets, nor the Gospel
 hand
 A thirteenth month some years in view to
 stand
 And other times omitted on the sand.
 That's work of Babylon and Sanhedrin,
 Though the Christ chides those left in sin
 Who do not follow scribe and priest in bin.
 Perhaps he said the things with tongue in
 grin.
 The calendars men make for themselves
 here
 Are blasphemous indeed and without cheer.
 Let me serve You upon the day You
 choose,
 The seventh-day a Sabbath not to lose
 In any calendar of length or not:
 You have protected at least Sabbath's plot.

38 You who believe, what ails you that
 When it is said to you out flat,
 "Go forth to fight in way of God?"
 Then you bow yourselves to the sod.
 What! Do you fend for this world's life
 And miss the coming one for strife?
 But the provision of this world
 Is little compared to that furl'd
 In the hereafter life *with God*.
 39 Unless you go out, He'll chastise
 You with painful punishment's guise.

And He's put in your place a folk
 Other than you, and you'll not stoke
 A bit of harm on Him. And God
 Has power over all on the sod.
 40 If you'll not help him, Allah did,
 When disbelievers turned the grid
 Against him, he was one of two,
 When they were both in the cave's pew,
 When he said to the one with him,
 "Don't be afraid, God's with us trim."
 So God sent down peace on him, and
 Strengthened him with hosts in band
 You did not see, and set at nought
 The word the unbelievers bought.
 And God's Word is exalted and
 God is all-mighty one at hand,
 All-wise. 41 Go out and in parade
 Either in light or heavy stayed,
 And strive and struggle, with your gear
 And with your persons, in the way
 Of Allah. This is the best way,
 If you just knew *and did not stay*.

Beloved, I do go forth to strive, I do,
 I strive against a myriad foes for You.
 The multiplied and shattered world of men
 Gives birth to minor gods again, again,
 To multiply and shatter on each other,
 Each friend and enemy, brother with
 brother.

There is no god but God I whisper, cry,
 And yet the gods and guns go marching by.
 There is no god but God, heavy or light
 The message echoes in a moral night.
 It is a pain that You are One till I
 Retreat to nothingness where there's no lie,
 Unfold in the oneness of which I'm told
 There is no greater place to have been bold.

42 If there's been quick gain and the path
 An easy one, they'd have made swathe
 Behind you following, but that
 Distance was too far from where sat
 This folk, yet while they swear by God,
 "If we'd been able, we would plod
 Along with you," they cause their own
 Destruction, and God knows alone
 That they are liars *down to the bone*.
 43 May Allah pardon you! Why did
 You give them leave before those hid
 Who told the truth became revealed,

And so the liars were unsealed?
 44 They do not ask leave of you who
 Believe in God, the last day too,
 From striving with their wealth and health,
 God knows who's pious and with stealth.
 45 The only ones who ask leave are
 Those who do not believe afar
 In God and the last Day, and their
 Hearts are in doubt, so in the sway
 Of their doubt they are tossed astray.
 46 If they'd intended to march out,
 They'd have prepared themselves about,
 But God did not want them to go,
 So He kept them back from the show,
 And it was decreed, "Sit here by
 The ones who sit *idle or try*."
 47 If they'd gone out with you, they'd not
 Have contributed any sought
 But only mischief at the drought.
 They'd have gone about among you
 To sow dissension in the crew,
 And some of you would listen too,
 And God knows the unjust in view.

I ask no leave and no exemption here,
 Beloved, before the things I love or fear.
 I have no need to ask before command.
 I am one left bereft upon the land.
 You call the weak and strong both out to
 fill

Your great commands and each act of Your
 will,
 But You've forgotten me upon my hill,
 Left high and dry without a cent or bill.
 Beloved, I seek no license, no, nor leave,
 I humbly bow before silent reprieve
 From every duty sent on humankind.
 I've been created to be one resigned
 To nothingness, no task to beat the air,
 But only wait before the golden stair.

48 They sought dissension before they
 Caused trouble for you, ere the day
 That truth came and God's word prevailed,
 Though they don't want what it entailed.
 49 Among them there's a man to plead,
 "Exempt me, don't try me in need."
 They've fallen at the test already,
 And hell surrounds wicked unsteady.
 50 If good comes on you, they are grieved,
 And if hardship you have received,

They say "We took matters in care
Before," and turn away to share
Rejoicing *in the grief you bear*.
51 Say "Nothing shall come on us but
What God's decreed for us and shut,
He is our Lord, believers should
Rely on Him, *for He is good*."

All things work together for good, I read
In the sweet Gospel preaching once
decreed,
For those who love You. So I reckon now
That good Muhammad with a wrinkled
brow
Is telling just the truth after the seed.
The hope of running bold against Your law
Is founded on illusions in the craw.
The good is not a sign of favoured paw,
Catastrophe's no evidence in awe
That You reward and punish in Your state.
The only certainty that's come of late
Is that what You've begun in grace to wait
Must bear the good fruit that You plan in
fate.
Leave me, Beloved, relying on Your rate.

52 Say "What! Are you waiting for one
Of the two better things begun
From us? But we expect for you
That God will punish by our crew
Or from Himself. So wait away,
And we too shall await *that day*."
53 Say "Whether you spend in the way
With a good will or grudgingly,
It will not be accepted pay,
Because you're in iniquity."
54 And nothing prevents them to be
Accepted for their offerings' fee,
Except that they reject God and
His messenger, and take no hand
In prayer but with ill grace and spend
Not but in a reluctant end.
55 So don't be amazed by their wealth
Or by their sons, for God in stealth
Means to torment them with these things
In this world's life and when their wings
Depart in their unbeliefs.
56 They swear by God that they're of you,
While they're not of you but a crew
In fear. 57 If they'd find refuge or
A cave or place to enter door,

They would have rushed into that store.
58 Among them are some who blame you
Because of the alms come in view.
If they are given from the due,
They're happy, and if they don't get
A share of it, they come to fret.

The very man! I see him everywhere,
Always complaining of his taxes' share,
And always hoping for a hand-out there,
A grant, a stipend, or at least the bare
Aid to the unemployed upon the stair.
Beloved, there are too many here to count
Who fit this verse Muhammad came to
mount,
And who remain with angels at the fount
So that the lame cannot descend to get
The healing that he craves. He can't, you
bet.
Beloved, I do not blame You for the way
Men choose to live their hour and power
and day.
But when You do create and resurrect,
I hope that You will make it more select.

59 If they'd been content with what God
And His apostle on the sod
Had given them and so had said:
God is enough for us. Soon God
Will give us of His grace in prod
And His apostle too. To God
Do we turn *here in hope as led*.
60 The alms are only for the poor
And for the needy and the sure
Workers in that, and for whose heart
In pact is sought for captives' part,
And those in debt and in the way
Of God and the traveller, as due
Ordained by God. And God is true
In knowing all, and all-wise too.

It's a rare person I find in this place
Who is content with the pence of his race.
The many want the more, the few in trace
Are satisfied with herbs beneath the mace.
It is a rare man who with dollar found
Is happy with his lot upon the ground.
No doubt that's all the fault of government,
And not an attitude where a man went.
Beloved, I am a loser since I choose
To be satisfied with my herbs and blues,

And do not lift a finger for a mite
Beyond the stores I eat for living right.
I am a loser of the stress and spite,
I only gain a living and the light.

61 Some harm the messenger to say
That he's an ear *for all in sway*,
Say he's the ear of good for you,
He believes in God and the crew
Of the believers, he's mercy
To you who believe, and those who
Harm the apostle of God see
A great and grievous penalty.
62 They swear by God to you so they
Might get in your good graces' pay,
And God and His apostle too
Have greater right that they should do
What pleases Him, if they've faith too.
63 Don't they know that for those who will
Oppose God and messenger still
Will have the fire of hell to stay?
That is a painful downfall's sway.
64 The hypocrites here are afraid
A sura will be sent arrayed
About them to show openly
What's in their hearts *for all to see*.
Say "Ridicule just as you like,
When you most fear, Allah will strike."
65 If you take them to an account,
They'll say "We only came to mount
Discussion and amusement's fount."
Say "What's so funny about God,
His signs and messengers in prod?"

I've thought of that myself, Beloved, it's
true
That those who are alive in prophet's view
Have always to fear that he'll say the true
And cause them grief for many things they
do.
It's so much easier to live without
A living prophet to dispel all doubt.
The words of prophets always lend excuse
To do what one desires and for abuse
Of what they wrote and left but are not here
To read aright to hypocritic ear.
Beloved, I'm glad no prophet comes to me
To tell me how bad I am in the spree.
It is enough to live beneath your eye,
You are the best and worst of every spy.

66 Make no excuses, you've denied
After you had believed and tried.
If We forgive some of you, We
Shall ever chastise some sorely,
For they are extremely guilty.
67 The hypocrites of buck and wench
Agree together on the bench,
They foster wickedness and foil
The good, and keep their hands in spoil.
They have forsaken God, and He
Forsakes them. Hypocrites truly
Transgress in their iniquity.
68 God's promised hypocrites both buck
And wench and disbelievers stuck
Hell fire for their abode and muck.
That is enough for them to tuck.
And God has cursed them and for them
Is lasting pain for stratagem.
69 Like those before you, they in strength
Were above you in wealth at length
And children, so they enjoyed then
Their portion. So you too again
Enjoyed your portion as those then
Before you did enjoy their gain,
And you enjoy your discourse vain,
As those did too. Those are the ones
Whose labours have no benisons
In this world and the one to come,
And those are the losers in sum.

As Rob the Ranter reports of the goons
Who kept the presbytery of Ayr's fair
doons,
You send a man to hell for naught he's done
But only for Your glory under sun.
You take a man to glory in the sky
Or on the earth to enjoy future pie,
Not for his deeds well done, but with a sigh
That grace is born in Your own heart
thereby.
Beloved, I thank You for the wealth I eat
Beneath the mercy of Your sky in treat.
If I enjoy it in the vestibule
Of hell or heaven, as saint or blighted fool,
It is the hand of Providence I share
Beneath the hope of an ethereal air.

70 What! Did the news of those before
Not come to them? Take on the shore
The folk of Noah, 'Ad, Thamud,
The people of Abraham rude

And the dwellers of Midian,
 And the towns overthrown in span.
 Their messengers came to them each
 With clear evidence then to preach.
 So God did not unjustly teach,
 But they were unjust in their reach.
 71 And the believer man and girl,
 They are the guardians in pearl
 Of one another. They enjoy
 Good and forbid evil as should,
 And they set up the times of prayer,
 And pay the poor-rate in their share,
 And obey God and messenger.
 On them God will bestow His sure
 Mercy. God is almighty and
All-wise above what man has planned.

There are many around who with a sigh
 Of faint hypocrisy pretend they vie
 Not with the men and women that they spy,
 And judge not so they may not be judged
 by
 The other come to counter what they try.
 Pretence is name of game, though Jesus' word
 Is called to justify the evil bird.
 The true in faithfulness are quick to judge
 The wicked deed and foster without fudge
 The good deed perpetrated not to budge.
 Beloved, deliver me from those pretending
 To be such sweet Christians in their
 defending
 Oppression and the curse that falls from
 lips
 Of those who load and unload wicked
 ships.

72 O messenger, strive hard before
 The infidels as well as store
 Of hypocrites, and be severe
 Against them. And they shall appear
 To stay in hell. Painful is such
 A destination that they touch.
 74 They swear by God they did not say
 What words of doubt they had in play,
 And disbelieved after the way
 They entered into Islam's sway,
 And they planned what they could not do,
 And did not seek revenge in view
 Except because God and by grace
 His messenger enriched their place.

If they repent, it will be good
 For them, and if they turn back hood,
 God will chastise them with reward
 Both painful in this world unstored
 And in the one to come. And there
 Shall not be for them on earth's share
 Any protector or aid there.
 75 Among them are such who made pact
 With God. "If He gives us unslacked
 His grace, we'll give alms and we'll be
 Among the righteous ones in fee."
 76 But when He did give them His grace,
 They became stingy with the trace,
 And they turned back out of their place.
 77 That's why He's put hypocrisy
 In their hearts till the day come free
 When they shall meet Him, because they
 Failed to fulfil to God the way
 They'd promised Him and because they
 Had been such liars *without pay*.
 78 What! Don't you know that God
 perceives

Their inmost hidden thoughts' aggrieves
 And secret whisperings, and so
 God is the greatest One to know
 The unseen *things that never show?*
 79 Those who make fun of those who give
 In charity so some can live
 Among believers and those who
 Do not find anything in due,
 But their hard earnings, so they scoff
 At them *freely*. God too will scoff
 At them and for them there shall be
 A painful punishment *and free*.
 80 If you beg for their pardon or
 Not, if you beg seventy times' score
 That they be pardoned, Allah will
 Not forgive them, because they fill
 Their leaving Allah and the one
 He sent and messenger begun,
 And Allah does not guide those who
 Are of the false, rebellious crew.

Though I forgive at Your dear servant's
 word
 The seventy times seven You preferred,
 You do not You Yourself, Beloved, forgive
 The ones who ridicule the poor who live
 To give in charity from little store.
 How easily one shows respect and more

To those who hold the gold. But wealth is
true
That is awareness that in each is You.
You give in charity with every hand
That in its poverty has to command
A blessing on the other. Let me wake
To find my art in giving for Your sake.
Let me not shun the worthy gift of him
Who bears You in his heart and in his
whim.

81 They were delighted, those who stayed
Behind to sit behind arrayed
Allah's apostle and they prayed
Not to have to strive in God's way
With their wealth and their bodies' sway,
And say "Let's not go while it's hot."
Say "Hell fire is a hotter lot!"
If they just understood the plot.
82 That's why they'll have but little
laughter
And weeping much for reward after
What they were used to earn and got.

Your joking about hell-fire seems to me
As inappropriate as it can be,
Considering that You're God Almighty.
You ought to keep a straight face and a
sombre
Instead of showing child's delight in
bomber
And napalm as we used to love to see
On each news programme set eternally.
Fact is this northern heat beneath the
rumour
Of global warming has become a bloomer,
And I must seek the refuge of the lake
Whose temperature keeps rising at the
stake.
No worry. Summer's too short here, so
don't
Think I'm complaining of the heat and
won't
Be grateful for the respite and its brunt.

83 If God brings you back to some band
Of them, then they ask for the stand
Of your leave to go out again,
Then say "You'll never go as men
With me and never come to fight
A foe with me. You chose your right

To sit the first time. Now just sit
With those who stay from the outfit."
84 Don't pray over such of them who
May die, and don't stand in the view
Of his grave. They disbelieved in
God and His messenger to win
And died as wicked ones in sin.
85 Don't let their wealth and spawn amaze.
God just desires to strike in craze
These with such things in this world and
To let their soul depart from band
While they are infidels to stand.
86 Whenever a sura's revealed
To make them believe and *be healed*
By God and strive hard with His sent
Apostle, they come to prevent
With their means asking of your leave,
"Let us stay at home in reprieve."
87 They'd rather sit at home because
A seal's been set on hearts and paws,
And so they do not mind the clause.

That's rather a vindictive way to treat
Those who were afraid to fight in the heat,
Especially when I remember You
Are the same God who told Messiah to
Command we pray for enemy in crew.
Not even prayers at funeral, dear God,
That seems so unforgiving on the sod.
It's not even their fault, because you put
A seal on heart to impede hand and foot.
I praise You for Your judgements on the
folk
Who sit back and scoff at the ones gone
broke,
As well as for the grace You have in hand
To those who follow You and Your
command,
And cantillate Your books with a brass
band.

88 But the apostle and those who
Believe with him strive hard in view
With wealth and their own bodies too.
And for them there are such good things,
And they're successful ones *in springs*.
89 Allah's prepared gardens for them,
And under them flow rivers' hem,
Where they abide, that is their gem.
90 Some came with their excuses, from
The dwellers of the desert come,

Begging leave to sit with those who
Lied to God and messenger too,
To those of them who disbelieved
Will soon come great pain unreprieved.

91 Task will not come upon the weak,
Nor on the sick nor so to speak
On those who find not wherewithal
To spend, when they are on the ball
With God and His Apostle's call.

Against the doers of good there
Is no way. God's forgiving, fair,
And the most merciful *to bear*.

92 Nor does the task fall on the few
When they came to you in the view
Of asking mounts, and then you said
"I find no means to bear you led."

They went back with eyes filled with tears
And sorrowful as it appears
They had no means to help arrears.

93 The ground is against those who claim
They are exempt because of fame
And wealth. They'd rather stay behind
With women resting: Allah's sealed
Their hearts, they know not what they
yield.

I claim exemption, My Beloved, from all
Things that are duties and the siren call
Of every pleasure, but the duty and
The pleasure of the soul with empty hand
That comes to You, the one to whom You
come.

O my Beloved, in judgement take the sum
Of my good deeds and evil, find their
number

To be at nought, and let me only slumber
Within your loving heart. My deeds for
nought

Be wasted, cast-off images, I ought
Not come to You with anything, for there
Is nothing worth its sight, and so I dare
To seek alone Your mercy and Your grace,
As I stand singly in this slaughtering place.

94 They'll make excuses to you when
You come back to them from the fen,
So say "Don't make excuses now,
We won't believe you anyhow,
For God's informed us of your state,
And God will view your actions' rate,
And His apostle, then shall you

Be turned back to the Knower true
Of secret and the manifest,
And be informed that you invest
Your actions or not for the best.

95 They'll swear to you by God, when you
Come back to them, that you in crew
Might turn aside from them. So turn
Aside from them. They are unclean
And their abode is hell *unseen*,
A right reward is what they glean.

Call none unclean, You said to Peter once,
When he slept on the roof and like a dunce
Saw unclean creatures soil the heavenly
sheets.

He would not slay a porker for his treats.
But they are now unclean who try to claim
A share in heavenly kingdom to their
blame,

Who have no witness in the heart and
tongue

That You've sent down the grace on old
and young

That is repentance for the sins once slung.
Let me not swear my loyalty to You,
But bow in the repentance that You do
Inspire in heart and hand, and so not be
Among the unclean who join hell with glee,
There to party in luck eternally.

96 They'll swear to you so you'll be pleased
With them, but if you're pleased and
sleezed,

God is not pleased with wicked folk,
No matter how they preen and poke.

97 The Arabs are firm in their doubt
And in hypocrisy they're stout,
And more inclined not to regard
The limits God sent down *to guard*
To His apostle. God knows all,
And He is wise *before their thrall*.

98 The Arabs think that what they spend
In charity's a fine in end,
And they hope for calamity
To fall on you. On them shall be
The force of the calamity.

And God hears all, knows what's to be.
99 And of the Arabs there are those
Who believe in God and the glows
Of the last day and what they spend
In charity the deem an end

To approach God and the prayers of
The messenger *sent down in love*.
It shall be means of such approach
For them, *and without false encroach*.
For soon God shall open to them
His mercy *like a precious gem*,
God's oft-forgiving and remains
All-merciful *through all earth's pains*.

I really don't think that the Arabs now
Are quite as bad as those here anyhow
Described for being scum of earth and
worse
Than any other folk a man might curse.
The ones I met on pilgrimage at least,
For all the rumours of both man and beast,
Were kind and sweet and helpful as I came
As guest of Allah to the Meccan fame.
Beloved, bless Arab and bless those who
live
Beneath Your divine hand on what You
give,
And when the earth is filled with grace
alone,
Let them to stand upright before Your
throne.
Until then, let us Gentiles snicker well
About the words You spoke of them in
spell.

100 And the first and foremost among
The Meccan immigrants unsung,
And the Madinan helpers rung,
And those who followed them in right,
God is well-pleased with them in sight,
And they are well-pleased *with His light*,
And He's prepared gardens for them,
Beneath them flow rivers in stem,
There forever they shall abide,
This is achievement great and wide.
101 Of those Arabs around you there
Are hypocrites, and from the share
Of Madina also, and they
Are stubborn in hypocrites' way.
You don't know which of them are such,
But We know them *and twice as much*.
Twice will We punish them and then
They'll be set in a grievous pen.

It's strange, Beloved, that You describe
here those

Now so respected in Companions' rows.
You say that even Muhammad could not
Distinguish hypocrite from the good lot
Among his own Companions. Now we
think
That all of them speak purely on the brink
Of revelation, and take what they say
Above the Qur'an, not to mention gay
Scripture sent down before. Beloved,
forgive
This foolish way that men expect to live,
Or send us all to hell where we may keep
Up Jewish, Christian, Muslim ways and
weep
Through the black of eternity, then sleep.
All faith establishments are hells on heap.

102 Others confess their faults, they mix
A good act with their evil tricks.
Maybe God will turn back to them,
God's oft-forgiving, mercy's gem.
103 Take their alms from their wealth and
so

Clean and purify them to go,
And pray for them. Your prayer indeed
Is an assurance in their need.
God hears all and knows every deed.
104 Don't they know that God is the One
Who accepts the repentance done
By His slaves and their charity
Of alms, and God is verily
He, the returning ever and
The most merciful in the land?
105 Say "Act as you will, but God sees
Your deeds and His Apostle's keys,
And the believers. Then you will
Be brought back to the One to fill
All knowing of hidden and seen.
Then He'll inform you what you've been
Doing *both in and off the scene*.

106 Others stand to wait God's command
Whether He'll punish them in band
Or whether He'll repent and stand:
For them God knows wisdom *at hand*.
107 Those who built a mosque to cause
harm

To the believers with alarm,
To cause unfaithfulness and more
Dissension on the faithful's score,
And an ambush to him who'd war
Against God and His sent before,

And they'll swear, "We just meant the
good."
God hears witness they're liars in flood.

Sometimes the building of a mosque may
be
More harm than good though builded
faithfully.

I once told Muslims out to build a mosque
A better deal would be book-selling kiosk
Distributing Qur'ans to all and sundry
Rather than brick and mortar for conundry.
Let European populace and those
Who dwell upon the turtle's back and toes
Revert to Islam and then come to build
There own mosques among corn, squash,
beans they've hilled.

Beloved, the world's a mosque enough for
me,

I pray beneath the sky and spreading tree,
The larch in broadened arch and in the way
Under the wrinkled birch in summer sway.

108 Never go there to stand and pray,
A mosque set on piety's way
Deserves more that you go to pray
There, where men love to be cleansed well,
And God loves the purified swell.

109 Which is the better, one who lays
His foundation on fear that stays
In God and goodwill, or the man
Who lays his foundation on span
Of crumbling hollow bank, and so
It crumbled down with him in tow
Into the fire of hell not slow.
And God does not guide any folk
That is unjust *under His yoke*.

110 The building they make will continue
To be source of the bone and sinew
Of unrest in their hearts until
Their hearts are cut in pieces' swill.
God knows and is wise *to their pill*.

If You've not brought any unjust folk to
The garden and the church You've let be
true,
Then by my meditation of the pew,
There is no folk brought into churchly view
By You at all. They're all unjust in rate,
Not by the rage that I may come to state,
But by the one criterion in gate,

The Decalogue itself. There is no body
Religious or politic that's not shoddy.
Beloved, I stand accusing You. I try
To be both fair and positive a guy,
And write things beautiful. But You come
in
Presenting ugly conflicts to my sin.
How can I ever let my beauty win?

111 God's bought from the faithful their
own

Bodies and wealth theirs to atone
To be in the garden. They fight
In God's way, and they kill for right
And they are killed. A promise set
On Him in the Torah to get,
And Gospel, and Qur'an: who's more
Faithful to his covenant store
Than God? So rejoice in the act
Of sale, and that it's a great fact.

112 Those who turn to God in worship
And praise, and fast, who bow from hip,
Prostrating themselves, who enjoin
The good and forbid evil coin,
And keep within God's limits shown,
Proclaim to those believers lone
The good news *from the divine throne*.

113 It's not for the apostle or
For the believers to seek store
Of pardon for idolater,
Even though they are near of kin,
After it's been proclaimed to win
That they're dwellers of hell for sin.

Ah my Beloved! So there is a folk true,
Defined by the faith that they have in You,
And not by labels and institutions,
Not by the name of game, but by home-
runs.

They hear the Torah, Gospel, and Qur'an,
They turn in prayer and praise and from the
dawn

Enjoin the good, decry the evil spawn,
And keep the ten commandments not
withdrawn.

I'd only add the Psalms, Beloved, in store
Of Scriptures read by the led to Your door,
But let me add nothing at all to faith,
Neither a word, a worship or a wraith,
And I shall join that nameless crew that
stays

Beneath the barriers, beyond the haze.

114 Abraham sought his dad's pardon
Because of the promise he'd done,
But when it became clear that he
Was really just God's enemy,
He declared himself clear and free.

Abraham was tender of heart,
And patient *with the other's part*.

115 God's not about to lead astray
The folk He's guided in the way.
He even shows them clearly what
The should stay away from in glut.
God knows all things *and where they stay*.

116 God, He rules in both heaven and
earth,

He brings to life, takes to the berth
Of death, and there is not for you
Another helper to guard you.

117 God's turned to the apostle fair,
And the Meccan emigrants there,
And the Madinan helpers share,
Who followed him in time to dare,
After some hearts nearly repair
From off the way, but He returned:
To them He's gracious and they've learned
His mercy *fallen on the spurned*.

118 And on the three who stayed behind,
Until earth narrowed where they pined
Despite its greater amplitude,
And they themselves bowed at the feud
Within them, thinking no refuge
Was found for them from God till huge
Refuge came from Him, He turned back
To them in mercy that the slack
Might turn them back to Him. Indeed
God, He is oft returning, speed
Is His in mercy and in deed.

Three men absent from Tabuk's expedition
Repented of rebellion and sedition,
And fifty days remained in tears and prayer
Until the grace of this verse met them there.
So Ka'b bin Malik, Hilal bin Omyya,
And Marur bin Rabi bowed to Your law,
And in submission to damnation's claw
Suddenly find Your grace trumps
condemnation,

And shows the sinner ration and elation.
Beloved, though I have sat on sidelines
here

As though in shy and a self-conscious fear,
The gift of Your repentance on my bier
Wakes me to life and love once more
sincere.

The witness to three shirkers mends the
station.

119 O you believers, fear then God
And be with the truthful on sod.

120 It was not for Madina's folk
And the surrounding desert's bloke
To stay away behind the one
That Allah sent, nor when they'd done
To prefer their own lives to his.

This is because fatigue that is
Nor hunger in God's way, nor that
That walk a way enraging fat
Infidels, nor foe's injury,
But because God's reckoned decree
Of righteous deed in credit wee
To them. God does not let things go
In vain, the reward and the show
Of doers of good, *He's not slow*.

121 They do not spend the small or great,
Nor cut across a valley's rate,
But it's written down to their fate,
So God will reward them not late
With better than what they relate.

Beloved, I cry punishment and reward,
The lick of gold as well as flash of sword!
I have, one undeserving, benefit
From the new day upon Puijo's outfit,
The brightness of the sun on snow and tree,
The cries of the angelic chaffinch free,
The bullfinch, here more rarely, setting
flame,

Or at the least a red coal on my claim.
Such pleasures merit punishment I trow,
Or at the least a payment or a vow.
Instead You let me off without a word
Of thanks or praise before my heart now
stirred.

The way You run Your market is absurd.
The best costs naught, the pence gleams
like a bird.

122 And it's not for the faithful they
Should go out all in band to sway.
Why should not then a company
From every party by decree

Go out to acquire knowledge great
In faith, and so they may instate
Warning to their folk and not late
Returning to them, so they'll be
More cautious in action's degree?
123 O you believers, fight those of
The infidels nearby in glove,
And let them find you hard to shove.
You know God's with those who remain
Steadfastly guarding *from insane*.

124 And when a surah is sent down,
There are some of them with a frown
Who ask which of you has increased
In faith because of the word leased.
But as for the believing ones,
It strengthens them in faith by tonnes
And they rejoice *despite their guns*.
125 But as for those in whose hearts lie
A sickness added them thereby,
Uncleanliness to their unclean
And they shall die in doubt and spleen.
126 Don't they see that they're tried one
time
Or twice in every year and clime,
Then they do not turn back to God,
And don't remember of the prod?

The dhikr or remembrance is a thing
Not optional for every sort of wing
Who's been saved by the grace that You
send down
Upon the villagers and on the town.
The grace the comes from You is certain
here:

It turns the people back to You in fear
By gift of such repentance without leer,
And secondly it brings them to the gate
Of service of remembrance to relate
The verses and the miracles that You
Inspired to be wrote down in Your book
too.

And so I cry my sema on the day
And bend my tongue to memory to pay
The night for comforts dark that You relay.

127 And when a sura is sent down,
They glance at one another's frown,
"Does the believer see renown?"
And then they turn away. God's turned
Their hearts because they have not learned,
128 A messenger has come to you

From among your own people too.
He's grieved when you fall in distress.
He has concern for your welfare,
And toward the faithful his address
Is in compassion, mercy's share.
129 But if they turn away, then say
"God is enough for me today.
There is no god but He in sway.
On Him I do rely, and He
Is the Lord of the great throne's see."

For many I have shared concern to bear
The burden of salvation in the glare
Of churchly day and artificial light,
And seen them turn back into faithless
night.

That's measure of the times, failing insight.
I now know that I have no load of care
For the salvation of the world or friend,
Or even for my own soul in the end,
For only You can save and naught I do
Can add a grain of merit to the view.
Some turn away and bear the price of that,
Some eat the grace and taste the heavenly
fat.

Reality is made of such in store,
And there is nothing any can do more.

Surah 10 Yunus, or Jonah

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 A L R These are the signs of wisdom's
book.

2 It is a wonder for the folk
That We revealed a man who spoke
From among themselves at the stroke,
"Warn humankind and bring good news
To those who believe and who choose
The firm foundation with their Lord."
The infidels say "This is just
A sorcerer *upon the dust*."

3 Your Lord's Allah who made the sky
And the earth in six days for why,
And He is firmly set upon
His throne *both day and night and dawn*.
He regulates all things, and there
Is no mediator can share
Salvation outside of His care.
That is for you Allah your Lord,
Therefore let Him be One adored.
What! Will you not come in to mind
Remembrance of what's God's assigned?

The service of remembrance, dhikr in
The Arabic, and sema in the din
Of recitation of Your Word's no sin
As mullah and rabbi and preacher might
Have it held for their unbelief and spite,
But is commanded from Your Word from
start

Until the end and seal, Muhammad's part.
And so I join the sema and the whirl,
The dhikr and the hearing and the swirl
Of mind remembering Your lovely names
As rising from Your revelations' flames
Of love and cheer and hope above all
blames.

The grace that You send down upon my
hand

I spread again to all around the land.

4 To Him shall all of you return:
The promise of God's truth to learn,
He starts creation, then brings it
Back so that He may reward fit
Those who believe and do the good.
And those who disbelieve there should
Be for them the drink from the bowl
Of boiling drink, and so their goal
Is painful punishment that they
Failed to believe in the right way.
5 He's made the sun with *streaming* rays,
And the moon a light *for His praise*,
And planned the stations so you might
Know years in number and the sight
Of reckoning. God did not make
This but for truth. So for His sake
God makes His signs appear in wake
For a folk understanding stake.
6 In the sequence of night and day,
And what God created in sway
Of heaven and earth, indeed there are
Signs for a folk who guard *their star*
Against the evil, *wicked way*.

What miracle do You provide for me
As I look on the changing, shadowy
Night and the rise of day? What sign I
pray?

What hope of hopelessness makes up the
day?

The hours are filled with footsteps of the
sun

About my quartered room, and when that's
done,

The night creeps in with hardly any turn,
At least in summer where the days still earn
The light of the white night until they burn.
Beloved, the days and nights teach me to
know

The round of Your creation on the glow,
And as they count past one hand in their
rate,

The Sabbath comes to confound my new
state.

The Sabbath night and day never come late.

7 Those who hope not to meet Us then,
And are satisfied with the den
Of this world's life and pleased again,
And those who're neglecting Our signs,
8 These have their dwelling *by designs*
In fire for what they earned *in lines*.

9 Those who believe and do the right,
The Lord guides them *not by their sight*
But by their faith. Beneath them flow
Streams in gardens of bliss *to show*.

10 They'll shout there, "Glory be to You,
O God!" And their greetings there too
Are "Peace" and finally they'll say
That God's is the praise every day,
The Lord of the worlds He is sway.

11 If God requited punishment
In due for evil as fast lent
As men wish He would give reward
For good deeds, then long since would all
Men have been doomed against the wall.
But We leave those who do not wish
To come back to meet Us in *dish*
Of the last day to wander on
In their blind stubbornness *till dawn*.

With right good humour You now do
pretend

That human beings have the time to spend
When waiting for their punishment to bend,
But want the gifts of sustenance as soon
As wakefulness dreams of the coming
noon.

It's good for You to speak with
condescension

About the way we children in suspension
Suspect the clock runs fast and slow in
spite

To give the good and give the evil plight.
It may seem funny in Your divine sight.
But hear, Beloved, our human life is brief
And cries out often for some sweet relief
From hope and hope's last pains before our
grief.

Remember bud is gold before the leaf.

12 When pain falls on a man he cries
To Us whether stands, sits, or lies.
But when we take the pain away,
He goes on as though in no way
He's cried to Us or felt at bay
The pain that fell on him in sway.
So the transgressors learn to think
What they do is fair on the brink.

It is a true thing, I duly admit
That when the pain is passed, I come to sit
In moments of reprieve and so forget
The grace that healed my toil, the toil I met.
But why should You scorch any for that
way?

Do You know anything of human pay?
You have not given a thousand years to
thank

You for Your blessings grown up green and
dank.

If we forget the pain of life and death
And forget to thank You in the next breath,
It is because such breaths are few on earth,
And we hope to draw some in light and
mirth.

Beloved, I thank You on this tiny note,
And then turn back to the life of my rote.

13 We destroyed generations passed
Before you when they came at last
To do wrong, and apostles true
Had come to them with clear signs too,
But they would not believe. So We
Come to recompense the guilty.

14 We made you then successors in
The land after they went to bin,
To see how you would act *or grin*.

15 When Our clear signs are read to those
Who do not hope to see Our rows,
They say "Bring out a new Qur'an
Or change this one *that you have drawn*."
Say "It's not my job to make changes
By prompting or by my own ranges.

I only follow what's revealed.
I fear disobeying to yield,
And punishment from my Lord too
On a great day soon come in view."

16 Say "If God has so willed, I'd not
Have recited it to your lot,
Nor would He have taught it to you.

I've lived an age of life in view
Among you before it. What! Then
You do not understand again?"

17 Who does a greater wrong than this,
To make a lie against God's hiss
Or to deny His signs and miss?
The guilty never success kiss.

The lies men make against You in their
glee,

Or in their desperation for a fee,
Do You no harm, Beloved, do You no
harm.

Not so the lies men make for the alarm
Of others, neighbour, or the weak of arm.

Those lies result in every kind of loss
To humankind, the weaker on the toss,
The greater harm to suffer from the boss.

So what is greater wrong, to lie of You
Or of the humblest human in Your view?
Your sovereignty protects You from the
flame

Of human heart's desires and human game.
But many on the deck and underneath
Break down before the onslaught and the
wreath.

18 They worship than God other such
That cannot hurt or profit touch,
And say "These are out mediators
With God." Say "What do you instaters
Think to inform God of what things
He does not know in heavenly wings
Or on the earth?" Glory then be
To Him and Exalted is He
Above what they associate
With Him *as the divine in state*.

19 Humankind was just one group, then
Later they differed *into ten*,
Without a word gone from your Lord,
It would have been cast in reward
According to their difference scored.

20 And they say "Why is their no sign
Sent him from his Lord *to divine*?"

Say "The unseen is just for God,
 So wait, I'm also *on the sod*
 Among those who await *and plod*."
 21 When We make folk taste of mercy,
 After pain's touched them in degree,
 See, they devise plots against Our
 Signs. Say "God's quicker in His power,
 Our messengers record in hour
 All that you devise *where you scour*."
 22 It's He who makes you able here
 To travel by land and sea sere.
 So you go on board ships in sway.
 And they sail on with them in way
 Of good winds, and so they rejoice,
 Till they have storms and billows pour
 In on them from all sides in store
 And they're surround without shore,
 And so the cry to God sincerely
 Professing faith in Him and clearly
 Saying "If You deliver us,
 From this, we'll be grateful, *gracious*."
 23 But when He saved them, see, they
 came
 Rebelling in the earth for shame.
 "O humankind, your rebelling
 Is against your own selves to sting,
 Provision for just this world's life,
 Then unto Us after the strife
 You shall return, and We'll inform
 You of what you did *in the storm*."
 24 This world's life's just like water that
 We pour on you down from the vat
 Of the sky, to mix in the soil
 And cause the produce to unfoil
 From the earth of which men may eat
 And cattle also find a treat.
 Till when the earth puts on its veil
 Of gold and ornaments prevail,
 And its folk think that they have power
 Over it, then Our command's flower
 Comes by the night or in the day,
 Then We caused it be reaped away,
 As though it had not ever been
 The day before and cast in bin.
 So We explain the signs come clear
 To the folk who reflect sincere.
 25 And God called to abode of peace,
 And guides whom He wills in release
 To the right way and *of surcease*.
 26 For those who do good there's reward
 Most excellent for them as stored,

No darkness shall come on their faces,
 Nor shame fall on them *in their places*,
 These are dwellers in garden's traces,
 There to abide *eternal graces*.
 27 Those who have earned for evil pain,
 Its recompense is just amain,
 And shame shall come on them indeed.
 From God they'll have no guard in need.
 As if their faces had been veiled,
 As surface of the dark night sailed,
 Those are the inmates of the fire:
 They ever dwell in it's desire.
 28 On the day we gather them all
 Then We shall say to those who call
 On others, "Stay there where you are,
 You and your gods you've joined as star.
 Then We'll divide them each from each,
 And tell them their joined gods they
 preach,
 "It was not Us you bowed to reach."
 29 That's why God is witness enough
 We're unaware of your work tough.
 30 Everyone will there realize
 What she's sent forward in her guise,
 That they'll be brought then back to God,
 Their true Lord, and what for their prod
 They fabricated will turn sod.
 31 Say "Who provides you sustenance
 From sky and earth? Or who with glance
 Controls the hearing and the sight?
 Who brings the living from death's might,
 And brings the dead from living light?
 Who manages everything right?
 Then they will say "God", then ask them,
 "Then will you guard you in His hem?"
 32 Then this is Allah, your true Lord.
 And what is apart from truth stored
 But the false? Where then have you turned
 Away *to seek a thing not learned?*
 33 So is proved true your Lord's word that
 The unbelievers sinned and sat.
 34 Say "Of your gods associate,
 Are there any who can create
 And turn it back to its state?"
 Say "Just God can originate
 And then return it on its fate,
 So what do you turn to in rate?"
 35 Say "Of those you join to God is
 There any who can guide with fizz
 Into the truth?" Say "It is God
 Alone who guides to truth on sod.

Is the one who guides to truth more
 Worthy to be followed in score
 Or one who does not got aright
 Unless he's guided by the light?
 What's happened to you? How you blight!
 36 And most of them just follow their
 Own suppositions in the air.
 Conjecture cannot face the truth.
 God knows what they do *from their youth*.
 37 This Qur'an's not to be invented
 By anyone but God prevented,
 But it's an affirmation of
 What went before it from above,
 An explanation of the Bible
 Without a doubt, without a liable,
 From the Lord of the universe.
 38 Or do they say "He's made it worse?"
 Say "Bring a chapter like and verse
 And call for help on whom you may,
 Besides God if you're in truth's sway.
 39 No, they denied the thing that they
 Did not understand and the ray
 Of knowledge with it, and the true
 Of clarification in view
 Did not come to them. So they did
 Deny those before them in bid.
 See the end where the unjust hid.
 40 Among them is the one who did
 Believe in it and among them
 Is the one who denied the gem,
 And your Lord knows who kept in hem
 The mischief that they came and did.

The Qur'an is an explanation sent
 Down from You, my Beloved, so those
 who spent
 Their willing thoughts upon the Bible when
 The days of heresies fell upon men.
 The Qur'an should be used to learn to know
 What revelation means that You made
 show
 In former writings now found in the Bible.
 And yet men turn from the whole to the
 tribal
 And one takes just the books of Moses fair,
 Another takes the Pauline letters' ware,
 Another takes the Gospel love to share,
 And finally some take the Qur'an bare,
 Which cannot be interpreted aright
 Without the Bible known and kept in sight.

41 If they deny you, then just say
 "For me there is my work each day
 And for you is your task and way,
 You're innocent of what I do
 And I am innocent of you.
 42 Among them are some who will hear
 And obey Me. Can you make hear
 The deaf? They do not grasp the cheer.
 43 Some of them gaze at you, but can
 You guide the blind who see no man?
 44 God does no unjust thing to folk,
 But men to their own selves lay stroke.

It's either You or dear Muhammad who
 Is Baptist and not Calvinist in crew,
 Because I see the double election
 Here but single predestination done.
 You have elected and have given grace
 To those You will, but You pour no
 disgrace
 On anyone. The road to hell is chosen
 Freely and willingly by those unfrozen
 In hopes of fire of lust and hate to find
 The comfort satisfaction in the rind.
 Beloved, give me no choice, and I shall not
 Run in the way of rogue and of the sot.
 I hope no freedom to die no, nor yet
 Anything but Your guiding bit and set.

45 On the day when He'll gather them
 As though they had not stayed in hem
 Of earth or in the grave except
 An hour of the day *they had wept*,
 They'll recognize each other then.
 Those who denied meeting of men
 With God will perish for the failed
 To be guided right *when they sailed*.
 46 If We let you see something of
 What We warned them against above,
 Or take you to Ourselves in glove,
 Then unto Us is their return,
 God is witness of what they earn.
 47 To every folk messengers took,
 When their apostle comes to them,
 The issue will be judged in gem
 Of justice and they'll not be wronged.

To every people, O Beloved, You sent
 Apostles that proclaimed You where they
 went.

You do not wrong the world when You cry
 down
 The heathen worship that goes on in town.
 Apostles have gone out to every way,
 And those You sent have always had their
 say
 Proclaiming You alone to be their God
 Instead of every idol, pea and pod.
 Do me too justice, my Beloved, and rend
 The idols from my heart, return to bend
 My sights from splintering in Your
 creation
 To see the oneness of Your great salvation:
 Salvation is to heal the broken jewel
 Of one in You, deprive hell of its fuel.

48 They say "When with this threat come
 true,
 If you are truthful in your view?"
 49 Say "I keep for myself no harm
 Or benefit besides God's arm.
 To every folk's appointed time.
 When their time's up, they cannot climb
 Away from it by an hour's mime,
 Neither to haste or retard *rime*.
 50 Say "Do you see if punishment
 Comes from Him on you to relent
 By night or day, what then is there
 Of it the guilty rush to share?
 51 Is it when it happens then you
 Will believe it once come in view?
 What! Now? When you've been rushing
 crew?
 52 Then it's said to the unjust: "Taste
 The staying punishment in waste!
 Would you have other than what you
 Has earned and done come in your view?"
 53 They ask you: "Is that true?" Then say
 "Indeed, by my Lord! That's the way,
 And you'll not escape *His wrath's pay*."
 54 And if every soul that has done
 Injustice had all that is won
 In earth, it would be then enough
 In ransom for the great and tough.
 And they'll proclaim their repentance
 When they see the doom and the dance,
 And it shall be decided there
 Between them with justice and care
 And they shall receive a just share.

You keep giving Muhammad some advice

On what to say to unbelieving mice.
 There's quite a list of set responses here,
 And some are witty too, I have no fear.
 I'd like to have a Qur'an sent to me
 To tell me how to answer in the spree.
 I'm too sweet with these butchers, so agree
 To bring the angel Gabriel where I see.
 Beloved, it's just a joke, don't take my word
 Too seriously, not anything You've heard.
 I am content that angels in my path
 Are merely sparrows, finches, aftermath
 Of magpies strutting and blackbirds that
 paint
 My garden speckled. That's enough for
 saint.

55 Let it be known that God's is what
 Is in the heavens and the earth shut.
 Let it be known God's promise done,
 But most of them don't know the fun.
 56 He gives life and causes to die,
 And unto Him all come back by.
 57 O humankind, a warning word
 Has come to you from your own Lord,
 And a cure for what's in your breasts,
 And guidance and mercy in chests
 For the believers *all in herd*.
 58 Say in the grace of God and in
 His mercy, in that they should win
 Rejoicing. It is better than
 All they can gather in a span.
 59 Say "See what things God has sent
 down
 For you of sustenance' renown,
 Then you made a part with a frown
 Unlawful and some lawful crown."
 Say "Has God given to you the right
 Or have you invented for spite?"
 60 What do those then imagine who
 Invent lies against God in view
 Of resurrection day come due?
 God is the Lord of grace for man,
 But most give no thanks for the plan.

If everything belongs to You in all
 The sky and earth, from sea-caves to the
 hall
 Of glacier glass in translucence in thrall,
 I look upon Your wealth without a ticket
 Into the grand museum and the wicket.
 The vast parade of hopeful jewels cake

The mass of time and space lost in their
wake,
And all wait for Your command and Your
call.

Beloved, I'm here to represent the small,
The snowflake and the frostwork on the
wall,

The window pane in fingered filigree,
The shimmering on twig and bush and tree.
We wee ones lift a tiny voice to show
Your glory and Your praises on the go.

61 There's nothing that you do or make,
No recitation in the stake
Of the Qur'an, nor any action
Performed by humankind of faction,
But We are witness over you
When you are caught up in the view.
There does not lie hidden from view
Of your Lord atom's weight on earth
Or in the skies nor in its berth
Anything less or more but it
Is written in the book that's fit.

62 The friends of God shall know no fear,
Nor do they grieve *when they appear*,

63 Those who believe and guard *the dear*.

64 For them are life's good news come near
In this world and the one to come.
There is no changing of God's sum.
That is the great end that will come.

65 Don't let their rhetoric dismay,
The glory is God's every day,
He hears all and knows every way.

66 Indeed, God's is all that is found
In heaven above and earthly bound.
They do not follow such as joined
To God, who call on those purloined
Besides God. They just follow their
Own posturings and lyings' share.

67 It's He who made for you the night
So you might rest in it, and sight
In the daytime. In it are signs
For folk who listen to designs.

Nothing's too small to meet Your sight,
And all things to Your eye are light,
While I in darkness move to find
That what I see is seen in blind.
And yet in darkness too there goes
The silent sound Your footsteps pose.
I turn to see that You are there,

And find the darkness still is bare.
I trust, Beloved, that each small thing
That lies beneath Your guarding wing
Remains always beneath Your care.
You made the night, You brought the day,
And in their light and shadows play
Your servants on the silver stair.

68 They say God took Himself a son.
Glory be to Him! He is One
The Self Sufficient. His alone
Is what is in the skies in tone
And in the earth. You have no power
Over this. What! Do you come glower
In witness against God for what
To you the knowledge has been shut?
69 Say those who invent lies about
God will never succeed *in clout*.
70 Just a reprieve in this world, then
To Us is their return again,
Then We shall make them taste severe
Chastisement for their doubting *fear*.

Each Muslim that I meet wants to know
first

If I believe You have a son uncursed.
Each Christian that I see requires for blame
That I believe the Trinity in claim.
Beloved, I do believe that You regard
Men You've created to receive the card
Of Your salvation are called sons of God.
It's written in Genesis six for prod.
Beloved, I do believe that in the heart
Of every human soul there is a part
That holds a threefold love for You in cart.
But what I do believe in doubter's jest
Will satisfy no Christian as a guest
Nor even Muslim. Each one throws his
dart.

71 Recite to them of Noah's story
Who told his folk on promontory,
"O my folk, if my standing here
To remind of God's signs in cheer
Is hard for you, still on God I
Rely, so come out to defy
And your associated gods,
And don't let them be doubtful clods,
And pour them on me like the sods.
72 But if you turn back, then I did
Not ask a recompense in bid

From you. My recompense is just
From God, and I'm commanded first
To be of those bowed *to the dust*.

I have not challenged anyone to pour
Out trinities on me, I keep no score,
Nor do I come defying to the church
And crying doubt to those there in the
lurch.
And yet they come dragging their dolls
before,
And bandering theologies galore,
While I climb on my quieter in perch
And look out on the calm of fir and birch.
Muhammad was a good man long ago
To answer all the steaming and the show.
With seventy new devices in the glow
Of Ethiopic church Christology,
He had to know a lot more mystery
Than nowadays anyone's theology.

73 But they denied him so We saved
Him and those with him so encaved
In the ark, and We made them be
Successors and drowned those in fee
Who denied Our signs, and so see
The end of those warned *faithfully*.
74 We raised up apostles again
After him to their folk and men,
So they came to them with clear sense,
But they would not believe a pence
In what they had denied before.
So We seal up the hearts in store
Of the transgressors at the door.

I always wondered why that hard-shell
Baptist
Called Noah had so few converts that
tapped us.
In one hundred and twenty years he got
Just seven converts to enter his slot.
I figure he did not know Whitfield's pose
Or how the Wesley's managed as they rose.
He should have joined the Anglicans in
hose.
But now I know, Beloved, the explanation,
When any heart was touched for an elation,
You came and hardened that heart once
again,
Since they were predisposed among all
men

To go to hell and not pass go in station.
You only meant the eight to have a ration.

75 We sent after them Moses and
Aaron to Pharaoh and his band
With Our signs but they turned out proud
And they were just a guilty crowd.
76 And so when truth came down to them
From Us they said "Sorcery's hem!"
77 Moses said "What! Do you now say
About the truth come in your way?
Is this sorcery? But there's no
Success in what sorcerers sow."
78 They said "Have you come here to turn
Us from the faith ancestors earn,
And so just you two may be great
In the land? And in you two late
We do not believe *in your state*."
79 Pharaoh said "Bring me every skilled
Sorcerer *in the land unbilled*."
80 When sorcerers arrived then said
Moses to them, "Throw down as led
What you've got in hand to throw *dead*."
81 So when they'd thrown down, Moses
said
"What you've brought in sorcery fed
God soon will bring it to no stead.
God does not prosper wicked bread."
82 God will show the truth to be true
By His words, though the guilty too
Be against it *in what they do*.

When Pharaoh called for all those in the
land
Who were of the magician sort and brand,
He founded the great paradigm in hand
For every church thereafter that's been
scanned.
They come with bishop's rod and staff to
make
The bread and wine into a human cake,
And such is sorcery that bishop's bake.
Throw down a crumb and see if I am fed
With what is wrenched from bone and with
what bled.
Beloved, let sorcerers remain behind
The altar and iconostasis blind.
I take a breath and jump into the fray
With the same bread I've eaten every day,
And hope it will add to the things I pray.

83 Only the spawn of Moses' folk
 Believed in what he did in stroke
 Despite fear of Pharaoh and his
 Chiefs, lest he torment them in whiz,
 And Pharaoh was raised in the land,
 And of extravagant in band.
 84 And Moses said "O people mine,
 If you believe in God divine,
 Then trust in Him, if you're among
 The ones submitting *to His rung*.
 85 Then they said "Just on God rely!
 O Our Lord, make us not to try
 By the unjust folk *coming by!*
 86 "And save us by Your mercy from
 The disbelieving people come."
 87 And We revealed to Moses and
 His brother, "Take for the folk's band
 Of you two houses in the land
 To stay in Egypt and there make
 Your houses places for the sake
 Of worship, and set up right prayer,
 And give believers good news there."

This setting up of Sabbath worship in
 Egypt among the slaves who hoped to win
 Was a rebellion hard and fast to grin.
 Slaves have no right to Sabbath rest and
 fame.

They ought to work and drop into death's
 flame.

The world I see around me lies in game
 Of reckless marketing and just the same
 As Pharaoh's Egypt, hopes no slave will
 rise

To keep the Sabbath under Sabbath's skies.
 Beloved, let those last houses set apart
 In Egypt be a witness to my heart
 That in the face of this world's market part
 I may remain steadfast and one to turn
 Away reciting the words that still burn.

88 And Moses said "O Our Lord, You
 Have given Pharaoh and his crew
 Both splendour and riches in life
 Of this world, O Our Lord, so rife
 That they lead folk astray from Your
 Path? O Our Lord, destroy their wealth
 And harden their hearts in their stealth
 So they will not believe until
 They see the punishment's pain fill."
 89 He said "The prayer of you both now

Is accepted. So keep fast now
 Both in the right path and do not
 Follow the way of those who sought
 No knowledge *of the right in plot*.
 90 We made the sons of Israel then
 Pass through the sea, and Pharaoh then
 And his bands chased them in the sway
 Of their rebellion and the way
 Of their hostility, until
 As they were drowning at the fill
 He said "I do believe that there
 Is no god but the One in whom
 The sons of Israel against doom
 Believe and I've submitted bloom.
 91 "What! Now, when you would disobey
 Before and made mischievous way?
 92 "But today We shall save you in
 Your body so you may from sin
 After you be a sign to those
 Who come. But many folk of those
 Are heedless of the signs We chose.
 93 We gave the sons of Israel
 True lodging and provided well
 But they did not differ until
 Knowledge had come to foot their bill.
 So your Lord will judge on the day
 Of resurrection of the way
 They disagreed *from God in sway*.
 94 But if you are in doubt about
 What We've sent down to you in shout,
 Ask those who read the book once sent
 Before you. So the truth once lent
 Has come to you from your Lord, so
 Don't be among the doubters' show.

You're fair, Beloved, in how to treat the
 deal

Of the Qur'an. It's not just how we feel,
 Or whether our ancestors took the rope.
 The proof is not in pudding or in hope,
 But simply if the Qur'an does agree
 With Bible verses we know faithfully.
 My scanning says it does. But some are
 free

To disagree with me. Priority
 Is for the better readers in the way
 Of Arabic and Hebrew, not to say
 The Greek of Gospel met in roundelay.
 Beloved, the Qur'an's true so far as it
 Inclines to support what the Torah fit
 Has told me about grace here where I sit.

95 Don't be like those who must deny
The signs of God, then you would sigh
Among the losers for the try.

96 Those against whom your Lord's word
comes

To pass will not believe the sums,
97 Even if every sign should come
To them until they see the hum
Of grievous punishment on bum.
98 Why wasn't there believing town
With faith to profit its renown
But the folk of Jonah? When they
Believed We from them took away
The torment of shame in the life
Of the world and provided rife
For them for a fixed time of life.

99 If your Lord had so willed, all those
Who are in the earth would propose
Belief, all of them. Will you then
Compel folk against their own ken
To be believers among men?

100 And it is not for any soul
To have faith except by the toll
Of God, while He throws the unclean
On those who use no sense *for spleen*.

101 Say "Watch what's in the sky and
earth.

But signs and warnings are no worth
To people who have faith in dearth."

102 What! Do they wait then for a thing
Except what happened in the sting
Of the days of those passed away
Before them? So then come to say
"Wait then. I too wait here and stay."

103 Ultimately at end of day
We save Our apostles and way
Of those who believe, even so
It's binding on Us *in the row*
To save believers *as they go*.

The story of the prophet Jonah is
Remarkable for all its biz and whiz.
The prophet runs away and then repents
After a great fish knocked him into sense.
And then You spared the city for his
preaching
And left him more ashamed of what he's
reaching.

Too bad for him You did not show this
verse

In sight of all the wondering universe
Before his deep depression under curse:
In the end You save Your apostles and
Give them the great reward right where
they stand.

At end perhaps You do, but Jonah waits
Hot and bothered outside the city gates,
Resigned or not to get reward's rebates.

104 Say "O folk, if you are in doubt
As to my faith, then I am stout
To worship not those whom you take
To worship besides God in wake,
But I worship God who takes you
Away and I'm commanded too
To be of the believers' crew."

105 And saying "Set your face toward
Faith uprightly and don't take sword
Among the polytheist horde.

106 "Do not call on any but God,
What neither profits you a card
Nor harms you. For if you do so,
Then truly if you did it though,
Then you'll be in the unjust row.

107 "If God afflicts you with some harm,
Then none can be removing arm
Except He Himself, and if He
Wills any good to you, none be
Who can repel His grace' decree.
He brings it to the ones He wills
Of His servants. And He then fills
With forgiveness and mercy's hills."

108 Say "O you people, so the truth
Has come to you from your Lord sooth.
So whosoever receives such
Guidance, he receives guidance touch
For his own self. And who will stray
Most surely to his harm's away.
I'm no keeper of you in sway."

109 And follow what's revealed to you
And forbear till God gives the cue
Of judgement. And He is the best
Of all the judges *to invest*.

I'd think this word enough to keep all men
Of faith out of the armies sent again
To make the world safe for democracy
Of exploitation. Such iniquity
It is to join in lifting arms with those
Who are the polytheists Satan chose.
The only army now I know that takes

One God alone is the Iranian shakes,
 And that too has its harnesses and hopes
 Not unlike those of bishoprics and popes.
 Oh yes, then there is Israel of late,
 Unpopular in every sort of state
 For maintaining its borders from the freight
 Of arms to feed both sides the bread of
 hate.

Surah 11 Hud, or The Prophet Hud

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 A. L. R. A book with basic verses made,
 Further explained in stark and stayed,
 From One who's wise and knowing all,
 2 That you should worship at the call
 No one but Allah. "Truly I
 Am for you from the One *in sky*
 To warn and bring the gospel by,
 3 'Seek then forgiveness from your Lord,
 And turn repenting to His sward,
 So He may give you pleasure good,
 For the time appointed as should,
 And pour abounding grace on all
 Who have the merit of *His call*.
 But if you turn away, then I
 Fear that a great day's penalty
 Will come on you. 4 "To Allah's your
 Returning, and He's power o'er
 All things." 5 See they fold up their hearts,
 To lie in hiding from His parts!
 But even when they hide beneath
 Their cloaks, He knows what's in the
 wreath,
 Both hidden and revealed, for He
 Knows *all* the hearts *eternally*.

Beloved, You see not only what man does,
 You see the inmost of what is and was
 The motive of his actions, bad and good.
 Let me lie bare and open as I could
 To Your sight burning, purifying, straight.
 Let me come running through the golden
 gate
 Of fire to You, Beloved, and also through
 The gate of knowledge and of what is true.
 Lay off illusions and the veils between
 My heart and Yours, let everything be seen.
 Conceal no love of Yours from my
 embrace,
 And I shall bare to You both heart and face.
 I am a treasure too who would be known

If but to You my secret treasure's shown.

6 There is no moving creature in
 The earth but from God it must win
 Its sustenance, and He knows well
 Its resting place and where to dwell.
 All's in the revealed book *in cell*.
 7 He has created heavens and earth
 In six days, and His throne of worth
 Was on the water, so He might
 Test you, which of you do act right.
 And if you say "You'll be raised up
 After death," those who like a tup
 Do not believe would say "Just see
 How this is open sorcery."
 8 If We hold back from them torment
 Until appointed time is sent,
 They'll say "What's holding up the show?"
 Beware, on the day it comes slow
 To them it shall not turn from them,
 And will surround them in its hem,
 What they used to scoff *at below*.

The Qur'an is as relevant today
 As ever in at least one thing to say
 About the doubt of resurrection's sway.
 The doubter sees it all as sorcery
 And superstition that the body might
 Be resurrected someday out of spite
 Or for the glory of reward in sight.
 Another doubter rather keeps the soul
 Alive and haunting for the medium's toll.
 But few there be who both acknowledge
 death

And the return to the body of breath.
 So all around I see the bitter news
 Of those who scoff at judgement in the
 mews.

I cling to revelation in my pews.

9 If We make man taste mercy from
 Us, then remove it from his bum,
 He then despairs, ungrateful lum.
 10 If we make him taste favours We
 Send on him after distress, see,
 He'll say "My trials have disappeared."
 He's joyful, and to boasting geared,
 11 Except for those who forbear and
 Do good. Those ones, for them in band
 Is pardon and reward in hand.

You do explain the flagrant way that men
Doubt and scoff at the judgement word
again.

They take the good as their deserts for wen,
And evil as surprising in their den.

I feel in my own skin that attitude.
It creeps upon the human sort of brood.
And yet in service of remembrance I
Hear Your Word trumpeting against the
sky

And know that glitter and the surface field,
The popular and what men's works may
yield

Are transitory here, and beyond that
Is meat and marrow and the glowing fat.
Beloved, I boast in You alone and find
Your sovereignty is solid though I'm blind.

12 Maybe you'll give up part of what
Is revealed to you and be shut
In your breast by it, lest they say

"Why has no treasure come to pay
Him or an angel come with him?"
You're just a warner. God remains
The guardian of all that obtains.

13 Or do they say "He's an inventor."
Say "Bring then ten surahs preventer
To be like it, and call upon
Whomever you may to be drawn
Other than God, if you're true spawn."

14 Then if they do not answer you,
Then know that this Qur'an is true,
Revealed by God's knowledge in view,
And that there is no god but He.

Will you then submit faithfully?

15 Whoever desires this world's life,
And its glories (without the strife),
We shall pay them for their deeds done,
They have no loss *when they've begun*.

16 These are those for whom there is
naught

In the hereafter but fire bought,
And vain shall be all that they wrought
In it, and vain their doing's thought.

17 Is one then with a clear proof from
His Lord and follows him to come

A witness from Him, and before
Having the Book of Moses' store,
A guide and mercy at the door?
These have faith in it, and those who
Of the sects disbelieve the true,

The fire is promised for their due.

So do not be in doubt of rue.

It is the truth come from your Lord.
But most folk don't believe in horde.

Let me, Beloved, be of no sect but Yours,
If that is Hizbullah for all its scores
Or Vatican or Hagia Sophia's sores,
I know nor care not shut within my doors.
I take the Word and eat its flesh in sight
And drink the flowing nourishment of light,
And find the sacrifice that You have made
In sending revelation on parade
Sufficient in the white nights where I'm
laid.

The hope of every book I hide in heart,
And step out on the quartzite rock to start
The morning with my firs to do my part
If only to hold up a helping hand
To divine blessings falling on the land.

18 Who's more unjust that the one who
Invents a lie against God's due?

These shall be presented before
Their Lord and witnesses in store,
"These are those who lied against Lord
Of their life. Beware, the curse stored
Of God is on the unjust horde."

19 Those who keep folk from path of God
And seek to make it turn the sod,
They in the coming day shall be
The unbelievers' mutiny.

20 These shall in no way weaken what
God does in the earth nor is put
For them friends guarding except God.
The torment shall be double rod
For them. They could not bear to hear,
And did not used to see *and fear*.

21 These are the ones who've lost their own
Selves and their false ones to atone
Have left them in the lurch because
Of the lies they invented straws.

22 Without a doubt these are the ones
Indeed in the coming day's runs
Will be the greatest losing guns.

The reason it's so great a crime to lie
About You, my Beloved, I know well why.
You never say a word in Your defence,
And every time the gay silence relents
And lies are spoken about You both near

And far, there is no one, Beloved, I fear
To take Your part and say aloud the true
And tell the world that You are really You.
Oh no, instead men rise to make the stand
For glory to proclaim their wisdom planned
And marked in grand theologies in hand.
When lies are told about You, the door's
wide
For every kind of spiritual pride,
But never for righting the wrong inside.

23 Those who believe and do good and
Keep themselves humble under hand
Of their Lord, these are those who'll be
Live in gardens eternally.

24 The likeness of the two groups runs
Like the blind and the deaf in buns,
And seeing and the hearing ones.
What! Can they be equally set?

Will you not take note of them yet?

25 We sent Noah to his folk saying
"I'm a plain warner to you straying."

26 You shall not worship any but
Allah. I fear for you the glut
Of painful punishment unshut.

27 The chiefs of those who disbelieved
Among his people unreprieved
Said "We don't see in you a thing
But a man like ourselves to spring,
And we seen none follow your word
But the lowest folk in our herd,
At first impression, nor do we
See any excellence to be
In you above ourselves, so we
Consider you to lie *for free*."

The arguments of disdain always take
Two forms to kneed and cut and then to
bake.

The first is that the messenger's a man
(As though an angel or a monkey can
Better speak to the human race and scan).
The second is that those who are not tied
To superstition and scientist's pride
Are not among the honoured folk at all.
But these two arguments against the wall
Are not to be answered by wisdom's call.
The one fails, for if ET came to stall
No one could understand what he had said.
The other fails as soon as faithful sped

Are honoured with both glory and with
bread.

28 He said "O my folk, do you think
If I am on clear proof in brink
From my Lord, and He has bestowed
On me mercy from His own load,
And it has been made dark to you,
Shall we compel you to the view
While you are not in favour too?
29 "And O my people, I do not
Ask of you any wealth in plot.
Reward for me is what God's wrought
And I will not come drive away
Those who believe. They shall some day
Meet their Lord, but I see you stray
A folk in ignorance away.

30 "And O my people, who will aid
Me against God if in parade
I drive them off! What! Will you not
Take note here of the thickening plot?

31 "I don't tell you I have with me
God's treasures, and the unknown see,
Nor say that I'm an angel here,
And I don't say of those not dear
To you that God will never give
The good to them to make them live.
God knows best what is in their hearts,
For then I should be of the parts
Of unjust men *shooting their darts*."

Why yet reward! I know how Noah felt,
But isn't that a blow beneath the belt?
I've rarely got reward for any deed
Or pay from those who teach me more of
greed,

But whether it be pleasure or be pain
In store for me, I rather think the gain
Is in the waiting for what You may give
Out of Your sovereign grace for me to live.
Beloved, the people paid Noah no cent.
They did not praise him for a discourse
lent.

But he waited a lifetime for Your wage
And found a farm, a vine, a cup and page.
I'd rather have applause than drink alone
Without a stitch in tent to cover bone.

32 They said "Oh Noah, you have been
In argument with us to win
And kept on arguing, now spring

On us what you've threatened to bring,
 If you're a truthful one to sing."
 33 He said "God will bring it on you
 Only if He wills, and so you
 Will not prevail against His due.
 34 "My good advice will profit not,
 If I intend to give the plot
 Of good advice, if God still wills
 To leave you astray in your swills.
 He is your Lord, and back to Him
 You shall return *on the day dim*."

The earth continues as it was before
 Is the best argument for lack of gore.
 It's better than disdain of men in store.
 And yet the argument that evil day
 Has not yet turned up is in seed for play
 A failure, for if ever things should change,
 It would be too late to come in the range
 Of ark's salvation. The whole argument
 Is wasted time and energy full spent.
 Without the grace of faith all men will fail
 To enter in the ark and so set sail
 On oceans of salvation. Holy grail
 And other superstitions rather hail
 Them from their changeless and calm days
 unbent.

35 Or they say "He's invented it."
 Say "If I've invented a bit,
 On me be my guilt, let it sit,
 And I am free of that which you
 Have made yourselves guilty in crew."
 36 And it was shown to Noah that
 "None of your own people out flat
 Will ever believe except those
 Who have already on their toes,
 So don't grieve for what such ones chose.
 37 "And make an ark under Our sight
 And Our revealing what is right
 And stop pleading for the unjust,
 For they'll be drowned to the last dust."
 38 And he started to make the ark.
 And when his people's chiefs would park
 By him and mock him, then he said
 "If you mock us, then we'll be led
 To mock you too like that instead.
 39 Soon you will know on whom comes
 down
 A torment that will make him frown,
 And at last on whom there shall fall

The final punishment of all."
 40 Until when Our command arrived
 And water gushed out of the hived,
 And We said "Bring in of each kind
 A pair, and your family lined,
 Except the one sentence is passed,
 And those who believed at the last."
 And there believed with him *that day*
 Only a few *saved from the spray*.
 41 And he said "Get on board, and in
 The name of Allah let sail win
 And anchorage away from sin!
 My Lord is oft-forgiving and
 Most merciful *in all the land*.
 42 And it moved on with them inside
 Amidst the waves like mountainside,
 And Noah called out to his son,
 And he was reticent begun,
 "O my son, come into the ark
 With us and don't be in the park
 With unbelievers *in the dark*."
 43 He said "I'll just go up this peak,
 A mountain that's secure I seek
 Safe from the flood." But Noah said
 "There's no protector to be led
 Today from God's decree but He
 Has mercy." And a wave's debris
 Passed between them, and he was downed
 To be counted among the drowned.
 44 And it was said "O earth, drink up
 Your water, and O sky, like cup
 Withhold!" And the water was stayed
 And the decree fulfilled obeyed,
 And it landed up Judi's mount,
 And it was said "Away in count
 With the unjust folk where they're laid."
 45 And Noah cried unto his Lord
 And said "My Lord, my son adored
 Is of my family. And now
 Your promise is true anyhow,
 And You most just of judges' brow."
 46 He said "O Noah, he is not
 Of your family. Actions plot
 Him other than the righteous lot.
 So don't seek from Me what is not
 Known to you. I warn you is slot
 Not to be of ignorant taught."

The son of any prophet is described
 By faith and good deeds and not by the
 bribed

Of blood and genes provided by the loins.
The son of any prophet here that joins
The crowd to scoff at Your name and Your
law

Is not a son of prophet but of claw.
Beloved, though I'm no son of prophet
here,

And not a tooted one, desired for fear,
Or loved by any but perhaps my wife,
I turn to You for breath as well as life
To cantillate Your books, Your names and
find

In You my father and my mother joined.
Let brother and the sister that I lack
Be found in You alone and in Your track.

47 He said "O my Lord, so I seek
Refuge in You from what I speak
Without the knowledge. If You do
Not forgive me, have mercy too,
Then I'll be of the losers' crew."

48 It was said "O Noah, go out
In peace from Us and blessings stout
Be on you and on the folk those
With you and whom We shall in rows
Provide, and then afflict those from
Us with a painful torment come."

49 This is the news of the unseen
Which We reveal to you on screen.
You did not know it nor your folk
Before this. So patient in yoke
Be, for the end is for the stroke
Of pious ones *of whom We spoke.*

The tidings are unknown to Your own sent
Prophet from book and manuscript unbent,
Despite the circulation of the view
Found in the Torah, Psalms, the Gospel
too,

And in the books apocryphal of late.
The tidings are a revelation great.
No use to complain that some word before
Is like or unlike this one at the door.
Because this revelation come to him
Does not conflict with Bible words undim,
I know I can rely upon the truth
Of what the Qur'an says to age and youth,
But most to age now since my fasting days
Are in the past. I still have strength to
praise.

50 To the folk of 'Ad We sent Hud
Their brother. He said a word good,
"O my folk, worship only God,
You have no god but Him on sod.
You just invent another pod.

51 "O my folk, I do not ask you
To give a recompense in view.
My recompense is with the One
Who has created me when done.
What! Don't you understand the due?

52 And O my folk, beg your Lord too
For His forgiveness and then turn
Repentant back to Him to *learn.*
He sends clouds on you pouring down
Abundant rain *upon the town,*
And He adds strength to your renown,
So don't turn away *from His frown*
Like guilty ones *just fit to drown."*

53 They said "O Hud, you have not brought
To us a clean sign of your thought,
And we will not give up our gods
On your word only in the pods.

We don't believe in you for clods.
54 "We only say some of our gods
Have struck you down with evil rods."
He said "I call Allah to bear

Witness and you may also share
That witness that I am clear of
The associates that you love
55 "Besides Him, and then you conspire
Against me, all of you on fire,
And of that evil never tire.

56 "I put my trust in God, my Lord
And your Lord too though unadored,

There is no living creature made
But He holds it by forelock stayed.
My Lord's on the right path displayed.
57 But if you turn back, then I've given
What I've been sent for you to live in,
And my Lord will bring after you
Instead of you another crew.

You cannot harm Him anyway.
My Lord's on all's protecting sway.
58 When Our decree came, We saved Hud
And those who believed what they could
With him by mercy from Us, and
We saved them from severe remand.

59 This was 'Ad, who denied the signs
Of their Lord, disobeyed the lines
Of His apostles, and went after
The words of tyrants and their laughter.

60 They were followed in this world by
A curse and on what's coming nigh
In resurrection. See, 'Ad's folk
Did not believe what their Lord spoke.
See, fall Hud's people with the stroke
On 'Ad who *fell beneath the yoke*.

The folk of 'Ad cut forests down to make
As many idols as a baker cake.
When rain failed them, they came to Hud to
cry

That he should pray to You above the sky.
His wife, one black and bald, and ugly too
Came out to warn them that Hud's fields in
view

Were also withered and no fruit to eat.
And yet they begged him for a prayer in
treat.

Though rain came, they did not repent a bit.
Beloved, today no doubt the rain in fit
Will come on me and mine. May I repent
Of everything I've done in wicked show,
And praise Your sovereign grace here as I
go

About my dry fields watering-can aglow.

61 To Thamud We sent Saleh who
Was their brother, and he said true,
"Worship God, you've no god but Him.
He raised you from the earthly dim
And made you prosper. So come ask
Forgiveness from Him, then take task
To turn repenting to Him, my
Lord is an answerer and nigh."

62 They said "O Saleh, you've been here
Among us for both hopes and fear.
Do you forbid us from the faith
Of our ancestors in the wraith?
We're troubled in doubt by the thing
You call us to *from wandering*."

63 He said "O my folk, don't you see?
If I've a clear sign from decree
Of my Lord and He's given mercy
From Himself, who will then help me
Against God if I disobey?
So you add to my lot no pay.

64 "And O my folk, this is Allah's
She camel for you in a pause
Of sign, so leave her to graze there
On God's earth and don't touch her there
With evil, for then punishment

Will come upon you when it's sent."

65 And yet they hamstringed her, so he
Said "Enjoy your dwelling for three
Days. This is a promise that you
Should not deny *though it's with rue*."

66 When Our decree came, then We saved
Saleh and those believers slaved
By mercy from Us, from the shame
Of that day. Your Lord *without blame*
Is strong and mighty *in the claim*.

67 The blast gripped those who were unjust
So in their homes they lay in dust,

68 As though they did not dwell in them,
See Thamud's folk did not believe
In their Lord, and they fell from hem,
Folk of Thamud without reprieve.

When Hussayn prayed for little Ali where
The water disappeared into din's air,
The Muslims laughed and slaughtered the
small child

Despite the prayer of Hussayn uttered wild,
That he was like the camel Saleh sent
Before the folk of Thamud evil-bent.

I need not pray a deprecation on
The Yezidites that follow in the spawn
Of those who take refuge before the dawn
In prayer that's sweeter than their sleep
undrawn.

The prayer of Hussayn and of Hud suffice
For both the good believer and the nice.
The water-courses lie beneath the sand
To water every tree upon the land.

69 Our angels came to Abraham
With the good news, said to the lamb:
"Peace" and he answered "Peace" and then
Did not waste time but brought again
A roasted calf to feed the men.

70 But when he saw their hands did not
Reach out to take it, then he thought
They might not be human and so
He started to fear them below.

They said "Do not fear. We are sent
To Lot's people and to prevent."

71 And his wife standing by there laughed,
Then We gave her the good news quaffed
Of Isaac and after Isaac
Of Jacob *come to fill the stack*.

72 She said "Oh woe to me, shall I
Still bear a son when I'm not spry,

So old and this my husband too
Is an old man? It can't be true."
73 They said "What! Do you wonder at
God's own decree? God's mercy sat
On you with His blessing, O folk
Of the house, He alone in stroke
Is worthy to be praised by us,
He alone is all-glorious!"

The people of the house of Abraham
Were not the wives and concubines or
lamb,
But Sarah joined that lofty crew because
She was the mother of Isaac, whose laws
Were taught to Jacob and who became
great
As chosen of the Lord, no other fate.
A wife may come and go by circumstance,
But children are of the same gene and
dance,
Though righteousness is not by man's arm
done,
Nor by the line of kinship ever one,
But by the sovereign grace that You pour
down
Upon the chosen race in any town.
Beloved, I turn toward the house that You
Reveal to be the purified of few.

74 When the awe had gone from the man
Abraham and the good news' span
Came on him, he at once began
To plead with Us for Lot's folk's plan.
75 Abraham was indeed forbearing,
Compassionate, repentance sharing.
76 "O Abraham, don't even try!
Your Lord's decree must needs pass by.
To them will come a torment such
As cannot be averted much."
77 When Our messengers came to Lot,
He was grieved for them, helpless plot,
And would protect them from the sot,
And so said "This day is one caught."
78 His people came to him in haste,
For earlier they did for waste,
And he said "O my people, these
My daughters are purer than sleaze,
So guard yourselves against decrees
Of God, and don't disgrace me now
Before my guests come anyhow.
Do none of you have a just brow?"

79 They said "Indeed you know that we
Do not need your daughters in fee,
And you know what we want plainly."
80 He said "I wish I had the strength
To resist you or find at length
A strong supporter in degree."
81 They said "O Lot, we're messengers
From your Lord. Never shall these fers
Reach you. So go out with your folk
While part of the night's still in stroke,
And let none turn back, but your wife.
She'll suffer what they do in strife.
Their time appointed is the dawn,
And is not morning drawing on?"
82 So when Our decree came to pass,
We turned their town up in the grass,
And rained down on them stones of clay
Baked, in layer on layered pay.
83 Marked ill by your Lord, nor are they
Far distant from the unjust way.
84 To the folk of Midian We sent
Their brother Shu'aib to relent.
He said "O my people, worship
God, you have no god *worth a clip*
But He, and don't subtract a dip
From measure and weight, I see you
In your prosperity, I do
Fear for you the torment to come
On the day when all things fall dumb.
85 "O my folk, give full measure and
Right weight in justice, take no hand
In fraud of people's wealth and do
Not act corruptly in earth's view
To make such mischief *in your pew*.
86 "What's left by God for you is good
For you if you believe as should,
And I'm no keeper over you."

The minor prophets whose names are so
weak
In their renown: Hud, Saleh, and less meek
Shu'aib, are still a greater light today
In a world where all things are up for pay.
Shu'aib comes with reform of wealth and
coin,
The very thing today he could enjoin
As this world flails towards a hopeful way
And yet is sunk in its dishonest stray.
Let honest weight and satisfaction stay.
Beloved, what's left is enough in my view,

The bread, the sweetmeat, and the
meadowrue,
But You hide in this word the very few
Left to House of Muhammad as a crew,
Three hundred and thirteen beside the wall
Of Kaaba under Makkah's swallows' call.

87 They said "Shu'aib, does your faith
make

You tell us that we should forsake
What our ancestors in the past
Worshipped or that we should be last
To do with our wealth what we please?
Ha! You're forbearing *in your ease*,
And rightmindedly *take our keys*."

88 He said "O my folk, don't you see
If I'm in my Lord's guidance free,
And He Himself's provided me
Good sustenance, and I do not
Desire unlike you in the plot
To take myself what I forbid
You to enjoy? I only did
Strive for reform as I can do,
And my guidance is God's in view.
On Him I do rely and to
Him I turn in repentance too.

89 "O people mine, don't let your way
Of opposing me make you stray
In sin, lest what fell on the folk
Of Noah fall on you in stroke,
Or what came on Hud's people or
The people of Saleh in roar,
Nor were the folk of Lot far off
From you *in how you act and scoff*.

90 So ask forgiveness from your Lord,
And turn to Him, truly my Lord
Is merciful and lovingkind,
And ready to receive the blind."

91 They said "O Shu'aib, we do not
Understand much of what you've taught.
We see you just as a weak man
Among us. Were your family's scan
Not here preventing us, we'd take
Up stones and kill you *like a snake*.
You're not strong to resist our rake."

92 He said "What! Is my family
Of more account in what you see
Than God? And you cast Him behind
Your backs, neglecting unresigned?
My Lord surrounds the things you mind.

93 "O my folk, act as best you can,

I too am acting like a man.

Soon you'll know on whom torment comes
To his disgrace, and who in sums
Is lying. Keep watch and I too
Will keep the coming in my view."

94 When Our decree then came to pass,
We saved Shu'aib and those en masse
Who had believed with him by grace
That came from Us. But in their place,
Those who did injustice, the blast
Came on them so they were at last

In their homes inert corpses cast,
95 As though they had not lived in them.
See then, away with Midian's hem,
Just as Thamud's folk too were cast.

Belief, Beloved, comes to the heart of man,
Not by his choice nor by the things he can,
But by the mercy of Your loving heart,
Design eternal decreed from the start.
Belief, Beloved, is not mine here to give,
I have no powers, it is by You I live,
But if by mercy You give faith to me,
I pray that I may live obediently.
Though many of the Midian host lay down
Beneath the curse that Shu'aib saw in town
As well as by the blast of trumpet known
To Gideon's three hundred men alone,
The rest of humankind is dead in sin
Unless Your mercy wakes and takes them
in.

96 We sent Moses reciting signs
And with clear power to meet designs,
97 To Pharaoh and his chiefs, but they
Followed Pharaoh's orders in sway,
And Pharaoh's was not the right way.

98 He'll lead folk resurrection day,
And bring them down into fire's sway.
But woeful will be guidance then,
And woeful the place of their den.

99 They're followed by a curse in this
And in that of the day to kiss
The resurrection. Pained reward
Shall they be given *by their Lord*.

100 This is the tale of towns We tell
To you, of them some stand as well
And some have been mown down to tell.

101 We did them no injustice then,
But they were unjust to their men,
And so their gods on whim they called

Did nothing for them when appalled,
Gods besides God, when came to pass
Your Lord's decree. They could not add
A thing but their perdition sad.

102 So is the grasping of your Lord
When He grabs the towns in reward
For their injustice. His grasped sword
Is painful and severe *when gored*.

103 In this there is a sign for him
Who fears coming chastisement grim,
This is a day for which mankind
Shall be gathered in one resigned,
This day be witnessed unrefined.

104 And We do not delay the time,
It is appointed *for the crime*.

105 The day it comes, no soul shall speak
But by His leave, then some shall keep
In wretchedness, others be blessed.

106 And as for those as wretched then,
They shall be in the fire again,
For them there shall be sighing and
The groaning *of all every hand*.

107 They shall remain there for all time
As long as sky and earth in clime
Remain, except as your Lord wills.

Your Lord does whatever He wills.
108 And as for those who will be blessed,
They'll be within the garden dressed
Abiding there so long as sky
And earth endure, except as by
The will of your Lord. It will be
A gift continuing *to see*.

109 So do not wonder what these folk
Are worshipping, they follow yoke
Of their ancestors faith before.

We'll surely pay them back the score
In full for their share in such gore.

Determinists and free will faithful find
Here a field play among blind leading
blind.

Why must the human be the slave of mind?
Your will and grace, Beloved, will come to
pass

No matter what may think a lad or lass.
Let all remain where You please, and let
me

Be among humankind that You set free
To praise Your name throughout eternity.
Beloved, the towers of hell, the gardens
brief

Of heaven both are the terms and towns of
grief

To those with expectations of relief.
I speculate not in my tumbled way,
I look not for the night in summer's sway,
Nor for the blessed light in winter's grey.

110 We gave to Moses the sure Book,
But variance came in the nook,
And had not a word gone out from
Your Lord, the matter found in sum
Would surely have been then decided
Between parties opposed, derided.
So they are in doubt unconfided.

Because the Jews rabbinical and those
Who fanned the flames Samaritan in rows
Could not agree on many words they chose
In Torahs set in common and in foes,
The many are in doubt now as they look
Upon the Qur'an as a sacred book.
The Qur'an ties up ends and friends that
seem

Disquieted and ragged as I deem
In Torah, though the Torah that I find
Is a perfection as it is designed.
Beloved, I hear the Qur'an say to me
To keep the Torah without doubt's degree,
And then doubt shall not in eternity
Cast me out from Your face's symmetry.

111 To all your Lord will recompense
In full for all their deeds dispense,
Of what they do He knows with sense.

112 So stand fast as you are commanded
And also the one that He's handed
To you, do not exaggerate,
He sees what you do in your state.

113 Do not incline to those who act
Unjustly lest the fire in fact
Come to touch you, for you have no
Protector but God on the go.

114 Set firm prayer in the day's both ends,
And at approach of night, so fends
The good deed for the evil act.
This is a reminder in fact
For those mindful *of what is stacked*.

This great proof that I must get the times
right
Only by hearing prophet's guiding light

And the tradition of the Imams' plight
 Is hardly worth the weight I find in sight.
 While I accept with love and joy the voice
 Of prophet and Imam, I still rejoice
 That the Four Books are clear enough to
 give
 The details of the way I ought to live.
 It's only those who neglect one book here
 And one book there, and grasp only in fear
 The part, who have still questions on the
 ear
 And doubts as to what's right and wrong
 and clear.
 I take the Four Books as clear word and
 find
 The prophets and Imams living in kind.

115 Be patient, for God will not let
 The reward of the righteous get
 Lost, *but it surely will be met.*
 116 But why were there not among those
 Who lived in generations' rows
 Before you some with understanding
 Forbidding mischief in earth's landing,
 Except a few of those and whom
 We saved from among them from doom?
 Those who did injustice went on
 After to what they had been drawn
 To enjoy, they were guilty spawn.
 117 Your Lord was not here to destroy
 Towns unjustly whose folk employ
 Themselves in righteousness *and joy.*
 118 If your Lord had so willed He would
 Have made men a single folk good,
 But they will not cease to divide,
 119 Except the ones left to abide
 In you Lord's mercy. And for this
 He did create them. In the bliss
 Of your Lord's word it is fulfilled.
 I will fill hell with the jinn spilled
 And men, all those together willed.
 120 All that We tell you of account
 Of the apostles is to mount
 Firm with it your heart. So the truth
 Has come to you, and so with ruth
 An admonition and reminder
 To the believers *to be kinder.*
 121 And say to those who don't believe,
 "Do what you can, we too achieve,
 122 "Wait, and we too await reprieve.
 123 "God's is the unseen of the skies

And of the earth, and to His eyes
 Is the whole of what's made returned,
 So worship Him and trust unspurned.
 Your Lord's not heedless of what's earned."

This morning as I came to recite what
 David had written in the Psalms unshut,
 I knew repentance lying in my gut.
 If that is evidence that You in grace
 Work on my heart, I put on patient face
 And grasp the faith and the hope that You
 trace

Upon the book of evidence and mace.
 Be patient, so the holy Qur'an states,
 For You will not let the reward's abates
 Fall, but will surely bring the good to pass.
 That does not mean I just sit on my ass.
 With or without reward, Beloved, I know
 The pleasure and the fear I see in show
 Upon the screen of revelation's row.

Surah 12 Yusuf, or Joseph

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 A. L. R. These are the signs of the book
 full.

2 We have sent it down, the Qur'an
 In Arabic so you'll be drawn
 To understand it *even and dawn.*
 3 We narrate to you the best story
 Of all the stories that in glory
 We've revealed to you in Qur'an,
 Though before this you were of those
 Who did not know about its rows.
 4 When Joseph told his father, "Dad,
 I saw eleven stars as clad
 And sun and moon, I saw them all
 Prostrating before me to fall."
 5 He said "O my son, now take care
 Not to tell your brothers the share,
 Lest they plot against you a plot.
 Satan's a foe to human lot.

It was the beauty of his face and not
 The dreams and coloured coat of Torah's
 plot

That came inspiring brothers' envy rot
 And made the father warn his son a lot.
 It was the beauty of his face that glowed
 In sweetness on all men and all men
 showed

The innocence of a rare soul's abode

By divine grace and mercy once bestowed.
Beloved, let me be grateful that I am
Like Christ a root of the dry ground and
lamb

Unnoticed in the flock. I need no rise
Of envy to cloud my crystalline skies.
The cover of my firs and birches here
Is just as dear as that of the pines near.

6 "So your Lord will choose you and teach
You interpretation to preach,
And perfect His grace to you and
To the children of Jacob's land,
Even as He perfected it
To your ancestors in times fit,
Abraham, Isaac in their guise.
Your Lord's all knowing and all-wise."

The visions of the things above the sight
Of humankind, the stars in gloried light,
And sun and moon, are things not to be
seen

Or heard or spoken of to those between.
I hear the warning of Jacob's sweet voice,
And still I am so filled that I rejoice
Before the evil hearts of jealous men,
And suffer long and often in their den.
Beloved, keep me apart and safe in You,
Hidden within Your heart where You are
true,

And keep my lips sealed and eye peeled to
view.

Beloved, the ancestors of many ways
Impinge upon my life both nights and days,
But there is nothing better than Your
praise.

7 In Joseph's story and his brothers'
There are signs for both sons and mothers.

8 When they said "Joseph and his own
Brother are dearer than our loan
To our father, though we are more,
Our father errs upon that score.

9 "Kill Joseph or make castaway
In some other land, and that way
Catch the attention undivided
Of your father, and underided
Become a righteous folk to stay."

10 One of them said "Do not kill him,
But throw Joseph into some dim
Bottom of a well. Passers-by

May take him up, if you are sly."

11 They said "O our father, what cause
Is with you you don't trust our paws
With Joseph? We wish him well now.

12 "Send him with us tomorrow so
He may enjoy himself and show
A time for sport, and truly we
Will be for him the surety."

13 He said "It makes me sad that you
Should take him away from my pew,
And I'm afraid lest a wolf eat
Him while you're heedless of his feet."

14 They said "If the wolf should devour
Him while so great a crowd's in power,
We'd surely be losers *an hour*."

The dream of Dunya, Bilhah's daughter
showed

The fear the ladies of the household rode.
It was she by her dream unwittingly
Gave to the brothers the excuse freely
To claim the wolves were wicked on the
hills

And likely to claim lives amid the rills.
The fears of little girls impinge on men
And give them their ideas deep in their den.
Beloved, I see the visions come of late
As well as minding those of former state,
And find the bogeymen still play their
tunes

Against the backdrop of my fresher runes.
Above the fears of children and their
friends

I find Your providence makes Your
amends.

15 So when they'd gone with him agreed
To put him in well-bottom's lead,
And We revealed to him, "You will
Most surely tell them of their bill
One day when they recognize nil."
16 They came to their dad that night
weeping.

17 They said "O our father, once leaping
We left Joseph by our things keeping.
Then the wolf ate him, but you'll not
Believe us, though a truthful lot."

18 And they came with his shirt, on it
Was false blood. He said "No, unfit
Is what you've done, but I still sit
In patience, and God is the One

Whose help is to be sought when done
Against what you describe *as won*. ”

The omened tales proliferate that say
The knives called out how that they would
not slay,

The ram said the blood was the blood of
sheep,

Joseph's empty house wailing voices keep,
Joseph's pigeons were crying in their sleep,
The hungry wolves spoke to Jacob denying,
And all these tales and all the more are
vying

To glorify Joseph that sorrowed day.
Beloved, I hardly know the certain truth
And yet I do admire that lovely youth.
There is hardly a man that's lived to be
As fair and sweet and wise as Joseph wee,
And yet the great temptation to love him
Before Your face and word perceived turns
dim.

The coat of many colours in the scheme
Of Torah in tradition casts a beam
From the fire that old Nimrod lit to burn
The prophet Abraham for what he'd earn.
It was the shirt that Abraham had worn
When thrown into the fire with utter scorn
And failed to die before the pagan king.
That coat was such a wondered, precious
thing.

Beloved, the precious coat of Abraham
Was soak in the blood of a slaughtered
lamb.

What miracles that coat held in its fold!
And how that coat contrived to make men
bold.

Beloved, I have enough coats in this place
Of winter and of ice on window's trace.

19 And there came down a caravan
And sent their water drawer's span
And he let down his bucket there,
And said “Good news, a youth to share!”
And they hid him with merchandise.
God knew what they did by surprise.
20 And they sold him for paltry price,
For a few dirhams counted twice,
They had no interest in a trice.

The sign I find first in Joseph's tale's that

A brother's not to be trusted, the fat
Or thin, the friendly on the mat
Or any other style a brother's at.
Thank God I have no brothers in this place,
Nor any kin besides my daughter's grace
And grandson still to me a friendly face.
I need no brothers to leave me in trace
In wells of water to be found and sold
Or else left out to wander in the cold.
No Faithful steps beside me, Hopeful peers
Around the corners of his own and not my
tears.

The ummahs and the congregations pass,
But I turn back from every lad and lass.

21 The man who bought him in Egypt
Said to his wife, “Give him a crypt
Of honour, maybe he will be
A profit to us or then we
Will adopt him as a son wee.”
So We established Joseph in
The land, and that We might in din
Teach him interpretation's bin,
God has power over His affair,
But most of men know not He's there.
22 And when he had attained his prime,
We gave him power and knowing time,
So We reward those without crime.
23 She in whose house he was then tried
To seduce him from the pure's side,
And she locked the doors and she said
“Now come *and join me on the bed*. ”
He said “Refuge in God, my Lord,
He made my dwelling here restored,
The unjust don't prosper, abhorred.”
24 She pined for him, and so might he
But he stayed on his Lord to see.
So We turned back the ill and shame
From him. He was and without blame
Of Our freed servants *that We claim*.
25 They both raced to the door and she
Tore off his shirt from behind, see,
And they met her husband beside
The door, and so she said and cried,
“What is the punishment of him
Who intends evil and the grim
To your wife but to be shut fast
In prison and tortured to last?”
26 He said “She tried to seduce me
From my self and my purity”
And her own house bore witness true:

"If his shirt's torn from the front view
 Then she is speaking what is true
 And he is lying through and through."
 27 "And if his shirt is torn behind,
 She is one of the lying kind,
 And he is truthful, *be not blind.*"
 28 So when he saw the shirt torn back,
 He said "It's truly of the lack
 Of you women, great is your knack.
 29 "O Joseph, let the matter go,
 And you wife ask forgiveness low,
 For you are of the guilty show."

Tradition of the Torah comes in shades
 Of many colours by the Jewish blades,
 And this in revelation reflect which
 Of those contain most truth when at the
 pitch.

The tearing of the shirt in front or back
 Shows who is truthful in seducing's stack,
 And truth comes out for those of righteous
 mien,

Despite satanic warfare where men glean.
 Beloved, my shirt is torn in back and front
 Because I am a servant often blunt,
 And fail to follow You in all I do,
 I am not like good Joseph in Your crew.
 I lack both beauty of face and virtue.
 Deliver me from both myself and You.

30 The women in the city said
 "The wife of great Aziz was led
 To seek to seduce her slave from
 His right. He has touched her in sum
 Deeply with love. We see here in
 Clear error *and dead in her sin.*"

31 And when she heard their scheming
 talk,
 She sent for them and readied stock
 For a feast and gave each of them
 A knife and said to Joseph gem:
 "Come out to them." So when they saw
 Him, they all praised the man with awe.
 In their amazement they all cut
 Their hands and said where he did strut,
 "Hasha-lillah, This is not one
 Mortal, but noble angel son!"
 32 She replied then, "This is the one
 About whom you blamed me, and I
 Tried to seduce him on the fly,
 But he kept firmly guiltless, and

If he does not do out of hand
 What I say, I'll have them remand
 Him to prison and he shall be
 Brought down into a low degree."
 33 He said "O my Lord, prison's dear
 To me above all you appear
 Inviting me, but if You do
 Not turn away their guile in view,
 I may yearn for them and become
 One of the ignorant ones' bum."
 34 So his Lord heard him and He turned
 Away their guile against him burned,
 He is all hearing, knows concerned.
 35 Then they decided after they
 Had seen sign of innocent way
 In him, that they would put away
 The man in prison, time to stay.

Of forty dining women, nine fell down
 In fainting swoon to see the man in town
 Most handsome with alluring leg and
 crown.

The spell they spoke that asked God to
 protect
 Them from Joseph's beguiling looks select
 Was powerless before the lust inspired
 By Your creation's pinnacle unwired.
 So when they got up from their swoon, they
 told

Zulaika to keep him in prison cold
 For a few days, and see if he'd unfold
 And give them their desires, their desires
 bold.

Beloved, the like has never since been seen,
 And yet the world is not a better screen
 Than in the days Zulaika chose the lean.

36 With him in prison came to youths
 And one of them spoke out in truths:
 "I saw me *in dream* pressing wine"
 The other said "I saw me fine
 With bread in basket on my head
 And the birds eating it instead.
 So tell us the interpretation,
 We see you're good in reputation."
 37 He said "There will not come to you
 The food by which you're fed in crew,
 But I'll inform you both of its
 Interpretation as it fits
 Before it come on both of you.
 This is what my Lord's brought to view.

I have rejected the faith of
 The folk who do not hold in love
 Allah, and deny what's to come,
 They're disbelievers to a bum.
 38 "I follow my ancestors' faith
 Of Abraham, Isaac no wraith
 And Jacob. It's unlawful we
 Should join anything in degree
 With God. This is by God's grace on
 Us and on humankind and spawn,
 But most folk do not thank when drawn.
 "O my two fellows prisoned here,
 Which is better, to hold in fear
 Many lords differing from each,
 Or God the one not to impeach?
 40 You only worship besides Him
 Mere names that you have named as grim,
 You and your ancestors, God's not
 Sent down for them power on the spot.
 There is no judgement but what's God's.
 He's commanded you all with prods
 To worship naught but Him alone.
 This is the right religion's own.
 But most folk do not know the throne.
 41 "O my two fellows prisoned here,
 As to the one of you in fear
 He'll pour out wine before his lord
 To drink and so get his reward.
 As for the other, he shall be
 Crucified so upon the tree
 The birds shall eat from his head's spree.
 It is a matter of decree
 About which you inquired of me."
 42 And he told the one that he knew
 Would be saved of the youthful two:
 "Mention me to your lord as due."
 But Satan cause him to forget
 To mention it to his lord yet.
 He stayed in gaol a few years set.

The Torah fails to point out Joseph spoke
 First to the questioners and to each bloke
 About Your oneness and how pagan gods
 Are merely wind and words and empty
 pods.
 The Qur'an with a cheer reports the speech
 And shows how Joseph at once came to
 preach
 That You are one alone, no trinity
 Among Egyptian goddesses to be.
 Beloved, I seek You only, singly, and

I bow before Your throne set on the land
 That stretches out in birch and fir and pine
 And aspen too, cold water and not wine,
 As far as Vladivostok where some day
 I'll see the sparkling ocean rise, I may.

43 The king said "I saw in a dream
 The seven fat cows that I ween
 Came to be eaten by seven lean,
 And seven ears of corn all green,
 And others dryer than corn seen.
 Courtiers explain what it may seem
 The meaning of the dream I dream."
 44 They said "These are confused dreams
 bred,
 We do not know what they may mean."
 45 The one who'd been released then said
 After he finally was led
 Back to his memory instead,
 "I'll tell you what it means, but I
 Must go and confer on the sly.
 46 "Joseph, O truthful one, explain
 To us the seven fat cows' reign
 Which seven skinny ones devoured,
 And seven ears green and the scoured
 Seven dry, so I may return
 To the folk and then let them learn."
 47 He said "You shall sow seven years
 But what you reap, leave in its ears,
 Except the little you shall eat.
 48 "Then shall come after seven years
 Of drought which shall devour the treat
 Of all that you've laid by before,
 Except a little left in store.
 49 "Then after that will come a year
 People will have much rain appear,
 And so they press wine *without fear*."

I've had some nightmares in my time,
 though I
 Have never seen them come true by and by.
 Perhaps the dreams of kings are powerful
 And must be planned about for seed and
 hull.
 I've seen some courtiers in psychology
 Who list delusions of both bond and free
 And are as certain as certain can be
 They know the future and the past decree.
 But I am not like Joseph, I am not
 Like the notorious ones in Your plot,
 Who set the day and time and field and lot

With corn and meat and wine and all things
sought.

I feed alone from Your hand and I find
My sustenance is better than the wine.

50 The king said "Bring him in to me!"
So when the messenger came free,
He said "Go back to your lord king
And ask him what's the suffering
Of the women who cut their hands.
My Lord knows the guile on their strands."

51 The king said "What was wrong with
you

When you tried to seduce in crew
Joseph?" The women said with rue,
"Hash-lillah, we here do not know
Any wickedness in his show."

Aziz's wife said "Now the truth
Has come to light though without ruth,
I did try to seduce him then.

And he's among the truthful men."

52 "This in order that he may know
That I've never been false in show
To him in his absence, and that
Allah will never guide the flat
Trap of the false ones here below.

The lovely Joseph, pure and undefiled,
Was proven innocent from charges wild
And reckless. Neither greed nor cruelty
Had any power to move him, he was free
No matter where he was, the empty pit,
The royal house or royal prison, it
Was all the same for one who never was
False to himself or any other cause.

Beloved, make me escape the snares of
those

Who falsely point, but more what falsely
grows

Within the self-illusion. Rather snare
My self in Your Self. Joseph was aware
That You are closer far in absence than
In presence. That's why Joseph played the
man.

53 "I don't try to justify my
Own self, one's always threatened by
The evil way, except the one
My Lord had mercy on when done.
My Lord is oft-forgiving and
All-merciful upon the land.

54 And the king said "Bring him to me,
I'll have him in monopoly."

So when he'd talked with him, he said
"You are before us from this day
A trusted counsellor at bay."

55 He said "Set me over the store
Of treasury in the land, for
I am a keeper, knowing sway."

56 So We set Joseph in the land,
To take possession in his hand,
We set Our mercy on whom We
Please and We do not waste the fee
Of those who do good faithfully.

57 Surely the recompense hereafter
Is better for those without laughter
Who believe, do not wickedly.

I do not envy the state of those who
Today rule over treasuries when due.
But balance of the wealth always in view
Throughout all history is full of rue.
It is no new thing that I see the row
Accounted for in hopelessness as low
As that that totters before my eye slow.
All things in flux remain with changing
crew.

Beloved, I thank You that you've put me
near

The quartzite mountain I love without tear,
The needle-strewn path that I tread each
day

Up to the place of look-out where I stray.
My treasury suffices for the hut
When I open at dawn my eye once shut.

58 The brothers of Joseph came and
Entered the palace there to stand
And he knew them but they did not
Recognize him at all in slot.

59 When he'd provided them their fare,
He said "Bring me your brother there
From your father. Do you not see
That I give full measure freely?
And I'm the best of hosts in fee?

60 "But if you don't bring him to me,
Then there shall be no measure, see,
For you, and you'll not come near me."

61 They said "We'll try to get him from
His father, and accomplish rum."

62 He told his servants "Put their goods
Into their saddle-bags, like hoods

They'll see it when they get back home,
So they'll have to come back, not roam."

63 So when they returned to their dad,

They said "O our father, it's sad

The measure's denied us, so send

With us our brother to that end

We may get the measure of corn.

Certainly we'll keep him from scorn."

64 He said "Can I trust him with you

Except as I trusted in crew

His brother long ago in view?

But God is the best guard, and He

Is most abundant in mercy."

65 And when they opened up their own,

They found their goods returned in stone.

They said "O our father, what can

We hope for? Our goods are in span

Returned to us. We'll bring more corn

For our folk and guard from all scorn

Our brother, and we'll get what's more

The measure of a camel's store.

This is an easy thing to pour."

66 He said "I'll never send him there

With you until you pledge in share

Firm covenant in God's name that

You will most surely bring him pat

Back to me, unless you're attacked

Surrounded by the foes unbaked."

And when they pledged him covenant,

He said "God's over all we say,

A guardian witness of the way."

67 And he said "O my sons today!

Do not go in by one gate's way.

But go in by different gates' sway.

I cannot avail against God.

Judgement is only God's in rod.

On Him do I rely and on

Him let those who rely, stay drawn."

68 When they had come in by the way

Their father told them to in sway,

It did not avail against God,

But a desire in Jacob's prod

To satisfy his soul in pod,

And truly he had knowledge for

We had taught him why and wherefore,

Though most folk do not know the store.

Precautions are wise things to take by men,

The coming in through different gates

again,

The keeping more than one egg in the den,

And more than one plan to succeed in fen.

And yet the truth is that the ultimate,

Despite the insignificant in state,

That follows the free will in desolate,

Is the umbrella of Your sovereign great.

Beloved, my cunning plans of rice and wen

Reveal the heart's desire no doubt to ken,

But after all is bled and won I stake

Reliance on You only in the wake,

And find the blue of sky and brass of earth

Conform to You at last to sing their berth.

69 And when they came to Joseph's place,

He lodged his brother in his grace,

And said "I am your brother here,

So don't grieve at what they may fear."

70 And when he had furnished their good,

The drinking cup was placed in hood

Of his brother's saddle-bag, then

A crier cried before the men,

"O you of this great caravan,

You are all thieves in what you scan."

71 They said as they turned round to see,

"What is it you're missing prithee?"

72 They said "We miss the drinking cup

Of the king and who brings it up

Shall have a camel load of corn,

And I'm responsible and sworn."

73 They said "By God, you know that we

Did not come to make mischief free

In the land nor such thievery."

74 They said "But what shall be the pain

Of punishment if you speak vain?"

75 They said "The punishment for it

Shall be that he in whose bag it

Is found shall himself be a slave

In penalty for such a knave,

So we punish wrong-doing grave."

Beloved, let me be a slave now I'm caught

With Your cup in my coffers for my lot.

I've been framed by both family and friends

To be a thief and liar without ends,

So let me have the benefit of that

And live a servant in Your house and fat.

Poor Benjamin was innocent of all:

The patriarchal bishopric in thrall

Is one too hard-hearted upon the ball.

So let me be a slave to Christ the king,

Or stand before Your throne under Your

wing,

And ride the tide upon the crystal sea,
Your servant now and such eternally,
Despite the fact I have no note to sing.

76 Then he began to search their sacks
Before the sack his brother stacks,
Then he drew it out from his own
Brother's sack. So We planned the loan
For Joseph. It was not for him
To take his brother under grim
Law of the king unless God willed.

We raise the degrees as fulfilled
By Our decree, and over each
One given knowledge is the reach
Of the all-known One to teach.

77 They said "If he steals surely he
Has stolen his brother before,"

But Joseph kept it secretly,
And did not tell them of the score.

He said "You are in a bad way,
And God knows best the thing you say."

78 They said "O Aziz, he's a dad,
A very old one to be sad,
So take one of us in his place.

We see you are a man of grace."

79 He said "May God protect us from
Seizing an innocent one come
Other than him with whom we found
Our property, for then our ground
Would be an unjust one unsound."

A camel load of corn is offered him
Who brings the royal cup back from the
brim.

Benjamin trusts his brother by the word
Of the Qur'an, there is no meaning blurred
As in the Torah, where he too is left
To guess his fate for being framed for theft.
Beloved, let me steal any camel here,
And surely justice will be boughten dear.
These two points tie the strings of Torah's
tale,

And answer questionings that came up
hale.

I wondered how good Joseph could have
sent

Poor Benjamin into a doubtful vent.
I wondered what was offered in reward
For finding cups replenished to their lord.

80 When they gave up convincing him,

They turned back whispering in dim,
And the oldest of them said trim:
"Don't you know how your father took
From you a covenant to brook

In God's name, how you failed in past
About Joseph? So I'll not cast
Myself from this land till my dad
Permits me or God decides sad.

He's the best of judges we've had.

81 "Go back to your father and say

'O our father, your son for pay

Has stolen, and we only bear

Witness of what we've known to share
And could not prevent unforeseen.

82 "So inquire in the town and scene

Where we were and the caravan

We went with, if we're truthful man."

83 He said "No, you've contrived
yourselves

The story to fit on your shelves,
So patience does, maybe God will
Bring them to me after the bill.
He is all-knowing, all-wise still."

The stories good men still contrive to make
Themselves seem innocent before the stake
Would make a devil shudder to regard.
The human heart is hard, it's very hard.
The fact is a man's never accused of
The true crime that he commits hand in
glove.

It's always lies contrived, and most of them,
Are lesser than the truth that would
condemn.

You have provided men with lies so we
Can bear up under them and righteously
Deny our guilt. But if You let accuser
Speak truth, the weight would be of such
abuser

That it would crush the spirit. Beloved, I
Am glad to be falsely accused and sly.

84 And he turned from them then and said
"Alas, my grief for Joseph led!"

And his eyes turned white in their grief
As he tried to gain some relief.

85 They said "By God, you will not cease
To think of Joseph for release
Until you're ill or come to die."

86 He said "I only complain by
My distress and grief to God, and

I know from God what you in band
Fail now and then to understand.

87 "O my sons, go and ask about
Joseph and his brother in doubt,
And do not despair of God's mercy.
The ones who despair of God's mercy
Are disbelieving folk in doubt."

88 So when they came to him they said
"O Aziz, distress touched our head
And our family home and bred.
And we've come with a little stead
So give us measure full and spread,
And deal with us in charity.
God reward such with charity."

89 He said "Do you know what you did
To Joseph and his brother, hid
The consequences under lid?"

90 They said "Are you Joseph?" He said
"I am Joseph and this one is
My brother. God has poured down His
Grace on us. The one who in share
Practices piety to bear
Fails not to find reward of God
On doing of the good on sod."

91 They said "By God, God's chosen you
Above us, we're a guilty crew."

92 He said "There's no reproof for you
Today, and may God forgive you,
He's the most merciful of all
Those who have mercy *in the stall*."

93 "Take this shirt from me and present
It before my father's face sent,
And he shall then receive his sight,
And come to me, both son and wight."

Beloved, the differences that I see
Between the Qur'an and the Torah flee
Before my sight and I remember that
The oral histories where men have sat
Around the evening fires are never flat,
But ripple and flow like the river waves
And lightly bear men on to meet their
graves.

The Talmud brings to light a host of songs
Devolving on the rings and rights and
wrongs.

So Jacob was told by Your spirit what
His sons did not know when their minds
were shut,

And Joseph's shirt that failed him long ago
Returns to bring back sight on Jacob's row.

I am amazed by how men's lives here flow.

94 And when the caravan had left,
Their father said "I feel bereft
The scent of Joseph, though you think
That I am trembling on the brink."

95 They said "By God, you do mistake."

96 So when the messenger in wake
With the good news came, he cast it
Upon his face: his eyesight lit.
He said "Did I not say to you?"

I know from God what hid from you?"

97 They said "O our father, then ask
Forgiveness for us, take the task,
Since we are guilty where we bask."

98 He said "I'll soon ask forgiveness
For you from my Lord, He is oft
Forgiving, merciful aloft."

99 When they came before Joseph, he,
He favoured his relatives wee
And said "Come into Egypt fair,
If God will to keep you safe there."

100 He raised his parents to the throne,
And they fell down to him alone
Prostrating and he said "My dad,
This is meaning of dream I had
Before. My Lord's made it come true.

He was kind to me when He drew
Me out of prison and brought you
From the desert after Satan
Sowed dissension between this man
And my brothers. My Lord is gracious
To whomever He wills and spacious,
He's all-knowing, all-wise in plan.

101 "O my Lord, You gave me in span
Dominion and taught me the meaning
Of *unhopeful* events as leaning,
Beginner of the skies and earth!
You are my guardian in berth
Of this world and the one to come.

Let me die in submission's sum,
And join me with the righteous hum."

102 This one of the tale unseen
We have revealed to you to glean,
Since you were not present with them
When they resolved their matter's hem,
And while they made their plans on scene.

103 And most folk will not now believe
Thou you desire for their reprieve.

104 What! Don't you ask of the reward
For it, for this is just outpoured

In warning to the worlds restored.

The miracle the Torah fails to note
Is plain here on the pages that he wrote:
The blindness that fell on Jacob for tears
Or for the age deprived of what appears
As joy to other men, that blindness came
To change into sight given for his claim.
Though no shirt of an ordinary son
Can open the blind eyes of anyone,
The grace that You bestow, Beloved, is
done

In miracles that stop the very gun.
The shirt once lost to sacrificial blood
To hide the sins of brothers in a flood,
Is now replaced by on that returns grace
Upon the patriarch's obedient face.

105 How many miracles are found
Upon the sky and on the ground
Which they pass by turning around!
106 And most of them do not believe
In God but only idols' sleeve.
107 What! Do they then feel they're secure
That there may come upon them sure
Chastisement from God or might fall
On them a sudden unknown pall?
108 Say "This is my way, I invite
To God. With clear and fervent sight,
I and the one who follows me.
And glory be to God, and I
Am not of polytheist guy."
109 And We did not send messengers
Before you but men and such fers
To whom We revealed, from among
The people of the towns outstrung.
What! Don't you journey in the land
To see what's been the end at hand
Of those before them? Certainly
The dwelling of the coming spree
Is the best for those who guard well
Themselves. What! Don't you see the spell?
110 When the apostles in despair
Thought they were betrayed, then Our care
Came to them and We saved the ones
We wanted to, and Our wrath stuns
The guilty people on their buns.
111 In their tales is a lesson drawn
For men of understanding dawn.
It is not a tale made up but
A confirmation sure of what

When before it, explained detail
Of all things and a guide to sail
And mercy to folk who prevail
To have faith *in both calm and gale*.

Beloved, I hear again the story told
In versions of the campfire and the bold
How Joseph was a great man, heart of gold,
And how he lived to overcome when sold.
Though I am neither slave nor ruler set,
I may have been sold sometime in the wet,
And may have been cause of decisions let,
And so I beg the lesser of the tale
Be seared upon my mind and heart to pale
Attractions of a world set out to be
Temptations to deprive men to be free.
I see the confirmation of the grace
And mercy that come pouring from Your
face,
And find them better than the golden mace.

Surah 13 Ar-Ra'd, or The Thunder

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 Alif, Lam, Mim, Ra.

These are the verses of the book,
And that which has been sent down, look,
To you from your Lord is the truth,
But most folk don't believe in ruth.
2 It's God who raised the skies without
The help of pillars you can scout,
Then firmly set Himself upon
The throne and made below Him drawn
The sun and moon, each one to run
Its course in times appointed done.
He regulates the matter, so
Explains the signs that come and go
That you may be sure you will meet
With your Lord *when the time's complete*.

3 And He it is who spread the earth
And made in it mountains in girth
And rivers. He's made in it two
Kinds of all fruits come in pairs' view,
And makes the night enshroud the day.
In this there are signs come in sway
For a folk who reflect *and pray*.

4 On earth are parcels side by side,
And gardens of vines to abide,
And corn fields, palm trees with one root
And others having many's suit,
Though watered by one and the same.
Yet some We make of greater fame

Than others in their fruits for game.
 In this are signs for folk who know
 And understand the way to go.
 5 If you would wonder, wonder then
 At wondrous sayings among men.
 "What! When we are dust shall we rise
 In a new creation's disguise?"
 Such as these disbelieve their Lord,
 And they'll have shackles for reward
 About their necks. And they're the men
 Of the fire to abide again.
 6 They tell you to bring on the test
 Before the good, and they invest
 In punishments to teach them best.
 Your Lord's a Lord forgiving folk
 Despite their injustice in stroke.
 Your Lord's requital's heavy yoke.
 7 Those who do not believe then say
 "Why has no sign been sent this way
 To him from his Lord in His sway?"
 You are a warner and a guide
 To every people, every side.

Beloved, I hear You bleating of the fire
 And how men chained must enter in Your
 ire.

I do not doubt the fact. But I say this:
 I hear of Your forgiveness and Your bliss.
 The single ordination Baptists preach
 Is that You ordain bliss to all who reach,
 But never ordain any into hell.
 That is their own invention and their spell.
 Beloved, the round of human doctrines
 goes

Beyond the meadows where my footsteps
 chose

A way to whirl beneath Your sun and stars,
 Hand lifted to the mediation's bars
 Of blessing from Your throne and divine
 ways

Until the earth is filled up with Your praise.

8 God knows what every female bears,
 And what the wombs reject of wares,
 And what they increase *on the stairs*,
 And all is measured *in His fairs*.

9 The knower of unseen and seen,
 The great, the most high *there has been*.

10 It's the same among you of those
 Who hide their speech or show their woes,
 And the one who hides in the night

And goes out by day *in the light*.

11 For him there are those following
 Each other, some at the back wing
 And others in the front to guard
 Him by God's commandment as starred.
 God does not change the rate of folk
 Until they change what's in their stoke.
 When God wills punishment to one
 Folk, there's no way to keep undone,
 There's no protector but the One.
 12 It's He who shows the lightning's flash
 In fear and hope and with a crash,
 And He who makes the clouds to lash.
 13 The thunder with His praise comes
 down

To glorify Him in the town.
 He sends the thunderbolts and strikes
 With them the ones He wills and likes,
 And still they dispute about God,
 While He is mighty on the sod.
 14 To Him is true prayer only due.
 Those to whom they pray besides view
 Of Him do not give answer true
 To them, but are like one who stretches
 His two hands to water that fetches
 To his mouth, but it will not reach.
 The prayer of infidels and screech
 Is just an empty way to preach.
 15 To God all that's in heaven and earth
 Prostrates, either by willing berth
 Or so compelled. So do their shades
 In shadow at morn and eve's *glades*.

I look about me to see how all things
 Prostrate themselves, the little things with
 wings,
 And tiny-footed creatures without stings
 Or with that fond protection's followings,
 The grass before the harbour, and the sprig
 Of meadowrue, and every birchen twig.
 Indeed the prophet's right, all creatures bow
 Before the divine throne and pray
 somehow.

It's only I who turn my eye to get
 More than I need to eat and wait to fret
 For wealth and wonder, when I might
 instead
 Bow after the example of those spread
 About my feet and shoulders as they're led.
 Your worship fills the hours of all I've met.

16 Say "Who is the Lord of the skies
 And of the earth to come in guise?"
 Say "God." Say "What! Do you then take
 Besides Him guardians in wake
 Who have no profit nor do harm
 To themselves *with halter or arm?*"
 Say "Are blind and seeing alike?
 Can darkness and light the same strike?"
 Have they made God some partners who
 Create created things in view
 Like what He's created that sets
 Them in confusion in their nets?"
 Say "God's Creator of all things,
 He's One, all-mighty prevailings."
 17 He sends down water from the sky
 Then valleys flow in measured vie,
 The torrent bears the swelling foam,
 And from that what they melt in loam
 Of fire for the sake of both jewels
 And instruments comes up in schools
 A scum like it. So God compares
 The truth with what the falsehood wears.
 Then as for scum, it goes away
 As worthless on that very day.
 And as for what profits the crew,
 It remains on the earth in view.
 So God set parables in view.
 18 For those who answer their Lord's call
 There is the good, and those in stall
 Who do not answer Him, if all
 That's in earth and its like were theirs,
 They'd give in ransom for their shares,
 For them shall terrible account
 Be made in their hell to amount.
 And what a wretched resting place
 It will be everywhere in trace.

Though many die each year, Beloved,
 among
 The thunderbolts and lightning flashes
 strung,
 I cannot fear the storm when the storms
 sung.
 I have not feared the storm since I was
 young.
 The lovely lights that blinds the universe
 Turn radiant for an instant darkened curse
 And shows the world a beauty beyond all
 That calm days have in store and in the
 stall.
 Beloved, let thunder toss my soul above

And bounce my life across Your strings of
 love
 Until the storm is over and content,
 And I come out and wonder where You
 went.

The sill is wet with rain the panes prevent
 The freshness of the day. I leave my spent.

19 Is the one who knows what's been sent
 Down to you from your Lord that went
 In truth, like one who's blind *and spent?*
 Only those who have understanding
 Can bear in mind these things
 commanding.

20 Those who fulfil God's covenant
 As they have sworn and do not slant
 Away from their pledge and their grant,
 21 And those who foster what God's set,
 Fear their Lord and dread what's to come
 In terrible reckoning's sum.
 22 And those who're patient seeking what
 Is pleasing to their Lord, and shut
 Themselves in prayer and spend of what
 We have provided them both in
 Secret and openly in bin,
 Deflecting evil without sin,
 For these is the achievement where
 They shall *eternally* dwell there.

23 The garden of eternal bliss
 Which they will enter there to kiss
 The righteous among parents, spouses,
 And their offspring of their own houses,
 And angels shall come in to them
 From every gate and every gem.

24 "Peace be to you because that you
 Persevered in patience in pew.

How excellent is what comes on
 The dwelling place ever of dawn."

25 And those who break the covenant
 With God after it's pledged to grant,
 And cut through what God's ordered to
 Be joined and make mischief undue
 In the land, they and theirs shall be
 The curse and theirs the destiny
 Of terrible abode in fee.

26 God broadens the substand for whom
 He wills and straitens it in doom.
 And they rejoice in this world's life.
 And nothing is this world's life's strife
 Compared to the hereafter but
 Some temporary games unshut.

Beloved, give me all that You have to give,
And let me die or then else let me live.
Give me abode of hell, if that's the way
That I must go among the men who stray.
Give me abode of bliss, not for a day,
But for eternal pleasures in Your way.
Give me, Beloved, what You have for my
own,

And let my life or death before Your throne
Be to the glory of You, God, alone.
I see the covenants and hear the tone
Of recitation in the mosque and moan
Of Jewish synagogue, the Christian song.
I see and hear, and know that I belong
To You alone and not the rising throng.

27 Those who do not believe may say
"Why's no sign sent to him today
From his Lord?" Answer, "God's let stray
Whomever He wills and He guides
To Himself whomever besides
Turns to Him *from the heathen rides*."

28 Those who believe and so have set
Their hearts at rest by Allah met
In service of remembrance sway,
Indeed by God's remembrance way
Are hearts set at rest *day by day*.

29 Those who believe and do the good,
A great bliss shall be under hood
To them and fine place where they stood.

30 So We sent you to a folk then
Before whom other nations' men
Have passed away, so you'd recite
To them what We have brought to light
To them while they deny *in sight*
The One Beneficent *and right*.

Say "He's my Lord, there is no god
But He. On Him and on His rod
I do rely, to Him return."

31 If there were a Qur'an by which
The mountains could be made to pitch,
Or earth split in two by it or
The dead made to recite its store,
No, the command is wholly God's.
What! Have not those upon the sods
Who do believe yet known that if
God wills He could guide all the stiff?
And those who disbelieve, it will
Not cease to strike them to the fill
For what they do, a torment still,

Or it will land beside their place
Until God's promise come in trace:
God does not fail promises stern.

The service of remembrance comes each
week

As Sabbath day draws on to give a peek
Of heaven's delights and the eternity
That penetrates the times that we here see.
That moment and that day remain
throughout

The coming week to bless my soul in doubt
And show the times and ways of
blessedness

Among the free who rise up to confess
That You are one alone, the divine Friend,
The Saviour and Creator to the end.
Beloved, I pause and speak the recitation
Of the sweet words recited to each nation
In the books of Your given revelation
And find rest for my heart before Your
station.

32 They scoffed at messengers who came
Before you, but I gave the same
Respite to those who disbelieved,
And then I seized them unreprieved.
How then was My requital heaved?

33 What! Is He then who stands above
Every soul in what's done *in love*?
Yet they ascribe to God and join
To Him the partners of their coin.
Say "Name them." Do you think to show
To Him something He does not know
In the earth, or is it just stow
Of words? No, but what they invent
Seems justified in what they meant
To those who disbelieve, and they
Are kept back so from the right way.
For whom He leaves to go astray
There shall be no guide *night or day*.

34 For them there's torment in the life
Of this world and surely the strife
Of torment in the one to come
Is more in pain and grief in sum,
And for them there shall never be
Protector from God's *enmity*.

35 The likeness of the garden set
In promise the righteous will get
Is that there flow beneath it there
Streams, and its fruits are ever fair

And so its shade. This is reward
Of those who guard against the sword
Of wickedness, while punishment
Of disbelievers is fire sent.
36 And those to whom We've given the
book

Rejoice in what We've sent to look
For you and of the families
Are some who deny parts to please.
Say "I'm commanded I should serve
Just God. And I will never swerve
To join any other with Him.
To Him I give the call undim,
And to Him's my return *from grim*."
37 So We've sent its authority
In the fair tongue of Araby.
And if you follow their desires
After what's come to you like fires
Of knowledge, there shall never be
For you besides Allah any
Guardian or protector from spree.

Beloved, since nonage I have read Your
Word
In Hebrew and in Greek, the tongues I
stirred
With teacher and with friend under
unblurred
Days joyful and fulfilling as occurred.
I did not know the Arabic until
I'd passed the prime of going on the hill
To look out on Your world and blush for
shame
That You had made such an abundant
game.
And now I find, Beloved, the revelation
Is not done with that book so named in
station,
But brings account to Jew and Christian
still,
The one to take Messiah by Your will
The other not to make gods multiplied.
The Arabic comes out to take a side.

38 We sent apostles before you
And gave them wives and spawn in crew,
And it's not for a messenger
To bring or make a sign occur,
But by Allah's permission sure.
For every age a book will stir.
39 God does erase whatever He

Wills and confirms similarly,
And with Him's the source of the book.
40 We'll either let you take a look
At part of what We promised them
Or take to Ourselves your soul's gem,
For your job's just to bring the word
And on us to call them when stirred.
41 Do they not see that We come to
Their land and reduce borders' view?
God will pronounce a judgement too.
There's no reversing His command,
And He is swift to take in hand.
42 Those before them contrived their plans
But God's is all the planning's scans,
He knows what every soul has earned,
And soon the disbelievers spurned
Will know for whom the lasting home
Will be prepared after they roam.
43 Those who do not believe may say
"You are no messenger in sway."
Say "God is witness and enough
Between me and you and one tough
At knowing of the book's relay.

A book in every age, the sentence runs
And makes me think that in the writings'
tonnes
The Arabs held perhaps in great regard
All writing just for writing in the yard.
It was not like today, when every hand
Can punch the keys and make the ether
stand
In full and cipherment. It took some more
In former centuries to hit the score
And learn to read and write and keep the
store.
And yet I do have faith that You provided
A book and were not One to be one-sided.
Some disappeared and others were
corrupted,
But Your salvation's never interrupted.
The books may lie unread beneath the gore.

Surah 14 Ibrahim, or Abraham

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
1 Alif. Lam. Ra.
A Book which We've revealed to you,
So you may lead humankind true
Out of the depths of darkness to
The light by their Lord's bidding to,
To the way of Exalted One

Worthy of all praise *when begun*.

2 God's is all in the heavens and earth,
Woe to the disbelievers berth.

3 Those who love the life of this world
More than the coming life unfurled,
And hinder folk from path of God,
And make that path crooked to plod,
These are in error far from rod.

4 We never sent a messenger
Except in the folk's tongue to stir,
So he might clearly bring to light
To them the things We have in sight.
Then God lets stray the ones He will
And He guides those that fit the bill,
And He's the mighty, wise One still.

5 Indeed We sent Moses with signs
Of Ours to say "Lead out the lines
Of your folk from darkness to light
And remind them of God's days' sight.
In this are signs for those who stay
Patient and grateful on the way.

6 And when Moses said to his folk:
"Remember now God's favoured stroke
To you when He delivered you
From Pharaoh's folk afflicting you
With dreadful torment, and were slaying
Your sons and sparing girls for paying,
And in this was a great trial from
Your Lord *as any trial come*."

That one great and mighty miracle taught
One time in history has always bought
Hope for the oppressed since that day, and
yet

You hardly ever reach that high tide met.
The most of men are slaves from birth to
death

Despite Your giving them each moment's
breath,
And women even more in thralldom's net
Require a freedom beyond that they've
sought.

Beloved, I take the Exodus in hand
And meditate upon it as You planned
From day to day, at least in Your
command,

And like the millions more who draw their
hope

From that faint, far-off history's thin rope
Arise to meet the day upon the land.

7 And when your Lord declared it so:

"If you are grateful I will show
Increase to you, but if you are
Ungrateful, then My painful bar
Will be a harsh one where you are."

8 And Moses said "If you remain
Such grateful ones, you stand to gain
With those on earth, and all of you:
God's self-sufficient, praised by crew."

9 What! Did you not hear what became
Of those before you, of the claim
And folk of Noah, and Ad and
Thamud, and those come in the land
After them? None knows them but God.
Their messengers came to them by
Clear signs but they put hands up by
Their mouths and said "We disbelieve
What you were sent with to receive,
And doubt what you ask to achieve,
A matter troublesome to grieve."

10 Their messengers say "What! Of God
Is there doubt at all on the sod,
Who's origin of heaven and earth?
He calls you to forgiveness and
A time of respite in the land!"
They said "You are just men like us,
You just want to turn us in fuss
Away from what ancestors held.
So bring some authority spelled."

11 Their messengers then said to them:
"We are men just like you, but God
Bestows His favours and His rod
On those He wills of servants' prod.
It's not our duty to bring you
Authority unless on cue
From God Himself. On God alone
Should the believers trust *in stone*.

12 "And what reason then can there be
That we should not trust God's decree?
He's guided us into our ways,
We will endure your hurtful craze,
On God should one rely who prays."

The call for scientific proof that You
Are sovereign and demand the human crew
Should toe the line is only an excuse
To keep on engaging in some abuse.
The scientific proof does not prove all,
But only the experimental ball.
The right and wrong are well enough for all
To see and hear in or outside the hall.

Beloved, I do not need proof You exist,
I do not need to know what I have missed,
But I have heard the word of what is right
And what is wrong in heaven and earthly
sight

And see that many do not understand
The clear word that You show me on the
land.

13 The disbelievers said to their
Apostles, "We'll drive you from share
In our land if you don't return
To our religion and to learn."

And so their Lord revealed to them,
"We'll surely destroy unjust hem.

14 "We'll settle you then in the land
After them. This is for the band
Who fear My presence in command
And fear My wrath on every hand."

15 They turned for help and every one
Of insolent, rebellious gun
Was disappointed in the run.

16 Behind him's hell and he shall drink
What's given him, waters that stink.

17 He'll drink it sip by sip and stay
With difficulty to swallow it,
And death shall arrive in his way
From every side, and still not slit
Him, but it shall remain behind
Him in a punishment consigned.

18 The disbelievers in their Lord,
Their likeness is so: their deeds stored
Are like the ash blown by the wind
On day of storm. For what they've sinned
They'll not have any hold on what
They've earned, this is conclusion shut.

19 Don't you see that God has created
The heavens and the earth related
In truth? If He wills He will take
You away and bring in your wake
A new creation and a stake.

20 For God this is not hard to break.

21 And they shall come up from the graves
Before God all together slaves,
Then the weak shall say to those who
Were arrogant, "We were your crew,
Now can you take away from us
Any of the chastisement's fuss
From God?" Then they will say "If God
Had guided us then in our pod,
Then we would have guided you too.

It doesn't matter now if we
Implore our Lord impatiently
Or await our pain quietly,
There's no escaping His decree."

At least I am not among those distressed
To find themselves impatiently addressed
For having led astray. I am alone
And preach to fin and scale, not flesh and
bone,

And to the magpie and at times the lark.
I preach and teach a teeming fauna's park.
But no man can say I have led astray,
Since no one here believes a word I say.
Beloved, I am not planted with the weak
Who follow humankind in what they seek,
But test Your Word alone and take a peek
At what You say, forgetting steeple leak.
Two groups in hell I have avoided well,
But without Your grace I'll fail of the spell.

22 Satan will say after the matter
Has been decided, "It was fatter
What God promised you of the truth
Than what I promised without ruth
And failed to do of what I said.
And I had no power when I led
You but that I called and you came.
So don't blame me, but when you blame
Blame just yourselves. I can't help you
Now nor can you help me in crew.
Beforetime I did not believe
In your joining me to God's sleeve.
Truly for the unjust shall be
A punishment come painfully."
23 And those who believe and do well
Will be admitted *for a spell*
Into gardens beneath which flow
Streams to abide in them not slow
By the leave of their Lord, their greeting
There will be "Salaam", peace, when
meeting.

24 Do you not see how God sets out
A parable? Word without doubt
Of a good tree, whose root is fixed
Firm and its branches to not nixed
As far as the sky round about.
25 It yields its fruit in every time
By the permission given in clime
By its Lord. And God sets in view
Such parables for people's crew

That they may reflect on the due.
26 And the parable of a word
Of evil is the one that's heard
Of evil tree, rooted upon
The surface of the earth outdrawn,
It has no firmness in the dawn.
27 God sets those who believe with firm
Word in the life of this world's perm,
And in the day to come, and God
Leaves the unjust ones here to plod
In wandering, and so God does
Whatever He pleases to buzz.

The two trees in the garden whereby You
Saw Eve and Adam depart from the true,
The two trees in the Revelation too,
And the two trees in Matthew's judgement
seat
All bring to mind the parable that's meet.
Lay axe to root, Beloved, or let me grow
Above the fossil waters that here flow
Through the salt desert of the life I know,
And I shall find the way of praise to go.
Or else among the unjust that I find
Go wandering on the tundra birchen-lined,
Until the day sinks into winter night,
And I find darkness fills the earthen plight.
Take two trees for a parable and write.

28 Have you not seen those who exchanged
God's bounties for ungrateful ranged
And sent their people down estranged
Into perdition's dwelling granged?
29 Hell! They shall enter into it.
An evil place to stay, unfit.
30 They set up equals to God so
They might lead people then to go
Astray from His path into woe.
Say "Enjoy while you can, for soon
You'll return to the fire for boon."
31 Say to My servants who believe
That they should set prayer and retrieve
For charity what they must spend,
Both secret and the open kenned,
Out of what We have given them,
Before the day comes in the hem
When there shall be no bargaining
Nor helping each other on wing.
32 God's the One who made heaven and
earth,
Send water from the heavens on dearth,

And brought forth from it things of worth
In sustenance for you, and took from berth
Ships of the sea by His command,
Laid rivers calm beneath your hand.
33 He's subdued for you sun and moon
In their runs and brought down as soon
For you the day and night in boon.
34 He gives you all things that you ask,
And if you count up in your task
His bounties you'll not have in mask
Numbers enough to count the cask.

Beloved, there are more numbers than we
need
To count the stars as far as human greed
And curiosity would take the lead.
And would You have us know that what
You give
Of sweetnesses that humans need to live
Goes far beyond the numbers in our store,
When everything we count can take one
more?
That's more than my mind ever wants to
heed.
Beloved, the ships are vast, I do agree,
And they are great for moving Your
bounty,
And rivers still take on the stores of grain
And bring them to the people at the main.
We've yet to see the sun and moon submit
To human hand here where we pine and sit.

35 When Abraham said "O my Lord,
Make this city secured and floored,
And keep me and my children too
From worship of idols in crew.
36 "My Lord, they have led many folk
Astray, so all those in my yoke
Are surely with me, and the one
To disobey me, You have done
To be oft-forgiving and the most
Merciful of *all those who boast*.
37 "O our Lord, I have made to stay
Some of my offspring in the way
Of wilderness not to be tilled
Near Your holy house where they milled,
So they may there establish prayer.
So make the hearts of some folk there
Yearn to them and provide their share
Of fruits so they may thank in prayer.
38 "O our Lord, You know what we hide

And what we bring to light to bide,
And nothing's hidden now from God,
Of anything upon the sod,
Of anything in heaven's pod.

39 "Praise is God's Who has granted me
In old age Ishmael and the wee
Isaac. My Lord hear's faithfully.

40 "O my Lord, let me set up prayer
And also from my offspring there
O our Lord accept now my prayer.

41 "O our Lord, forgive me and my
Parents and the believers nigh
On the day when the reckoning
Shall be established on the wing."

Though I am not a parent then or bold
Of Abraham, I'm not thrust out in cold
Despite the climate all around my house
Among the pines and firs and cuddled
grouse.

Though I'm no parent of Abram of old,
I'm not cast on the trashpile of the sold,
But among the believers can find share
Despite the doubting customs, oh beware.
For Abraham, Beloved, prayed once for me
When he prayed for believers by the tree
Of revelation there in Canaan's land.
He prayed for those who come to stand
Beside Your house, Beloved, and so I know
That Abraham's prayer stands for me to
show.

35 *And when said Abraham "My Lord!
Make this city secure from sword,
And preserve me and my sons from
Worshipping idols, beating drum.*

36 *"My Lord! Truly they've led astray
Many among humankind's sway,
So whoever follows me he
Is for obedience of me,
And whoever me disobeys,
But You're forgiving in Your ways,
Most merciful eternally.*

37 *"Our Lord! I have made some of mine
Offspring to live and by design
In a valley unarable,
Near to Your holy house in full,
Our Lord, that they may there set up
Prayer, to make some men's hearts fill up
With yearning for them, and provide
Them fruits, gratefully satisfied.*

38 *"Our Lord! Truly You know what we
Conceal and what we show freely:
For nothing from God is to hide,
Whether on earth or heaven wide.*

39 *"Praise is God's, Who has granted me
Ismail and Isaac in old age:
Because truly my Lord is He,
Who hears prayer in my pilgrimage!*

40 *"O my Lord! Make me one who sets
Up prayer, also of angelets
Among my offspring, O our Lord!
And accept my prayer for reward.*

41 *"Our Lord! Forgive me, and my
parents,
And the believers with forbearance,
On the day that the reckoning
Will become an established thing!"*

Among the sons of Isaac and Ismail,
There have been many who have lived a
while

Upon the Meccan sands, and some have set
Their prayers there daily, nightly, and have
met

You face to face. All prayers are answered
here,

Some in Your grace, and some at last in
fear.

Who have no land to till have time to pray
As they look out upon the burning way
Towards the inner desert, or beyond,
Towards the Red Sea where the lifted wand
Brought answers once again to Abram's
prayer,

Who thanked You for the sons of old age
care.

Beloved, as I look forward to the age
Of Abram, let prayer my thirst too assuage.

42 Don't think that God does not take note
Of what the unjust does to dote.

He's only waiting to surprise
Them on the day He opens eyes,

43 They'll flee in fear, their heads up high,
Their eyes not telling them the why,
Their heart empty as they go by.

44 Warn the folk of the day to come
When punishment comes on the hum,
The those who did unjustly say
"O our Lord, give us just some play
Of brief time to answer Your way

And follow the apostles' sway.”
 What! Did you not swear in times past
 That you will not fall down at last,
 45 And you dwelt in abodes of those
 Who did unjustly in their rows,
 And it was made clear to you then
 How We had dealt with all such men,
 And set out examples of when.
 46 And so they did devise their plots
 But all was in God's view in slots,
 Even when their plot shook the earth
 To move up mountains from their berth.
 47 And do not think that God will fail
 His promise to apostles hale,
 God's mighty in vengeance to pale.
 48 On the day when the earth shall be
 Changed into a new earth to see,
 And the skies and shall be come out
 All to God the One and the stout.
 49 You'll see the guilty on that day
 Bound together in their chains' sway,
 50 Clothed in pitch, faces in fire's pay.
 51 So God may recompense each soul
 With what it's earned, God's swift in toll
 Of reckoning *the wicked goal*.
 52 This is a clear message for man,
 That they might be warned by its scan,
 That they might know He's God with plan,
 One, and that men who understand
 Might mind *the outcome of His hand*.

I've seen the mountains moved for coal and
 gas,
 And all removed before the lad and lass
 Grew up and moved to West Virginia's pass
 When eastern Kentucky turned a morass.
 And yet the generations come along,
 And those who perpetrated all the wrong
 Go peacefully into the grave until
 Some company comes to dig their grave's
 hill.
 I see Muhammad promised long ago
 That such men as move mountains in their
 show
 Will meet their doom. So I await the day
 And hope to see the light where the ghosts
 play
 And sing their songs and beat their drums
 and sway
 Along the edge of melodies that stay.

Surah 15 Al-Hijr, or The Rocky Tract

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 A. L. R.

1 These are the signs of revelation,
 Of a reciting giving ration
 Of things clear *to the folk and nation*.

The Psalms make clear the hidden thought
 unveiled

In Moses' book, and then themselves are
 paled

By those bright streams of revelation in
 Christ's gospel. Now at last above the din
 Of speculation, recitation makes
 Things clear at once for earth's and
 heaven's sakes.

These are the miracles of revelation
 Set forth for every kindred, tongue and
 nation,

A clear Qur'an from A to R and back,
 In which pure guidance to You does not
 lack,

Until the moment when all word and sound
 Are called back to the One who sent them
 round,

And Your great love speaks only in the
 bare

And desert silence of the passing air.

2 Often shall unbelievers wish
 They'd eaten from submitters' dish.

3 Leave them, so they can eat and joy
 Beguiled by the hope they employ,
 For soon they shall know *the hellish*.

4 We did not destroy any town
 Without its fixed term running down.

5 No folk can hasten on their doom
 Nor can they avoid it *in bloom*.

6 They say "O you on whom came down
 The reminder, one of renown,
 You're out of your mind *with your frown*."

7 Why don't you make an angel come
 Against us if truth is your sum?"

8 We do not send the angels down
 Except with truth, and so their town
 Would not have respite for renown.

9 We've sent down the reminder, so
 In guarding it We'll not be slow.

10 And We sent messengers before
 You among the people of yore.

11 And no apostle came to them

But that they mocked him in their hem.
12 Just so We make it come too through
The hearts of guilty ones in view,
13 So they do not believe the true,
And so already's gone before
Example of the folk of yore.
14 Even if We should open wide
A gate of heaven by their side
So they might ascend there to bide,
15 They'd only say "Our eyes deceive
Us as by a strong drink's reprieve,
Or we're bewitched as we perceive."

It is an academic doubt, no doubt,
To say with an appeal if not a shout,
That eyes deceive and limitations set
Bewitchment on the things humans have
met.

One cannot know in certainty indeed
As long as human perceptions of speed
Are limited by physical in rote,
The touch, the sight, the smell, the hearing
note,

The taste upon the tongue of what You
wrote.

And yet the taste bears well, though all else
fail,

As Psalmist calls to taste and so not fail
To know that You, Beloved, are good, and
so

The while of sacrifice and life not slow
Shall not pail in the coming dawn and
glow.

16 Indeed We've made come in the skies
The constellations in their guise,
And made them beautiful for wise,
17 And kept them from all adversary,
18 Except for one who steals a chary
Sound, he's followed by flame seen scary.
19 The earth We've thrown down and cast
on

It mountains and cause them to spawn
All growing things in measure drawn.

20 And We have made for you in it
Means to sustain you and keep fit,
And for the ones that you do not
Sustain among the creatures' lot.

21 There's nothing but with Us is its
Abundance, and by starts and fits
We send it where it's known and sits.

22 We send the wind to fertilize,
We send down water from the skies,
And so We give you it to drink,
You are not its keepers in link.
23 We only bring life and bring death,
And We're the heir of all in breath.
24 We know those who long to be first
Among you, and We know who durst
Not come to the fore *for the worst*.
25 Your Lord will gather them at last,
He is all-wise, knows all the cast.

Fact is that men today store up the flood
In cisterns and in reservoirs of mud,
Nor was control of water then unknown
In happy Araby, where all things grown
Delighted eye and heart before destruction
Of irrigation and its interruption.
Perhaps that's what You meant, Beloved, to
note

In what the good Muhammad came and
wrote.

Beloved, I wait for water falling down
From the sky to sprinkle both farm and
town

Around me, and my flowers where they
bloom,

About the springing well and little room.
If rain does not come, then my field is dry
Except for what I come with pails to ply.

26 Indeed We created the man
Of clay that gives a sound in span,
Of black mud moulded in the pan.

27 The jinn We have created too,
But of the hottest fire in view.

28 Mind when your Lord said to the crew
Of angels, "I create the man
Of the essence of the black span
Of mud and fashioned in the pan."

By Torah I'd have thought the man you
made

Was red, since Adam is a name so played
With red in Edom and Your stock in trade.
But the Qur'an is clear in saying that
The man was made of black mud pitty-pat,
And so I acquiesce in tit for tat.

What sure is that the first man was not
white,

It would have frightened jinn at the first sight.

Beloved, the human heart is darkened too,
Because it is so interested in view
Of race and colour of the skin that grew.
Let me look past the outward and the in
And know that all are caught in wicked sin,
But You are gracious and You come to win.

29 So when I complete him and breathe
Into him My spirit to wreathe,
Fall down prostrating *as you can*.
30 So all the angels did prostrate
Themselves to him in his estate.
31 Except Iblis, that one refused
To be with those who *unabused*
Prostrated themselves *as accused*.
32 He said "O Iblis, what keeps you
From joining the prostrating crew?"
33 He said "I'm not one to prostrate
In obeisance to man in state,
For You created him in rate
Of black mud in the pan of late."

Satan's the first racist to grace the earth
With presence of his hellish sort of worth.
He failed to bow to Adam because he
Was black and not deserving of glory.
How many follow Satan in his way
Of racist compromise with heathen sway,
While humble servants of God know and pray,
And wait the rising of eternal day.
Beloved, I curse the word of Satan still,
I hate the way his worship comes to fill
The church and synagogue and mosque on hill
With racist action despite rhetoric.
I see the seed that started all the trick
Of sin upon the earth and heretic.

34 He said "Then get out, you are one
Cast out and cursed for what you've done.
35 "And truly on you lies the curse
Till Judgement Day shall do its worse."
36 He said "My Lord, give me respite
Till the day they are raised in light."
37 He said "Indeed you are among
Those with respite, *so I have sung*.
38 "Till the day of known time is rung."

39 He said "My Lord, because You've left
Me wandering *as one bereft*,
I'll surely decorate the path
Of error to them for Your wrath,
And cause them all to stray *to Gath*,
40 "Except the elect slaves that You
Have freed *from my plot's cockadoo*."
41 He said "This is right way to Me.
42 "On My slaves no authority
Is yours, but only on the one
Who follows you in what you've done
In deviation's wicked run.
43 "And Hell is surely the abode
Promised to all that crew and load.
44 "To it are seven Gates: For each
Of those Gates is a place to teach
The class assigned for them in reach."

To hell are seven gates, but into Paradise
Are twelve gates opened, free and without price.
Three gates in each of four enjewelled walls
That welcome in the willing as One calls.
To Paradise are seven leagues and time
Yet every soul is ready at the climb.
The robin burns his breast at every gate
That leads to hell where many people wait
And hope that bird will quench the fires of hell.
You have, Belovèd, in that bird done well.
As I extinguish hell in my own heart
I drink the robin's nectar for my part
Until there is no room in me at all
For anything but heaven and Your call.

45 The pious shall come to remain
In midst of gardens under claim
Of fountains *pure and without blame*.
46 "Come in in peace and safety's frame.
47 "We'll root out rancour from their hearts,
As brothers dignified in arts
To sit on couches opposite.
48 "No weariness shall make unfit,
Nor shall they be cast out of it."
49 Proclaim to My servants that I
Am most forgiving and am nigh
With mercy on earth 'neath the sky,
50 And that My chastisement shall be
Chastisement grievous as can be.

51 Inform them of Abraham's guests.
 52 When they came to him as in tests,
 And said "Salaamun!" then he said
 "We feel afraid of you instead."
 53 They said "Don't be afraid of us!
 We bring you good news without fuss
 Of a son wise and fabulous."
 54 He said "Do you bring me such news
 When old age has touched me with dew,
 Of what then do you bring me news?"
 55 They said "We bring you good news
 true,
 So don't be of despairing crew."
 56 He said "Who here comes to despair
 Of the mercy of his Lord's share
 But those who are astray in care?"
 57 He said "What is your business then,
 O messengers of God to men?"
 58 They said "Indeed we have been sent
 To a folk guilty, a folk spent,
 59 "Except the family of Lot.
 We'll save that family in the plot
 60 "Except his wife. We're certain she
 Will be among remaining scree."

Qur'an avoids the term angel of YHWH
 And speaks just of the messengers in view
 Without the trick theology may do.
 I've heard the Christian say the Trinity
 Came down to Abraham and then made
 free
 To eat his goat and taste his butter too
 Despite rabbinical in what to brew.
 The Bible text is filled to disagree.
 Beloved, the Qur'an makes the tale go free
 Of questionings and shows the great mercy
 Alone in news of offspring and the wrath
 That You determined on the evil path.
 Qur'an ties up loose ends the Bible leaves,
 Or else turns round the questions with
 reprieves.

61 So when the messenger came to
 The family of Lot and crew,
 62 He said "You're truly folk unknown"
 63 They said "No, we come to you shown
 With what they have been doubting hone.
 64 "And we come to you with the truth,
 We certainly do so with ruth."
 65 Go out with your band in the night
 And follow after them in sight,

And let not any of you turn
 Back, go out as you came to learn.
 66 We showed him Our decree: their roots
 Should be cut off in morning's suits.
 67 The people of the town came out
 Rejoicing with a song and shout.
 68 He said "These are my guests, and so
 Do not disgrace me with your show.
 69 "Fear God and put me not to shame."
 70 They said "Have we not come in aim
 To forbid you to try to claim
 For other people to our blame?"
 71 He said "Here are daughters of mine
 If you want marriages in line."
 72 And by your life, surely were they
 In their intoxication's sway,
 Wandering in a bewildered way.
 73 So the blast took them come the dawn.
 74 We turned it upside down and drawn
 And rained down baked clay stones upon
 Them, 75 truly in this there are signs
 For those who scan with heedful lines.
 76 It's on a way with clear designs.
 77 In this there is a sign for those
 Who are believers in their rows.
 78 The dwellers of Sodom too were
 Among the unjust ones, it's sure.
 79 We poured vengeance on them and they
 Were both on an open highway.

Your messengers to Sodom took their way
 Across a path of violent dismay
 And saw depraved men from the shadows
 flock
 Toward the victim of their trade in stock.
 Your messengers knew from the time they
 took
 Their steps towards the town what
 treasured nook
 Of flame would meet the welcomers who
 look
 To strangers for a treat combined with
 hook.
 Beloved, the days have little changed, I
 trow,
 Behind the smiles a crook bides anyhow,
 And those who can't avoid the claw must
 bow
 Beneath the harrow. This You do allow
 Until the day of clay in stone to fall
 Upon the fevered, unsuspecting hall.

80 Inhabitants of the rock tried
 The messengers and so denied.
 81 And We brought out Our signs, but they
 Ignored them and they turned away,
 82 They carved homes in the
 mountainsides
 Thinking security abides.
 83 So the blast seized them at the dawn.
 84 Their wealth they depended upon
 Could not deliver them *and spawn*.
 85 We did not make the skies and earth
 But by the truth *that gave them birth*,
 And truly the time comes apace
 So pardon with forgiveness' grace.
 86 Your Lord, He is the great Creator,
 He knows all *things*, *He's the instater*.
 87 Indeed We've given you the seven
 Oft-repeated verses, the heaven
 Sent and the *noble*, great Qur'an.
 88 Don't strain your eyes at what We've
 drawn
 With some of them pairs in their crew
 To be enjoying, don't in pew
 Grieve for them, but let down your wing
 For the believers providing,
 89 And say "I am an open warner."
 90 So We did send down upon scorner
 Fold who fostered divisions' corner.
 91 Those judged the Qur'an into parts.
 92 So, by your Lord, We'd take such arts
 Into examination's carts,
 93 As to what they did in their starts.
 94 So proclaim openly what you
 Are bidden to, and turn from view
 Of polytheists *and such crew*.
 95 We are sufficient then for you
 Against the scoffers *in the pew*,
 96 Those who set up with God another
 Shall soon know clearly not to smother.
 97 Indeed We know your breast goes strait
 To hear wicked things they relate.
 98 But celebrate your own Lord's praise
 And be of those who all their days
 Prostrate themselves down in their ways,
 99 And worship then your Lord until
 There comes to you the certain fill.

Let me but celebrate, Beloved, Your praise
 Despite the scoffers and the crowds in
 craze

Before the oecumenic, pagan lays,
 If only by a slender voice and frail,
 Let me speak in my heart if not in gale
 Of wind and rush of Pentacostal fervour.
 Let me be Yours if only a time-server.
 Beloved, I come before Muhammad's wing
 And flee the Evangelical's last sting,
 And find there's ample room where few
 resort,
 The refugees of faith, business and sport.
 Let me not separate the Qur'an's word
 Into the abrogated and absurd,
 And the still validated by the herd.

Surah 16 An-Nahl, or The Bee

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 Allah's is the sovereign command.
 Do not then try to quicken stand,
 Glory to Him, He's far above
 Having partners they try to shove.
 2 He sends down angels with the spirit
 By His own decree not to fear it
 On whomsoever He may will
 Of His servants saying in fill,
 "Warn that there is no god but I,
 And so fear me *beneath the sky*."
 3 He created the heavens and earth
 With the truth. He is high in worth
 Above what they associate
 With Him *in His exalted state*.
 4 He created man from a drop
 Of semen and see he'll not stop
 Disputing *about every prop*.

I too have noticed, my Beloved, that men
 Made of mere semen argue in their den
 Of darkness and of flickering firelight
 About the attributes of divine right.
 Though You create all things and in Your
 worth
 Exalt Yourself above both sun and earth
 And take the moon or not beneath Your
 berth,
 You are not so great that You rise to make
 A disputation like we humans take.
 The one says You are three instead of one,
 The other says that Jesus is Your son
 And therefore as divine as You can be.
 Another claims though You are one not
 three,
 That You're defined by our philosophy.

5 The cattle too He made for you,
 To warm you and benefit too,
 And for your sustenance in view.
 6 For you they seem good when you drive
 Them back and forth, and so they thrive.
 7 They bear your burdens to the lands
 You could not reach without their hands,
 Except by distress in your bands,
 Your Lord's of pity, mercy's strands.
 8 He made horse, mule and donkeys too
 So you might ride on them and view
 Their beauty in adornment too,
 Creating more than what you knew.
 9 On God rests guidance to the way
 Of righteousness, though some men stray,
 And if He wills He'll certainly
 Guide you all right and faithfully.

Proof that those many who lay a strong
 claim
 To be the Muslims of Your prophet's fame
 Are lying is found in this very verse
 That shows them to be among men the
 worse.

Those who do not think donkeys beautiful
 Deny the great Qur'an, and do not pull
 A hairsweight in the garden of the blessed,
 But go into a place where there's no rest.
 Beloved, keep my eye sharp to see the ass
 As beautiful among the ones who pass
 Me in the street and on the fields' morass.
 It may be in the ears the ornament,
 Or in the tail, or in the mane upsent,
 Or in the liquid eye the ass has lent.

10 It's He who sends down water from
 The skies for you, and so you come
 To drink from it, and by it trees
 And pasture for cattle to please.
 11 He grows for you by it the corn,
 And olives and palms not forlorn,
 And grapes and all the fruits there born,
 In this is a sign for a folk
 Who reflect on things *at a stroke*.
 12 He's made subservient for you
 The night and day, the sun and view
 Of the moon, and the stars have been
 Subdued to you by what He'd win,
 In this are signs for a folk who
 Understand *all the things in view*.

13 What He's produced on earth of hues
 Diverse, there is in this to use
 A sign for folk not to refuse.
 14 It's He subjected the sea
 To you so you might have in fee
 Fresh meat and take out from it too
 The ornaments we wear in view,
 And you see the ships part the waves,
 And so you can seek in its staves
 His grace and give thanks *as good slaves*.
 15 He's thrown down mountains great upon
 The earth lest you be shaken, drawn,
 And rivers and roads where you may
 Be guided and not go astray,
 16 By landmarks as well as the star
 They are guided *from shoal and bar*.
 17 What! Is the One who has created
 Like the one who has not as rated?
 Will you not then consider weighted?
 18 If you wished to count Allah's bounties,
 You could not do so, *though such mounties*,
 God's oft-forgiving and He is
 Most merciful of all *in biz*.
 19 God knows what you hide, and He
 knows
 All of the things that you disclose.
 20 Those they call on besides God do
 Not create anything in view,
 But themselves are created too.
 21 They're dead, not living and perceive
 Not when they'll be raised *for reprieve*.

Philosopher and theologian spell
 Out definitions of the divine well,
 But the Qur'an defines a better way:
 You are Creator and from day to day
 Provide the things that human beings need
 To go on in their disputation's greed.
 So Your existence is not to despise,
 And atheism must in every guise
 Deny the rain and sun and growing tree,
 Since they define Your being and degree
 To human mind and kind by Your decree.
 Beloved, the argument is spent alone
 In darkness and in blindness by Your
 throne.
 There's nothing but the senses to atone.

22 Your God is One God and those who
 Do not believe in coming rue,
 Their hearts are repulsive and they

Are men of pride *in their own way*.

23 God truly knows the things they hide
And show. The proud He cannot bide.
24 And when it's said to them, "What's this
That your Lord has sent down to kiss?"
They say "Just ancient tales to miss."
25 Let them bear their own burdens then
On the day of Judgement of men,
And also the burdens of those
Whom they led astray in their rows
Without knowledge. See, evil's there,
Evil it is in what they bear.

How true it is, Beloved, that You are one,
And true it is that humankind is done
In pride unspeakable under the sun.
No innocence before the gate I see,
But only wickedness' hypocrisy.
The way is fraught with those who spin a
tale
Pretending they are faithful ones and hale,
And those who are but dead in their own
sins.
The both of them cast out and in their bins.
Cast me out too in hell if there's no way
Else to cleanse the earth that you have in
pay.
I'd rather spend in hell eternity
Than add to evil of terrestrial spree,
Than spread the foul stench of iniquity.

26 Truly those before them did plot
And the God hit their house with rot
From the foundations and so fell
The roof down on them, into hell
Torment they came, but could not tell.
27 Then on the day of resurrection
He'll bring them to disgrace, reflection,
"Where are My partners about whom
You have been arguing for doom."
Those endowed with knowledge will say
"Truly disgrace and evil way
Is on the unfaithful this day."
28 Those whose lives angels terminate
While they're unjust in their estate,
Then they'd submit, "We did not do
In times past wickedness and rue."
"Yes, God knows well what things you do.
29 "So enter in the gates of hell
To stay in it, woeful to tell
Will be the dwelling of the proud."

30 And it is said unto those who
Guard themselves against evil crew,
"What's that your Lord's sent down?" They
say

"Good, for those who do good in this
World there is a good not to miss,
And the abode hereafter's yet
Better, and excellent is met
The dwelling of the pious set."
31 The gardens of eternity,
They'll enter there and there they'll see
The rivers flowing. They'll enjoy
In them whatever they employ,
So God rewards the pious boy.
32 Those whom the angels take away
In a good state, to get they'll say:
"Peace be on you, so enter in
The garden doing without sin."
33 What! Do they wait for anything
Except the angels come in ring
Or the decree of their Lord sing?
So did the ones before them too.
God was not unjust to that crew,
But they to their own selves untrue.
34 The evils they did came to harm
Them, and encompassed in alarm
What that they scoffed about in arm.

I am afraid to take philosophy,
And any sort of grand theology,
Pretending that Your fine divinity
Is this or that or has a fellow glee
In spirits or in flesh of the free.
If I should choose a gloried son of man
To sit on Your throne of deity's scan,
I fear I might be raised up from the grave
And asked to point him out among the
brave.
So let the deadlock lie in bedrock nigh
Until the day after the day I die,
And when I'm raised I shall not look
around
For one to join with You upon the ground,
Or one to count divinities in sound.

35 The ones who made up other gods
Say "If God had willed by His rods
We should have never worship aught
But Him, as our ancestors bought.
Nor had we done but what He sought.
That's just what they said before them.

Is there then any duty's gem
 For Our apostle but the clear
 Proclaiming *of what they should fear?*
 36 We raised in every nation one
 Apostle saying "Worship none
 But God and every idol shun,"
 So of them some God came to guide,
 And others confirmed error's pride,
 So travel round the countryside,
 And see what's happened to the crew
 Of those who denied what is true.
 37 If you desire they should be guided,
 Truly God does not guide those sided
 In paths astray, and neither comes
 For them any helpers in sums.
 38 They swear by God with their best oath
 That God will not raise one from growth
 Who dies. No, it's a promise binding
 On Him in truth, but most are blinding.
 39 So He will show them what they came
 To differ about and in blame,
 And those who disbelieved might know
 That they were liars all in tow.
 40 Truly just Our word is enough
 For a thing when We will the tough,
 We say to it "So be" and then
 The thing exists *on earth with men*.

Creation's not from nothing as the sound
 Theology would have upon the ground.
 It's from Your word that says let be and so
 All things that germinate begin to grow.
 The word that shakes the universe is bare
 And yet I hardly hear a whisper there.
 All things in silence meet You in the air,
 And nothing but affirms the divine glare.
 Beloved, I wander round my forest crypt
 And wonder what to make with a word
 slipped:

A fern unrolling, or a hopeful leaf
 Of birch that sings and sighs and to be brief
 Slips into yellow and at last to grief.

41 And those who migrate for God's glory,
 After they are oppressed and gory,
 Truly We'll give them good return
 In this world, and reward they earn
 In the hereafter's so much greater
 If only they knew *soon or later*.
 42 Those who endured things patiently,
 And on their Lord rely only.

43 And We did not send before you
 Any but men, revealed in crew,
 So ask folk of reminder too
 If you do not know what to do,
 44 With clear proofs and with scriptures
 read,
 And We sent down to you outspread
 Reminder that you may be led
 To make clear to mankind what's sent
 Down to them to know and relent.
 45 What! How they feel secure in plot
 Of evil, till God in their lot
 Causes them to be swallowed up
 By the earth or comes like a tup
 To them in wrath they perceive not.
 46 Or then He'll seize them in their flight,
 They cannot escape from God's right.
 47 Or then He'll seize them by a loss
 In small steps, for before the toss
 Your Lord's pitying, merciful.
 48 Or they do not see towards the pull
 Of what God's made that all things turn
 The shadow to the right and burn
 Toward the left and bowing down
 In such obeisance without frown
 Before God while they are let down.
 49 Whatever's in the sky and earth
 Bows down prostrated to God's berth,
 The creatures and the angels too,
 They're not too proud in what they do.
 50 They fear their Lord above and do
 Whatever they're commanded to.

All creatures bow to You, Beloved, and I
 Watch with a careless and a boastful eye
 To see all things on earth beneath the sky
 As though You were a non-existent fly.
 All creatures bow, while I whirl on apace
 Without a glance toward Your glowing
 face,
 Forgetful of the living and the race,
 The hope and harrow, mercy and the grace.
 Beloved, though men like me turn and
 return
 In sacrifice before the red-hot urn,
 Acknowledging not anything they earn,
 I stop at Your stroke and relent awhile,
 Unknown and still unknowing in my guile,
 Enamoured a brief speckling with Your
 smile.

51 God said "Do not take you two gods,
 Indeed He's only One God, so
 Of just Me should you fear the prods."
 52 "His is what's in sky and below
 On earth, to Him obedience show,
 Do You fear aught but God in stow?"
 53 "Whatever bounty is with you,
 It is from God, so when touch rue
 And distress, to Him *be alone*
 Cry of help *from the divine throne*.
 54 "Yet when He takes distress from you,
 See, some of you associate
 Others with their Lord *in estate*,
 55 "That they may deny the good rate
 We've given them. Let them enjoy
 Themselves for a time, soon they'll cloy."

I learn, Beloved, as I read on and on.
 I'd wondered why the need of one book
 drawn
 Beside the Gospel, though I knew the show
 Was to tell Jews that Jesus was a glow,
 And Christians he was not Almighty's row,
 But now I find a thing I did not know.
 I thought idolatry was ignorance
 And the desire of people come to dance.
 But now I know idolatry arises
 When people do not thank You for their
 prizes,
 But wish to deny what You've given them,
 So they can take the thanks for food and
 gem.
 Let those who will enjoy their space
 awhile,
 And let me show You my thanks without
 guile.

56 They set apart for ignorance
 A portion of the sustenance
 That We provided them. By God!
 You'll certainly be asked in prod
 About your inventions on sod.

I disagree then with tradition set
 That says abundances include the met
 Qur'an, the Oneness, and the Imamate,
 And not the sustenance You give in rate.
 Though a host does not require explanation
 Of what the guest has eaten in his ration,
 You do require account of meat and drink

That humankind brings offering at the
 brink
 Of idol and of church set up to wink.
 I am required to give to You account
 Of what I've given idols on the mount.
 Beloved, strip me of nourishment and good
 If I give them to idols in the wood,
 And pour libations at a pagan fount.

57 They ascribe daughters to God too,
 Glory be to Him. They take to
 Themselves their own desires in view.
 58 When the news comes a daughter's born,
 His face becomes black, filled with scorn.
 59 He keeps himself then out of sight
 In the chagrin of such news' plight,
 Whether to keep her with disgrace
 Or bury her without a trace.
 See, wickedness is without grace.
 60 For those who ignore what's to come
 There is an evil likeness' sum,
 God's is exalted likeness won,
 For He's the mighty, all-wise One.
 61 If God in justice took account
 Of man's iniquities' amount,
 No one would be left at the fount.
 He gives respite for a fixed term.
 So when their time comes though they
 squirm,
 There's no delay from the doom firm,
 Nor advance of an hour's amount.
 62 They ascribe to God what they hate,
 And let their tongues in falsehood state
 That they deserve the good in rate.
 It's unavoidable the fire
 Should come on them for their desire,
 And they'll be first to feel its ire.

Let's not remember those satanic words
 Now tooted by the infidels in herds,
 But note the Qur'an makes the contrast
 clear
 Between the fact that people once held dear
 The story that gods bore both sons and
 daughters
 And send them to herd sheep and goats by
 waters.
 If gods are pleased to bear daughters as
 well
 As sons, then why do their worshippers tell

The news of a girl's birth with
disappointment.
What's better than the divine in
anointment?
The logic is impeccable and true.
If God has daughter then the human crew
Should be as thankful for a daughter born
As for a son, and hold neither in scorn.

63 By God! We sent apostles down
Before you and on every town,
But Satan made them think their deeds
Were even better than their creeds,
So he's their guardian today,
For them shall be a grievous pay.
64 We only sent the book to you
So you could teach them how its view
Differs from their disputes in vain,
And guidance and a mercy plain
To those who believe *in God's reign*.
65 And God has send down from the sky
The rain, then brings the life thereby
To earth after it's parched and dry,
This is a sign for folk who try.

Since great Arminius came in to rule
That human deeds are foreknown by Your
school,
The churches and their flocks think deeds
of faith
Are better than reliance on the wraith
Of casting all hope on You, like a fool.
And so great Satan comes to take the place
Of You, Beloved, who save by sovereign
grace.
He is the guardian and the lord of church
And synagogue and mosque who take the
perch
That every man must make choice in the
lurch
And You submit to the will of men's
smirch.
Satan's old lie that men should be like gods
Is live and healthy in religious pods,
And steals the show from fashion and from
mods.

66 There is for you a lesson true
In how the very cattle do.
We give you to drink what is found
In their paunches *above the ground*,

Between the faeces and the blood,
Milk pure and fine come in a flood
For those who drink it *to be sound*.
67 And from the fruits of date-palms too,
And grapes as sweet as ever grew,
And you take from them wicked brew
As well as sustenance and stew.
This is a sign in people's view
Who understand and know the true.
68 Your Lord revealed to the bee saying
"Make hives in the mountains and swaying
Trees, and in the things men build
praying."
69 "So eat then of all fruits and walk
In ways of your Lord and in talk
Submissively." There comes from it
A drink of many colours fit
To heal mankind, in this too's found
A sign for folk of a mind sound.
70 And God's created you, and then
He takes you to the earthen den,
Where you revert to lowest state
Of the age, unconscious to wait
After having such knowledge great.
God knows all and does all in rate.

The Grecian theory of immortal soul
Without conditions as the final goal
Is belied by Semitic hope and fear
And seeing that in graves men disappear,
And with them go both joys and every tear,
All consciousness and knowledge of the
earth,
All planning and all following of mirth.
The barzakh of tradition is a sign
Of pagan penetration in design,
Of Hellenistic faith, Egyptian lore,
Extension of a mythic, cosmic war.
Beloved, I trust my resurrection's true,
The putrefaction of the body's view
Passed in creation of all things as new.

71 God's favoured some of you above
The others in provisions' glove,
Now those who've been more favoured do
Not give their sustenance as due
To those whom their right hands possess,
So they may have equal address.
What! Is it then God's bounty they
Deny in acting such a way?
72 God's given you wives of your own

And given from your wives by groan
 Children and grand-children and more
 Sustained you with good things in store.
 What! Is it then falsehood that they
 Believe, and in God's bounty's sway
 They disbelieve to act that way?
 73 They worship things other than God,
 Things that own for them naught in pod
 Of sustenance from sky or earth,
 Nor have they any power in berth.
 74 So do not invent likenesses
 To God, God knows what's right and His,
 But you know nothing of the biz.
 75 God sets for the likeness of two:
 One is a slave and owned as due,
 Who has no power of much or few,
 The other We sustained from Us
 A sustenance and glorious,
 And he spends from it secretly
 And he spends from it openly,
 And are the two equal to be?
 All praise is God's, but most of them
 Know nothing of *the divine gem*.
 76 God sets for the similitude
 Of two men: one of them imbued
 Without speech, dumb, incapable,
 A burden to his master full;
 Wherever he sends him to pull,
 No good comes of it. Can he be
 Equal to him who enjoins justice
 And walks the straight path *come to trust*
Us?

In things of life, in wealth and power to do
 And power to think and speak and right the
 true
 You've made the human frame in glories
 that
 Must differ where each sort of human sat.
 Some speak and know the glories of the
 earth
 And show the mighty things of heavenly
 worth,
 And others bear the burden and the way
 Of incapacity from day to day.
 The many in between are here to stay.
 Beloved I praise You for diversity,
 The differences of the stars to see,
 Some shining with a will, bright as can be,
 And other faint beyond notice and light.
 And yet all Your creations shed their light.

77 God's is the unseen of the sky
 And of the earth come by and by.
 The matter of the hour to come
 Is like the eye's twinkling in sum,
 Or even closer. Truly God
 Has power over all on the sod.
 78 God brought you from your mothers'
 wombs,
 You did not know a thing from blooms,
 And He gave you hearing and sight
 And hearts to give thanks as is right.
 79 What! Don't they see birds in the air
 Hung motionless with naught to bear
 Them up but God? This is a sign
 For those who believe the divine.
 80 God's made your homes a place of rest,
 And from animal skins caressed
 Homes light to carry when addressed
 On day of the march and the camp,
 Of the wool, fur and hair revamp
 Good things to provide for your best.
 81 God's made for you shelters' retreat,
 For you of the mountains in seat,
 And He's made you garments to guard
 You against temperature that marred,
 And garments to protect in fray,
 So He completes for you that way
 His bounties that you may obey.
 82 But if they turn away, on you
 Falls only the duty in view
 To give clear warning to the crew.
 83 They recognize bounties of God,
 And yet they deny them on sod,
 The most of them unfaithful clod.

This sweet Qur'an sounds like Allah
 proposes
 That He's inventor of the cultured roses
 Of the nomadic way of life that sends
 Its children through the desert's blistered
 ends.
 Nomadic life according to some views
 Is a choice made to leave the cities' cues
 And return to more primitive in state,
 Away from urban powers and urban rate.
 Beloved, I tread the wilderness to find
 Your ways secreted from all humankind,
 And skip the cobblestones and steeples
 where

The preachers preach to all the good and fair.

I tread the wilderness until I see
Before my eye the great, heavenly city.

84 On the day We'll raise up from each
People a witness, *one to preach*,
Then there'll be no leave for those who
Do not believe, nor shall that crew
Plead any excuses undue.

85 And when those who act unjustly
Shall see the torment not to be
Decreased for them, so they'll not come
Into a respite from the hum.

86 And when those who associate
With God other idols in state
See their idols, then they shall say
"O Our Lord! These are joined to stay
With You, the ones we set in bay."
But they'll throw back on them their word,
"Truly you are liars when heard."

87 They'll offer to submit to God
On that day as under the prod,
Betrayed by what they forged in pod.

88 Those who do not believe and keep
Others from the way of God steep,
We shall increase their torment's leap,
Because of mischief that they heep.

89 And on the day when We shall raise
Up every folk out of their maze,
A witness and bring you to bear
Witness of all this people's share,
And We've sent down on you the book,
Explaining everything it took,
A guidance and a mercy's nook,
And joyful news to those who look
To You in submission aware.

The idols men set up today in gold
Or steel or oil or in a fancy hold,
That do not speak a word today shall rise
When You who create speech beneath the
skies

Give the command, shall speak a word in
blame

Of those who bide them to achieve their
fame.

Then shall the fashioned suit cry out aloud,
The shiny car and tank speak from the
crowd,

And they shall lay the blame on the
unbowed

And justify You as the only true
God of the universe and human pew.
I wait that day, but as I wait for You,
I pray You take from me all idols' brew,
And leave me bare before Your throne in
view.

90 God fosters justice, charity,
And giving to kin aid in fee,
Forbids lewd acts and evil too,
As well as rebellion undue,
And calling you to take heed too.

91 Fulfil the covenant of God
When you have covenanted laud,
And do not break oaths you have made,
While you've made God surety paid,
God knows what each of you has made.

92 Don't be like her unravelling yarn,
Dividing it thinly to darn,
After she's spun it to be strong,
So taking your oaths in the wrong,
One nation more flourishing strong.

God only tries you by this song.
He'll make it clear on judgement day
About your differing *in pay*.

93 And if God willed, He'd surely make
You all a single nation's take,
But He lets err the ones He wills
And guides the ones He wills *for thrills*,
And you'll be questioned about all
The things you were doing *in stall*.

The reason there are so many who make
Sects differing before the truth in wake
Is simply that You let men make mistake
In order to set them in piles to burn
For all the errors that they come to earn.
The reason You send many into grief
Of human tradition's church's relief
Is so the hidden garden of the fair
May be in peace without the wicked there.
I thank You for the two or three who come
To praise Your name before the bloody
hum

Of bishopric of the empowered bum.
A little while and human hand will fail
Before the fires of hell weakened and pale.

94 Don't use oaths as means of deceit

Between you, lest a foot's retreat
 Slip after it's been set and you
 Taste of the evil that you brew
 In hindering others from God's pew,
 And for you's great torment in view.
 95 Don't sell the covenant of God
 For a small price. Truly with God
 Is what is the better for you
 If only once you really knew.
 96 What is with you will pass away
 And what's with God will always stay,
 And certainly We'll give away
 Their reward to those in the way
 Who show their patience and the best
 Of what they did and did invest.
 97 Whoever did good, man or wench,
 And was believer on the bench,
 Then We'll make them live a life good
 And pure, and give them what We should
 With the best of the things they could.
 98 When you recite the Qur'an then
 Seek refuge with God from the den
 Of Satan the accursed of men.
 99 But he has no authority
 Over those who believe and see
 Reliance on their Lord's decree.
 100 His power is just over the ones
 Who will befriend him in their tonnes,
 And those who join to idols' buns.

Praise You, Beloved, that Satan's power
 comes down
 Only on those who strut about the town
 And arm in arm with him under Your
 frown,
 And worshipping their idols of renown.
 Praise You, Beloved, he has no power at all
 Over the ones who hear You and Your call,
 On whom You pour Your grace and make
 repent
 Of their sins as regeneration's sent.
 Beloved, I hope to be set in that crowd
 That's set apart from Satan's crew and
 proud.
 I do rely on Your divine decree
 And not on any good thing I may be
 Or do: I stand without a single plea
 Before Your throne as long as I'm allowed.

101 When We change one sign for another,
 And God knows best what He sends down,

They say "You are a forger, brother!"
 No, most of them have no renown.

The battle of the books sweet Christians
 make
 Often returns to two arguments' wake.
 They say the Qur'an plagiarizes all
 It takes from the Bible found in the stall,
 Or then they say the Qur'an is amiss
 Since in a thing or two it does not kiss
 The Bible principle. And so men hiss.
 Beloved, they cannot have it in both ways.
 Either the Qur'an's right to follow praise
 Of Bible and relate its stories' stays,
 Or right to change the rules and so not be
 Caught up in any sort of forgery.
 The battle of the books is cutting low,
 But better kill with words than swords in
 show.

102 Say "Holy Spirit's brought it down
 From your Lord with the truth in crown,
 To set firm those who believe and
 As guidance and good news to stand
 To those who submit to God's hand.
 103 We know they say "It's just a man
 That shows him the way that's to scan."
 The tongue of the one they presume
 Is foreign and not here to groom,
 While this tongue's Arabic's clear room.
 104 Those who don't believe in God's signs
 God does not guide them in designs,
 For them's a painful torment's lines.
 105 The ones who lie are just the folk
 Who don't believe what Allah spoke,
 And they are liars at a stroke.
 106 The one who does not believe God
 After he once believed in pod,
 Except as he's compelled while heart
 Remains steadfast with faithful art,
 On such remains the divine wrath
 To bring into the torment's path.
 107 This because they love this world's life,
 Preferring it to coming rife,
 And God does not guide any folk
 Who is unfaithful to His yoke.
 108 These are those on whose hearts God's
 set

A seal, and on their hearing yet,
 And on their sights, and these remain
 A heedless people and a vain.

109 Without doubt in the time to come
They'll be the losers *deaf and dumb*.
110 Then your Lord to those who went out
After their persecution stout,
And then they struggle patiently,
Afterward your Lord forgives free,
And He is One of great mercy.

There's always an excuse to reject those
That You sent to step on the people's toes.
If the book comes in Hebrew, then they
shout

That it's in a tongue they know naught
about.

If it's in Arabic to those who stand
Upon the Meccan soil and desert sand,
Then they're dissatisfied and they're
unmanned.

There is no satisfying human hearts.

You are the only One who has no darts.
Believe me, my Beloved, for all Your arts,
Only those You touch with a special grace
Are able by Your strength before Your face
To stand in faith, believing every trace
Of reason and of mighty works to brace.

111 One day every soul will come up
Struggling for itself *to the cup*,
And every soul full recompensed
For all her actions, none *incensed*
Will be unjustly dealt with *then*.

112 Allah sets forth a parable:
A city enjoying by men
Security and quiet *full*,
Abundantly supplied with wealth
From every place: Yet it *in stealth*
Was ungrateful for favours from
Allah: So Allah made it come
On it hunger and terror like
A garment, because of the *strike*
That they did. 113 And there came to them
An apostle from among them,
But they falsely rejected him,
So wrath seized them *for being dim*
Even in their iniquities.

114 So eat of all the good bounties
Which Allah has provided you,
Lawful and good, and do be *true*
And grateful for the favours *shown*
By Allah, if *before His throne*
It is He whom you serve *alone*.

Ingratitude more than the fat of rabbit
Is the foul and the wicked sort of habit
That brings down Your wrath on the
wealthy few
And every city that bides in that view.
Ingratitude is something to appear
Before the human choice of love and gear,
And barely runs the gauntlet but acclaims
A royal place before Olympic games.
Beloved, I fear I am ungrateful too:
My expectations blind me from the brew
Of Kauthar that I sip from hour to hour
Beneath the humble walls on which I
glower,
As though a heady wine forbidden me
Stalked just beyond my window, behind
tree.

115 He has only forbidden you
Dead meat, and blood, and flesh of swine,
And that over which other name
Than Allah has been spoken fine.
But if one is forced by need's claim,
Without wilful disobedience,
Nor transgressing due limits' sense,
Then Allah is Oft-Forgiving,
Most Merciful *in everything*.

116 But say not, for any false *thing*
That your tongues may put forth *and sing*,
"This is lawful, and this forbidden,"
So as to ascribe false things *hidden*
To Allah. For those who ascribe
False things to Allah *for a bribe*,
Will never prosper. 117 There is but
A paltry profit, but the glut
Of penalty that they will bear
Is a most grievous *thing to share*.

118 To the Jews We prohibited
Such things as We've mentioned to bid
To you before. We did them no
Wrong, but they were used to the wrong
Done to themselves. 119 Truly your Lord,
To those who do wrong in accord
With ignorance, but then repent
And make amends, your Lord relent,
After all this, is Oft-Forgiving,
Most Merciful *and ever living*.

The sinew of the thigh, the inner fat,

The milk and meat, that's where the Jew is
at.

And yet the Muslim takes this sign in store
For an excuse to eat the rodents' core,
When in another place the Qur'an states
To look at Torah for the list of plates
That are still lawful after Jewish rates.
Beloved, let me abstain from the unclean,
And the unhealthful in this world and
mean,
And let the porker live in its latrine.
With Daniel's lentils I make do as might
Say the wise Persian poet come in sight,
And so need not to flatter kings and write
Whatever I see coming in the light.

120 Abraham was indeed a fine
Model, devoutly followed sign
Of Allah in obedience, true
In faith, and he did not join *crew*
Of gods with Allah: 121 He displayed
His gratitude for favours made
By Allah, Who chose him, and guided
Him to a straight path. 122 We *decided*
To give him good in this world, and
He'll be, in the hereafter's land,
In the ranks of the righteous men.
123 So We've taught you the inspired *ten*,
"Follow the ways of Abraham
The true in faith, *strong as a ram*
Not to join gods with God *again*."
124 The *punishment for Sabbath breaking*
Was only made for those forsaking,
But Allah will judge between them
On Judgement Day *with diadem*,
As to their differences. 125 Invite
All to the way of your Lord right
With wisdom and fine proclamation,
And argue with them in vocation
That is best and most gracious *made*.
For your Lord knows best, who have
strayed
From His Path, and who *best* receive
Guidance. 126 And if you catch them out,
Catch them out no worse *to deceive*
Than they will *also* catch you out:
But if you show patience, indeed
That is the best *way to proceed*
For those who are patient. 127 And You
Be patient, for your patience *true*
Is but from Allah. Do not grieve

For them: do not distress your *sleeve*
Because of their plots. 128 God's with
those
Who restrain themselves, and who chose
To do good *whatever arose*.

You are, Beloved, the refuge of the ones
Who guard themselves from evil and their
sons.

Those who do good escape from Your
reproof.

The evil doers are the ones aloof.
The Psalmist says not one does good at all.
He makes a point that we might hear his
call.

Guard me from evil so that I might be
With you and thus do good eternally.
For Self alone within the human soul
Can guard from evil and set toward the
goal.

O hidden Self, come through the many
veils

And do that good that righteousness entails,
And dissipate the mists of self and wonder,
With still small voice and fire and flood
and thunder.

Surah 17 Bani-Israil, or the Children of Israel

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 Glory to Him the One who bore
His servant by night from the door
Of holy mosque to that one set
Upon the furthest reaches yet,
Which We have blessed there where it
stands,

So We could show to him commands
Of Our signs. He is the all hearing
And of all things He's the seeing.

2 We gave Moses the book and made
It a guidance for Israel's grade,
"Take no guardian other than Me."

3 The offspring of the ones that We
Bore with Noah, and truly he
Was a servant and faithfully.

4 We had declared to Israel's folk
In the book: "You will come to stoke
Mischief in the land twice and be
Lifted to go arrogantly.

5 "So when the first fulfilment came,
We sent Our servants of fame,

Who came into your inner room,
 So was fulfilled warning of doom.
 6 "Then We gave you your turn to win,
 And helped you with both wealth and kin,
 And made you numerous of fin.
 7 "If you do good, it's selfishly,
 If you do evil, it's like spree,
 So when the second promise came
 To sadden your faces for shame,
 They came into the mosque again
 Destroying what they would for gain."
 8 Maybe your Lord will have mercy
 On you, but if you backslide free,
 We'll return to punishment's spree,
 And We've made hell again to be
 The prison of those who deny.
 9 This Qur'an guides to that whereby
 Upright and joyous tidings vie,
 For the believers who do good,
 For them to have reward they should.
 10 For those who don't believe in what
 Is coming hereafter, We've shut
 Up for the painful torment's glut.

Of course if all men did believe at last,
 Then the torment You've planned would be
 outcast.
 I hope You do bring all souls to the mast
 Of reconciliation for their past.
 But if You do not do so, I can see
 Only the baleful torment faithfully
 Arising for deniers of the day
 Of reckoning for what men do and say.
 Beloved, nothing is more to reason's word
 Than that our actions have effects when
 stirred,
 And what we do results in further pain
 Or in the fruit of good deeds without stain.
 It's stupid to think men can get away
 With doing what they like and never pay.

11 Man prays for evil as for good,
 A hasty man is every hood.
 12 We've made night and day be Our signs,
 Then We caused night's sign to resign,
 And brought the day's sign into sight,
 That you might seek grace from the light
 Of your Lord, and so you too might
 Know the number and count of years,
 We've explained all the works and gears.
 13 We've caused every man's destiny

To cling to his neck and We'll bring
 Out on the day of reckoning
 A book he'll find open to see.
 14 "Read in your book. You are enough
 Yourself to reckon up your stuff."

I do read in the book of Psalms and find
 (Psalm 90:12)
 The count of days and years given to mind,
 And so I find that wisdom waits for me
 In counting of the Psalms by their degree
 And in the recitation of the book
 Sent down upon Muhammad for a look.
 I number the days of my life of crook
 And find them few and narrow as did he
 Who was called a supplanter by decree
 Of Pharaoh being blessed most happily.
 Beloved, though I have wasted all my days
 In failing to give You the proper praise,
 Accept not my repentance from my ways,
 But rather praise upon praise that I raise.

15 Whoever gets guided aright,
 He gets guided for his own sight,
 And he who goes astray so goes
 According to his own hurt's rows.
 No one shall bear another's weight.
 We do not punish folk in state
 Before sending apostles late.
 16 When We mean to destroy a town,
 We send folk Our commandment down,
 So they can easily obey,
 But when they transgress it and stray,
 Then proof appears, and so We make
 Complete destruction for its sake.
 17 How many peoples We've destroyed
 After Noah! Your Lord's employed
 Regarding sins His slaves enjoyed,
 He's all-aware, seeing through void.
 18 Whoever planned for present life,
 We hasten to him what is rife
 Of Our own pleasure as We wish,
 And then assign to him his dish
 Of hell where he'll enter despised
 And driven away from the prized.
 19 Whoever planned for the hereafter,
 And striving struggled for the rafter,
 And is believing, striving then
 Will be rewarded once again.
 20 We aid them both from bounty found
 By your Lord, and the bounty round

Of your Lord's not limited ground.
21 See how we caused some to excel
And surely the hereafter's spell
Is greater in degree and well
In excellence not to dispel.
22 Join not to God another god,
Lest you're unfitted on the sod,
Despised, neglected under rod.

You do provide each soul the help he needs
To fulfil all his destinies and greeds.
The bounty of creation comes to all,
The sun shines on the folk and rain does
fall

Upon the just and unjust on the mall.
From out of bounties given to all men
In grace and mercy, I search in my den
For the great grace of Your salvation's way,
The gleaming of the resurrection day.
Beloved, Your bounty brings all from the
fray
Returning breath to dust and light to pay,
And fills the breast with joy and fear to
play
Upon the hills of Your eternity.
I seek the bounties that You have for me.

23 Your Lord commanded not to bow
Worshiping any but His brow,
Goodness to parents, if they reach
Either one or both to the peach
Of old age, don't say fie to them
Or chide them, speak generous gem.
24 Bring down on them compassion's wing
In the humility you sing:
"O my Lord, have mercy on them
As they cherished me in the hem
When I was small and among them."
25 Your Lord knows best what is in you:
If you are then a righteous crew,
Then He's forgiving to the one
Who repents for the things he's done.
26 Give to the near kin what's his due,
And to the needy, traveller too,
And do not waste your earnings few
On vanities that end in rue.
27 Those who waste are the devils' kin.
Satan's always ungrateful in
His dealings with His Lord for sin.
28 If you turn away from them to
Seek mercy, from your Lord in view

For what you've hoped, then speak to them
A kindly word *like sparkling gem*.
29 Don't make them shackle hand to neck,
Nor stretch it out as far in beck,
Lest you should then sit down bereft
With nothing blamed for what is left.
30 Your Lord gives sustenance to those
Among the hungry that He chose,
And measures it in measure's rows.
He's full aware of His slaves here,
Seeing all things that may appear.

Beloved, I thank you that in grace You
gave
Me not to speak an ugly word unbrave
To my own father aged as he was
Before his entering beneath death's claws.
Beloved, I pray I never chide the one
Who brought me from the womb though
before done
Neither of them may have planned for my
birth.
I was wanted by You alone for worth.
Beloved, let me honour both mum and dad
As long as I live for the life they had,
And when I come into my own reward,
Let me be granted peace for that, my Lord.
The measure of the sustenance is true,
And all in faith remain before they grew.

31 Don't kill your children in the fear
Of poverty or want of gear,
We sustain them and yourselves too,
To kill them is wicked to do.
32 Do not come near adultery,
It is an act shameful to see,
A very wicked way to be.
33 Don't kill anyone God forbids
But for a just cause under lids.
Whoever's slain unjustly, We
Give his heir the authority,
But he must not come over due
In killing, aided by God too.

Killing in self defence and vengeance for
The slaying of the innocent at door
Is here permitted, if it's not too sore
Or too extravagant and carried more.
The Quakerly in me depreciates
The need to plan for such initiates,
But who am I to limit what men do

When they're confronted with the killing crew?
 Beloved, You take each case that human's try
 Into consideration under sky,
 And warn us to abstain from ruthless share
 Of murder and of killing and warfare.
 If only we who must protect our ware
 And market could consider Your word bare.

34 Don't approach the wealth of bereft
 Among the orphans but what's left
 For good until he does grow up,
 And then fulfil the promised cup,
 A reckoning will once be made
 For promises paid and unpaid.
 35 Give full measure in what you mete,
 And weigh with a true balance neat,
 This is good and fairest complete.
 36 Don't pursue what you do not know,
 The hearing, sight, and heart must show
 In answer for the ways they go.
 37 Don't walk on earth in prideful sway,
 For you cannot break earth away
 Or reach the mountains in their stay.
 38 All this and with its wickedness
 Is hateful in your Lord's address.
 39 This is what your Lord has revealed
 Of His own wisdom and unsealed.
 Don't set up with God other gods
 Lest you be cast into hell's pods,
 Blamed and cast out forsaken clods.
 40 What! Has your Lord preferred to give
 You sons, and taken for to live
 Daughters Himself from angels there?
 What you say is awful to bear.

The last time blame was cast for claiming
 You
 Had daughters in the flaming, flouting
 crew,
 You condemned men for thinking
 daughter's rue,
 And wanted them to love them like sons
 too.
 Now Your argument's the opposite sent.
 You ask the feeble men once to relent
 From having sons, the better part and pact,
 And leaving You the daughters, worse in
 fact.

You don't disdain a parable insane,
 But even take a gnat for a fat grain.
 But let me say there's nothing to complain
 In having only daughters. That's my gain.
 If You should ever try it, You would see
 You'd enjoy the rest of eternity.

41 We've shown in the Qur'an so they
 Might take warning, but the display
 Adds to them just aversion's way.
 42 Say "If there were other gods with
 Him, as they pretend in their myth,
 They surely would have sought a way
 Against the Lord on throne in sway."
 43 Glory be to Him for He's high
 Above what they pretend and vie,
 He is high and He's great thereby.
 44 The seven heavens and the earth
 Do celebrate His glory's worth,
 And what's in them, and there is not
 Any but glorifies His lot,
 But you do not understand how
 They glorifying come to bow,
 He's patient and forgiving now.
 45 When you recite the Qur'an here,
 We make a hidden veil appear
 Between you and those who do not
 Believe in the future day's plot.
 46 We've set on their hearts coverings
 Lest they should gain understandings
 And in their ears a heaviness
 And when you mention and address
 Your Lord alone in the Qur'an,
 They turn their backs away in scorn.
 47 We know best what they listen to,
 Both when they come here to hear you,
 And when they whisper secretly
 And the unjust say "You just see
 A man bewitched in such degree."
 48 Just see what they compare you to.
 They've gone so far astray they do
 Not find the way back to the true.

The veil upon the human heart when men
 Read or hear read the Qur'an sung again
 Is almost universal, so I try
 To understand the reason and the why
 For Your creation of the earth and sky
 And human souls who come to magnify
 Themselves among the fowl and furried
 guests

That make their ways on earth's valleys and
crests.

Beloved, I hear the syllables resound
In beauty and in terror on the ground,
And find the veils are torn and flutter round
My head and heart and spirit as I wake
To hear the promises and threats' mistake,
And bow in love and horror at the take.

49 They say "What! When we become
bones

And rotten dust, shall we get loans
On new life created *from stones?*"

50 Say "Whether stones or iron it is
That you become, it makes no whiz,
51 "Or any thing created yet
That seems the harder for your bet."
But they will say "Who'll bring us back?"
Say "The One who created you
In the first place!" Then they will slack
Their wagging head and say to you,
"When will that be?" So then reply,
"Before you know the when or why."

52 On the day when He'll call you out,
And you respond with praise in shout,
You'll think you stayed there but a pout."

The time spent in the grave is just a wink,
It goes faster than anyone can think.
As soon as death hits breath without a link,
The consciousness is gone from off the
brink.

The resurrection seems to follow on
The very light that first would greet the
dawn,

Though centuries may lie between the day
That death took the fair soul from life
away,

It must seem but a second to all those
Who wait the resurrection in their rows.
It does not matter whether just a night
Or century divide the stars in plight.
I wait with earnestness what You bestow,
Beloved, upon me standing here below.

53 Say to My servants that they should
Say only what is best and good.
It's Satan sows dissension where
They are, and Satan takes the share
Of open enemy to bear.

54 Your Lord knows you best, if He wills,

He will have mercy on your frills,
Or if He wills, He will chastize,
And We did not send you in guise
Of guardian over their tills.
55 Your Lord knows best all those who
stand

In heaven or upon earthly land,
We have exalted some to be
Messengers to others' degree,
And We gave David Psalms freely.

You gave the Psalms to David, and I take
That book of Psalms to sing in David's
wake.

A hundred fifty Psalms in plaint and
prayer,
Petition and in praise and everywhere
In penance I have done in sinful share.
I thank You for the Psalms and their
delight,

I thank You that You remind in the sight
Of sweet Muhammad that the thing is right
To sing the Psalms of David with my
might.

Beloved, I praise You here in these small
words

In script as palatable as the curds,
But in the round of days in which I walk
Upon the earth and hear the common talk,
I return to the Psalms with line and chalk.

56 Say "Call on those you think are gods
Beside Him. They have no power's prods
To take away your painful rods
Nor even power to change the pods."

57 Those whom they call to seek the way
Of their Lord, which of them in sway
Is nearer to hope of mercy,
And fear His punishment in fee,
Your Lord's chastisement dread to see.
58 And there is not a town but We
Will destroy it before decree
Of judgement day, or punish it
With a chastisement We see fit,
That's written in the book to sit.

59 Nothing prevents Us sending signs
Except the ancient ones' designs
Denied them, and We gave Thamud
The she-camel, a sign so crude,
But they acted unjustly then
To her, Our signs were sent to men

To warn them once and then again.
 60 When We said to you, "Your Lord true
 Encompasses the people's crew,"
 And We did not bring visions' view
 On you but as a trial to folk,
 And the accursed tree like an oak
 In the Qur'an, and made them fear,
 But it did not add to their gear
 Except transgression's grievous tear.

The day of battle and the divine aid
 Came down upon the people like a shade.
 But life today is hardly anywhere
 More just than in the day Your hand laid
 bare.

I see the camels still and I still know
 That camels are hamstringed upon the go,
 And evil hearts remember in the glow
 Of evening what the morning had to show.
 Beloved, I fear the punishment that's set
 Upon the Judgement Day and I have met
 The hope of Paradise, but what I get
 Is in the hand divine. Before all time
 I have assurance of the power sublime
 That has sway despite faithlessness and
 crime.

61 And when We told the angels thus:
 "Bow down to Adam *without fuss*,"
 They all prostrated themselves but
 Iblis who said *with his heart shut*:
 "Am I to bow down before him,
 The one You made of clay and trim?"
 62 He said "Do You see what You give
 Honour above me *here to live*?
 If You give me respite to stay
 Alive and work till Judgement Day,
 I'll cut off his posterity
 Except a few *that You set free*."
 63 He said "Away! But of them those
 Who follow you as though they chose,
 Hell is your recompense in rows,
 A full reward *that you propose*."
 64 "Pull off any you can by your
 Voice, and gather the army's store
 And cavalry against their door,
 Partake with them in wealth and spawn,
 And make your promises as drawn."
 Satan's promises are deceit.
 65 "My own servants shall not take seat
 Under Your authority's treat,

Your Lord is guardian enough
 For them *through both the thin and tough*."

It is the grand intention that makes pure
 Obedience or failure of the sure.
 Abraham failed to kill the beloved son
 Despite command descending from the
 gun.

Iblis failed to prostrate himself before
 A mere man made of clay in wattled store.
 If he had failed obedience because
 He could not bring himself despite Your
 claws

To bow to anyone but You alone,
 Would You then have cast him out of the
 throne?

It was a wrong intention in the act,
 And not the act itself that failed the pact.
 Beloved, give me intentions pure and good,
 And then see if I shall do as I should.

66 Your Lord's the One who sails your
 ships

Across the seas and without slips
 In grace, He's always been for you
 Most merciful *of all the crew*.

67 When any distress in the sea
 Come upon you, and then they flee,
 Those ones you call, then only He
 When He brings you into safety
 On the land you unfaithfully
 Turn from Him. So man's always been
 Ungrateful *and dead in his sin*.

68 What! Do you feel secure that He
 Will keep the earth in its degree
 From sloping down on you in spree?
 Or He'll send violent wind down
 With stones on everyone in town,
 And you'll have no guard of renown?

69 Or are you sure He'll not take you
 Back once again where the winds blew,
 And drown you for disbelief's rue?
 Then you will not find anyone
 To plead against Us when you've done.

70 We've honoured Adam's children and
 We bear them on the sea and land,
 Provide them with sustenance grand,
 And We've exalted them above
 Most of Our own creation's love,
 Raised by decree *on every hand*.

The trust in you upon the seas is grand
 And told of many saints from strand to
 strand,
 How passengers might wail and weep and
 cry,
 But those who trusted You beneath the sky
 Were calm and did not fear at all to die.
 Not all have followed Jonah's expertise
 To flee from You in every time they please.
 Beloved, I rarely set sail in a ship.
 I did enough of that in youthful clip
 When just a student plying Sweden's shore,
 The land I still love better than some more,
 And found the gale or found the calm in
 store
 Always the same to bring me back to find
 The safety of the land could be less kind.

71 Remember day of judgement when
 We'll summon every folk of men
 With their leader, then those who get
 His book in his right hand well set,
 Shall read without injustice met.
 72 And whoever's blind in this time
 Shall in the hereafter too climb
 In blindness further in his crime
 Astray from the right way *in mime*.
 73 They nearly meant to turn you out
 From what We'd revealed without doubt
 To you, to make you invent some
 Against another, then each bum
 Would take you as a friend *and hum*.
 74 If We'd not firmly set you, you
 Would surely have listened a few.
 75 Then We'd have made you taste a share
 Double in this life and to bear
 Double after death, then you'd not
 Have found you helper from Our drought.
 76 They nearly meant to tear away
 These from the land, so they might stay
 To drive you out, but then they'd not
 Have stayed after you in the plot.
 77 That's how We treated messengers
 Of Ours We sent before your *spurs*,
 And you'll not find Us changing *curs*.

The share of punishment after this life
 For the unfaithful prophet is such strife
 In both the now and coming that the knife
 Is doubled in the chest to sound of fife.
 The share of pain in every life is tough,

So doubling it is bound to be so rough
 That none should chose to deny the bright
 word
 That You sent them to speak and then be
 heard.
 Myself, I am not sent. I raise a head
 And threaten You and everything I've said,
 And wondered why and wherefore and
 been led
 To doubt and then to hope and then be sped
 In glory and in praises back to bed.
 That's how it goes with unprophetic bird.

78 Start prayer after the sun goes down
 Until the night-time raises frown,
 And the recital at the dawn,
 That repetition when it's drawn
 Is witnessed *until it is gone*.
 79 And in the night leave sleep for prayer,
 As an addition to your share,
 Maybe your Lord will raise you high
 To an estate that's praised thereby.
 80 And say "O my Lord, make me go
 Into a good entrance and show,
 And make me go out at a gate
 As pleasant as in any rate,
 And grant me power from You in aid."
 81 And say "The truth's come in parade,
 And the falsehood vanished unstayed."
 Truly falsehood's vanishing made.
 82 When We sent down the Qur'an which
 Is healing and mercy in pitch
 To the believers, it can add
 To the unjust only things bad.
 83 When We bestow bounties on man,
 He turns aside and goes a span,
 And when catastrophe hits him,
 He becomes sad, he becomes grim.
 84 Say "Every one acts by his own
 Mould, so your Lord has the best known
 Who's best guide of the right path shown."

Beloved, Your Word is life to those You
 choose
 And condemnation to the ones who lose.
 The power of Your Word is marvellous,
 And comes down in its glory upon us.
 But glory has two faces to light up:
 The chosen and elect as well as tup.
 Your Word is healing to the ones You
 make

Recipients of grace for Your own sake.
 Your Word is death and blindness to the
 crew
 That hears but does not hear the good and
 true.
 Your law's a mirror of the state of man,
 To some it shows a face divine to scan,
 To some it shows their doom before their
 time
 To see them curse the sharing of Your
 rhyme.

85 They ask you about spirit's way.
 Say "Spirit's from my Lord's law's sway,
 And you're not given the knowledge way,
 Except a little and a ray."
 86 If We please, We will take away
 The little We've revealed to say.
 Then you'd find no one in the way
 To plead for you against Our sway,
 87 Except the mercy from your Lord,
 His grace on you is greatly stored.
 88 Say "If men and the jinn could join
 Together to produce false coin
 Like this Qur'an, they could not bring
 The like of it, though in the spring
 They helped each other then to sing."
 89 We've shown the people in Qur'an
 Every example, but they're drawn
 Not to it except to deny,
 For most folk so *under the sky*.
 90 They said "We won't believe in you
 Until you make a spring run true
 For us out of the earth in view,
 91 "Or such a garden for you where
 Date-palms and grapes and rivers share
 The gushing out of water there,
 92 "Or make the sky fall on us like
 You threatened us before to strike,
 Or bring God or angels in sight
 To testify that you are right,
 93 "Or you show us your house of gold,
 Or go up to the sky one bold,
 And we'll not believe you went up
 Until you bring us down in cup
 A book that we can read out cold."
 Say "Glory be now to my Lord,
 I'm just man and not one adored,
 Though sent out from my God and Lord."

Beloved, I'm like the pleased Arabs then

Who clamoured for the golden-littered
 glen.

If any man came to my door to spend
 His glitter to convince me he could lend
 Me wisdom of the stars, like all the others,
 I'd follow him with other brothers' mothers.
 It is a human trait since the new breed
 Supplanted the Neanderthalian seed.
 The sparkling is the thing we take in need,
 And like the shiny crow, lift every bead.
 Beloved, if any single man and poor
 Make claims upon the justice at Your door,
 I too would leave him standing like a bore.
 I blindly flail on a receding shore.

94 And nothing prevented belief
 Among the people when the feoff
 Of guidance came to them except
 They said "It's just a man inept
 God's sent as messenger unkept."
 95 Say "If there were upon the earth
 Angels to walk, settled in berth,
 We would have sent down from the sky
 An angel then to guide them by."
 96 Say "It's enough that God is here
 A witness between me and you,
 He knows His servants, what is true,
 He's all-aware, sees far and near."
 97 Whomever God guides, He'll guide
 right,

Whomever He lets stray from sight,
 You'll never find him guards but Him,
 We'll gather them upon the grim
 Day of the resurrection on
 Their faces, blind, dumb, deaf and drawn,
 And so their dwelling shall be hell,
 As soon as the flames come to quell,
 We shall increase their blaze as well.
 98 This is their recompense, for they
 Did not believe Our signs in sway,
 And said "What! When we've become
 bones

And decayed dust no more with groans,
 Shall we be raised up in a day?"
 99 What! Don't they see the God who made
 The sky and earth is not one stayed
 From making again likes of them?
 He's set them a term without doubt,
 But the unjust ones turn their hem
 From all but denying about.

100 Say "If you own the treasury

Of my Lord in His great mercy,
Then you'll be careful not to spend,
And man is stingy in the end."

The Qur'an is still relevant this time,
Despite the fact it came down once in
rhyme

To quell the heresy that Jesus is
The God Almighty and no human whiz.
Today the many who face death still show
The doubt that resurrection day will glow,
But think that death ends all in quiet peace,
Unconscious of the world around release,
Or even worse, think that the soul must rise
Immortal in immaterial guise.
Beloved, give me the faith or not to know
What You will do before the world below,
The bones and dust once dry will flourish
when

You come to resurrect the world again.

101 We gave Moses our nine clear signs:
As children of Israel's designs,
When he came to them Pharaoh said
To him "O Moses, you've been led
Under a magic spell, I'm sped."

102 Said Moses, "You know well these
things
Have been sent down by no such wings
But by the Lord of heaven and earth
As evidence of noble worth.
And I consider you indeed,
O Pharaoh, to be one with speed
Doomed to destruction *for your greed.*"

All who stand in Your name before the
wise
And kingly in their own and the world's
eyes
Live to hear that they're plagues with magic
wrought
On mind and spirit, and in weakness taught.
Those who bear witness in disdain of those
Who stand in Your name live to see the
throes
Of their attempts foiled by the Red Sea's
floes.

The whirling goes on always in this guise.
Beloved, I stand upon a desert place
And look for nothing but Your given grace

And for the hope and health come from
Your face.

Beloved, I stand alone before the world
Spread out before me in its forests furled
And in the lakes in waves and waved
uncurled.

103 So he decided he'll take them
Off the face of the earth in hem,
But We downed him and all those who
Were with him in the sinful crew.
104 So We said to Israel's sons true,
"Live in safety in the land too."
But when the second warning came,
We gathered you in a mixed game.
105 We sent the revelation truth,
And in truth it's come down forsooth,
And We just sent you to proclaim
Good news to warn *sinner*s from *shame*.

106 A recitation set out in
Portions so you may find therein
Appropriate recitals for
Men at times, We've revealed the store
In stages, *each one at the door*.

107 Say "If you believe it or not,
It's true that those who in their lot
Received such knowledge beforehand,
When it's recited where they stand,
They fall down on their faces and
In humble prostration's remand.

108 "And they say 'Glory to our Lord.
Our Lord's promise is truly stored.'"
109 They fall on their faces in tears,
Add to their humility's *fears*.

110 Say "Call on Allah or Rahman,
By whatever name you call on
For Him, for to Him do belong
The best of names. Don't make loud song
Of your prayer or whisper along,
But in a middle course and strong."

111 Say "Praise be to God who begets
No son or partners in their sets,
Nor does He need protection from
Humiliation that would come,
Exalt Him for greatness *and hum!*"

The Sabbatarians who hope they know
The right name from the wrong name on
the go,
And take their yahweh's everywhere they
show,

Do not know all the wonders that You
know.

Allah, Allahumma, or Rahman in
Your mercy above health and hope and sin,
It matters not what language in the din
I use to speak to You: I just begin.
Beloved, the nine and ninety names I fear
Do not do You the justice to appear
On lip and tongue, but still I wake to sing
Your names as I whirl round and round the
sting.

Beloved, give me a thousand more and still
I shall not have the words to fit the bill.

Surah 18 Kahf, or the Cave

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 Praise be to Allah, who has sent
His servant the book, and has spent
No crookedness in it or lent.
2 Straight so to warn of punishment
In horror from Him, and so He
May give good news and happily
To those who believe and who do
Good deeds, and they have a good view
For their reward, 3 where they'll remain
For ever. 4 So He'll warn out plain
Those who say "God has sired a son."
5 No knowledge do they have of one,
Nor did their ancestors outdone.
It is a terrible thing that
Comes from their mouths saying out flat
Nothing but lies for all of that.
6 You'd only grieve yourself to death
To follow them, in sorrow's breath,
If they don't believe this word pat.
7 What's on the earth We've made to be
A shining show for earth to see
So We might try them, and so know
Which of them's best in conduct's show.
8 What's on earth We shall turn to dust
And dry earth *without leaf or rust*.

Eternal generation from the great
And immaterial God in estate,
Or the birth in time of the Arian rate,
Are both the falsehoods of the Christian
pate
That rather looked to time's philosophy
Than to the revelation's high decree.
Beloved, I turn from faith and from doubt
too

And merely whirl about the earthen crew
To the sounds of Your Word made clear
and true.

I find the ways and maze from day and
night,
And enter in the joy and in the light,
To find that Your One undefined for men
Who prostrate themselves as Your pleasure
when
They find the way to Your throne set again.

9 Do you mind the cave's fellows and
The scribing were wonders to stand
Among Our signs *throughout the land?*
10 See, the young folk went to the cave,
They said "Our Lord, grant us as brave
Your mercy, set affairs for us
In the right way and without fuss."
11 We covered their ears for a time,
Some years in the cave and the clime.
12 Then We awaked them to try
Which of the two groups come to vie
Was best at reckoning the term
Of years they'd stayed there and affirm.
13 We tell you their story in truth,
They were men who believed from youth
In their Lord, and We set them right
In guidance *to go past the night*.
14 We strengthened their hearts, see they
rose

And said "Our Lord is Lord of bows
In the skies and on earth as well.
We'll never make petition swell
To any other god but Him.
If we did so, it would be grim
To have spoken such a thing dim.
15 "These folk of ours have taken up
For worship other gods in cup
Instead of Him. Why don't they bring
Out a reason that's convincing
For what they do? Who does more wrong
That such as invent such a song
Against God, *knowing all along*.
16 "When you turn away from them and
The things they worship on the land
Besides God, go then to the cave,
Your Lord will pour His mercies' wave
On you and set your ways to please
In comfort and the best of ease."

Beloved, give me a cave, companion and

A canine guide to sleep on paws or stand
Before the entrance to keep out from me
The shadows of the world's idolatry.
Beloved, give me a hermitage of mind
Before the browsing of the sheepled and
kined,

Where on the glow of profit and loss I
Will see above me an eternal pie.
I turn from what I see and hear and know
That there is something other than the
cheer.

I turn from what I think and do for show
And find beyond the doing something dear.
Beloved, as I turn in my turning's go,
The days and nights eternal would appear.

17 "You would have seen the sun come up,
Going to the right of cave's cup,
And when it set turn to the left,
While they lay in the open cleft.
Such are the signs of God He makes.
The one that God guides surely takes
Right guidance. But the one that God
Lets stray, for him you'll find no pod
Of protection to lead him right,
18 "You would have thought upon the sight
That they were awake, though in night
Of sleep. We turned them on their right
And on their left sides, and their dog
Stetched out his front legs on the cog
Of the cave entrance. If you'd come
On them, you would have turned back
dumb

From them and run away in fright.
19 "So we raised them up, so they might
Ask one another. One then asked
'How long have you been here and basked?'
They said 'We stayed a day at best
Or part of a day come to rest.'
They said 'God know best how long you
Have stayed here.' Now send one of crew
With money of yours to the town,
To buy the best food that's come down,
And bring some to you, so you'll eat
All you need of the coming treat.
And let him act with courtesy
And care and not give in degree
Knowledge of you in company.

The emptiness of sleeping death I find
Rebels against the Hellenizing grind,

And all the hope of hearth where coals are
dead

Lays down between its paws a sleepy head.
It is amazing that men find deep sleep
To count no time at all to laugh or weep,
And still believe that the grave is no bed
Of rest after the days on earth have fled.
Beloved, none knows the number of the
folk,
Nor number of the sleeping days in stroke.
The only thing that's sure is just one dog
Entered the cave with them to stay incog.
Perhaps the dog is more important than
The naming and the numbering of man.

20 "For if they found you, they would stone
You or force you to come atone
In their worship, and in that case
You'd never come to win the race."

21 So We made their case known abroad
To the folk, so they'd come to laud
God's promise as true, without doubt
About the time of judgement's shout.
See how the dispute of their case,
To say "Build a house for their grace,"
Their Lord knows best about their pace.
Those who won out in the case said
"Let's build a house of worship spread
Over them there, over each head."

22 Some say there were three, the dog
being
The fourth among them, others seeing
That there were five, the sixth the dog,
With doubt and guessing in a fog,
But others say that seven lay,
The dog was the eighth one to stay.
Say "My Lord knows best how to count,
But few know of the right amount."
Don't stay to argue, except on
An issue that is clear as dawn,
Nor ask any of them about
The sleepers sleeping in redoubt.

Nobody in the world knows how to count
The seven sleepers, no one knows how
many
The years that bless that hidden cave and
mount
With dreamless sleep, or dreams if there be
any.

The empires pass, and with them men of
fame,
While they who are not of this world, but
yet
Rest on its poppy-strewn breast just the
same,
Live, souls unseeing either stage or set.
If they should wake again they'd fall and
pray
To slumber on, the shepherd's dog at
guard,
To wake at last and stand at judgement
Day.
Some choose the better part, though rough
and hard:
Some choose the cave, the silver coin, the
rod,
The sleeping dog, the barren house of God.

23 Don't say about a thing at all,
"I'll surely do so at the call
Of dawn *and after on the ball,*"
24 Except you add "If God but wills."
And mind your Lord when you take spills
Forgetting, and say "I hope that
My Lord will guide me where I'm at
And always closer than this to
The right path *and the one in view.*"

Quoting from good St. James, the Qur'an
waits
Upon the share of love submitting states
To call all men who have the heart to learn
What Your will, my Beloved, sets out to
earn.
If God but will be my watchword today,
And so inform the verses that I pray,
Until I find the right and better way,
The path of guidance from the worldly
sway.
Beloved, I sink upon the dergah floor
And find no touch to rise and whirl the
more
Until Your hand give strength and Your
command.
I wait and wait again the divine hand.
In one rush every flame and spark returns
To You, Beloved, and everything else
burns.

24 So they stayed in their cave for three

Hundred years and some add in spree
Nine more. 26 Say "God knows best how
long

They stayed. With Him is secrets' song
Of heaven and earth. How well He sees,
How finely He hears slightest breeze!
They have no guard other than Him.
I does not share His power in trim
With anyone howe'er so grim.

27 Show what has been revealed to you
Of the book of your Lord on cue.
No one can change His Words, and none
Will you find as a refuge won
Other than Him *as He's begun.*

28 Keep yourself happy with those who
Call on their Lord at morning's view
And at the evening seek His face.

Don't let your eyes stray from their place
To seek the glories of this life.

Don't obey any whose heart We
Have let neglect remembrancy
Of Us, one who follow desires
Of self, whose case at once aspires
Beyond all boundaries and wires.

29 Say "The truth's from your Lord." Let
him

Who will believe, and let him dim
Who will, reject it and with vim.
For the wrongdoers We've prepared
A fire like walls and roof when shared
Of a tent to hem them in bared.
If they cry for relief, they'll get
Some water like melted brass set,
And it will scald their faces wet,
How awful is the drink they've met!
How hard the couch to lie on yet!

Al-haqqu min rabbikum is the word
Of dhikr I repeat as I am stirred
By the sweet syllables of the Qur'an
That whisper and resound upon the dawn.
Al-haqqu min rabbikum said the sweet
Old dervish as I sat beside his feet.
He pointed to the grass around and said
Min rabbikum is what the blades are led
To whisper and to shout above my head.
He pointed to his wrist and said the blood
Recited always al-Haqq in a flood
Of praise to You and wonder to each man
Who has the grace to be beneath Your ban,
The mercy to rest in Your world in span.

30 As for those who believe and do
Righteousness, truly We'll not view
The perishing of their reward,
Of any who take righteous cord.
31 For them eternal gardens grow.
Beneath them there the rivers flow.
They'll put on golden bracelets glow,
And wear green clothing of silk fine
And brocade heavy in design.
There on raised thrones they will recline.
How good the reward, and how fine
The couch they have where to recline!

Green clothes are what my own grandson
prefers
Instead of the chinchilla and such furs,
And those he dresses in green, only curs
Surround him with admiring eyes and
spurs.
Green clothing for the righteous and the
just
Instead of blackened canvass and stained
rust
Are the reward of those who know to trust.
Green clothing then delights one who
concurs.
Beloved, I am a dervish dog at best,
And if my fur is not enough in crest,
The woollen state is the one where I rest.
I'm not one to sit out in silken dressed.
Let me be among those who are both
blessed
And tricked out in the lesser cuts and shirrs.

32 Show them the parable of two
Men, to one of them We gave two
Gardens with vineyards and around
Them date palms, in between the ground
Of the two We set corn-fields round.
33 Each of those gardens produced well,
And did not fail to meet the spell,
And in between We caused to swell
A river flowing not to quell.
34 This one said in abundance found
To his companion on the ground
As they were arguing around,
"I'm richer than you are and so
I have more honour on the go
And power in my men to show."
35 He went into his garden then

In a state unjust to his den.
He said "I trow that this will then
Ever disappear from the glen,
36 "Nor do I think that judgement hour
Will come. Even if I in power
Am brought back to my Lord, I'll find
Something better to change outlined."
37 His friend said to him as they went
About their course of argument,
"Do you deny Him who created
You out of dust and then elated
From a sperm drop and then formed you
Into a man and set in view?
38 "But for my part, He's God, my Lord,
None shall join with my Lord adored.
39 "Why did you not when you went in
Your garden say "Let God's will win!
There's no power but with God begin.
If you perceive me less than you
In wealth and children come on cue,
40 "It may be my Lord will give me
Something better than your land's fee,
And He might send on your land yet
The thunderbolts for the sky set,
And make it a bog of sand met.
41 "Or the garden's water might run
Off underground, so when you've done
You'll never find it there unspun."
42 So his produce was set about,
And he was left twisting in doubt
And wringing hands over the rout
Of what he's spent on property,
Which had now fallen in degree
To the foundations in the spree.
He could just say "Now woe is me!
I wish that I had never set
Partners to my Lord such unmet."
43 He did not have hosts to help him
Against God, nor was he one grim
To save himself *and set up trim*.
44 The only protection comes from
God who is the true one in sum.
He's the best to reward and best
To give success *above the rest*.

Two gardeners have confronted each with
each
Since Abel brought the lamb and Cain the
peach.
The wealth and pomp of offering then
begun

Has been the source of every battle won
And lost in name of faith upon the ball.
Beloved One, keep me from the churchly
stall.

I want no garden furnished with the fruit
Of greed, I want no family to boot.
I leave the hope that fruit may save my soul
Before the day of judgement with its toll.
The garden is a fragile sort of peace,
It's wall is scaled by school-boy on release,
And all the hope and help on earth is left
When gardens fall and owners are bereft.

45 Set forth to them similitude
Of the life of this world and crude.
It's like the rain that we send down
From the skies, the earth's green from
frown

Drinks it up, but soon becomes brown,
Which the winds strew in scattered crown.
It's just God who prevails above
All things *below*, *all things in love*.

46 Riches and children are the lot
That tempts within the earthly plot.
But the things that endure, good deeds,
Are best in your Lord's sight and needs,
As rewards and best as hope feeds.

47 One day We shall remove the hills,
And you will see the earth that fills
As level, and We'll gather them
Together and not leave from hem
Any one of them *with his bills*.

48 And they'll be mustered in their lines:
"Now have you come to Us in signs
As We created you at first.
Indeed, you thought We had not durst
Brought you to the appointed, cursed
To meet *before Us as to burst*."

49 The book will be set out to see,
And you will see the sinful spree
In terror great, because of what
Is written there. They will say shut:
"Oh, woe to us, what book is this!
It leaves out nothing here to kiss
Of small or great, but takes account
Of it to everything's amount."
They'll find all they did set for show.
No one will your Lord fail to know
To treat, or with injustice stow.

Quoting the Psalm that life is like the grass

That's mown in morning dew and in the
pass
Of evening's dried and burnt remains as
fresh

In the Qur'an as in the Bible's mesh.
I see the passing of life in a breeze,
I see the passing of all things that please,
And as my wrath and tears are dried away
Along with drying of life's pleased sway,
I see the worth of that eternal day
When You alone, Beloved, hold sceptre's
clay.

I trust that on that day You will be just
And merciful in Your decrees on dust,
The stone heart carved by sculptor set
alight
By the immortal pangs that strike the night.

50 See, We said to the angels, "Bow
Down to Adam." They anyhow
Bowed down except Iblis. And he
Was one of the jinns, and in spree
He broke the command of his Lord.
Will you take him with progeny
As protectors rather than Me?
And they are foes to you in cord.
Evil will be the exchange stored
For the wrong-doers *unimplored*.
51 I did not call them to witness
Creation of the sky's address
And of the earth, nor their own making.
It is no task set for the taking
Of such as I to lead astray.
52 Once day He'll say "Now call on those
You thought My partners as you chose,"
And they will call on them, but they
Will not hark to the things they say,
And We'll make them a place to stay
Together in perdition's sway.
53 The sinful ones shall see the fire
And realize their fate is dire,
No way will they find to escape
And turn away from it to gape.
We've shown in detail in this book
Of the Qur'an, let men just look,
In every kind of parable,
But man is in things to the full
One to content *if with a bull*.

55 What's there to keep men from belief,
Now that guidance comes in relief
To them; nor from prayer to forgive

From their Lord, but the ancient sieve
 Of old repeated to make live,
 Or else the wrath brought in the place
 For them to confront face to face?
 56 We only send the messengers
 To give good news and warnings' stirs.
 But unbelievers vainly state
 Their arguments to set up as great
 Against the truth. They treat My signs
 As a joke, and their warnings' lines.
 57 Who does more harm than one who sees
 Reminder of his Lord's signs' breeze,
 But he turns away from them, and
 Forgets what's sent out by his hand?
 We've set veils on their hearts lest they
 Should understand this on a day,
 And on their ears deafness to sway,
 If you call them to guidance' way,
 They'll never accept guidance' sway.
 58 But your Lord's most forgiving and
 Full of mercy. If He'd command
 Them to account for what they've earned,
 Then He'd have hastened their plight
 learned,
 But they have their appointed time,
 Beyond which they'll find in no clime
 A refuge from punishment's grime.
 59 Such were the people We destroyed
 When they iniquities employed,
 But We fixed an appointed time
 For their destruction for their crime.

I fear the veils that You have set before
 My heart, Beloved, that hide me from the
 score
 Of signs of Your existence and the way
 You maintain the creation in Your sway.
 I steer the veils that I have met around
 My hiding place upon the earthly ground,
 And thread them out of darkness into day,
 And so find reasons somehow here to pray.
 Beloved, there is a refuge on the earth,
 Between the gates of fire and earth for
 berth,
 And to that place a bend my steps in turn
 That circle in the dergah what I earn.
 I look at everything that spins in spark
 And fade from life and light into the dark.

60 See, Moses said to one with him,
 "I'll not give up however grim

Till I reach joining of two seas,
 Or spend years travelling *on my knees*.
 61 But when they reached the joining
 place,
 They forgot their fish, in its trace
 It went through the sea as in grace
 Of a tunnel straight without lace.
 62 When they'd gone on, then Moses said
 To the one with him, "Let's be fed
 With early meal. We've suffered much
 In weariness from travel's touch."
 63 He answered, "Did you see when we
 Came to the rock? From mind did flee
 The matter of the fish. But none
 Except Satan could have begun
 To make me forget to tell you
 About it. It took its way through
 The sea in a marvellous view."
 64 Moses said "That's what we were here
 To look for." So they went back sheer
 In the way they had come in fear.
 65 They found one of Our servants dear
 On whom We'd bestowed mercy's gear
 From Ourselves and whom We had taught
 To know things from Our presence
 wrought.
 66 Moses said to him, "May I come
 To follow you, so you in sum
 Will teach me of the truth that you
 Have been taught and the higher view?"
 67 He said "You will not, it is true,
 Have patience with the things I do.
 68 How can you be patience about
 Things you don't understand in rout?"
 69 And Moses said "You will find me,
 If God so wills, do patiently,
 And I shall not disobey you
 In anything I come to do."
 70 He said "If you would follow me,
 Then make no questionings of me
 Of anything until I speak
 To you about the thing you seek."
 71 They both went on till in the boat
 He sunk it, and no more to float.
 And Moses said "Have you sunk it
 To drawn those in it as unfit?
 You've done a strange thing in your wit."
 72 He answered, "Didn't I tell you
 You'd have no patience in my view?"
 72 Said Moses, "Don't chide me that I
 Forgot, and don't cause me to sigh

By making it hard where I lie.”

74 They kept on going till they met
A youth, and he killed him, you bet.
Said Moses, “Have you killed a man
As innocent and without plan
To hurt anyone? Surely this
Is a foul deed you ought to miss!”

When Khidr killed the boy, Your servant
said
“What has he done, that he is lying dead?”
So it becomes the one who lives in law
To question every act and stand in awe.
But law alone is not the only gate.
The guide led Moses on, but let him wait
To see the father’s and the mother’s love
Fulfilled of him, saved by his death, and of
The love of one unborn. All things return
Into the gate where everything must burn.
Have patience in the gate of law and then
Have passion in the gate of fire again.
The fire is quenched in water of the
knowing,
And water swallowed by the earth of
showing.

75 He answered, “Did I not tell you
You’d have no patience in my crew?”
76 He said “If I ever ask you
About a thing after this brew,
Don’t keep me in your company.
Then you’d have reason in degree
To dismiss and deliver me.”
77 Then they went on until they came
To dwellers of a city’s fame,
And asked for food, but they refused
Them hospitality accused.
They found there a wall just about
To fall down, and set it up stout.
Moses said “If you wanted to,
You’d get paid for the thing you do.”
78 He said “That’s enough, we must part
From one another where we start.
Now I’ll tell you the secret of
What you were impatient in shove.
79 “As for the boat, it was owned by
Some men in poverty to lie.
They sailed in it on waters nigh.
But I wanted to make it be
Unusable, for the decree
Of a king near who seized each boat

By force, each one that was afloat.

80 “As for the youth, his mum and dad
Were folk of faith, they were not bad,
And we were afraid he would grieve
Them by rebellion’s stubborn weave
Ungrateful and without reprieve.
81 “So we wished that their Lord would
give

Them in exchange one who would live
In better purity and in
Closer love to them without sin.
82 “As for the wall, it was owned by
Two orphaned youths in town nearby.
Beneath it was buried to lie
A treasure that belonged to them.
There father was a righteous gem.
So your Lord wished that they should come
To their age full of strength in sum
And get their treasure out when done,
A mercy from your Lord to stun.
I did not do it by my own
Will. Such is the meaning alone
Of what you found to be a bone
Impatiently *with heart of stone.*”

The explanation of all things unfair
That I see round me on the fetid air
I trust will make me praise You all the
more
Upon the glassy sea and heavenly shore.
I see the iron seeds sprout in the way,
I see the brazen faces turn and bray,
And find no solace till I turn from me,
See the face divine of eternity.
Beloved, three times You come to chastise
how
Impatiently I stand before Your brow.
With faith and without sight teach me to
show
The hope and expectation of the glow
Of Your fast providence. Leave me to sleep
Upon the deck despite the storm I weep.

83 They ask you about Zul-qarnain.
Say “I’ll recite his tale not vain.”
84 We did establish on the earth
His power and We gave him in berth
The ways and means to all ends’ worth.
85 He followed one such way in girth,
86 Until when he reached setting sun,
He found it set in spring of dun.

Near there he found a people spun.
 We said "O Zul-qarnain, come now
 And punish the folk anyhow,
 Or treat them with kindness and bow."
 87 He said "Whoever does the wrong,
 We'll punish that one, sent along
 Back to his Lord. And He will rise
 To punish him in horrid guise.
 88 "But the one who believes and works
 In righteousness, he'll not have shirks,
 But a fine reward, and his task
 Is easy by the thing We ask."
 89 Then he went down another way,
 90 Until he found sun's rising sway,
 And found it rising on a folk
 For whom We'd not given from stroke
 Of sun any protecting oak.
 91 As they stayed, We completely knew
 What was before him *in their crew*.
 92 Then he followed another way,
 93 Then followed he another way
 Until he reached a place in bay
 Between two mountains, where he found
 Beneath them a people around
 Who hardly understood a word.
 94 They said "O Zul-qarnain, Gog and
 Magog do great mischief on land.
 Shall we give you money to make
 A block between us and their wake?
 95 He said "What my Lord's set in me
 Is better. So with industry
 Help me, and I'll build a stout block
 Between you and them *in the rock*.
 96 "Bring me blocks of iron in stock."
 So when at last he filled the space
 Between the mountainsides in trace,
 He say "Blow." Then when he'd made hot,
 He said "Bring molten lead in plot
 For me to pour over the lot."
 97 So they were made unable to
 Go over it or to dig through.
 98 He said "This is a mercy too
 From my Lord. But when comes in view
 The promise of my Lord, He'll turn
 It into dust. And so will burn
 In truth my Lord's promise to earn."

Whether it's Alexander or Darius
 Named here is a question still to defy us.
 I know Ezekiel's imprecations rise
 Against Gog and Magog up to the skies.

And Revelation makes the reader wise
 To know that pair are Satan's to devise
 Before the lake of fire. Beloved, despise.
 I take position here righteous and pious.
 The day of Gog comes faster now than
 when
 Muhammad came reciting as with pen.
 The iron and the lead that kept the way
 Shall melt at last and mountains shall
 decay.
 I hear the cry of the great king and wait
 For Your sent ones, Beloved, come to the
 gate.

99 On that day We'll leave them to rush
 Like waves on one another push.
 The trumpet will sound and We'll take
 Them all in groups for judgement's sake.
 100 And We'll bring hell that day for those
 Who don't believe to see the show,
 101 Whose eyes had been veiled from the
 sight
 Of My remembrance, and who might
 Not even be able to hear.
 102 Do unbelievers think they can
 Take My servants as guards in scan
 Besides Me? We have prepared hell
 Unbelievers can enjoy well.
 103 Say "Shall we tell you of those who
 Lose most by their own deeds in view?"
 104 "Those whose efforts are wasted here
 In this life, while they thought their gear
 Increased by their works done *in fear*?"
 105 They are those who deny the signs
 Of their Lord and the true designs
 That they must meet Him. Vain will be
 Their works then and then nor shall We
 Give them on judgement day some fee.
 106 That's their reward, hell, because they
 Rejected faith, and took My way
 Of signs and messengers in sway
 To be a joke *found in some play*.

I do, Beloved, rejoice in the great hell
 That You provide for those not doing well.
 The prisms that all men see on the way
 Through this terrestrial studio in play
 Of the sculptor divine in cosmic ray
 Suffice for joy. Let hell then come in sway.
 I do, Beloved, deny the many signs
 That wickedness provoking in designs

Shall rise in its success in lines and lines.
Instead I turn my faith to You and see
The hopeful glimmers of eternity.
As paradise and hell compete, I find
That sight remains without faith in a bind,
And hope creates an eye that is not blind.

107 As for those who believe and do
Righteous deeds, they have found in view
For their enjoyment gardens true
Of paradise *given in due*,

108 Where they shall stay. No change will
they

Wish for their part *and from that day*.

109 Say "If the sea were writing ink,
For my Lord's words, then at the brink
Would the sea run dry before they
Were written all, and yet in stay
If We added the like in sway."

110 Say "I am just a man like you,
But inspiration's come in view,
That your God is one God, and who
Expects to meet his Lord, let him
Do righteousness and not be dim
To worship his Lord, and admit
No partners with Him as unfit."

I guess noble Qur'an's the source of all
Those poems and poses that before the fall
Of love require the sea be ink to write
The words that nothing else can quite
requite.

Let sea be ink or not, I need no tint
To spread my words to You in awful hint
Of love and find frustration and some time
My very wrath set forth in fancied rhyme.
Beloved, let me with ink and pen or not
Set forth the truth of what You have in plot:
That You are one and none joins You in
lot,

But shall meet every creature You have
made

To worship You or not, till all are paid,
To do the righteous deed or come unstayed.

Surah 19 Maryam

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 Kaf, ha, ya, 'ain, sad.

2 A recitation of mercy

From your Lord to His servant free,
Zachariah. 3 He cried now see

To his Lord in dark mystery,
4 Praying "O my Lord, how weak are
My bones, and my head's hair of tar
Is shining grey. But never yet
Have I been unblessed as I set
My prayer to You, O my Lord met.
5 I now fear my kin and such who
Are after me. My wife is barren,
So give me an heir then to share in
From Yourself and one I can care in,
6 To represent me, represent
Descendants of Jacob. Present
Him, O my Lord, one with whom You
Are well-pleased *as he comes in view*."
7 "O Zachariah, We give you
Good news of a son, his name true
Shall be John. On no one of that
Name have We bestowed honour flat
Before." 8 He said "O my Lord, how
Shall I have a son anyhow
When my wife's barren and I've grown
Weak from old age that's in me sown?"

Just like a man is Zachariah here.

He prays for grace, and when grace would
appear,

He doubts it's possible. If so, why did
He pray in the first place and raise a lid
On can of terms? But so men are, I see.
They pray for freedom, but will not be free.
They pray for justice, but will not be just.
They pray for life, but long to enter dust.
Beloved, give me a name and son or not,
Give me a place to stand in judgement's lot,
Or send me out with empty hand in plot,
But in Your giving and Your sending
sought,

Remember I too am a man in store,
Irrational before the heavenly door.

9 He said "So your Lord does proclaim,
'That's easy for Me, just the same
I did create you once before,
When you were nothing in the store.'"

10 He said "O my Lord, give a sign."

The answer was, "Here is your sign,
You shall not speak to any man
For three nights, though not dumb in span."

10 So Zachariah came out to
His folk from his chamber in view.
He told them by signs to raise high

Praises of Allah to the sky
In morning light and evening nigh.
12 "O John, grasp the book with your
might!"

And We gave him wisdom from light
Of youth to keep him wise in sight,
13 And righteousness as from Us too,
And purity, devout in pew,
14 And kind to his parents, and he
Was no proud or rebellious wee.
15 So peace be on him the day he
Was born, the day he dies, the day
When he'll be raised to life to stay.

The three days of John's farther are unlike
The Gospel story. Some will find a spike
For unbelief before the Word and strike.
The worshipping of factuality
Couched in language of dull reality
Turns the heart from the art of sending
down

By word of mouth traditions in the town.
What is a grace come visible to men
Is sure to be transmitted once again.
The fact that one remembers the thing
spread

While some in looking look beyond the
head
Does not mean any lie who in their awe
Tell best the tale they can of what they saw.
Beloved, let me be among the right led.

16 Recite in the book Mary's tale,
When she went apart from the pale
Of her kin to place in the east.
17 She placed a screen from them
increased,

Then We sent her our angel, and
He came before her as she scanned
In form of a man as was planned.

18 She said "I seek safety from you
In the most gracious One in view,
If you fear God, *stay back and do.*"

19 He said "No, I am only sent
A messenger from your Lord lent
To you gift of a holy son."
20 She said "How shall I have a son,
Since no man has touched me and come,
And I am not unchaste in sum?"

Mary is no fool as some try to show,

Who thinks that she can hide the come and
go

Of fornication with a pious glow
Of virgin birth planned after secret low.
She makes no claims of false gods and the
tale

Of purity after the events pale.
But like the good Zachariah before,
She doubts the birth of one beyond the
chore

Of human faith unhappily wrought more.
Beloved, let me be like Mary as I
Look out upon a wicked world and spy
The angel coming to me like a man.
I have no hope or thought or any plan
To raise myself to glory in the scan.

21 He said "Exactly. Your Lord states,
'That's easy for Me *in the gates*
To appoint him a sign for men,
A mercy from Us, set again.

22 She conceived him and she went out
With him to deserted redoubt.

23 The pains of childbirth drove her to
The trunk of a palm, she cried too,
"Oh that I had died before this!
That I'd been forgot in abyss!"

24 But sounded to her there below,
"Don't be sorry, your Lord's not slow
To give a stream beneath your row.

25 "Shake towards you the trunk of the
palm.

It will drop down fresh ripe dates calm
On you. 26 "So eat and drink and then

Refresh your eye. If you see men,
Say 'I have vowed a fast to God
Most gracious and this day in pod
I'll not discourse with human laud.'"

The myth of inn and oriental fare,
Of wisemen and Mythraic sort of care
Are missing from the Qur'an, so beware.
Without them this may not be Word of God
Come down to comfort lowly folk on sod.
It may be evil treachery in pod.
Beloved, the human mind has grief enough
To chase repentance from the heart in
rough,

And the discrepancy that we must find
In Scriptures is a thing to make us blind.
And yet I'm glad to know poor Mary felt

The freshing of the dates there where she
knelt.
And yet I'm glad to know the stream ran
fresh
Beneath the pains that Maries may enmesh.

27 At last she brought it to her folk,
Carried him. They said "Mary croak,
A wonder you have brought in yoke.

28 "O Aaron's sister, your dad's stroke
Was not for evil, and your mum
Was not an unchaste woman's bum."

29 But she just pointed to the child.
They said "How can we talk so wild
With one whose babe in cradle mild?"

30 He said "I'm servant of Allah,
He's given me revelation's awe,
And made me a prophet to draw.

31 "And He's made me blessed
everywhere,

And he has enjoined on my prayer
And charity long as I wear.

32 "He's made me kind to my mum and
Not proud and miserable to stand.

33 "So peace is on me the day I
Was born, on me the day I die,
And on the day again that I
Shall be raised up to life *with cry*."

The formula is just the same as that
Above that speaks of John upon his mat
As blessed in birth and death and
resurrection.

The sweet Qur'an does not make a
selection.

The clear text is that both of them like men
Are born and die and resurrect again.

There is no occultation to return
To die upon a future place and burn.
Beloved, when I read the Qur'an, let me
Receive the word the Qur'an has in fee,
Neglect the speculation and lies
That men invent to cover up their spies.
Beloved, when I read, let me note full well
The truth despite the words men speak
from hell.

34 So Jesus was the son of Mary.
It's a true word and not one chary.
35 It's not fit to God's majesty
That He should beget progeny.

Glory to Him, at His decree,
He only says to it, "So be!"

And it is *to eternity*.

36 God is my Lord and your Lord too.

Him therefore serve, this is the view
Of the way straight and *the way true*.

37 But the sects differ with themselves,
Woe to unbelievers on shelves,
Because of Judgement's coming day.

38 How clearly they will see the way
And hear, the day that will appear
Before Us. But the unjust fear
Nothing today but they appear
In error's *wickedness and clear*.

39 But warn them of the day of pain,
When the matter decreed is plain,
For they neglect faith on the wane.

40 It's We who will inherit earth,
And all creatures on it of worth,
To Us they all come back in berth.

The Bible does not know the Christ child
spoke

To Mary's relatives, friends and kinfolk
To justify his mother with the bloke
That here accuses her of unchaste stroke.
And yet it is a thing that I'd have thought
Of first of all, such accusation brought.
There's not a woman round who bears a
child

Out of wedlock except they say she's wild.
Beloved, I bear no wonders in my loam,
I set no lights of miracles in home.
And so I need no witness I am right,
Nor any witness that I've come to fight.
If Christ has spoken once, he's spoken well,
Whether the crowd believes or not the
spell.

41 The tale of Abraham, and he
Was a man of the truth to see
A prophet *come in God's mercy*.

42 See, he said to his dad, "O my
Father, why do you worship, why,
What does not hear and see and what
Can never profit you in gut?

43 "O my father, to me has come
Knowledge that has not touched your bum,
So follow me, I'll guide you to
A way that's plain and straight and true.

44 "O my father, don't serve Satan.

For Satan's a rebel in span
 Against the most gracious in plan.
 45 "O my father, I fear lest there
 Come on you punishment to bear
 From the most gracious, so that you
 Become a friend to Satan's crew."
 46 He answered, "Do you hate my gods,
 O Abraham? Then stop your pods,
 Or I will stone you. Get away
 From me and a good long time stay."
 47 Said Abraham, "Peace be on you.
 I'll pray to my Lord for the due
 Forgiveness on you. He to me
 Always comes to act graciously.
 48 "And I'll turn away from you all
 And from those upon whom you call
 Besides God. I'll call on my Lord.
 Maybe by my prayer to my Lord
 I'll not be left unblessed, *restored*."

The error of Abraham was the way
 He spoke there to his father gone astray.
 Few dads are capable of hearing what
 Their sons have learned of the world's why
 and but.

The other way around is what is known,
 Tradition's handed down from father's
 throne

To son who takes the joy of family crown
 And worships at the altar of renown.
 Beloved, the call of Abraham is not
 A thing to envy in the human plot.
 It separates the families and creeds
 Neglecting many, many human needs.
 Let me call on the God of Abraham,
 Forgetting who he is and what I am.

49 When he had turned away from them
 And from those they worshipped in hem
 Besides God, We granted him there
 Isaac and Jacob and each bear
 Prophetic role We made to share.
 50 We granted them Our mercy too,
 And height of honour on tongue true.
 51 Mention in the book Moses too.
 For he was specially chosen and
 He was a messenger to stand
 As prophet *far as Egypt's land*.
 52 We called him from the mount's right
 side,
 And brought him near to Us to bide

In secret *conversation wide*.
 53 And by Our mercy We gave him
 His brother Aaron also trim
 A prophet *without woe or whim*.

You did forget to mention here the fact
 That Aaron was the prophet come in tact
 To speak for Moses to the king and folk
 Because good Moses was slow as he spoke.
 His slowness of speech may be why You
 did

Call Moses a god to the thing he hid.
 Moses was god to pharaoh and his brother
 Became his prophet in the hopes to smother
 Oppression. Every true god has that will,
 The will to set men free of human bill.
 Beloved, if I love Moses and his mate,
 The priestly Aaron at the slaughter gate,
 It is a human love. It does not rate
 As anything salvific on the hill.

54 Mention Ishmael too in the book.
 He was true in his promised nook,
 Messenger and prophet *forsook*.

55 He used to call his folk to prayer
 And charity, and he was there
 Accepted in his Lord's sight's share.

56 Mention Idris in the book too.
 He was a man and prophet true.

57 He raised him exalted in view.

58 Those were some of the prophets on
 Whom God poured out His grace outdrawn,
 Of Adam's descendants and of
 Those We bore with Noah in glove,
 And descendants of Abraham
 And Israel, those guided like lamb
 By Us and chosen. When the signs
 Of the most Gracious sounded lines
 In hearing of them, they would fall
 Down in prostration at the call
 To adoration in tears' thrall.

59 But after them there came a crew
 Who missed their prayers and followed
 stew

Of their lusts soon, and they will face
 Destruction of their wicked race,
 60 Except those who repent believing,
 And work such righteousness receiving.
 For these will come into the place
 Of the garden and without pace
 Of being wronged in the least trace.

61 The gardens of eternity,
 Those that the most gracious freely
 Has promised to His servants in
 The unseen, for His promise must
 Come to pass *once upon the dust*.
 62 They will not hear there any vain
 Conversing, but the greetings plain
 Of peace. And they will have therein
 Their nourishment by morn and din
 Of evening *when they're coming in*.

When Ellen White called for two meals a
 day

I reckon she had read the Qur'an's way
 Of eating morn and afternoon in sway
 Of paradise when the Lord's come to pay.
 Or then she had a vision of the place
 As a prophetic means to know the grace
 Directly that Muhammad without fail
 Reveals of paradise in meat and kale.
 Beloved, forgive my joking at Your quest,
 Since I have been Your own and honoured
 guest,
 And eaten in the Kaaba's shadowed vest
 The cakes of honey-dew and nectared best.
 The greeting of peace falls here on my ear,
 Before the heavenly home gains to appear.

63 Such is the garden that We give
 As a portion to those who live
 Our servants guarding against sieve
 Of evil. 64 "We descend not but
 By orders from your Lord. He's got
 What is before us and behind,
 And what's in the middle to find.
 And so your Lord never forgets,
 65 "Lord of the skies and earthly sets,
 And all between them. Worship Him,
 And be regular and as trim
 In patience in His worship *grim*.
 Do you know any worthy of
 The same renown and so much love?"
 66 Man says "What! When I'm dead, shall I
 Then be raised up alive to spy?"
 67 But does man not remember We
 Created him from naught to see?

Creatio ex nihilo is met
 In dogma of the Christian sort of set,
 And even down to earth Jews I have let
 Expound their theories also are not wet.

The gnostic faith in immaterial
 Has transfixed every mind of lad and gal.
 The Bible says from things invisible,
 Not things that don't exist and are not full.
 Beloved, I do affirm the recognition
 That You are neither material submission
 Nor any immaterial ignition.
 The fact that You're not to be defined in
 And out of the mind that humans would
 win
 Is rather proof than not that You still grin.

68 So by your Lord without a doubt,
 We'll gather them from round about,
 As well as evil ones in rout.
 Then We'll bring them out on their knees
 Around about hell *as We please*.
 69 Then We'll pull out of every sect
 All those who were worst to select
 Stubborn rebellion against Him
 Who is most gracious *and with vim*.
 70 We know best who's most worthy there
 Of being burned therein for share.
 71 There's none of you who can escape
 Passing over it. It's the shape
 Of your Lord's decree, *no red tape*.
 72 But We'll save those who guarded then
 Against such evil among men,
 And We'll leave the wrong-doers there,
 Cast down on their knees for their share.

It's by Your knowledge and not by
 foresight
 That You, Creator of all things, do right
 In casting the rebellious ones in hell
 And saving whom You will from that dark
 spell.
 It's by Your sovereignty and by Your grace
 That all men shall once come before Your
 face
 To meet the judgement that their works
 would trace
 Upon the sod of granite and of lace.
 Beloved, I call Your justice down on me
 As on all men and long so to be free
 To die in hell or else in paradise
 Enjoy the undeserved of good and spice.
 It's by Your knowledge, grace in
 sovereignty
 That all and any meet eternity.

73 When Our clear signs are read aloud
To them, the unbelievers proud
Say to those who believe, "Which of
The two sides is the best in glove?
Which makes the better argument
To show in the council when sent?"
74 How many generations went
Before them to Our destruction,
Who were superior in fun
And arms and before the eye spun?

The argument from civilized sounds great
From pen of Chesterton at going rate.
It also sounded good in ancient Rome
In tolerance for every idol home,
Despite philosophy of doubt on loam.
It sounded good when brought to bear upon
Sly Socrates in draught of hemlock drawn.
The argument that civilized is best
Filled Amorite heart and kidney with zest
Against the atheistic Abraham
Who travelled to ignore the gods in cam
At every post that he endured with sham.
Beloved, though Cain still spells his
speculation,
I look about to find a righteous nation.

75 Say "If anyone goes astray,
The most Gracious extends a ray
To them until when they see dire
Warning of God, either in pain
Or the coming, then once again
They'll realize whose place is worst,
And who is weak in power and cursed.
76 And God puts forward guiding those
Who seek the guidance as it grows,
And everlasting things, good deeds,
Are best in your Lord's sight for needs,
And best when they return from creeds.
77 Have you seen the kind who reject
Our signs, yet say "I am select
To gain wealth and offspring unwrecked?"
78 Has he seen through to the unseen,
Or made a pact behind the screen
With the most Gracious One and keen?
79 No, We'll write down what he says, and
We add to his pains out of hand.
80 To Us returns all that he speaks,
And he'll appear for all he seeks
Before Us bare and lone *like freaks*.
81 They've taken other gods than God,

To give them power and glory's prod.
82 But they'll reject their worshiping
And become foes against their thing.

The very gods imaginary and
Formed of the souls of devils in their band,
Reject the worship they themselves in hand
Inspired and fostered on the minds of men.
They will rise up in their rejection then.
The very idols that in splendour stand
Upon the city temples to command
Refuse the worship of the heathen den.
The gods of intellect's philosophy
Who are of fateful spirit's primacy
Require prostration of the heart set free
Until a day when spirit turns to dust
And worshipper must bite the bitter crust.
The blind prayer fails to rise as fail it must.

83 Don't you see how we set the ones
Of wickedness against the buns
Of unbelievers, to incite
Them to fury against their plight?
84 So do not rush against them, for
We just give them a little score.
85 The day We gather righteous ones
To the most gracious, like a crew
In front of royalty in view
Of decorations, 86 and We cast
The sinners into hell to last
Like the parched cattle driven down
To water *to assuage their crown*,
87 No one will have the mediation
But such as has got the permission
From the most gracious Lord in station.
88 They say "The most gracious addition
Is that He's sired a son." 89 Indeed
You've published a most monstrous creed.
90 At it the skies would burst their seams,
The earth crack up under the gleams,
And mountains crash in crazy reams,
91 That they should cast a son upon
The most gracious *at eve or dawn*.
92 For it does not fit majesty
Of the most gracious One that He
Should sire sons without dignity.

The sweet Qur'an agrees, it seems, with that
Monastic sort of speculation's twat,
That celibacy becomes spirit's flame
And faith more than attraction to a dame

Or stud, depending on gender of same.
 It might have just as well seen a conceit
 Conclusive in the propagative treat,
 And said that You should not be deprived
 where
 The human has a procreative share.
 All arguments in faith and doubt seem
 dreary,
 And I am sated with the book and weary.
 Each point has counterpoint and every skit
 Is acted against its own counterfeit.
 Beloved, You are the only One to sit.

93 There is no being found above
 In the sky or in earthly glove
 But must come to most gracious one
 As a servant *and not a son*.
 94 He takes them all into account
 Precisely knowing their amount.
 95 And every one of them will come
 To Him in individual hum
 On the day of judgement in sum.
 96 On those who believe and do deeds
 Of righteousness, most gracious leads
 Them in the stores of His love's creeds.
 97 So We've made it easy to say
 In your own language and to pray,
 So with it you may give good news
 To righteous ones and warning clues
 To people in contention's pews.
 98 How many generations' views
 Before them have We just destroyed?
 Can you find even one employed
 Or hear a hint of their fame joyed?

The symphony of Your creation's bound
 Rises in glory and in speech around
 The universe that's mine in several sound
 Of hill and lake and forest where like
 hound
 I life my head to howl Your glories
 gowned.
 Is Arabic a tongue of ease? Not so,
 But if I let that falsehood fall and go,
 You will impose a greater on my sight.
 Hebrew is easier, and that's truth trite.
 You might have given dervish every tongue
 To compliment the canine sort of lung.
 But You gave Arabic and chance to wield
 A verbal sword before the Torah's shield.
 I may recite, but I keep eye unpeeled.

Surah 20 Ta Ha

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 Ta Ha.

2 We've not sent down Qur'an to you
 To be distress for you in pew,
 3 But only as an admonition
 To those who fear God's ammunition.
 4 A revelation from Him who
 Created earth and heavens' view.
 5 The Most Gracious is firmly set
 Upon the throne *no others get*.
 6 To Him belongs what's in the sky
 And on the earth, and all that's by,
 And all beneath the ground to spy.
 7 If You pronounce the word aloud,
 For certainly He knows the shroud
 And what is even more in cloud.
 8 Allah! There is no god but He!
 To Him the names most beautifully.

"Allah, there is no god but He" resounds
 Upon the fatal air above the grounds
 Of battle for the souls of men and for
 The treasures that such men may keep in
 store.

The thrill of truth is great to bolster hand
 Of violence against womaned and manned,
 And keeps the rage run ragged to the full
 As the believers kill, and fight and pull.
 Beloved, let me not shout Your name aloud
 Before the wonder of the jostling crowd.
 There is no hope in congregations set,
 And hardly in the few that I have met.
 And still I hope in You beyond despair,
 Beyond the raging of the natal air.

9 Has Moses' story come to you?
 10 Behold, he saw a fire *true*:
 So he said to his family, "Tarry,
 I see a fire, perhaps *if wary*
 I can bring you some burning brand
 From it, or guidance *out of hand*."
 11 But when he arrived at the fire,
 A voice was heard, "Moses, *retire!*
 12 "Truly I am your Lord! Therefore
 Put off your shoes *before the door!*
 You're in the sacred valley Tuwa.
 13 "For indeed I have chosen you a
Prophet: Hear, then, the inspiration.
 14 "Truly, I am Allah: There's no

God but I, so serve Me *in station*,
Establish the prayer *where you go*
To celebrate My praise *and know*.
15 "Indeed, the hour is coming fast,
Though hidden by design *at last*,
For every soul to get reward
By measure of her works outpoured.
16 "So don't let those who don't believe
In it, but follow their lusts' weave,
Turn you away from it, or you
Will be destroyed out of your pew.

When You speak to a man, Beloved, You
show
First that You are One beyond come and go
Of human life and tirade and the flow
Of civilized contempt that fills the row.
When You speak out, Beloved, You're at
the brink
Of hope for humankind, for those who
think,
And at Your speaking thought turns to the
light,
And souls are snatched away from their
dark night.
Beloved, no charge can make the seasoned
glow
Of sky turn health and wealth on earth
below,
And yet the heavenly hand is what turns
bright
The harvest of the years to human sight.
I see the syllables rush link to link,
And find the truth is best of every drink.

17 "And what's in your right hand to show,
O Moses on the come and go?"
18 He said "It's my rod where I lean,
And pull down nourishment and green
For my flocks, and for usage keen."
19 He said "O Moses, cast it down."
20 He threw it and see the renown,
It turned into a snake to squirm.
21 He said "Grab it up, and be firm.
We'll turn it back at once to be
A rod again from infamy.

The serpent worship that in days of old
Gave way to serpent worship of the fold
In Axum, Yemen, and the Afric horn
Was what for Moses too had to be borne.

Though You, Beloved, devoured the
serpent's way
And by the rod of Moses took Your sway,
That venomous tradition all the while
Continued waiting for Muhammad's smile.
Beloved, when Eve bowed to the serpent's
will,
She let that ancient faith of shine and swill
Come on the earth, and that pain still arises
In all the heathen marches it comprises.
Let Moses' rod fall in the desert place
And in the court before the Pharaoh's face.

22 "Now put your hand close to your side.
It will come out of where you hide
As white as without harm to be
Another sign and properly.
23 "This is so We can show you two
Of our greater signs come in view.
24 "So go to Pharaoh, for it's he
Who has transgressed all boundary."
25 He said "O my Lord, stretch my breast,
26 "Make my chore easier at best,
27 "And take away impediment
Of speech I have and from You lent,
28 "So they can understand my word.
29 "And give me a counsellor stirred
From my own family, 30 "Aaron,
My brother. 31 "Increase to me brawn
Through him, 32 "and let him share my
task,
33 "So we may celebrate and bask
In Your praise and need never ask,
34 "But aye remember You, 35 "for you
Are One to keep us here in view."
36 He said "Moses, your prayer is granted.
37 "We favoured you before and planted.

The great petition of all prophets rises
Above the clamour of revealed disguises,
And hopes that You will send him two by
two,
And give a willing partner for a crew.
The brother is more sacred to the heart
Of human blindness than the divine cart,
Musahip is a sweeter fellow than
The angels and the heavenly sort of span.
Beloved, though I am here upon Your
earth,
I find no brother from womb of my birth,
And face alone the nasty neighbourhood

That rises infantine on field and wood.
The truck and measure of that childish fare
Is still the guage of what I eat and wear.

38 "See how We sent your mother too
A message inspired in her due:
39 "Cast in a casket and throw it
Into the river, the stream fit
Will bring him to the bank and there
He'll be taken by one in share
Who's My foe and his foe to bear.'
But I'll cover you with My love,
To raise you by My eye above.
40 "See how your sister went out and
Said 'Shall I find you one in hand
To nurse and raise him?' So We brought
You back to your mother when caught,
To cool her eye from grief in plot.
Then you killed a man, but We came
To save you from trouble in blame,
And We tried you in many ways.
You stayed for years in the folk's lays
Of Midian. Then you came here
As ordained, Moses, to appear.
41 "And I've made you for My own praise.

There's hardly any man who does not
blame
Your prophet chosen from eternal flame
For killing the Egyptian in the game.
The self-proclaimed in innocence that bide
On death-row and in bedlam all deride
Him for the hand he lifted as in pride.
The preachers and the bishops in disdain
Look on that act as murder and as vain.
But I, Beloved, alone of creatures here
Applaud that killing of the sweet and dear
Egyptian that raised the taskmaster's hand
Against the oppessed of an oppressed land.
If Moses ever did a thing for freedom,
It was that act before he came to lead them.

42 "Go, you and your brother in strength
Of My signs and don't shirk at length,
In keeping remembrance of Me.
43 "Go both to Pharaoh, because he
Has crossed over every boundary.
44 "Address him sweetly, so he may
Take warning or fear of his way."
45 They said "Our Lord, we are afraid
Lest he should rise up in pride laid

Against us and transgress unstayed."
46 He said "Have no fear, I'm with you.
I see and hear all that you do.
47 "So go before him, both of you,
And say 'We're messengers sent true
By your Lord. So send out in crew
The folk of Israel with us too,
And don't afflict them. We in view
Come with a sign from your Lord too.
Peace to all who follow the cue.
48 "It has been shown to us that pain
Is for those who turn back in vain."

The prophet always comes against the king
And his establishment of heathen ring,
And even Daniel kept his soul apart
From government despite doing his part.
When Naaman gave his hand to potentate,
His heart was far away in Israel's state.
So Moses knew and feared the king's
response
To Your word and he measured how it
daunts.
Beloved, each man and woman in this
place
Is sent against establishment in race
To act according to Your ten-fold law.
All folk are called to bow or stand in awe.
Not only the elect have duty clear
To keep Your law, Beloved, and in Your
fear.

49 He said "Moses, who is your Lord?"
50 He said "Our Lord is He who scored
On each thing its form to record
Its nature and guide it as stored."
51 He said "In what state then do lie
The former generations' high?"
52 He answered, "That knowledge is by
My Lord and so recorded high,
My Lord errs not nor can forget,
53 "It's He who made for you to set
The earth like a spread carpet met.
He's made you able to go round
In it by rounds upon the ground,
And sent down water from the sky."

Egyptian rulers are obsessed to know
What of the world of death and of its woe.
As soon as Pharaoh thought a man in show
Could tell him of the future and its glow,

He set aside his duty to the race
 Forgetting rulership with heavy mace
 And longed to see a glimpse of the dead
 face
 That he himself should wear in future
 grace.
 Beloved, I've heard the many sing that
 song,
 And try to reach the resting, deceased
 throng.
 The past and future are well suited here
 To distract men from present duty dear.
 Beloved, lead me today in Your will shown
 Among the wooded ways and overgrown.

With it We've produced pairs of plants
 Diverse and manifold in grants.
 54 Eat yourselves and bring cattle out
 To pasture, in this are signs stout
 For men who understand, no doubt.
 55 Thence We created you and thither
 We shall return you once to wither,
 And from it We'll bring you again.
 56 We showed all Our signs by the men
 Of Pharaoh, but he would reject
 And refuse all Our signs select.
 57 He said "Have you come to drive us
 Out of our land with magic fuss,
 O Moses? 58 "But we too can make
 Magic to match yours in the stake.
 So make a rendez-vous between
 Us and you, and it will be seen,
 Neither of us will fail to show
 Up where we'll both have even go."

The quarrels of men have not changed at all
 Upon the rolling merestrial ball:
 It's all about the land they have in thrall,
 And owning land is reason not to stall
 In killing the intruder at a call.
 So Pharaoh stand in fear that Moses came
 To question his own power and his land
 claim.

I always thought the labour question must
 Have been abetted by a bit of rust
 To taint the name of Moses and the trust
 Of Pharaoh after every sort of gust.
 Beloved, I too look on the square of land
 My mother-in-law left in loam and sand
 With jealous eye against the truthless band.

59 Moses said "Your appointment lies
 In the day of festival vies,
 And let the people gather there
 When the sun is well up to share."
 60 So Pharaoh went his way to make
 His plan and plot then came awake.
 61 Moses told him, "Woe to you then!
 Don't plot a lie against God's glen,
 Lest He destroy you completely
 By the punishment in His fee.
 The maker of lies fails in spe."
 62 They argued about their affair,
 But kept it secret in their lair.
 63 They said "These two are certainly
 Magicians. They intend to free
 Your land of you by magic spree,
 Destroy your best of pageantry.
 64 "So get your plan together and
 Assemble in rows, for the manned
 Today will win the upper hand."

So many festivals leave in the lurch
 Those who are faithful to the flock and
 church.

The holiday brings people out to lunch,
 And while the men and women in a bunch
 Lean on each other, the pickpockets thrive.
 I think they did invent holidays live.
 But somehow festivals of yearly taint
 Come in to satisfy both knave and saint.
 Beloved, I leave the festivals to those
 Whom You in mercy or in anger chose,
 And in my closet bow on every day
 To find that You stand still above the sway.
 Let crowds come to the mill, I turn away
 To find the still small voice where satyrs
 pray.

65 They said "O Moses, will you throw
 Or will we be the first to go?"
 66 He said "No, you have the first go."
 Then see how their ropes and their rods,
 It seemed to him by magic pods,
 Started to writhe and ring in sods.
 67 Moses started to fear inside.
 68 We said "Don't be afraid of pride.
 For you have the winning hand's ride.
 69 "Throw what's in your right hand and it
 Will swallow up what is unfit,
 What they've made as magician's trick.
 Magicians won't prosper in thick."

The Christmases and Ramadhans appear
With Hanukkahs to give the people cheer,
And as I see the writhing hopes I fear
That overwhelming paganism's here.
But You, Beloved, rebuke my doubt and
show

The winning hand is the hand last to throw,
And after all the faiths established go,
There comes the Decalogue, ten in a row.
Beloved, the fear of pride is not so small
Within my narrow breast not to appal,
And so Your warning written on the wall
Is well received by my intent and faith.
I turn from the unfit in shining wraith,
The hope of those who dance before the
gall.

70 So the magicians were cast down
Prostrating themselves by the town,
They said "We believe in accord
Of Aaron's and of Moses' Lord."

71 He said "Do you believe in Him
Before I give you leave in grim?
This must be your chief who taught you
To do the magic that you do.
I'll cut off your hands and your feet
On opposite sides of the street,
And I'll have you crucified on
The trunks of palms, until it dawn
On you which of us can give more
And lasting punishment in score."

72 They said "We'll never regard you
Above the clear signs in our view,
Or above Him who has made us.
So decree what you will for fuss.
For you can just decree the life
Of this world in its sinful strife.
73 "As for us we've faith in our Lord.
May He forgive us errors scored,
And magic that you made us do,
God is best and abides for true."

In days of Egypt's glory, men felt sure
That calling it as they saw it for cure
Was the best way to keep the memory pure.
There was no way to control minds back
then

Except the crucifixion of the wen.
But now psychology is bent before
The blasts irrational that two makes four,

And brain-wash and brain-dump come in to
pour

The mount beside university door.
Beloved, I'm glad to live in times like
these,

Where knowledge and perception are just
sleaze,

And what I know I do not know at all,
But think that politics will clean the stall.
I whirl about the prayer and learning hall.

74 The one who returns to his Lord
A sinner will have hell restored.

There he'll not live or die outpoured.

75 But those who come back with faith
there

Who have worked out a righteous share,
For them are ranks exalted fair.

76 Eternal gardens beneath which
Flow streams in every crystal ditch,
They'll live there for ever and such
Is the reward of those who touch
The cleansing from wickedness much.

The holy Qur'an always comes back to
How many rivers flow beneath the view
Of Paradise laid out for mortal pew
Made deathless in the gardens of sweet
dew.

A man and woman taught alone by You
Some magic words of hope along the way
May take reward of gardens for their pay.
Come tell me, my Beloved, of streams that
flow

Eternally beneath the heavenly glow
Like nectar flown from Kauthar till I know
What shelters my obedience at last.
All flight and fight and might is in the past.
I sing my songs of hell and paradise,
Not caring anymore who's bad or nice.

77 We sent Moses a revelation:
"Go by night with My slaves in station,
And make them a dry road to tread
Through the sea, without fear or dread
Of being caught by king instead."

78 The Pharaoh followed with his hosts,
But waters overwhelmed their boats
And covered them up *at their boasts*.

79 So Pharaoh led his folk astray
Instead of leading the right way.

Look to this truth, Beloved, and tell all
 men:
 When Pharaoh led his troupes about the
 glen,
 He followed Moses' tracks and sought
 again
 The way that You were leading from the
 den
 Of Egypt to the desert free air's fen.
 The path that was the right way for the one
 Was path of destruction for the undone.
 The church and synagogue may both
 entwine,
 The mosque may reject both because of
 wine,
 But the same path for all is laid and sure,
 Though one find it salvation and the cure
 Of sin and death, and others find the way
 Lead on the hell where they may read and
 pray.
 Beloved, I walk the path. You give the ray.

80 O folk of Israel, We saved you
 From your foe, and made a pact true
 With you on right side of the mount.
 And We sent down to you account
 Of manna and of quails in crew.
 81 "Eat the good things that We've
 provided
 For nourishment, but go decided
 Against excess, lest My wrath come
 Down on you in justice to hum.
 Those on whom My wrath comes at last
 Will perish in the angry blast.
 82 But there's no doubt that I am He
 Who forgives often by decree,
 And to those who repent believing,
 And do right, those at last receiving
 The guidance of truth faithfully."

All the days trekking out of Egypt meant
 Lasting in dunes and desert as those sent.
 Among the righteous chosen and the lent
 How many manufactured some dissent?
 Make my heart pure, Beloved, of every
 way
 Unleashed by freedom of Egyptian sway,
 Hung on the bound of lust and greed's
 dismay,
 Above foundations of earth's cruelty.

Make my heart grieve or not, Beloved, to
 see
 A cloud of witnesses about the tree
 Dug in the soil to seek eternally
 A well of water living for a day.
 Love me or not, Beloved, I spin my song,
 I lend my voice to both the right and
 wrong.

83 "What made you come so quick ahead
 Of your folk, Moses, whom you've lead?"
 84 He answered "See, they're close behind,
 I rushed to You, my Lord to find."
 85 He said "We've tried your folk while
 you
 Were away, and Samiri crew
 Has led them astray from the true."
 86 So Moses went back to his folk
 In anger under sorrow's stroke.
 He said "O my folk, did your Lord
 Not make you a fine promise scored?
 Did the promise seem long to come?
 Or did you hope that wrath to hum
 Should descend from your Lord on you,
 And so you broke your promise due?"
 87 They said "We didn't break our pact
 With you, as far as our strength backed.
 But we had to bear such a weight
 Of jewellery of all the state,
 And we threw them in, which was what
 The Samiri said we should shut.
 88 "Then he brought out in front the great
 Image of a calf and not late
 It seemed to moo, and so they said
 'This is your god, the god that led
 Moses, but he forget instead.'"

Two things made an excuse to worship
 false
 Gods with a trap-set and a rock-roll waltz:
 The fact that gold hung heaving on the
 neck,
 And the fact that the hollow calf select
 Groaned with the desert breeze at echo's
 beck.
 Beloved, I see the wealth about my place
 Is heavy, whether from the divine grace
 Or from the greed endemic to men's face.
 Beloved, I hear the solemn sounds intone
 Gyration amplified before Your throne.
 No wonder in this day and page the rate

Idoltrous and heathen is so great.
See how fast Muslims change before the
fire
Of cultivation of both good and dire.

89 Could they not see that it could not
Give them a word in answer's plot,
And it had no strength to do harm
To them or to do good in arm?
90 Aaron before this said to them,
"O my folk, you're in a trial's hem.
For truly your Lord's gracious, so
Follow me and obey my show."
91 They'd said "We'll not give up this way
But we'll continue so to pray
Until Moses comes back in sway."
92 He said "O Aaron, what kept you
From intervening with this crew
When you saw the wrong things they do
93 "To turn away from my way true?
Did you disobey my word too?"
94 He answered, "O my mother's son,
Don't grab me by my beard and bun,
I was afraid that you would say
'You've caused a division in sway
Of Israel's folk and did not stay
To honour my word and obey.'"

When Moses asked his brother of the plot
That built the golden calf the people
sought,
He did not speak in courtesy and fine
Polite words sweetened with both bread
and wine.
He smacked him on the butt and grabbed
his beard.
That's what a brother does that is not weird.
Idolatry or not, brothers can make
Their questions take direction at the stake.
Beloved, I have no brother, sister here,
And so I guess I always must appear
Before the crowd and in my hall and gear
Polite and never have the chance to veer.
My courtesy, if courtesy is near,
Is product not of patience but lone rake.

95 He said "What about you, Samiri?
96 He answered him, "I was not weary
To see what the folk did not see.
I took a handful from the print
Of the messenger's foot by dint,

And threw it in, as I thought best."
97 He said "Get out, what's in your life
Will be to say 'don't touch me rife.'
And furthermore you've got a promise
That will not fail a doubting *Thomas*,
Look at your idol, of whom you
Are fervent worshipper on cue.
We'll have it in a flaming fire
And scatter on the sea with ire."

How many Samirs in the world today
Look to the relicts of prophetic ray
For help and hope instead of what they
pray!
The writing on the amulet, the throw
Of tesbih to declare the way to go,
The visit to the tomb beseeching those
Who are long dead and rotting in their
clothes,
Are all ways that Muhammedans here
chose
To make idoltrous their praying rows.
Beloved, keep me unstained from what
they do,
Keep me apart from idols at the shoe.
The temples of the superstitious crew
Are built with glass and steel and seem to
show
The latest in the spirit and the glow.

98 But the god of all of you's One
God: there is not god but He won.
All things He comprehends in His
Knowledge. Whatever We do is
Tell you some tales of times long past.
For We sent you a message cast
From Our own presence *and to last*.
100 If any turn away from it,
They'll bear the burden that is fit
On judgement day. 101 And they will stay
This way, and heavy will it weigh,
The burden they bear on that day.

Beloved, I do believe in the four books,
The Bible and Qur'an with doubting hooks,
And hear You speaking behind every word
That falls on ear and makes the eye be
blurred.

Beloved, I do believe the Qur'an came
In warning to men of good will and blame,
And as I hear the warning, my eye weeps

To find the many ways the idol creeps
 Into the human heart, into my own.
 Cast down the idols from my inner throne
 As Ali threw them down on shoulders
 where
 The feet of pilgrims now keep passing
 there.
 Cast down each idol from my heart and
 make
 My life a clear pool for reflection's sake.

102 The day the trump will sound, the day
 We'll gather sinful, wall-eyed stray.
 103 In whispers they'll confide in then,
 "I was no longer than some ten."
 104 We know best what they'll say, when
 their
 Chief leader in mischief will dare:
 "You did not stay more than a day!"

My humanistic doubt, though strong to say
 That I love every sort of human way,
 Makes me to wonder what there is that may
 Follow death from now till the Judgement
 day.
 I cannot quite believe that I shall rise
 Alive again beneath the glowering skies,
 And so I join the doubters You despise.
 Maybe I've listened to too many lies.
 Beloved, I doubt the resurrection, true,
 But I cannot doubt that I'm made by You,
 The One and Real and True beyond the
 view
 Of universe in empty screen and dew.
 If You can once create of soil and wind,
 Then You can resurrect the winged and
 finned.

105 They ask you about mountains' sway.
 Say "My Lord will just pluck them up
 And scatter like dust *under tup*."
 106 "He'll leave them as plains smooth and
 flat,
 107 "No crooked or curved way in that."
 108 On that day they will follow call,
 No crookedness in him to fall.
 All sounds shall be humbled before
 The presence of Most Gracious, nor
 Shall you hear but tramp of their feet.
 109 On that day intercession meet
 Shall not avail except for those

For whom permission given in rows
 By the Most Gracious and whose word
 Is accepted by Him *as stirred*.
 110 He knows what's before or behind.
 Then they shall not an answer find.
 111 Faces shall be humbled before,
 The Living, Self-Subsisting, more
 Eternal. Without hope shall be
 The man caught in iniquity.

You call some from the pale of sin to be
 Elect and chosen and eternally,
 While others hear no call and so remain
 Dead in their sins and in their wicked stain.
 Most Gracious, I hear only silence where
 I stand beneath the breath of sky and share
 The air with fir and pine. Your voice is
 void
 Beneath the clouds that eagles have
 enjoyed.
 Though I hear no voice but the magic lilt
 Of Bible and Qur'an before my guilt,
 I hope the feast is set for my soul too.
 If not, deprive me not of love for You,
 And I shall go to hell and praise Your name
 While I am caught beneath the glowing
 flame.

112 But the one who does righteous deeds
 And has faith, will have no fear's seeds
 Of harm or diminished proceeds.
 113 So We have sent this down and cast,
 An Arabic Qur'an to last,
 Explaining in it in detail
 Some of the warnings to prevail,
 So they may fear God or that it
 May give remembrance of Him fit.

You may think, my Beloved, You did so
 well
 In sending the Qur'an's Arabic spell,
 But fact is it is not easy to tell
 One word from other on that scribbled
 page.
 It is a struggle to read that I wage.
 Besides the script and language hard to
 read,
 It is so cryptic sometimes that I need
 To take a tafsir and to contemplate
 What You meant by a sentence so ornate.
 So do not think You've made an easy task

Providing the Qur'an instead of mask.
You ought to give out prizes to the folk
Who stick to reading what the Arab yoke
Has placed upon the heart and mind in
stroke.

113 Over all is God, King, the Truth.
Don't be too quick to show in ruth
The Qur'an before it's revealed
To you completely and unsealed,
But say "O my Lord, give to me
More and more knowledge in degree."

115 We had already, beforehand,
Make a pact with Adam to stand,
But he forgot. And We then found
On his part no resolve profound.

116 When We said to the angels then,
"Prostrate yourselves at Adam's den,"
They prostrated themselves, but not
Iblis. He refused in the plot.

117 Then We said "O Adam, truly,
This is to you an enemy
And to your wife. So don't let him
Drive you both from the garden's hem,
To thrust you into misery.

118 "There is there for you so you'll not
Go hungry or naked uncaught,

119 "Nor suffer thirst nor sun's heat got."

120 But Satan whispered ill to him.

He said "O Adam, I am trim
To lead you to eternal tree
And to a kingdom that will see
No destruction eternally."

121 The end was they both ate from that
Tree, and their nakedness and fat
Was shown them. They began to sew
Together for coats leaves that grow
In the garden. So Adam came
To disobey his Lord in blame,
Seduced as he allowed the shame.

Beloved, the day of Adam long ago
Was not as clear as this one in the show.
The one who did not bow down in the row
Pretending to believe in You alone
Deceived him by hypocrisy in stone.
But I may now take warning from the best,
And know that those pretending in the west
To worship You alone, come to invest
An interest in deceiving with the rest.
So let me flee from those who worship one

God as well as from heathen ones in dun,
And find my hope and help and knowledge
won

In You alone, and not the hotly crew
Pretending everywhere to preach of You.

122 But his Lord chose him, and turned
him

And gave him guidance *from the grim.*

123 He said "Go down the both of you,
Together from the garden's view,
With enmity one to another.

But if there surely comes another
Guidance from Me to you, the one
Who follows My guidance when done
Will not go straying nor shall fall
Into misery and its thrall.

124 "But the one who turns away from
My message, truly he shall come
Into a life diminished and
We'll raise him up blind then to stand
On Judgement day *in sinful band.*"

125 He'll say "O my Lord, why have you
Raised me up blind, when I had view?"

126 He'll say "You did so, when Our signs
Came to you, disregarding lines.
So you'll today be left in pines."

127 So We do to the one who comes
Transgressing beyond bounds and sums,
And not believing in the signs
Of his Lord. And the pain alligns
In the hereafter far above
The grief and measure of his love.

Beloved, as Adam learned after the trick
Not to trust in the personage who's slick,
Let me turn from deceit to know Your will
Presented in the Bible from the hill,
And in Qur'an that lingers with me still.
I disregard the signs from day to day,
Reciting them so little in my way,
And yet I love the message and the sound
Of Arabic and Hebrew on the ground.
Does love of sound redeem my narrow
past?

It's all I've got in witness and to cast
Before You as a plea to save my soul
From my own self and plight before the
goal.

Recite, recite's the only way to last.

128 Is it no warning to such men
How many generations then
Before them We destroyed, in whose
Dens they move? Truly in these cues
Are signs for men of thoughtful views.
129 Had it not been for a word that
Went out before from your Lord stout,
Their pains had been upon their rout.
But there's a time and set about.

130 So be patient with what they say.
Celebrate your Lord's praises way,
Before the rising of the sun,
And before its setting when done.
And celebrate them some time in
The hours of the night and begin
At the terms of the day, so you
May have your joy upon the view.

131 Don't strain your eyes to wish for
things

We've given to some of their strings
To enjoy of these earthly things,
By which We test them, but what your
Lord provides is a better store,
And more enduring in the wings.

132 Enjoin prayer on your people and
Be constant in that. We don't stand
To ask you to provide for them
Their sustenance. But We in hem
Provide it for you. But what comes
Hereafter's for righteousness' sums.

133 They say "Why does he not bring us
A sign from his Lord with a fuss?"
Has not a clear sign come to them
Of all that was in former gem
Of Books of revelation's hem?

134 And if We had laid on them pains
Before this, they'd have said of blains,
"Our Lord, if only you had sent
A messenger to us and lent,
We would have followed Your signs meant
Before we were humbled and set
To the shame that we now have met."

135 Say "Each one waits, so wait therefore,
And soon you'll know who is before
On straight and even way, and who
Has gained the guidance of *the true*."

As David said the Holy One should not
See anything corrupt nor stand his lot
With others in the grave consuming them,

So I will stand where many might
condemn,

And stretch my hands in prayer to You
alone,

Who keep the guided ones, spirit and bone.
Yet wait, and not complain nor rail nor rant
Because there are deniers still extant,
The pure and uncorrupted divine guides
Remain untouched and their words stand
besides.

But time will tell, and when time ends at
last,

Without an argument shall all men fast
And surely know who have been on the
way,

And who have followed guidance, a clear
ray.

Surah 21 Anbiyaa, or The Prophets

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 The doom is nearing humankind,
Yet they heed nothing as though blind,
And turn away *from the resigned*.

2 There never comes to them a new
Message from their Lord but they do
Listen to it as just a joke.

3 Their hearts mess around and just poke.
The wicked hide their private plan,
"Is this like yourselves more than man?
Will you succumb to witchcraft wrought
With your eyes open to get caught?"

In days past when Muhammad preached
the word,

He found they laughed at everything they
heard,

The warnings of damnation and the cry
That bodies would revive beneath the sky.
Now jeremiads fill the public air,
And only some romantics from despair
Turn with a cue to rose, lily and dew.

Now everyone talks doom instead of few.
Beloved, I take the joke in yoke and ply
My fears and peddle them or at least try,
While every preacher with collection plate
Storms on against political in state,
And see the coming fall as silver lined,
Where preachers are exalted and well
dined.

4 Say "My Lord knows of every word

In the skies and on earth preferred.
 He's One who hears, knows what occurred.
 5 They say "No, it is all a dream.
 No, he invented what would seem.
 No, he's just a poet on beam.
 Let him just bring us a sign like
 The ones sent to old ones to strike."
 6 Before them not one of the folk
 That We destroyed believed in yoke.
 Will these believe *and give a poke?*
 7 Before you also messengers
 We sent were only men, *not curs*,
 To whom we gave their revelations.
 If you don't realize these stations,
 Ask those who have the message rations.
 8 We did not give them bodies that
 Did not eat food to make them fat,
 Nor were they untouched by death then.
 9 At last We brought about to men
 Our promise, and We saved them and
 Those whom We pleased, but We
 destroyed
 Those who transgressed the bounds
 employed.

Destruction's fallen on the world since time
 Has made itself known to human in crime,
 And that is not in evidence of rhyme
 That You control the heavens and the earth.
 Destruction falls indeed, but what of that?
 The thin are always thin, the fat are fat.
 Whether bodies are touched or laid on mat,
 The argument I see is of no worth.
 Some live through tribulation, yes indeed,
 And others die cut down before the weed,
 But in the living and the dying here
 There is no proof that You'll ever appear.
 Promise or not, I fail to go beyond
 The bounds that You have set on heart and
 pond.

10 We have revealed for you a book
 In which is a message you took,
 Will you not understand and look?
 11 How many were the people We
 Completely destroyed because see
 Their wickedness, and then We set
 In their stead other people met?
 12 But when they felt Our punishment,
 See they fled from what had been sent.
 13 Don't flee, but return to good things

Of this life given you in springs,
 And to your homes so you may be
 Called to account in your degree.
 14 They said "Woe to us, we're indeed
 Wrong-doers of a wicked creed."
 15 And that cry of theirs did not end
 Till We made them a field to spend
 And mow, as ashes quiet wend.
 16 We did not make for simple sport
 The heavens and earth and all report.
 17 If it had been Our wish that We
 Should just enjoy a pastime free,
 We should have done it in the spree
 Of things nearest to Us in fee,
 If We should take such strategy.
 18 No, We cast truth against the false,
 And it breaks out its brain in waltz,
 And see the falsehood blown away.
 Ah, woe to you for the wrong way
 That you ascribe to Us in sway.

I have ascribed nothing to You nor writ
 A condemnation of the little bit
 I see You doing to make the world fit.
 Continue as You like to let the world
 Full-blown sink to the dust and come
 uncurled.

It's nothing new the rage of men and air
 Fill all with a destruction of the fair.
 I make no complaint nor do I ascribe
 To You the efforts of those who would
 bribe.

Beloved, the false is blown away, it's true,
 As well as everything good in my view,
 And yet after a tempest in a cup,
 I turn about and praise You like a tup,
 As though the crashing doom were just a
 play
 Upon a stage and finished in a day.

19 To Him belong all in the sky
 And on the earth. Even those who vie
 In His own presence are not too
 Proud to serve Him, nor without cue
 Do they get weary as they do.
 20 They celebrate His praises by
 Night and by day, nor do they lie
 Down weary or stop in the try.

The seraphim and cherubim that vie
 Together in the heavens of the sky

To praise Your name, Beloved, and then
 come by
 To say thrice holy Lord of hosts and try
 To fill the earth with glory, they are sly.
 The quoting of Isaiah is a feat
 For good Muhammad and a regal treat.
 I do not question that the word is filled
 With glory or the sound the angels billed,
 But as they celebrate Your praises where
 The stars swirl on the deep and blackened
 stair,
 I reckon that my trouble's with my ear
 That I am tomb'd in silence not to hear.
 I cackle with my grackles, never fear.

21 Or have they taken other gods
 From the earth who can raise from clods?
 22 If there were in the heavens and earth
 Besides God other gods of worth,
 There would have been confusion there.
 But glory to God, Lord on throne,
 Above what they call Him to own.
 23 He can't be questioned for His deeds,
 But they'll be questioned for their creeds.
 24 Do they worship gods besides Him?
 Say "Bring your clear proof and not dim.
 This is the message come with me
 And message of those before me."
 But most of them don't know the truth,
 And turn away, *both old and youth*.

Confusion is full proof that You alone
 Are God to sit upon a heavenly throne.
 Indeed, I know that it is true at best,
 When there are two or three here to invest
 As Baptists, there are three or four opinions
 To rise up vying for Baptist dominions.
 My only hope of some consistency
 Is to admit that You were never three.
 Beloved, be in the word Muhammad sent,
 Or in the sword of Ali still unbent,
 Or in the sacred meal that Jesus lent,
 But in Your being be without dissent.
 And I shall count You on as many hands
 As I have fingers growing reprimands.

25 No messenger did We send out
 Before you without revealed clout,
 Our inspiration sent to him.
 There is no god but I, be trim
 And worship Me alone with vim.

26 They say "The Most Gracious begot
 Spawn." Glory to Him on the spot.
 They're servants raised to honour's plot.
 27 They do not speak before He does,
 They act by His command that was.
 28 He knows what's before them and what
 Behind them lies, and they keep shut
 The intercession but for those
 Who are acceptable in rows
 To stand in reverence at His *toes*.
 29 If any of them said "I'm god
 Besides Him," We would quickly prod
 Him into hell. So We reward
 Those who do wrong *before their Lord*.

Proof of Your oneness is a thought once
 more
 That I had hardly mentioned here before.
 It's that if any prophet in this place
 Had proclaimed that You exist with a face
 On three or more, You'd have shoved him
 in hell.
 Since hell contains few prophets in its well,
 That shows that you are one, easy to spell.
 Some may consider that proof beyond fact,
 But since I've never seen hell as I'm sacked,
 I can't pretend to bear You witness here.
 There may be prophets in hell, so I fear.
 But if You say so, I think I'll contrive
 To believe hell bereft of prophets live,
 And empty of their witness to appear.

30 The unbelievers, don't they see
 That earth and sky were joined degree
 Before We split them *with the sea*?
 We made from water everything
 That lives, why're they not believing?

Here's scientific proof, if any's needed,
 That the Qur'an is true, best to be heeded.
 That all life's made of water from the sea
 Is evolution most elementary.
 Here's proof the Bible is the Word of God,
 And shows creation's work upon the sod,
 Since the Qur'an admits on second day
 You split the earth from sky in waters' pay.
 Beloved, the reading of the Scriptures lends
 A voice to everyone to make amends,
 And he who doubts doubts on for what it
 sends,
 And he who believes finds a hook to stay

His faith on till the dawn of the doomsday.
I fail in my belief, but I still pray.

31 We've set on earth mountains as firm
Lest it should shake and make them
squirm,

We've made there wide pages for them
To pass through in guidance as gem.

32 We've made the heavens a canopy
Well guarded, still they will not see
The signs these point to in decree.

33 It's He who created the night
And day and sun and the moonlight.
All float in the appointed rite.

The ones who claim the moon lays out the
weeks

Because the Psalm speaks in appointments'
tweeks,

Fail to remember You created all
To float in their appointed cycle's stall.
It's not just moon that makes appointments
here,

But also sun and night and day appear.
The clouds and mountains too as well as
plain

Perform their tasks beneath the sun and
rain.

Wild ass and bird meet on the fruited hill,
And cattle and wild herb come to fulfil
Their promises to sparrows without chill.
The deer too take their way, and the wines
spill,

But none of these determine Sabbath day.
Let lunar Sabbath counters meet their pay.

34 We did not grant to any man
Before you immortality.
If you should die, would they by plan
Then come to live eternally?
35 Each soul shall have a taste of death,
And We test you by evil breath
And by the good by way of test:
To Us you must return *and rest*.

This verse seems to deny the Muslim threat
That Jesus never died when he was met
On earth. But then the cunning answer's set
That he'll appear to die before we get
To judgement day, and so fulfil the way
That Scripture holds in inspiration's sway.

Beloved, the history of life and death
Is one of humankind from breath to breath,
And You give to the one You will a day,
And to another centuries to stay,
But in the end all life is in the hand
Of the One who's created it to stand.
Let nothing come between me and the word
That You provide for life, though I've not
heard.

36 When unbelievers see you, they
Just hold you in ridicule's sway.
"Is this the one who talks of gods?"
And they blaspheme then without odds
At mention of Most Gracious' nods.
37 Man is a creature of haste: soon
I'll show you My signs without boon,
Then you'll not tell Me, "Bring them doon."
38 They say "When will this promise be,
If you are speaking truthfully?
39 If only unbelievers knew
When they will not have power to
Keep back the fire from faces cru
Nor from their backs, and no help can
Reach out to any to a man.
40 No, it may fall down suddenly
On them and daze them wonderfully.
No power of theirs can damp the spree,
Nor will they get respite's degree.

The fine sight of hell I get here is just
What I'd expect after my earthly trust.
Hell on earth makes me think that every
hell
Must be hemmed in both front and back as
well.

So the Qur'an affirms the human state
And the impressions we get as we wait
For the trump and opening of the gate
To heaven or hell according to the slate.
Beloved, I find You burning me enough
To make me think that every hell is rough,
And in the burning You make my skin
tough.

I can't escape the fire because You breathe
The breath of life in me, and so enwreath
Me with Your love as well as stays and
stuff.

41 Mocked were messengers before you,
But their scoffers were hemmed in crew

By what they mocked *when it came true*.
42 Say "Who can keep you safe by night
And by day from Most Gracious' might?"
They turn back from the sound of name
Of their Lord spoken *as in blame*.

From the days of Seth the sound of Your
name
Has been the only refuge from the blame
Of sin and sordid faith in wealth and fame,
And yet men turn back from it all the same.
Let me have no prayer or devotion here
But recitation of Your own name dear,
And as I climb the ladder Jacob found,
Bear me, Beloved, up from the tattered
ground
Into the bosom of good Abraham
Who died on Jacob's breast. Beloved, I am
Enamoured of the names that still resound
In praise of You. And so I here am bound
To whirl forever with that sacred breath
Until I enter in the palls of death.

43 Do they have gods able to guard
Them from Us? It would be too hard
For them to help themselves, nor can
They be defended from Our plan.
44 No, We gave the good things of life
To these men and their fathers rife
Until the term grew long for them.
Do they not see that we reduce
Their borders gradually in sluice?
So will they win over the deuce?
45 Say "I just warn you according
To the revealing." But deaf sting
Will not hear the call through warning.
46 If just a breeze of anger from
Your Lord should touch them as they
come,
They'd say "Woe to us, for wrong's sum."
47 We'll set up scales of justice for
The day of judgement, so the score
Of not a soul will be dealt in
Unjustly in the least way's din,
And if there's weight of mustard seed,
We'll bring it to account indeed,
And We suffice to know the need.

Two things are too confused in men's eyes
here,

The grace that gives immortal life from
fear,
And judgement that brings to account the
peer.
Wrong will be punished and the right
reserved
For the rewards that good-doers deserved,
And so Your justice my Beloved's
preserved.
But life in resurrection is not earned
Or so acquired by anyone who's learned.
Only the power that once created us
Can raise us up again after the fuss
And silence of the grave. Beloved, I know
Your hand of power alone can rule the row,
And so I stand with empty hand before
The judgement and the open heavenly door.

48 In the past We granted to Moses
And Aaron the Criterion
For judgement that indeed discloses
A Light and Message *that shines on*
For those who would do right, 49 those
who
Fear their Lord in their secret thought,
And hold the hour *of judgement true*
In awe. 50 This blessed message *is taught*
Which We've sent down, don't set at
naught.

Criterion may be noble Qur'an
In hand of dear Muhammad under palm,
But here Criterion was given in hand
To Moses and to Aaron in the land.
The tables of the law on which You wrote
Came down to them like lightning stroke
that smote
The heart and eye and ear with the clear
sound
Of what and why and how all men are
bound.
Beloved, I take those tables two and find
That in their promises I'm well confined
To eat the bread and after I have dined
To rest in grace and love and still resigned
Raised to obedience among the kind.
Beloved, I praise You for the firmer
ground.

51 In former times We have bestowed
On Abraham, whose conduct showed

Him righteous, and We knew him well.
 52 Behold! He said to his own folk
 And to his father too he spoke
 "What are these images, to which
 You're devoted?" 53 They said "Enrich
 Your mind with what our fathers had
 To worship." 54 He said, "You indeed
 Are truly wrong and both in need,
 You and your fathers." 55 They said "Do
 You bring us Truth, or is it you
 Are jesting?" 56 He said "No, your Lord
 Is Lord of heaven and earth, who made
From nothing but creative word,
 All things, I witness *unafraid.*
 57 "And by Allah, I have a plan
 For all your idols when you go
 Away and turn your backs." 58 So he
 Broke them in pieces, all but the
 Enormous one that they might turn
 To it enquiring *what they earn.*
 59 They said "Who did this to our gods?
 Someone impious *as the clods!*"
 60 They said "We heard a youth that spoke
 Of them. It's Abraham that broke
 The gods," 61 They said "Then bring him
 out
 Before the people's eyes, no doubt,
 They will bear witness." 62 Then they said
 "Are You the *wicked* one that fed
 Our gods destruction, Abraham?"
 63 He said "No, it's the battering-ram
 Of this one left, the biggest one!
 Ask them, if they can speak the truth."
 64 So they turned to themselves *in ruth*
 And said "Surely you folk are wrong!"
 65 Then they were confounded with shame.
 "You know well these speak not a name!"
 66 He said "Do you take besides God
 A thing to worship like a clod
 That cannot do you good nor harm?"
 67 "Fie on you all, and on the arm
 Of what you worship besides God!
 Have you no sense?" 68 They said "Burn
 him
 And save your gods, who shall spurn him!"
 69 We said "O Fire! Be cool and safe
 For Abraham!" 70 But they would chafe
 Against him with their strategy.
 But We dealt with their policy,
 And so they lost. 71 But We saved him
 And Lot and sent them on no grim

Journey to that land We have blessed
 To give him and his nations rest.

O my Beloved, You have a sense of
 humour!
 And how I covet that, poor serious gloomer
 That I am! You inspired a rangy youth
 To grand destruction for You and Your
 truth,
 And then when he was questioned by
 police,
 He gave a snotty answer for caprice.
 "I knocked your idols down and broke
 them, I?"
 Then ask the idol's witness, it shall cry
 Against me accusation. Can't it speak?
 Then how can it give you the things you
 seek?"
 The punks and teeny boppers seem to be
 The best in all the land in their country.
 But actions like this end in punishment
 Of fires which are not always coolly meant.

72 And We bestowed on him Isaac
 And, before We had called him back,
 Jacob, and We made righteous men
 Of every one. 73 And then again
 We made them leaders, guiding by
 Our *good* command, and We sent by
 Them inspiration to do good
 Deeds, to establish *as they should*
 The daily prayers, and charity,
 And so they served Us faithfully.
 74 And to Lot, too, We gave judgement
 And knowledge, saved him *from the town*
 That practised *everywhere they went*
 Abominations *to cast down.*
 Truly they were an evil nation,
 Rebellious people *in their station.*
 75 And We gave him Our mercy too,
 Since he was righteous *and he knew.*

Not that you bestow mercy on the one
 Who attains righteousness in what he's
 done,
 But that You gave him righteousness and
 then
 Bestowed on him Your mercy among men.
 The glowing righteousness You gave set
 him
 In conflict with the city You saw dim,

And so in mercy You brought him and his
 Out of the town before destruction's whiz.
 Beloved, You add judgement to knowledge
 and
 You add the third, salvation at Your hand.
 I seek the knowledge of grace in command
 And find You add to that judgement to
 stand,
 And so I flee from knowledge and
 judgement
 Into salvation that You came and lent.

76 Mind Noah when he called before,
 We listened to him and saved more
 And his family from distress sore.
 77 We helped him against people who
 Rejected Our signs, truly who
 Were folk of wickedness in crew.
 So We drowned them all in the stew.

It's more like You called Noah than he
 called.
 Poor Noah's not much for calling
 stonewalled.
 He preached a hundred twenty years and
 bent
 Only his own three sons' wives to consent
 To join him and his offspring and his wife
 Within the ark of safety to save life.
 You should have called a master of fine
 speech,
 One using rhetoric upon the beach,
 And so saved a whole congregation where
 The ark was floating empty between air
 And sea. Of course the animals in fee
 Who had no choice went into that safety.
 You're better now in missionizing zeal,
 As preachers come to tell us how they feel.

78 Mind David and Solomon too,
 When they gave judgement in affair
 Of the field where some sheep had there
 Gone astray in the night, and We
 Did witness their judgement freely.
 79 To Solomon We gave revealed
 The understanding of the yield.
 To each We gave judgement and field
 Of knowledge. It was Our power here
 That made the hills and birds appear
 To celebrate Our praises by
 The songs that David came to ply,

It was We who did these things nigh.

As an adherent of the faith that springs
 In no establishment of earthly wings,
 The faith of David (many take the word
 Of Torah, and some others I have heard
 Refer to Gospel light, while many more
 Hold to the sweet Qur'an's recited lore),
 I here applaud the good report You give
 Of how the hills and birds appear to live
 In wonder and in celebration of
 The Psalms sung by the shepherd boy with
 love.
 Let me increase my prayers from the dear
 sound
 Of David's Psalms resounding on the
 ground,
 And so climb up the crystal stair to find
 The place where music echoes as designed.

80 We taught him making coats of mail
 To benefit you, guard you hale
 From each one's violence in gale,
 Will you be grateful on the trail?

To be frank, coat of mail no longer guards
 The body from the splinterings and shards
 Of U depleted or more anciently
 From shrapnel cast about the world in glee.
 Perhaps You taught the present-day
 advance
 In military might and ghostly dance,
 But that does not prevent the maiming of
 Those who step in the wrong place at a
 shove.
 We need a David and a Solomon
 To rid the world of evil, now we've won.
 But if You resurrect the holy one,
 You'd better keep him hidden from the sun.
 We're like to do him in before You turn
 Around to refill his grave or his urn.

81 We stilled the gale for Solomon
 At his command to the land won
 And blessed, for We know all things done.
 82 And of the wicked ones were some
 Who dove pearling for him to come,
 Did other work beside, and it
 Was We who guarded them as fit.

The pearls of Solomon are in his crown,

While others are arranged with great
renown
In proverbs and in wisdom, while the town
Goes dancing in a ring and then falls down.
Beloved, even the wicked and rejected
In this world of the lost and the selected
Can do a work for You, if only diving
Beneath the sea to find the pearls surviving.
My wicked heart and hand may not repent
Of the quaint spites they often come to
vent,
But at least as I come before Your Word,
I can collect the pearls that the swine herd
Has failed to trample and set in a book.
See this is the fifth volume, take a look.

83 Mind Job, when He called to his Lord,
"Catastrophe has met my board,
But You are best of those adored
In mercy." 84 We hearkened to him,
We took away the painful grim,
Gave him back to his people's whim,
And doubled their number in trim
As grace from Us, reminder too
For all who serve Us in their crew.

The pain of Job was not worth half the trial.
You ought to be ashamed, the way You
smile.

Just look how poor Job's wife in her despair
Called imprecations on the empty air
And showed You in Your true colours.
Beware.

For You, perhaps, Job's pain was worth the
deal.

You were so justified by what You heal.
Think of the children dead, and come to
feel

What wealth and health and habit can't
reveal.

Two new-borns can't replace the child that
died

And sank into the grave as though to hide
From love and life until the resurrection.
It's not You here a wonder and confection,
But Job, who never wavered in rejection.

85 Mind Ishmael, Idris and Zul-kifl,
All men of patience without snuffle.

86 We brought them in Our mercy, for
They were among the righteous store.

87 Remember Jonah, when he left
In anger thinking We're bereft
Of power over him. But he
Cried from the depths of darkness free,
"There is no god but You: glory
To You," and was wrong in degree.
88 We listened to him and saved him
From his distress, and so in trim
We deliver the faithful rim.

The four great patient ones contrast with
him

Who made his home in the whale's belly
dim.

Though You choose four times more often
the best

In patience, or having chosen invest
Them with the patience as a grace at best,
There are such servants of Your will who
chafe

And flee and then complain when mercies
strafe.

Beloved, You leave me like neither of
those,

Not like the patient ones nor wrathful pose
Of Jonah. For I bind myself to be
Neither a patient waif nor in degree
A preacher too successful to cry down
Your imprecations on the righteous crown.
I sit alone to make Your set of three.

89 And Zakariah, when he cried
To his Lord, "O my Lord beside,
Do not leave me without offspring,
Though You're the best heir on the wing."
90 So We hearkened to him, and We
Granted him John, We healed freely
His wife for him. These always came
Quickly to good works to their fame.
They used to call on Us with love
And awe's humility above.

Elisabeth and Zakariah make
A loving couple for Your angel's sake.
The rumours are that evil was their lot
When jealous co-religionists were sought
To doubt and then explain Your grace in
plot.

My scientific mind refuses too.
But what's a modern man laid out to do?
I seek no heirs in John of Baptist hue.

Beloved, the cry for offspring in the way
Seems justified because You in Your sway
Created such an instinct to produce.
But in the world today, it's of no use,
Considering the billions that depend
On You alone for nourishment to end.

91 And she who kept her chastity,
We breathed on her Our spirit free,
And made her and her son a sign
For all nations and peoples' line.

The breathing of the breath on others for
A blessing is an ancient way in lore.
Elisha breathed on one and raised the dead.
A sheikh once breathed on me and on my
head.

But Mary claimed the greatest breath of all,
It was You who breathed on her at the ball.
The breath divine is stronger than that
found

In any but Elisha on the ground,
And can impregnate as well as resound
In every place in revelations bound.
Beloved, breathe on the very stones and
make

Them bear messiahs for Your mercy's sake,
And fill the world with justice and with
grace,
And so make it a better sort of place.

92 This your fraternity is one,
And I'm your Lord so serve no one
But me. 93 But some cut off their way
From one another, yet will they
All come back to Us under sway.

The understatement that You indulge in,
Beloved, makes me laugh though I'm in
chagrin.
Some cut themselves off from the others'
way

Is definitely seen the way folks pray.
I've prayed inside the church and
synagogue,
As well as in the mosque, and without grog
Sung in the cemevi to Ali's praise.
I've seen division multiply and craze.
And yet will all proliferations here,
And all the places I deign to appear,
There is no temple that accepts my hand.

I'm left without a congregation planned
Except the temenos of my own heart
With its stone walls enclosing Your own
part.

94 The one who does both righteous deeds
And has faith in Our righteous creeds,
His efforts will not be rejected.

We'll count his favour as selected.

95 But there's a curse on every folk
That We've destroyed, it is no joke
That they shall not return in yoke,

96 Until Gog and Magog are let
Through, and they quickly overget
Swarming from every hill they've met.

97 Then will come nigh the promised
threat.

See unbelievers' eyes will gaze
In horror. "Ah, woe to our maze,
We were negligent and in craze,
We did wrong indeed to amaze."

The fair Euphrates has been all dried up
By Turkish dam and drained down to a cup.
The only prophecy that stands to come
Is that Gog and Magog break through like
bum.

Dajjal will summon Dabbatul-Arz too,
Just as the book of Revelation's view
Gave long ago to John on Patmos' pew.
Then shall the great Mahdi bring justice'
cue.

The fair Euphrates has been caught and
dried

To make way for the eastern kings to bide,
And I look on the course of earth's events
And see the hidden hand that stays,
prevents

The rush into abyss, but waits the day
When You come in Your kingdom and
Your sway.

98 You and the gods you worship still
Besides God are fuel for hell's hill.
To it you'll come to pay your bill.

99 If these had been gods, they'd have not
Been sent into that hellish lot.

But each one will stay there *and rot*.

100 There they will only hear the sound
Of wailing and weeping around.

101 Those for whom good from Us is sent

Before, will be kept from that vent.
 102 They'll not hear of hell any hint.
 What their souls wish for, in that glint
 They will abide not to relent.
 103 Great horror will bring them no grief.
 But angels meet them with relief.
 "This is your day promised in feoff."
 104 The day when We scroll up the sky
 Like a book that's been read foreby,
 Just as We brought the first creation,
 So We'll produce a new relation,
 A promise We've brought on Ourselves,
 We shall fulfil it on the shelves.
 105 Before this We wrote in the Psalms,
 After the Torah message qualms,
 "My righteous servants shall be heir
 To the whole earth and everywhere."
 106 In this is a message to share
 With all folk who worship Allah.
 107 We sent you only as in awe,
 A mercy for all creatures fair.

Reminder or the dhikr is the book
 That You gave to Moses and where I look
 Each Sabbath day and find just written
 there
 The words I need to hear and words to
 share.
 I come upon the Sabbath day reciting
 The Torah and the Psalms without igniting
 The interest of the world around me here.
 My hand's stretched out to take Your
 blessing bare
 And spread it out in blessings everywhere.
 But that small whirling goes on without
 rein,
 And without notice from the worldly fane.
 Beloved, give me the strength to come
 again
 Upon the Sabbath to recite for men
 The Torah and the Psalms in my own den.

108 Say "What has come to me revealed
 Is that your God is One appealed,
 Will you then submit to Him heeled?"
 109 But if they turn back, say "I show
 The message to you all to know
 The truth. But I do not know if
 What you have promised will come swift.
 110 He knows what's open in your speech,
 And what you hide *of what you preach.*

111 "I don't know but it is a test
 For you and a grant and behest
 Of provisions for a time's rest."
 112 Say "O my Lord, judge You in truth.
 Our Lord Most Gracious is forsooth
 The One whose aid should now be sought
 Against the blasphemies you've taught."

I seek Your help, Beloved, against the false
 Beliefs I hear about me in the waltz.
 There's no one on the earth who gets so
 much
 Thrown at him to convert him with a touch:
 The Mormon and Jehovah's Witness share
 Augments the Evangelical's stained ware,
 And every other person who comes round
 Is sure I am mistaken by a pound.
 Beloved, I leave the measure of the taught
 And come to You alone among the sought,
 And find that blasphemies fall in their plot
 Before the fact of justice in Your lot
 And sovereign grace that rises like the dew
 Before the morning light comes into view.

Surah 22 Hajj, or The Pilgrimage

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 O humankind! Fear now your Lord!
 For catastrophic time is scored
 To be a terrible thing stored.
 2 The day you see it every mum
 That's nursing will forget the bum
 Of babe, and every pregnant dam
 Will have miscarriage from the slam.
 You'll see humankind reel and sway
 As in a drunken fit away.
 But they'll not be drunk, but in dread
 Of the wrath of Allah instead.
 3 Among men there are some who still
 Argue about God without will
 Of knowledge and go after each
 Wicked rebel stubborn in reach.
 4 Of that one it's decreed that one
 Who turns to him for favour done,
 He'll lead him astray and he'll guide
 Him to pain of fire to abide.
 5 O humankind, if you have doubt
 About the resurrection route,
 See We created you from dust,
 Then out of sperm, then out of lust
 Of a clot like a leech and then
 Out of a piece of flesh of men,

Part formed and part unformed again,
 So We may show the facts to you.
 We make those We will stay in due
 Time in the wombs, then We bring you
 Out as infants until you reach
 Your age of full powers on the beach.
 Some of you are called then by death,
 And some sent back in old age breath
 And weakness, so they know nothing
 After having known everything.
 You see the earth bare without life,
 But when we pour down the rain rife
 On it, it is stirred and it swells,
 And puts forth every kind that tells
 Of beauty growing *in the dells*.
 6 This is true because God is true.
 He gives life to the dead in crew,
 And He has power on all things due.

The life of every man and woman here
 Is in Your hand, Beloved, it does appear.
 You make from dust and blood and all such
 gear
 And breathe the breath of life to make them
 fear.
 You sustain, You let die, You resurrect
 All by Your power and choice of the elect.
 All praise is due to You, Creator fair
 Of everything that jostles here and there.
 I see the life spring up beneath the stone
 And push its way above the earthly groan
 And know that You live to provide the
 way.
 Beloved, I see Your making day by day,
 And as the night comes on, I bow to pray
 Before the richer colours of Your throne.

7 Indeed the hour will come, there can
 Be no doubt about it in scan,
 Or that God will raise from the graves
 All, *both the damned and elect slaves*.
 8 Yet there among men is the one
 Who disputes about God when done,
 Without the knowledge, without guidance,
 With a book of a clear confidence,
 9 Bowing and simpering to lead
 Astray from God's path and His creed.
 For him there is disgrace in life,
 And on the day of judgement rife
 We'll make him taste the penalty
 Of burning flame *that he will see*.

11 There are among men some who serve
 Allah as though in time preserve.
 If good comes to them they are glad.
 If trial comes to them they are sad
 To turn their faces, so they lose
 Both this world and the coming views.
 That is lose that all see and choose.

I must admit, Beloved, though I am one
 Who's prayed beside the Kaaba under sun
 Of Makkah, I still feel the stronger pull
 Of gratefulness when my own plate is full
 And Angst to find the trial comes on me.
 I quickly turn away unfaithfully
 And say because the evil's on my head
 You Yourself don't exist or can't be led
 By tears and prayers to pity suffering
 Of humankind beside the reeking spring.
 If You've elected me to Your salvation,
 You have not chosen me among the nation
 Of those who never doubt You in Your
 station.
 I am a doubter often where I sing.

12 They pray to such gods besides God
 As neither can hurt nor give prod.
 That is a straying on the sod.
 13 They pray to one whose harm is nearer
 Than is his profit to come clearer.
 Wicked indeed is the boss man
 And evil the companion's span.
 14 God will admit those who believe
 And work righteously to receive,
 To gardens beneath which flow streams,
 For God fulfils His plans *of dreams*.
 15 If anyone thinks God will not
 Help *His apostle* in the plot
 Of this world and the world to come,
 Let him stretch out a rope to hum
 From ceiling and cut off his life.
 Then let him see if his plan rife
 Will stop what enrages in strife.

Experiment in proof and evidence
 That You supported Muhammad on fence
 Is not what I intend to try abroad.
 To hang myself is not a proof of God.
 What were You thinking when You gave
 this word
 To the sweet Prophet when his heart was
 stirred?

First off, the act's no value in my sight,
For once I'm dead, I've hardly got a right
To see whether the plot stops You at all
From riding bare-back on terrestrial ball.
So let us both return to judgement hall
And learn to compromise about the squall.

16 So We have sent down the clear signs,
And God guides those whom He designs.
17 Those who believe and those who take
The Jewish scriptures for their stake,
And the Sabians, Christians too,
And the Magians and the crew
Of polytheists, God will judge
Between them on the day *to budge*,
For God is witness of all *fudge*.
18 Don't you see that to God bow down
In worship all things *round the town*
In heaven and on the earth, the sun
The moon, the stars, the hills in run,
The trees, the beasts, and some men too?
But a great number are in view
Of punishment. Such God will stew
In their disgrace. None can raise to
Honour, for God does what He'll do.

I raise me to no honour, that is true,
Beloved, in all the things I say and do.
I merely rate the willing and the view,
And see what next appears coming from
You.

If all things bow to You, as You relate,
Except from men created here for hate,
If sun and moon follow in their degree
According to the Psalmist's words to see,
Then I return to You as well to take
The recompense or not as saint or rake.
The punishment of every man's disgrace
Established for unworthy in this place
Does not imply that any by their hand
Can raise the head before You, come to
stand.

19 These two foes dispute with each other
About their Lord, but every brother
Who denies, for them will be cut
Out a coat of flame, and unshut
Over their heads will be poured out
Such boiling water *at their shout*.
20 It will scald their bodies inside
As well as their gross, sinful hide.

21 Added to that there will be too
Maces of iron to beat them through.
22 Each time they try to get away
From the pain, they are forced to stay,
And "Taste the pain of burning's sway!"
23 God will admit those who believe
And works of righteousness achieve,
To gardens beneath which flow streams.
They'll be decorated like dreams
With golden bracelets and pearls too,
And cloaks of silk *beyond all view*.
24 They've been guided to purest speech,
They've been guided into the reach
Of Him who's worthy of praise too.

For most men living in this day and hour
Descriptions of Your hell and the flame's
power
Serve only to affirm You cannot be
A God at all from our eternity.
We're certain in this day and age that You
Are never cruel in the things You do,
Perhaps by contrast with the orange state
That we've confected in our worldly rate.
Beloved, the question's merely borrowed
from

The education we've endured as scum,
And so I turn away without replying,
And stop my efforts at faithless defying.
Some are sent to the fire and some are sent
To paradise without injustice spent.

25 As for the ones who reject Him,
And keep back for God's way in trim,
And from the sacred mosque, which We
Have made for men, (equal to be
Is the resident and the guest)
And any whose purpose at best
There is profane and wrong to do,
Them We'll make taste of pain in view.
26 See, we gave the place to Abram,
Of the house, "Don't take any scam
Beside Me, and hallow My house
For those who circumambulate,
Or stand, or bow or then prostrate
Themselves in prayer *at last to drowse*.
27 "Proclaim to men the pilgrimage,
They'll come to you on foot and page
Of every kind of camel, lean
Because of journeys through the scene
Of distant mountains to careen,

28 "To find the benefits for them,
And celebrate God's name a gem,
Through days appointed, over beasts
That He's provided them for feasts,
So eat it and feed those in need.

29 "Then let them finish rites prescribed
For them, perform their vows imbibed,
And walk around the ancient house."

Again, Beloved, I turn toward the place
That Abraham rebuilt before Your face
And bow in prayer that this year I'm not
there

Beneath the canopy of desert air.
The threshold is my Kaaba once again
As I gaze on the line of travelling men
Who make their way to Your house on this
day.

I have no camel nor do I take foot
To start the pilgrim's happy roundelay.
Since I remain at home and do not put
The hearth-fire out, Beloved, come in to me
In divine pilgrimage, and let me see
The myriad minarets of dark fir tree
Breathe welcome to the bright reality.

30 It goes like this: whoever gives
Honours to God's holy rites lives
In the good graces of his Lord.
Then you may eat of cattle, but
Those kinds that were already shut.
But shun idols' abomination,
And keep from false word's *adulation*.

31 Be true in faith to Allah, and
Never join partners to His hand.
If any join partners to God,
It's as if he'd fallen to sod
From the sky and been caught by birds,
Or carried by the wind like turds.

The council of Jerusalem set out
These very principles as good and stout,
And they remind us of the rabbis' clout
In stating Noah's covenant about.
The only thing that's missing's fornication,
And when I look about the installation,
Methinks the Muslim tribes who keep this
word

Also forget to refrain from the herd
That fornicates in synagogue and church.
This one law is one all faiths leave in lurch

With quaint excuses for positions' perch.
Beloved, my hormones if not heart also
Reverberate with the crowd on the go,
But shyness keeps me pure, not lawful row.

32 It is like this: whoever takes
In honour symbols for God's sakes,
Such should come from the heart's right
stakes.

33 In them you have your benefit
For the time as appointed it.
At last their place of sacrifice
Is near the ancient house to slice.

I too stood in the Meccan place to slay
A sheep in honour of Your house and day,
And sent the meat to hungry people who
Applauded the reception come in view.
It is the Mesopotamian way
Of honouring the gods or God in sway
For centuries and more, and I might say
Millennia have looked on the strew sight
Of goats stretched out and bled before the
night.

Beloved, my heart and mind return each
time

I join the sacrificial throng in mime
To Abraham and how he taught his brood
To leave off worshipping of muted rude
And turn to You alone and leave the crude.

34 To every folk We did appoint
Ceremonies to celebrate
The name of God and to anoint
The nourishment He gave in rate
Of beasts. But your god is One God.
Submit to Him upon the sod,
And then proclaim the good news to
Those who humble themselves in view,
35 To those whose hearts when Allah's
name

Is mentioned are filled without shame
With fear, and who come patiently
To persevere in painful spree,
Regular prayer pray faithfully,
And give their own in charity
From what We've given them in fee.

Though all the world is filled with ancient
cults

As well as wickedness and brass insults,

The happiness of one is hard to bare:
Rejoicing in Your lovely names in air.
Those whose hearts fill with holy awe and
fear

To have the sacred name fall on the ear
Are blessed above all men and women too,
They have remembrance of Your name as
due.

Beloved, I hear Your Hebrew names and
still

Recite Your names in Arabic to fill
My brimming heart with ecstasy and awe.
I here recite be fair names of Allah.
As morning turns to night and night to day,
I say Your sacred names as here I pray.

36 The sacrificial camels We
Have made for you as among those
Symbols from God, in them he chose
Good for you. So pronounce the name
Of God upon them in their game,
When they're down on their sides, then eat
And feed those content with the treat,
And those who beg in humble feat.
We've set the beasts beneath your hand
To make you grateful where you stand.
37 It's not their flesh or blood that rises
To God, it is your own comprises
Your piety gone up to Him.
He's made them under you as grim
So you might glorify Allah
For His guidance to you in awe
And publish the good news to all
Who do right *in paddock and stall*.

The camel is abomination known
As shekets since the Torah has been shown,
And shekets or makruh it still remains,
Despite Qur'anic blessing on its gains.
As desert has increased since Torah rose,
So divine grace expands and where it
shows

The dispensation to take camel fare,
I find Your mercy working everywhere.
Beloved, find me not one remiss to miss
The treat of camel meat within my bliss.
I do not live where camels can be found,
I whirl upon a tundra sort of ground.
But where the camels fall in sacrifice,
I do not blame the few who take a slice.

38 God will defend those who believe,
God does not love those who deceive
And turn against faith or on sleeve
Show their ingratitude's *reprieve*.
39 To those against whom war is made,
Is given right to defend raid,
Because they're wronged, and truly God
Has strength to help them where they plod.

The right of self-defence is clear enough,
But how to implement the thing is rough.
If the aggressor comes with tanks and
bombs

The walking stick's no better arm than
Psalms.

When Ephrathite walked out with staff of
height

To face the wilderness of Indian might,
He needed nothing thicker than the oak.
Today offence is of a greater stroke.
Beloved, I raise an impotent stick here,
And strike intruders down and without fear,
And find they turn and knock me down
instead,

A wonder I don't fall upon my head.
The right of self-defence, like right of
speech,
Is best held quietly and out of reach.

40 Those who've been driven from their
home

Against their right, for no more loam
Than saying "Our Lord's God alone."
If God did not use one folk to
Keep down another in their stew,
Then they'd have torn down monasteries,
Churches and synagogues like fairies
And mosques in which the name of God
Is celebrated on the sod.

God will help those who help His own.
God is strong and high on His throne.

41 Those who, if We set in the land,
Keep regular prayer in their stand,
Give regularly charity,
Foster the right, forbid the spree
Of wrong. With God remains the end
Of all affairs and to amend.

It's fine to say to trust in God's protection
When everything is safe and in connexion,
But what about the times when danger rises

And enemies appear without disguises?
You'll help Your own, You say, and yet I
know

How many folk have fallen in the show
Of wickedness against Your law and grace.
This world's a dangerous and awful place.
If prayer and charity can beat the gong
And keep the town in peace against the
wrong,

It's yet to be a proven thing and song.
I hardly know a place where such is done
Besides the village that lies under sun
Of ancient Harran, I think of that one.

42 If they treat you as false, so did
The nations before them in grid,
The folk of Noah, 'Ad, Thamud,
43 Those of Abraham and Lot's brood,
44 The folk of Midian, Moses too
Was rejected by his own crew.
But I gave unbelievers time,
And only then did I their crime
Punish, but what action sublime!
45 How many peoples We've destroyed
Who were so wickedly employed?
They fell off their roofs, wells were left
Useless and high castles bereft.
46 Don't they travel throughout the land
So their hearts might learn wisdom's hand
And their ears might so learn to hear?
It is not just their eyes are blind,
But their hearts in their breasts confined.
47 Yet they ask you to bring on quick
The punishment. God is not slick
To fail in His threat. For a day
In sight of your Lord is in sway
Like a thousand years that you weigh.
48 To how many peoples did I
Give time of grace, when they were sly
To use the chance in doing wrong?
In the end I punished their song.
To Me all of them come along.

It's easier to prove the punishment
Upon the wicked world that You have sent.
Gomorrah is still famous where You spent
The brimstone of such horrors came and
went.

It's easier to show Your mighty arm
Upraised against the city for its harm,
Than to assess how often You have come

To intervene protecting chosen some.
Beloved, I trust You've been about Your
ways,

And You deserve undoubtedly Your praise,
But truth is told that innocent and those
Who pray and give in charity enclose
The victims of such acts of God let loose.
Obedience is no hedge or excuse.

49 Say "O men, I'm just sent to you
To give a clear warning as due.
50 "Those who believe and do the right,
For them's forgiveness and a sight
Of nourishment's generous light.
51 "But those who strive against Our signs,
And try to turn them in designs,
They'll be companions in fire's lines."
52 We never sent a messenger
Or prophet before you but sure
When he set forth a wish, Satan
Cast something in that desire's span.
But God will cancel anything
That Satan throws in on the sting,
And God will affirm His signs' wing,
For God is full of knowledge and
Has all wisdom at every hand;
53 So He might make the whisperings
Of Satan a test of those things
In whose hearts is disease and who
Have hard hearts. The wrongdoers' crew
Are sect apart for what they do.

I don't doubt ultimate in restoration,
Nor that the divine will on every nation
Will someday come and spill in
conflagration.

But while I'm waiting for the grand defeat
Of evil and the wicked way's retreat
From heart and hearth and harbour of elite,
I'd wish to see less suffering in the street.
But You, Beloved, are there to choose the
ration.

Though heaven is cheap enough after the
battle,

The march to it is very much like cattle
Set out for slaughter. Bear my point of
view:

I'm caught in days and years, I'm not like
You.

While tanks and bulldozers repeat their
lines,

I wait and wait to perceive Your designs.

54 And those to whom knowledge is
granted
May learn the truth from your Lord
planted,
And so believe in it, and their
Hearts may be made humble to share,
For God guides those who do believe
To the straight path that they receive.
55 Those who reject faith will not cease
To be in doubt about the fleece
Until the time comes suddenly
On them, or there comes penalty
Of a day of catastrophe.
The day of power will be of God.
He'll judge between them on the sod,
So those who believe and who do
Righteous deeds will come in the view
Of gardens of delight as due.
57 For those who reject faith and who
Deny Our signs, there will be sent
Humiliating punishment.

Beloved, I live from day to day in sight
Of righteous deeds and gardens of delight
As well as the day of which I've no doubt
That's coming on a world gone down the
spout.
I see Your judgement on my heart and
ways
As I sink down from burning life and craze
Into the coals of the red furnace blast:
I see the moment flare, the angels cast
Their burdens into hell. I see the gate
Ajar and glory stream from heaven's estate.
The vision where I live and move is sure,
The things I see from breath to breath are
pure,
And yet I wait upon the threshold here,
And kiss the doorposts where I shed a tear.

58 Those who become refugees in
The cause of God and then don't win
But are killed or die, God will grant
A fine inheritance. Not scant
Is God to give the best extant.
59 He'll let them in to a place where
They will be most pleased to be there,
For God's all-knowing, He'll forbear.

The Qur'an just repeats the Gospel promise
That was said before John and doubting
Thomas,
That those who've given up homes and
hearths and lands
For the name of Your sent one and
commands,
Shall be rewarded with abundant rate
Both in this life and in the future state.
The affirmation of such grace is great,
And ought to fill some hearts
commensurate.
Beloved, this word's repeated once again
For the condition of both mite and men,
For earth today is filled with refugees
Who've lost both homes and lands before
the breeze
Of greed in war and economic stands.
Thanks for encouragement in fleeing
hands.

60 If one has not retaliated
In greater measure than the grated
Harm he received, and is again
Attacked without cause, God will then
Help him, for God blots out forgiving
As long as a man keeps on living.
61 That is because God brings the night
Into the day, and the day's flight
Into the night, and it is God
Who hears and sees *all on the sod.*
62 That is because God is the true,
And those beside Him they call too,
They are vanity, falsehood too.
Allah is He, most high and great.

Death is no loss, it seems, upon the sod
Beneath the eye of mercy and of God.
Inheritance is not made on the sand
That blows before the wind at Your
command,
But in Your fast decree and it will stand.
The vengeance of the oppressed is
complete,
But not to overbound their loss and seat.
Refraining from excess results it seems
In blotting out the guilt of ashen streams.
Beloved, the proof of these two great
rewards
Is found, not in a nation lifting swords,
But in the balancings of night and day,

The alternatings that show You're in sway.
The tables are so set for their accords.

63 Do you not see that Allah sends
Down rain from the sky and it spends
Upon the earth to make it green?

For God is He who knows the scene
Of secrets and knows well their state.

64 To Him belongs all in the sky
And on the earth, God is not sly,
But free of all wants, worthy of
All praise and worthy of all love.

65 Do you not see Allah has made
Subject to you all on earth stayed,
And ships that sail around the sea
By His command? The rain keeps He
From falling on earth but by fee
Of his leave. Allah is most kind,
Most merciful to humankind.

66 It's He who gave you life, will bring
You under death in silent wing,
And will give you life once to sing
Again. Man's an ungrateful thing.

The rain's a gauge indeed for desert folk
To think that You'll appear to give the
stroke

Of justice to the world after the long
And fiery noon of kingships in the wrong.
The word is sure to desert folk, and yet
The second argument is better bet:

The fact that You gave life once is the
proof

That You're up to the resurrection's spoof
And not like to fail before the task's goof.
Beloved, I breathe today, and so by right
Of science and statistics in their might,
I'm like to breathe again beneath Your
sight.

It's not on empty promises You sing
The worlds into their being on the wing.

67 For every folk We've set up rites
And ceremonies which by sights
They must follow. So don't let them
Dispute with you about the gem,
But just invite them to your Lord,
For you're in the right way restored.

68 If they wrangle with you, just say
"God knows best what you do in sway."

69 "Allah will judge between you on

The day of judgement and upon
The matters that you differ on."

70 Don't you know God knows all that's in
The sky and in the earthly bin?

It's all on record and no trick
For God to look it up and pick.

71 Yet they worship besides Allah
Things without authority's awe
Sent down to them, and of which they
Have no true knowledge. In the pay
Of those who do wrong there is none
To help them when they have begun.

The argument among men of this race
Is stuck on rites and passages in trace,
On variations in the cultured pace,
Ignoring the great and the true in grace.
You call men to acknowledge at Your face
Your oneness and the sway of divine nature
On all of humankind both now and then.
If we could only turn our sights again
On You instead of on the way to pray,
The time to fast, and in our better way
How many fingers to lift in the blessing,
We should not be left quarrelling and
guessing.

Perennial philosophy for all
Its wrong is right to cast shapes on the wall.

72 When Our clear signs to them are heard
Recited, you'll notice occurred
On unbeliever faces stirred
Denial. They nearly attack
With violence those who're not slack
Reciting Our signs to them. Say
"Shall I tell you something in way
Worse than these signs? It is the fire.
God has promised them something dire
On unbelievers. So their end
Is evil, *an evil to lend.*"

73 O men, here's a comparison.
Listen to it. Those you have drawn
To call on besides God cannot
Create a fly, if all in plot
Came for the purpose. If a fly
Should snatch away from them thereby
They'd have no strength to take it back
From a fly who'd stolen their snack.
Weak are those who call and weak too
Are those that they petition to.

74 No just evaluation they

Make of God, for God is in sway
 Strong to carry out His will's way.
 75 God chooses messengers from men
 And angels, for God is again
 The one who hears and sees all men.
 76 He knows what is before them and
 What is behind them. To God's hand
 Go all affairs to sink or stand.
 77 O you who believe, come bow down,
 Prostrate yourselves around the town,
 Adore your Lord and do good deeds,
 So you may prosper *where He leads*.

Prosperity is made up of good deeds.
 That's something to add to the golden feeds
 That companies and salesmen ought to buy
 And eat for breakfast and then come and
 try.

Prosperity is made up of good things
 Done to the house and neighbourhood in
 rings.

Before reality I come to stand
 And find prosperity is Your command.
 Fie on the preachers who preach success in
 The world of Christian lovers in their bin,
 And find their bank account is out to win.
 Beloved, let my hand do a good deed here,
 Not striving for eternal weight of cheer,
 But for the time's prosperity that's near.

78 And strive in His cause as you ought.
 He's chosen you, and He has not
 Set hardships on you in the way
 Of faith, it is the worship's sway
 Of Abraham your father's day.
 It's He who's named you Muslims too,
 Both earlier and in this pew,
 So that the messenger may be
 A witness for you, and you be
 A witness to humankind, see.
 So set up prayer regularly,
 And keep on giving charity,
 And hold fast to Allah's decree.
 He's your protector, the best to
 Protect and the best to help too.

The faith of Abraham, Beloved, You give
 In five great principles that surely live
 In every heart submitted to Your care,
 No greater burden, greater love is there.
 This is the great jihad, the holy war

There is no other war You have in store.
 The first great battle is prayer or salaah,
 The second is alms-giving or zakaat.
 The third is the great fast, held fast to You,
 The fourth is pilgrimage, a refuge true
 For those who seek Your help, who are the
 best

Of helpers and protectors where we rest.
 The fifth is all of these and really first,
 Confessing You alone, in You immersed.

Surah 23 Al-Mu'minuun, or The Believers

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

- 1 The believers must win at last.
- 2 Those who are humble in their prayers;
- 3 Who flee vain conversation's blast;
- 4 Who do deeds in charity's shares;
- 5 Who keep away from copulation,
- 6 Except with those joined in elation
 Of matrimony, or whom their
 Right hand possesses for its share,
 For they are free from blame to bear.
- 7 But those whose desires go beyond
 Those limits have transgressions donned.
- 8 Those who faithfully keep their trusts
 And covenants from falsehood's dusts,
- 9 Who keep their prayers, 10 these will be
 heirs,
- 11 Who will inherit paradise.
 They'll live there and it will suffice.

The people's opiate is needed still,
 The promises of success on the hill
 Of future days. Now rise up for the kill.
 Beloved, don't listen to my cynic's bill.
 Those who keep promises and say their
 prayers
 Are up to be kept safe from other's cares,
 And if not here, in some more able time
 Rejoice to have escaped the greater crime.
 Beloved, no doubt the promises I've kept
 Are fewer than the ones I made inept,
 And prayers have speckled my days and
 my years,
 But few have been of perfect form and
 tears.

Let me despite my wares inherit nice
 Corners of hell or then of paradise.

- 12 Man We created from a blob;

13 Then We set him as a sperm do
In a fixed place to rest. 14 Then We
Made the sperm a clot of blood wee,
Then of that clot We made a lump,
Then from the lump We made a hump
Of bones and flesh, and from it made
A new creation. So be paid
Praise to God, Creator best stayed.

The modern mind of late would find this
word
To prove the Qur'an's a message unblurred
To show truth from ignorant ages past
That only now the scientist in blast
Of fortune can relate today at last.
I never found that science was criterion
Worth proving faith on or eye to get bleery
on.
But who am I to crop enthusiasm
Just because I am caught in my own
spasm?

Beloved, the secrets of genetic mill
Are here propounded, so Your words fulfil
From their inception what You come to
will.
I do believe, despite my rage to doubt,
And that is why You do not shut me out,
But show the bloody gobs to have some
clout.

15 After that at last you will die.
16 Again on Judgement day to vie
You will be raised up with a sigh.
17 We've made above you seven layers,
We don't forget creation's prayers.
18 We send down water from the sky
According to measure to try,
We make it soak the soil, and We
Can drain it away faithfully.
19 By it We cause to grow for you
Gardens of date-palms and vines too.
In them you have abundant fruit.
Of them you eat all that you suit.
20 A tree too springs from Mount Sinai,
Producing oil and spices by
Those who use it for food come nigh.
21 In cattle too you've much to learn,
From in their bodies We will churn
For you to drink, and lots of good
For you, and you eat as you should.
22 On them as well as ships you go

And finally get there not slow.

I hardly ever hear a Christian raise
This argument for Your glory and praise
And to prove Your existence in the haze.
The fact that cows are good for milk and
meat
And also for transport when that's a feat,
Is rarely seen as proof perfect that You,
Beloved, exist to prove the thing that's true.
I too love cows, especially cows when
young
And eager to nurse with a lively tongue.
I too love cows white speckled with the red
And all in fields of green alfalfa fed.
I'll drop my vain philosophy instead,
My attributes both positive and not,
And know in cows Your image has been
caught.

23 Among prophets We also sent
Noah to his people unspent.
He said "O my folk, worship God.
You have no other *on the sod*.
Will you not fear Him *as you plod?*"
24 The unbelieving elite of
His people said "He's no more shove
Than a man like yourselves. He just
Wants to make himself better lust
Over you. If God had been pleased,
He could have sent down angels breezed.
We never heard of such a thing
Among ancient ancestors' spring."
25 "He's just a man possessed, so wait
A while *and you will see his fate*."
26 He said "O my Lord, help me now,
They accuse me of a false row."
27 So We inspired him, "Build the ark
Under Our sight and guidance mark.
Then when comes Our command, and
spring
Up fountains of the earth on wing,
Take on board pairs of everything,
Male and female, your family too,
Except those of them who're untrue
Against whom the decree is due.
Don't intercede with Me for those
Who are wrong-doers: they once chose
To be drowned *when the flood arose*.
28 And when you set sail in the ark,
You and those with you from the park,

Say "Praise be to God who has saved
 Us from folk who so wrongly raved."
 29 And say "O my Lord, make me know
 How to set out under the show
 Of your blessing, for You are best
 To make us able to invest."
 30 Truly in this are signs, by which
 We try *men to see how they pitch.*

The ark was not so much to keep the crew
 Of Noah from the drowning waves that
 grew,
 But to teach him to praise You with the
 wealth
 Of breath lent from the animals in stealth.
 The ark was made to save of course, but
 not
 So much from the flood in the corners
 caught,
 But from the mocking of the selfish lot
 Who laughed at Noah and his foolish plot.
 Beloved, save me from mocking churches
 here
 That blast me for my simple faith and fear,
 And save me from the failure to give praise
 To You upon my fragrant nights and days
 Of sun and cloud about my hillside ways.
 Save me from both the strange as well as
 dear.

31 Then We raised after them to be
 Another generation *free.*
 32 And We sent them a messenger
 From themselves: "Worship God, be sure
 You have no other god but Him.
 Will you not fear *to do the dim?*"
 33 The leaders of his folk, those who
 Did not believe and denied too
 The confrontation that's to come,
 On whom We poured out all the sum
 Of goods in this life, said like bum:
 "He's no more than a man like you,
 He eats what you eat and drinks too
 The same thing you drink of the brew."
 34 "If you obey a man like you,
 See, it's sure that you'll be lost too.
 35 "Does he promise that when you die
 And become clay and bones awry,
 You'll be brought up again to spy?
 36 "What you're promised is a far cry.
 37 "There's only our life in this world.

We'll die and live, but never swirled
 Up resurrected and uncurred.
 38 "He's just a man to makes a lie
 Against God, but we're not to try
 To believe in him, such a guy!"

The resurrection is most common theme
 Of the Qur'an, although in Torah's gleam
 It's hardly seen at all. So with each book
 We take a little different sort of look.
 The men of Makkah on that far-off day
 Mocked the thought that they'd ever see a
 ray
 Of light at all after death's come to stay.
 It did not matter whether paradise
 Or hell was in the future for their price.
 They laughed at any resurrection's dice.
 Beloved, this day and page is also filled
 With doubt about the resurrection spilled
 On body. Either they say spirit stays,
 Or there's no resurrection to Your praise.

39 He said "O my Lord, help me now,
 For they accuse me of false trow."
 40 He said "In just a little while,
 Then they'll be sorry for their guile!"
 41 Then the blast came on them as right,
 And We made them a trash heaps plight
 Of dead leaves. So away with such
 Folk who do wrongfully as much.
 42 Then We raised after them the more
 In generations *from Our store.*
 43 No one can hurry up their score
 Or slow it down, *it's at the core.*
 44 We sent Our messengers in line,
 Each time a people's sent one fine
 Came to them, they accused him well
 Of lying words and casting spell:
 So We sent them down the same road.
 We turned them into legends' load.
 Away with folk who won't believe!
 45 Then We sent Moses on the sleeve
 With Aaron his brother along
 With Our signs and with seeing strong
 Authority *and power in song*
 46 To Pharaoh and his leading men.
 But they were arrogant again,
 A people proud *in deed and pen.*

If every generation makes the same
 Mistake in their rejection of Your fame,

I'd think I could advise You what went
 wrong.
 You did not sing a loud enough in song.
 You should have caught attention better by
 A word or two sent down from Mount
 Sinai
 Or floating sweetly on air in the sky
 Might have contrived to make them see that
 You
 Are really God, Creator and the true.
 If by divine decree You decide fate
 In hell or paradise for sinful rate,
 Then by divine decree You might set free
 The populace of scorn set mockingly.
 Of course with You the thing's never too
 late.

47 They said "Shall we believe in two
 Men like ourselves? Their folk in crew
 Are slaves to us, *and that is true!*"
 48 Accusing them of telling lies
 They fell into destruction's plies.
 49 We gave Moses the book, so they
 Might have its guidance on their way.
 50 We made the son of Mary and
 His mother a sign in the land.
 We gave them refuge on high land,
 And rest and safety and to stand
 Among springs *ready at command*.

The college of the prophets stands through
 ages
 To face the human fortress and men's rages
 With truth. I wonder why, Beloved, You
 bring
 Them before the imperial to sting.
 The heart that is not touched with grace
 cannot
 Respond to warnings sent but never sought.
 The hand untouched by grace can only lie
 Upon the back of others heavily.
 Beloved, I see the prophet and the glee
 Of courtier and of rank fall at the sigh
 When You appear where men fail to
 comply.
 But before that, what is the use of coil,
 The waiting and the sighing at the toil,
 When nothing of the seed takes root in
 soil?

53 But people have broken their pact

And brought themselves in sects to act,
 Each party happy with its stacked.
 54 But leave them in their disarray
 Of ignorance until their day.
 55 Do they imagine because We
 Have given them a high degree
 Of wealth and sons, 56 that We will speed
 Them into every good with greed?
 No, they don't understand their lead.
 57 Truly those who are staid in fear
 Of their Lord; 58 those who heed the steer
 From their Lord; 59 those who do not add
 Associates with their Lord *glad*;
 60 Those who hand out their charity
 With hearts filled and forebodingly,
 Because they'll come back to the fee
 Of their Lord; 61 it is these We speed
 In every righteous sort of deed,
 And these are the chief in their *creed*.

You answer well my query, Beloved, here
 When You say leave all men to disappear
 In disarray and ignorance and fear.
 The great Muhammad had no task but one:
 Reciting the Qur'an beneath the sun.
 My task is just to complain with the sound
 Of ghazel sonnet flashing round and round.
 It's not my task to sell Your politics
 Or to embroil myself where the dog licks
 Its wounds and then comes back to face the
 tricks.
 You give Your paradise to those who do
 Good deeds of grace and seated in their
 pew.

What reward or what punishment have You
 For one who only rhymes away the dew?

62 On no soul do We place a load
 That's heavier than they can have towed.
 In front of Us there is the writ
 That clearly shows the truth as fit,
 So they'll never be wronged a whit.

The Muslim and the Christian want to fight
 About the true and false, the wrong and
 right.
 And yet the word to each is made the same:
 You do not lay on either any claim
 Beyond what each can bear. And yet the
 game

I see around me and in my own heart

Is that we find the load we bear in part
Beyond the strength and grace we have in
cart.

What great excuse can I give back to You,
Beloved, for failing to put on my shoe?

Instead I pray the gravel and the thorn
Beneath my whirling feet not leave them
torn

And bloodied, while my boots remain on
shelf,

A-shine, well polished by some skilful elf.

63 But their hearts are unknowingly
Confused in this. And these are fee

Of actions on their part which they
Will always just accept in sway,

64 Until We grasp them on the day
Of pains who got the good in way

Of this world, see, they'll groan and pray!

65 "Don't moan in prayer at least today,
Because you'll not get Our help's lay.

66 "My miracles were oft recited
To you, but you turned back benighted

67 "In pride, spoke foolishly about

The message, like one in the rout
Of nightly tales." 68 Do they not think

About the Word, or has the brink
Of anything come to them that

Did not come on ancestors' mat?

69 Or don't they recognize the one
Sent with a message they've begun

To deny? 70 Or do they still say

"He is possessed"? No, he'd relay

To them the truth, but most of them
Just hate the truth *and so condemn*.

The miracles of revelation stand
In glad array, and verse by verse command
Attention from the good and faithful band
And from the froward, wicked heart and
hand.

The songs of Torah, prayers of David too,
The Gospel in its Greekly sort of hue,
The Qur'an lovely and rugged to view,
All whisper their demands of love from
You.

Instead I turn so oft to peer and pew
And love the jingling of launched song
that's new,

And to the taste of crowd and element.

Beloved, bring me around from whirling
spent

To stay upon the better Word that's sent
By Gabriel instead of rock and rue.

71 If the truth had been right along

The way they wanted for a song,

Then sky and earth would all be wrong,

And everything in them a gong

Confused, corrupted and ding-dong.

No, We sent them a warning sign,

But they turned from it to resign.

72 Or do you ask payment from them?

But payment from your Lord's a gem.

He's best to give nourishment's hem.

73 You call them into the straight path.

74 Those who do not believe in wrath

Of the hereafter go astray

And are lost out of the right way.

Muhammad calls to the straight path, I see,
So why so many foes for enemy?

I hear around me every day the speech
Of those who call Muhammad come to

preach

A child molester, pedophile, and more,

The thief of relative's wives at the door.

Beloved, what is the straight path that I
showed?

It is the faith that You are one who slowed
Man to stay in prayer and give alms and

seek

The house of God, and fast upon a peak,

To be just to all men, to help the poor

And further rights of the oppressed for
sure.

What is there here, I ask, to justify

The heat, the hate, and the will to defy?

75 If We had mercy on them and

Took their pain from them on demand,

They would be stubborn still to stand

In their transgression, wandering there

And back and forth, confused with care.

76 We laid pains on them, but they did

Not humble themselves at the bid

Of their Lord, nor beg for a boon,

77 Until We opened on their tune

A portal into punishment.

See what despair they have been sent.

78 He has created for you hearing,

And sight and feeling and appearing
Of understanding. Little thanks
It is that you put in His banks.

You think I should be grateful for the ear,
The eye, the feeling and once to appear
The understanding. You think wrong, my
Dear.

The ear makes me be grateful when I hear
The good, but not for evil at the store.
The eye I love when beauty comes before
Me, not when ugliness or evil's score
Makes dark my sight. For pain I do not
praise

Capacity to feel through endless days.
For understanding least of all, my Sweet,
Since You gave it to so few on my street.
It is a lonely way, a far retreat.
But in adversity grant me the grace
Of gratitude for You, the one true face.

79 And He has multiplied you through
The earth, and to Him at your due
You shall be gathered back in view.
It's He who gives both life and death,
To Him night and day's round of breath,
So won't you understand the clue?

81 Instead they just repeat the things
Like what was said in old-time springs.

82 They say "What! When we die and be
Dust and bones, could we really be
Raised up again *and faithfully*?

83 "Such things have been promised before
To us and our ancestors' store.

They're only tales of ancient lore."

84 Say "Who owns the earth and all things
That are in it? Show your wise rings!"

85 They'll say "God." Then say "Will you
still

Not take the warning and fulfil?"

86 Say "Who's the Lord of seven skies,
And the Lord of the throne in guise?"

87 They'll say "God." Say "Won't you then
be

Filled with the awe *of His glory*?"

88 Say "Whose hand rules here over all,
Who guards, but no one guards His hall,
If you know anything at all?"

89 They'll say "God's." Say "Then how are
you

Benighted in the things you view?"

It seems the ruthless mocking of the day
When Muhammad came with the heavenly
ray

Was only half as bad as what I see
Around me in sophisticated spree.
In those days doubt was only resurrection.
They thought this seventy years of earth's
selection

Was all there could be for the human soul.
They were not on a Hellenistic roll.
But they admitted You created all
And ruled the dust and glitter on the ball.
Now those who are the wisest of good men
Doubt both the resurrection and again
Existence of Creator in His den.
You see, Beloved, degeneration's wen.

90 We've sent them truth, but they indeed
Believe and follow a false creed.

91 Allah did not beget a son,
Nor is there any god unspun
With Him. See each god would have taken
Away what he created making.
And some would have gloated by others.
Glory to God! He has no brothers.

92 He knows what's hidden and what's
clear.

He's too high for partners come near.

A false creed is the one that makes a god
Of Jesus the sweet sent one on the sod.
My own fair church by Francis Bampffield
stated

Has a creed that has never yet abated.
It says that Jesus is lawgiver here,
And Lord that was awaited to appear.

It says the Scriptures of truth and of cheer
Are rule of faith and worship and of life
For both the husband and the faithful wife.
So the Qur'an and the creed of my church
Are in a full agreement and one perch.
The Qur'an affirms what was Bible truth
Of oldsters and for flaming, blaming youth.
Neither book came to leave us in the lurch.

93 Say "O my Lord, if You will show
Me what they're warned about to go,

84 "O Lord, don't put me in the glow
Of folk who do a wicked row."

95 And We can show you about what

They have been warned *of things unshut*.

96 Fight evil with the good. We know
Well what they say and what they show.

97 And say "O my Lord, I will seek
Refuge with You from what they peek,
The evil ones *of evil streak*."

98 "And I seek refuge with You more,
O Lord, lest they knock at my door."

99 Till death comes upon one of them,
He'll say "Lord, send me back from hem,

100 "So I may do righteous things that
I did not do when there I sat."

"Indeed not, it's an empty promise."

Before them is one to keep from us,
A barrier till the day they're raised
To find that Allah's only praised.

Nothing has taken the imagination

Of orientalist in flagellation

And Muslim mind like the barzakh to be
The source of tales and wonder on the
spree.

Some are the fearful taunts of angels come
To beat the sinner dead and under thumb.

Some are taught with the humour and the
laugh

That would make of death nothing but a
gaff.

Beloved, barzakh is silent after death.

It only meets the ear and eye with breath
While light of day falls on decision's brow.

The barzakh is a thing of here and now.

When I come to the barzakh for my fate,
I plan to lay me down to sleep and wait.

101 So when the trumpet sounds, there'll be

No more comings and goings free

Between them on that day, and they

Will not ask of each other's pay.

102 Those whose scales are heavy will get
Eternal salvation, you bet,

103 And those whose scales are light will
find

They've lost their souls left in Hell's bind.

104 The fire will burn their faces and
Their grinning, contorted lips stand.

You have a gruesome view, Beloved, of
faces

In fire and grimstone sorts of hellish places.
Is it divine imagination or

Foreseeing horrors on the future shore?

Some say Your grace is pre-ordained by
sight

Of what free will accomplishes of right.

If that is so, I'd think that foresight on

The grinning, twisted lips of hellish dawn

Would make You foreordain all humankind

To paradise instead of hell resigned.

But who am I to speak of space and time

Whose own heart is a wilderness of mime

To be explored beyond the scope a man

Can compass in three score and ten by
plan?

105 "Were not My miracles recited

To you, and you held them beslighted?"

106 They'll say "Our Lord, misfortune
came

Upon us rushing in its claim,

And we were a folk in the blame.

107 "Our Lord, come and take us from this,

Then if we go back there to kiss,

Then we'll be transgressors to miss."

108 He'll say "Dive down in it for shame.

Don't speak to me to make a claim.

109 "There were among My servants those

Who used to pray 'Our Lord, we chose

Belief, so now forgive us, and

Have mercy on us, for Your hand

Is best to show mercy to stand.'

110 "But you just laughed at them until

You made yourselves forget the shrill

Message of mine while you laughed still.

Three times a day and one-half by my
count

So evangelical in vengeful mount

Tells me to chose salvation or be lost.

I feel that I am battered and I'm bossed.

How glad I am to see You laugh at them

And treat them like the mockers they
condemn.

They chose belief. My God, what egotism.

I'd rather have a bout of rheumatism.

Let me chose nothing in this world or
theirs,

Beloved, let my choice lie here unawares.

But choose me, if You will, Beloved, and
make

Of me what You design for Your own sake.

I have no faith to offer You nor wealth,

But Your own glory and Your saving
stealth.

111 "I have rewarded them today
For the patience to stay the way.
They're the ones who've got the good pay."
112 He'll say "How many years did you
Stay on the earth, *to state it true?*"
113 They'll say "We stayed a day or few,
But ask those who keep count on cue."
114 He'll say "You only stayed a while,
If you had only known the guile.
115 "Did you think We'd created you
For just a joke, and you'd not do
The journey back to Us for view?"
116 Exalted be Allah the King,
The Truth, there is no god in ring
But He, the Lord of glory's throne.
117 If anyone prays but alone
To God, he's got no right to that.
He'll be taken to account fat
With his Lord. Unbelievers fail
To break through to the prize on sale.
118 So say "O Lord, forgive and show
Mercy, for You are best in row
Of those who show mercy and know."

You're not a slave-master, Beloved, as I
See the Qur'an correct the meaning sly
That Christians gave the sonship on the rye.
A slave-master takes all the work he can
Out of the back of each woman and man
He has in cattle-yard. But You in scan
Reward the servant for the patient way
He takes reality. The patience lay
In Your first gift. So gift is from the start,
And at the finish, this is divine art.
What have I that I've not got from Your
hand?

You are the one deserving of the planned
Reward. The ravings of Your band
Provide not even empty donkey cart.

Surah 24 Nur, or Light

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
1 A surah which We have sent down
And which We've ordained *on the town*:
In it We've sent down clear signs, so
You may have admonition's *glow*.
2 The woman guilty and the man
Guilty of fornication's ban

Or of adultery, beat them both
A hundred lashes *for their oath*.
Do not feel pity in their case,
A thing commanded by God's grace,
If you believe in God and in
The last day. Let some *without sin*
Of the believer testify
Their punishment *and so say why*.

This outrage of a hundred lashes here
Conflicts with Torah which it would appear
Limits the flogging to forty at most,
Lest judge and executioner should boast.
(Deuteronomy 25)

The price for such sex crimes in Torah is
Simply the death sentence in a quick whiz.
(Leviticus 20:10)

The principle to put the suffering one
Out of his misery's no longer fun.
Beloved, I stake my own addictions done
Where mercy killing fails to show a brow,
And so go limping through the world
somehow.

My death or my translation's coming soon,
And so I need not ask for other boon.
Avoid the lash I'll try from noon to noon.

3 Let no man guilty of adultery
Or fornication marry sultry,
Except a woman likewise guilty,
Or unbeliever *being sily*,
Nor let any but such a man
Or unbeliever in his span
Marry a woman caught like that.
To the believers such are scat.

For fornication Torah grants reprieve
Of sacrifice and marriage on the sleeve.
Adultery is another Bible case:
It's death for that without pity or grace.
The Qur'an sets them both as in one place,
Demanding lashes to a hundred race.
The faiths of both books fail to keep up
pace.

The Muslims follow Torah, and give death,
While Christians hold such sin with catch
of breath
And let the guilty escape punishment.
Beloved, You might as well have never
sent

The Bible and Qur'an, for what we've
spent.
Religion has no effect on the way
Morals or not among men come to sway.

4 Those who accuse a woman chaste
Without four witnesses in haste,
Give them a beating for their pains
Of eighty lashes, and give reins
No more again to what they say.
Such men are wicked and astray,
5 Unless they repent for the thing
And make better their lives from stings;
For God's forgiving mercy sings.
6 For those who accuse their own spouses
With no proof but their own for dowses,
The witness of one can be taken
If they swear by God four times making
Themselves to tell the truth *forsaken*.
7 The fifth time is they call a curse
From God on themselves for the worse
If they are lying *through their purse*.
8 And the wife escapes punishment
If she bears witness four times lent
By God that he's telling a lie.
9 And the fifth is she calls down on
Herself God's anger if he's drawn
To tell the truth about her gone.
10 If it were not for Allah's grace
And mercy on you, and the face
Of God forgiving, full of sense,
11 Those who told lies are among you
Ensconced as an amazing crew,
Don't think it is evil on you.
Rather it is a good thing too.
To every one among them comes
The recompense of his sin's sums,
And to the instigator comes
A harsher penalty on bums.

You are so hopeful, my Beloved, to think
That men and women on the awful brink
Will not lie freely through their thief as
soon
As they have a change to encounter noon.
No oaths suffice, no called-down
imprecations,
The human heart is here to fill the stations
Of decide to keep the idol You
Set in each human heart: Your presence
true.

Beloved, I think I know reality
And in my heart see what is clear to see,
But do not ask me to with human word
To confess truth before the human herd.
Let silence echo throughout space and start
Afrighted by the stir of human art.

12 Why didn't the believers there,
Both men and women in their share,
When you have heard of the affair,
Put the best face on what they heard
In their own minds and say when stirred,
"This is a clear lie we have heard"?
13 Why didn't they bring then in proof
Four witnesses? It is a spoof,
When they've not brought witnesses' proof,
Such men in God's sight lie and goof.
14 If God's grace and mercy were not
On you, in this world and the lot
Of the one to come, then a pain
Most harsh would have grabbed you for
gain
For rushing gullibly into
This matter *when it was not due*.
15 See, you took it upon your tongues,
And spouted from your mouths in rungs
Things you did not know about.
You thought it was a joke to shout,
While it was serious in the sight
Of God, who did not take it light.
16 When you heard the thing, why did you
Not say "It is not right on cue
For us to speak about this too:
Glory to God! It's slander's view."
17 Allah warns you not to repeat
Such things if you're believers meet.
18 God makes the signs clear to your sight.
God's full of knowledge, wisdom right.

That's better, my Beloved. When You
require
Four witnesses, You show that You admire
The fact that two or three of Pentateuch
Were simply not enough, though king and
duke.
If one man cannot know and speak the
truth,
And two or three fear to reveal forsooth,
Surely where four agree, we can be sure
That the witness is satisfied and pure.
Beloved, I doubt that ten thousand of men

Could recognize the truth they met again
Of the last night they spent about the town,
And if they could before the waging frown
Of questioner, I doubt they'd whisper what
They know to be the truth in their gates
shut.

19 Those who love scandal spread abroad
Among believers will be shod
With grievous pains in this life and
After. Allah will understand,
And you do not know *of the planned*.
20 If God's grace and mercy had not
Been on you and God's full in plot
Of loving-kindness, mercy's lot.
21 O you believer, do not go
After Satan's footsteps in show.
If anyone will follow in
The footsteps of Satan for sin,
He'll order the wrong way for shame.
If God's grace and mercy had not
Been on you, none of you in lot
Would ever have been pure. But God
Will cleanse the ones He will on sod.
God's one who hears and knows *in pod*.

The only hope for any on the hill
Is cleansing of Your grace and mercy still.
Depravity marks every institution
And spoils even the US Constitution.
As soon as doors to mercy open wide,
There are some to come out from where
they hide
Devouring innocent and poor decried.
The only hope is Your grace to abide.
Beloved, I follow in the footsteps clear
Of Satan and find everywhere the fear
Of decide and hope to gain the throne
And cast down every other god with stone.
If You will cleanse the earth, then cleanse it
now
Or when You have decided on the how.

22 Don't let those among you with grace
And wealth by oath go without trace
Of helping kin, poor, and the folk
Who've been driven from home by stroke
Of God's cause. Let them too forgive
And forget, don't you want to live
Also in God's forgiveness' view?
For God is oft-forgiving too,

And merciful *of all the crew*.

Support of poor and refugee is not
A thing of voluntary sort of plot.
It is demanded by the word You sent
By good Muhammad on earth to prevent
The chaos and the ruin that we find
About the world and Iraq by the blind.
The law is implemented by the hand
Of every power that's human in the land
To make the refugee safe on the sand,
And fill the plate with every sort of sweet
The tongue desires for daily bread and
meat.

The hope of poor and refugee is vain,
Unless he turn it back toward Your train,
Away from human hand out for the gain.

23 Those who speak ill of women chaste,
Not wise yet believing in haste,
Are cursed in this life and the next.
For them's a penalty perplexed,
24 On the day when their tongues and
hands

And feet give witness of their stands
In actions *beyond God's commands*.
25 On that day God will recompense
Them justly, and they'll have the sense
That God is truth, and He brings all
Things openly against the wall.
26 Unclean women are for such men
Unclean, and unclean men again
For impure women; while the pure
Women are for men who are sure
In purity, and pure men too
Are for women of a pure view.
They are not touched by what folk say.
They have forgiveness and in pay
Provision of the honoured way.

The evil spoken of chaste women is
Not limited to just that power and biz.
The evil spoken of anyone who
Is not guilty of what's claimed he would do
Is just as reprehensible and makes
As many waves as in chaste women's
wakes.

I am a woman chaste of all the harms
That I've been now accused of for alarms,
And yet the sins that weigh my blackened
soul

Are never mentioned in accuser's toll.
It is a grace that accusations do
Not correspond to what is right and true,
So the self-righteous outrage soothes the
pate,
And the true guilt is hidden from the hate.

27 O you believers, do not go
In houses except your own row,
Before you ask for leave and then
Have greeted those inside again.
That's best for you to hearken when.
28 If no one's home, then don't go in
Before permission's in your bin.
If you're asked to go out, then go.
That makes a better way in show
For you. And God knows all you know.
29 It's no fault on your part to go
In houses where none live in row,
Which serve some other purpose' stow.
God knows who you have come to show
And what you keep secret and slow.

The coming into houses in a way
That's secret fosters several things to stay
Away from: first it fosters theft of things
That lie about the dwelling such as rings
And silver and brocade. But there's another
Thing that makes for the openness in
brother.

And that's what comes next in sight as I
read:

The warning against sexual misdeed.
Beloved, let every house be sought alone
By the door and with the leave from the
throne

Of the host and the owner. So the clear
Will always be the better without fear.
But You, Beloved, have my leave anytime
Or any way to come in my hut's rhyme.

30 Say to believing men that they
Should lower their gaze in their way
Of modesty. That will make them
A greater purity in hem.
God knows well all they do *each day*.

31 Say to believing women they
Should lower their eyes and keep way
Of modesty, and not display
Their beauty and ornaments gay
Except what shows. They should let down

Their veils over their breasts from crown
And not display their beauty but
To their own husbands, and to jut
Their dads, their husbands dads, their sons,
Their husbands' sons, the brothers guns
Or their own brothers' sons, or their
Sisters' sons, or their women's share,
Or the slaves that their right hands hold,
Or menservants who are left cold,
Or children with no sense of shame.
They should not clang the feet to draw
Attention to the jewelled claw.
O you believers, turn you all
Together to God, bliss in thrall.

The letting down of veils is not quite clear.
It could mean to uncover faces' cheer.
Traditions says the opposite, but I
Am often forced to wonder as I spy
The words the Qur'an takes to in reply
To questions in the heart of man increased.
The questions flow from the great and the
least.

Beloved, I do not clang my feet to make
A sound attracting some attention's sake,
But I do lift a bitter voice to say
That my books ought to sell for better pay.
I see throughout earth's history though now
That others have done the same plot
somehow

And still remain obscure, despised today.

32 Marry those among you who be
Single or virtuous to see
Among yourselves, male or female,
If they are poor, God will prevail
To give them means from His own grace.
God surrounds all, knows every trace.
33 Let those who have no means to marry
Keep themselves chaste, till God is wary
To give them wherewithal from grace.

If any of your servants trace
Request for a writ, give them such
If you know what good they may touch.
Give them of your own that God's given.
But don't make your maids who have
striven

Turn to prostitution when they
Desire in chastity to stay,
So you may gain life's profits' sway.
But if somebody forces them,

After their forcing, God's a gem
 To forgive and grant mercy's hem.
 34 We've already sent verses down
 To make things clear to all the town,
 A warning of folk who passed on
 Before you, and admonition
 For those who fear *both night and dawn*.
 35 Allah is the light of the sky
 As well as the earth passing by.
 His light's likeness is as if there
 Were an alcove and in its glare
 A lamp, and the lamp closed in glass,
 Its glass as it were shining mass
 Of star lit from a blessed tree,
 An olive, neither ancestry
 Of east or west, whose oil is near
 In shining, though without fire peer,
 Light upon light! And Allah guides
 Whom He will to His light besides,
 Allah makes parables for men,
 Allah knows everything again.

Let me compare no thing to You, no thing
 Created can express Your essence. King
 And commoner alike are equally,
 Beloved, beneath Your very sovereignty.
 But You Yourself say You are like the light
 Revealing to the souls of men the sight
 Of sky and earth, and truth in physical
 And spiritual dimension. Parable
 At Your command, the universe prostrates
 And even gnat reveals divine estates
 To humankind. Like light, You guide
 without

Being seen in Yourself, like light, no doubt,
 You are no form, but yet within my heart
 Your niche in stone is bright from end to
 start.

36 In houses God has raised to honour,
 To glorify in them His name.
 In them He does receive His honour
 At morn and eventide the same,
 37 By those unmoved by flight or sale
 From God's remembrance without fail,
 Nor from prayer regular, nor from
 The practice of charity's sum.
 Their fear is of the day when hearts
 And eyes with be changed from their parts.
 38 That God may reward them in view
 Of the best of the deeds they do,

And add more for them from His grace.
 For God provides for those in trace
 Whom He will in abundant brace.

Remembrance of God rises from the text
 Of the Qur'an to worry the perplexed
 Who do not see it among pillars five
 Or roots ten of Islamic practice' hive.
 The dhikrullah that guides me through the
 day
 Is repetition of promise in sway.
 The one that takes me through the fragrant
 night
 Is the breath that I breathe in Your delight.
 Remembrance is the sweetest of Islam,
 The following of Your names from the
 palm
 And to the forehead where the eyebrows
 meet
 In arches gathered on the golden street,
 Until the heart is opened to the right.
 Beloved, give me both ear and heavenly
 sight.

39 But unbelievers, their deeds are
 Like a mirage seen from afar
 In sandy deserts, which the man
 Burning with thirst errs in his scan
 For water, till he comes to it,
 He finds it is just nothing fit.
 But he finds God's with him, and God
 Will balance his account in prod,
 And God is quick in counting's wit.

O my Beloved, do You not understand?
 I want the fair mirage above the sand!
 The carrot immaterial in flight
 Before my donkey brain trained up in sight
 Of social expectations in the night
 Demands mirages all around the land.
 Be quick to count me silver and some gold,
 But not so much that alms eat up the rolled!
 O my Beloved, do You not realize
 That life in time and space requires in guise
 An expectation always before eyes,
 And heart turned toward the future to
 surmise?
 What does it matter that at last it's dry?
 At least our lives are lifted high to vie.

40 Or like the dark deep of the sea

Immeasurable and running free
With wave on wave, above the clouds,
The veiling darkness, shroud on shrouds,
If a man stretches out his hands,
He'll barely see them where he stands,
For the one God gives no light, there
Is never a light anywhere.

41 Don't you see that God's praises are
Sung by all beings near and far
In heaven and earth, and fowl of wing
Outspread? Each one knows its own thing
Of prayer and praise. And Allah knows
Well all they do *set up in rows*.

42 Indeed to God belongs the power
Over the sky and earth to tower,
And to God is the final goal.

The tumbling grass sings wings on wings
Allah, Allah, and the hawk flings
Its praises on the air, each beast
And branch has its sema increased:
All things on earth and sea and air
Praise You above all things made fair,
But I alone forget to praise
And thank You throughout all my days.
A moment here, an hour to boast,
I join my voice to heavenly host,
But far more often only grieve
Or find my own trash on my sleeve.
Forgive the slender voice that takes
Your name at times for favoured breaks.

43 Don't you see that God makes the clouds
Go sweetly, then joins them in shrouds
And piles them up? Then you will see
Rain come out of them faithfully.
He sends down from the sky gigantic
Mountains full of the hail and frantic,
He fells with them the ones He will
And turns it from whom He will still,
His searing lightning falling bright
Near takes away in blindness sight.
44 It's God who alternates the night
And day, truly in these things right
Is warning for those who have sight.

Beloved, I stand in awe before the weight
Of the worlds and the skies that You create,
The flash of lightning in the dark that
wakes

The live-oaks from their sleep and nearly
shakes
Their beards, while every leaf one moment
lies

Like emerald and shining under skies.
I stand in awe of Your hand on the cloud,
And rain and hail and snow in power
endowed.

Beloved, I stand in awe before the set
Of beauty in the many things I've met,
And here before the words of revelation
Done in the beauty of a heart's elation.
The Word and what it makes upon the air
Remains a woven mystery to share.

45 And God created every beast
From water. Some of them at least
Crawl on their bellies, others walk
On two legs, and still others balk
Not at walking on four legs. So
God has created His will's stow,
For God has power on all below.

46 We truly sent down signs to make
Things evident. And for His sake
God guides whom He will in a way
That is straight *in the light of day*.

Like every other beast, I have been slow
And crawled upon my belly once to go.
And then on all fours like the cat and bear,
And after that I also came to share
The standing on hind legs like bird and ape.
Beloved, some things a man cannot escape.
But how I stand I cannot measure why,
Except as I'm created by the by,
And so walk in the ways of nature laid
By You when You came down to have
Word made.

No matter how I move among the beasts,
Beloved, let me be guided not by priests,
But by Your hand among those whom You
will
Lead out upon the field and verdant hill.

47 They say "We do believe in God
And in the messenger to prod,
And we obey." But after that,
Some of them turn away out flat,
They're not believers where they sat.
48 When they are called to God again
And to His messenger as men

To be judged between them, so then
Some of them refuse from their den.
49 But if the right is on their side,
They come to him devoid of pride.
50 Is it that there's disease in heart?
Or do they doubt or fear in part
That God and His sent one will treat
Them without justice? They defeat
Themselves who do wrong and unmeet.

How many ways there are to flee from him
Whom You sent with the Qur'an and not
dim!

Some flee into the church to sing a hymn,
Some flee into the temple for a whim,
Some take the right to deny all and trim
That claims to be of faith, and some are
grim

To point out rumours of evil done late
By prophet and by relative in wait.
Beloved, let me come at the single word
And hear the command on my ear then
stirred.

Let me train up my heart and hand to do
According to the best Qur'anic view
That lies within parameters of dew,
The Torah revelation's foremost cue.

51 Believers reply when they're called
To God and His sent one installed,
So He may judge between them then,
Is this, they say "We heard again
And so obey." It's just such ones
Achieve the happiness that runs.

52 It's such obey God and the one
He's sent, and fear God and have spun
The right that will win *on the run*.

53 They swear strongly by God that if
You just commanded them in skiff
They'd set out. Say "Don't swear at all.
Obedience is a reasoned call.
God knows well what you do in stall."

Beloved, I make no oaths by Your dear
name,
I make no promises to join the game,
I swear not by the heights or depths in
flame,
But only pray that when Your command
flies,
I shall bow with what obedience complies.

I've heard the oaths that fill the market
square,
The yells defeated by what is not fair,
The names raised in a raucous faith to share
With every comer in the pews that wait
Before the altars of the church and state.
Beloved, I make no clamour, though I
speak
Incessantly beside the word I seek.
I merely follow in paths of the meek,
And hope You do not notice all my cheek.

54 Say "Obey God, obey the sent,
But if you turn away as bent,
He's just responsible for what
Is placed on him, and you for glut
That's laid on you. If you obey
Him, you'll be led in the right way.
The messenger's task's just to preach
With clarity and each to reach.
55 God's promised to those among you
You do believe and work the true,
That He'll most certainly grant view
In the land an inheritance,
As He gave it to those in stance
Before them, that He'll set in power
Their way of faith in its own hour,
The one He chose for them. And He
Will change them after fear's degree
To state of peace, security.
They'll worship Me and join no such
With Me. If any do as much
To reject faith after this, they
Are rebels in a wicked way.
56 Establish daily prayer and give
Alms regularly and so live
Obey the sent one, so that you
May have mercy upon you due.
57 Don't think that unbeliever can
Prevent at last the earthly plan.
Their dwelling's fire, and it is true,
An awful place of refuge pew.

The Qur'an calls for the obedience
Of all to You, Beloved, also presents
Command to obey the sent one and
prophet.
This latter one's a thing some come to scoff
at.
Would it be not a burden less upon
The road we tread from morning until dawn

To obey You alone, and least such men
As claim to represent You in the pen?
Beloved, truth is that some will be
deceived,

And some will be unsure and unreprieved.
Of course obedience to You is easy
To wrangle and distort among the breezy,
And every brain imagines Your command
And Your permission for the thing at land.

58 O you believers, let those your
Right hand possesses in the store,
And those not come of age speak out
For leave on three occasions' rout:
Before the morning prayer, and when
You take your clothes off once again
In the noon heat, and after late
Night prayers, these are three times in state
When you're unclothed. Outside those
times

It's not wrong for you or their chimes
To mix and mingle for your rhymes.
So God makes clear signs for you too,
Since God knows all, has wisdom's clue.

59 But when the children among you
Become adults, let them ask too
For leave as other adults do.

So God makes clear His signs to you.
God's full of knowledge, wisdom too.

60 Old women who are past the time
Of marriage, there's no blame or crime
If they get undressed, if they don't
Make lewd display of beauty's fount.
But it's best for them too to be
Modest. And God is one to see
And perceive all things faithfully.

The principle of modesty required
By the Qur'an is somewhat softly wired.
The boundaries are not so very clear,
And there are choices, at least for those
near

The pinnacles of power, in how attired.
The fancy Muslim of this day and fear
Seems to do opposite of this for cheer.
The younger ladies on the street take off
The scarf while older ones, past time to
scoff,

Despite permission of God, Qur'an and
The messenger, decide to cover tanned.
Beloved, the human character at best

Is out to find excuses east and west.
Sit back and laugh at all the things You've
planned.

61 It's no fault in the blind nor in
One born lame, nor the ill of kin,
Nor in yourselves to eat at home,
Or in the house upon the loam
Of fathers, mothers, brothers too,
Or of your sisters, in the view
Of your dad's brothers, sisters too,
Or mother's brothers, sisters too,
Or in the houses of which you
Have the keys, or in the house too
Of a good friend of yours in lieu.
It does not matter if you eat
Together or alone in seat.
But if you go in houses, then
Greet each the other like good men,
A greeting blessed and purified
As from God. So God does provide
Clear signs for you, and so abide.
62 Only such are believers who
Believe in God and in His true
Messenger. Then they are with him
About a thing of common trim,
They don't go off till they've asked leave.
Those who ask your permission are
Those who believe in God and star
His Messenger. So when they ask
For your permission for reprieve,
Give leave to those you wish and ask
God for their forgiveness to bask,
For God's forgiving and He'll be
Most merciful *to company*.

The mercy and the ravage of Qur'an
Both lie in one thing often remarked on:
Where Bibles fail to tell us what to do,
The Qur'an is excruciating to.
The mercy is that all uncertainty
Of what would heal brazen society
Is gone and we are met with clarity.
The ravage is detail of orders' rue.
Beloved, I see how the debates go far
Towards establishing elite and star,
And that is why the simple last solution
Is covered by the latest of pollution.
Let mercy and frustration find their core,
Still humankind in fact needs nothing more.

63 Do not consider the call of
 The messenger among you shove
 Like the call of one of yourselves.
 God know those who hide like some elves
 Under excuses on their shelves.
 Let those take warning who oppose
 The commands the sent one arose,
 Lest some pain fall on them at last,
 Or other punishment to blast.

64 Be certain that to God belongs
 What's in the sky and earthly throngs.
 He well knows what you are about.
 One day they'll be brought back in rout
 To Him, and He'll tell them the true
 Of what they did, God surely knew
 All the things that the people do.

The rules for entering and coming out,
 For sitting down to eat, to loll about,
 Are here to say how men should come to
 show

Respect to Your sweet messenger below.
 Instead I fear they're taken on the go
 As courtesy toward the elite row,
 And give a model now how to succumb
 To giving more respect to moneyed bum.
 Beloved, let me lift hat in howdy do
 To You and to Your messengers in crew,
 But as for senators and cabinet men,
 And kings and presidents shown out again,
 I leave them and their houses and return
 To Your simplicity in what I earn.

Surah 25 Al-Furqan, or The Criterion

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 Blessèd is He Who has sent down
 Criterion to His servant,
 An admonition *without frown*
 To all creatures *that are extant*.

I bless You, my Beloved, that You sent
 down
 Criterion to Moses that each town
 And every creature might hear Your
 command
 And admonition, and all understand.
 So every prophet that stands both agreed
 And relevant to his own times and need
 Applies and magnifies the word once sent
 Until the day and year when You relent.
 The table of the law determines how

To know each prophet's worth and thus to
 bow
 To his obedience. Each one is true
 Who follows that Criterion and You.
 May I join with Muhammad and with
 Moses
 To serve You and what Your command
 discloses.

2 He to Whom belongs the dominion
 Of heavens and earth *and all opinion*:
 No son has He begotten, nor
 Has He a partner on His score:
 It is He Who created all,
 Ordering them by protocol.

The first command of that Criterion
 That You gave prophet Moses once upon
 The heights of Sinai, was quite simply this,
 That You are one and therefore none can
 miss

The truth that no son is heir to Your power,
 No partner sits with You for even one hour.
 Thus You are Sovereign over heaven and
 earth

By virtue of creatorship and worth.
 Creator, Sovereign, and Beloved, I come
 To lay hold on the revelation's sum,
 I shall have no god other but You only,
 And trust that on the throne You are not
 lonely.

All things upon the screen of universe
 Spell out Your unity in fleeting verse.

3 Yet have they taken, besides Him,
 Gods that can create nothing, dim,
 But are themselves created, that
 Have no control of *where they're at*
 For hurt or good to themselves, nor
 Can they control death, life *before*
 Nor *after* resurrection. 4 But
 The unbelievers say "And what
 Is this but naught, a lie which he
 Has forged, and others *willingly*
 Have helped him at it." But in truth
 It's they who have put forth *in ruth*
 Iniquity and a falsehood.
 5 And they say, "Ancients' tales he would
 Cause to be written, dictated
 Before him morning, *also read*
 At evening." 6 Say "It was sent down

By Him who knows *and with renown*
 The mystery in heavens and earth:
 He's oft-forgiving, without dearth
 Of Mercy, truly *it's His crown.*"

7 And they say "What sort of apostle
 Is this, who eats food, and *colossal*
 Walks through the streets? Why has not an
 Angel been sent (*instead of man*)
 To give admonition with him?"

8 "Or *why* has not a treasure brim
 Been bestowed on him, or why has
 He *not* a garden for enjoyment?"

The wicked say "The man's deployment
 You follow is just bewitchment."

9 See what comparisons are sent
 They made for you! They've gone astray,
 And never will they find their way!

Who fail to take the first command You
 gave
 To Moses on the mount, Your faithful
 slave,
 Require a messenger who has both wealth
 And nothing of the body to in stealth
 Spend wealth upon. He must have garden
 and
 An angel with a flaming sword in hand.
 Thus wickedness sets up its own hard terms
 To give excuse for feeding hungry worms
 Instead of joining in eternity.
 All hail that false, bewitching trinity:
 Health, wealth and miracle instead of bright
 Expression of the divine will forthright.
 Who fail to take the first command are lost
 In arguments of arguments at cost.

10 Happy's the One if by His will
 He could give you a better thrill
 Than those: garden beneath the which
 Flow streams, and He could bring your
 pitch
 To palaces *upon the hill.*

11 No, they deny the time, but We
 Prepared a flaming fire's degree
 For those who deny the time's spree.

12 When it catches sight from afar,
 They'll hear its roar and groan at bar.

13 And when they're thrown bound in that
 place,
 Together tightly packed in trace,
 They'll beg destruction on their face.

14 "Today don't beg destruction's stroke,
 But for a hammering *like oak!*"

15 Say "Is that better or the grace
 Of the eternal garden's race
 Promised to the righteous elect?
 For them that is reward select
 And a goal to achieve in place.

16 "For them there'll be all they wish there.
 They'll live there always in that share,
 A promise prayed for from the care
 Of your Lord." 17 The day He will bring
 Them all together from wandering,
 And those they worship besides God,
 He'll ask, "Was it you on the sod
 Led these slaves of mine once astray,
 Or did they themselves go away?"

18 They'll say "Glory to You! Not right
 Was it for us to take in sight
 Protectors other than Your plight.
 But You gave them and their ancestors
 Good things until they, *unlike questers*,
 Forgot the message: indeed they
 Were a folk lost and gone astray."

19 "Now they have shown you to lie in
 What you say: not avoiding sin,
 You cannot avoid penalty
 Or get help when you are needy."

The one among you who does wrong,
 We'll make him taste a painful song.

20 And the apostles whom We sent
 Before you were all men who spent
 To eat food and walk through the street:
 We've made some of you tests to treat
 For others: Will you have patience?
 For Allah's One who sees *with sense.*

The usefulness of men, Beloved, is slight,
 A waking, eating, walking toward the
 night.
 As even prophets eat and walk, they too
 Know what goes in comes out, ah, yes, they
 do.

The difference between You God and men:
 They defecate and defecate again.
 You only sit upon the throne without
 The need of more ablutions when in doubt.
 Such comfort is this word You have to
 show,
 Some men are made for just one thing
 below,

Not that they might attain the gates of
 grace,
But that they might teach patience in this
 place
By their vain words and violence in act.
I thank You for the lesson and the fact.

21 Those who do not fear to meet Us
Say "Why don't angels come to us,
Or why do we not see our Lord?"
Their self-esteem is arrogant,
Great is the insolence they grant
To their impious words in rant.
22 The day they see the angels, then
Is no joy for sinners of men.
They'll say "There is a barrier
Forbidden you altogether!"
23 We'll contemplate the deeds they did
And make such actions that they hid
Like dust upon the air that flies
In scattered wings to see it rise.
24 The garden folk that day will be
In their abiding place and see
Their resting places of beauty.
25 The day the sky will split with clouds
And angels sent down in their shrouds,
26 That day the stand of right and truth
Shall be for the One who's in ruth.
It will be a day of affliction
For unbelievers *in addiction*.
27 The day the evil-doer bites
His fingers as he so recites:
"Oh if I'd only gone the way
Of the sent one and not astray!
28 "Ah! Woe is me! I wish I had
Not taken for a friend the bad!
29 "He led me in the path away
For the message after the ray
Had come to me and hoped to stay.
The evil one's here to betray!"
30 The messenger will say "My Lord,
My folk considered the adored
Qur'an is simple nonsense stored."
31 So We've made every prophet find
A foe among the sinful kind,
But your Lord will suffice to guide
And ever be a help beside.

Beloved, I am no prophet in this place!
Since fair Muhammad none have felt that
 grace

And condemnation to the lonely place,
The fire before the population's face,
The panting in flight from the ruthless race.
Beloved, I am no prophet, so why do
I find a foe among the righteous crew
As well as with the sinful set in pew?
I ought to be the friend of every man,
Since I see in each one the divine span.
Suffice to guide me through the maze and
 craze
Of populace without a word of praise
For You or good or hope beyond the stays
Of work and worship cut out of their ways.

32 Those who leave off belief will say
"Why did the Qur'an come in sway
To him all in once piece." It's so
That We can strengthen your heart's flow,
We've recited it to you slow,
In stages step by step to go.
33 No issue do they raise but We
Bring you the truth in clarity.
34 Those who'll go to hell on their faces,
Will be in evil straits and places,
In a way astray in their traces.
35 We sent Moses the book and gave
His brother Aaron to serve slave,
36 And We gave order, "Both go to
The folk rejecting Our signs true"
And those We destroyed from the view.

Musahiplik is what You once created
With Moses and his bother unabated.
But that was ancient and destroyed by one
Named Cain who murdered brother under
 sun
And hid the body by the scratches made
By raven in the soil, though one unpaid.
Think of the two by two sent by Your gun
Out to both Jews and to Samaritan.
Musahiplik is nothing new nor far
From the experience of hopeful star
Or from the least to cultivate the land.
The two united on the earth to stand
Remain beyond the failure and the flight
Of those lone dervishes caught in Your
 sight.

37 And Noah's folk, when they left off
The sent ones, We drowned those who
 scoff

And We made them a sign to be
 For humankind. So prepared We
 Wrong-doers a harsh penalty.
 38 As 'Ad too and Thamud and those
 Fellows of the Rass and in rows
 A generation between them.
 39 To each We set parables' gem
 And such examples. And each one
 We crushed in their destruction's tonne.
 40 They must indeed have passed the town
 On which was poured out with a frown
 A rain of destruction's array.
 Did they not see it gone astray?
 They don't fear resurrection day.
 41 When they see you, they turn and twist
 In mocking shouted and they hissed,
 "Is this the one that God has sent
 As messenger in hopeless bent?"
 42 "He nearly took us from our gods,
 If we'd not been such faithful sods."
 Soon they'll know when they see the pain,
 Who is the one that's led in vain.
 43 Do you see such as take for god
 His predilections in self's pod?
 Could you dispose affairs for him?

As I am met by crowds who would compel
 Me by their arguments of buy and sell
 To conform to their gods and goddesses,
 I find myself in quandary and biz.
 Each one has taken the god of his choice,
 The predilections of his own tongue's
 voice,

And laid it out upon the bier to see,
 A golden thing under a canopy.
 Beloved, let me have the true God though
 He

May not conform to what I'd like to see,
 Abrasive to my loved philosophy,
 And from my expectations fully free.
 That God I shall not choose. Let Him
 choose me
 If You desire so in Your sovereignty.

44 Or do you think they hear or know?
 They are just like the cattle trim.
 No, they are further off the row.
 45 Have you not turned sight to your Lord?
 How He makes long the shadow's sword!
 If He willed He could make it stop.
 So We make the sun guide the fop.

46 Then We bring it towards Ourselves,
 Shortened by easy stages' shelves.
 47 It's He who makes the night a shroud
 For you, and sleep rest under cloud,
 And makes the day to get up loud.
 48 It's He who sends the winds to bring
 Good news before His mercies sing,
 And We send down rain from the sky,
 49 That by it We may vivify
 The dry land and quench thirst of things
 That We've created in its rings,
 Cattle and men in numbered springs.
 50 And We've distributed for them
 To make them celebrate in hem
 Their praises, but most men are turned
 Away from gratitude they've spurned.

You send the rain no doubt from sky upon
 The deserts of Arabia outdrawn,
 But only in the sparsity they know
 To be the blessing of Your vertigo.
 You send the rain upon this land of mine
 Beneath the tundra as though by design
 Only in summer's light. In winter though
 You send upon the land the freezing snow.
 If I had been creator of earth's dust,
 I should have sent each field upon the crust
 A daily shower to water plant and seed
 And nourish the things human beings need.
 See how great is Your power! You can
 create
 A mind with better plans than You instate.

51 If it had been Our will We might
 Have sent a warner of the right
 To every populated site.
 52 So don't hark to the faithless folk,
 But struggle hard against their stroke
 With the *Word heard once that God spoke*.
 53 It's He set free two bodies great
 Of flowing waters in their state:
 One of them drinkable and sweet,
 The other salty and no treat,
 Yet He's set barrier between
 Them in partition as unseen
 Prohibiting the passage lean.
 54 It's He who has created man
 From water, then He set up clan
 And marriage, for your Lord has span.
 55 Still do they worship besides God
 Things without profit on the sod

Nor power to harm them. And those who
 Do not believe is helper too
 Against his own Lord in his pew.
 56 But you alone We sent to give
 Good news and warnings how to live.
 57 Say "No reward I ask of you
 For it but this: that each one who
 Desires may take a straight path to
 His Lord *in all things he will do.*"
 58 And put your trust in Him who lives
 And does not die, and as it gives
 Exalt His praise, for He well knows
 The wayward way His servants chose.
 59 He who created sky and earth
 And all between of any worth
 In six days, and is firmly set
 On the throne, God most gracious yet.
 Ask about Him of any bet.

After the six days of creation met
 In Bible and in Torah for the pet,
 I see that You came to rest on the day
 That was blessed for delight after the pay.
 But in Qur'an the day's become a throne
 Upon which You have settled without
 groan
 Of weariness. Did You instead delight
 To see that You had made everything right?
 Beloved, the Sabbath and the throne are
 one,
 And show that You after good things are
 done,
 Stop to evaluate and judge each sun
 And daughter of humankind on the run.
 Judge me for right and paradise and rest
 Upon the day that You created best.

60 When it is said to them, "Prostrate
 To the most gracious in His state,"
 They say "And what is most gracious?
 Shall we bow as you order us?"
 It just adds to their flight from Us.
 Blessed He who made stars in the skies,
 And placed a lamp there and the guise
 Of a moon giving of her light.
 62 And it is He who made the night
 And day to follow each in might,
 For such who have the will to praise
 Him and show gratitude *for days*.
 63 The slaves of the most gracious are
 Those who walk on the earth afar

In their humility, and when
 The ignorant approach the men
 They say "Peace!" and then "Peace!" again.
 64 Those who spend the night to adore
 Their Lord prostrating on the floor
 And standing; 65 those who say
 "Lord, turn from us the wrath and stay
 Hell's wrath, it is a grievous way,
 66 "Evil indeed is its abode,
 And as a resting place in mode;"
 67 Those who in giving do not show
 Extravagance or stingy row,
 But keep to equity between;
 68 Those who do not address with God
 Any other claimant on sod,
 Nor take life God's made sacred but
 For a just defence, nor lend butt
 To fornication—and who
 Does this will be punished as due.

Beloved, I have not yet achieve the glory
 That You in the Qur'an give out as story
 Of who is righteous and who is one gory.
 I stand among the wicked wig and tory.
 The righteous man and good is one who
 sees

Approaching of the ignorant in glees
 And does not wait to revile him at all,
 But greets him with peace and with peace
 not small.

Beloved, there is no ignorant or low
 Compared to me that merits less the show
 Than what You make of me when I return.
 You greet my ignorance with peace and
 spurn

No bumbling words or silences with stern
 Reproaches. Let Your grace make me to
 learn.

69 The penalty on Judgement Day
 Will be doubled to him to stay
 There in his own shame-driven way,
 70 Unless he does repent, believe
 And do righteous acts in reprieve,
 For God will not change such men's wrong
 Into good, God's forgiving long,
 Most merciful *in deed and song*.
 71 The one who repents and does well
 Has turned to God not to rebel,
 72 Those who witness no falsehood's stand,
 And passing by futility,

They turn from it and honourably;
 73 Those who when given into hand
 The warning signs of their Lord's way,
 Do not become weak at the stay
 As though deaf or in blindness' sway;
 74 And those who pray "Lord, grant us
 wives
 And offspring to comfort our eyes,
 And let us lead the righteous' lives."
 75 Those are the ones who'll get the prize
 Of highest place up in the skies,
 Because of patient constancy.
 There they will find greetings to be
 With peace, 76 and dwelling there to see
 How beautiful is the abode,
 And place of rest after the load.
 77 Say "My Lord is not worried that
 You do not call on Him from mat.
 But you've surely rejected Him,
 Inexorably that will turn grim."

Though I sit silent in my place and do
 Not call upon Your names before the crew
 Of human faces that rejected You,
 That does not mean my heart has not stayed
 true.
 You are not hurt or bothered by the fact
 That the lost and the damned have failed to
 act,
 But only remark on the higher pact
 Of sovereignty that has remained intact.
 Beloved, I do not pray for the chips ground
 Into the mud around the statue found
 Made by Your hand and word and Your
 decree
 Into Your image of eternity.
 But rather look on what You make
 delighted
 And leave the dross behind and
 unaffrighted.

Surah 26 Ash-Shuara, or the Poets

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 Ta, Sin, Mim. 2 These are the book's
 verses
 That make things clear (*instead of curses*).
 3 Maybe you fret your soul with grief,
 That they do not enter belief.
 4 If We willed, We could send them down
 From the sky a sign on the town
 To make them bend their necks instead

In humble submission as led.
 5 But no new message comes to them
 From the Most Gracious *to condemn*,
 But they turn from it *head to hem*.
 6 They have rejected it indeed.
 So they will soon know and with speed
 The truth of what they mocked *in greed*.
 7 Don't they look at the earth, how great
 And fine are all the things in state
 That We've produced when We create?
 8 Indeed in this there is a sign.
 But most of them doubt the design.
 9 Indeed your Lord is He, the high
 In might and most in mercy's ply.

St. Paul also points to the grand creation
 As proof of Your divinity in station.
 That's what You give to humankind to see
 Instead of forcing men and outrightly
 To submit to You in humility.
 The vision of Your glory here is veiled,
 And so the human face that would have
 paled
 Is rigid in its stubbornness regaled.
 Beloved, what I believe or not of You
 Is so irrelevant a thing in brew,
 I laugh. Creation is no rhyme or reason
 For my belief in You in time and season.
 Rather incredible is Your belief,
 Beloved, in me, crouched in my human
 grief.

10 See, your Lord called Moses, "Go to
 Folk of an iniquitous crew,
 11 "The people of the Pharaoh too,
 Will they not fear God at the cue?"
 12 He said "Lord, I fear they will claim
 It is with falsehood that I came.
 13 My breast will be tight, and my speech
 Will stutter, so let Aaron preach.
 14 "Besides, they have a charge of crime
 Against me, I fear any time
 They might come kill me *on a dime*."
 15 God said "Not at all, go on then,
 The both of you, with Our signs then,
 We are with you and We will hear.
 16 "So go and both of you appear
 To Pharaoh and say 'We have been
 Sent by the Lord of all worlds seen,
 17 "So send Israel's sons out with us."
 18 He said "Were we not so gracious

To nourish you a child with us,
And did you not stay many years
Among us and too without fears?
19 "And you committed such a deed,
And were ungrateful in your greed."

20 Said Moses, "I did so that time
When I was in error and crime.
21 "That's why I ran away from you
When I became afraid of you,
But my Lord has since given me
Judgement and then appointed me
As one of His sent ones to me.
22 "And this is the favour's reward
By which you chide me as with sword,
Enslaving Israel's sons in ward."

The killing of the wicked brute who lay
The whip against the Israelite in play
Is now thrown up to Moses in a way
To make him look a murderer and more,
An ingrate after all Pharaoh's good store.
Now Moses takes the blame and sweetly
speaks

To make the king look up at dawning
weeks.

He sets aside his own defence to take
Your work at hand. Beloved, when I at
stake

Distract myself from truth to my defence,
Bring this to mind, how Moses here relents
In meekness. Let me also turn aside
From my defence in ownership of pride.
Let evil deeds remain evil in tents.

23 Said Pharaoh "And what is the Lord
Of all the universe restored?"

24 He said "The Lord of heavens and earth
And all between, for what you're worth."

25 He said to those who stood around,
"Do you not listen to the sound?"

26 He said "Your Lord and the Lord of
Your ancestors from start to shove."

27 He said "Indeed your messenger
Sent to you is a madman sure."

28 He said "Lord of the east and west
And all between, would you invest
In common sense, it would be best."

The Pharaoh did to in vest appear
Before the judgement bar of reason's leer,
And so ran his own country with a tear

Into the ground. But that's yet to be seen.
Now he still sits upon the throne to preen,
And all the courtiers look after him,
And smile and nod and agree with the trim
And cute responses that he comes to make
When Moses mentions Your name at the
stake.

Beloved, I see and hear such answers still
In every arrogant mouth on the hill
Of life today. All men of ready wit
Are bound to look on others with a fit
Of heady answers uttered with a will.

29 He said "If you present a god
Other than me upon the sod,
I throw you in prison *by prod.*"

30 He said "Even if I showed you
A thing clear, convincing and true?"

31 He said "Then show it if you are
As truthful *as you claim in star.*"

32 So he threw down his rod and see,
It was a serpent plain to be.

33 And he pulled out his hand and see,
It was as white as it could be.

34 He said to the chiefs around him,
"This is a good sorcerer grim.

35 "His plan's to take your land away
By sorcery, so now what say?"

36 They said "Let him wait and expect
Along with his own brother kept,

And send to the cities by ept
Messengers to gather from there

37 "And bring up all sorcerers' share."

What is the plan when men are faced with
signs

Of excellence among Your own divines?
Instead of turning in faith to the true,
They look for sorcerers to grace their pew.
The human mind is fickle when the right
Is brought before the human eye in sight,
And reason that should bring the mind to
light

Is turned to preservation of the fight.

Beloved, I've been faced with more signs in
view

Of what You have for humankind of true,
And found the booth at the fair for their
trade

Is empty, while the evil in parade
Is at the head of every longer queue,

And reason's wasted on men and waylaid.

38 So sorcerers together came
For the appointed day of fame,
39 And so the people too were told,
"Are you assembled now and bold?
40 "So we may follow in the lead
Of sorcerers that win and heed?"
41 So when the sorcerers arrived,
They said to Pharaoh as contrived,
"Of course we'll be paid if we win?"
42 He said "Abundantly *as sin*,
For in that case you'll be raised up
Nearest to the throne like a tup."

I too like priestcraft and hope to be paid
At least for the books I write still unflayed.
Who knows what will result when people
see

How I've engaged in common blasphemy.
There is no court to take me up as when
Ed Elwall rose before the preacher's wen
And proclaimed there's no god but You and
then

They took him to assizes to prove his case.
He was acquitted by the judges' mace.
Three hundred years the later and I stand
As much in heretic's eccentric band.
The wisdom of truth never makes headway
Beyond the ripples of the crowd at play.
Let nothing by Your grace go out
unplanned.

43 Moses told them, "Throw down your
thing."

44 So they throw down their ropes and
sling

Their rods, and say "By Pharaoh's might,
We certainly shall win the fight."

45 Then Moses threw his rod, when see,
It swallows up immediately
All the false illusions they free.

46 Then the sorcerers all fell down
Adoring prostrate on the crown,

47 Saying "We believe in the Lord
Of the worlds, 48 the Lord who's unfurled
Moses and Aaron." 49 He said "Do

You believe in Him before cue
I give you in leave? Indeed he
Is just your chief in sorcery.
But soon you'll know. Be sure I'll cut

Off your hands and your feet to butt
On opposite sides and I'll make
You all die on the cross for stake."
50 They said "It doesn't matter now
To us, we'll go back anyhow
To our Lord. 51 "We just still desire
That our Lord will forgive the dire
Faults we have done, so we may be
First among the believers free."

The king cares not what sorcerer and folk
Believe in or hold gods under their yoke,
As long as they so do obeying him.
The truth itself has nothing of the grim.
The king regards his right above all things.
And people still today, and without kings,
Love to submit to the authority
Of leader rather than live honestly.
They may groan and remark on the duress,
But backed against the wall, they do not
guess.

The leader wins the day with heavy hand,
Whether or not he speaks in the command
Of truth. Beloved, deign not at all to bless,
Deign not to bless the banned or the
unbanned.

52 We inspired Moses as We spoke,
"Go by night with My servants broke,
You'll be followed by every bloke."

53 The Pharaoh sent out messengers
To the cities as it occurs,

54 "These are just a small band of fers,
55 "And they rage against us aloud.

56 "But we are a well-informed crowd."

57 So We sent them out from the ways
Of gardens, springs, 58 and treasures' stays,
And every kind of honoured place,
59 So it was We made Israel's race
The heirs of such things done in grace.

60 So they pursued them at sunrise.

61 When the two groups each saw the
other,

The people of Moses like brother
Said "We'll surely be taken and smother."

62 He said "Not at all, my Lord's here
With me, and soon it will appear
How He will guide me, *never fear*."

63 Then We inspired Moses to say
"Strike the sea with your rod in play."
So it divided and each part

Became like a big mountain's art.
 64 We made the one group come up near.
 65 We saved Moses and all with him.
 66 But we drowned all the others grim.
 67 In that is a sign, but the most
 Of them do not believe *the boast*.
 68 Truly your Lord is He, the high
 In might, most merciful *when nigh*.

The parting of the sea is well explained
 By winds and tides and after it had rained.
 Perhaps the parting was miraculous
 In happening at the time of the fuss.
 It does not matter to my mind, because
 All things are miracles within your laws,
 And all existence is a sign of You.
 I merely sit here in my humble pew.
 Beloved, part the sea that roils in my soul
 As I flee from the fast Egyptian shoal
 And look toward the desert and the sky.
 Perhaps a promised land lies here nearby.
 But if not, forty years of desert life
 I take upon my soul and rise to strife.

69 Recite to them Abraham's tale.
 70 See, he said to his father and
 His folk, "What's worship by command?"
 71 They said "We worship idols and
 We keep them always at our hand."
 72 He said "Do they hear when you call?
 73 "Or do you good or yet appal?"
 74 They said "No, but we found ancestors
 Of ours doing so *with their nesters*."
 75 He said "Do you see whom you've been
 Bowing to in worshipping's scene?
 76 "You and your ancestors to ween?
 77 "For they are my foes, but not so
 The Lord of universe to go;
 78 "Who has created me, and it
 Is He who guides me *in paths fit*,
 79 "Who gives me food and drink to sit,
 80 "And when I'm ill, He heals all whit,
 81 "Who'll bring me to death, then to life,
 82 "And who, I hope after the strife,
 Forgives my faults on judgement day.

Atonement comes in judgement in the sky,
 Not on the earthen burthen wondering why.
 Fair Abraham looks forward to the met
 And intercession beyond offerings set.

That's why he intercedes here both with
 men
 And later with You Yourself once again.
 His interceding is a prophecy
 Of the salvation that You offer free.
 Beloved, I turn to food and drink and sit
 To find Your providence in benefit,
 And healing and my dying and the day
 Of resurrection coming in hope's ray.
 And so I ask forgiveness in Your way
 And in Your time. My heart is made of
 clay.

83 "O Lord, pour out on me the ray
 Of wisdom and count me among
 The righteous ones in the straight way,
 84 "So that my name in honour sung
 May be in truth on every tongue,
 85 "Make me heir of the happy state,
 86 "Forgive my father for the rate
 He is astray with those of late,
 87 "And let me not be in disgrace
 The day of resurrection's trace,
 88 The day when neither wealth nor sons
 Will have the power to sway the tonnes,
 89 "But only he who brings to God
 A heart sincere upon the sod,
 90 "To the righteous the garden will
 Be brought near *and desire fulfil*,
 91 "And to those in the wicked way
 The fire will be set in display,
 92 "And it shall be said to them then,
 'Where are the ones you worshipped then
 93 "Besides God? Can they help you men
 Or help themselves *out of their den*?'
 94 "Then they will be thrown I the fire,
 They and the straying, wicked crier,
 95 "And the whole army of Iblis.
 96 "They'll wrangle there for their release:
 97 "By God, we made a clear mistake,
 98 "When we held you of equal stake
 With the Lord of the worlds *in wake*.
 99 "And our seducers were of those
 Caught in their guilt and in their throes.
 100 "Now we have none to warm our toes,
 101 "Nor any friend to feel our woes.
 102 "Now if we only could return,
 We'd have true faith instead of burn!"
 103 Indeed in this there is a sign,
 But most do not believe a line.
 104 Truly your Lord is He, the high

In might and merciful come nigh.

I turn and return in that burning hell
Of fires of love for You that would impel
Me on the brazen earth beneath the sky
To whirl about before the day I die.
If I in some far-off eternity
Escape Your love and come back here to
see

The footprints I have made on dergah floor,
Then open up to me faith's golden door.
Until then let me be a doubting Thomas,
Awakened or asleep within Your promise,
To burn a rising spark into that night
That lies unchanging darkness in Your
sight,
To rise a moment hot and glowing till
The vastnesses of space and love fulfil.

105 The folk of Noah did reject
The messengers *sent and select*.
106 See how their brother Noah told
Them, "Will you not fear *Allah bold*?
107 "I am to you a messenger
Worth trusting in all that occur.
108 "So fear God and obey me too.
109 "No payment do I ask of you
For it, my reward's only from
The Lord of the worlds *as He's come*.
110 "So fear God and obey me too."
111 They said "Shall we believe in you
When only the low classes do?"
112 He said "And what do I know of
The things they do *and what you love*?
113 "Their account is just with my Lord,
If you could only grasp the scored.
114 "I'm not one to chase of the folk
Who do believe me in a stroke.
115 "I'm only sent with warning clear
And proclaimed in the public sphere."
116 They said "If you don't stop it now,
O Noah, we'll stone you anyhow."
117 He said "O Lord, indeed my folk
Have turned away from me *in stroke*.
118 "So judge between me and them clear,
And save me and those with faith here
Who are with me *and I hold dear*."
119 So We delivered him and those
With him in ark filled as We chose.
120 So We drowned those who stayed
behind.

121 That surely is a sign in kind,
But mostly they've no faith resigned.
122 Your Lord indeed is He, the high
In might and merciful come nigh.

The lower classes are the ones naïve
Who follow prophets come to preach in
sleeve.

The wise and the elite look with disdain
On messengers left in the cold and rain.
The Christian message was too small and
vain

For higher classes in simplicity.
They only took it after the faith spree
Of the Nicaean council's Trinity
Brought in Hellenistic philosophy
To mate with pagan atheism's tree.
Beloved, You are the One, alone for me,
Creator of the universe and still
The God upon Your throne on Zion's hill,
The God alone throughout eternity.

123 The 'Ad turn from the messengers.

124 See there brother Hud as occurs
Said to them, "Will you not fear God?"

125 "I am to you upon the sod
A messenger worthy of trust.

126 "So fear God and obey or burst.

127 "No payment do I ask of you
For it, my reward's only due
From the Lord of the worlds in view.

128 "Do you build a monument on
Every hilltop to play upon?

129 "And do you get yourselves to own
Great buildings to live there alone?

130 "And when you put your strong hand
out,

Do you pretend your full redoubt?

131 "So fear God and obey *with shout*.

132 "Yes, fear Him who has freely set
On you all that you know or bet.

133 "He's given you cattle and sons,

134 "And gardens and springs in their runs.

135 "Indeed I fear for you the pain
Of a great day *to come and reign*."

136 They said "It matters not to us
Whether you chide or not with fuss.

137 "This is nothing but the device
Of the old folk come to suffice,

138 "And we're not ones to meet with pain
And penalties spoken in vain."

139 So they turned from him and We came
To destroy them. This is sign's claim,
But most do not believe the aim.
140 And indeed your Lord is the one
Who's high in might and mercy done.

In fact, I ask for pay, and yet I'm not
A prophet or a messenger in plot.
I want the folk to buy my books a lot.
But in the end, I too look just to You,
Beloved, for payment for the things I do.
I've written near a decade as I read
The Hebrew, Greek and Arabic with speed,
And answer You Your words in simple
creed.

I leave my cogitations to Your ear
Rejoicing in the silence that I hear.
At least You do not yet come in with fear
To frighten me away, to shed a tear.
My blasphemy remains in what we share:
You are my God alone that I make bare.

141 Then Thamud turned from messengers.
142 See their brother Salih in furs
Said to them "Will you not fear God?
143 "I am sent to you on the sod
Worthy of all trust at the prod.
144 "So fear God and obey my rod.
145 "No payment do I ask of you
For it. My reward is just due
From the Lord of the worlds in view.
146 "Will you be left safe with your stuff,
147 "Gardens and springs not to live rough,
148 "And fields of grain and date-palms
bowed

To breaking with their fruit allowed?
149 "And you care houses from the hills
With the skill that with wonder fills.
150 "But fear God and obey my drills.
151 "Don't do what they tell you who sit
In their extravagance in fit,
152 "Who make their mischief in the land,
And do not mend their actions planned."
153 They said "You are bewitched to stand.
154 "You're just a mortal man like us.
Bring us a sign if truth's your fuss."
155 He said "Here is a camel dame,
She has the right to water's claim
And you have right to water here
Each in the day it will occur.
156 "Don't harm her, lest the penalty

Of a great day grasp you in fee."
157 But they ham-strung her till they came
Full of regrets *and full of shame*.
158 But punishment came on them still.
Indeed this is a sign to fill.
But most of them ignore the bill.
159 Indeed your Lord is He, the high
In might, most merciful come nigh.

I shudder when I think of beast hamstrung.
The cruelty of humankind is sung
In every moment of the life I've rung.
I hear the groan and squeal from beastial
lung.
Beloved, the height of infidelity
Is what men do to animals freely,
Pretending that You gave dominion when
You set their borders on earth once again.
Dominion that You gave was men might
eat
The fruit and nut and grain for something
sweet.

Beloved, I sing and pray and preach before
A congregation of animal store:
The birds and mice that run the forest floor,
The small ones You created at my door.

160 Lot's people rejected the sent.
161 See how their brother Lot once went
To them to say "Will you not fear?
62 "I am your messenger it's clear
I'm worthy of all trust to steer.
163 "So fear God and obey me dear.
164 "No payment do I ask of you
For it, my pay is only due
From the Lord of the worlds in view.
165 "Of all the creatures in the world,
Will you go into males unfurled,
166 "And leave the ones God's made for
you

To be your mates? No, you're a crew
Transgressing all limits in view."
167 They said "If you don't stop now, Lot,
You will surely get thrown from plot."
168 He said "I deploy what you do.
169 Lord, save me and my family crew
From all such things that they would do."
170 So We saved him and family,
171 Except a hag who stayed to see.
172 The rest We destroyed utterly.
173 We rained destruction down on them,

And evil was that shower's hem
On those warned without heeding them.
174 That surely is a sign in kind,
But mostly they've no faith resigned.
175 Your Lord indeed is He, the high
In might and merciful come nigh.

The folk of Lot were worse than most, I
see,
And yet the Saviour mild in his pity
Noted the cities of fair Galilee
Were worse than even Gomorrah in spree.
No doubt the villages that stretch abroad
Through Europe and on American sod
Have cruelty and lust enough to make
A dent on Sodomy for goodness' sake.
Beloved, I hear Lot's word raised up in call
And often turn back to my own faith's
thrall,
And in my lusty cruelty just laugh
At his prophetic message given in gaff.
Such is the human heart. I turn to You
And find a better way and life in view.

176 Companions of the wood rejected
The messengers *so well selected*.
177 See how Shu'aib had said to them,
"Will you not fear God and His hem?"
178 "I am your messenger and true
Worthy of every trust from you.
179 "So fear God and obey my view.
180 "No payment do I ask of you
For it, my pay is only due
From the Lord of the worlds on cue.
181 "Give a just measure, bring no loss.
182 "And weigh with true scales and not
toss.
183 "Do not hold back from men what' due,
Nor work wickedness in the land,
Making mischief *where you stand*.
184 "And fear Him who created you
And generations beyond view."
185 They said "You're one of those
bewitched.
186 "You nothing but a mortal pitched
Like us, we think you lie unhitched.
187 "Now bring down the sky on us if
You are a truthful one and stiff."
188 He said "My Lord knows best of all
What you are doing to appal."

189 But they turned from him. Then the
pain
Of punishment of a day's lain
In gloomy shadow seizing them,
That was a great day's pain in hem.
190 That surely is a sign in kind,
But mostly they've no faith resigned.
191 Your Lord indeed is He, the high
In might and merciful come nigh.

In times past You warned those who stayed
and stole
A gramme or two of flour to beat the coal,
And then when they continued in deceit,
You smacked them down in destruction
complete.
Just take a look now at the way we deal:
The box is oversized for settling's weal,
And if the weight is right in tiny letters,
The buyer's sight is caught by box's fetters.
My petty plaint distracts from what is done
By presidents and bankers when they've
won.
Their bail-outs rob taxpayers of their
billions
And You complain still of the bright
pavilions
Where merchants in the market of Shu'aib
Shave off a hair from scales to make a
bribe.

192 Indeed this is a revelation
From the Lord of the worlds in ration.
193 With it descended spirit and truth,
194 To your heart and mind, that from
youth
You might be warned *in faith or trick*,
195 In clear language, the Arabic.
196 Without doubt it was prophesied
In former people's books beside.
197 Is it not a sign to the wise
Of Israel's folk who knew its guise?
198 If We had revealed it among
Any of the non-Arabs' tongue,
199 And if he'd recited to them,
They'd not have believed in its gem.
200 So We have made it to go in
The hearts of those despoiled in sin.
201 They'll not believe in it until
They see harsh punishment fulfil,
202 Then it will come down suddenly

On them, and they will never see,
 203 Then they will say "Shall we receive
 From this a mere moment's reprieve?"
 204 Do they ask for Our penalty
 To come upon them and quickly?
 205 Do you see? If We let them take
 Joy for a few years' respite's sake,
 206 Still on them at last it will come
 As they were promised it in sum.
 207 Their enjoyment will profit none.

The people still complain of speech and
 tongue,
 And language is the more important rung
 Than what is said and what is warned from
 lung.
 It's how it's said and not what's spread that's
 hung.
 Beloved, see how I say a thing for right,
 So quaintly and so sweetly for a mite,
 Not in the Arabic, but in the queen's
 Own English (or not, as the royal means).
 I rhyme and rate and pose and prate until
 The pages come and go and pages fill.
 But after all my speech and Your's, my
 Dear,
 The saying is as one, and though it's clear,
 None take the silver words as they appear
 Except the fond elect You chose to fear.

208 We never destroyed a folk won
 Without first warning them a tonne,
 209 And so reminding them, and We
 Never destroy them unjustly.
 210 No wicked ones brought down to see
 This message given faithfully.
 211 It would not suit their vain desires,
 Nor could they utter it for hyres.
 212 They've been set far from hearing it.
 213 So do not call on any fit
 Of other gods with God to sit,
 Or you will be among those who
 Are under the penalty's rue.
 214 And warn the nearest of your kin,
 215 And droop your wing to those within
 Who do believe and follow you.
 216 If they do not obey you, say
 "I am free of what you display."
 217 And put your trust in Him who's high
 In might and merciful come nigh,
 218 Who sees you standing *day by day*,

219 How you prostrate yourself and sway
 With those who also come to pray,
 220 For He hears and knows all things'
 way.
 221 Shall I let you know on whom comes
 Down evil ones in spirit hums?
 222 They descend on each lying one,
 And wicked person when he's done,
 223 They pour in rumours' vanities,
 And most of them lie as to please.
 224 As for the poets, those who stray
 In evil follow in their way.
 225 Don't you see how they wander by
 Bewildered in each valley's lie?
 226 And they say but do not comply?
 227 Except those who believe, and do
 Righteousness, remember God too,
 And they defend themselves at last
 Only before injustice' blast.
 Soon will unjust attackers know
 What strange ways their affairs will go.

I am a poet too, at least a rhymester,
 Producer of the doggerel for timester,
 And so I look for myself in the one
 Who wanders and bewildered under sun,
 To say and not comply with what is done.
 Beloved, though I may not be wise and
 true,
 A doubter and a doubtful one in view,
 I do practice what little that I preach.
 I keep hypocrisy out of my reach
 By making claims too small for pear or
 peach.
 That's why I am alone, not one to teach.
 But You remember every speck and spare,
 You bless the humble and the lonely share,
 And multiply the waiting of it there.

Poetics deals in innovative fashions
 In every era of expected rations.
 The epic glorifying of elite
 Praises the lust to war and love for treat.
 The pastoral of lower classes' way
 Praises the keeping of the wolf at bay.
 Robert the chilly had his own to say
 On figure of a poem from delight
 To wisdom. I reject that out of spite.
 I have my own poet's philosophy:
 A poem neither starts not ends decree,
 But shines on ordinary things to show

What others pass by in a magic glow
And so brings sight of heaven here below.

Surah 27 Al-Naml, or the Ants

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
Ta. Sin.

1 These are verses of the Qur'an,
A book that makes things clear anon,
2 A guide, and gospel for those who
Believe *and follow heavenly view*.
3 Those who set up the daily prayers
And regularly give their wares
In alms, and also have the trust
In the world coming after dust.
4 As for the ones who don't believe
In coming pain, coming reprieve,
We've made their actions in their eyes
Seem wonderful, not to despise,
So they wander in their lost guise.
5 Such are the ones for whom is pain,
And in the future's loss, not gain.
6 As for you, the Qur'an's sent down
On you from the One of renown
And wise and knowing all the town.

Beloved, I love the verses that You sent
Upon Your messenger, and how he went
About reciting what You had to say.
It was indeed a true, auspicious day
When You vouchsafed to him Your gloried
Word.

Today at last my heart too has been stirred.
It is a double glory that I find
Faith in the noble Qur'an, though I'm blind,
And might have been left in the cold for
kind

Who think that human actions in this world
Are far more glorious than what You've
hurled

Upon the altar of earth where I've whirled.
Beloved, You sent the book on one man
then,

And left its explanation to the ten
Or more to follow. Teach me how and
when.

7 See, Moses said to his family:
"I see a fire, I'll go and see
And bring back news or burning free
A brand to light our fuel so we
May warm ourselves in some degree.

8 But when he came near, a voice rose,
"Blessed are those in the fire and those
Around about *in rows and rows*.
And glory to God who is Lord
Of *all* the worlds, *the great adored*.
9 "O Moses, truly I am God,
Exalted in power, wise on sod.

You say that You are Allah here, but when
You gave this word to Moses once again,
You told him that Your name then was in
brief

I am that I am, which has caused some
grief.

Each one who rises up today is sure
That the name that he hails alone is pure.
And if the Scriptures give a certain sound
To one, another must be cast on ground.
Beloved, if that were so, it would be rough,
But it is simply not found here enough.
Instead inventions multiply to be
Alphabetized for everyone to see.
I turn in horror, my Beloved, and flee
To You and to Your throne's eternity.

10 "Now will you just throw down your
rod!"

But when he saw it moving round
As if it were a snake on ground,
He turned and ran. "Moses, fear not,
For truly in My presence sought,
Those called as messengers fear not.

11 "But if any of them do wrong,
Replacing good with evil song,
Indeed, I'm oft-forgiving long,
Most merciful *to weak and strong*.

12 "Now put your hand up in your chest,
And it will come out white at best,
Among the nine signs at a stroke
To Pharaoh and to his folk,
For they're a people who rebel
In their way never to do well."

13 But when Our signs came in their view,
So they'd have opened their eyes to,
They said "This is magic in brew."

14 And they rejected those signs in
Iniquity and prideful sin,
Though their souls were convince to win:
So see what was the end of those
Who acted wickedly in rose.

The book of Revelation comes to speak
 Of the ten last plagues fallen in a week.
 The Qur'an makes out nine signs in the way
 That Moses spoke to Pharaoh in a day,
 And not ten as the quizlings want to say.
 I count and count again: water to blood,
 The frogs, the lice, the flies above the mud,
 The sores on cattle, and on people too,
 The hail, the locusts, and the darkened
 view.

I cannot count but nine, and yet I find
 The battle of the book goes on well wined
 In accusations flying for the count
 Of nine or ten as the correct amount.
 Beloved, save me from all the well-defined.

15 We gave knowledge to David and
 To Solomon. They both command:
 "Praise be to God, who's favoured us
 Above many slaves of His bus
 Who do believe incredulous."
 16 And Solomon was David's heir.
 He said "O people, we have share
 Taught in the speech of birds and on
 Us has been granted all things drawn,
 This is truly grace *and not brawn*."
 17 Before Solomon came his hosts,
 Of jinns and men and birds from coasts,
 And they stood in ordered ranks' boasts.
 18 At last, when they came in a vale
 Of ants, one of the ants was hale
 To say "O ants, flee for your lives,
 Lest Solomon's army contrives
 To crush you unaware of hives."
 19 And he smiled at the thing she said,
 And uttered: "O Lord, let me led
 Be grateful for the benefits
 That You've poured on me and the writs
 On my parents so I may do
 What's righteous, the things pleasing You,
 And bring me by Your grace in pew
 Of You righteous servants in view."

The Bible also shows that beasts can talk
 When it reminds us how no donkeys balk
 Without a reason. The sweet Qur'an shows
 How ants too were kept alert on their toes
 And spoke to one another in their rows
 Against the armies brought as though in
 foes
 By Solomon. Remember, Dear, You made

The animals all talking in parade.
 Beloved, I know the beasts are far from
 dumb.
 They used to tell me dogs heard tone in
 sum,
 The tone of voice and did not understand
 The words that people spoke. Dogs must be
 grand
 To know by the mere tone what we must
 rate
 In syllables as well as tone ingrate.

20 He took count of the birds and said
 "Why don't I see the hoopoe fled,
 Or is he among absent bred?
 21 "I'll punish him severely or
 I'll execute him, without score
 Of clear excuse brought to the fore."
 22 But the hoopoe not far away
 Said "I've gone round while you just stay,
 And I bring Saba's news today."
 23 "I found a women ruling them,
 Provided with both gear and gem,
 She has a grand throne neath her hem.
 24 "I found her and her folk to bear
 Worship to the sun for God's ware,
 Satan has made their actions seem
 Pleasing in their eyes, so to cream
 Them off the path, so they receive
 No guidance and so no reprieve,
 25 "So they'd not worship God who brings
 To view what's hidden in the springs
 Of heaven and earth, and knows full well
 The things you hide and things you tell.
 26 "God, there's no god but He, the Lord
 Of the supreme throne *and adored*."
 27 He said "Soon we shall know if you
 Have lied or told the thing that's true.
 28 "Go now with this missive of mine,
 Deliver it to them in sign,
 Then stand aside and see what they
 Provide responding in their way."

The hoopoe bird's responsible for all
 That happened to King Solomon in thrall
 Of Queen of Sheba. Listen at the wall.
 To worship sun or serpent, none does well
 To fall beneath so heathenish a spell.
 So Solomon did right to turn his cheek
 Towards the pagan sort of mess and meek.
 It was his duty and of course his call.

Beloved, there is no god but You above,
No god but You for all creation's love.
So every messenger speaks out the tune,
And every sacred book that's read at noon,
All say the same, that You are only one
Before and after everything is done.

29 She said "O courtiers, see here
Delivered me a letter queer
Worthy of note, worthy of cheer.
30 "It is from Solomon and thus:
'In name of God, the most gracious,
Most merciful, 31 "don't make a fuss,
But come submitting and righteous."
32 She said "O courtiers, give advice
In my affair, nothing I slice
But in your council that is nice."
33 They said "We're strong and ready to
Fight bravely and as is our due,
But the command is in your view,
So think what you will order too."
34 She said "Kings, when they come into
A country, ravage it and set
The noblest folk as meanest met,
That's what they do with what they get.
35 "But I'll send back a gift and see
What returns with my embassy."
36 When they came to Solomon, he
Said "Will you give me wealth's degree?
But what Allah has given me
Is better than your wealth in fee.
No, it's you who joy in gift's glee.
37 "Go back to them and certainly
We'll come to them with such army
They'll not be able to withstand.
We shall expel them from the land
In their disgrace, humility."
38 He said "O courtiers, of you,
Which can bring me her throne in view
Before they come submitting too?"
39 'Ifrit of the jinns said "I'll bring
It to you before you can spring
Up from your council. Truly I
Am strong enough under the sky
And can by trusted to comply."
40 Said one with knowledge of the book:
"I'll bring it to you as you look!"
Who he saw it set in his nook,
He said "This is by my Lord's grace,
To test me if I've grateful trace
Or not. And if any in place

Is grateful, truly gratitude
Is for his own soul's gain and brewed.
But if anyone's thankless, then
My Lord is free of needs of men,
Above all in His honour's ken."

Ifrit's my favourite among the jinn,
The boaster with or without mortal sin!
I'd like to see the jinn move palace and
A throne about the ocean and the land.
If ever Ifrit comes around to me,
I'll ask him of his wondered equestry.
Who can resist with arms and fight the
great

And merciful king Solomon at gate?
Beloved, I am Your jinn, give me
command

And power to do as You say by Your hand;
And I shall joy to jump by night and day,
And never tire to do Your will and stay
Within the shadow of Your throne or lift
It up and bear it off as any gift.

42 He said "Change her throne so she'll not
Recognize it come on the spot.
Let's see if she's guided or not,
One with no guidance in her lot."

42 So when she got there, she was asked,
"Is this your throne?" As she was tasked
She said "It was just like this, yes,
And knowledge was granted no less
On us before this, since we've come
Submitted to God for the sum."

43 And she turned from false worship's
way

Of others besides Allah's sway.
For she came from a folk without
Faith *but were always prone to doubt.*

44 She was bade enter the high hall,
But when she say it like to fall,
She thought it was a watered lake,
And bared her legs for wetness' sake.
He said "This is a palace paved
With smooth plates of glass you have
braved."

She said "O Lord, I've wronged my soul,
I do submit, and at the goal,
With Solomon to the worlds' Lord,
The elevated and adored."

It's all a joke and magical contortions!

And yet behind are cynical extortions.
I see conflict of powers and hear the whine
Of the foul wind in dark above the pine,
And know the centuries do not abate,
But every power of air in love or hate
Comes down upon the midnight power's
estate.

Yet after all the legendary rate,
The mind and heart of the queen and the
king
Are joined submitted to You in their ring
Where tapers flicker and the dread sounds
sing.

Beloved, above the sorcery I find
A better message of the dear and kind.
Keep me in magic and outside the rind!

45 We sent to Thamud and their brother
Salih with a message in other:

"Worship God." But see they became
Two parties fighting with the same.

46 He said "O people, why do you
Ask for the hastening in view
Of evil instead of the good?
If only you'd ask as you should
God for forgiveness, you might hope
To receive mercy *and not rope*."

47 They said "An evil sign we see
From you and those who do agree."
He said "Your evil omen's set
With God, you're under trial met."

48 There were in the city nine men
Of a clan, who made mischief's den,
And would not repent it again.

49 They said "Let's make a common pact
By God that we'll in secret act
By night on him till we've attacked
His people and say to his heir,
'When they were killed, we were not there,
It is the truth we've come to share.'"

50 They plotted and connived, but We
Too planned, but such they could not see.
51 See what was the end of their plot.

We destroyed them and their folk's lot.
52 Such were their houses, ruined there,
Because they did the wrong aware.
Truly this is a sign to share
With a folk with knowledge to bare.

53 We saved those who believed when they
Acted with righteousness in sway.

54 Lot said to his folk, "Do you do

What's shameful though you keep in view?

55 "Would you really lie down to men
In your lusts rather than women?
No, you're a folk of senseless den."

56 But his folk only answered so,
They said "Run Lot's folk out, and go
Away from your city not slow.

These are men who prefer to know
Themselves clean and pure in a row."

57 But We save him and family,
Except his wife, by Our decree
We made her of those left to be
Behind *destroyed in misery*.

58 We poured down on them showers'
spree,

And evil was the shower's degree
On those who were warned by decree.

59 Say "Praise be to Allah, and peace
On His servants whom in release
He has chosen. Who's is the better?
Allah or the false gods they fetter?

Praise be to You, Beloved, and peace to
those

Whom You have chosen as a living rose
Among the thorns, the messengers and
guides,

Let me not follow anyone besides.

Praise be to You, Beloved, who can
compare

With You among the gods of earth and air?
If I search out such ones, You only say,
Though you know them, I know none
anyway.

And so I am left foolish in my knowing
Of worthy things to worship from their
crowding.

Praise be to You, Beloved, and be all praise
From all created things in all their days,
And peace alone, and peace to them who
are

Your servants in this world, beneath this
star.

60 Or who's created heavens and earth,
And who sends you down rain in dearth
From the sky? Indeed by it We
Make grow the planted orchards free
Full of delight, full of beauty.
You have no power to make trees grow.
A god besides Allah to know?

No, they're a folk turned back to go
From justice *that they ought to know*.

61 Or who's made the earth firm to live,
Made rivers in it like a sieve,
Set mountains not to be moved there,
Set barrier between the share
Of two water pools flowing there?
A god beside Allah to bare?

No most of them no nothing there.
62 Or who listens to the distressed
When call is made on Him addressed,
And who relieves the pain and makes
You heirs of the earth in its wakes?
A god besides Allah to sing?
Little you know of anything.

63 Or who guides you through deepest dark
On land and sea and makes to park,
And who sends the winds of good news
Brought before His mercy to choose?
A god besides Allah? God's high
Above the things they choose to vie.

64 Or who originates creation,
Then brings it again in its station,
And gives you nourishment abounding
From the skies and the earth resounding?
A god besides Allah? Say "Bring
Your proof, if you are not lying."

65 Say "None in the sky or on earth,
Except Allah, knows hidden berth,
Nor can they see when they'll be raised.

66 Still less can their knowledge unfazed
Encompass the hereafter. No,
They are in doubt about its glow.
No, they are blinded to its show.

My mind cannot encompass the hereafter,
And it's not because of disdainful laughter.
It's merely that what I have not gone
through

By my experience of morning dew
Remains a theory without hands on to.
A man can understand down to the heart
Only that in which he has had a part.
A child may see the many go each day,
And still when starting school find a new
ray,

A chapter beyond all she thought was true.
The same must be for me as I from pew
Of earth awake in recreated soul,
And find at last that I have reached the
goal.

Let me keep this in mind along the way.

67 The unbelievers say "What! When
We become dust instead of men,
We and our ancestors in den,
Shall we indeed be raised again?"

68 "It's true we were promised this, we
And our ancestors formerly,
These are just tales told anciently."

69 Say "Go throughout the earth and see
What's been the end of the guilty."

70 But do not grieve for them distressed
Because of their plots *left unguessed*.

71 They also say "When will it be?
Say if you've spoken truthfully."

72 Say "It may be that some event
You want to hasten on relent
In your pursuit and so prevent."

73 But truly your Lord's full of grace
To humankind. Nearly each face
Is one ungrateful *in that race*.

74 Indeed your Lord knows all their hearts
Have hidden in their inward parts,
As well as what they tell *for starts*.

75 There is nothing of the unseen
In heaven and earth, but's written clean.

76 Indeed this Qur'an does explain
To Israel's children on the wane
Most things of which they disagree.

Indeed, Beloved, I read the Qur'an here
And find each dangling question of the tier
Of Torah answered before eye and ear.
I see the full truth come and disappear.

Indeed, Beloved, what laws were left in air,
What failed to be complete in Israel's share
Is now perfected before day of doom.

I read and understand the fragrant bloom.
Beloved, my help and hope's recited clear,
Is brought before the gleanings of the heir,
Is lightened and refreshed within my room.
I find once clarity where once was fear,
I find perplexity is turned to cheer,
And with the double share I stake the loom.

77 It surely is a guide and it
Is a mercy to those who're fit
In their belief *to know and sit*.

78 Indeed your Lord ordains between
Them by His own decree unseen.
And He's exalted in His power,

All-knowing *in the tempting hour*.

79 So put your trust in God, for you
Are on the revealed path and true.

80 Indeed you cannot make the dead
To listen, or can you for dread
Make the deaf hear the call when they
Turn back *from the true and right way*.

81 Nor can you be the blind ones' guide
To keep then from straying aside.
Only those will you get to hear
Who believe in our signs as clear,
And they will bow, submitting here.

82 And when the word's fulfilled on them,
We'll bring up from the earth in den
A beast against them. He will speak
To them because humankind seek
Not to believe in Our signs' peak.

83 One day We'll gather from each folk
An army of those who in stroke
Reject Our signs, kept under yoke,
84 Until when they come He will say
"Did you reject My signs to play,
Though you were not in knowledge sway,
Or what was it you did, pray say?"

85 The word will be fulfilled on them,
Because of their wrong-doing's hem,
And they'll be speechless to condemn.

86 Do they not see that We have made
The night for them to rest well laid
And the day to give them their light?
Truly in this are signs in sight
For any folk believing right.

87 The day the trumpet will be sounded,
Then struck with terror those abounded
In heaven and earth, except those whom
God will please to exempt from doom,
And all shall come before His place
Aware of their lowly disgrace.

88 You see the mountains and you think
That there are firm upon the brink,
But they shall pass away like clouds
That disappear away in shrouds,
Such is the artistry of God,
Who sets all things in ordered rod,
For He knows well what's done in pod.

89 If anyone does good, good will
Be counted to them on their bill,
And they'll be safe from fear that day.

90 And if anyone does the ill,
Their faces will be cast away
Into the fire. "Do you receive

Reward other than that in sleeve
Which you have earned by deeds'
reprieve?"

I've seen the mountains from the place
where I

Played as a child beside grandmother's
house,

And lifted eyes toward the hills on high
And laughed to see the flitting bat and
mouse

When evening cast the hills in darkened
way.

I've seen the mountains solid in the ray
Of fading sun and at the end of play.

They disappeared when I was very young
Each time the day sank lower in its rung.

Beloved, I can believe that mountains pass
Since I have seen them go as though a glass
Had stripped reality of sight and sound.
The silent mountains flee above the ground.
Beloved, I pass before the hills around.

91 As for me, I have orders given
To worship the Lord of this shriven
City, Him who has hallowed it
And to whom belong all things fit.

And I'm commanded to be one
Of those who bow submitting done
To God's will *when at last I'm won*,

92 And to recite the Qur'an's word,
And if anyone's heart is stirred
To follow guidance, they do it
For the good of their own souls fit,
And if anyone goes astray,
"I'm only a warner" I say.

93 And say "Praise be to Allah, who
Will soon show His signs unto you,
So you will know them set in view,"
Your Lord is mindful what you do.

I bow, Beloved, submission is a thing
That only You can know in human wing.
Whether I do submit or not, no man
Has inkling under the sky in its span.
Let everyone regard what he can scan.

I bow, Beloved, and take praise on my lips,
And none can know among these human
ships

Whether that praise comes from the heart
or hips.

The weather of the mind reflects indeed
Upon the face, and all men may take heed,
But still hypocrisy may fast impede
Submission and praise gathered like a
weed.

Beloved, let Your praise be upon my heart,
And Your submission always see my part.

Surah 28 Al-Qasas, or the Stories

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 Ta, Sin, Mim.

2 These are the verse of the book
That make clear *wherever you look*.

3 We recite to you of the tale
Of Moses and Pharaoh no fail
In truth, for people who believe.

4 Pharaoh puffed himself in the land,
Divided the folk where to stand,
Oppressing some under his hand,
He killed their sons, but kept alive
Their daughters, in mischief to strive.

5 We desired to be gracious to
Those who were oppressed in his view,
To make them leaders and heirs too,

6 To set them a firm place in land,
And show Pharaoh, Haman and band,
At their hands the very results
Against which the took care's insults.

The rumours of a heaven-sent child
In every legend and tale wild
Inspire the king irreconciled
To kill the boy babies he finds.
I hear of Herod in his blinds
Did the same, though no history
Records the fact for memory.
It is perhaps the bent of fear
In every kingdom's mother's ear
That tells the tale both loud and clear,
While the recorders, men of state
Neglect to mark down deeds of hate.
Beloved, if Moses and the boy
Jesus escaped, I jump for joy.

7 We sent this word to Moses' mum:
"Nurse him, but when your fears have
come,
Throw him into the river then,
But do not fear or grieve again,
For We shall bring him back to you,
And make him of Our sent ones' crew."

8 The folk of Pharaoh drew him out,
That he should be a foe to flout
And cause them sorrow, for Pharaoh
And Haman and their band not slow
Were sinful men, wicked to go.

9 The wife of Pharaoh said "A joy
To the eye for me and to ply
For you, don't kill him. It may be
That he will be a help to me
And you, or we may adopt him
As a son," not seeing the grim.

10 But there was a loss in the heart
Of Moses' mother, near to start
Revealing her case, but We came
To fortify her heart in claim,
So she'd stay in believer's game.

11 She said to the sister, "Go out
And follow him to see about,"
So she watched him disguised to be
A stranger, so they did not see.

12 We made him refuse first to suck,
Until she said, "Shall I with luck
Show you folk of a house what will
Nourish and bring him up to fill
For you and care for him with will?"

13 So We brought him back to his mum,
To comfort her eyes with it some,
And not grieve, and so she might know
God's promise is true and not show,
But most them them fail to see so.

Qur'an takes rumours of Moses and fair
Egyptian princess that took him up bare
From drowning Nile. I am pleased now to
note

That You were there to keep him in the
boat

And make him not nurse till his mother
came

To lay him on her breast without a claim.
The story's silent of the oven hiding,
And Moses safely in the flames abiding.
Beloved, traditions that swerve in detail
From what is written in the blessed mail
Also feed human souls with faith and hope.
They are a tattered means to help us cope
With a world that seems ruthless at the
birth

Of so many new babies on the earth.

14 When he reached adulthood and set,

We gave him wisdom's knowledge met,
For so We reward those who do
The good *and keep Our will in view.*

15 He came into the town one time
When its folk were not watching crime,
And he found there two fighting men,
One of his own faith, and again
The other of his enemies.

Now the man of his faith said please
To help him against his foe, and
Moses hit him with fist in hand
And finished him off *from the land.*

He said "This is an evil work,
For he's a foe who does not shirk
From leading away from command."
16 He prayed, "O Lord, I've wronged my
soul.

But please forgive me is me goal."
So He forgave him, because He
Is off-forgiving, of mercy.

17 He said "O Lord, since You've bestowed
Your grace on me, I'll not be toed
To help the sinful ones in goad."

The illustration of wisdom divine
The Qur'an brings to light instead of wine
Is that Moses came to kill an oppressor.
That was not very wise, be the confessor.
The fact remains despite the prayer
repenting

And the report of You, Beloved, relenting.
The soul is wronged in the wisdom You
give

Upon this fateful screen of hope to live.
Beloved, in knowledge of Your face I come
To separate the struggling ones who hum
Within the stony chamber of my heart,
And cast upon the one a fatal dart.
I hide my self beneath the desert sand
Of Egypt, mummified perhaps to stand.

18 He saw the morning in the town,
And looking round and in fear's frown,
When see the man who'd called before
Cried out again for his help sore.
Moses said to him, "It is clear
You're quarrelsome, the truth to fear."

19 Then when he tried to take hold of
The man who was a foe to shove
Them both, the man said "O Moses,
Do you intent now to dismiss

Me as you killed one yesterday?
You only want power over prey
In the land, not one who sets right.
20 And there ran a man into sight
From the other side of the town.
He said "O Moses, now get down,
The rulers counsel of your case
To kill you, so get from this place,
Is my advice before your face."
21 And so he ran away in fear.
He prayed, "O Lord, come me dear
From folk in wickedness to steer."

When a man slays by grace the other self
That wars against the right upon the shelf
Of chambered heart, the first thing that
emerges

Is that the rulers take council for scourges.
The social balance must require the
struggle

In right proportions of the two in tuggle
To keep the lust and cruelty and greed
Within the bounds of civilized in creed.
Beloved, I see each who kills trinity
Within the soul is then forced quick to flee
Into the desert from humanity
To hide for forty years beside the sheep,
Awaiting burning bush with eyes that
weep.

Beloved, You only know the soul and keep.

22 Then when he turned towards Midian,
He said "I hope my Lord will scan
Before me the right path in plan."

23 When he came to the watering hole
In Midian, he found there in toll
A band of men giving to drink,
And nearly two women on brink
Holding their flocks back from the link.
They said "We cannot give to drink
Until the shepherds will retreat.
Our father's an old man to meet."

24 So he drew for them both, and he
Turned back to the shade of a tree,
And said, "Lord, I'm truly needy
Of any good that You'll send me."

Without lust, cruelty or greed to make
Both soul and body struggle for the sake
Of earth's existence, Moses could not take
Even the water to drink on the wake

Of desert flight. He fell into the need
Of all things and dependence on Your seed.
His hand, though strong, could not lift for
his own,

But only for the help of others' groan,
And then to return to the shade alone
To pray in sighs that all of life's bereft,
Without the trinity, there's nothing left.
Beloved, I too complain beneath the knife
That carries me away from sweetest life
And into the shade of the single strife.

25 Then one of them came back to him
Walking there timidly and trim.
She said "My father invites you,
In reward for your help in view
Of watering them for us two."

So when he came to him and told
The story, he said, "Now be bold,
You have escaped unjust folk's hold."

26 Said one of them, "O Daddy dear,
Hire him for wages, it is clear
The best one to hire is the man
Who's strong and trust-worthy by plan."

27 He said "I plan to marry one
Of these two daughters of mine won
To you, if you'll serve me eight years,
But if you stay ten years in gears,
It will be from you, it appears.
But I do not plan to put you
Into any hard place and view.

You'll find me to be in God's will
Among whom righteousness fulfil."

28 He said "Let it be so between
Me and yourself. Let it be seen
Whichever of two terms I steep,
Let there be no ill-will to creep.
Let God be witness, our word keep."

The soul that's fled the civilized in life
Is apt to end up with a desert wife.
So shyly she may tiptoe round the shade
Extending father's invitation laid,
That heart knows not until the dowry's paid
And years are caught in the round and
parade

Of nights beneath the silent stars and made
Of patience before all creation stayed.
Beloved, I follow Moses through the park
Of stone and sand and bush to find a lark
Arising and against the sun to light

And dive once more in everlasting flight.
The heavens by day and night swim in the
soul
Of him who lies in inspiration's toll.

29 When Moses had done, by decree
He travelled with his family,
He saw a fire before the mount
Tur. He said on his kin's account,
"Stay here, I see a fire. I hope
To bring some news, or then to cope
A burning firebrand warming scope."

30 But when he arrived there a voice
Was heard from the valley of choice
On the right bank, from a tree set
In holy ground. "O Moses met,
Truly I'm God, Lord of worlds let.

31 "Now throw your rod down." When he
did

His saw it moving, a snake hid,
And he fled and would not come back.

"O Moses, come near in your track
And do not be afraid, for you
Of one of those in safety's crew.

32 "Move your hand to your chest, and it
Will come out white without stain's fit,
And bring your hand up to your side
Against fear. Those who signs abide
As witness from your Lord to those
Pharaoh and the chiefs that he chose,
For they're indeed rebellious folk,
And very wicked under yoke."

33 He said "O Lord, I've killed a man
Among them and I fear the plan,
Lest they kill me too when they can.

34 My brother Aaron, he is more
Eloquent in speech than my score,
So send him with me as an aid,
To strengthen me, for I am laid
In fear they may accuse me then
Of lying before them again."

35 He said "We'll surely strengthen you
By your own brother come in view,
And bestow both of you with power,
So they'll not be able an hour
To touch you. By Our signs you'll take
The victory, and in your wake
All those who follow you *at stake*."

The man who's slain the evil twin within

Deems himself not of strength of soul to
win

In any controversy or in fight,
Or struggle for survival of the right.
So Moses answers You, that he has been
A hermit of the desert after sin.
It was no vain excuse, acknowledgement
Of grace before the Nile that You had sent.
Beloved, my desert is a hill and town,
A lake beneath the tundra's nearby frown,
And there I lay my head in peace to sleep,
While faith's marouders their own vigil
keep.

36 When Moses came to them to show
Our clear signs, they said to their woe,
"This is just magic tricks invented,
When in ancestors' time prevented,
We never heeded such a row."

37 Moses said "My Lord knows best who
It is comes with guidance in view
From Him and whose end will be best
In the hereafter. To contest,
Wrongdoers will fail *from foot to crest*."

38 Pharaoh said "Courtiers, no god
Do I know but myself in prod.
So then, O Haman, fire the clay,
And build a great palace that way,
So I may go up to the god
Of Moses, but I think the sod
Is just a liar *stuck in the pod*."

39 And he was proud and insolent
In the land far beyond intent,
He and his band, they thought that they
Would not have to come in Our sway.

40 We grabbed him and his band and We
Cast them abroad upon the sea.
Now see what is the end of those
Who did the wrong and so arose.

41 We made of them chiefs summoning
Into the fire. And at the spring
Of judgement day they'll find no aid.

42 In this world We've send down waylaid
A curse to follow them until
On the day of judgement they will
Be among the despised *to kill*.

The faith departure that I see about
Pharaoh's arrogance is in his redoubt
The fact that sun is god and he's his son,
The source of Christianity when done.

The faith of Moses is another breed:
It must dispense with divine offspring's
creed,

The king who's son of God in literal,
And God is sun of sod sidereal.
Beloved, I take the faith of Moses sought,
The faith in You alone above the taught,
Creator of both sun and sons in store,
Of kings and armies on the Red Sea shore.
Let that faith be the light across a sea
Into the promised land of Your decree.

43 We revealed to Moses the book
After We'd destroyed every nook
Of generations come before,
With understanding for men's store,
And guidance and mercy so they
Might get the warning *without pay*.

44 You were not on the western side
When We commanded Moses' ride,
To witness what happened to bide.

45 We raised up generations fast,
And lengthened eras while they passed.
But you were not living among
The folk of Midian unstrung,

Reciting Our verses to them.
But We send messengers in hem.

46 Nor were you at the side of Tur
When We summoned messenger pure.
But as a mercy from your Lord
To give a warning to folk bored
Without a warner before you,
So they might get the warning true.
47 If We had not, then in the case
Calamity might seize their race
For what their hands have sent abroad,
They might come saying then, "Our Lord,
Why was no messenger restored
To us? We should then have implored
To follow Your signs for reprieve
Among the people who believe."

The book revealed to Moses still remains,
Although all before it is lost in stains
Of Your destruction on all humankind
Rejecting messages You'd left behind.
Moses' books despite critical acclaim
Are in the mint condition that You aim,
Despite the many reasons some refuse
To take them for the value You accuse.
Beloved, the lovely books of Moses make

The Sabbath reading that I keep in stake,
And as I read it week to week I find
That my heart changes from the weak and
blind
To know the joys of heaven all there
outlined.
You have not left me bereft by my lake.

48 But now the truth has come to them
From Ourselves, they say to condemn,
“Why are no verses sent to him
Like those sent down to Moses trim?”
So do they not reject what came
In past times to Moses in claim?
They say “Two kinds of magic tricks
To help each other in their fix.”
And they say “We’re not taken in,
We reject all such things in bin.”
49 Say “Bring a book from God that’s
better

In guidance than either such letter,
So I can follow it, do if
You are a truthful folk in tiff.”
50 But if they don’t listen to you,
Know they just follow their lusts’ view,
And who is more astray than one
Who follows his own lusts for fun,
Devoid of guidance from Allah?
For God does not guide folk in awe
Who keep doing the wrong when done.
51 Now We’ve extended them the word,
So they may be with warnings stirred.

The critic of Qur’an has nothing new
When he complains it’s different from the
view
Of book of Moses that’s read in the pew.
But it does not end there. They also strike
Against it because they find it too like.
Both difference and similarity
Are reasons to reject Qur’anic spree.
The critic always finds a view and cue.
Beloved, I take the book of Moses true,
And the Qur’an and love them both and
You.

And as I hear the melody they make
Upon the air in recitation’s wake,
I find the revelation rising clear
In heart and in the listening of the ear.

52 Those whom We sent the book before,

They have believed this message more.
53 And when it’s recited to them,
They say “We do believe the gem,
For it’s the truth come from our Lord.
We’ve truly been submitting toward
Allah before this thing restored.”
54 Twice will they receive their reward,
Since they’ve persisted and turn back
The evil with the good in whack,
And they spend from what they’ve in stack.
And when they hear vain speech, they turn
Away from it and say to spurn,
“To us our actions, to you yours.
Peace be to you, we seek no scores
Of ignorance *upon our shores*.”
56 True, you’ll not be able to guide
Each one you love to the right side,
But Allah guides those whom He will,
And He knows best who foot the hill.
57 They say “If we should follow in
The guidance with you without sin,
We’d be snatched away from our land.”
Did We not set them a sure stand
To which products in tribute fanned
Come in all shapes, provision made
From Ourselves? But most of them paid
No notice to understand planned.

The excuse not to live here righteously
Because it would draw persecution’s spree
Is founded well in earth’s reality.
There’s not much choice in the USA now
Among the trinity that rules the how:
The Catholic-crypto-Catholic bow,
The liberal and fascist holy cow,
And last Evangelical sinful row.
Beloved, I flee within the chambered heart,
And take its stony walls to keep apart
From evil, while You draw me out to see
The vastnesses of Your eternity,
The glories of Your starry minstrelsy,
The glitter and the fuss of divine art.

58 How many peoples We destroyed
Exulting in their life of void!
Now their cities deserted stand,
Except a very few in band,
And We remain their heirs in hand.
59 Your Lord was not one to destroy
A people till He did employ
A messenger reciting them

Our signs. Nor will We yet condemn
 A people except when their folk
 Work out iniquity in stroke.
 60 The things that you receive are just
 Aids in this life and glitter dust.
 But what's with God is better far,
 Enduring more *than even star*,
 So will you not be wise *and trust*?
 61 Are these alike, one to whom We
 Have promised good things in bounty
 Sure of achievement, and the one
 To whom We've given comforts done
 In this life, but who on the day
 Of judgement's brought into its sway?
 62 That Day He will call them and say
 "Where are My partners in your pay?"
 63 Those against whom the charge is set
 Will say "Our Lord, these are ones met
 Whom we have let astray to get.
 We led them wrong as we were wrong.
 So we abandon them along
 Before You. It was not us they
 Came bowing to in homage pay."
 64 It will be said "Call then in aid
 For your associates repaid."
 They'll call for them, but they'll not hear.
 They'll see the penalty with fear,
 Wishing they'd been in guidance dear.
 65 That day He'll call to them and say
 "What answer did you give in sway
 To the messengers *on your way*?"
 66 Then the tale of that day will seem
 A blinding darkness in a dream,
 And they'll not be able to raise
 A query from each other's daze.

The call to judgement sets the heart to hear
 And make evaluations of the clear.
 You do not ask me what good I have done
 Or point out wickedness beneath the sun,
 But rather what answer I gave to each
 Of those You sent as messengers to preach.
 Those who in truth accept the former
 crowd,

From Moses to the voice lifted aloud
 Of Jesus, recognize how Ahmed bowed
 Receiving Jibril's lightning as uncowed.
 Beloved, I take Your messengers with
 vigour

Without making distinctions. So the trigger
 Is pointed at my head. Where I am led

All are equally in Your great truth spread.

67 But anyone who had before
 Repented, believed at the door
 And worked out righteousness in store,
 Has hopes among those who receive
 Salvation *and divine reprieve*.
 68 Your Lord creates and decrees just
 As is His pleasure on the dust.
 They have no choice in any trust.
 Glory to God! And far is He
 Above the partners they decree.
 69 And your Lord knows all that conceal
 Their hearts and all that they reveal.
 70 And He is God. There is no god
 But He. To Him be praise and laud,
 At the beginning and the last.
 To Him is the command and blast,
 And to Him you will come back fast.
 71 Say "Do you see? If God should make
 The night forever for your sake
 To Judgement day, what god is there
 Besides God who can the light share?
 Will You not obey then with care?"
 72 Say "Do you see? If God should make
 The day forever for your sake
 To Judgement day, what god is there
 Besides God who can give a share
 Of night for you to rest? Will you
 Not then regard another view?"
 73 It's out of His mercy that He
 Has made for you night in degree
 And day, so you may rest and so
 You may seek out His grace not slow,
 And so be grateful *as you go*.
 74 The day He calls them He will say
 "Where are the partners in my pay
 That you imagine still have sway?"
 75 From each folk We'll take witness true,
 And We'll say "Bring your proof in view."
 Then they'll know truth is God's *alone*,
 And what they invent *to atone*
 Will leave them hopeless *at the throne*.

Partners invented by the faithful crew
 Of crypto-pagans are a thing of rue
 That goes beyond the idol made of stone:
 It's not outright idolatry alone.
 But every human concept of the mind,
 The theological image embrined,
 The innovation of worship in kind,

All are in partnership of idols' way
 And infringe on Your rulership in sway.
 Beloved, I strike down like Ali in time
 The idols of my heart, and tongue, and
 rhyme,
 And turn and turn again, repenting fast,
 To You upon Your throne, till I'm outcast
 And dizzy from returning to the blast.

76 Korah, he was of Moses' folk,
 Acted with insolence in yoke,
 Such were the benefits that We
 Had poured on him their very key
 Would have been more than men could
 bear,

See how his people told him there,
 "Do not rejoice in pride, for God
 Does not love vaunters in their pod.
 77 "But use what Allah's given you
 To find haven in coming true,
 And don't forget your lot that's here.
 But do good and God's given cheer,
 And don't look to cause mischief here,
 For God does not love maid or fere
 Who make troubles on earth appear."

78 He said "This has been given me
 Because of what I know in fee."
 Did he not know God had destroyed
 Before him generations ployed,
 Which were better than he in strength
 And of greater wealth come at length?
 But wicked ones are not brought in
 Ready account for all their sin.

79 So he went out among his folk
 To vaunt his wealth. Those in the yoke
 Of this world's life said "What a bloke!
 If only we had Korah's lot,
 He's a great man and lucky sot!"

80 But those granted true knowledge said
 "Woe to you, God's reward that's spread
 Is best for those who do believe
 And work righteousness for reprieve,
 But such shall no one hear achieve
 Except those who are in God's sleeve."

81 We made the earth swallow him and
 His household, and he had no band
 To help him against Allah's stand,
 Nor could he defend his own land.

82 And those who had envied his place
 The day before on morrow's trace
 Said "Oh, It's God who gives and takes

To any for His servants sakes
 And as He pleases at their stakes.
 If God were not gracious to us,
 He could make the earth swallow us.
 Oh, those who reject God will not
 Come to prosper in any plot."

Korah's the patron saint of all those who
 Pretend to represent and preach of You.
 Established faith is handmaid of the state
 As Nebuchadnezzar would illustrate.
 If Constantine chose tolerance to date
 In Roman office instead of the rate
 Of Donatist, he was wise in his way.
 He had a flock of priests who would not
 stray,

Experienced in expedient's play.
 Beloved, I seek the church with no power
 here,

With no wealth and no temple but the bier
 Of Sabbath dawning equally for all.
 Some enter in the vast and perfect hall,
 And others turn back from the divine call.

83 The coming refuge We shall give
 To those who intend here to live
 With honesty out of the sieve
 Of mischief, and the end turns out
 Right for the righteous come about.

84 If any one does good, the gain
 To him is better than the blain
 Of his deed, but if one does ill,
 He's only punished to his fill.

85 The One who ordained the Qur'an
 For you will bring you back to dawn
 Of the return. Say "The Lord knows
 Best who brings guidance in its rows,
 And who is in clear error's throes."

86 You did not expect that the book
 Would be sent to you for a look
 Except as mercy from your Lord.
 So don't give your support to those
 Who turn away in wicked rows.

87 And let nothing keep you back from
 The miracles of God that come
 After they have been shown to you.

Invite folk to your Lord, and do
 Not stay among those in their pew
 Who join gods with Allah the True.

88 Don't call on any other god
 Except on Allah. There's no god

But He. All will perish except
His own face. And to Him is kept
The order, and to Him will you
Be brought back *once into His view*.

The purpose of the Qur'an in surprise
Is not to make a new faith under skies,
But to call back to that beginning guise
That Christ affirms before the law was met
By hardened human hearts in divorce set.
The great divorce of human faiths belies
The first faith, that of Adam, where he tries
To hide from You, and You call to him
wide.

Beloved, I hear Your call from where I hide
Among the many faiths where humans
bide.

It is Your will that such divisions cast
A shroud about the minds made here to
last.

Only the greatly favoured without merit
Enjoy Your grace, though they can hardly
bare it.

Surah 29 Al-Ankabut, or the Spider

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
1 Alif. Lam. Mim.

2 Do men think they will be left off
Since they say, "We believe, *not scoff*."
And that they'll not be tested then?

3 Before them we tested all men,
So Allah surely shall find out
Those who are true from those who doubt.
4 Do those who practice misdeeds think
That they can trick us on the brink?
Evil's their calculation's *link*!

5 Who hopes to meet Allah, the time
Of Allah will come in their prime,
He hears and knows all things *in rhyme*.

6 Who strives, strives only for his own.
Allah needs no creation's *groan*.

7 Those who believe and do good deeds,
From them We'll blot out all the seeds
Of evil that may be in them,
And reward them with the best gem.

My faith and good deeds I bring up to You,
Giving You only what You would accrue,
And not my own, and in the waited hue,
I stand to feel the blotting out that comes
As the reward of the best gem in sums.

Some think that You forgive in mercy all
That they repent of in the honoured hall.
Some think that You forgave before their
pall

By killing Christ and nailing to the wall,
Without repentance and without a game
To flee from sin and wickedness in claim.
Some wait forgiveness as they too forgive.
But I want no forgiveness, I would live
Not just forgiven, but blot out the shame.

8 We've enjoined on man to be kind
To parents, but if they unwind
To get you to set up with Me
Of what you have no knowledge, see,
Do not obey them. For you must
Return to Me *and not to dust*,
And I'll reveal all in your trust.
9 Those who're faithful and do right deeds,
We'll let them in among the *steeds*
Of righteous who reject false creeds.

The holy Qur'an here harks back to quote
Your Decalogue, the words that You once
wrote

On tables of stone to become the measure
Evaluating every froth and treasure.
Kindness is honour paid to parents then.
That's something to remember right now
when
The fashion is to leave them in the lurch
And honour rather the state and the church.
Obedience to parents is the way
To long life on both earth and in the sway
Of paradise. Obedience in all
But command to take idols in the hall
To worship instead of You. I recall
You only, my Beloved, and so obey.

10 There are among men such as say
"We believe in Allah *and pray*,"
But when tormented in the cause
Of Allah, he considers claws
Of the people God's punishment.
But if there comes help from the Lord,
They say for sure, "We're with your
sword."

And does not Allah know the best
Of what is in His creatures' breast?
11 And Allah surely knows those who
Believe, and as surely those who

Are hypocrites *in what they do*.

How many times I've heard the blame once
set

Upon You and Your name, while some
forget

That human actions are what bring on earth
The pestilence, the flood, the fire, the
dearth.

Stupidity to blame You for the seed
Of evil that grows up like hark and weed,
When the hand of a man it was indeed
That planted wickedness in act and creed.
Beloved, I humbly bow before the plough
Of adverse blades that sink my hopes in
row,

And wait for You to judge the prickled
worm

That left me once bereft of weight and
term.

In all things I receive I thank You for
The good and leave the rest to wicked
score.

12 The unbelievers say to those
Believing, "Follow what we chose,
And we will bear the consequence
Of all you do that's without sense."
They will not bear a bit of their
Iniquities. Lies are their share.

13 They'll carry their own loads and loads
Of others with their own in goads,
And on the day of Judgement they
Will give account for their false way.

Some make taqleed to follow the address
Of scholars waiting in the wings to mess.
Some still acknowledge what their fathers
wore

And think the outer cloak with stay the
shore

For tidal wave and flood or something
more.

Some follow less than scholars, taking out
Opinion from the public and the shout
Of media to drown the still small voice
That in each heart arises with Your choice.
I hear You speak to me in earth and field,
I hear Your voiced repeated in the yield
Of revelation written and appealed,

And follow the words by both sight and
sound

To whirl obedience upon the ground.

14 We surely sent Noah one day
To his people and there to stay
For years a thousand minus fifty,
But the flood overtook them *nifty*
Since they were wrongdoers astray.

15 But We saved him and those along
With him in the ark, We made strong
A sign for all folk *right and wrong*.

16 And Abraham said to his folk,
"Serve Allah and fear His sure stroke,
That's best for you as you should know.

17 "But you serve instead of the glow
Of Allah idols set in show
And you invent a lie to go,
Sure those you serve besides Allah
Have no power to fill up your maw.
So seek all nourishment from God,
And worship Him, thank for His rod,
And to Him you'll come back to *plod*."

18 If you reject the Word like those
Before you doing as they chose,
The duty then of prophet rose
Only to preach clearly what goes.

19 Have they considered not how God
Brings the creation from the sod?
Then He will bring it back again,
That's easy for Allah, *not men*.

20 Say "Travel through the earth and see
How Allah did produce *with glee*,
So Allah brings about again
The hereafter *before all men*.

21 "He punishes whomever He
Pleases, and has mercy to be
On those He wishes, and to Him
You will be returned *glad or grim*.

22 You cannot thwart Him on the earth
Or in the heavens *for their worth*,
Nor do you have besides Allah
Guardian or helper *from the claw*.

I travel on the earth indeed and see
All about me the creation's wide sea
Of miracles caught up in soil and air
As well as in the roaring ocean there.
As my feet touch the many sacred sites
That criss-cross earthly days and heavenly
nights

I find the melodies of cricket and
 The furnishings of spiders here at hand
 To marvel that the world is bright and fair.
 Beloved, I travel now in mind alone
 Since feet with age begin to turn to stone,
 And still the freshness of creation here
 Is more than men's lifetimes can with such
 gear
 Return to contemplate. I travel near.

23 Those who deny the signs of God
 And the encounter with His rod,
 They'll despair of My mercy too,
 For such is painful touch in view.
 24 But his folk only answered then,
 Saying "Kill him or burn his *den*."
 But Allah saved him from the fire.
 These are indeed signs to admire
 For a folk who have faith's *desire*.
 25 He said "You've taken idols such
 Besides Allah and for the touch
 Of love among yourselves to be
 In the world's living *wickedly*.
 But on the Day of judgement you
 Will disown one another's view,
 And curse each other, while you stay
 In the fire without help in pay."
 26 That's why Lot had faith in Him and
 Say "Surely I go to the land
 Of my Lord. He's Almighty and
 Omniscient *over every hand*."

The populace about my darkened den
 Is filled with such careless and carefree
 men
 Who do not consider Your law of ten
 Is worth a groat or even single yen.
 They find that many gods will fill their
 plates
 With many images and names of states,
 And Sabbath days on any day of week
 To give their parents a curse or a tweek.
 Adultery is fair and stealing good,
 If one's not caught abounding through the
 wood,
 And murder, perjury and coveting
 Are just good ways to maintain queen and
 king.
 But on a day the populace will cast
 All these idols out that they have amassed.

27 We gave him Isaac and Jacob,
 And We ordained among *the hub*
 Of his descendants prophethood
 And revelation *of the good*,
 And gave him reward in the world,
 And in hereafter when unfurled,
 He'll be among the righteous *curled*.
 28 And Lot when he said to his folk,
 "You do indecent things that none
 In the world *and among the woke*
 Has ever done before you won.
 29 "Do you come to men and cut off
 The way, and commit with a scoff
 Outrages where you come to trough?
 But their response was only saying
 "Bring us God's punishment and flaying
 If you are truthful in your laying."
 30 He said "O Lord, help me at last
 Against this corrupt lot that passed."
 31 And when Our messengers came to
 Abraham with the good news too,
 They said "Surely we shall destroy
 The people of this town's employ.
 Its people do wrong to enjoy."
 32 He said "It's Lot who's living there."
 They said "We know best the town's share.
 We'll surely save him and his lot,
 Except his wife, she'll stay in plot."
 33 And when Our messengers came to
 Lot, he was distressed at their view
 And in a tight place for their due.
 But they said "Do not fear or grieve!
 We shall deliver you, receive
 Your family except your wife,
 She will be one who stays in strife.
 34 "And we shall certainly bring down
 Upon the people of this town
 A punishment from heaven because
 Of the wicked things on their paws."
 35 Surely We keep it showing sign
 For a folk who know the design.

It's a strange word You gave to Lot that he
 Should not grieve, since those in his house
 go free
 Except his wife. Two daughters they may
 be,
 And like as not no blood relation yet,
 Since they were eligible to be set
 As wives once the wife herself came and
 met

Destruction in the pillar of salt that
Still stands, perhaps, in the same place it
sat.

Again, if Lot's wife is returned for age
Of forty in exchange for acreage
In two twenties, then perhaps You are right,
He should not grieve the coming of the
night.

I still think, my Beloved, Your choice of
word

Leaves something more desired for what
occurred.

36 To Midian We sent Shu'ayb,
Their brother who said to describe,
"O my folk, worship Allah now,
And expect the last day somehow,
And do not act in wickedness
Upon the earth causing distress."

37 But they maligned him, and so then
An earthquake seized upon their men,
And they lay dead under their roofs.

38 And 'Ad and Thamud sent as proofs,
Evident to you from their place
Of habitation. Satan made
Their deeds seem right to them displayed,
And so he kept them from the way,
Though they could discern light of day.
39 And Korah, Pharaoh, and Haman.
Moses brought them clear proofs to scan,
But they were insolent on earth,
Though they could not win from their
berth.

The Haman that live there in Moses' time
Is not one found in former Scriptures'
rhyme,

And for that reason some with faithless act
Contend the Qur'an is a pallid fact.
The argument is that a Haman lived
And thousand years or more since Moses
sieved

The Nile for revelations of Your pact.
And since a Haman's mentioned on that
score,

The critic must suppose there can't be
more.

Irrationality, Beloved, is met
In every place the human heart is set
Against the duty to love You and keep
Your law of ten, Criterion to sweep

Doubt of Your Book from those who mock
and peep.

40 Each of them We seized for his crime,
Among them were those who one time
Felt Us unleash a rain of stones,
And those of them seized by the groans,
And of them those We caused the earth
To swallow up, and those whose berth
Was drowning. It was not God who
Wronged them but it was they who grew
To wrong themselves. 41 The parable
Of those who take helpers in full
Instead of Allah is one of
The spider that takes home above,
And surely the weakest of nests
Is the home where the spider rests,
Had they but known! 42 Allah sure knows
Whatever they invoke in shows
Besides Him, and He is Almighty,
The All-wise *come before the flighty*.
43 We set out such stories at hand
For humankind to understand
If they have knowledge *in the land*.
44 Allah created sky and earth
With the truth *of all things in worth*.

Have You, Beloved, created all by Haqq,
So Haqq has given grass and tree and rock?
Ah, that is why in every place I look,
I see the verses of the sacred Book.
The grass that grows in every blade repeats
Al-Haqq, Al-Haqq, and so the ox that eats
Is nourished by the ever springing signs
That show Al-Haqq in all of Your designs.
Wherever I may look in earth and sky,
All things by Haqq continue to pass by.
Reality is not a gate afar
Attained by only saint and hopeful star.
It is the here and now no one escapes
Who lives among the cockatoos and apes.

45 Recite what is sent of the Book
By inspiration where you look,
Establish prayer, for prayer indeed,
Restrains from shameful things and seed
Of wrong-doing, remembrance of
Allah's the greatest *thing of love*,
Allah knows what you do *for shove*.

Beloved, some stand for prayer but leave
behind
The service of remembrance, take the rind
And spit out fruit with seed, while thinking
that
Their actions will be approved where You
sat.
Beloved some whirl remembering your
name
And sacrifice the self in holy flame,
But leave prostration and reciting of
Your Book as though having forgotten
love.
Beloved, let me share in the trinity
Of recitation of the Book and see
My prayers to you rise from prostration and
Bring Your name to my lips in memory
As long as I whirl on the barren land
Beside the granite boulders on the sand.

46 Do not dispute with people of the Book
Except with better means *than thought and
look.*

Unless it be with those who do the wrong,
And say "We have faith in that which is
strong
Sent down to us and has been sent to you,
Our God and your God's one and same to
do,
And to Him we submit *upon the pew.*"

Who dispute with the people of the Book,
Saying only the Qur'an's fine, mistook
Their arguments. The Bible is preserved
Exactly as Allah wished and unswerved.
Who find deficiencies in it depend
On own criteria to comprehend
What's wrong and right, and that's idolatry
Condemned both in Qur'an and the decree
Of Bible. The book the Qur'an confirms
Is still with us just as it was in terms
When Ahmed spoke the light of angels
there.

Dispute with better means! The Book they
hate
Is filled with prophecies Ahmed's not late
To fulfil with the best of words in state.

47 So We've sent down the Book to you,
And those to whom We gave in view
The Book believe that it is true,

And of these there are some who do
Believe in it, and none deny
Our signs except the faithless guy.

Your signs or verses, my Beloved, are
great,
Confirmed of righteousness yet leaving bait
For doubters who set up criteria
Of pencil mark and spelling in their crawl,
And because numbers do not tally in
Their minds, think they are free to go and
sin.

Your signs start with Genesis, Jubilees,
And follow down the sodden centuries
To come at last to the bright light today
Of the Qur'an. Now no one can gainsay
Your revelation in each word that's found
In these fair writings that make bright the
sound

Of human voice where Your voice
overprints,
Except the faithless guy puckered with
quince.

48 You did not have a recitation
Of any scripture given in ration
Before it, nor did you write it
With your right hand to make it fit
For then the doubters would use wit.
49 Rather it comes as verses clear
In the breasts of those who hold dear
The knowledge given, not denies
Our signs except with wicked eyes.
50 They say "Why has no sign been sent
Down to him from his Lord *unspent?*"
Say "Miracles are God's alone,
I only warn, clearly make known."
51 Is it not enough for them that
We have sent down the Book so fat
Which is recited where they're at?
There is surely a mercy and
A warning in that for the band
Of people who have faith *to stand.*

Indeed the Book of Revelation's fat
And few there are that sitting on prayer mat
Recite it all. Some stop with Torah sung.
Some add the Zabur to unwilling tongue,
While others watch the Gospel for excuse
To sin under a sacrifice' abuse
Of killing a good man upon a cross.

Who do not recite all are men in loss.
The Torah and the Psalms, the Gospel too
Are joined in confirming the thing that's
true,
The glorious Qur'an once come in view.
I let my lips caress Your name and still
Recite the ancient Scriptures with a will
To sound upon Mecca and Zion's hill.

52 Say "God's enough as witness here
Between me and you, He'll appear
Knowing whatever's in the sky
And what is on earth. Who rely
On falsehood and defy Allah,
They are the losers *in their crow*."
53 They challenge you to hasten on
The punishment for them at dawn,
Had it not had appointed time,
The punishment had been their clime.
Surely it will fall on them fast
And they will not know what has passed.
54 They challenge you to bring in quickly
The punishment, and hell *though sickly*
Will catch the faithless on the day
When punishment turns on their way
From above them, under their feet,
And He'll say "Taste some of your treat!"
56 O My servants who have faith still,
My earth is vast *both plain and hill*,
So worship only Me *until*
57 Each soul shall have a taste of death.
Then you'll come back to Us *for breath*.

The recitation of the true and wild
Verses resounding on the air unstyled
Is all the argument that You have given
To humankind for Books to love and live
in.
None here can avoid the fire in the spot,
All are created in the same grand plot.
All must taste of the fire and come to meet
You at the day of faith or judgement's feet.
I may feel fire burn in my breast today
As I recite Your words without delay,
Or I may feel the fire consuming soul
When the last day comes on the honour
roll.
All men may choose between the fire and
fire
But all must know either death or desire.

58 Who have faith and do good deeds We
Shall surely settle *by decree*
In high houses of paradise
With streams flowing under them nice,
To stay in them *eternally*.
59 How fine is the reward of those
Who do well patiently and chose
To put their trust in their Lord's *pose*.
60 How many are the beasts that do
Not carry provision in view.
Allah provides for them and you,
And He hears all and knows all too.

The promise of Your paradise is far
Beyond my wants and needs on this small
star.
I need no flowing streams of milk and
wine,
I need no nourishing of pungent vine
By hidden fossil waters, nor do I
Need luxuries beyond pie in the sky.
The pleasures of Your word in my brief life
That stay me up against the raging strife
Are sweet enough, reward enough for me.
The one kiss of life You give's ecstasy.
Let others take the prizes, I and well
Rewarded by the sounds of Sinai's bell,
The cadences of Moses' shaking sound,
The Psalms, the Gospel and Qur'an I've
found.

61 If you ask them "Who has created
The heavens and the earth, and who mated
The sun and the moon *light related*,
They'll surely answer "Allah did."
Then where do they stray *when they hid*?
62 Allah spreads out provisions for
Whomever He wishes in store
Of His servants, and makes it fast.
Surely Allah knows all things *passed*.
63 And if you ask them, "Who sends down
Rain from the sky, with which the town
And land He vivifies when it
Has withered in like death to sit?"
They surely answer "Allah does."
But most are irrational fuzz.

Who doubt that You created all are those
Who thought You an old man with stinky
toes.

Idolatry is kin to science when

It lights a lamp of thought in thoughtless men.

Reality You are and nothing less,
Beyond person and shadow to confess.
Reality is the womb of the rain
As well as sky and earth, none made in vain.

Provisions spread for man and beast are caught

In the web of Reality and taught
To be the strength and movement and the life

Of universe and dance to harp and fife.
Beloved, You are above all things and yet
Sit enthroned in my heart with treasures set.

64 The life of this world's nothing but
Playing, entertainment to glut.

The living of hereafter's sure
Life had they only known *the cure*.

65 When they get on a ship, they cry
Allah in trusting in His ply,
But when He brings them back to land,
See, they give Him partners *in band*,
66 Ungrateful for what We have done.

Let them enjoy, soon they'll know *gun*.

Beloved, I think I too might cry and pray
If I were on a ship sinking today.
And yet I know the wooden hull or steel
Is more protection than what I can feel
Here on the dry land with no ship to guard.
The stony earth is also something hard
And could crush me at any moment's glance.

It is illusion that I've life to dance.
Death yawns at every breath, and yet I prance.

Beloved, I flee to You from the taut veil
Of the illusion that man can prevail,
And trust you only that I breathe again
After I hear the taunting of some men
And feel the pulsing heartbeat of the gale.

67 Haven't they seen how We've appointed
A place of safety and anointed,
While other folk stand disappointed?
Would they believe false things and be
Ungrateful for God's blessing free?
68 Who's greater in wrongdoing than

One who makes up a lie in span
Against Allah, denying truth
When it comes to him, *though a youth?*
Is not the final resting place
Of the faithless in hell *to race?*
69 And as for those who strive in Us,
We'll surely guide them without fuss
In Our paths, and Allah indeed
Is with the virtuous *in need*.

Beloved, I ask a boon of happiness.
The greatest gift that a man can caress.
I ask not wealth nor riches, poverty,
Or anything around me I can see.
I ask a greater thing than gold and ware
Of wisdom on the heart and in the air.
Beloved, I ask with pleading You will give
Me one thing constant as long as I live.
Give me no more, Beloved, and I shall be
Content to live with every misery.
Beloved, I pray now for this bounty's boon
From morning till the awkward light of noon
And further in the night until I sleep.
Give me, Beloved, a grateful heart to keep.

Surah 30 Al-Rum, or The Roman Empire

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 Alif. Lam. Mim.

2 Byzantium has been defeated

3 In a near land, but once completed

They will be victors once again

4 In a few years *to wait with yen*.

To Allah belongs each command,

Before and after, when they stand

On that day faithful to rejoice

5 At Allah's help *with a loud voice*.

He helps whomever He desires,

Almighty is He, mercy *inspires*.

6 A promise of Allah, Allah

Does not break His promise *as straw*,

But most folk do not know in awe.

7 They know only the outward part

Of the world's life and just the start,

But they are ignorant of what

The future holds, hereafter shut.

They say the Qur'an holds no prophecies
That have been fulfilled with *éclat* and
breeze,

But in fact here is one that must relate
 To the true history of Rome and its fate.
 The Qur'an says the defeat of Byzance
 Is just a temporary step the dance
 In stumbling took, and this forecast is true.
 It was centuries later that withdrew
 The power from Byzance and Byzantine
 crew.

Beloved, Your word is every right and
 shows
 That You know everything before it blows.
 I flee to You while I know hardly what
 Is on my back or what my mind unshut
 Will think with the next breath to serve my
 gut.

8 Do they not think about their own?
 Allah did not create the *throne*
Of heaven and the earth and all things
 Between them except with true wings
 And for a certain term. Indeed
 Many people still doubt the need
 To meet their Lord. 9 Have they not gone
 About the land in benison
 So they may see what was the fate
 Of those who were before their state?
 They were stronger than they, and they
 Ploughed up the earth and in its sway
 Grew in numbers above the day.
 Their messengers brought them clear
 proofs.

It was not Allah bashed their roofs,
 But they themselves took the wrong way.
 10 Those who committed wrong deeds
 failed
 In that they denied God's prevailed
 Verses in sign, deriding them.

I touch my hand to mouth for fear and
 shame
 That I or any might blaspheme Your name
 By deriding Your Book recited well
 Above my noons and nights to cast a spell
 Of silver and of magic that will tell
 Me of Your heart of love and of Your way
 Commanded from Sinai to guide the day.
 I touch my hand to mouth, let me not take
 A single word from You and cry mistake,
 But search the hidden and the hard to find
 What You, Beloved, might well have had
 in mind.

You can take even error of the scribe
 And perversity of the head of tribe
 To attempt to change Your word, all go
 blind.

11 Allah begins creation's hem,
 Then He will bring it back again,
 Brought back to Him shall be all men.
 12 And when the hour's appointed then
 The guilty will despair of men.
 13 None of those they set up in brief
 As partners will give them relief,
 And they will cast their partners out.
 14 The day of the time's set, no doubt,
 They'll be divided on that day.

Let me, Beloved, set no associate
 With You as God, no, not the perfect mate
 Or prophet or divine guide in the state.
 Messiah and prince, angel in relief,
 All fail of being gods to some men's grief,
 Because there can be only one belief,
 And only one Reality relate.
 I hold to You, and know there's no despair
 In the great harmony that You bring where
 The knowledge of divinity to share
 Floats on the human brain and settles there.
 Beloved, the time is set, my heart will wait
 And find the fleeting lives of small and
 great
 Illumined on that day of shattered air.

15 As for those who have faith and stay
 To do good deeds, they live rejoicing
 In a garden both fine and choicing.
 16 But as for those without faith who
 Denied Our signs as well as view
 Of the hereafter, they'll be brought
 To punishment *for what they sought*.
 17 So glorify Allah when you
 Come to the evening and its dew
 And when you rise at dawn's new view.
 18 To Him is all praise that is due
 In heaven above and in the earth
 At nightfall and when you find berth
 At noon. 19 He brings the living from
 The dead, and brings the dead to come
 From living, and revives the earth
 After its withered death *in dearth*.

Four times of prayer You mention here,
 Beloved,
 The morning, evening and the noontime
 shoved
 Back from the squeezed time, I suppose
 that's why
 The late afternoon prayer is mentioned by
 A chapter of its own, the 'asr, and
 Proclaimed a benefit to all on hand.
 Four times of prayer make four gates in the
 wall
 Of paradise, and so at the prayer call
 I rush to You, if only in the hall
 Of my own closet and the secret tent.
 The perfumed moments that Your odours
 sent
 Upon my soul resound with prayer's
 ascent.
 Beloved, I glorify You in the night
 With voice and silently in the sunlight.

20 His miracle's that He created
 You from the dust and separated.
 21 His miracle is that He made
 For you mates from your own selves
 flayed,
 That you may take comfort in them,
 And He set love and mercy's gem
 Among you. There are surely signs
 In that for folk who see designs.
 22 His miracle is the creation
 Of heaven and earth, and every station
 Of difference of your tongue and hue,
 These miracles to keep in view.
 23 His miracle is that you sleep
 By night and day, and that you keep
 His grace. There are indeed signs for
 A people who hear what's the score.
 24 His miracle is that He shows
 You lightning rousing fear and throes
 Of hope, and He sends down the rain
 From the sky, and revives with gain
 The earth after its deathly pain.
 There are surely signs not in vain
 For a folk who're in reason's reign.
 25 His miracle is that the sky
 And earth stand by Him to comply,
 And then when He calls you forth from
 The earth, behold you too will come.
 26 To Him is what's up in the sky,
 And what is in the earth and nigh,

All obey Him *to creep or fly*.
 27 It's He who starts creation's gale,
 And then He brings it back *to sail*,
 An easy task He will prevail.
 To Him highest comparison
 In heaven above and yet upon
 The earth. And Almighty is He,
 And knowing all *eternally*.

Your miracle is on the leaden sky
 To turn to silver all the hidden why.
 Your miracle is in the first near sigh
 That almost goes unnoticed in my ear.
 Your miracle's in everything I hear.
 Your miracle's the first, new-fallen snow
 That turns the world from autumn to the
 glow
 Of light in darkness by the come and go
 Of those who reach the graveyard and in
 sight
 Leave candles burning, burning tiny light.
 Your miracle is in the wind that claims
 The crusted ice to tinkle where the games
 Of what green and red feathered bathers
 find
 On frozen water barrel undermined.

28 He gives you an example from
 Yourselves. Do you have any *bum*
 That your right hands possess that are
 Your partners in the wealth in car
 That We've bestowed on you? Do you
 Fear them as you fear each the view
 Of one another? So We do
 Utter the verses for a folk
 Who apprehend them at a stroke.
 29 No, wrongdoers follow their own
 Desires with our knowledge *full grown*.
 So who'll guide those Allah has led
 Astray? They'll have no helpers *bred*.
 30 So set your face steady and true
 As folk of pure faith, Allah's due
 Work by the way that humankind
 Originated and designed.
 There's no changing Allah's creation,
 That is the upright faith in ration,
 But most do not know in the nation.
 31 Turn back to Him repenting and
 Fear Him, maintain in prayer to stand,
 And don't be among those who join
 Gods with Allah, *counterfeit coin*.

32 Dividing up faith into sects,
 Each having its own god-elects.
 33 When distress touches humankind,
 They cry to their Lord out of mind,
 Turning back in repentance kind.
 Then when He lets them have a taste
 Of His mercy, see, some to waste
 Set partners up with their Lord and
 34 Ungrateful for the gifts in hand
 We've given them, stay to enjoy.
 Soon they will know what We employ.
 35 Have We sent down to them a word
 That might speak of what they concurred
 Joining to Him what is absurd?
 36 When We let people taste the mercy,
 They rejoice in it, but oversey
 Should evil touch them because of
 What their own hands *without a glove*
 Have sent ahead, see, they become
 Discouraged. 37 Don't they see in sum
 That Allah expands provision
 For whomsoever He has done
 And tightens it? There are indeed
 Signs there for those whose faith's decreed.

The age-old question comes again as it
 Comes to each human being who has wit
 To say "Curse God and die" as Job's wife
 did.
 And yet the holy prophet came and hid
 In You, Beloved, both in the days of wealth
 And in the horrid night of creeping stealth
 Beyond catastrophe. In truth I hide
 In You for refuge from the rising pride
 That haunts those whose bellies are full of
 meat,
 As well as refuge when the times deplete
 My stores of grace. I turn from wealth and
 power
 And seek refuge in You. When comes the
 hour
 Of sorrow, You appear upon the scene
 Alone to record how much pain's between.

38 Give every relative his due,
 The needy and wayfarer too.
 That is better for those who seek
 The face of Allah's pleasure peek,
 It's those who prosper *in the crew*.
 39 That which you invest for interest
 To increase people's wealth the best

Does not increase in Allah's breast.
 But what you pay in charity
 Seeking Allah's face and to see,
 Those are the ones recompensed best.
 40 It's Allah who created you,
 And then He provided for you,
 And then He makes you die in crew,
 Then He will bring you back to life.
 Is there anyone among those
 Associated with you chose
 To do anything of the kind?
 Pure is He and exalted, mind,
 Above having partners they find.

Is this a fair challenge to those who seek
 A partnership with You and try to peek
 Out from Your majesty as gods and sheep?
 No fair! No fair! You well know none can
 bring
 The dead to life, awaken from that sleep
 That crouches on all things that weep and
 sing.
 That's why, perhaps, some try to rise on
 wing
 Ascribing deity eternal to
 Poor Jesus who was just a humble Jew,
 Although by Your word and Your name the
 dead
 At his command rose up alive to spread
 Rumours of grace from You beyond the
 tomb.
 He himself after reversing the doom
 Called himself son of man, that's what he
 said.

41 Corruption's on both land and sea
 Because of the folk's action's fee,
 So He may make them taste a wee
 Of what they've done atrociously
 Until they may come back to Me.
 42 Say "Travel over earth and see
 What was the fate of those who be
 Before, most in idolatry."
 43 So set your face to the right faith
 Before there arrives like a wraith
 The day that cannot be avoided
 From Allah. That day unalloyed it
 Will be men are divided *in*
Two groups, one righteous, one of sin.
 44 The faithless ones shall face what comes
 From faithlessness evil in sums,

And those who act in righteousness
 Only prepare their souls' address
 45 For the reward He'll give to those
 Who have faith and in what they chose
 To do they do in righteous deeds
 Out of His grace *for all their needs*.
 Indeed He loves no faithless breeds.
 46 Among His signs is this that He
 Sends the winds as bearers of the
 Eternal gospel, giving you
 A taste of His mercy, as do
 Ships sailing in allowance free,
 So you may seek His grace and so
 That you may be grateful and show.
 47 We surely sent messengers to
 Their people before ever you,
 And they brought them clear proofs *as due*.
 48 It is Allah who sends the wind
 Arising with the clouds and finned,
 Then He by His desire will spread
 Them in the sky and break as led
 In fragments, where you see the rain
 Come down from them upon the plain,
 Till it comes to His servants where
 He wishes, they rejoice to bear
 49 Before it came a worried look.
 50 Observe the effects mercy took
 In Allah's way, how He revives
 The earth after its death with lives!
 He is the raiser of the dead,
 And has power over all things spread.
 51 If We send wind with yellow blight
 They become thankless at the sight.
 52 You cannot make the dead to hear,
 Nor can you make the deaf give ear
 To the call when they turn their backs,
 53 Nor can you lead the blind in stacks
 Out of their error in their tracks.
 You can make hear only those who
 Have faith in Our signs and who do
 Submit themselves *in all things due*.

I thank You, my Beloved, this word is true
 That comes in comfort to me in my pew.
 It seems that no one hears the word I speak
 Whether it is a clear one or to peek
 With wonder and supposing in its cheek.
 The reason simply is one cannot make
 The dead to hear the blind to see a shake,
 And so my words that seem to take their
 spell

From exquisite draughts of Your gushing
 well
 Fly out inaudible, and truth to tell
 Invisible to those headed toward hell.
 The reeking sulphur and the clanging bell
 Drown out the twitter of my angel cake,
 And rarely does a soul turn and awake.

54 It's Allah who created you
 From weakness, then He gave you due
 Power after weakness. Then to come
 After power He ordained in sum
 Weakness and old age, He creates
 Whatever He desires in states,
 And He is the All-knowing One,
 Omnipotent *above the sun*.
 55 And on the day with the Hour set
 Transgressors will swear and lay bet
 That they remained only an hour.
 So they were used to lie for power.
 56 But those who had knowledge and faith
 Will say, "Surely, body or wraith,
 You stay in Allah's Book until
 The Day of Resurrection fill.
 This is the Day of Resurrection,
 But you did not know *its selection*."
 57 On that day the excuses fall
 From the wrongdoers who install
 But do not benefit at all,
 Nor will they receive any call
 To grace by repentance *and gall*.
 58 Truly We've drawn before mankind
 In this Qur'an every verse signed.
 Indeed if you bring them a sign
 The faithless surely will resign,
 Saying "You just invent the line."
 59 In this way Allah seals the hearts
 Of those who do not know their parts.
 60 So in patience let weigh the word
 Of Allah's promise undeterred.
 Do not let yourself be upset
 By those without conviction *yet*.

In peace I ride about the cloud of grief
 That settles on the city and the place
 Of merchandise with no sign of relief
 Against the jaundiced features of its face.
 In patience I repeat the sacred word
 Of promise in the silver light of grace
 Along the echoing feet undeterred
 I find the desert of the meadow trace.

Beloved, the slumber of frenetic sound
The ghost chains rattling cannot fail to take
I hardly hear now I'm beyond the bound
Of whirling recitation for Your sake.
My feet answer the comfort of the ground,
My hands take up Your tasks in daily
round.

Surah 31 Luqman, or The Wise.

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 A. L. M.

2 These are verses of the wise Book,

3 A guide and mercy for the look
Of well-doers, 4 who maintain prayer

And pay the charity and share
Certainty of the Final Hour,

5 Who follow their Lord's guiding tower,
They're those who prosper *in His power*.

6 But there are among men who be
Buyers of tales of knowledge free
To lead astray from Allah's way
And ridicule *the light of day*,
For such there is a humble pay.

7 When Our signs are rehearsed to such
He turns back with arrogant clutch,
As if he had not heard as much,
As though both ears were deaf to touch,
To him a painful penalty.

8 For those who believe faithfully
And do good deeds, for them will be
Gardens of bliss eternally,
A true promise of Allah rise,
He is Almighty, the All-wise.
10 He alone created the skies
Without pillars or any guise,
And cast firm mountains in the earth
Not to shake you *with trial and dearth*,
And spread there every kind of beast.
We sent down water and increased
From the sky causing every kind
Of splendid thing to grow and mind.

11 This is the creation of God.
Now show Me what others on sod
Besides Him have created such.
Rather sinners just err in touch.

One proof of Your divinity, Beloved,
Was that You raise the dead to life once
gloved

In grave and dust. This second proof You
give

Is that no other can arise to live
Creating earth and sky and sending rain
Down on the hills and valleys, fertile plain.
So every kind of splendid thing proclaims
Your sovereignty growing out of the flames
Of sky created anew every day
As the world turns against the solar ray
To like the primrose that peeks through the
snow.

You are Creator and that makes You show
That You are God. If one may raise the
dead

I then ask him to make the new dawn red.

12 Surely We made Luqman one wise,
Saying "Give thanks to Allah's eyes,
And whosoever gives Him thanks,
Gives thanks only for his own banks.
And whoever's ungrateful raised,
Allah's sufficient and all praised."

13 When Luqman taught his son, he said
"O my son! Don't ascribe as bred
Partners in worship with Allah,
Partner ascribing's great faux-pas."

14 We've laid duties on humankind
In regard of parents to mind,
His mother carried him through all
Weakness on weakness in her call,
To weaning that's two years in all.
Give thanks to Me and parents too,
To Me is *your* return *in view*.

15 But if they try to make you join
In worship with Me some false coin
Of which you have not heard from Me,
Do not obey them or agree,
Yet bear them in life's company
With justice and with courtesy,
Follow My way penitently,
Then to Me will be your return,
All that you did in truth you'll learn.

The great commandment, one with promise
strewn

Is here repeated by Luqman for boon:
Honour parents no matter what their state,
Obey in all things but unholy rate
Of idol worship. Here is proof in part
The holy Qur'an's not a work of art
Alone, but breath of revelation's wheel
Sent down admonishing, sent down to heal.
Beloved, there's no command in positive

So finely given to make people live
In visions of glory beyond this one
That honouring one's mum, whether it's
fun
Or not, is what schools the soul in the right
And leads the whirling footsteps towards
the light.

16 "O my son! Should it even be
The weight of a mustard seed wee,
And should it be inside a rock,
Allah will produce it *in stock*.
Indeed Allah attends to all
And is aware of all in all.
17 "O my son! Maintain prayer and bid
What is right and what's wrong forbid,
Be patient with what befalls you.
18 "Don't turn your cheek away in pride
From the people and do not stride
Exultantly upon the earth.
Allah does not love bragging berth.
19 "Be modest in the way you act,
And modulate your voice in fact.
The ugliest of voices is
The donkey's voice *to wheeze and whiz.* "
20 Don't you see Allah has put down
For your use all things in the town
Under the sky and on the earth
In bounties flowing measure's worth,
Both seen and unseen *on the earth?*

There are many men in the market street
Who stop to pray on time and cross their
feet
With the right resting on the left to be
Pretence of slaughter sheep before Your
fee.
Though many pray, how many come to say
What's right and forbid the wrong in the
sight
Of the sun looking down on human plight?
They reason human tongues refuse to speak
At the oppression of widow and weak
Is simply to avoid what will befall.
That's why You hasten to add to the call
Be patient with the consequences when
You point out justice before evil men.
Pot greens along the path are enough then.

Yet among folk are those disputing
About Allah and so confuting

Without knowledge or guidance or
Illuminating Scripture's score.
21 When they are told to follow what
Allah has sent down, they are shut,
Saying "We'd rather follow that
We found there where our fathers sat."
What! Even if Satan had been
Seducing to wrath for their sin?
22 Whoever surrenders his heart
To Allah and does the good part
Has surely grasped the firmest art,
With Allah rests the end of all.
23 As for those without their faith's wall,
Let their faithlessness not stand tall.
To Us will be their return and
We shall inform them in a band
About what they've done out of hand.
Indeed Allah knows best their heart.
24 We'll provide for them a brief time,
Then We'll shove them in a harsh clime.

You lull to sleep the wicked who refrain
From keeping Your ten laws under the rain
That revives earth and brings them such in
gain
To fill their barns and palaces with wealth.
You lull to sleep the foolish with good
health.
Let me, Beloved, remember that my peace
Does not depend on how much in release
I've had to eat of cake and drink of wine,
Or how golden and silver when I dine
Utensils are, but rather to what place
I've acted by You law under Your grace.
Though I may be sleek and fine in my face,
If I've not obeyed Your word, all is done
And lost before the setting of the sun.

25 If you ask them who has created
The skies and the earth, then elated
They'll surely say now "Allah did."
Say "All praise be in Allah hid!"
But most do not know of the bid.
26 To Allah is all in the sky
And all on earth. Indeed thereby
Allah is All-sufficient and
All-laudable *in every land*.
27 If all the trees on earth were pens,
And all the seas seven times amens,
The words of Allah could not be
All written in ink where we see,

Indeed Allah's Almighty, wise.
28 And your creation or your rise
Is only as a single soul.
Allah's all-hearing, sees *the goal*.

How many lovers have sighed for the ink
Of all the oceans for the love they think
Is in their breast! And so good John too
wrote
That earth could not contain in store or boat
All that was done at Jesus' hand to dote.
It would be an unseemly thing if such
A sentiment failed of Qur'anic clutch,
And limited alone to French and Dutch.
Beloved, let ink be dried or running down
And flushing out the frontiers of the town,
But I return to You despite Your frown.
Beloved, let earth be filled with what You
do,
And let my heart be thrilled to see the view,
But I return to You despite the pew.

29 Have you not noticed Allah makes
The night to pass into day's wakes,
And makes the day pass into night,
And He's disposed the sun aright
And the moon, and each moving wight
For a specific term in sight,
And that Allah is well aware
Of what you do *and what you share?*
30 That's because Allah is the Truth,
Reality He is forsooth,
And whatever they might invoke
Besides Him is null at a stroke,
Because Allah's exalted, great.
31 Have you not seen the ships in state
That sail through the ocean by grace
Of Allah? So that He may trace
To you some of His signs? There are
Signs there for every patient star
And grateful servant *in His car*.
32 When a wave like a canopy
Covers them, they arise to flee
Calling on Allah with firm trust.
But when they set foot on the dust
Some doubt again and hesitate.
But no one rejects Our signs' rate
Except a thankless reprobate.
33 O humankind, do not swerve from
Your duty to your Lord in sum,
And fear the day no father can

Atone for his child, no child's man
Enough to atone for its dad
Even to the smallest *in pad*.
Surely Allah's promise is true,
Don't let this present life fool you,
Nor the deceiver make you think
The false is true in Allah's rink.
34 Indeed the knowledge of the hour
Is with Allah, He has the power
To send down the rain, and He knows
What it is in the womb that grows.
No soul knows what she'll gain tomorrow,
No soul knows in what land will sorrow
Claim her, but Allah knows all things,
Is fully aware of all *stings*.

How many times deceivers make the false
Seem true to Christian eyes stuck on the
waltz
Of human sacrifice and Trinity!
Now many times deceivers call You three.
How many times deceivers make the true
In Bible seem false to the Muslim crew
Who imitates the liberal in view
Of Christian scholarship is critic's brew!
Beloved, I beg the true from You and find
That truth makes human hearts ever be
blind,
And raises hackles of those who are sure
That they know more than what is good
and pure.
Let me close eyes to the false in the bind
And open them before the grace I find.

Surah 32 Al-Sajda, or The Prostration.

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
1 Alif, Lam, Mim.
2 The revelation of the Book,
There is no doubting in it, look,
It's from the Lord of all the worlds.
3 Do they say "He's forged what he hurls?"
No, it's the truth and from your Lord,
That you may warn a folk implored
To whom did not come earlier
A warner so they need not err.
4 It's Allah who created skies
And the earth and whatever lies
Between them in six days, and then
He stepped onto His throne again.
You do not have besides Him guard
Or intercessor. Is it hard

To take an admonition's word?
5 He directs the command inured
From the sky to the earth and then
It goes back up toward Him again
In a day of a thousand years
By your time reckoned *in your fears*.

The ascent to the Sabbath throne makes
You

The Sovereign of the world I have in view,
If not the universe displayed on cue.
Religions toss Your throne out in the mess
Of the material You came to bless.
It was too hard distinguishing the church,
So Diocletian left it in the lurch
To see who would turn over member lists
And Bibles to the executionists.
When Constantine saw who complied, he
made

Them bishops of imperial church in grade.
In recent centuries another stage
Of fair apostasy writes on the page:
Commercial Christianity to wage.

6 That is the Knower of the lent
And the unseen, Omnipotent,
All-merciful, 7 who brought to light
Everything He created right,
And started man's creation from
The clay *from which humankind come*.
8 He made his children, they are based
On a despised liquid in waste.
9 Then He fashioned him as was due
And breathed into him something new
Of His spirit, and made for you
The hearing, sight and hearts *in view*,
Although thankful ones, they are few.
10 They say "When we're lost in the dust,
Shall we be renewed as at first?"
They doubt the coming of their Lord.
11 Say "Death's angel *with flaming sword*
Who's put in charge of you will take
You back to your Lord *for His sake*."
12 If only you could see the guilty
Hang their heads before their Lord *wilty*,
"Our Lord, We've seen and heard, send us
Back so we may act as righteous,
Surely we're now convinced *of worse*."
13 Had We desired We might have given
To every soul guidance to live in,
But My word came in witness then

"Surely I'll fill hell both with men
And jinn *of the guilty in den*."

I fail to understand You in creation,
Beloved, for mere casting in extirpation.
Why not create all for grace and salvation?
Why cast in hell some and for Your elation
Guide others into heaven's consolation?
Philosophizing is a human trait
Created in the mind of man like fate,
And yet the questioning reveals not late
Or soon the answers to the vital state.
You do and I still question, and that will
Continue as long as You come to fill
My lungs with breath of life. I question
still.

But Your decree is safe above the world
As vaults of diamond, ruby, emerald.

14 So taste your due for all that you
Forgot in the day coming true.

And so We've now forgotten you.
Taste the eternal punishment
Because of what you did and meant.

15 Only those believe in Our signs
Who when they're reminded in lines,
Fall down prostrating and in praise
To their Lord, not proud in their ways.

16 They rise up from their beds to pray
Their Lord in fear and in hope's ray,
And give in alms from Our provision
To them *and gain reward's decision*.

17 No eye has seen what treasure's kept
Hidden for them of comfort sweet
As a reward for what they've done.

18 Is someone who's a faithful one
Like one who's a transgressor *Hun*?
They're not the same, *not by a tonne*.

19 Those who believe and do right deeds
Receive gardens where life exceeds
Reward for what they used to do.

20 But as for those who have transgressed,
Their refuge is the fire *unblessed*.
When they try to leave the fire's fold,
They'll be turned back and they'll be told
"Taste punishment of the fire by
Which you once were used to deny."

Hell is a place that's hard to hold in check.
The inmates all want out to rest a speck
From pains and tortures of the fire on neck.

The garden waiting for Your chosen ones
Is quite the opposite, which no one shuns.
It's filled with all delights in tonnes and
tonnes.

The one's an abode for the rich in wreck,
The other's reward for righteous home-
runs.

Beloved, let hells and heavens in this place,
In past and future and the present space
Whirl in their sparkling fires and fair
insights,

But I turn from them all for Your delights.
The knowing of Your oneness is reward
Beyond the flowing nectars and the sword.

21 And surely We will make them taste
The nearer punishment ungraced
Before the greater lash is placed,
So that they may return disgraced.

22 Who is a greater sinner than
One who's reminded of the span
Of his Lord's signs, and disregards?
Our vengeance on their guilt bombards.

23 Surely We gave Moses the book,
"Doubt not that you'll meet Him and look,"
And We made it a guidance to
The folk of Israel in view.

24 Among them We appointed those
Who guide the people as We chose,
When they'd been patient and believed
In Our signs revealed unrelieved.

25 Surely your Lord will judge between
Them on the Day of rising seen
Concerning what they used to split.

26 Does it not dawn on those who sit
How many generations We
Have destroyed before them in glee,
Amid the ruins where they walk?

There are indeed signs there that talk.
Will they not listen, those who balk?

27 Do they not see that We carry
Water to the dry earth freely
And with it We bring forth the crops
Of which they eat, it also drops
Down for their cattle? Don't they see?

28 And they say "When will victory
Come if you're speaking truthfully?"

29 "On the day of the victory
The faithless will have no avail
Of faith then sparked nor will they sail
In any respite from the gale."

30 So turn from them and wait the day.
They too are waiting *for their pay*.

You do just right, Beloved, when You
bring rain,

Not for the human tribe who strive in vain,
But for the gentle cows, the cattle here
That feed upon the hills and without fear.
You do indeed the right, my Dear, when
You

Bring the sweet rains along with sweeter
dew,

And cause the grass to grow that feeds the
cattle,

And makes the straw in stall the calves hear
rattle.

Beloved, the sweet Qur'an rings with Your
word

To feed and nourish all the lowing herd,
And stills the heart to know Your call to
each,

The bulls, the oxen, heifers, cows to preach
To humankind the measure of Your own,
The patience of the hopes in fields alone.

Surah 33 Ahzab, or The Confederates

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 O Prophet! Fear Allah, and do
Not listen to unfaithful crew
Of unbelievers, hypocrites.

Truly Allah there *where He sits*
Is full of knowledge, wisdom's *writs*.

2 But follow that which comes to you
By revelation from your Lord.
For Allah knows well what you do.

3 And trust in Allah *the Adored*,
Allah's sufficient in trust stored.

4 Allah has not made any man
Two hearts in his one body's span,
Nor has He made your wives whom you
Divorce by Zihar mothers true.

Nor has He made your sons adopted
Your true sons for what you have opted.
Such things are just words from your
mouths.

But Allah tells the Truth, He mouths
The way. 5 So you should call them by
Their fathers' names, and so comply
With what's more just in Allah's sight.
And if you do not know their dads,
Then they're your brothers on faith's pads

And your relatives. There will be
 No sin upon you in your fee
 For error that you make in that,
 Unless you're conniving a spat.
 Allah's forgiving, merciful.
 6 The prophet's closer to faithful
 Than their own souls, and his wives are
 Their mothers. The blood relatives
 Are more entitled to what gives
 Inheritance from each the other
 In the Book of Allah than other
 Faithful and emigrants, except
 Any favour you may have kept
 To other friends. This is a thing
 Already in the Torah's ring.

It seems in fact it's happened that a child
 Has been born with two hearts, though that
 is wild.

The Qur'an's word's still valid since the
 thing
 Was one heart outside of the body's ring.
 Divorce by pretence of incest is strange,
 Far stranger than adoption in its range.
 With all the different stings of human life,
 The principle remains through all the strife,
 A child has the right to know and be called
 By name of father as best known and
 walled.

Beloved, You have no father in the world,
 Progenitor in all the stars unfurled,
 And yet You have a loving care for those
 Who might be born in circumstance and
 froze.

7 Remember when We took a pledge
 From the prophets and from your ledge
 And from Noah and Abraham
 And Moses and Jesus *in pram*
 The son of Mary, and We took
 From them a solemn promise, look,
 8 So He may come evaluate
 The truthful of their truthful state.
 And He's prepared the infidel
 A painful punishment *in hell*.
 9 O you who do believe, recall
 Allah's blessing upon you all
 When the armies came for your fall
 And We sent down on them a storm
 And armies invisible swarm.
 And Allah sees best what you do,

Because He keeps all things in view.

And out of dust Ali came with the head
 Of Amar, who after two calls instead
 To accept peace or keep prophet in dread,
 Hamstrung his steed and for further
 bloodshed

Attacked the peaceful Ali. I remain
 In shocked abhorrence of the cruel vein.
 Beloved, the battle of the Ditch is far
 Behind the world today, like distant star,
 And yet I've perched above Madina's
 towers

To see in vision all the distant powers
 In drama before my eye wondering there.
 Beloved the refugees who fled in share
 From out Madina's sweet caress return
 Into the blazing fires, I see them burn.

10 When they came at you from above
 And from below you for the shove,
 And when eyes rolled, hearts were in
 throat,

And you doubted what Allah wrote,
 11 The faithful then and there were tested
 And jolted with shaking and bested.
 12 And when the hypocrites then said
 As well as those with hearts misled,
 "Allah and His messenger fed
 Promised only delusion's bed."

13 And when a group of them then said
 "O folk of Yathrib, no place here
 For you exists, go back and fear."
 And a group of them tried to get
 The prophet to allow them set
 Saying "Our houses lie exposed,"

Although there was no danger posed,
 They only tried to flee when nosed.
 14 Had they been attacked from the side
 And asked to turn and faith deride,
 They would have done so without doubt,
 15 Despite their pledge to Allah's route,
 Before that they would not have fled,
 Well promises to Allah must
 Be kept *even down to the dust*.

16 "Flight will not save you if you flee
 From death or from them wickedly,
 And then you'll only stay at ease
 For just a little while *on knees*."

17 "Who is it that can protect you
 From Allah should He come cause you

Illness or desire to grant you
 Mercy?" They will not find in view
 Defender or helper beside
 Allah alone *in every tide*.
 18 Allah knows who you are to make
 Discouragement, who of you take
 Others to help and then forsake
 After a moment's battle's stake,
 19 Grudging, and so when fear arises,
 You see them looking with surprises,
 Rolling their eyes as though at death
 Fainting *a catching at their breath*.
 Then when the terror's passed they burn
 You with their sharp tongues as they earn
 In greed for wealth. They always spurn.
 So Allah has made their works fail,
 And that's easy for Allah's *sail*.
 20 They think confederates have not
 Withdrawn, and if they should be sought,
 They'd wish they wandered in the plot
 Of Bedouins, and seeking news
 About you, but if they should choose
 To be among you they would fight
 Only a little for what's right.

This fine description of the people who
 Were the companions that the prophet
 knew
 Ought to be guide to make me wise when I
 Hear these fine hypocrites quoted for why.
 The sharp tongues have produced traditions
 rare
 And handed them down to Umayyad share
 By which faith is turned to imperial,
 A second Rome to vie with Byzantine
 And Muscovite for every sip of wine
 Tasted by those sitting beneath the vine
 Madina offered, while the battle raged.
 Beloved, I too sit here and disengaged
 By centuries. I'm waiting to be paged.
 Call out the guided from Kaaba uncaged.

21 You have indeed in Allah's sent
 Apostle a pattern unbent
 For anyone whose hope rests firm
 In Allah and the last day's term,
 Who engage in dhikr as sent
 From Allah. 22 When believers saw
 Confederate forces in awe
 They said "This is what Allah and
 His Apostle said beforehand,

And Allah, His Apostle too
 Only told us what thing was true."
 It only added to their trust
 And zeal in obedience *as must*.
 23 Among believers there are men
 Who fulfil what they've pledged again
 To Allah. Of them there are some
 Who have fulfilled their pledge in sum,
 And of them there are some who wait
 And have not changed at all their fate,
 24 So Allah may reward the true
 For steadfastness in what they do,
 And punish well the hypocrites,
 If He so wishes for their fits
 To accept their repentance *kits*.
 For Allah's Oft-Forgiving and
 Most Merciful *upon the land*.
 25 Allah turned back the infidels
 Despite their anger, for their swells
 They gained nothing, and Allah spared
 The faithful from fighting the rared.
 And Allah's full of strength and He
 To do His will is Almighty.
 26 Those people of the Book who helped
 Them, Allah pulled them down, they
 yelped
 From their fortresses for their hearts
 Filled with terror *from Allah's darts*.
 Some of them you killed and others
 You turned to prisoners *for mothers*.
 27 And He made you heirs of their lands,
 Their houses and their goods in bands,
 And of a land you had not walked,
 Allah has power on all unblocked.
 28 O Prophet! Tell your wives a thing,
 "If you desire life of this spring
 And worldly gloss, then come, I'll make
 Provision for enjoyment's sake
 And set you free in a fine stake.
 29 "But if you seek Allah and His
 Apostle, and abode that is
 In the hereafter, truly He
 Allah has prepared it to be
 For the well-doers great reward.
 30 O wives of the Prophet unscored!
 If any of you're guilty of
 Public unseemly push and shove,
 The punishment is doubled her,
 That's easy for Allah to stir.

To be familiar with the blessed one

Whose prophecy made prophesying done
Made vulnerable to punishment the greater
Since love and knowledge was sin's
mediator.

Who loves and knows is far more guilty
than

The careless, thoughtless, and the ignorant
man.

Oh double then my punishment, my Dear!
And cast me in the furnace, I've no fear!
For I have knit my heart to You for good
And kindled day and night all that I could
For love of You, and so for love and
knowing

My guilt is greater than any guilt going.
I will be punished in the sevenfold fire
And burnt to nothing in Your rash desire.

31 Whoever of you is devout
In serving Allah and with clout
His Apostle striving to do
Righteousness, then to her We do
Grant a double reward, and We
Have prepared her generous fee.

32 O wives of the Prophet! You are
Not like the other women's star,
If you fear Allah, then do not
Be careless in the speech you've wrought,
Lest one whose heart is filled with ill
Should make empty desires fulfil,
But speak always in honour sought.

33 Stay quietly within your homes,
And don't show off your polychromes
As in before-times' ignorance.

Establish prayer and charity,
Obey Allah and the decree
Of His Apostle, and Allah
Only desires to take the crew
Of uncleanness from you, O folk
Of the Household, and at a stroke
Make you pure with a complete soak.
34 Recite the dhikr that's rehearsed
To you in your homes of the versed
Signs of Allah and His wisdom,
Indeed Allah hears all the sum,
Is aware of all, *blessed and cursed*.

The service of remembrance of the laws
Of Moses, the Zabur, and Gospel clause,
Of holy Qur'an, was installed for those
Who were the wives of the prophet in pose.

Beloved, I am no prophet's wife nor one
To whom the revelation came for fun,
But still I come with dhikr of Your names
To seek the burning love of Your hell
flames.

I see the signs and hear the miracles
Recited in the presence of the bulls
Of Bashan and I quietly retreat
To whirling and reciting in the street,
A mumbled share that those I hap to meet
May disregard, taking note of no feat.

35 For Muslim men and women, and
Believing men and women stand,
For pious men and women too,
For men and women who are true,
For men and women patient and
The persevering where they stand,
For men and women humbly due,
For men and women who give alms,
For men and women without qualms
Who fast, for men and women who
Guard chastity, and for the crew
Of men and women who greatly
Praise God, for them is God's decree:
Forgiveness and reward greatly.

36 It's not right a believer man
Or woman, when by Allah's plan
And that of His messenger's span,
Should have a choice in their deciding.
If any one disobeys God

And His sent one the way he trod,
He's in the wrong path without prod.
37 See, You said to one who had got
The grace of God, your favour sought,
"Keep your wife and fear Allah's plot."
But you hid in your heart the thing
That God was about to give wing.
You feared the folk, but it's fitting
You should fear God more in fearing.
Then when Zaid had divorced her and
With the formal divorced as planned,
We joined her in marriage to you,
So there may be no troubles stew
For the believers when they take
The wives of adopted sons' stake
For wives, after their own divorce,
And formally agreed, of course.
God's command must be in full force.

38 There can be no difficulty
To the Prophet in what God's plea

Has shown to him as a duty.
 It was the practice God ordained
 Among those anciently unstained.
 And the command of God is sure,
 Decree determined to be pure.
 39 Such will proclaim God's messages,
 And fear Him and fear none that is
 Not God. God truly suffices
 To call to an account for biz.
 40 Muhammad's not the father of
 Any of your men found above,
 But he's Allah's messenger and
 The last of the prophets at hand.
 And Allah knows all things *that stand*.

Muhammad is no father of a man,
 But of a boy and woman, no one can
 Blame either for the straits of humankind,
 Contortions of benighted pagan mind.
 He is the one You sent at last to last
 Till times of prophets in this world have
 passed.
 He seals the prophecy of each book sent
 Before him and confirms it true and spent.
 Let me lay hold on seal and safe and store
 And hear their words and speech and what
 is more
 Fulfil in whirling deed each burning word
 That day to day my trembling heart has
 stirred.
 Seal up the book, so only those may read
 Who understand what's sealed and then
 take heed.

41 O you believers, celebrate
 The praises of Allah in state.
 42 And glorify Him morn and night.
 43 He sends His blessings on your sight,
 As do His angels, that He may
 Bring you from darkened depths to stay
 In light. He's full of mercy to
 The ones who believe in the true.
 44 Their greeting on the day they meet
 Him will be "Peace!" Abundant treat
 He has prepared for them *to eat*.
 45 O Prophet, truly We have sent
 You as a witness, and have lent
 You the good news to bear and warn.
 47 So give the good news without scorn
 To the believers, so they'll get
 From God a great abundance set.

48 Do not obey the hopes of those
 Who do not believe and in rows
 The hypocrites, and take no note
 Of their annoyances at throat,
 But put your trust in God alone.
 God is well able to atone.

The promise of a heaven is beyond
 What I desire, my heart's not quickly
 conned.
 I joy enough in meadow leaf and frond
 Of fern beneath the canopy waylaid
 Within the Puijo forest's welcome shade.
 I need no heaven beyond what You have
 made
 Of earth for me. And yet I'd not be stayed.
 I'm in minority upon the dust
 To be satisfied with the bread in crust,
 Or even to have such a crust to taste
 Among the wealthy ones who have to
 waste.
 Beloved, give my reward of heaven if there
 Is anything to fall into my share
 To one who has had to live on earth bare.

49 O you believers, when you marry
 Believing women, then are chary,
 Divorcing them before you've touched,
 No period of waiting unclutched
 Is necessary. Give a gift
 And set them free with pretty rift.
 50 O Prophet, We've made legal to
 You your wives when you've paid their due
 In dowry, and those your right hand
 Possesses of the prisoners' band
 From war that God's assigned to you,
 And daughters of your father's crew
 Of aunts and uncles, and the daughters
 Of your mothers' uncles and waters
 Of aunts, who migrated with you,
 And any believing wench who
 Consecrates herself to the due
 Of the prophet if prophet too
 Wishes to wed her. This is just
 For you, and not believers trust.
 We know what We've ordained for them
 As to their wives and captives' hem
 Whom their right hand possess in gem,
 So that no difficulty rise
 For you. And God does not despise
 To be forgiving in His guise,

Most merciful not to condemn.
 51 You may turn back any You will,
 You may receive to fit the bill
 Any You wish, and there's no blame
 On You if You invite the same
 That You had set aside before.
 This would be near to cool their eyes,
 Assuaging their grieving in guise,
 And to be satisfied each one
 With what You've given them when done.
 God knows what's in your hearts and God
 Knows all things, is patient in prod.
 52 It is not legal you should take
 More wives after this and in wake,
 Nor to exchange them for some more,
 Despite the beauty of a score,
 Except such as your right hand's got,
 And Allah watches every plot.

The Christ is qualified or not to be
 A celibate in a Jewish country
 Where every male is married to a wench
 As soon as he can leave his mother's bench.
 Some do intend to say the man was married
 To one or more with concubines that
 tarried.

But every action of the Christ or him
 Sent after into this world's wicked grim
 Must hear the criticism people make,
 Who are here just to leach out a mistake.
 Beloved, I love the Christ who had no wife,
 I love him still if several in his life
 Shared board and bed, and if Muhammad
 came
 With many, I attribute him no blame.

53 O you believers, do not go
 Into the prophet's houses row
 Until permission's granted you,
 For a meal or to wait its brew.
 But when you are invited, come,
 And when you've eaten get out from
 The place without familiar talk.
 Such action annoys Prophet's stock.
 He is ashamed to make you leave,
 But God's not ashamed to conceive
 To tell the truth. And when you ask
 For anything you want, your task
 Is to ask from before a screen.
 That makes for purity unseen
 In your hearts and for theirs to bask.

Nor is it good for you to come
 Annoying God's sent one for some,
 Or that you marry his wives left
 As widows after him bereft.
 Indeed such is in Allah's sight
 A great enormity and fright.
 54 Whether you show a thing or hide,
 God's knowledge of all will abide.
 55 There is no blame to come before
 Their fathers or their sons in store,
 Their brothers or their brother's sons,
 Or sisters' sons, or women's runs,
 Or those whom their right hands have got.
 Fear God, for God sees all the plot.
 56 God and His angels come to bless
 The prophet. O believers met,
 Send blessings on him and greet him
 With all respect and treat him trim.
 57 Those who bother God and the one
 He's sent, God's cursed them when He's
 done
 In this world and in the hereafter,
 Preparing them in shameful laughter
 The punishment that they have won.

Respect is due to the ones that You sent,
 But see how few there are of those present
 Who show regard and equally for those
 Prophets with warning to be on their toes.
 One choses his own favorite to dispose
 The others with a shrug or even more,
 The claim that devils have increased their
 store.

Sectarian response to You who're one
 Must be within Your will when things are
 done.

No doubt it syphons off the wicked herd
 And leaves the two or three with voice of
 bird

To share remembrance of Your lovely
 names

Before the world in blessings and in flames
 Of love to You with faithful hearts astirred.

58 Those who bother believing men
 And women unjustly again
 Bear shame and wickedness in tonne.

Not only prophets are due their respect,
 But also the believers who neglect
 The offices of worldly power and wealth

Ought to be dealt with justly, not with
stealth.

If prophets go without regard, how can
Believers living simply in their span
Expect a better lot from those who scan?
No doubt the rate that's to berate is great.
Beloved, I feel it falling on my pate,
Though I'm a doubter and no doubt deserve
No deference from any, those who swerve
And those who faithfully live in Your
curve.

I miss the temple of idols and still
Stand at mosque door collecting shoes and
swill.

59 O Prophet, tell your wives as well
As daughters, and believing swell
Of women that they ought to put
Their outer clothing on from foot.
It's more convenient they be known
And not molested when alone.
And God's forgiving, merciful.
60 Indeed, if hypocrites with full
Diseased hearts and those who arouse
Rebellion in town to carouse,
Do not stop, We'll stir you on them.
Then they cannot when you condemn
Stay in it long as neighbours' hem.
61 They shall be cursed no matter where,
Be seized and killed not to forbear.
62 So God acted in ancient times.
No chance God will excuse their crimes.

It is a quandary in Sodom's town,
Whether the wives and wenches of renown
Should not disguise themselves in hopes
degree
Of status would preserve them from the
spree
Of harsh harassment, or if rather men
Would be more likely to leave them free
when

They went incognito about the glen.
Myself, I keep the lower profile best,
And think that better than once to invest
In body guards. There was one that asked
me

For such a job. My bank account just
laughed

When I suggested any sort of draft.
Protection for myself and for my wife

Is in You only, in both peace and strife.

63 Men ask you all about the hour.
Say "God only knows and has power."
What is there that will make you know
The hour might be ready to show.
64 Indeed Allah's cursed unbelievers,
Prepared them blazing fire *for cleavers*.
65 For them to stay there finally,
With no guard or helper in fee.
66 The day their faces will be turned
Upside down in the fire and burned,
They'll say "Woe to us, oh that we
Had obeyed God, sent one's decree!"
67 And they'd say "Our Lord, We obeyed
Our chiefs and our great rulers stayed,
And they misled us on the path.
68 "Our Lord, give them in double wrath
And curse them with a greater curse!"
69 O you believers, don't be worse
Than those who troubled Moses while
God cleared his name of any guile
That they had spoken. He was great
In honour before Allah's state.

The war trials might have been redundant if
The criminals had read Qur'an in skiff
And then kept to its law with a lip stiff.
They might have thought responsibility
Belongs to every man and woman free.
They might have thought no excuse would
be right

To say they just obeyed orders of wight
Set over them in some authority.
The SS was a voluntary thing,
So orders all revert to source and spring.
Beloved, let me take orders from You first
And last and let the governments be cursed
And blast usurpers from the throne where
still
Your hidden one and guided fits the bill.

70 O you believers, fear Allah,
And say a word always in awe.
71 Then He may make your conduct right
And sound and forgive you in sight
For your sins. He who obeys God
And His Messenger, has in pod
Highest achievement *on the sod*.
72 We offered the trust to the sky
And to the earth, mountains to vie,

But they refused to bear the task
 In fear, but man failing to ask
 Took it up, unjust, foolish mask,
 73 So God must punish hypocrites,
 Both men and women in their writs,
 And unbelieving man and wench,
 While God turns to believers' bench
 With mercy on both man and wife.
 God's oft-forgiving without strife,
 Most merciful *to give us life*.

It is a hidden duty that seems great,
 Obedience to Your messenger in fate.
 Fact is obedience to You alone
 Makes me obedient to all from Your
 throne,
 The prophet of Islam and Moses too,
 And Christ beloved of me though without
 pew
 Among the Christian sort of hopeful crew.
 You send the word as though two duties
 rise,
 The duty to You and the one in guise
 Of your sent one. I take the book in hand
 That describes both laws that I understand
 That You for ever and now still command.
 Beloved, obedience is easy where
 So simple a thing is my daily fare.

Surah 34 Saba or Sheba

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 Praise be to God to whom belong
 All in both heaven and earthly *song*,
 To Him be praise in world to come,
 He's full of wisdom, knows the sum
 Of all things *both the right and wrong*.
 2 He knows all who go down to earth,
 And all that comes from it of worth,
 All that comes down from heaven above
 And all that goes up *reaching love*,
 And He's most merciful to be
 The oft-forgiving *by decree*.
 3 The unbelievers say "To us
 Will never come the hour to fuss."
 Say "No, but truly by my Lord,
 I will come on you as abhorred,
 By Him who knows the unseen thing,
 From whom's not hidden anything
 In heaven or earth of atom's weight,
 Nor anything less or the great,
 But is in the record of fate.

4 "So He may reward those in state
 Of faith and work deeds right *and great*,
 For such is forgiveness and store
 Abundant *on rewarding shore*."
 5 But those who struggle against Our
 Signs to frustrate them without power,
 For such will be a penalty,
 A punishment that all will see.
 6 And those to whom knowledge has come
 See what's sent down to you to hum
 From your Lord, that is truth, and that
 It guides to the path high and flat,
 Worthy of all praise *in its sum*.

Doubt of accountability is foolish,
 When men themselves by nature are so
 ghoulish
 To hold all to account who have harmed
 them,
 And take in their vengeance in stratagem.
 Those who deny Your judgement on the
 earth
 In hopes of keeping their oppression's
 worth
 Of gain throughout eternity on spot,
 Will someday be surprised with what
 they've got.

Beloved, the future is unknown to me,
 A doubting Thomas in my doubt's decree,
 And yet I trust that You are just in all
 You do in heaven and on the earthly ball.
 Let justice and mercy among the show
 Return upon the evening and its glow.

7 The unbelievers say "Shall we
 Point out to you a man *in spe*
 To tell you, when you're scattered round
 Dispersed, that you'll be raised and sound
 A new creation on the ground?
 8 "Has he invented against God
 A lie, or has a spirit's rod?"
 No, those who do not believe in
 The hereafter, they're in the bin
 Of penalty and farthest sin.
 9 Do they not see what's before them
 And what's behind them of the hem
 Of sky and earth? If We so wished,
 We could make earth swallow them
 splished
 Or make some of the sky fall on.
 Indeed in this is a sign's dawn

For every worshipper who turns
 To God *away from one who spurns*.
 10 We granted grace before upon
 David from us. "O mountains drawn,
 Sing back the praise of God he laid
 In songs, you birds too. And We made
 The iron soft for him as he drayed.
 11 "Make coats of mail, balanced in rings
 Of armour chain, so do good things,
 For I see all you do *unstayed*."

The very birds sing David's songs, and so
 If every man forgot to meet the glow
 Of dawn and dusk with Psalms upon the
 lips,
 They still should be heard from the sailing
 ships
 Beneath the sea-gulls, and in field and
 wood
 Where every wren's and sparrow's
 prophethood
 Is shared with sun and leaf and dew and
 foil
 Of life beginning from the magic soil.
 Beloved, I join with David's song's delight,
 Like some old dervish in Damascus' night,
 And follow the sweet Hebrew sounds to
 sing
 My hours and days and years beneath the
 wing
 Of fellow quire. Beloved, I join my sleep
 With David's words and wake his words to
 keep.

12 To Solomon the wind came down.
 Its early morning step from town
 Was a month's length, and evening bound
 Was a month's too. And We made then
 A font of molten brass in trim
 To flow for him. And there were found
 In front of him jinns who like men
 Worked at his behest at the limb
 Of his Lord, and if any turned
 Back from Our command, of the burned
 In blazing fire of pain he learned.
 13 They worked for him as he desired,
 Arches, images basins hired
 As large as lakes, and cooking pots
 Set firmly. "Work in David's lot
 With gratitude! But few of My
 Servants are grateful *by and by*."

14 Then when We had decreed his death,
 Nothing showed them his death in breath
 But a small worm of the earth which
 Was gnawing out his staff in pitch.
 So when he fell, the jinns saw well
 That if they'd know the unseen fell,
 They would not have stayed in the way
 Of working so hard in shame's pay.

The small worm eats at staff of life that
 holds
 Each man on earth. The silvers and the
 golds
 Are merest tinsel in the breath of life.
 The calm is outermost around the strife.
 The small worm eats the staff of loyalty,
 The rod of power, the base humility,
 And of a sudden darkness covers light,
 And every soul sinks down into the night.
 Beloved, the worm that silently in threat
 Adorns the secret places where I've met
 The hopes and jeers of meagre melody
 May well devour the wooden-coated me.
 But no worm can destroy the coming cloud
 Of judgement where alone You are
 allowed.

15 There was for Sheba in times past
 A sign in their homeland to last,
 Two gardens one to right and left.
 "Eat of provisions unbereft
 From your Lord, and give thanks to Him,
 A plot of beauty in the whim
 Of happiness, and a Lord who
 Is oft-forgiving to the crew."
 16 But they turned back and We sent on
 Them the flood from the dams out-drawn,
 And We made those two gardens be
 Producers of bitter fruit's fee,
 And tamarisks and small lote-tree.
 17 That was the recompense that We
 Gave them because ungratefully
 They had rejected faith. So We
 Never give recompense' decree
 Except to ungrateful in spree.
 18 Between them and the town where We
 Poured out Our blessings, We had placed
 Cities in high positions spaced,
 And so between them We had set
 The stages of the journey met
 In due proportion. "Travel there

And be safe by night and day's share.”
 19 But they said “Our Lord, put more space
 Between our journey stages race.”
 But they wrong themselves in that thing.
 At last We made them as the ring
 Of a tale told, and We dispersed
 Them all in scattered pieces *cursed*.
 Truly in this are signs for each
 Who's patient in thanksgiving's reach.
 20 On them did Satan show his wiles
 And they followed him in their miles,
 All but a band not caught in guiles.
 21 But he had no power over them,
 Except We might test the man's hem
 Who believes in hereafter's gem,
 Distinguishing him from the bum
 Who doubts the coming day in sum.
 Your Lord guards all things in the hum.

The power of Satan's limited to show
 The strengths and weaknesses of human
 row,
 To test the ones who believe in the glow
 Of the hereafter and distinguish them
 From every tinsel and falsified gem.
 The power of Satan extends to no place
 Of temptation beyond the human race
 Upon the path of mercy, divine grace.
 Beloved, I turn from power to mercy's view
 And find in every turn I confront You,
 And as I turn from You to You I find
 My whirling on the sands You have
 assigned,
 And so I whirl beyond both star and moon,
 Beyond the blazing sun on blazing noon.

22 Say “Call on others as you choose,
 Besides God, who've no power to use,
 No atom's weight in heaven or earth.
 They have no share of any worth,
 None is God's helper in his berth.
 23 “No intercession can help them
 Before Him, except hardy stem
 Of those to whom He gives the leave.
 At least when terror leaves their sleeve
 They'll say 'What does your Lord
 command?’
 They'll say 'What's true and just at hand,
 And He's most high and great to stand.’”
 24 Say “Who gives you your nourishment
 From sky and earth when it is sent?”

Say “It is God, and sure it be
 That either you or either we
 Are rightly guided or astray
 In error apparent to sway.”
 25 Say “You'll not be questioned about
 Our sins, nor shall we meet in doubt
 Questions of what you carry out.”
 26 Say “Our Lord will gather us and
 Will at last make the matter stand
 Between us in truth and as just.
 He will decide, He's one to trust
 Who knows all things *upon the dust*.”
 27 Say “Show me those that you have
 joined
 With Him as partners and purloined,
 There is no way you can. No, He
 Is God, high in power, wise to be.”
 28 We've only sent you out to be
 One to all men with good news free,
 And warning them, most do not see.

The faith of this world is the faith of power,
 And every church stands up to have its
 hour,
 And yet the idols that in marble shriek
 And icons that the painter's crafts make
 bleak
 Are powerless on the coming judgement
 day,
 Although now they seem to pay their own
 way.
 Idols are always tempting at the bone
 Because of contribution to the throne.
 Beloved, I find the pop song and break-
 dance
 Of the cathedral and the mosque advance
 Before the crowd and hold a light and lance
 Until the people bow in loving stance.
 Beloved, I turn away from where I prance
 And hide my eyes from every livid glance.

29 They say “When will this promise be,
 If you are speaking truthfully?”
 Say “Rendez-vous for you is set
 Upon a day which must be met
 Not delayed not moved up to get.”
 31 The unbelievers say “We'll not
 Believe in this scripture unsought
 Nor in what came before it taught.”
 If you could just see when those who
 Do evil have to stand in crew

Before their Lord, casting the blame
 On one another in their shame!
 Those who had been despised will say
 To the arrogant ones that day,
 "If it had never been for you,
 We'd have been of believers too."
 32 The proudful then will say to those
 Whom they despised set in their rows,
 "Did we keep you back from the true
 Guidance after it had reached you?
 No, it was you transgressed in view."
 33 Those who had been despised will say
 To the arrogant ones in sway,
 "No it was your plot night and day.
 See, you told us to be without
 Right gratitude to God and shout
 Equals to Him." They will declare
 Repentance seeing painful share.
 We'll put yokes on infidels' necks,
 It's what they get for their deeds' pecks.

It truly looks as though the faith in gods
 In human form: the presidents and sods
 In parliaments, the tyrants, and those who
 Control the money that stays out of view,
 Blinds populace and binds them in their
 pew.

So there's a reason for the accusation
 In judgement that the leaders of the nation
 Are those responsible for their hell's ration.
 Beloved, it's all excuse. Each worthy man
 And woman chooses hell by her own plan.
 I too choose hell, unless You by decree
 Lay grace upon my heart and hand's
 degree.

I choose it with eyes open and freely,
 Unless, Beloved, You have mercy on me.

34 We never sent a warner to
 A folk, but the wealthy in crew
 Said "We will not believe the true
 With which you have been sent in view."
 35 They said "We have more in our wealth
 And in our children, not with stealth
 Can we be punished *in our health*."
 36 Say "Truly my Lord broadens and
 Restricts provision in the land
 To whom He wills, most folk in hand
 Fail truly here to understand."
 37 It's not your wealth or children that
 Will bring you near to Us on mat,

But only those who believe and
 Work righteousness, these ones shall stand
 In their reward abundantly,
 In the dwellings on high safely.
 38 Those who struggle against Our signs,
 To frustrate them in their designs
 Will be thrown in their pains' repines.

Beloved, You have not been a man, so You
 Do not know how things feel here in my
 pew:

It is wealth and offspring that make a man
 Come close to You through prayer and
 sacrifice,
 Come to church, synagogue, or then to scan
 The mosque and tekke or the temple's plan.
 Those social places all require both wealth
 And ostentation, let me say with stealth.
 Beloved, You have been present on the
 earth

In the eyes and ears of those who by birth
 Were sent to represent Your laws and
 ways.

You have seen how we people spend our
 days.

And yet You set aside the prayers we raise
 In praise of the things we've acquired of
 worth.

39 Say "Truly my Lord broadens and
 Restricts the nourishment in land
 To those of His servants command
 As He pleases, and nothing do
 You spend in the least or a few
 But He will give it back to you.
 For He's the best of those who grant
 The nourishment *of cow and plant*.

40 One day He'll gather all of them,
 And say to the angels, "Condemn,
 Was it you these men used to take
 To worship for their sinful sake?"

41 They'll say "Glory to You, with You
 Is our guidance-protection's view
 And not with them. No, but they came
 To worship the jinns in their blame,
 Most of them believe in their claim."

42 So on that day no power shall they
 Have over one another's sway
 For benefit or in harm's way.
 And We'll say to wrong-doers then,
 "Taste penalty of fire again,

That you used to deny and when.”
 43 When Our clear signs recited be
 To them, they say “This is only
 A man who want to hinder you
 From what your ancestors held true.”
 And they say “This is just a lie
 Invented.” Unbelievers say
 Of the truth when it comes their way,
 “This is just magic clear in sway.”

It seems deniers in the past believed
 In magic among the long and short-sleeved.
 Today it's more religious folk who think
 That magic is a danger on the brink.
 The signs You sent may have been vivid
 then,
 And so You've toned them down for
 modern men.
 It seems deniers in times past laid claim
 On what traditions taught them not to
 blame.
 Today it's more to deny the past faith,
 Than to cling to the dogmas of a wraith.
 When men find reasons to scoff at Your
 will,
 Just anything it seems will fit the bill,
 And opposites suffice to climb the hill.
 Any denial does, it's just the same.

44 But We had not given them books
 To study, nor sent down for looks
 The messengers to them before
 You as warners in a great store.
 45 Their predecessors did reject
 And these have not received select
 Of what We'd granted to those, yet
 When they rejected sent ones met,
 How awful was My action let.
 46 Say “I chide you on one point set,
 You stand up before Allah met,
 In pairs or singly and reflect,
 Your fellow's not possessed, neglect,
 He's no less warner to you sent,
 In face of awful punishment.”
 47 Say “No reward I ask of you,
 It's in your interest what I do.
 My payment's only from God due.
 He's witness to all things in view.”
 48 Say “Truly my Lord casts the truth,
 He has full knowledge of the youth
 And old in what they hide in ruth.”

49 Say “Truth has come and falsehood
 makes
 Nothing new nor restores the takes.”
 Say “If I am astray, I'm just
 Astray to my own soul's lost dust.
 But if I get guidance, it's come
 Because of inspiration's sum
 Of my Lord to me. It is He
 Who hears all things far and nearly.”
 51 If you could see when they will shake
 In terror, but then there will take
 No way of escape, and they'll be
 Seized where they happen then to see.
 52 And they'll say “We believe it too.”
 But how could they receive from pew
 So far away in what they do?
 53 Since they rejected faith before,
 And cast reproach on unseen store
 For far off where they were before?
 54 Between them and their wishes there
 Is placed a barrier as share
 Done in the past with parties fair.
 For they were in suspicion there
 And in doubt *and without a care*.

To some You give a book, while others
 stand
 Beneath the judgement of the sent one's
 hand
 That You have given every folk in time,
 A warning stated in both prose and rhyme,
 But rarely left in a book's written clime.
 Those who receive the book and those who
 stay
 Within the oral pale for time of day
 Both know to reject all the things You say,
 Or else incorporate a part to be
 Included in oppression's minstrelsy.
 So were born state religions that still keep
 Stability on earth, while faithful sleep
 Without awareness of satanic power
 That fills the earth with temples in an hour.

Surah 35, Suratul Fatir, or The Originator

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 Praise be to God who has created
 The heavens and the earth instated,
 Who makes the angels sent with wings,
 Two, three, or four pairs as He flings,
 Adding to the creation bound

All that He pleases on the ground,
For God has power on all things.

The kinds of angels described in the books
Turn here and there for different kinds of
looks.

The seraphim and cherubim I find
Within the Bible pages are in kind
With those here who have wings spread
under vined

And golden canopies of the refined.
Let wings be in their pairs on every day
And in the glistening light that comes to
play

On two or four or eight set in array.
But mostly where I sit to watch them come
The angels twitter with two wings in sum,
All coloured gray and brown and black and
white,

And red and green and blue under sun
bright.

They sing and fly about and then alight.

2 What God in His mercy bestows
On humankind none can oppose.
What He withholds no one can grant
Except He does. He's high to plant
His power and wisdom as He chose.

3 O humankind, remember well
The grace of God to you a spell.
Is there creator other than
God to give you nurture in plan
From heaven or earth? There is no god
But He. How then upon the sod
Are you drawn in delusions way
Far from the truth *that is in sway*?

4 If they reject you, so did they
Reject the messengers in sway
Before you. Let God come repay
Deciding all affairs one day.

5 O humankind, the promise true
Of God! Let not present ado
Deceive you, nor let arch-fiend's cue
Deceive you about God in view.

6 Indeed Satan's a foe to you,
So treat him as an enemy.
He only invites his degree
To be companions in the spree
Of flaming fire *eternally*.

The reasoning is circular if fine:

There is nowhere creator on the vine
But the Creator, and that's left as proof
That You exist, Beloved, perhaps a spoof.
The reasoning is circular, but still
The fact is that reality does fill
The universe, which means that is is,
And nothing is not but the not in quiz.
Beloved, I let none now deceive me more
About You, whether You are at the door
Or at the jugular like robbers who
Catch people for their pocketbooks in view.
I fail to believe every theory true
Or false, but only take the very You.

7 For those rejecting God there comes
An awful penalty in sums,
But for those who believe and do
Righteous deeds, is forgiveness true
And a reward abundant too.

8 Is the one who is pleased by wrong
So that he considers the song
To be good, held equal along?
For God lets stray the ones He wills,
And guides aright the ones He wills.
So do not let yourself be grieved
With sighing for the unreprieved.
For God knows well all that they do.

9 It is God who sends out in view
The winds, so they raise clouds in dew,
And We drive them into a land
That's parched, and revive the earth's sand
After its death of dearth. Just so
Will be the resurrection's show.
10 If any look for glory's power,
To God belongs all glory's power.
To Him rise up the pure words' hour.
He raises up each righteous deed.
They who connive in wicked greed,
For them's an awful pain indeed,
And plotting will be vain in seed.

Though some may read the words that
those who do
The righteous deeds will be taken into
The paradise, and so think anyone
Can choose to do what may need to be
done
To wake up in all glory for the fun.
But You own all the glory and its power,
And none can take them from You for an
hour.

And You raise up each righteous deed by
name,
And not the human being in the game.
Beloved, there are no righteous deeds but
Yours,
And You're the one who comes to us and
pours
Them on the human heart and hand and
sight.
You are both will and power to do the
right,
And only You before the human flight.

11 And God created you from dust,
Then from a sperm drop and in trust
He made you in pairs. No female
Conceives or gives birth in avail
But with His knowledge. Nor is man
Of long life granted days in span,
Nor is a part cut off from life,
But by decree ordained from strife.
All this is easy in God's way.
12 The two streams of the water are
Not alike: the one's sweet by far,
And good to drink, the other salt
And bitter. Yet from each in fault
You eat the tender meat and fresh,
You take up the pearls in your mesh
To wear. And you see ships abroad
That cleave the waves, so you may prod
Out bounties, grateful then to God.
13 He blends the night into the day,
And he blends day into night's sway,
And he's put the sun and the moon
Into subjection and right soon,
Each one runs its appointed boon.
Such is God your Lord, His is all
Dominion. Those on whom you call
Besides Him have no power at all.
14 If you call on them, they'll not hear
Your call, and if they listen dear,
They cannot give answer to prayer.
On judgement day they'll not take share
In partnership you'd give them there.
And none can tell you like the One
Who knows all things when things are
done.

The sun and moon run in appointed boon
And look down on the earth by night and
noon,

Obedient to the commands that come soon
From Your creating hand and heart a-doan.
Some look to sun and moon for their
command
Of love and art to rest upon the sand.
But the true know that only You reveal
The times upon the raging potter's wheel.
Beloved, I turn from calendars of late,
From every sort of Roman hate and fate,
And link my lines among the weekly rate.
No moon or star tells me to come to You
In prostration of myself in Your view,
In gathering with others in the pew.

15 O humankind, you need Allah,
But God is One free of all straw
Of wants. He deserves praise in awe.
16 If He wanted, He could blot you
Out and bring a new life in view.
17 Nor is that hard for God to do.
18 No bearer of loads can take on
Another's load if heavy drawn
He called another to his load.
Not the least of it can be hoed,
Even by a near relative.
All you can do is warn to live
In fear of their Lord who's unseen
And kept up daily prayers and keen.
Whoever purifies himself,
Does so for his own good and shelf.
The end of all is to God's scene.

Beloved, You can destroy a man and bring
New life upon the earth to praise and sing,
And nothing is too hard for Your doing.
But I can only warn others to live
In fear of You, unseen in earthly sieve,
And bow in prayer from day to day and yet
Keep myself pure from every sinful set,
And know the end of all is what You get.
Beloved, the heart of man would be
perverse
Always in his desire here to reverse
The roles and be a great, shining destroyer
And maker and controller and employer
Of lives in multitude. Let me return
From my creating to the power to learn.

19 The blind and seeing are not same.
20 Nor are dark depths like lightened
flame.

21 Nor are shade and heat of sun same.
22 Nor are they alike who're alive
And those who are dead *not to jive*.
Allah can make any He will
To hear, but you can't fill the bill
To make them hear who're in the graves.
23 You're just a warner *sent to slaves*.

Those who rest in the graves hear not the
words
Spoken above them in condemning herds,
In rue and desolation and complaint,
Or even consolation of the saint.
The dead in soil or in the soil of sin
Hear neither warning nor the call to win.
They cannot rise again to meet the dawn
With faith or life who lie beneath the lawn.
Beloved, You only can speak such a word
That dead in flesh or sins may undeterred
Hear and obey, arising from the deep,
To shake away the lethargy and sleep.
Speak if You will, or hold Your royal
tongue,
But then be satisfied with what is sung.

24 We've sent you in truth one to bring
Good news, and as a warner sing,
And there was never a folk yet
Without a warner having met
Among them living and to let.
25 If they reject you, so did those
Who came before them in their rows,
To whom came sent ones with clear signs,
Books of dark prophecies' designs,
And book enlightening *inclines*.
26 In the end I punished those who
Rejected faith with awful rue.

The prophet can speak aloud what You
will,
But no one will hear or come to fulfil
Unless You give them grace upon their hill,
The grace of fair repentance from the swill
Of idol worship of each kind at hand,
From all the institutions in the land.
The books You send at prophets' hands
abound
In warnings clear as well as omen's sound
In darker sayings and ambiguous.
Your punishment comes down in awful
fuss

On those who ignore the clear signs that
bring
The soul into the right path where to sing.
I flee to You and beg Your grace a while
To come before Your face and without
guile.

27 Do you not see Allah send down
Rain from the sky *upon the town*?
By it We then cause to produce
The varied-coloured things unloose.
And in the mountains there are ways
Of white and red in varied praise,
And black in saturated craze.
28 Among men, creepers, and the cattle,
They are diversified *for battle*.
Those fear God of His servants made
Who have the knowledge *He has laid*.
For God's exalted in His might,
And oft-forgiving every slight.
29 Those who God's book come to recite,
Establish daily prayer with might,
And give out of what We've provided,
Both secretly and open-sided,
Hope for returns that will not fail.
30 For He'll pay them their salary,
No, He'll give more from His bounty.
For He is oft-forgiving and
Ready appreciating stand.

Let me recite, Beloved, the book You sent
Both day and night and let my voice
prevent
The rising sun, at least in wintertime,
Since I live in the sort of northern clime
Where You send summer on the night so
fast
That darkness never rises to the mast.
Beloved, let me recite Your book and know
The glories of the rain as well as snow,
The mountain's colours red and white and
tan,
The rocky slopes in purple-lighted span,
As well as the dark firs and purpled pines,
The birchen grace and tiny vetch in vines.
Beloved, as I recite Your book let me
Enter into gloried eternity.

31 What We've revealed you of the book
Is true, confirming if you look
What came before it. God knows well

And sees what His servants dispel.
 32 We've granted the book in heir to
 Our servants as We've chosen to.
 But there are some among them too
 Who wrong their own souls from the view.
 There are some who take middle view.
 And finally there are some found
 Who are by God's leave on the ground
 Of being best in good deeds round.
 That is the highest grace *that's found*.
 33 The gardens of eternity
 They'll enter and wear the beauty
 Of golden bracelets and pearls too.
 Their clothing will be silken new.
 And they will say "Praise then be to
 God who has taken from us grief."
 For our Lord's oft-forgiving, lief
 To give appreciation's feoff.

If You confirm the book before Qur'an,
 The Bible as it stood in hand at dawn
 When good Muhammad spoke these words
 outdrawn,
 Then the Qur'an falls with the Bible when
 The Bible is destroyed by wicked men,
 Historical criticism again,
 And ignorance or sheer ignoring what
 The good Book would command to be
 unshut.
 Beloved, there is no logic in my view
 In taking one book to reject anew
 The other. Both agree in what to do,
 And so in that agreement both must fail,
 Or both must stand in glory to prevail.
 I read their words of warning and I quale.

35 "He has out of His bounty's store,
 Settled us in a refuge more,
 Where no toil's weariness in store."
 36 But those who reject, for them there
 Will be the fire of hell in share.
 No end will be appointed them
 To die or penalty from hem
 Be lightened. So We do reward
 Each ungrateful one *with the sword*.
 37 There will they weep and cry for help:
 "Our Lord, bring us out like a whelp.
 We promise to work righteousness
 And not as we used to address.
 Did We not give you long life's view
 Enough to get the warning too?"

And the warner did come to you.
 So taste it, there will be no help
 For the wrong-doer and his whelp."
 38 God knows the hidden things above
 In heaven and on the earth in shove.
 He has full knowledge of all things
 That are in human hearts and wings.

You know with perfect knowledge what
 appears
 In heaven above and in the earthly fears.
 You are aware of every measurement,
 Each angle that the angels may present,
 The form of being and the coloured fray
 Of cosmic night and the eternal day.
 The scent of truth, the feel of gushing rain,
 All things from You are hidden once in
 vain.

Beloved, I see the market and the march,
 The buttresses, the gargoyles, every arch,
 And find that stone recedes before my eye,
 And human sense and subject flash and try
 To be and are not with the passing years.
 I restlessly turn, touch and tend my gears.

39 He's made you heirs upon the earth.
 Then if any reject that worth,
 They work against themselves in berth.
 Their rejection just adds to hate
 Of unbelievers in their state
 Before their Lord's sight and not late.
 Their own rejectings only add
 To the destruction they'll have had.
 40 Say "Have you seen the partners you
 Call on besides the one God true?
 Show Me what they've created in
 The earth and in its spreading bin.
 Or do they have share in the skies?
 Or have We given them a book wise
 From which they bring proof in its guise?
 No, what wrong-doers promise each
 Other's nothing, delusion's reach.
 41 God sustains both the heavens and earth,
 Lest they cease to perform in berth,
 And if they should fail, there is none,
 No single being or band won,
 Who can support them after that.
 He's most forbearing and out flat
 Most oft-forgiving of all done.
 They swore their greatest oaths by God
 That if a warner hit their sod,

They'd follow his guidance before
 Any other fold on the shore.
 But when a warner came to them,
 It's only given more to condemn
 As they retreat from good in hem,
 43 Because their arrogant ways in
 The land and their plotting of sin,
 But plotting wickedness will just
 Corral the doers of such dust.
 Are they just looking for the way
 The ancient peoples lost their sway?
 But you'll find no change in the way
 Of God, not turning back will you
 Find in God's way, it's always true.
 44 Don't they go travelling through the
 earth
 To see what's come on those of worth
 Before them, though they were the better
 Of them in strength and every letter?
 Nor is God stopped by anything
 In heaven or on the earth to spring.
 For He knows all and in His wing
 Is all the power on everything.
 45 If God punished men by the way
 That they deserve, He would not stay
 To leave on the surface in pay
 A single living creature's lay.
 But He gives them a trial time.
 When the time's up, God has in sight
 All of His servants and their plight.

Heirs of the earth and of the skies above,
 At least as far as telescope in glove,
 Men are and may be still beyond the shove
 Of nature and delight, and yet I find
 The heritage abundant is still blind.
 We know the truth and truth turns into dust,
 We know the shine and day sees clinging
 rust
 Where morning was a shimmering and
 bright.
 The heritage is great, the knowing slight.
 Beloved, empirical investigation
 Each day brings less in returns to my
 ration,
 Each day leaves more to wonder why and
 where,
 As I grasp at the things of which I'm heir.
 At last and after hope just You are there.

Surah 36 Ya-Sin

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 Ya-Sin. 2 Qur'an with wisdom filled,
 3 You are a sent one *that God willed*,
 4 On a straight path. 5 It is revealed
 Sent down by Him exalted in
 Power and most merciful to win.
 6 So you may warn a folk whose own
 Ancestors had no warning cone,
 And so who remain ignorant.
 7 The Word is proved true and not scant
 Against the most of them, for they
 Do not believe *in the right way*.
 8 We have put yokes around their necks
 Right up to their chins, so their specks
 Are turned up so they can't see checks.
 9 We've placed a barricade before
 And after them, and furthermore,
 We've covered them not to see more.
 10 It's all one to them whether you
 Warn them or not. They see no true.
 11 All you can do is warn such ones
 Who follow the word and fear guns
 Of the most gracious and unseen.
 Give such good news and so to glean
 Of the forgiveness and reward
 Abundant *that's for such restored*.

The question rises why the need to warn
 Those who are destined anyway to scorn?
 The facile answer that they might not get
 Excuse for failure to believe is met
 By argument that they were never free
 To take salvation without Your decree.
 The bad news is all are guilt-ridden here
 And are condemned to hell without a tear.
 The good news is that grace and mercy fall
 On some snatched from the wickedness in
 pall.

Beloved, the barricades are set and true,
 The barricades are always kept in view,
 But punishment of angels runs betide
 On those who catch the vision of Your side.

12 We shall give new life to the dead,
 And We record the things they've said
 Before and what they leave behind,
 All things have We taken in kind
 Account in a clear writ designed.
 13 Present a parable to them,
 Of the companions of a gem
 City. See, there came in its hem

Some messengers *to see the bind*.
 14 When We sent them two messengers,
 They rejected outright the fers,
 But We increased them to a third.
 They said "We've been sent out and spurred
 Upon a mission *as occurred*."
 15 They said "You are just men like us.
 No such thing sends the most Gracious.
 You're only lying in the fuss."
 16 They said "Our Lord knows we've been
 sent
 Upon a mission to you bent.
 17 "And our duty is just to state
 The message clearly and relate."
 18 They said "On our part we perceive
 An evil omen from your sleeve.
 If you don't stop, we'll stone you here.
 A terrible punishment's fear
 Will fall on you as we appear."
 19 They said "Your evil omens rise
 From your own selves. If you are wise
 And warned? No, but you are a folk
 Transgressing all bounds at a stroke!"
 20 Then there came running from the part
 Furthest of the city's heart,
 A man who said "My folk, obey
 The messengers' word come today.
 21 "Obey those who ask no reward
 Of you, and who have themselves stored
 The guidance *come down from their Lord*.

The world is filled with lords and masters
 great,
 And all demand obedience and hate
 The one who questions their authority.
 You only, my Beloved, among the sea
 Of kings and presidents, of popes and pirs,
 Give love in answer to the human fears
 To bow to You. All others would constrain
 Recalcitrants to justify their reign.
 Because You have no need of my
 compliance
 My soul divine gives up its rash defiance.
 Commandments in Your mouth are
 promises
 Instead of prohibitions, membrances
 Of love, a time set, secret trysts unbroken,
 From day to day and week to week a token.

22 "It were no smart thing I should do
 Not to serve the One without crew

Who has created me, and to
 Whom you shall once return in view.
 23 "Shall I take gods other than Him?
 If the most Gracious thought not dim
 Catastrophe for me, no use
 Would be their mediation's ruse
 For, nor can such gods save me trim.
 24 "I should by doing so be in
 Apparent error and a sin.
 25 "As for me, I've faith in the Lord
 Of you. Hear then my warning word."
 26 It was said "Enter then into
 The garden." He said "Oh me, if
 My folk just knew and were not stiff!
 27 "For that my Lord has granted me
 Forgiveness and enscribed decree
 For me among those honoured free."
 28 We did not send down on his folk
 After him any army's stroke
 From heaven, nor did We need to.
 29 It was just one great blast in view,
 And see, they were flattened in rue.
 30 Oh too bad for my servants, there
 Does not come a messenger fair
 To them but they ridicule care.

The revelation whether for the folk
 Or for the faith and comfort at a stroke
 Of the soul single before Your vast throne
 Ends in the ridicule of all and own.
 The one sent to the many must assent
 To giving of the message that was meant,
 But he to whom the vision must remain
 Mere comfort for his own soul and his gain
 Had better seal his lips before the train
 Of wicked worshippers and their disdain.
 The whip the angels touch to the new dead
 Is laid already upon the proud head
 Of those who catch the vision from the sky
 Before the day that they must come to die.

31 Don't they see how many there are
 Of generations before far
 That We destroyed? They'll not return
 To them *whatever they may earn*.
 32 But each one of them all will be
 Brought before Us for judgement's spree.
 33 A sign for them's the drought-drenched
 earth.
 We give it life, and from its berth
 Bring corn that you eat for its worth.

34 We bring up from it orchards there
With date palms and vines and the share
Of springs appearing in the air.
35 So they may enjoy fruits of this.
It was not their hands that made this.
Will they not give thanks and not miss?
36 Glory to God, who made in pairs
All things that the earth comes and wears,
As well as their own kind and things
Of which they have no mind or rings.

A sign of Your reality is earth
That lies inert and in the grasp of dearth,
And then at the sign from the humble sky
Bursts into green after the plants that die.
A sign of Your reality is in
The pairs both male and female that would
win
A place for progeny upon the soil,
A place to grapple with the day of toil.
Beloved, I give You thanks that all is
wrought
In motion and a movement still unsought
That leaves the soul to whirl upon the plot,
To rise up fed and nourished, and then not,
To fall an ash upon Your footstool bare
To find that after all You are still there.

37 And a sign for them is the night.
We bring the day from it in sight,
And see they're sunk in darkened plight.
38 The sun runs its path for a time
Appointed for it and its clime,
That is the decree that He shows,
High in His power, all things He knows.
39 And the moon, We've measure for it
The palaces to travel fit
Till it comes back having grown old
Like the stem of a date-stalk told.
40 It's not permitted to the sun
To overtake the moon in run,
Nor can the night outstrip the day.
Each goes along in its own way.
41 And a sign for them is that We
Carried their folk in the degree
Of ark filled with its husbandry.

The signs of the appointments of the sun
And moon are not that they are safely done
For calendars of months and years in stake,
And not especially the week to take,

But that the courses of the stars and those
Great bodies have a sign here that You
chose

By which to comfort every human heart
That You who care for heavenly bodies' art
Will in the wild and wayward way of men
Bring all to their true path and once again
Lift every soul into its prospered place
Before the decree of Creator's face.
Beloved, I praise You for the folded night
As well as for the daylight in Your sight.

42 We've made them such more where to
ride.

43 If We desired, We could preside
Over their drowning, then there'd be
No helper nor security,

44 Except by way of Our mercy,
And by the reprieve for a time.

45 When they are told in prose or rhyme;
"Fear what's in front of you and that
Which will be after you thereat,
So you may get mercy," they're flat.

46 No sign comes to them from among
The signs of their Lord that are sung
But they turn back from it *as stung*.

47 And when they're told, "Give out freely
Of what God's provided in spe,"

The unbelievers say to those
Who do believe, "Shall we impose
To feed the very ones God could
Himself feed if He only would?
You've gone astray, lost in the wood."
48 They say more, "When will this threat
be,

If you are speaking so truly?"

49 They'll only have to wait for just
A single blast. It will seize dust
And grab them in the middle of
Their disputations and their shove.

50 They will have no chance then to
choose,

To make a will or for a ruse
Return to their own folk to cruise.

The chance to choose is decreed for all
men,

And each one chooses by creation's yen,
And each joins in what fire best quenches
pain,

Best lifts the hopes of heart to light again.

The chance to choose is one strand of the
staid

Creation that You set up on parade,
A red umbrella placed beneath the white,
With paper tassels golden in the sight
Divine decreed above it for delight.
Beloved, I praise You for the small degree
Of the illusion we all have in fee,
Until we enter in eternity.
I bear the paper parasol in pride
Beneath the greater love You bring beside.

51 The trumpet shall be sounded, when
See, from the graves will rush the men
To meet their Lord *alive again*.

52 They'll say "Oh, woe to us! Who's
raised

Us up from the beds or rest praised?"
"This is what the most Gracious had
Promised. And true was the word glad
Sent by the messengers We had."

53 It will be just a single blast,
When see, they will be caught up last
Before us *to the judgement classed*.

54 On that day not a soul will be
Wronged in the least, but you shall see
The payment of iniquity,
The deeds done past in equity.

55 Companions of the garden then
On that day shall rejoice again
In all that they have done in den.

56 They and their fellows will be in
Groves of shade, reclined *with their kin*
On noble thrones *instead of bin*.

57 Fruit will be there for them to eat,
They'll have whatever as a treat,

58 "Peace" is the word they'll have to greet,
From Lord most Merciful to meet.

There's nothing clearer on the sky and page
Than the Qur'an teaches from age to age
The hope of resurrection in the stage
Of body and of breath at last to wage
Life in the flesh though still outside the
cage.

The echoes of the Bible here remain
In amplifying of the sun and rain
Upon the graves to fertilize the hill
Until the trumpet sounds loud as to kill.
The bodies rise to praise as well as rage.
Beloved, I know that You will raise me still

After the breath returns, my members fill
The grave, and when I rise, I'll see about
The glories I now know only in sound.

59 "O sinners, depart from this day.

60 "Did I not warn you on the way,
O Adam's children, you should not
Worship Satan? For he was caught
An enemy to you in plot.

61 "You should worship Me here this day,
For this is the right and straight way.

62 "But he led off a great crowd of you,
Did you not see he did not love you?

63 "This is hell that was warned about.

64 "Embrace the day you would cast out."

65 That day We'll set a seal upon
Their mouths. But their hands will be
drawn

To speak to us and feet bear witness
To all they did and without fitness.

66 If We had wanted, We'd have blotted
Their eyes out, they'd have run besotted
And groping for the way, but then
How could they have seen things again?

67 If We had wanted, We'd have changed
Then to stay in place and not ranged.

Then they could not have moved around,
Nor have turned back to error found.

68 If We grant long life to mankind,
We make him opposite designed.

Will they not understand and mind?

69 We've not taught prophet poetry,
Nor is it set as his duty.

This is a message recitation

To make things clear *to every nation*.

70 So it may give an admonition

To any in living condition,
And so the accusation made
Against rejecters is relayed.

Two human tasks remain outside the ken
Of prophets by pretence of wisdom when
Their words are bandied back and forth in
rate.

Two tasks fall empty on the empty plate.
The one is grand philosophy of late,
What human minds cannot escape and wait.
The other is grand poetry that speaks
In songs and visions that the weaker seeks.
But all three members of this trinity,
Philosophy, poetry, prophecy,

Burn in the soul beyond endurance till
The fires alight descend on soul to kill.
It is not You, Beloved, who's three in one,
But the destroying angels when they've
done.

71 Don't they see We created them
Among the things Our hands in gem
Have molded, cattle that remain
Under their sway to give them gain?
72 And We've set them there for their own?
Some of them transport them like throne
And others they can eat alone.
73 And they have profit from them too,
And get their milk to drink and brew.
Why don't they thankfully take view?
74 Yet they take gods other than God,
Vain hopes to find help on the sod.
75 They have no power to help them there,
But they will be brought to the share
As a band *condemned without care*.
76 So do not let their words grieve you.
We know what they hide of the true
As well as what they bring to view.

The argument of holy cow arises
At least twice in what the Qur'an
comprises,
And shows that Hindus are not very far
Off from the track of the true guiding star
In keeping cattle like gods in the car.
The golden calf became an idol not
Because it was a cow that had been shot,
But because it was made of gold and could
Not give us milk or transportation good.
The cattle on the hills remain a sign
That You are the Creator of the vine,
With joy let me take up the soma's wine
And praise the lovely bulls on Bashan's
line.
Yours are the thousand hills covered with
kine.

77 Does not man see that it is We
Who created him from sperm wee?
Yet see, he's an adversary.
78 He makes comparisons for Us,
And forgets his creation's fuss.
He says "Who can give back the life
To decomposing bones and rife?"
79 Say "He will give them life again

Who the first time created men.
He's expert in creation's yen.
80 "The same one who produces fire
For you from the green tree's desire,
When flash you kindle it from drier."
81 "Is not the one who made the skies
And earth well able to devise
The like again?" Indeed it's so.
For He's the high Creator, ho,
Limitless skill and knowledge show.
82 When He intends, command of His
Is "Be!" and so the thing just is.
So glory to Him in whose hands
Is all dominion in all lands,
And you'll be brought back to His bands.

The argument for Your existence from
The sperm is just as surprising to come
As that from cattle giving milk in sum.
The white in darkness is the proof that You
Uphold the universe that You made too.
No doubt the argument convinced some
men

In ancient times when mythic views again
Preyed on the life and vitals in the den.
Today we are more certain of the view
Empirical and philosophic shrew
Is only gauge of truth, not population
Of men and cattle romping in their station.
Beloved, give us more scientific ration
To make of us a great and holy nation.

Surah 37 As-Saafat, or The Ranks

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 By those who set themselves in ranks,
2 And so are strong repelling banks,
3 And so proclaim the message sent.
4 Indeed, indeed your God is One!
5 The Lord of skies and earth undone
And all between them, and the Lord
Of every point of rising sun.
6 We have adorned the skies and scored
The lower heavens with the bright
Beauty in the stars come to light,
7 To guard against stubbornness in
Rebellious evil spirits' sin,
8 So they'd not turn their ears toward
The high assembly but by sword
Be cast away on every side,
9 Abandoned to penalty wide,
10 Except some snatched away by stealth,

Like brands from flaming fire in health
Of piercing brightness for its wealth.

I'm lucky to be of the Iroquois
Who have, they say, twelve souls that they
enjoy.

I have a pagan soul that I employ
About the skies adorned with hope I scan.
I have a Christian soul, a Jewish plan,
A Muslim soul and one Samaritan.
My Hindu soul clashes not with the Jain,
My Buddhist with my Taoist soul in vain.
Confucianist is the last soul I name,
Besides the Druid that I love to claim.
The twelfth soul is the first, a secret song
Outside the lays of righteousness and
wrong

Of the great world traditions: it's my soul
That's hidden in You, my Beloved and
goal.

11 Ask what they think: what's harder to
Create, they or the other crew
Of beings We've created too?
We made them out of sticky clay.
12 While you're amazed at marvelled way,
They ridicule it as for pay,
13 And when they're warned, they give no
heed,
14 And when they see a sign indeed,
They turn it to a mocking creed,
15 And say "This is clear magic's mead.
16 "What! When we die and become dust
And bare bones, shall we then have trust
To be raised up again to lust
17 And our ancestors too from crust?"
18 Say "Yes, and you will then be
shamed."
19 It will be a single cry claimed,
And see, they'll start to see unmaimed.
20 They'll say "Ah, woe to us, is sent
Upon us day of the Judgement!"
21 "This is the day of separating,
Which you denied in your elating."

Pretence of some humility to see
Death as the end of human power to be
Conflicts, methinks, with that grand loyalty
To self and to one's human royalty.
Since kings and commoners all rot to dust,
And science gives no hint that any must

Be resurrected to make an account,
Pretence of rule must be lacking amount.
There is no sense denying resurrection
And claiming some kingly kind of
confection.

Just stop, Beloved, for a bit of reflection.
If men were truly an immortal kind,
Then there'd be sense in serving such kings
blind.

Only You, my Beloved, deserve my mind.

22 It will be said "Bring up those who
Do wrong and their wives into view,
And things they worshiped in their crew
23 "Besides God, and lead them astray
Into the fire to burn away.
24 "But stop them, and to make them stay,
25 "What is wrong with you that you do
Not help each other in your rue?"
26 No, but that day they will submit,
27 And they will turn as though in fit
To question each other to sit.
28 They'll say "It was you who used to
Come to us from the right hand due."
29 They will reply, "No, it was you
Who had no faith in right and true.
30 "We did not have power over you.
No, it was you who were a folk
Under stubborn rebellion's yoke.
31 "So now the true evidence spoke
Against us, the word of our Lord
That we'll have to taste what is stored.
32 "We led you astray as we too
Were ourselves astray from the true."
33 Indeed that day they'll share the pain.
34 That's how We deal with sinners vain.
35 For they, when they were told the view
That there's no god but Allah true,
Would puff themselves with pride in pew,
36 And say "What! Shall we give up gods
Because of a mad poet's prods?"
37 No, he has come with the great truth,
And he confirms to old and youth
The messengers before with ruth.

If wives are brought into account, they too
Are folk responsible for what they do,
And not just an extension come in view
Of men. So they too go to glistening hell
For worshipping the many things they tell.
One cannot have it both ways, so to speak,

Both the equality that women seek,
And safety from accounting as though
weak.

Beloved, the truth You hold is for the old
And young as well as for timid and bold.
I stake my lot among the youthful fair
And with the women waiting on the stair
Before the judgement throne. And You are
there,
The sure to know and recompense with
gold.

38 You'll taste the grievous penalty,
39 But it will be no more in fee
Than retribution for what you
Have done. 40 But the sincere and true
Servants of God, 41 For them's appointed
A sustenance *pure and anointed*,
42 Fruits, and honour and dignity,
43 In gardens of felicity,
44 Facing each on thrones of decree.
45 They will pass round to them a cup
From a clear-flowing fountain up,
46 And crystal clear, delicious taste
To those who drink and do not waste,
47 Free from drunkenness, nor will they
Suffer intoxication's sway.
48 And besides them there will be chaste
Women restraining glances' paste
With eye enlarged in wonder's ray,
49 As if they were eggs to relay.
50 Then they will turn to one another
And question each of them his brother.

Description of the beauty of the form
Of human body resurrected warm
Is hot by standards known in every dorm.
The difference lies in the liquor's storm,
Which can be drunk until the gut is full
Without intoxication at the pull.
The reward of the chosen is beyond
The comprehension of both free and bond.
Beloved, my taste and lust depends on You,
Creator of the body and the view
Of soul within, without sitting in pew.
Beloved, my own esthetic for the glance
Of egg-like eyes is up to You for chance,
As well as my aptitude for the dance.

51 One of them will begin the talk
And say "I had a friend in stalk,

52 "Who used to say 'What! Are you of
Those who bear witness that they love
The truth? 53 "When we die and turn to
Dust and bare bones, shall we take to
Ourselves rewards and punishment?"
54 He said "Would you look on the sent?"
55 And he looked down and saw him in
The middle of the fire for sin.
56 He said "By God, you almost brought
Me to perdition and unsought.
57 "Had it not been for my Lord's grace,
I'd surely have been in that brace.
58 "Is it that we shall never die,
59 "Except our first death when we vie
And we'll not be punished thereby?"
60 Indeed this is great to achieve.
61 For such let those who wish to strive
Struggle to get *and keep alive*.
62 Is that more fun or Zaqqum's tree?
63 For We have truly made it be
A test to note iniquity.
64 For it's a tree that springs up from
The bottom of hell-fire to come.
65 The sprouts of its fruitstalks are like
The heads of devils bout to strike.
66 Indeed they'll eat from it and fill
Their bellies with that fateful bill.
67 After that they'll be given a brew
Of boiling water to their rue.
68 Then they'll go back to take their place
Within the blazing fire's disgrace.
69 Indeed they found ancestors strung
On the wrong path on which they stung.
70 So they rushed in their footprints' rung.

The common argument against You then
Was that dry bones and dust are fate of men
And nothing after death can reconcile
The man to what on earth he did awhile.
That faith annihilation rests upon
Observing bodies rot when they are drawn,
A fact throughout the world around to see,
And so a sure guide to eternity.
But You, Beloved, respond in kind to say
Reality also reveals a way
Distinct from that. It is a fact that they
Who live were made so or they so were
born,
And that source of the first life without
scorn
Can just as well return life at the morn.

71 Indeed before them many folk
 Of ancient time took the wrong poke.
 72 But We send in those days of yore
 Among them warner as before.
 73 Then see what was the end of those
 Who were warned to keep on their toes,
 74 Except sincere servants of God.
 75 Noah cried to Us as in prod,
 And We're the best to hear prayer's rod.
 76 And We delivered him and his
 Folk from the great drowning that is.
 77 We made his progeny endure.
 78 We left for him in ages sure
 To come in later times: "Peace and
 Greetings to Noah and to stand
 Among the nations *and command*."
 80 So do We recompense those who
 Do the right thing in what they do.
 81 For he was one of Our slaves here
 Who did believe and did not fear.
 82 The rest We drowned them in the Flood.

The best way to acquaint the world with
 truth
 Is just to drown them all and without ruth.
 So You did once in days of Noah when
 Appeared in store the violence of men.
 It may have been an error on Your part
 To leave his progeny to make a start
 On fresh ways of injustice if not art.
 Or then You ought to make a Flood again.
 Beloved, I do not beg for such except
 You notice that my own prayer is inept:
 I ask for justice on the world at large
 But mercy for myself upon Your barge.
 Teach me and mine to pray aright and we
 May enter in heavenly eternity.

83 Among those who followed his bud
 Was Abraham. 84 See, he approached
 His Lord with a heart unencroached.
 85 See, he said to his father and
 To his folk, "What is *that uncanned*
 That you here worship *that is banned*?
 86 "Is it a lie, gods other than
 God, that you desire and you plan?
 87 "Then what's your concept of the Lord
 Of the worlds that should be adored?"
 88 Then he looked up to see the stars.
 89 And he said "I feel ill *at spars*."

90 They turned from him and went away.
 91 He turned then to their gods to say
 "Have a bite to eat of your pay.
 92 "What's wrong with you that you don't
 speak?"
 93 He turned and hit them on the cheek
 With his right hand. 94 Then on the run
 They came to cross him for his fun.
 95 He said "Do you worship what you
 Have carved yourselves to keep in view?
 96 "But Allah has created you
 And also everything you do."

The arguments that Abraham accedes
 Are not such as my folk take in their
 speeds.
 He proves that none are gods that cannot
 eat
 Or so protect themselves from fist set neat.
 He proves that what a man carves in the
 cold
 Is not a god at all though made of gold.
 Three out of three could prove that Jesus is
 A god of gods, because he was a whiz
 To eat and when attacked at least one time
 Escaped and left the people where to climb.
 Besides that, he was not carved by man's
 hand,
 But by the very word that You command.
 Beloved, God is no man and man's not God
 Was written clear in Torah and the sod.

97 They said "Build him a furnace, do,
 And throw him in the fiery flame!"
 98 Afterward they then tried again
 To find a way to get him then,
 But We brought them all into shame.
 99 He said "I'll go back to my Lord.
 He'll surely guide me when restored.
 100 "O Lord, grant me a righteous son."
 101 So We gave him good news a boy
 Was ready to suffer, employ
 Forbearance *for the coming joy*.
 102 When he was old enough to work
 With him, he said "My son, such quirk
 I see in vision I must make
 A sacrifice of you in stake.
 What do you think of that in wake?"
 He said "My father, do as you
 Have been commanded in the view.
 You'll find me, if Allah so wills,

To practice patience, constant skills.”
 103 When both submitted will to God,
 He laid his forehead on the sod.
 104 We called to him “O Abraham!
 105 “You’ve already fulfilled the scam
 Of the vision!” So We reward
 Those who do the right above board.
 106 This was a clear test that was scored.
 107 We redeemed him by sacrifice.
 108 We left this for him to suffice
 Among the generations that
 Came in the later times and sat:
 109 “Peace and greetings to Abraham!”
 110 So We reward those who do right.
 He was believing slave in sight.

Some say because the Qur’an does not
 speak
 The name of Ishmael, the argument’s weak.
 In fact it is not so, because this son
 Is not the one that’s spoken of when done
 In the next miracle and given name
 Of Isaac. This son’s Ishmael, son of fame.
 The rite of passage was performed at least
 For every son first-born and every beast
 That parted mother’s matrix and increased.
 The rite is clear in Genesis, but here
 The Qur’an points to redemption come
 near.
 How strange the ways the sects have come
 to light!
 This ought to be the Christian’s book
 outright,
 And Torah ought to be the Muslim’s might.

112 We gave him good news of Isaac,
 A prophet, righteous one in stack.
 113 We blessed him and Isaac, but of
 Their progeny are those in love
 Who do right, while others clearly
 Do wrong to their own selves freely.
 114 Again We poured Our favour on
 The two men Moses and Aaron,
 115 And We saved them and their fold
 from
 The great calamity unspun.
 116 And We helped them to overcome.
 117 We gave them the book which in aid
 Makes things as clear as can be weighed.
 118 We guided them to the straight path.
 119 We left this for them without wrath

Among the generations that
 Came in the later times and sat.
 120 Peace and greetings to Moses and
 To Aaron *too where they both stand.*
 121 So We reward those who do right.
 122 They were two faithful slaves in sight.

I have a stone to stick with Muslim waif,
 Who comes to pray in the Qur’anic strafe:
 He follows the Qur’an, and blessed is he,
 By calling down a blessing faithfully
 On Abraham as well as on the sweet
 Last prophet who came here to guide men’s
 feet.

But never have I heard in call to prayer,
 Or in the final blessing uttered there,
 A single word of praise of Moses and
 Of Aaron. Was it not also command?
 Beloved, my prayers are still deficient here,
 No matter how I juggle and I fear.
 I reach to You for grace and so repent
 Of all the good works I used to present.

123 So too was Elijah among
 Those sent *by Us to be unsung.*
 124 See, he said to his folk “Will you
 Not fear *God and keep Him in view?*”
 125 “Will you call on Baal and forsake
 The best of Creators in wake?
 126 “God, your Lord and ancestors’ Lord
 From ancient times and still adored?”
 127 But they rejected him, and they
 Will certainly be called to pay,
 128 Except sincere devoted slave
 Of God *among them to be grave.*
 129 We left this for them without wrath
 Among the generations that
 Came in the later times and sat.
 130 Peace and greetings to Elijah,
Servant of the Lord held in awe.
 131 So We reward those who do right.
 132 He was Our slave who believed *light.*

Let me get the formula right this time:
 Peace and greetings to prophets without
 crime.
 I call Your blessings down on Noah and
 On Abraham both of the blessed band.
 I call Your blessings once more then to
 stand
 On Moses and on Aaron and at last

On good Elijah who stands through the
blast
Of time untouched by death, and so I cast
Your peace and greetings on all of the best,
Obeying the Qur'an from east to west.
How many who pray in the Muslim way
Have blessed all five of these not gone
astray?
Beloved, make up the deficit I pray
Of me and mine and all who love to stay.

133 So too was Lot among those sent.
134 See We saved him and adherent,
135 Except a hag who lagged behind,
136 Then We destroyed the rest in kind.
137 Indeed you pass their place by day
138 And night, will you not see the way?

Lot is left out of the number that You
Require that many bless when they come to
Pray at the footstool of Your throne in
view.

The fact is that Muslims follow instead
Of the Qur'an the Torah born and led.
In Torah only Abraham is said
To be blessed by the tongue in prayer for
bread.

The Muslim prayer may well include that
mate
As well as blessed Muhammad for his rate,
But never once is Aaron taken by
The prayer and blessed again up to the sky.
So let the Muslim keep on following
The Torah, that was what You came to sing
When You send good Muhammad from the
spring.

139 So too was Jonah among sent,
140 When he fled to the ship full bent.
141 He cast lots and he was condemned.
142 Then the big fish swallowed him
hemmed,
He had acted worthy of blame.
143 Had he not glorified the name
Of God, 144 he would surely have spent
His days inside the fish as lent
Till resurrection day unbent.
145 But We cast him out on the shore
Both sick and naked as before.
146 We made grow over him a plant
Spreading like a gourd and not scant.

147 We sent him to a myriad men
Or more to preach to them again.
148 And they believed, so We let them
Enjoy themselves a while pro tem.

There's not a hint in the Qur'an at all
Of the mythic in elements to call
That are seen in the Bible text withal.
The dagon myth, the fish who swallows
sun,

Little red riding hood and eaten bun,
All are missed in the Qur'an for the fun.
The Vedic mushroom no doubt takes its
place

Among the others in the mythic race.
Beloved, I find the word of the Qur'an
On Jonah worth my while to ponder on:
The path to preaching to repent is long,
And wanders from the ship to sing a song
To fish at sea, to ply the shade of gourd,
Until it finds the soul and heart restored.

149 Ask them what they think, does your
Lord

Have daughters, while they sons adored?
150 Or have We made angels female,
And can they make witness unveil?

151 Don't they say from their own
invention

152 "God has born children" by
convention,

But they are lying by extension.

153 Did He choose daughters rather than
Sons *like another earthly man*?

154 What's wrong with you? How do you
judge?

155 Won't you receive a warning's nudge?

156 Or have you clear authority?

157 Bring your book if you truthful be!

158 They've invented a kinship too

Of bloodline between Him in view

And the jinns. But the jinns know that

They will come *to judgement out flat*.

159 Glory to God from what they make.

160 Not so God's servants as they take

Sincerity, devotion's wake.

161 For neither you nor what you take

To worship 162 can lead into trial

About God, 163 except those with smile

Who are themselves bound for fire's pile.

164 "Not one of us but has a place

Appointed to the entire race.
165 "We truly ranged in ranks in space.
166 "We're those who declare glory's
grace."

The argument of yore was not so much
That You do not exist for men to touch,
But that no life comes after death to be
Brought to the resurrection's fair degree.
By contrast jinns know that the coming
store
Of judgement awaits them and all the more
As time goes on in life and deathly shore,
In quiet passing on and stricken gore.
I wonder what the jinns make in their way
As gods in false and glittering array.
Men make their gods of gold and stone and
clay.
If the jinns follow them in wicked lay,
They must make gods of fire that cannot
stay,
And then go out with burning brands to
play.

167 And there were those who said instead,
168 "If only we had here outspread
A message from the ancient led,
169 "We'd surely be God's servants bred,
Sincere, *devoted hand and head.*"
170 But they reject it. Soon they'll know.
171 Already Our word in the show
Has gone before Our servants' row,
171 So they'd surely get help to go,
173 And Our armies will win and glow.

The happy Muslim of this hour and day
Proclaims he would accept the Gospel ray
And books of Moses and the Psalms in
sway,
If only we possessed the autographs,
The text untampered with by hopes and
laughs.

So they were prophesied in the Qur'an
To take that attitude, arrogant swan.
Soon shall they know upon the Judgement
hour
That their rejection of the Bible's power
Transmitted from the ancient Scriptures'
tower
Excludes them from the paradise of grace
And sends them all to hell to meet the face

Of the one who inspired them in their pace
Of such derision of Your books in place.

174 So turn from them a little while,
175 And watch them sink into their guile,
And they'll see how you win a mile.
176 Do they hope to hasten Our pain?
177 But when it falls on them again,
Upon the open place they gain,
Evil will be the morning for
Those who were warned *but took no store.*
178 So turn from them a little while,
179 And watch them sink into their guile,
And they'll see how you win a mile.
180 Glory to your Lord who is Lord
Of honour and of power in sword,
From what they ascribed to Him stored.
181 And peace be on messengers sent.
182 And praise to God, Lord and unspent
Of universe *and all it's meant.*

At last You grant peace on all those who're
sent

As messengers into this earthly tent,
This caravan saray in tilt and bent.
From now on I shall bless as many here
As I can find their names and to appear,
And pray Your peace on those who came
from fear

Proclaiming You are one and so all men
Must answer the same call to You again,
Must answer the same summons to Your
den.

Beloved, I link the names in praise and find
That with the raising of their fame to bind
Your blessings are imparted to the earth
And come upon my breath and life and
mirth.

The blessings on the prophets are well
lined.

Surah 38 Sadh

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 Sadh. But the Qur'an warning filled,
2 While unbelievers, they are billed
In self-esteem, division *killed.*

3 How many generations waited
Before We destroyed them as fated?
In the end they cried, when there came
No more time for salvation's claim.

4 So they're amazed a warner came

To them from among their own frame,
And unbelievers say "This man
Is lying magician by plan.

5 "Has he turned gods all into one
God? This indeed's admirable fun."

6 The chiefs among them turn away
"Walk away and to your gods stay
Faithful. For this indeed's a thing
Planned to distract you from truth's wing.

7 "We never heard such by the folk
Of these last days, it's just a poke
Of tales invented for a joke.

The theory evolutionary goes
That monotheistic thoughts once arose
When polytheism lost gloss and fame,
Though Lang and Schmidt produce another
claim.

If progress is right, then Ahmed was right
To follow in the wake of Christian spite
And Hindu lore, to say the many gods
Trifolium when ripened in their pods
Turn into three together, then for prods
Become one unity. Such is progress
Decked out in evolutionary dress.
Muhammad was inevitable then
In preaching one God to all earthly men.
I too may speculate and come to guess.

8 "What! Has the message been sent down
To him of all folk in the town?"

But they doubt of My own word's frown.
No, they've not tasted pain's renown.

9 Or have they mercy's treasures stored
Received of your exalted Lord,
Almighty, bounties' grantor scored?

10 Or have they power on heaven and earth
And all between of any worth?

If so, let them go up with ropes
And airplanes to the heavens' scopes.

11 But there they will be put to flight
By bands uniting for the fight.

12 Before them messengers for gain
Were so rejected, the folk plain
Of Noah, 'Ad, and Pharaoh too,
The Lord of stakes 13 and Thamud's view,
And people of Lot flying too,
Companions of the wood in pew,
Such were the united in rue.

14 Not one but rejected in time
The messengers, but at their crime

My punishment came justly and
Unimpeachably on their land.

15 These only wait a single blast
In power which must stay to the last.

You use as argument that in times past
All peoples fell and failed before the blast
Of Your catastrophe, and so today
We ought to listen to what prophets say.
Beloved, that argument moves not a whit
The hearts of wicked souls come now to sit.
We know that empires rise and fall, but still
We always hope to prise above the pall
And live forever in utopia,
Which means no place at all in language
law.

Condemned to repeat every mystery
That blossoms and fades in our history
We need not turn to You, nor can we see
Without Your mercy falling to our awe.

16 They say "Our Lord, bring quickly on
Our sentence before day is drawn."

17 Have patience for what they say, and
Remember Our servant well-scanned,
David, the man of strength and grand:
He always repented at hand.

18 We made the hills shout out together
With him Our praises in the weather

Of evening and at break of day,
19 And the birds gathered there to stay,

All with him turned to Allah's way.

20 We strengthened his kingdom and gave
Him wisdom and good judgement's wave
In speech and in decision grave.

Rather than vaunting and impatiently
Expecting punishment by Your decree,
I follow David in repentance here,
Repenting daily of the things I fear
I hold in repetition as in guise
Of service of remembrance to Your eyes.
Let me fail to sin but fail not to bring
The offering of repentance as I sing.
Beloved, I join angelic fowl of air,
The swallows and the martins darting there,
To sing the Psalms of David daily where
My feeble flame approaches You with care.
Look not on my repentance for a gift,
But brush it too aside from my soul's rift.

21 Has the tale of the litigants
 Come to you? See, they climbed the fence
 Into the private bedroom come.
 22 When they at last reached David's hum
 He was afrighted by their sight,
 They said "Don't be afraid tonight,
 We are two arguing of how
 The one's harmed the other in brow.
 Give a true judgement between us,
 And treat us not with injustice,
 But guide us to the plain way's right.
 23 "This man's my brother. He has nine
 And ninety sheep, while on my vine
 There is just one. He says to me,
 'Let me take care of her now, see'
 And he is rather harsh to me."
 24 He said "It's wrong of him to take
 Your sheep to add to his flock's stake.
 Many wrong others in the way
 Of business, but not those who stay
 In faith and act out righteousness,
 And they are too few of address."
 And David understood that We
 Had sent a trial for him to see,
 And asked forgiveness from his Lord,
 Fell down prostrating and adored.
 25 So We forgave him this, and he
 Enjoyed a nearness in degree
 To Us and fine place finally.

The Qur'an wisely sets aside the tale
 That Jews and Christians for ages would
 hale
 As proof that David killed a man to hide
 Adultery as well as kingly pride.
 I have my understanding of the text
 That leaves so many others full perplexed,
 But better speaks the Qur'an to the mind
 Of simple ones once troubled by the blind.
 Beloved, David did not commit such fault
 Nor give us excuse often as result
 That failed Christians take as a comfort
 when
 They do take neighbour's wife or do kill
 men.
 It's not excuse the Bible and Qur'an
 Demand, but the repentance that is drawn.

26 O David, We established you
 A king on earth. So judge now true
 Between men. Do not follow lusts,

For they'll lead you away from trusts
 In God's path. For those who go out
 Of God's path is penalty stout,
 For they forget day of redoubt.
 27 We had a purpose when We made
 The heaven and earth and all displayed,
 The unbelievers thought it not,
 But woe's to unbelievers caught
 In the fire *waiting to be taught*.
 28 Shall We treat those who believe and
 Do righteous deeds like those whose hand
 Is into mischief on the earth?
 Shall We treat those who guard their berth
 The same as those who turn aside
 From the right way and to abide?
 29 A book that We've sent down to you,
 And full of blessings and not rue
 So they can meditate its signs,
 And men who understand designs
 May take a warning *from its mines*.

I grasp the message the Qur'an brings me
 To follow David and his book in fee
 For my prayers woven wise in the daily
 Account of Psalms. It is no strange thing
 here:

Both Jews and Christians also take in gear
 The Psalms for daily nourishment and fear.
 It's only Evangelicals that drop
 The Psalms and join some Muslims in the
 slop
 Of leaving off the Hebrew texts that top
 All others in their exquisite beebop.
 Beloved, I hope for never other stop
 Than Psalms of David in my home and
 shop,
 To meditate and murmur till I drop
 Into eternity or till I pop.

30 To David We gave Solomon,
 How fine in Our service he's done!
 I always turned repenting won.
 31 See, there were brought to him at night
 The best-bred horses, swift in sight,
 32 And he said "I love love of good,
 And further my Lord's glory's bud,"
 Until the setting of veil's wood.
 33 "Bring them back to me." And then he
 Ran his hand on legs and necks free.
 34 And We made trial of Solomon.
 We set on his throne a doll, but

He turned to us away from glut.
 35 He said "O Lord, forgive me and
 Give me a kingdom not to stand
 For any after me. For You
 Are grantor of bounties in view.
 36 So We set the wind at his power
 To blow gently and at the hour
 As he commanded at his will.
 37 Also the evil ones fulfil,
 And every kind of builder's skill,
 38 As others to bound to his will
 In chains. 39 "Such are Our bounties still.
 Whether you grant them or withhold,
 No account will be asked or told."
 40 He too enjoyed nearness to us,
 A find place to return, *joyous*.

The horses of king Solomon remain
 The major criticism that the vain
 Bring against Your Word set and without
 stain
 Between the covers of the Bible lain.
 Four or forty of thousands, I'm insane
 To think it matters whether truth or bane
 Fulfills the plot. For kings or chronicles
 Are both consistent with their husks and
 hulls,
 And well filled with things to distract the
 mind
 From the repentance that Your grace would
 bind
 On the elect, but leave to wander blind
 Those who are counting horses once
 confined
 In stables of king Solomon resigned.
 The human sack supports pleasure and
 pain.

41 Bring to memory Our servant Job.
 See he called to his Lord in Lohb,
 "The wicked one's afflicted me
 With suffering and with misery!"
 42 "Strike with your foot, here's to dip
 down
 And wash cool and refreshing *gown*,
 And to drink *quenching of the town*."
 43 And We gave him his people back
 In double their number not slack,
 As a grace from Ourselves, a thing
 For a remembrance, for all who
 Have understanding in their view.

44 "And take in hand a little grass,
 And strike with it, let no oath pass."
 We found him full of patience true.
 How excellent in Our work due,
 He always turned back to *his pew*.
 46 We chose them for a special end,
 Declaring the message We send
 Of the hereafter *not to bend*.
 47 They were in Our sight of the band
 Of the elect and good to stand.

The holy Qur'an does establish fast
 Some texts for dhikr to keep in the blast
 Of worldly winds and liturgies unpast.
 The service of remembrance that stands
 still
 Beside the books of Moses on the hill,
 The Psalms of David and the Gospel fill,
 The quartering of the Qur'an to spill
 In loveliness, that service that still stands
 Is simply book of Job upon the sands.
 I've seen the cave of Job and I've bowed
 there
 To spend myself prostrating in its air
 Alive with centuries of pilgrims' prayer.
 Beloved, let me sing book of Job once
 more
 Before I enter on the heavenly shore.

48 Mind Ishmael, Elisha, Zul-Kifl,
 Each of them was without a snuffle
 Among the good and great in band.
 49 This is a warning for the good,
 A fine place to return as should,
 50 The gardens of eternity,
 Whose gates are open to the free,
 51 There they will rest, there they can call
 For fruit and drink as much as all.
 52 Beside them will be women chaste
 With downcast glances, without haste
 Of the same age *and the same paste*.
 53 Such is the promise made to you
 For the day of account in view.
 54 Indeed such will Our bounty be,
 It will not fail eternally.

Some Arabs that I know will mark the
 place
 Of paradise with disappointed face
 And tears of such disgust that the fair
 dreams

Fade, fade before reality that schemes.
A woman of the same age for reward,
After delights of loveliness on sward
With twenty, thirty years in junior mated
To grey-beards oggling maidens and
elated!

Beloved, how can You be undiplomatic,
And promise not girls but old women
static?

No men will strive for paradise but lust
Instead for hell where prostitutes bite dust
Before the onslaught of the raging hand
Of Arab and non-Arab Muslim band.

55 Yes so, but for wrongdoers will
Be a place of return that's ill.

56 Hell! They will burn in it and it
Will be a lumpy bed to fit.

57 Yes so, then they will taste of it
A boiling drink, a liquid dark,
And cloudy and freezing for spark.

58 And other penalties of like
To match these as they come to strike.

59 Here is a band that rushes fast
With you, no welcome for their blast,
Indeed they'll burn in Hell at last.

60 "No, you too! No welcome for you.
You've brought all this upon our crew.
Now we must stay in awful stew."

61 They'll say "Our Lord, whoever brought
This on us, add to him unsought
A double penalty of fire."

62 They'll say "What's wrong with us that's
dire

That we do not see men we thought
Were among the bad ones untaught?

63 "Did we fail to recognize then,
Or do our eyes now fail to ken?"

64 Indeed it's right, this quibbling there
Among the folk of the fire's share.

For all the pains of hell, at least the girls
Will be for older men and share their curls
With the sedate and elderly of state.
Each senator will have a younger mate.
Are not the pains of fire and molten brass
Worth wading through to get a piece of
mass

On a young chick instead of the tough meat
Of a wench of my own age as a treat,
As promised in the paradise I greet?

Beloved, teach me to count my chicks
before

They match and batch in hell or on the
shore

Of paradise, and catch the rate and roar
Of fires of hell or storms on seas of glass.
Teach me to count and teach each lad and
lass.

65 Say "I'm a warner, no god's there
But the one God, supreme in glare
And irresistible to bear,

66 "The Lord of sky and earth and all
Between them, exalted to call
On might, one to enforce His will,
Forgiving always, always still."

67 Say "That's a message above all,

68 "From which you turn away in call.

69 "No knowledge do I have of those
Rulers on high, when those ones chose
To talk among themselves in rows.

70 "Only has this to me been shown:
I'm to give warning clear and known."

71 See your Lord said to angels then,
"From clay I'm here to create men.

72 "When I've formed him and breathed in
him

Of My breath, then fall down to him
In prostration and keep it trim."

73 And so the angels fell prostrating
Themselves, all at one time relating.

74 Not Iblis though, he was too proud,
And was one rejecting aloud
The faith against all of the crowd.

75 He said "O Iblis, what prevents
You from prostrating yourself sense
To one I have created by

My hands? Are you too proud and why?
Are you one exalted to sky?"

76 He said "I'm better than he. You
Created me of fire, his brew

You made from clay to *stay in pew*."

77 He said "Then get you down from here,
For you're rejected, cursed to fear.

78 "And My curse shall be on you till
The day of judgement *comes to kill*."

79 He said "O Lord, give me respite
Till day of resurrection's light."

80 He said "Respite is granted you,

81 "Till day of time appointed view."

82 He said "Then by Your power I'll put

Them all to go on the wrong foot,
 83 "Except Your servants among them,
 Sincere and purified in hem."
 84 He said "Then it is right and fitting,
 And I decide what's right and fitting,
 85 "That I'll surely fill hell with you
 And those who follow in your crew."
 86 Say "No payment do I beg you
 For this, nor do I pretend new.
 87 "This is no less than message sent
 To all the universe and lent.
 88 "And you will surely know the right
 Of it after a little spite."

How many times, Beloved, You tell this
 tale
 That's missing in the Bible to prevail.
 No doubt You're making up for that lacune,
 And telling several times and telling soon
 Makes do when early folk could not review
 The message of the bloke who failed in
 pew
 To bow when so commanded as was due.
 For that Iblis was left without a boon.
 Beloved, though I may think I'm better far
 Than others riding in a lesser car,
 Have mercy on my ignorance to spar,
 And I shall wake from the fog of the veils
 To shift about the seas on greater sails,
 Until the oceans swamp me with their
 gales.

Surah 39 Al-Zumar, or the Crowds

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 The revelation of this book
 Is come from Allah, high to look
 In power, and full of wisdom's nook.
 2 Indeed We have revealed the book
 To you, serve God and bring Him true
 Sincere devotion *in His view*.
 3 Is it not to God such is due?
 But those who take protectors' crew
 Other than God, "We only serve
 Them to keep us out of the swerve
 From God." God will judge between them
 In what they differ in their hem.
 But God does not guide such as are
 False and ungrateful under star.
 4 If God had wished to take a son,
 He could have chosen anyone
 He's please to make under the sun.

But glory be to Him. He's God,
 One, irresistible in prod.
 5 He made the sky and earth aright,
 He makes the night come over day,
 And makes the day come over night.
 He's set the sun and moon in ray.
 Each one follows appointed way.
 Is He not the exalted One
 In power, He who forgive when done
 Again and again when he's won?
 6 He made you from a single frame,
 Then created of the same game
 His mate. And He sent down for you
 Eight head of cattle paired thereto.
 He makes you in your mothers' womb,
 In stages following the doom,
 In three veils of darkness like tomb.
 Such is God, your Lord, and to Him
 Belongs dominion. There's no grim
 God but He. Why turn back from Him?
 7 If you reject, indeed God will
 Have no need of you for the bill,
 But He does not like from His slaves
 Ingratitude. If in your waves
 You're grateful, He'll be pleased with you.
 No burden-bearer can hold true
 The burden of another's due.
 At last to your Lord's your return,
 When He will tell you truth to learn
 Of all you did, for He knows well
 All that is in human heart's spell.

Three stages and three veils within the
 womb
 Have graced each human being for his
 room
 On earth, on mercy, on the running path
 Made sweet diverging from Your utter
 wrath.
 A day, an hour, a hoping for the birth
 Sinks into past, but mothers know their
 worth.
 May I remember the dark times I first
 Came into being among blessed and cursed,
 Each moment caught in Your creating
 power,
 Lest harm should come to me within an
 hour.
 When I saw light after the stages three
 And stepped into the hostile company,
 I had naught to depend on but Your grace.

No one was there beside me in this place.

8 When some trouble touches man, he
Cries to his Lord to turn in fee
Repenting. But when He bestows
A favour on him from His rows,
He then forgets he cried and prayed
Before, and sets up rivals stayed
With God, and so misleads the strayed
From God's path. Say "Enjoy your word
Of blasphemy a while unstirred,
Indeed you're one of the crowd sent
Into the fire *not to relent*."

9 Is one who worships with devotion
During the hours of night in motion
Prostrating himself or to stand,
Who takes heed of the coming land,
And who places his hopes upon
The mercy of his Lord outdrawn?
Say "Are those equal, those who know
And those who do not know the show?
It's those who have understanding
Who get the admonition's *sting*."

10 Say "O my servants who believe,
Fear your Lord, good is the reprieve
For those who do good in this world.
Spacious is God's earth. Those who whirled
In patient perseverance' sway
Will truly get reward and pay."

11 Say "Truly I'm commanded to
Serve Allah with devotion due,
12 "And I'm commanded to be first
Of those who bow to God uncursed
In peace or in Islam well-versed."

13 Say "If I disobeyed my Lord,
I'd fear the penalty restored
Of a great day *without reward*."

14 Say "I serve God, devoted, true.

15 "Serve what you want pleasing to you
Besides Him." Say "Indeed the losers
Are those who lose their own soul's
choosers

And their folk on the judgement day.
That is the true loss without pay.

16 "They shall have layers of fire above,
And layers below them in the shove,
With this God warns His servants here,
O My servants, keep Me in fear."

Though times are evil, when they are, I do

Hope that my heart repenting shall come
through.

Of times both peaceful and of violence
Make opportunity my heart repents
As often as I breathe the solemn air
Strung with the songs of angels everywhere
Made out in notes of chaffinch and the
wren

Come down to ply their wares to me again.
Each day and hour I beg repentance gift
Let down from heaven as though by a rift
Where light and dark are mixed to send a
ray

Among the clouds and clearnesses of day.
I beg, Beloved, repentance for my words,
Not only for my deeds in wicked herds.

17 Those who avoid the evil thing
And do not fall in worship's wing,
And turn to God, for them's good news.
So proclaim the good news in pews.

18 Those who hear the word and who
follow

The best in it, who do not wallow
At Allah's leading, and those are
The ones with understanding's star.

19 Is one against whom the decree
Of punishment's due and justly?
Would you save one from the fire's spree?

20 But it's for those who fear their Lord.
High palaces in terrace scored
Have been built. Beneath them unfloored
Flow rivers of delight restored.
So is the promise of Allah.

God does not fail His promised awe.

21 Don't you see God sends down the rain
From the sky and leads not in vain
Through springs in the earth? Then He
makes

Things grow thereby in varied stakes
Of colours. Then it withers and
You see it wan and pallid stand,
And then He makes it dry away
And crumble in the light of day.
Indeed here's a message to mind
For men of understanding's kind.

22 Is one whose heart God's opened wide
To Islam, so he's let abide

In light from God? Woe to those whose
Hearts are hardened and not to choose
The celebration of God's praise.

They're clearly wrong wandering in maze.
23 God has revealed in beauty's lays
In the form of a book in ways
Consistent with itself to gaze.
The skins of those who fear their Lord
Tremble to hear it like a sword,
Then their skins and hearts soften, raise
The celebrations of God's praise.
Such is the guidance of God's ways:
He guides thereby whom He will raise,
But such as God leaves, such one strays,
Can have none to guide in their ways.

The best of Your Word, my Beloved, I
wish
Had fallen on my ear and in my dish
Of oats and butter. Let me taste the best
Made palatable by Your grace to test.
Among my hopeful dreams I find Your
Words
Still echo after sleep has joined the birds
Made vocal by the evensong to catch
Commemorations of the lighted match
Emerging from the wealth of grace in latch
Low swelling from a humming to a quire.
Watch now, Beloved, to give me my desire
Along the wakeful night dreams in the bay
I follow never lingering to stray.
Note well the shoal's direction in my way.

24 Is one who has to fear the fall
Of penalty on day of gall
Upon his face? It will be said
To the wrongdoers as they're led,
"Taste what you've earned and so be fed."
25 Those before them rejected too,
And so the punishment in view
Came to them by surprise for cue.
26 So God gave them a taste of shame
In present life, but greater claim
Is penalty of coming fame,
If they just knew, it's not a game.
27 We've put before men in Qur'an
Every kind of parable drawn
So they may have warning *of dawn*.
28 It is an Arabic Qur'an
Without any crooked things drawn,
To guard against the evil *spawn*.
29 God sets a parable a man
With many partners' diverse plan,
A man belonging to one man,

Are those two equal ones in span?
Praise be to God, but most of those
Have no knowledge *of what they chose*.
30 You'll die and they will die in rows.
31 In the end all of you at last
On judgement day come in the cast
A settlement on your disputes
Before your Lord *and at His roots*.

The faces that I see about me now,
Caught in illusion, eye and lip and brow,
I think in my dark wandering to be
Some startling, rampant ghost, the enemy.
But when I come, Beloved, before Your
face,
All faces disappear from time and place
And there is only One. So let me know
That everywhere among these dreams I go,
Behind the veil of face and anger where
I see what seems upon a gate of air,
Reality is sure and firm as earth
That You, Beloved, are every human's
worth.

There is dispute and always so with two,
But there is none where there is only You.

32 Who does more wrong that one who
speaks
A lie about God in his piques
Rejects the true when come to him,
Is there not in hell a place grim
For the blasphemers to be trim?
33 The one who brings truth and the one
Who affirms it, such rightly won.
34 They'll have all that their hearts desire,
In presence of their Lord, such hire
Is the reward of those who do
The good and righteous think in view.
35 So God will turn away from them
The worst of their deeds, give a gem
In recompense for what they've done
That is of the best to be won.
36 Is not God enough for His slave?
But they try to scare you so grave
With others besides Him to rave.
For such as God lets go astray,
There is no guide to the right way.
37 And for such as God guides there can
Be none to lead away from plan.
Is not God high in power and span,
Lord of the retribution's day?

If you should ask them who's created
 The heavens and earth and all elated,
 They'd tell you surely that God did.
 Say "See then, the things that you hid
 In invocation besides God,
 Can they, if God wills on the sod
 Some punishment for me, remove
 His punishment? Of if He prove
 Some grace for me, can they retract
 His grace?" Say "God gives what I lacked.
 In Him those trust whose trust is stacked."
 39 Say "My folk, do what you can do.
 I'll do so, but you'll soon know too,
 40 "To whom comes punishment of shame,
 On whom falls penalty and blame."
 41 We've shown to you the book in truth,
 For humankind, *both old and youth*.
 He who has guidanace gets the good
 On his own soul. But he who would
 Stray injures himself. Nor are you
 Set over them to care for crew.
 42 God takes souls at death, and those who
 Do not die during their sleep too.
 Those on whom He's passed death's decree,
 He holds back, but the rest to see
 He sends for an appointed time.
 In this are signs for those *in mime*
 Who contemplate *both good and crime*.

Sleep's better than to slander, said one chief
 Of dervishes, if I remember brief.
 Somehow the adhan that tells me that
 prayer
 Is better than sleep shudders me with care.
 Must two necessities join in compare?
 It is my practice to remember You,
 Beloved, with a sema' on lip or two
 As I rift into sleep. Greater success
 Is in the dhikr of partial address,
 Left so unfinished by the catch of sleep.
 I do prevent in me the need to weep
 As I avoid the dhikr La ilaah
 Illallah, for fear that for lack of awe
 Sleep take me after two first words in crawl.

43 What! Do they take to mediate
 Others besides God *for their fate*?
 Say "Even if they have no power
 Nor sense to rise up in the hour?"
 44 Say "To God is the mediation.
 To Him belongs dominion's station

Of heavens and earth. In the end you
 Will be brought back into His view."
 45 When God, the one and only's sought,
 The hearts of those without faith fraught
 In the hereafter then are filled
 With loathing and horror. When billed
 With others than He, see, they rise
 Filled up with joy, filled to the skies.
 46 Say "O God, Creator of skies
 And earth, knower of all that's done
 In secret or in open won,
 You'll judge between Your servants then
 In those matter about and when
 They have differed *in hearth and den*."
 47 Even if evil-doers had
 All that there is on earth unsad,
 And as much more, it could not fill
 A ransom from the pain and ill
 Of punishment on Judgement's day.
 But something will come in their sway
 From God, which they could never say.
 48 For evils of their deeds will come
 Before them and they will in sum
 Be all surrounded by the thing
 They used to laugh about and sing.

I lay a curse, Beloved, on every man
 Who mocks Your Word by pretending the
 plan
 Is to grant men a hareem of young girls
 In paradise, as everyone who whirls
 Deriding the Qur'an because they think
 It teaches such delights and with a wink.
 Those who read the Qur'an to get reward
 And those who read it to lift up a sword
 Against Your revelation are both stored
 For hell fire and I curse them under gourd
 With Jonah's wrath. Be merciful, my Lord,
 By Your decree alone and leave the floored
 To rage in peace or piece in gauge
 implored.
 Impotently I curse beneath Your scan.

49 Now when the trouble touches man,
 He cries to Us. But when in plan
 We grant a favour on his span
 As from Ourselves, he says "I got
 This because I'm so smart in lot."
 No, this is just a test to see,
 But most of them do not agree.
 50 That's what the many said before.

But all they did was of no *more*
 Profit or help to them *in store*.
 51 No, evil outcome of their acts
 Came up on them. The evil pacts
 Of this, the evil outcome of
 Their deeds will soon come in to shove,
 They'll never bar *Our plan above*.
 52 Don't they know God makes greater or
 Diminishes provision's shore,
 For any He pleases the more?
 In this are signs for faithful score.

I'm very smart or relatively so,
 One in a hundred can best me in show,
 And that's of course a very crowd below
 In any town of size, and that I know.
 And yet intelligence gives me no weight
 Nor even an excuse for a rebate.
 I have no gift or glory from my gait.
 Whether my supposed virtue or my hate
 Reveal a face, I see that I'm not late
 To have security thus far in rate
 Of rice and bread and water in my state.
 You choose to send some to the grave
 without
 A morsel to put in the thin or stout
 Stomach, and some you feed though they're
 in doubt.

54 Say "O my servants who've transgressed
 Against their souls, be still impressed
 By God's mercy, for God forgives
 All sins, He's One often forgives,
 Most merciful *the way He lives*.
 54 "Turn to our Lord, bow to His will,
 Before the penalty fulfil
 On you. After that you will find
 No help for you of any kind.
 55 "And follow the best of revealed
 To you from your Lord not concealed,
 Before the penalty strikes you,
 And suddenly and not in view.
 56 "Lest the soul say 'Ah, woe is me!
 I did neglect my God's duty,
 And was just in the mocking spree.'
 57 "Or lest she say 'If only God
 Had guided me at least with prod,
 I should have sat in righteous pod,'
 58 "Or lest she say to see the pain,
 'If only I'd another plain
 Chance, I should be among the sane!'

"No, but to you my signals came,
 And you rejected all the same,
 You were proud and so you became
 One of the rejecting faith's claim."

Since Your grace falls without the merit
 spoken,
 And based upon the divine decree's token,
 There is some sense in those in hell who
 cry
 "If only God had guided me on sly."
 But all have chosen the false way and path,
 And all deserve the falling of Your wrath.
 If You have chosen to release in grace
 Some of the crowd, You have that right to
 trace.
 It is not an injustice that You send
 Those who reject the message on the bend
 To hell and fire. It's merely mercy that
 You promise some release from the fire's
 fat.
 So justice and grace are Your attributes,
 The one to live, others to feel Your boots.

59 On day of judgement you will see
 Those who told lies of God freely,
 Their faces will turn dark. Is there
 No place in hell for the proud's share?
 61 But God will wave the righteous in
 Their place of salvation to win.
 No evil shall touch them nor be
 There any grief for them to see.
 62 God is Creator of all things,
 And He's the guardian and the wings
 Disposing all affairs and flings.
 63 To Him belong the keys to sky
 And earth, and those who will defy
 The signs of God, it's they who leave
 The signs of God, it's they who grieve
 The loss they're in without reprieve.
 64 Say "Is it someone besides God
 You command me to worship clod,
 O ignorant ones on the sod?
 65 But it's already been revealed
 To you, and to those before sealed,
 "If you join others, truly naught
 Will by your work, and you'll be caught
 In crews of those who lose the lot."
 66 No, but worship God and be of
 Those who give thanks to *God above*.
 67 They've made no right estimate of

God, such as is due to His glove.
On the day of judgement all earth
Will just be a handful in berth,
And the sky rolled in His right hand.
Glory to Him! He's high to stand
Above the partners they have planned.

The lies about You are the ones prevailing
In all theologies that I see sailing
About the institutions of good faith,
Maintainers of the status quo of wraith.
You use all to Your glory, but the frail
And human empires in their power pale
To keep the peace and those of humble veil
Who worship You in truth and without fail.
The ones may be the famous in this life,
The others may fall down before the knife
Of sword and of opinion in the strife,
But in the end all must return to You
And give account for all the things they do.
Then I too shall remember joy and rue.

68 The trump will sound, when all who
stand

In heaven and on earth faint, except
Such as God pleases to have kept.
Then at the second sound, see they
Will stand and look upon the day.

69 And earth will shine with its Lord's ray.
The record will be set in sway,
The prophets and witnesses brought
Out and a just decision taught
Between them, none wronged in the
frouth.

70 And to each soul will be paid full
For her deeds, and God knows the pull
Of all they do responsible.

71 The unbelievers go to hell
In crowds, till they arrive in spell
Its gates will open. Those who keep
It will say "Did not sent ones creep
To you from among yourselves there
Reciting to you your Lord's care
In signs and warning you of share
Of meeting of this day of yours?"
The answer will be: "True in scores,
But punishment's decree in stores
Has proven true against the doors
Of unbelievers in their scores."

72 It will be said "Go in the gates
Of hell to stay there for your rates.

And evil is the dwelling place
Of arrogant ones without grace."

73 Those who feared their Lord will be led
To gardens in crowds to be fed,
Until see their arriving there,
The keepers will say "Peace to share
On you, you have done well to bear,
Come in and live forever there."

74 They'll say "Praise be to God truly
Who has fulfilled His promise wee
To us, and given us land as heir.
We can dwell in the garden here
As well like, how great would appear
The reward for those who work cheer."

75 And you'll see angels round the throne
On every side, singing alone
The glory and praise to their Lord.
The sentence between them will be
In justice and the cry's decree,
"Praise be to God, Lord of worlds free."

Isaiah saw the angels singing round
Your throne in glory and a greater sound,
And since then every church upon the
ground

Has come in liturgy repeating found
The holy, holy, holy of the mound.
Muhammad heard the angels sing again
Before the tide and nourishment of men
"Praise be to God, Lord of the universe"
And turned not from the holy hymn to
worse.

Beloved, I too bow with that word on lips,
And prostrate myself from bowing at hips,
And raise a glory to Your name until
The laws and customs of prayer I fulfil.
But after all is said, You stand there still.

Surah 40 Al-Ghafir, the Forgiver

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
1 Ha, Mim.

2 The revelation of this writing
Is from God high in power and lighting
On knowledge full *and without blighting*.

3 He forgives sin, accepts repenting,
In punishment He's unrelenting,
The sovereign over all in reach.
There's no god but He, to Him then
Is the final goal *for all men*.

Beloved, I thank You truly for this word

Combining all knowledge against absurd.
You do forgive, You do accept repentance,
You do give wicked ones duly their sentence.

You are the sovereign over all and make,
Create, bring down at once to death and stake

Again in resurrection, and by choice
Regenerate the saved ones to rejoice.
Beloved, I read again the summary
Of all truth in Qur'anic verses three
And fall down in prostration on my knee
To give You all the praise and the glory.
There is no god but You and I return
To You at last and in Your love I burn.

4 None can deny and argue why
Of God's signs but unfaithful spy.
Don't let their strutting round the land
Deceive you *of what is at hand*.
5 But before them, folk too denied,
The folk of Noah and the tide
After them, and every folk planned
Against their prophet to seize scanned,
And argued in their vanities,
To condemn the truth as with ease,
But I seized them crushed to their knees.
6 So was the decree of your Lord
Proved so against unfaithful scored,
That truly they are the fire's horde.
7 Those who sustain the Throne and those
Around it sing glory, praise rose
To their Lord. So believe in Him.
Beg forgiveness for faithful vim,
"Our Lord, Your reach is on all things,
In mercy and knowledge that sings,
Forgive those then who turn repenting,
And follow Your path not preventing,
And keep them from the penalty
Of the fire blazing horribly.
8 "Our Lord, grant that they may go in
Gardens eternally to win,
Which You have promised them to stay
And to the righteous ones in sway
Among their ancestors, their wives,
And their posterity that thrives.
For You are high in might and wise.
9 "Keep them from ill and any whom
You do preserve from that day's doom,
On them will You have mercy shown,
That will be highest goal that's known."

Hear, hear! This prayer is great in mercy's sight,
And filled with promises and with delight
As well as with dire warnings for men's right!

The Shi'ite who requires the second reading
In the namaz be a whole one conceding,
In contrast to the Sunni who can take
These three verses in prayer in their estate,
Is limiting Your gift here to relate.
Beloved, I shall pray in the words I find
In every Scripture that's sent to the blind
To bring light in the darkness and the cloud.

Beloved, I join in even with the crowd
Of Sunnis in a mosque, when I'm allowed.
Incog or not, I come humble and proud.

10 The unbelievers will hear said:
"Greater was God's aversion spread
To you than your aversion to
Yourselves, since you were called to do
The faith and you refused the cue."

11 They'll say "Our Lord, twice have You made

Us without life and twice You gave
Us life, now we acknowledge sin.
Is there a way out of the bin?"

12 "This is because when God's invoked
As One alone, you were provoked
To reject faith, but when there joined
Partners with Him, believed purloined.
The command is with God most high,
The greatest above all the sky."

13 He shows you His signs and sends down
Sustenance for you on the town
From the sky, but only those get
Warning who turn to Allah yet.

14 Call then on God sincerely and
With a devotion to His stand,
Even if unbelievers' band
In hatred against it at hand.

15 Raised high above degrees the Lord
Of the throne by command adored
He sends the spirit to the ones
Of His slave He pleases in tonnes,
To warn of day of meeting scored.

I call upon Your names beloved and pray
To be among those in the coming day

Who need not cry aloud to find a way
 Out of the bin of their damnation's sway.
 What loss to universe is it that I
 Return to grave a third time when I die?
 By the same broken, what use is the prayer
 I raise to You in praise upon my stair?
 Beloved, let bliss and blessing pass my
 hand
 As I whirl on the borders of Your land,
 And curse or bless the population here
 By what I lend to You of voice and fear.
 But in Your blessing and Your cursing
 wide,
 I come to You alone and there I hide.

16 The day when they will come abroad,
 Nothing of them's hidden from God.
 Whose will will win upon that day?
 God's, irresistible to pay.
 17 That day will every soul get pay
 For what she's earned, no injustice
 Will there be that day *without bliss*,
 For God's quick in accounts *that miss*.
 18 Warn them of the day coming near,
 When the hearts will right right up sheer
 Into the throats to choke *with fear*.
 No good friend mediating cheer
 With the wrongdoers have come near,
 Who could be listened to *and steer*.
 19 He knows what does deceive their eyes,
 And all hearts hide that men devise.
 20 And God will judge with truth, but those
 Whom men invoke besides His pose,
 Will not be able to judge shows.
 God hears and sees all things and knows.
 21 Do they not travel through the earth
 And see what was the end of those
 Before them. They were in their worth
 Above them in strength and in rows
 In the land. But God at last chose
 To call them to account for sin,
 And no one against God can win.
 22 That was because there came to them
 Such messengers with a clear gem,
 But they rejected them. So God
 Called them to an account, His prod
 Is strong and punishment is broad.

Today there's more of travel, I do think,
 Than what was done in the days on the
 brink

Of the Qur'an's arrival on the link.
 The coffers of the bookers sound the clink
 Of tickets sold to tourists white and pink.
 And yet I see no more awareness now
 That ruins witness that old nations bow
 Before their punishment after the chance
 Blown that You gave them to conform and
 dance
 To Your tunes. Now the tunes where
 preachers prance
 Before religious folk make look askance.
 Beloved, I too have travelled and I'm jaded
 With seeing ruins common and paraded.
 I rarely take the warning they're degraded.

If ruins of the errant and the punished
 Are witnesses transgression is unfinished,
 Then when the Afghans blew up Buddhist
 Buddha,
 They showed themselves to be not only
 cruder,
 But ruinous of signs that You set out
 To warn the world of what You are about.
 Shame on iconoclastic Muslims and
 Shame on the Christian and the Jewish
 stand
 That sees only destruction of fine art
 Instead of the grand lessons on Your part.
 Beloved, You should have had me in the
 cart
 Advising Taliban where not to start,
 And everyone could have been happy when
 Explosives were saved for a later yen.

23 We sent Moses of old with Our
 Signs and with clear authority,
 24 To Pharaoh, and to Haman's power,
 To Korah, but they called him see
 A sorcerer lying freely.
 25 Now when he came to them in truth,
 From Us, they said "Kill sons of youth
 Who have believed with him, and keep
 Alive their daughters left to weep,
 But the plots of the unbelievers
 End in nothing but error weavers.
 26 Said Pharaoh, "Let me kill Moses,
 And let him summon Lord of his.
 I fear he'll change your faith to his,
 Or make mischief in the land's biz."
 27 Moses said "I've indeed called on
 My Lord and your Lord from each pawn

Of arrogance not to believe
In the day an account will grieve.”

The critic says that You and Muhammad
Were ignorant of all the things that had
Been written down before of what was sad
When Pharaoh kill the babies, which was
bad.

It was done at the birth of Moses, not
When he returned to Pharaoh with a plot.
The Bible says it was done at the birth,
The Qur'an says it happened for the girth
Of Moses coming back, but neither state
It did not happen in the other's rate.
There is no contradiction to say twice
A thing appeared, especially a vice
On the part of kings. We know they're not
nice.

The arguments of critics don't suffice.

28 A man believing from the court
Of Pharaoh concealing in sort
His faith, said “Will you kill a man
Because he says 'My Lord's Allah'?
When he's come to you with clear signs
From your Lord? If he lies in lines,
Let his sin of lying be his.
But if he's telling truth that is,
Then what he's warning of will fall
Upon you. God guides not at all
One who transgresses and lies *tall*.

29 “O my folk, yours is power today,
You got upper hand in the land.
But who'll help us from God's command
Of punishment, if it should fall?
Pharaoh said “I just show you what
I see, I do not guide you but
To the right path *and keep unshut*.”

30 Then said the man who believed, “My
People, I fear for you to die
Like on the day of the ally.

31 “Something of the fat of the folk
Of Noah, the 'Ad, and the stroke
Of the Thamud, and those who came
After them. But God has no claim
Of injustice to His slaves' fame.

32 “O my folk, I fear for the day
When you'll have a calling away,
33 “A day when you turn back and flee,
No defender for you shall be
From God. Any God leaves to stray,

There is no guide beside the way.
34 “And to you there came Joseph in
Times past with clear signs, but in din
You did not stop doubting his coming.
At last when he died, you said humming:
'No messenger with God send now
After him.' So God anyhow
Lets go astray such as transgress
And live in doubt and not confess,
Disputing about God signs with
No authority but the myth
That has reached them in grief and hate
In God's sight and believers' state.
So God seals every heart of those
Who arrogantly come oppose.”

Why does no critic rise to say this word
Is quoted from Gamaliel absurd
When he rose in the Sanhedrin and stirred
His hearers with the same word
undeterred?

The fact is there is no end to the shame
Of finding this and that in books to blame,
But what's the use and what's the fruit and
gain

Except to cause more strife as well as pain?
Beloved, You lend Your truth and spirit yet
To those You will and in their hearts have
set

Assurance of salvation from all time
And from eternity's decree sublime.
The arguments, though filled with wisdom
now

Convince no heart except the ones that
bow.

36 Pharaoh said “O Haman, build me
A palace high, so I may see
The way to attaining freely.

37 “The way to attain heavens above,
And ascend to Moses' god's shove,
But as far as I am concerned,
I think he's a liar and spurned.”
So it seemed right in Pharaoh's eyes
The evil of his deeds in guise,
And he was hindered from the path.
Pharaoh's planning just led to wrath.

Why not accuse the Qur'an at this spot
Of copying and falsely so the plot
Of how the tower of Babel built and got

Attention from You when You took a look
At what the wicked crew had come to
cook?

The palace that should reach the sky indeed
Has been invented more times and with
speed

That one can count in dynasties of greed.
The Bible mentions one, Qur'an another,
But in reality of earth, my brother,
There have been hundreds and indeed
today

There are more than ever before to sway.
Let those skyscrapers then fulfil their way
Until the day when they must come to pay.

38 The man who believed further said

"O my folk, follow me, I've led
You to the right path now instead.

39 "O my folk, this life presently
Is just convenience here to see.
It's the hereafter that is home

That will last from it not to roam.

40 "He who does evil will not be
Rebated but with the like to see.

And the one who works righteousness,
Where man or woman's address,
And is a believer, such will
Enter the garden. They will fill
Abundance without out measure's bill.

41 "And O my folk, how's it for me
To call you to salvation free
While you call me to fire in spree!

42 "You call me to blaspheme Allah
And join with Him partners in awe
Of whom I have no knowledge straw,
And I call you to that high power
Who will forgive you hour by hour.

43 "Without doubt you call me to one
Who's not fit to be called when done,
Whether in this world or to come.

Our return is to God in sum,
Transgressors land in fire to hum.

44 "Soon you'll remember what I say
To you, my own self I relay
To God, for God guards His own slaves."

45 Then Allah is the One who saves
Him from the evil they had planned,
But punishment fell on the sand
All around Pharaoh's folk and band.

Beloved, let me take Haman's foe's advice,

Although the critic thinks now once or
twice

That Haman is a man who lived and died
Long after Pharaoh's and Moses' carbidé.

Beloved, let me not join to You in sum
Any idol or man however rum,

Nor take to worship concepts and carved
ware

Which You should never have to bear or
share.

Return to You, Beloved, when I'm made
bare

Is all I need or want of glory's care.

I lay both book and company aside
And find in You my church where to abide.

Let others argue of the great divide,
Let others care for better groom and bride.

46 They'll be brought before fire at morn
And at the eventide forlorn.

And on the day of judgement set:

"Throw Pharaoh's folk in the worst yet!"

47 See, they will quarrel in the fire.

The weak ones will say without tire

To those who were proud, "We just came
To follow you, so take our blame
Of the fire's punishment in claim."

48 Those who were arrogant will say
"We'll all here, indeed God today

Has judged between servants for pay."

49 Those in the fire will say to those
Who keep hell, "Beg your Lord that chose
To lighten us the penalty
For a day from eternity."

50 They'll say "Did there not come to you
Your messengers with signs in view?"

They will say "Yes." Then they'll reply,
"Then pray, but the prayer and the sigh
Of those without faith will not fly."

51 We will without doubt help the ones
We sent and those believing tonnes,

In this world's life and on the day
When witnesses stand up to bray,

52 The day when no profit will be
To the wrongdoers in the spree
To give excuse, but they'll just see
The curse and home of misery.

More fervent prayers are never heard in
time,

Not in cathedrals, not in humble mime

Of laura or of church house or to climb
 In minarets in empires still sublime,
 Than those prayers prayed in hell, that
 place of prayer
 Beyond all synagogues for tear and ware.
 Beloved, I have loved prayer above all
 things,
 Above both women and perfumes in wings,
 Said the good prophet, so perhaps You'll
 choose
 To set him down in hell not to refuse
 To pray eternally. I'll join him there
 To praise you ever on the flaming stair.
 Cast me, Beloved, with prophets or without
 Into petitions' oft-promised redoubt.

53 We did give Moses in the past
 The guidance and we gave to last
 The writ of an inheritance
 To Israel's folk *for song and dance*,
 54 A guide and message to such men
 As have understanding again.
 55 Be patient then and persevere.
 For God's promise true will appear.
 And ask forgiveness for your sin,
 And celebrate praises in din
 For your Lord in the eve and in
 The morning tide, *if you would win*.
 56 Those who wrangle about the signs
 Of God without Our own designs,
 There's nothing in their breasts but wish
 To be great, which upon their dish
 Will never come. Seek refuge then
 In God, He hears and sees again.

You gave the verses, signs or miracles
 Of revelation to Moses' muddles,
 And ask me to be patient, bear in mind,
 And understand them and so be resigned.
 Beloved, not many read the Qur'an and
 Still accept what You gave by Moses' hand
 And walk according to the pure command.
 I wonder that Your will is such that one
 Is brought into Your promised blessings
 done,
 While hundred dead in sins feel no
 remorse,
 And only mock the law as without force.
 I wonder, my Beloved, and yet I find
 All round me miracles and undersigned,
 All round me twitterings of the unblind.

57 Surely creation of the skies
 And earth is greater matter's guise
 Than the creation of men. Still
 Most men don't understand the bill.
 58 Not equal are the blind and those
 Who see, nor the believers' rose
 And workers of righteous deeds and
 Those who do evil in the land.
 Little have you learned of command.
 59 The hour will come sure without doubt.
 Most men don't know what they're about.
 60 And your Lord says "Call on Me, I
 Will answer. But those who would vie
 In arrogance not to serve Me
 Will land in hell eternally."

Call on Me and I'll answer is a word
 You said first by Job, David and was heard
 In the voice of the prophet that You stirred
 From youth, poor Jeremiah, who
 concurred.
 When that fair promised entered the Qur'an,
 The birds who sang with David at the dawn
 Rejoiced to hear the Arabic outdrawn.
 In every language all around the world
 Your promises, Beloved, are oft unfurled,
 And swallows join the cranes to spread the
 sound
 Of glory coming down upon the ground.
 Call on Me and I'll answer. Beloved, I
 Call once again, and once again You're
 nigh,
 Lift high the sema', on the dergah fly.

61 It's Allah who has made the night
 For you to rest in it from sight
 Of days that help you see *your plight*.
 God's full of grace, bounty to men.
 Yet most men give no thanks again.
 62 Such is God, your Lord the Creator
 Of all things, there is no god mater
 But He, how are you led astray
 From the truth that has come in sway!
 63 So they're deluded who are used
 To rejecting God's signs refused.
 64 God made for you the earth to rest,
 And the sky a canopy blessed,
 And has formed you and made you fine,
 And given you with which to dine
 On pure and good, and such is God

Your Lord. So glory be to God
The Lord of universe in prod.
65 He is the living. There's no god
But He. Call on him sincerely
And with devotion. So praise be
To God, Lord of the worlds truly.

Where I live, my Beloved, the earth to rest
May very well be made of very best
Of granite and of quartzite to give zest.
But where I live, Beloved, the canopy
Of sky is far from enough on the sly.
When the cold silently steps on the rye
And slips into the cupboards and the room,
A mute and frugal harbinger of doom,
I fear I need a warmer covering.
Be my praise not a mocker and farthing,
But a response to cloak of wool and bright
To cover me and warm against the night
Of winter on my terraces in slight,
And on the paths that lead me into right.

66 Say "I'm prohibited to call
On those whom you invoke in stall
Besides God, since clear signs have come
To me from my Lord. At the drum
I've been commanded to bow down
To Lord of universe *and town*."

67 It's He created you from dust,
And then from a sperm-drop in must,
And then from a leech-like blood clot,
Then He brings you out from the slot
As a babe, then lets you attain
Your age in strength, then lets you wane
With age, though some of you die first,
Then lets you reach appointed pursed,
So you become in wisdom versed.
68 He gives life and death, and when He
Decides a matter, He says "Be",
And so it is *eternally*.

69 Do you not see the ones who make
A wrangling for God's signs at stake?
How are they turned away to bake?
70 Those who reject the book and what
We sent our messengers in glut,
But soon they shall know in the gut,
71 When yokes around their necks be shut
And chains, they will be dragged along,
72 In boiling, stinking liquid strong,
Then in the fire burned to a rut,
73 It will be told them, "Where are those

You took for worship and you chose,
74 Disdaining God?" They will reply,
"They've left us in the lurch thereby.
No, we in times past called awry."
So God lets unbelievers lie.
75 "That was because you would rejoice
On earth in things that were your choice
Instead of truth, and you would be
Insolent there in vast degree.
"Come in the gates of hell to stay,
Evil's the arrogant ones' pay."

Kun is the word. By that word You create
The heavens above in star-resounding fate,
The earth beneath in gold and tin and soil,
The sea about in tinseled fish and coil,
The air on which the birches and the firs
Reside to bear witness to what occurs.
Kun is the word let be, and so all things
Become and flourish to remark Your
wings.

Beloved, I praise You for creation's peal,
For halls of glory above what I feel,
For sulphured palaces below that reel,
For quiet days and nights beyond the wheel
Of slaughter ground where I press on for
weal

While woe remains upon the brass and
steel.

77 So persevere in patient way,
For God's promise is true to stay,
And if We show you here a part
Of what is promised them from start,
Or if We take your soul, it's just
To Us all return from the dust.

78 In times past We sent before you
Messengers, We've told stories true,
And some whose story We've not told.
No messenger could be so bold
To bring a sign but by God's leave.
But when God's command to grieve,
Affairs were determined to be
In truth and justice as decree,
And there so they perished, then and there,
Those who stood on falsehoods in share.

79 God made you cattle, so you may
Use some for riding, some for hay,
80 And there are other benefits
In them for you, so by your wits
You may get what your hearts may need.

On them and on ships you're with speed
Transported and carried indeed.
81 And He shows you His signs, so which
Of God's signs will you throw in ditch?
82 Do they not travel through the earth
To see the end of those in berth
Before them? They were greater and by far
In number and strength than these are,
And traces are left in the land.
Yet all they attained did not stand.
83 For when their messengers came to
Them with clear signs, they proudly drew
On knowledge as they had in view,
But very things at which they laughed
At last they came to them and quaffed.
84 But when they saw Our punishment,
They said "We believe in what God meant,
The one God, and we reject those
Partners with Him that we once chose."
85 But their profession of faith when
They see Our punishment on men
Will profit none of them again.
God's way of dealing with His slaves.
Those who reject the God who saves
Come to perish in hellish waves.

Those who're convinced of You, Beloved,
by fear
Of what they see fall on the morning clear
Of some destruction, are not touched by
grace.
They only flee to save their skin from
mace.
No rebirth from the death in sins takes
place.
Those who so pretend faith still do reject,
Though they may not know that what they
select
Is nothing but the sense and touch of flesh,
Succumbing to the slavery of the mesh.
Beloved, I turn toward the fire and flame
And like the moth rush in the dangered
game,
And wait for You to catch me in the glow
Or let me headlong fall into the low.
You only save me from the come and go.

Surah 41 Ha Mim, or Ha Mim Sajda, or Fussilat

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
1 Ha, Mim. 2 A revelation from

Most Gracious, Most Merciful come,
3 A book with verses clearly taught,
Qur'an in Arabic unsought
For folk who understand a lot,
4 With good news and with warning's plot.
But most of them turn back and got
Nothing to hear, for they hear not.
5 They say "Our hearts are under veils
From what you call us to in sales,
And in our ears a deafness rises
Between us and your screen devises,
So do your own thing, we'll do ours."
6 Say "I have only human powers
Like you. It is revealed to me
By inspiration, so you see
Your God is one God. So stand true
To Him and ask pardon for rue."
And woe to those who join gods with
Allah, *woe to any such myth*,
7 Those who do not work charity,
Deny coming eternity.
8 For those who believe and do deeds
Of righteousness is payment's pleads
That never fail or turn to weeds.

The heart under a veil is common here.
The excuse is that though it falls on ear,
The truth has not enlightened me with tear,
And so the proclamation come to me
Is not an obligation or duty.
Of course, I look around and see the way
The argument of the clever in sway
Cannot be met by lesser minds at bay.
But does that give the right to reject grace
Of reason when it's thrust into one's face?
I am alone intelligent enough
So far that I with reason can rebuff?
I trow not, but expect You to show then
Effects of grace You pour out here on men.

9 Say "Do you deny Him who made
The earth in two days on parade?
And do you join equals with Him?
He's Lord of universe in vim.
10 He set the mountains standing fast,
High above and poured blessings last
On earth apportioning all things
To give them nourishment in wings,
In four days more, by what they seek.
11 He included the sky in peek,
And it was like the smoke to reek.

He said to it and to the earth,
 "Come now together in your berth,
 Whether you will or no for worth."
 They said "We do come as You say
 In willing obedience lay."
 12 So He completed them to be
 The seven firmaments in spe
 In two days and assigned to each
 Its duty and command to reach.
 And We adorned the lower sky
 With lights and with a guard to vie.
 Such is the decree of the one
 Exalted in might, wise when done.

The quoting of the books of Enoch here
 Is blessing beyond blessing to the ear,
 Abundance on abundant faith and gear.
 The seven firmaments each in their way
 Are filled with glory in both night and day,
 And show the truth to all who come to
 pray.

Beloved, the books of Enoch are not found
 Among the many who upon the ground
 Proclaim to be Your true and only sound.
 Let me depart from those who fail to see
 The wonders that Enoch placed before me
 And those that You chose to know what is
 rare
 And what is bright and what is dark and
 fair.

I see Enoch look on eternity.

13 But if they turn away, then say
 "I've warned you of the coming pay
 Like that which took 'Ad and Thamud."
 14 See messengers came to the rude,
 Before and after them, "Serve none
 But God alone." They said when done,
 "If our Lord had wanted the fun,
 He would have sent down angels won,
 So we reject your mission's pun."

The arrogant always set up a test
 By which they refuse ever to invest
 In truth. This time the lack of angel's nest
 Suffices to say Your mission's just guessed.
 The arrogant today require no rod
 Of angel to accede to love of God.
 It is enough that the book departs from
 The myth that settled in the heart with
 scum

And in the darkened mind dumbled down
 with hum.

Beloved, let me not demand angel song,
 Nor text that measures not to my own
 wrong,

But let me cantillate the verses here
 With joyful heart and with a hand to fear.
 Then I shall meet Your angels with good
 cheer.

15 The 'Ad behave arrogantly
 Throughout the land, against the see
 Of truth and reason, and they said
 "Who is better than us and led
 In strength?" What did they not see God
 Who had created them on sod
 Was better than they in strength's prod?
 But they continued to reject
 Our signs and so came to neglect.
 16 So We sent on them a wind's blast
 Through catastrophic days to last,
 So We might give them just a taste
 Of punishment and shame disgraced
 In this life. But the penalty
 Of the hereafter, it will be
 More shameful yet, with no help's fee.

You may well send destroying wind on
 men

Who have rejected signs time and again,
 But every wind that comes destroying us
 Is not a necessary divine fuss.
 Instead for certain every evil thing
 That falls on humankind in this life's spring
 Remains a taste and small one of the sting
 Of the hereafter, a more shameful ring.
 Beloved, let me neglect no sign You send
 Upon the dawn or the dark night to bend
 The birches as they whisper, bow and lend
 My heart the ears to hearken to their end.
 Beloved, receive my hope of punishment
 On everything that is bent and unbent.

17 We brought Thamud guidance in sight,
 But they preferred blindness to right,
 So punishment in shame seized them,
 Because of what they'd earned in hem.
 18 But We saved those who had believed
 And practised righteousness reprieved.

Guidance is sent upon all men in grace,

But mercy only touches righteous face,
Those who believe instead of doubting
race,
Those who practice the righteousness You
trace.

The punishment is earned, while Your
salvation

Is grace and grace alone within its ration.
That's why the guidance is sent upon all,
And why the lost are given strength and
gall

To carry out their misdeeds to the wall.
Hell must be earned with sweat and blood
and fear.

It's only paradise that's free for cheer.
The price of hell is every act and deed.
The price of paradise is just its greed,
The hope and measure of the human need.

19 On the day God's foes will be brought
Together to the fire in plot,

They'll be marched in ranks for their lot.

20 At last when they reach it their ears
And eyes and skins will to their fears
Bear witness against them for what
Their deeds upon the earth were shut.

21 They'll say to their skins, "Why do you
Bear witness against what we do?"
They'll say "God's given us the speech,
He gives speech to all things and each.
He made you for the first time and
To Him you must return in band.

22 "You did not try to hide yourselves,
Lest your hearing and sight like elves
And your skins should bear witness then
Against you. But you thought again
That God did not know in His den
The many things you did in pen.

23 "But what you thought about your Lord
Had brought you to destruction's sword,
And you've become lost for reward."

I try not to blame people much for what
They chatter in my ear opened or shut.
I know good James is harsh about the fact
That people say the right as well as act
According to the wrong of tongue and lung.
Maybe the choice is rather to be sung.
I try not to blame people for their speech
Since I know that You gave the gift to
each,

And no one can raise a voice but by that
Sweet power You gave him like an acrobat.
Beloved, give me the speech I need to rant
And rattle in the wilderness of scant
And timid population where I glow
With messages both speedy and the slow.

24 If they just wait the fire will be
A home for them. And if they're free
To wait for the fire patiently,
It will be a home for them. If
They pray to be taken in skiff,
They'll not get into favour stiff.
25 We've destined for them mates like they
To lure them from behind and lay
Before them too. The sentence passed,
On early generations cast,
Of jinn and men, all those who've passed
Away, is counted in their blast,
For they are truly lost at last.

I told you the mates destined in hell rate
More in the eyes of those who take that
fate.

They are the young ones decked out in the
state

Of virgins, despite prostitution's pate.
The punishment of hell is that new skin
Returns to cover that burnt from within,
And by the same blame token hymen grows
Back every time its broken in the throes.
Beloved, hell is a brothel, which is why
So many go there quickly or else try.
The martyrs suicidal will not know
They've landed in hell, just because the
show

Is what they thought and hoped for on the
go.

Destine me no mate of that place below!

26 The unbelievers say "Hear not
This recitation, but talk sot
While it is read, so you may gain
The upper hand *and see the stain.*"

In the same way the hypocrites of old
Came out disdainfully as well as bold
To cause disturbance of the Scriptures read,
So those now called both Muslims and
well-bred

Are often ready to raise cue and cry

Against the former Scriptures coming by.
They claim it's Jewish to read Torah high.
They claim the Gospel's Christian on the
sly.

At last the Qur'an too will come to die⁴⁵

Then Allah is the One who saves
Him from the evil they had planned,
But punishment fell on the sand
All around Pharaoh's folk and band.
In hand of those without respect for what
You chose the first time round to put in gut.
Beloved, the disrespectful tune is raised
Each time Your name on earth here has
been praised.

In secret I recite so I'm unfazed.

27 But We'll give unbelievers taste
Of a harsh punishment to waste,
And We'll reward them by the worst
Of their deeds casting on them cursed.
28 Such is recompense of God's foes,
The fire, for them eternal throes,
Requit for rejecting signs
That We had sent into their lines.

Rejecting signs, ayaat, the verses sent,
Includes rejecting not just what they meant,
But also to neglect their recitation
As service of remembrance and elation.
For lack of dhikr men are thrown in hell,
The wicked with the righteous-looking
swell,
And all are left to take their punishment
Without a recitation being lent.
The dearth on earth of Word of God's the
threat

Of prophets before Muhammad was met,
And dearth in hell of the Qur'an will be
The spring of thirst for many, glory be!
Beloved, hide in my heart the gloried
Word,
And even in the lowest hell I'm stirred.

29 The unbelievers say "Our Lord,
Show us those among jinns and scored
Men who misled us, we shall crush
Them under our feet in the rush,
So they'll turn into a vile mush.
30 As for those who say "Our Lord's God,"
And stand tall and steadfast on sod,
The angels come down for reprieve,

"Do not be afraid, do not grieve,
But the good news of bliss receive,
Which you were promised *by God's leave*.
31 "We are your guards in this life and
In the hereafter, in your hand
Shall you have all you want to stand,
You'll get all you ask for in band,
32 "A welcome present from the One
Oft-forgiving, merciful One."

The creed of just war is based on the word
Of unbelievers when they are all stirred
With such hypocrisy to demand light
From You, Beloved, to show once in their
sight
The guilty among jinn and human wight,
So they can crush them all in wicked plight.
Such were the grand crusades, such was the
grade
Of caliphatic armies on parade,
And such the conquest that Cortez had
made
On Mexico for an indulgence trade.
Beloved, give me excuse for no war here,
But You protect my life, my kin and gear,
And let me die with never any fear
But of Your face, Beloved, Your face come
near.

33 Who's better in speech than the one
Who calls to God, works righteousness,
And says "I am of the address
Of those who bow in Islam's dress?"
34 Nor can goodness and evil be
Equal. Withstand with what in fee
Is better. Then hatred between
You and another will turn back
As it were a friend in your lack.
35 None will have such goodness except
Those who work patience and adept
At self-restraint, none but the folk
Of greatest good luck at a stroke.
36 If evil one sows in you wish
To discord, seek in God the dish
Of refuge. He's the One who hears
And knows each thing here that appears.
37 Among His signs are night and day,
The sun and moon. Worship not such,
The sun and moon, but rather much
Worship God only, who made them,
If He's the one you wish to serve.

38 But if they're arrogant, don't swerve.
For in the presence of your Lord
Are those who celebrate adored
His praises night and day. And they
Are never tired in service sway.

39 Among His signs in this, you see
The earth laid bare and desolate.
But when We send down rain freely,
It's stirred to life and yields its rate.
He who gives life to barren earth
Can surely give men in their berth
Life though they are dead of no worth.
He's power over all things *not late*.

40 Those who change the truth in Our signs
Are not hidden from Our designs.
Which is the better? The one cast
Into the fire, or he to last
Through safe to judgement day and passed?
Do what you wish, indeed He sees
All that you do *and all you please*.

Which is the better, fire or pleasure,
And in speech those who utter treasure
Of Your storehouse or those who creep
With doubtful slathering and peep?
Creator of speech, so You are and stay,
And some You create in the better way,
And others take the evil for their pay.
There's difference between waking and
sleep.

Beloved, give me the works of
righteousness
And that true faith of Islam to confess
That does not fool with those who would
impress

By choosing one book to the detriment
Of any other book that You have sent.
Lone dervish I may be by Your consent.

41 Those who reject the message when
It comes to them; it's among men
A writ high in its power again.

42 No lie can come near it before
Or from behind. It's sent in store
Down by One full of wisdom's lore,
Worthy of all praise *all the more*.

43 Nothing is said to you that's not
Revealed before in sent ones' lot.
Your Lord has at His orders sought
Forgiveness as well as a plot
Of grievous punishment *untaught*.

44 If We had sent this as Qur'an
Other than Arabic outdrawn,
They would have said "Why are not its
Verses explained clearly as sits?

What! Not in Arabic and yet
An Arab messenger and set?"
Say "It's a guide and healing to
Those who believe. And for the crew
Who don't believe, there's in their ears
A deafness, and blindness appears
In them. They are as called from far."

45 We surely gave Moses the star
Book once before, but argument
Came up about what the book meant.
Had it not been that a Word went
Out from before your Lord, they might
Have settled the thing out of sight.

But they stayed in suspicious plight,
With doubting about what was right.

46 Whoever works in righteousness
Benefits his own soul in dress,
Whoever works evil, then it
Is against his own soul *in fit*:
Nor is your Lord ever unjust
To His slaves *as some masters trust*.

I am unjust who only see in part,
While You, Beloved, see down into the
heart.

Who has both parts and guts must be
unjust,
Impartiality is not of dust.
But You who know no limits, no, nor
slices,

Can be alone impartial in complices.
The evil must attain the action that's
Accomplished rash and blindly, like the
bat's.

The One who sees without an eye and hears
Without an ear alone knows what appears.
The good belongs, Beloved, to You alone,
And thus You only have a heart not stone.
That heart of Yours it is that I make mine,
And so exchange for good what could not
shine.

47 To Him's the knowledge of the hour.
No date forms from its sheath to shower,
Nor does a female conceive power
To bring forth on the day that's set
To question them, "Where are the met

Partners of Mine?" They'll say "We do
Assure you none of us in view
Can take a testimony's pew."

48 The ones they used to call on then
Before will leave them in the fen,
And they'll see no way of escape.

49 Man's never tired to stand and gape
For asking good, but if ill touch
Him, he gives up all hope as much
And is lost in despairing clutch.

50 When We give him a mercy's taste
From Ourselves after trouble's waste
Has touched him, his is sure to say
"This is due to my goodness' sway.
I don't think judgement's hour's in pay.
But if I'm brought back to my Lord,
I still have much good that is stored
In His sight!" But We'll show their way
Who don't believe truth of what they
Did, and We'll give to them in pay
A taste of punishment to stay.

When We give man grace, he will turn
Away and get himself as stern
The other way. When evils burn
Him, then he prays so long to earn.
52 Say "Do you see it comes from God,
And still reject it on the sod?
Who's more astray than one who is
In separation from the biz?"

53 Soon We will show them our signs in
The regions and in their souls' sin
Till it is clear to them this is
The truth. Does it not now suffice
That your Lord witnesses each slice?
54 Ah, they're in doubt, are they about
The meeting with their Lord with shout?
Indeed, He surrounds all about.

Doubt in the reading of the book results
In sects and shoutings and at last insults.
Doubt about Your signs comes at last to
bear

On what will happen to that soul and where
She'll come to spend eternity and wear.
Show Your signs, my Beloved, on sin or by
The good deed that You ordain on the sly,
But as You show Your signs, let me rejoice
To find that You enter the world with
voice.

The silence of Your signs points me back
to

The only sermon You have preached in
view,
The Decalogue to show the way that's true.
There would be no sects if that word were
seen
By all who pose for truth upon the screen.

Surah 42 Shura, or Consultation

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 Ha Mim. 2 'Ain, Sin, Qaf.

3 He sends the inspired word to you
As to those before you in view,
God high in power, of wisdom too.

4 To Him are all in heaven and earth,
He's most high, greatest *of all worth*.

5 The skies nearly tear in half from
Above them *with the glory come*,
The angels celebrate the praise
Of their Lord, and pray Him to raise
Forgiveness for beings on earth.
See, God is He, the oft-forgiving,
Most merciful *to all things living*.

The angels through millennia have raised
To You their voices in the ways they've
praised,

And yet I hope to vie with them to make
Your praises know at least about the lake
And woods I tramp for the fall berry's sake
And looking for the mushrooms that
sometime

Delight me on the years when they are
prime.

All in the sky and on the earth remain
Your own, and yet I see no other gain
For me than cantillation of Your name.
The goals of man and neighbour are a
game.

Beloved, this hymn of Shura makes me sad
That I have not a greater voice to clad
My praises with, and show a brighter
flame.

6 And those who take as guards beside
Him others, God does not abide
To watch over them. You are not
Responsible for them in plot.

7 So We sent by the inspiration
To you a Qur'an in the ration
Of Arabic, so you can warn
The mother of cities that's torn

And all around her, warn them of
 The day of gathering above,
 Of which there is not doubt or shove.
 Some will be in the garden then,
 Some in the blazing fire again.
 8 If God had so willed He could have
 Made them a single folk *like Slav*,
 But He takes whom He will into
 His mercy and wrongdoers' crew
 Will have no protection in view.
 What! Have they taken besides Him
 Protectors? But Allah is grim,
 He is the protector and He
 Gives life to the dead. It is He
 Who has power over all you see,
 10 Whatever way you disagree,
 Decision's with God, so is God
 My Lord, In Him I trust for prod,
 And to Him I turn *faithfully*.
 11 Creator of the skies and earth,
 He's made for you mates in your berth,
 And pairs among the cattle too.
 This way does He multiply you.
 There's nothing at all like His view,
 And He hears and sees all you do.
 12 To Him the keys of heavens and earth,
 He broadens and restricts the berth.
 His gives sustenance as He will.
 He knows all things and knows them still.

I fear to take protectors for my place,
 My days of toil, my nights of sleep in
 grace,
 For fear that You abandon me and mine
 And leave me to the emptiness of vine.
 I fear to take the idol and the store
 Of gun and power not to mention more
 The missile and the tank to keep my shore.
 Instead I wait for You alone to save
 Me from the torment and grief of the grave.
 Beloved, the Arabic is clear enough
 To show me that You're the one who is
 tough,
 And I need sustenance alone from You,
 No matter what the battle marks construe,
 No matter what the kings and priests may
 brew.

13 The same faith He has set for you
 As that He gave in Noah's view,
 Which We've sent by inspiring word

To you, and that which We made heard
 To Abraham, Moses, Jesus:
 Namely that you stay without fuss
 Steadfast in faith and do not make
 Division in it. Those who take
 To worship other things than God,
 Hard is the way in which they trod
 As you call them. God chooses to
 Himself those whom He's pleased to view,
 And guides to Himself those who turn
To Him repenting and to learn.
 14 And they became divided then
 Only after knowledge in ken
 Reached them, through selfish envy's way
 Between themselves. If in its sway
 A Word that went out from before
 Your Lord had not come at the door
 Of time appointed, the issue's score
 Would have been settled on their floor.
 But those who're heirs to the book that
 Came after them, remained out flat
 Suspicious and in doubt of that.

The books of revelation come here cause
 Divisions of humankind and in laws.
 It is Your will that sects proliferate
 And as far as I see none of them state
 The simple, basic truth in all its glory.
 Each faith has just a part of the whole
 story,
 And every faith has falsehood at the core
 As well as in idolatry in store.
 Beloved, I too am human in this place,
 And it were egotism in my trace
 To separate myself from human sect
 And claim a place aloof and so elect.
 But keep my heart wholly for You alone
 No matter what pope sits upon the throne.

15 Now then for that reason call them
 And stand steadfast as like a gem
 You are commanded, nor go in
 Their vain desires, but say to win,
 "I believe in the book that God
 Has sent down, and commanding rod
 Makes me judge justly between you.
 God is our Lord and your Lord too.
 For us our deed, for you yours too.
 There's no contention between us
 And you. God will bring all of us
 Together, and to Him at last

Is the final goal of our cast.

16 But those who argue about God
After He's been accepted prod,
Vain's their argument in Lord's sight,
On them is wrath, for them the plight
Of terrible punishment's night.

17 God sent down the true book and then
The balance to weigh acts of men.
And what will make you realize
The hour may be close to your eyes?

18 Only those wish to hasten it
Who do not believe in it fit.

Those who believe hold it in awe,
And know it is the truth in law.
See those who argue about time
Are far astray *and lost in crime*.

If Daniel in the Bible and the book
Of Revelation predict Islam's hook,
At least the crimes of the Umayyad crook
And the Abbasid no good man mistook,
Then here the holy Qur'an comes to make
Prediction of the Millerites at stake,
Who hastened on the day of doom and
made

The dates come quickly on and in parade.
They said that those who then rejected what
They taught of the world's end had then
been shut

Out of salvation for failing to love
The lie that Christ would come down from
above.

Beloved, I thank You that You have saved
me

For that system of infidelity.

19 God's gracious to His servants here.
He makes His nourishment appear
To whom He pleases. He has power
To carry out His will and hour.
20 To any who desires the plot
Of the hereafter, We give lot
To his increase, and to the one
Who desires tilth of this world's fun,
We grant a bit of it, but he
Has no share in eternity.

21 What! Do they have partners to be
Who have set for them some faith free
Without the leave of God to see?
Had it not been for the decree
Of judgement, the issue would be

Decided between them in fee.

But the wrongdoers will receive
A grievous pain without reprieve.
22 You'll see wrongdoers in such fear
Because of what they've earned in gear,
That must come to fall on their ear.
But those who believe and do right
Will be in gardens of delight.
They'll have before their Lord in sight
All that they wish *for day and night*.

That will indeed be excellent
In gracious bounty and intent.
23 That is the bounty of which gives
Allah the gospel news that lives
To His servants, those who believe
And do righteous deeds to receive.
Say "No reward ask I of you
For this except the love that's due
To my nearest of kin in view."
And if any one earns the good,
We shall give him increase of good
For that, for Allah's Oft-Forgiving,
Ready to praise service of living.

Ah, who, Beloved, are those near relatives
To that great prophet to whom You gave
voice?

Not each who claims to be descended lives
The life to earn the good required and
choice!

Let me love then, Beloved, those near of
kin

Of that great Prophet, lives of whom
wherein

I see the marks of favour as divine
Guides and exemplary, living design,
Who love the right and hate the wrong
without

A falter or a failure, without doubt
Your holy law come in the flesh to all
Who longingly will listen to Your call.
Increase the good of those most pious lives,
And that of each who follows them and
strives.

24 What! Do they say "He's lying now
Against God"? But if God somehow
So willed, He could seal up your heart.
God blots out vanity to start,
And proves the truth by His words' dart.
He knows secrets of every heart.

25 He accepts from His slaves repentance
 And forgives them their sins in sentence,
 And He knows all you do, not part.
 26 He hears those who believe and do
 Right and gives them increase as due
 Of His bounty. But for the ones
 Who don't believe, there's pain in tonnes.
 27 If God increased His slaves provision,
 They'd surely transgress in division
 Beyond all bounds throughout the world.
 He sends down in due measure furl'd
 As He wills, for He knows His slaves
 With watchful eye *He guards and waves*.
 He sends down rain after hope's lost,
 And scatters His mercy embossed.
 He's the Protector to be praised.
 29 Among His signs are heavens raised
 And earth and living creatures there
 Scattered through them. He has the power
 To gather them and in an hour
 When He wills to bring in their share.
 31 Catastrophe falls on you by
 The things your hands made to employ,
 For many He forgives thereby.
 31 You cannot frustrate His design
 Through the earth, nor have you in line
 Any besides God to protect
 Or to give aid *to the elect*.

If You should give me greater store of gear
 And nourishment, O my Beloved, I fear
 According to the Qur'an I hold dear,
 I should abuse it, that is the word clear.
 I back away from that idea when I
 See how much folk upon the earth must try
 To stay alive and hardly can succeed
 In finding bread and herbs enough to feed.
 Catastrophe and famine are the creed
 Of the newscasters that come on the fly.
 What share You bring, Beloved, is not
 enough
 And living in this world for most is tough.
 But truly as I see what rich folks do
 I can believe the dire warning is true.

32 And among His signs are the ships,
 Sliding through ocean waves like slips.
 33 If it's His will He can bring down
 The wind. Then they would fail and drown
 Or motionless lie on the back
 Of the waters with their sails slack.

In this are signs for everyone
 Who perseveres in grateful fun.
 34 Or He can make them fail because
 Of what men have earned without laws,
 But much does He forgive *in claws*.
 35 But let those know who argue round
 Our signs, there's for them no safe ground.
 36 What you've been given here is just
 Convenience of this life of dust,
 But what's with God is better far
 And lasting more, for those on par
 Who do believe and put their trust
 In their Lord. 37 Those who avoid crimes
 Of greater weight and shameful rhymes,
 And when they're angry, they forgive,
 38 Those who obey their Lord and live
 To set their daily prayers, and who
 Do business by consensual view,
 Who spend out of what We bestow
 On them for sustenance to grow,
 39 And those who when wrong's done to
 them,
 Help and defend, though not condemn,
 40 The return for an injury
 Is equal injury's degree,
 But if a person does forgive
 And becomes reconciled to live,
 His reward's due from God, for He
 Does not love violent decree.

Beloved, what good news is this
 proclaimed thing!
 For every injury I take in wing
 And don't take vengeance, I get in the bank
 Of paradise a reward clean and swank.
 The Gospel says that You forgive as I
 Deem right to pardon sins in other guy.
 That conflicts with the Christian way
 whereby
 The killing of Your son atones for all
 That any and many do at the wall.
 But the Qur'an gives better news to bawl.
 Beloved, does it still work if I have given
 A provocation for the grief I live in?
 And what blows does any man ever give
 Except in vengeance for the way men live?

41 But if any help and defend
 Themselves after and wrong to bend
 On them, there's no cause for their blame.
 42 The blame is only against those

Who oppress men and such as chose
 Wrong-doing and insolency
 Transgress beyond the bounds' degree
 In the land, and defying right
 And justice. For such to requite
 Will be a penalty not light.
 43 But those who're patient to forgive,
 That would be a great way to live.
 44 For any that God leaves to stray,
 There's no protector for their way.
 And you will see wrongdoers when
 In sight of punishment again
 Say "Is there no way out of den?"
 45 You'll see them dragged to punishment
 In humble frame of mind and bent
 To their disgrace, with stealthy eye.
 And the believers will say why.
 "Those are in loss who've sold their souls
 And those belonging in their tolls
 On the day of judgement for goals.
 See the wrongdoers' painful shoals.
 46 And no protectors do they still
 Have for their aid, but God's own will.
 And for those whom God leaves to stray,
 There is no longer any way.

You leave to stray all those who choose to
 go
 To hell to get the reward for their show
 That they have chosen for pleasure and
 treat.
 Each one goes to the destination meet
 That he himself would take on nimble feet.
 It's mostly the attraction of the mates
 That share the common sort of hopeful
 fates.
 The end of every man is what You know.
 Beloved, there are some that You come to
 take
 Despite their choice of such destruction's
 wake,
 And they live in Your grace and mercy too,
 And not in any trace of derring do
 Hatched up in hell or on the earth that
 teaches
 The soul to lust for what the hell-fire
 reaches.

47 Listen to your Lord, before there
 Comes on a day that you must bear,
 Because of God. That day there'll be

For you no place of refuge, see,
 Nor will there be for you some room
 To deny *your sins before doom*.
 48 If still they run away, We've not
 Sent you to be guard of their lot.
 Your duty's just to give the word.
 And when We let man taste unblurred
 A mercy from Ourselves, then he
 Exults, but when some ill falls free
 On him on account of the deeds
 Which his hands have done for their seeds,
 Then is man ungrateful *in creeds*.
 49 To God belongs dominion of
 The heavens and earth, He makes with love
 Whatever He wills. He bestows
 The male or female as it grows
 According as His planned will shows,
 50 He grants both males and females, and
 He leaves the barren by command,
 He's full of knowledge and power's hand.
 51 It's not fitting for man that God
 Should speak to him upon the sod
 Except by inspiration trod,
 Or from behind a veil, or by
 Sending a messenger to cry,
 With God's permission, what God wills.
 He's most high, most wise *on the hills*.
 52 And so We have by Our command
 Sent inspiration to your band,
 You did not know what was its stand,
 And what was faith. But We have made
 It a light to guide in parade
 Such of Our servants as We will.
 And you guide in the straight path still,
 53 The way of God, to whom belongs
 What's in the heavens and the songs
 On earth. See all affairs return
 To God *for everything they earn*.

You do command to listen to Your Word.
 I listen and I listen, though it's blurred
 And faint behind the bustle of the herd.
 I listen to the sema' and I sleep
 Beneath the veils the human soul must
 keep.
 I listen to the sky and earth and creep
 Upon the forest floor and near to weep
 To find the revelation that is deep.
 Beloved, to You belong the sky and earth
 And You bring to them both all things of
 worth.

I listen to the voices echoed there
Before there comes a day of rending air
And ripping up of mountains for the fair,
And melting them in seas that run and dare.

Surah 43 Al-Zukhruf, or Glitter

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 Ha, Mim. 2 By clarifying Book,
3 We've made it a Qur'an and took
In Arabic, so you can hear
And understand what does appear.
4 It is the mother of the book,
In Our presence, noble and wise.
5 Shall We then take away in guise
The message from you and cast out,
For you're a folk of wicked doubt?
6 But how many were prophets sent
Among people of old and spent?
7 There never came a prophet then
Except they mocked him among men.
8 So We destroyed them, though they were
Stronger in might than these occur,
And so has gone on the likeness
Of ancient peoples in address.
If you should question them, "Who made
The heavens and the earth as laid?"
They would reply, "They all were made
By the exalted in power stayed,
And full of knowledge *not to guess*."

What does it mean Qur'an's mother of book
Sent down in Arabic to take a look?
The greater issue is what warning took
Of depriving of revelation's nook.
You took away the Torah and Zabur
By replacing with Talmud and Siddur.
You took away the Gospel and epistles
Replacing them with some patristic thistles.
Beloved, I see how infidelity
Is punished by the Qur'an too set free.
We've lost the Qur'an underneath a sea
Of ahadith, traditions made falsely.
O my Beloved, I return to the reading
Of the Four Books that had been so
receding.

10 He's made for you the earth spread out,
And made you roads in it en route,
So you may be guided about.
11 He sends down rain from the sky in
Due measure, and We raise from gin

To life by it a land that's dead.
Just so you will be raised when led.
12 He has created pairs of all,
And has made for you ships in stall
And cattle on which you ride tall,
13 In order to sit firm and square
Upon their backs, and when you're there,
You may praise your Lord's grace and say
"Glory to Him who's made these stay,
For we could never have done this
By our own trying not to miss.
14 "To our Lord we must surely turn
Back to *receive the things we earn*."
15 But they attribute to some of
His servants a share of the shove
With Him. Man's a blasphemous glove,
Ungrateful *for all the above*.
16 What! Has He taken daughters too
From what He's made created crew,
And granted to you sons instead?
17 When tidings come to one of those
That what he sets up as God's shows
As the most Gracious, his face falls,
And he's filled with grief that appalls.
18 Is one raised among vanities,
So cannot give account to please
In a dispute of rights and fees?
19 They pretend angels are female
Who themselves serve God in detail.
Did they see their creation too?
Their evidence be brought in view,
And they'll be called to account too!
20 They say "Ah, if it were the will
Of the most Gracious, we should still
Not have worshipped such false gods' hill."
They have no knowledge and no skill.
They only lie to foot the bill.

You give, Beloved in the Qur'an so much
In regulations of how dhikrs touch
The heart and what in sema' we should do.
I find much more for those than for the
brew
Of prayers prostrating on the earth in dew.
But this one regulation written clear
Has been ignored by all dervishes dear:
The sema' on the donkey's back or that
Set on the oxen's haunches without fat.
The sema' on the camel's back is known,
But cows are left without a word alone!
Beloved, I have not got a single cow,

And still I sing a miracle somehow
From Torah and Qur'an here where I bow.

21 What! Have We given them once before
A book to which they hold fast more?

22 No, they say "We found our ancestors
To follow a faith as inquestors,
And we guide ourselves as investors
In what they left behind as testers."

23 In just that way, when We sent down
A warner before you in town

To any folk, the wealthy ones
Among them said, "We found in tonnes
Our ancestors followed a faith,
And we'll keep following their wraith."

24 He said "What! Even if I brought
You better guidance than they taught
Your ancestor did and forgot?"

They said "As for us, we deny
That you are sent *down from the sky*."

25 So We exacted retribution
From them. Now see what's the solution
For those who rejected refutation.

26 See, Abraham said to his dad
And to his folk, "I'll not be had

By what you worship *that is bad*,
27 "I worship only Him who made
Me and He'll guide me in parade."

28 He left it as a word to stay
Among those come another day,
So they may turn back the right way.

29 I've given the good things of this life
To these and their ancestors rife,
Until the truth has come to them,
And messenger to make clear hem.

30 But when the truth came to them, they
Said "This is magic, we won't pay."

31 They also say "Why is not this
Qur'an sent down and not amiss
To some important man to kiss
In either of two towns in bliss?"

32 Are they the ones here to decide
Your Lord's mercy's portions to hide?
We portion out between them their
Own livelihood in this life's share.

And We raise some of them above
The others in the way they shove,
So some command work without love
Of others. But your Lord's mercy
Is better than We they decree.

33 If it were not that men might be

Of one wicked way of life's spree,
We would provide of all those who
Blaspheme the most Gracious in view
Silver roofs for their houses too,
And silver stairways for their cue,
34 And silver doors to go into,
And silver thrones to lie on too,
35 And also jewels of gold to wear.
But all this would be but the share
Of present life. Hereafter in
The sight of your Lord comes to win
For those who do right *without sin*.

Think now, Beloved, about the argument
Against the holy Qur'an that You sent.
"It can't be true, because it did not come
To some important man instead of bum
From two towns stated to be worth in sum."
Each unbeliever has criterion
Established in his heart and worth a tonne
By which he's certain Your revelation
Is null and void. Some make the due appeal
To history and others as they feel.
Beloved, let me seek no excuse to fail
Obedience to You, Your prophets hale,
And to the Word extant as You prevail.
Few find the harbour in unfaithful gale.

36 If anyone withdraws himself
From dhikr of Most Gracious, elf
Do We appoint for him to be
A friend and companion's degree.
37 Such one will keep them from the path,
But they think they're guided from wrath.
38 At last when one comes to Us, he
Says "I wish there were between me
And you the distance that is found
Between east and west on the ground."
Wicked is such a friend around.
39 When you've done wrong, it will avail
You nothing that day in the gale
To have mates in punishment's pale.
40 Can you then make the deaf to hear,
Or give direction to blind peer
Or to such who wander about
In manifest error and doubt?
41 Even if We take you away,
We'll surely make them also pay,
42 Or We'll let you see what we've set
Upon them, for We've surely met
In victory over their bet.

43 So hold fast to the revelation
Sent down to you, for you have ration
Of the right path *and with elation*.
44 It is the message for you and
For your folk, and soon you in band
Will be brought to account *to stand*.

The sema' is no option to be taken
Or left as the unfaithful mind is shaken.
Those who separate themselves from the
feast
Of Your remembrance are among the least,
The ones thrown in the fire to burn like
beast.
The dikr is required of all who wait
Upon Your name, Beloved, and at Your
gate.
It's not a sunna merely or a choice
To come to when one feels up to rejoice,
But breath to breathe and a life-giving voice.
Beloved, let me not forget of Your name,
But let me enter in the burning flame
Of Your remembrance day by day and
week
By week to know salvation that You seek.

45 Ask then our messengers We sent
Before you. Did We set in vent
Any gods other than most Gracious
To be bowed down to as one spacious?
46 We did send Moses early on,
With Our signs for Pharaoh out-drawn
And to his courtiers in chief.
He said "I'm sent for your belief
From the Lord of the worlds *for grief*."
47 But when he came to them with Our
Signs they mocked him with all their
power.
48 We showed them signs all in array,
Each greater than the other's sway,
And We seized them with punishment,
So they might come back and repent.
49 And they said "O magician you,
Call on your Lord for us in view
Of His pact with you, for we'll take
The guidance at last for your sake."
50 But when We took away the stroke
From them they took their word and broke.
51 And Pharaoh proclaimed to his folk,
Saying "O my folk, is not power
Of Egypt mine, these streams in flower

Beneath? What! Don't you see the shower?
52 "Am I not better than this man,
Who's despicable here and can
Hardly talk right *under the ban*?"
53 "If not, why does he not have gold
Bracelets on him or with him bold
Angels in parade and untold?"
54 Thus he made fools of his own folk,
And they obeyed him to a stroke,
They were rebellious under yoke.
55 When they at last came to provoke,
We made them pay for what they did,
We drowned them all *under the lid*.
56 We made them of the past a sign
To later ages by design.

Hear once again the arguments in store
To prove the revelation is no more
Than magic and illusion on the shore.
Three arguments show Moses in the wrong:
His speech impediment destroyed his song;
He did not have enough gold to be strong;
And angels failed to show with him along.
This trinity is still foundation of
Those who deny the revelation's shove.
Those are prophets alone who get their
word
Praised in the media before the herd.
Those are prophets alone who share the
gold,
And smile with an angelic face and cold.
Beloved, the world's not changed in being
bold.

57 When Mary's son is made a sign,
Your people raise a mocking whine.
58 They say "Are our gods best or he?"
This they set before you freely
Only in order to dispute,
They're a contentious folk to boot.
59 He was no more than a servant.
We poured Our favour on his slant.
We made him an example to
The children of Israel in crew.
60 And if it were Our will, We could
Make angels from among you good,
One after another on earth,
In ranks and in their ordered berth.
61 And he shall be a sign before
The hour, so do not doubt the score,
But follow Me, this is the way

That's right and good, straight to display.

62 Don't let the evil one keep you

From the way, he's a foe on cue.

63 When Jesus came with the clear signs,

He said "Now I have come in lines

To you in wisdom, and to make

Clear to you some things you mistake,

So fear God and obey my stake.

64 "For God, He is my Lord and your

Lord, so worship Him, at the door

Is the straight path forevermore."

When You quoted in the Qur'an the word

That Jesus spoke and the sweet John then

heard, (John 20:17)

You came to affirm that Jesus brought sign

That You alone are God above design.

Each revelation from the start reveals

The same good message that human heart
heals,

And each succeeding revelation peels

Back layers of the earlier on heels

And shows eternal truth in gears and
wheels.

Let me not fall into the evil way

That shadows Jesus for falsehood and pay.

Beloved, I take the witness of the lord

Jesus and treasure it among gems stored,

And keep You before heart and eye adored.

65 But parties from among them fell

Into dispute. Then woe in spell

To the wrongdoers, from the hell

Of a day more grievous to tell.

66 Do they just wait for the hour, so

It should come in a sudden show

On them, while they don't see *the glow?*

67 Friends on that day will turn out foes,

One to the other, but the rows

Of righteous ones *kept on their toes*.

68 My followers, no fear shall be

On you that day, nor grief to see,

69 Those who have believed in Our signs

And bowed to Islam *in their lines*.

70 Come in the garden, you and your

Wives in rejoicing at the door.

71 To them will be passed round for treat

Dishes and flasks of gold to eat

And drink and there will be all that

The soul could desire to be fat,

All that their eyes could delight in.

And you shall stay there *and to win*.

72 Such will be the garden for you

Inheritance for deeds done true.

73 You'll have abundance of fruit there,

From which you'll have satisfied share.

The faith of the Qur'an, unlike the faith

Of Christendom that focuses on wraith,

Is faith in the reality of what

You have created matter and unshut.

Theology material is bent

To deny immaterial things went

Into existence. But philosophy

Is always both a yes and no to see.

So I shall drink from goblets made of gold

As well as of the scintillating rolled

Imaginary matterless in fold,

And hope to satisfy all of the bold

Who remain certain of each thing they're
told

By nature and by their theology.

74 The sinners will be in the pain

Of hell to stay there under rein.

75 In no way will that be made light,

In despair will they enter night.

76 In no way shall We be unjust

To them, but it is they who must

Have been unjust to their own crust.

77 They'll cry, "O king, we wish your Lord

Would put an end to misery scored."

He'll say, "No, you stay where you're
stored."

78 We've brought the truth to you indeed,

But most of you hate truth in seed.

79 What! Do they have some settled plan?

But it's We who settle the span.

80 Or do they think We do not hear

Their secrets and private plots near?

Yes, and Our messengers are here

To made a record of their gear.

The punishment of hell includes the mates

That the depraved have desired on their
plates.

So how to keep such wenches from their
rates

Of pleasure? I suggest in speculation

Solution to the problem in elation.

Vagina dentata's a well-known theme

In folklore, at least in the tales I deem.

With a regeneration always met,
And irresistible desire in set,
Without a bit of fuel wasted we get
A punishment that's suitable and wet.
Beloved, I understand the trend of sect
In speculating, it's one to delect
And hold as dogma later, I expect.

81 Say "If the most Gracious had borne
A son, I'd be the first forsworn."
82 Glory to the Lord of the skies
And the earth, the Lord to apprise
The Arsh, from things the would devise.
83 So let them babble and play round
Until they meet the judgement ground
Which they've been promised to and bound.
84 It's He who's the God in the skies
And God on earth. It's no surprise
He's full of wisdom and the guise
Of knowledge *to propound no lies*.
85 And blessed is He to whom belong
Dominions of the skies in throng
And the earth, and all that's between.
With Him is knowledge of Hour seen.
And to Him you'll be brought to screen.
86 And those they invoke besides God
Have no power mediating rod.
Only the one who bears witness
To the truth, they know *without guess*.
87 If you ask them who has created
Them, they'll say surely unberated,
"God." How then are they so belated?
88 Of the cry "O Lord, these are folk
Who will not believe at a stroke."
89 But turn away from them and say
"Peace!" But soon they will know the way.

What good advice to retort to the fools
Who invoke trinities of gods in schools!
Turn from them and in turning do not fail
To say peace and so turning then prevail.
The doctrine that peace must be spoken on
The righteous only at the eve and dawn,
And wicked ones left without peace is
gone.

The lost have punishment enough in hell,
One need not curse or cast on them a spell.
But they deserve what little happiness
May come from the mouth of the ones You
bless

With peace and peace again in
cheerfulness.

Surah 44 Ad-Dukhan, or The Smoke

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 Ha, Mim. By the book making clear,
3 We sent it down upon a dear
Night, for We wish to warn *from fear*.
4 In it is made distinct each thing
Caught underneath the wisdom's wing,
5 By order from Our presence here.
For We send *revelations clear*,
6 As mercy from your Lord, for He
Hears and knows *all things faithfully*.
7 The Lord of the skies and the earth
And all between them in their berth,
If you had a certain faith's worth.
8 There's no god but He: It is He
Who gives life and gives death in fee,
The Lord to you and your first known
Ancestors *on the earth alone*.
9 And yet they play about in doubt.
10 Then watch for the day when the sky
Will bear smoke visible to spy,
11 Enveloping the folk, and this
Will be a grief's pain without bliss.
"Our Lord, remove the penalty
From us, for we believe truly!"
13 How shall the message be for them,
Since a messenger showed the gem
Clearly to them upon the hem?
14 Still they turn away from him and
Say "He follows others' command,
He is possessed in mind and hand."
15 We'll leave the penalty a while,
You'll only go back to your guile.
16 One day We'll seize you with a
slaughter,
Take vengeance *on both son and daughter*.

It is a dark night of the soul indeed,
As that Morisco saint once said in need,
That revelation fell upon the man
And glorified the darkness in its span.
The book fell in a cloud of darkness when
Moses received it on the mountain glen.
It fell in howling desert blackness on
The heart of Jesus Christ awaiting dawn.
In the dark cave where good Muhammad
prayed

The revelation fell and there it stayed.

Beloved, in my dark night of winter made
Of fir and birch and snow and lake waylaid
With ice, let the light of Your Word return
To where I wait to find it flame and burn.

17 Before them We tried Pharaoh's folk,
A most honoured messenger spoke,
18 Saying "Restore to me the slaves
Of God, I'm messenger who waves
To you and worthy of trust's glaives.
19 "Do not be proud against Allah,
For I have come to you for awe
Apparent. 20 "As for me, I seek
Refuge in my Lord, who's not weak
To be your Lord also, and He
Protects from your injuring me.
21 "If you do not believe in me,
At least keep yourselves from me free."
22 Then he cried to his Lord, "These are
A folk sunken in sinful tar."
23 "March out with My servants by night,
They're sure to pursue you *at light*.
24 "And leave the sea divided right.
For they're a host soon drowned in sight."
25 How many were the gardens and
Springs they had left behind to stand,
26 And corn-fields and yet buildings grand,
27 And wealth in which they took delight.
28 It was so. We made other folk
Inherit all of it in stroke.

The fate of Jews is one I do not care
To speak of and I do not care to share.
The leaving in Egypt of house and land
Was paradigm ever after to stand.
I lived in a town, ?be known by name,
And quoted in good Whittier's hall of fame,
And known for Christmas proclamation's
flame.

I knew Jews there whose property was set
Upon the edge of town to their regret,
Since Jews were well forbidden to own
there

A house or shop inside the city's stair.
On a day the town merely set the bound
Out further and confiscated their ground.
No compensation ever has been found.

29 And neither heaven nor earth shed tear
Nor were they given a respite dear.
30 We did deliver in times past

The children of Israel from blast
Of punishment 31 from Pharaoh's cast,
For he was proud even above
Inveterate transgressors' glove.
32 And we chose them in those times past
Above all nations, kin and caste,
And knowingly, 33 and granted them
Miracles as clear trial in hem,
34 As to these ones, who say for gem:
35 "There's nothing beyond our first death
And we'll not be raised back to breath.
36 "Then bring our ancestors, if you
Speak what is right and what is true."
37 What! Are they better than the folk
Of Tubba and those who for broke
Came before them? We destroyed such
Because they were in sin's guilt's clutch.
38 We did not made the heavens and earth
And all between them just for mirth,
39 We did not make them but for ends
Of justice, but who comprehends?

You chose indeed the folk of Israel then,
And Your decree remains now among men.
The gifts you gave in miracles still last
And stand against the stormy trial's blast.
The miracles, ayaat, are verses found
In Torah and Zabur and still around.
The folk of Israel, despite all that's said
Of some rebellion and wickedness led,
Has faithfully kept the jewels set in stone
And in the parchment lines before Your
throne.

Beloved, I take the miracles that You
Vouchsafed to humankind through Israel's
crew

And cantillate them day by day with rue
And with rejoicing as I know the true.

40 The day of dividing is time
Appointed for all them for crime,
41 The day when no protector can
Help his own in anything's plan,
And no help can they get in span,
42 Except such as get God's mercy,
For He's exalted as mighty,
Most merciful of all to see.
43 The tree of Zaqqum, 44 it will be
The food of the sinful, 45 like brass
Hot molten, it will boil and pass
Their insides 46 like water in mass

Boiling and scalding mightily.
 47 And so they cry, "Grab him and drag
 Him to the blazing, fiery crag!
 48 "Then pour on his head penalty
 Of boiling water in degree,
 49 "Taste it, indeed you were mighty,
 And full of honour, 50 and truly
 This is what you would doubt to see."

The sentence of the boiling water poured
 Upon the head of guilty unrestored
 Is one I'm glad no enthusiast bored
 As yet commended to Islamic state.
 Let every sinner guard and keep his pate
 Unsullied till the final cast of fate.
 Then let all hell break loose with fire and
 hate,
 With boiling water on the saved and gored.
 Beloved, the fine descriptions that You
 make
 Of hell are only worthy in the wake
 Of fiction and the movie-house opaque.
 Our hearts today are tender as we starve
 The population so that we can carve
 A luxury for those few who eat cake.

51 As for the righteous, they will be
 In a place of security,
 52 Among the gardens and the springs,
 53 Arrayed in fine silk and such things
 As rich embroidered work, and they
 Will turn to each other in sway,
 54 So. We shall pair them to fair ones,
 Women with lovely eye that stuns,
 Big and lustrous eye *in their ray*.
 55 There they can call for every kind
 Of fruit in peace and safety lined.
 56 Nor will they taste death there, except
 The first death. And He'll have them kept
 From pain of blazing flames there swept,
 57 As bounty from your Lord. That will
 Be the high achievement to fill.
 58 We've made this easy on your tongue
 So you may hearken to it sung.
 59 So wait and watch, they're waiting too.

Unless Ilyin's fair vision of the Lord
 Immortal in Jerusalem's restored,
 This picture of the righteous in reward
 Is like nothing that's happened in this world

Since happiness and life once came
 uncurled.
 Let immortality be shed abroad
 On all men and all women on the sod
 Under Your grace and mercy still in pod
 And then creation will give praise and laud
 To its perfection under hand of God.
 Beloved, send out Your blessing as my
 hand
 Is lifted in the whirling dervish band
 To catch the rays and pour them on the
 sand
 In nourishment on Your created land.

Surah 45 Jathiya, or Bowing the Knee

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 Ha Mim. 2 The revelation of
 The book is from Allah above
 In power and full of wisdom's love.
 3 In the heavens and the earth are signs
 For those who believe *in His lines*.
 4 In the creation of you and
 The animals upon the land,
 Are signs for those of faith in hand.
 5 And in the cycle of the night
 And day, and the fact that God's right
 To send nourishment from the sky,
 Reviving the dead earth thereby,
 And in revolving winds, there are
 Signs for those who are wise by far.
 6 Such are the signs of God that We
 Rehearse to you in truth to see.
 Then in what reciting will they
 Believe after rejecting sway
 Of God and His miracles' way?
 7 Woe to each sinful one to buy
 And sell falsehoods here on the sly.
 8 He hears the signs of God rehearsed
 To him, yet stubbornly perverse
 In pride, as if he'd not heard them,
 Then announce to him to condemn
 A penalty grievous in hem.
 9 And when he learns about Our signs,
 He takes them for a joke's designs,
 For such there'll be shameful repines.
 10 In front of them is hell, and there
 Is no profit to them to share
 For what they might have earned in care,
 Nor any guards they might have taken
 To themselves besides God forsaken,
 For them is a great punishment.

The miracles, the signs, the verses You
Have sent from the sky in the rain and dew
To be recited here with human breath
For many are the very ghost of death.
The grace that nourishes one with mercy
When once rejected by folk wickedly
Becomes the tool of their destruction bound
To bring their pride at last down to the
ground.

Beloved, I find Your words within the
night

Dreams that awaken me before the light,
And in the noontime brightness still the
sound

Re-echoes in the shapes by mind has found.
Make Your Word life to me and so I pray
Before the night, before coming of day.

11 This is the guidance for those meant
Who reject their Lord's signs when sent,
It is a harsh pain's anguishment.
It's God who's subjected the sea
To you, so ships may sail freely
Through it by His command so you
May search out His bounty in view
And so you might be grateful too.
13 He's subjected to you, as from
Him all that is in heavens' sum
And on the earth. See, in that there
Are signs for those who think with care.

14 Tell those who believe to forgive
Those who do not look out to live
To the days of God. It's for Him
To reward each folk well or grim
According to what they've earned trim.

15 If any does a righteous deed,
It makes sure his own soul in lead
Will benefit. If he does ill,
It works against him in the bill.
In the end you will all be brought
Back to your Lord and so be taught.

Those who believe are not the ones to bring
The wicked into punishment and sting,
But have the duty to forgive the ring,
Though perhaps not literally everything.
The damned are foreordained to carry
sword

Of magistrate before the common lord.
Believers are here to obey and learn

The heavenly life, not how on earth to
burn.

Beloved, the Gospel is not some high cross
To bring atonement by a dying boss,
But that forgiveness comes to those in
measure

Who have learned to forgive, a golden
treasure.

Long life has taught me to let go at last
The memories I've cherished of the past.

16 We did in past times grant to the
Children of Israel decree

Of the command's authority
And prophethood. We gave to them
For sustenance, things good in gem,
And favoured them above the folk.

17 We granted them clear signs in stroke
And it was only after that

Knowledge had been granted on mat
To them that they fell into sects,
Through insolent envy expects.
Your Lord will judge between them on
The day of judgement as to drawn
Matter they set up to go on.

18 Then We put you on the faith's way.
So follow that, don't swerve away
To follow the desires of those
Who do not know *the thing that goes*.

19 They will be of no use to you
In the sign of God, it is true.

It's only wrongdoers that do
Come as protectors in each pew
To one another. But God's right
To be the Protector in sight
Of all the folk who do the right.

20 These are clear evidence to men,
A guidance and a mercy then
To those of certain faith and when.

21 What! Do those who seek evil ways
Think that We shall hold them in stays
As equal with those who believe
And do righteous deeds for reprieve,
That their life and death is the same?

Ill is the judgement that they claim.

22 God has created sky and earth
For purposes of justice' worth,
And so each soul may find reward
For what she's earned, and none be scored
Of them for wrong by the Adored.

The foreordaining is to justice set,
 And not to arbitrary thing that's met,
 Although its critics often cast such blame
 Predestination's arbitrary shame.
 The purpose of creation's to be just,
 There is no other reason for the dust,
 The gold, the vetch, the heather, or the rust
 Bright orange on the fallen branch's crust.
 I beg predestination on my head
 If that is what it takes for justice led,
 And pray that grace that comes to all and
 fed
 Turn to me too in mercy as it must,
 If You've predestined me for faith and lust.
 Your glory is abroad, Beloved, outspread.

23 You see such a one who makes god
 From his own vain desire and prod?
 God knowing has left him astray,
 And sealed his hearing and heart's sway,
 And put a cover on sight's way.
 Who then will guide him after God?
 Will you not take the warning's prod?
 24 And they say "What is there but our
 Life in this world? We'll die an hour
 And live, and nothing but time can
 Destroy us." But they have no span
 Of knowledge, they guess to a man.
 25 And when Our clear signs are rehearsed
 To them in argument embursed,
 There's nothing but this. They say "Bring
 Our ancestors, if you can sing!"
 26 Say "It is God who gives you life,
 And then gives you death after strife,
 Then He'll gather you for the day
 Of judgement in which there's no sway
 Of doubt." But most men do not pay.
 27 To God belongs dominion of
 The heavens and earth, the day in glove
 That the hour of judgement is set,
 The day false dealers sentence get.
 28 And you will see each sect bow knee,
 Each sect will be called in decree:
 "This day shall you get what you earned
 By all you did and all you spurned.
 29 "This Our recording speaks of you
 With truth. For We used to keep view
 On record of all things you do."
 30 Then as to those who believed and
 Did righteous deeds, their Lord will stand
 Them to His mercy that will be

Achievement and for all to see.

You need not bring each sect to judgement
 here,
 It is a waste of time and waste of gear,
 Beloved, for I have judged them all in fear,
 Condemning all to hell before Your ear.
 Let Your eye then depose my judgement
 wild,
 And so exchange it for a sentence mild.
 But if You do, Beloved, then judge me too
 By the same mercy that You keep in view.
 Your record speaks the truth, but my own
 skin
 Is capable of feeling other's sin
 If not my own. So tell me in a din
 What You bring to repentance in my way,
 And I shall keep my judgement bound in
 sway
 And wait upon it for another day.

31 But as for those who reject God,
 "Were not Our signs recited prod
 To you? But you were arrogant,
 And were a folk of sinful slant.
 32 "And when it's said God's promise here
 Is true, and that the hour to fear,
 Of which there's not doubt to appear,
 You used to say 'We do not know
 What the hour is, we only show,
 Though it's a thought, we do not know.'"
 33 Then it will come to them for ill
 Of what they did and to fulfil,
 And they will be surrounded then
 By what they once laughed at to men.
 34 It will be said too, "Today We
 Will forget you and in degree
 As you forgot the meeting here
 Of this day of yours as in fear,
 And your abidings in the fire,
 No helpers have you to desire.
 35 This is because you used to take
 The signs of God for a joke's sake,
 And the world's life has deceived you."
 So that day they're not taken out
 From there or received in redoubt
 Of grace. 36 Then praises be to God,
 Lord of the heavens, Lord of the sod,
 Lord of all worlds *here and in pod*.
 37 To Him be glory in the sky
 And throughout the earth by and by.

And He is high in power and full
Of wisdom, *He is wonderful!*

Exalted in Your power and fully wise,
Beloved, Your glory spreads before my
eyes:

The stars untouched by sin glow on in
splendour,
Orion's chariot, wheel, sword and fender,
The suns that dwarf in magnitude the soul,
The foaming oceans, one gnat's drinking
bowl,

The hopeful forests green and scarred and
wrinkled,
The hills beneath the sky, granite and
crinkled,

I see the spires of Mecca, hills of Rome,
And Athens' pillars and the shining dome
Of Sultan Ahmet, here my sight is stayed.
I see things that both man and God have
made.

I see this glory, all of it besides,
Contained in one vast "I" where it abides.

Surah 46 Al-Ahqaf, or The Dunes

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 Ha, Mim. 2 The revelation of

The book is from Allah above
In might and full of wisdom's love.

3 We did not make the heavens and earth
And all between them in their worth
Except for a just purpose' berth,
And for a time appointed earth.

But those who reject faith turn back
From what they were warned of in stack.

4 "Do you see what you call upon
Besides God? Show me what they've drawn
On earth or if they have a share
In the skies, bring me to look there,
Or any bit of wisdom they
Have, if you're telling truth today.

5 And who is more astray than one
Who calls upon some being done
Besides God, such as won't reply
To him when judgement day will try,
And who are without consciousness
Of the call to them the address?

6 When humankind's gathered, they'll be
Hostile to them, reject their plea
To worship such gods and sundry.

The justice of creation is fulfilled
In the very few things that You have
willed:

That humankind should worship You
alone,

Or else hit the dirt and bite to the bone.
For on the day of judgement when they cry
For help to their gods of idolatry,
Then they shall all reject them and their
plea,

All gathered before You beneath the sky.
Beloved, there's none astray more than the
man

Who calls upon his own invention's plan,
When all of nature hales in songs as sweet
The measures of You blessed hands and
feet.

Let me join with the locust and the sparrow
To chirrup praises to You from the marrow.

7 When Our clear signs are rehearsed then
To them, the unbelieving men
Say of the truth come to their den,
"This is clear sorcery again."

8 Or do they say "He made it up"?
Say "If I'd made it up in cup,
Then you can get no single sup
For me from God. He knows best what
You talk about up from your gut.
He does suffice as witness set
Between me and between you yet.
He's oft-forgiving, merciful."

9 Say "I'm no bringer of new pull
Of doctrine among messengers,
Nor do I know what now occurs
With me or with you. I just go
After what is revealed in show
To me in inspiration's glow.
I'm just a warner head to toe."

10 Say "Do you see? If this is from
God and you reject it is sum,
And a witness from Israel's folk
Testifies to its same-like stroke,
And has believed while you remain
Prideful, truly God guides not vain
And unjust people *on the wane*."

11 The unbelievers say of those
Who do believe, "If in its rows
It were a good thing, such old crows
Would not have gone to it before
The cream of society's score."

Since they don't guide themselves in light,
They'll say "This is a lie outright."

Muhammad brought no new thing on the
earth,

No doctrine unknown before in the berth
Of Christian and of Jew, of Gospel and
Of Torah and the Psalms come from Your
hand.

Islam's an innovation in the thing
Where it departs from the book's revealing
That came before. The Qur'an just explains
Some of the darker passages in trains.
Beloved, let me take innovation where
I find it and cast it out to despair,
And fill my hand and heart with what You
give

In the four books of light I have to live.
The doctrine from the start, from Adam's
day,

Is clear, and it remains the righteous way.

12 Before this Moses' book was guide
And mercy, and this book beside
Confirms it in Arabic tongue.

It's to admonish unjust rung
And as good news to those who do
The right things *in the house and pew*.

13 Those who say "Our Lord is Allah,"
And stay firm, they shall be in awe
Without fear, nor grief for a straw.

14 Such shall be gardens' fellows there
To dwell forevermore and share
Reward for their good deeds and fair.

15 We made man's duty to be kind
To parents. In pain did she bind,
His mother did, to bear him and
In pain did she give birth in hand.
The carrying to weaning's time
Is thirty months and hard to climb.

At last when he reaches the age
Of full adulthood and the stage
Of forty years, he says "O Lord,
Grant me fatefulness for the horde
That You've bestowed on me adored
And on my parents, so that I
May work out righteousness and vie
To Your approval and Your eye.

Be gracious to me in this thing.
I have turned to You and from wing
I bow submitting *as I sing*."

16 From such We'll accept the best deeds
And pass by their failures as weeds.
Among the fellows of the place
Of garden, a promise in trace
Of truth, which was made for their grace.

This book in Arabic comes to confirm
The Torah and show Moses was no worm
In writing down the laws that You made
clear

Before the hard hearts human without fear.
The chapters of Adam and Noah would
Have been enough, if hearts had not struck
wood

Or stone instead of flesh and soft reply
To do Your will and just on You rely.
Beloved, I take the Torah in hand now
And cantillate its words each week and
bow

Before Your throne in Arabic or yet
In Hebrew or in English that I get.
But in all taking of the books I see
Within them and beyond them only Thee.

17 But the one who says to his folks,
"Damn you, you made me under yokes
Of hope that I'd be raised in spokes,
From generations past?" And they
Will seek God's aid and they will say
"Woe to you! Have faith, for it's true,
The promise of God comes in view."
But he says "This is nothing but
Old tales recited from the gut."

18 Such are the ones against whom's
brought

The sentence among those once taught
Among the previous generations
Of jinns and men past revelations,
For they'll be lost out of the plot.

19 To all are given their degrees
According to the deeds they please
And so that He may recompense
Their works and no injustice tense
Be done to them *and without sense*.

20 On the day unbelievers will
Be placed before the fire until
It's said "You got your good and fill
In the world's life, and took the pill
Of pleasure out of them. Today
You shall be recompensed to stay
With shameful penalty in sway.

For you were arrogant on earth
Without just cause, and in your berth
Transgressed *the law for all you're worth.*"

There may be a just cause for arrogance
It seems by this sign's blessed song and
dance.

The penalty's not for arrogant guys,
But for the arrogant without just whys.
The pleasure that is found in this world's
glow

Of sweetness in creation on the go
Is not a harbinger of hell to come,
Despite the message that You seem to hum.
Beloved, let me be arrogant and filled
With pleasure in the morning that's unbilled
In what to do and where to go, in bright
Sun filling the frost crystalline delight
Of sweeping birch still standing by
bathhouse,
Of ragged raspberry vines, and tracks of
grouse.

21 Note one of 'Ad's siblings. Behold,
He warned his folk about the cold
Dunes, but there'd been warners before,
And after him there came some more:
"Worship no other but Allah,
I hold the penalty in awe
For you on a great day to draw."

22 They said "Have you come here to turn
Us from our gods? Then bring to burn
On us what you warn us about,
If you are telling the truth stout."

23 He said "The knowledge is with God
Alone. I proclaim you the prod
Of which I've been sent, but I see
You stay a folk ignorantly."

24 Then when they saw clouds in the sky
Coming to meet their valleys by,
They said "This cloud will give us rain."

"No, it's what you wanted in pain
To come on quickly, a wind where
There is harsh punishment to bear.

25 "Everything it will destroy there
By its Lord's command." Then at morn
They saw their homes ruined with scorn.
So We reward the sinful born.

26 We'd firmly set them in the power
Which We've not given you an hour,
And We'd bestowed on them to hear,

And see, a heart and mind in gear,
But of no benefit to them
Were hearing, sight and heart and gem
Of mind, when they went on to be
Rejecting signs of God freely.

And they were surrounded by that
Which they before always mocked at.

27 We destroyed before them the folk
Around about you at a stroke,
And We have shown the signs to be
In many shapes that they may see.

28 Why was there no help coming down
To them from those they served in crown
As gods besides God, as a means
Of access to Him? No, they left
Them in the lurch. But that was their
Falsehood's and invention's share.

The proof, Beloved, is not in whether gods
Send help or not to those living like clods
Upon a barren hearth, a frugal store,
An empty cistern, and a broken door.
You too are mostly silent in the wake
Of drought and danger and catastrophe,
And all the fuss and prayers and hymns I
make

Return in silent questioning's debris.
Beloved, the silence is no proof that one
Is not a god. It's rather that You've done
In history a thing or two to bring
Some people out of Egypt on a wing.
The silence on the earth is deafening,
Whether of You or false gods without
sting.

29 See, We turned towards you company
Of jinns to hear Qur'an's decree.
When they stood in the presence there,
They said "Listen to silence share."

When the reciting ended, they
Returned to warn their folk that way.

30 They said "O our folk, we have heard
A book revealed after the stirred
Of Moses, to confirm the word
Before it. It guides to unblurred
Truth and to a straight path preferred.

31 "O our folk, hearken to the one
Who invites to God, and begun
To believe in Him. He'll forgive
You your sins and save you from grief
Of punishment *for unbelief.*

32 "If any does not listen to
The one who invites to God true,
He cannot stop God's will on earth,
And no protectors in his berth
Can he have besides God. Such men
Stay in apparent error's den."

33 Do they not see God who has made
The heavens and earth on parade,
And never wearied with the act,
Is able to give life in fact
To the dead? Yes, He has the power
Over all things *in every hour*.

34 The day that unbelievers will
Be set before the fire for thrill,
"Is this not real?" They will say then,
Indeed by our Lord." "Taste you men
The penalty for what you did
Always deny *and the truth hid*."

35 Therefore patiently persevere,
As did the messengers appear
With stout decision. Don't be quick
About it. On the day that's slick
They'll see what's promised them as if
They had not tarried in the stiff
More than an hour, a single day.
To proclaim is all you've to say.
But shall there be any destroyed
But those in transgression employed?

What should Your messengers be patient
for,

If not the coming of Your hell and gore?
I'd think they'd rather put the thing off
quick,

But You choose for Your prophets men
who're slick,

Who wait like Jonah for the punishment,
And hope to see the fire descend when sent.
They patiently proclaim, it may be true,
But they're impatiently awaiting You
To bare an arm and start a fire and brew.
Beloved, I am no prophet here, so I
Can take the passing of life with a sigh
For what I have not done and wonder why.
I can be patient with the hope and fear
Of what I know and feel, and what I hear.

Surah 47 Muhammad

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 Those who reject God and keep men
From God's way, their deeds will again

God bring astray *from the right den*.

2 But those who believe and do deeds
Of righteousness, and keep their creeds
In what's sent to Muhammad's hand,
For it is truth from their Lord's stand,
He will remove from them their ills
And bring the good upon their hills.

3 This is because those who reject
God follow vanities select,
While those who believe stay within
The truth from their Lord *without sin*.

So God presents men lessons near
In likenesses that here appear.

4 So when you meet the infidels
Strike at their necks with swords and spells.
At last when you've got victory,
Bind them to a fast, firm treaty.

After that's generosity
Or ransom, till war's laid aside.
So, but if it had been the pride
Of God, He could have turned their ride
Himself in punishment. But for
The testing of you, some with more.
But those killed in the way of God,
He'll never leave their deeds down trod.

5 He'll guide them and make good their
state,

6 And bring them to the garden's gate
That He's proclaimed for them to wait.

7 O you believers, if you will
Help God, He'll help you too and still
Put your feet firmly on the hill.

This sounds like Methodism on the spot:
Co-operation with the divine plot
Is necessary to get up the hill

Of Calvary and so to square the bill.
I'd thought from other verses that You take
The human heart by violence for sake
Of sovereignty and Your divine decree.
Don't turn from Calvin then for John
Wesley.

Beloved, the pact with You must always be
One hundred percent of Your sovereignty
And zero of the human part's degree.
For humans always fall to meet their own
In obligations. You must take the throne
And we must just depend on You alone.

8 But those who reject, to them comes
Destruction on their burning bums,

And He'll brand their deeds in their sums.
 9 That's since they hate God's revelation.
 So He's made their deeds conflagration.
 10 Don't they journey throughout the earth,
 And see the end of those in berth
 Before them? God brought punishment
 On them and the like to resent
 On those who reject God unbent.
 11 That's since God's Protector of those
 Who do believe, but those who chose
 To reject God have no guard's nose.
 12 God will let in those who believe
 And do righteous works for reprieve
 To gardens beneath which for leave
 Flow streams, while those who reject God
 Will enjoy and like cattle's fod
 Graze till the fire lands on their pod.
 13 How many towns of greater weight
 Than your town which drove out with hate
 Have We destroyed with none to rate?
 14 Is then one on the straight from Lord
 No better than the one abhorred
 To whom the evil of his works
 Seems pleasing and who follow quirks
 Of their own lusts *as well as shirks?*

Few men do evil for the wicked's sake,
 But because evil seems good in the wake
 Of their lusts. So I see the marbled cake
 Seduce the hearts around me for the lake
 Of fire. I see how sweetly bangs the boom
 Of rock and roll in worship to their doom.
 I know that what is evil stalking me
 Is something that I think is pleasantry.
 Beloved, reveal the truth to heart and hand,
 And I shall stand before You on the land
 Without a hope or share in wicked band.
 Beloved, make pleasant to my will and
 mind
 The ways of truth with goodness once
 combined
 To share no bold enticement of the blind.

15 A parable of garden blessed
 Of which the righteous are addressed.
 In it are rivers watered pure,
 Rivers of milk with the taste sure,
 Rivers of wine not to make drunk,
 Rivers of honey clear unsunk.
 In that place every kind of fruit,
 And grace come from their Lord to boot.

Can it be compared to what they
 Get in the fire come there to stay,
 And there receive for drink the cup
 Of boiling water burning up
 Their stomach and their bowels to cut?
 16 Among them are men who don't shut
 Their ears on you, but in the end,
 When they go out from you to fend,
 They say to those with knowledge kept,
 "What was it he said?" Such unwept
 Are men whose hearts Allah has sealed,
 Who follow in their own lusts' yield.
 17 But those who get their guidance, He
 Increases to them guidance wee,
 And pours out on them piety
 And keeping back iniquity.
 18 Do they just expect coming hour,
 That it should come in sudden shower?
 Already signs of it have come,
 And when it's on them in its sum,
 How can they benefit then by
 Their admonition *come in cry?*
 19 Know then there is no god but God,
 And ask forgiveness for your clod,
 And for the men and women who
 Believe. For Allah knows how you
 Move round and how you stay in pew.
 20 Those who believe say "Why is not
 A surah sent down on our plot?"
 But when a surah of sure meaning
 Is revealed, and fighting and keening
 Is mentioned there, you'll see those in
 Whose hearts is a disease of sin
 Look at you with a ghastly grin
 Like death approaching. Fit for bin.
 21 If they'd obey and say the just,
 When a matter came up for trust,
 It would be better on the dust
 If they were true to God as must.

The sweeter Christian of today will take
 The natural violence that's in his wake
 And use it for a passive aggressive
 Approach to innocent people who live
 Within his reach. That is the way they
 preach.

But here I see the Qur'an come to teach
 That violence outright and with an arm
 Well wielded in the field to do the harm
 Is indicated by You to the man
 That You have chosen under heaven's span.

I've seen that's so since Abraham took bow
And armour and three hundred for a show
And brought back Lot and Sodom's folk to
glow.

The warfare on earth is a fight below.

22 Then is to be waited in you,
If you were put in such power due,
That you would do mischief and rue
In the land and break your ties' cue
To kith and kin to follow view.

23 Such are the men whom God has cursed,
For He's made them deaf and the worst
Blinded the sight of those who durst.

24 Do they not then try with a will
To understand Qur'anic pill,
Or are their hearts locked up to fill?

25 Those who turn back as apostates
After the guidance in estates
Was clearly shown to them in rates,
The evil one who instigates
Them and kept them in false hopes' mates.

26 This is because they said to those
Who hate what God's revealed in rows,
"We will obey you in the part",
But God knows secrets of their heart.

27 But how when angels take their souls
At death and strike them with their coals
On faces and on their backs' shoals?

28 This is because they followed what
Called forth the wrath of God in glut,
And hated God's good pleasure too.
So He made their deeds fail from true.

Those who obey in part are those who take
One or two of the sacred books at stake,
The Torah, the Psalms, Gospels, or to
quake

Before the blessed Qur'an: such is a rake.
Beloved, let me fly in the face of all
Established faiths to answer at Your call,
Reciting four books daily until I
Am born again within Your will to die
To self and live to Self alone, where You
Breathe in the four books still come into
view.

Let those obey in part who share the task
Of politics and temple brothels' bask,
But let me a lone dervish wander far
Across the tundra following Your star.

29 Or do those in whose hearts is ill,
Think that God will not come fulfil
The light on all their rancour's bill?
30 If We'd so willed, We could have shown
Them up to you and you'd have known
Them by their character's traits blown.
But surely you'll know by talk's tone.
And God knows all you do *from throne*.

31 And We'll try you until We test
Those of you who struggle their best
And keep on patiently. And We
Will put you to the test freely.

32 Those who reject God, and keep men
From God's way, and resist again
The messenger after his light
Had shown them their guidance aright,
Will not harm God in the least bite,
But He'll make their deed fail in plight.

33 O you believers, obey God,
And obey His sent one by rod,
And do not make your deeds a clod.

34 Those who reject God and keep some
From the way of God, and then come
To death rejecting God, God will
Not forgive them, *they forfeit bill*.

35 Do not be weary, don't be faint,
Crying for peace when you should paint
The uppermost. For God's with you
And He will not put loss on you
For all the good deeds that you do.

It is true, my Beloved, that You reward
The good deeds done by selfishness in
sword

In this life by those condemned unimplored
To Your damnation. Good deed bear their
fruit,

And You are always a just God to boot.
Survival instinct and the social press
May help the depraved to do well at guess,
And even that well-doing You applaud
With a reward upon the budding sod.
But good deeds will not earn the life to
come,

The life of paradise where righteous hum.
Nothing can earn a man eternity,
Nothing he does can ever set him free,
But sovereign grace alone grants life freely.

36 This world's life is just play and fun.
If you believe and guard and run

From evil, He will grant reward
 To you, and not remove your stored.
 37 If He should take them all from you,
 And press you for them, you would do
 By covetousness and withhold,
 And He's reveal your ill-will cold.
 38 See, you're invited to give out
 In alms in God's way round about.
 But some of you are stingy guys.
 But any stingy ones are such
 To the harm of their own soul's crutch.
 But God is free of every need.
 If you turn back, He'll have decreed
 Another folk to take your place.
 And they'll not be like you in trace.

The stinginess of Scots is proven best
 In my own self, it's a thing I've confessed,
 Despite the fact three hundred years invest
 Since any in my line stood on the land
 And looked at Doon or Ayr as near at hand,
 Until I went myself and loved again
 The hills of Scotland and the Scottish men.
 But neither I nor Scots have been relaxed
 In giving alms, we're never overtaxed
 To grant a grace in gear and kale to those
 Who starve beneath our eyes if not our
 toes.
 Beloved, bless me and Scotland for the way
 We have dispensed provisions on a day
 When You have blessed providing ray on
 ray.

Surah 48

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 We've given you a victory clear,
 2 So God forgiving may come near
 You to forgive past and appearing,
 Fulfil His favour on your fearing,
 And guide you on the straight path hearing.
 3 So God may help you mightily.
 4 He has sent down tranquillity
 On the believing hearts, so they
 May add faith to their faith to pray,
 For to God belong all the powers
 Of heavens and earth, to God are showers
 Of knowledge and of wisdom's flowers.
 5 That He may let those who believe,
 Both men and women for reprieve,
 Into the gardens beneath where
 Streams flow, to dwell forever there,

And take away their ills from them,
 Which is in God's sight the best gem.
 6 That He may punish hypocrites,
 Men and women, and in their fits
 Polytheist men and their wenches,
 Who thing evil of Allah's benches.
 On them is a cycle of bad,
 The wrath of God is on them sad.
 He's cursed them and got ready hell,
 And evil is their end as well.
 7 For to God belong all the powers
 Of heaven and earth, to God's the showers
 Of heights of might and wisdom's flowers.

If You, Beloved, bring down tranquillity
 On human hearts with wisdom in degree,
 How do you satisfy the paradox
 And reconcile the two outrageous stocks?
 Tranquillity and wisdom do not share
 A methodology upon the stair,
 The one flees all responsibility,
 The other solves all problems I can see.
 Ah, now I see, Beloved, the question's met
 By changing my conception of the pet.
 It's wisdom flees the world whose power's
 set.

Tranquillity is the blindness they get
 Who fail to rail against injustice where
 Their piece of mind arises on the air.

8 We've sent you as a witness then,
 Bringer of good news, warning's wen.
 9 So you may believe in Allah
 And in His messenger with awe,
 So you may help and honour Him,
 And celebrate His praise in hymn
 Both morn and evening without sin.
 10 Those who swear loyalty to you
 Do no less swear loyalty to
 God. The hand of God's over their
 Hands, then any who fails to bear
 His oath, so harms his own soul's share,
 And any one who does fulfil
 What he has covenanted still
 With Allah, Allah will soon grant
 Him a reward *and one not scant*.
 11 The Arabs who held back will say
 To you, "We were engaged that day
 With flocks and herds, and family's way.
 So pardon us, and ask and pray."
 They say with tongue what's not in heart.

Say "Who has any power or part
 To pray on your behalf to God,
 If His will is to give you clod
 Or give you profit on the sod?
 But God knows well all that you prod.
 12 "No, you thought that the messenger
 And the believers would not stir
 Back to their families. This seemed
 A pleasure to your hearts unbeamed,
 And you brought forth and evil thought,
 For you're a people lost from plot."
 13 If anyone does not believe
 In God and in messenger's sleeve,
 We have prepared for those who leave
 God a fire blazing to receive.
 14 To God belongs the power above
 The heavens and earth, forgives in love
 The ones He wills, and punishes
 Whom He wills. Oft-forgiving is
 God and most merciful to His.

La petite politesse wherewith the soul
 Makes life a noncommittal, easy roll
 Is condemned by Your word, Beloved, I
 see.
 That is a condemnation too of me.
 I too say out of misplaced courtesy
 Blasphemies on both You and fellowmen.
 Give me the grace to swear outright again,
 To tell the awful truth, and not return
 To some ingrained excuse for what I earn.
 You have prepared the fire for the white
 lies
 Of those who live and earn and civilize.
 It's not for greater crimes that men meet
 hell,
 But for congenial words they come to tell
 And then forget on hearing dinner bell.

15 Those who hold back when you march
 and
 Take booty, "Let us have a hand."
 They wish to change Allah's decree.
 Say "Not this way you'll follow me.
 God has already made decree."
 Then they'll say "You're jealous of us."
 No, but they understand no fuss.
 16 Say to the Arabs who held back,
 "You shall be summoned for the slack
 Against a folk in violence.
 Then you will fight or they'll see sense.

Then if you show obedience,
 God will grant you a recompense,
 But if you turn back as before,
 He'll punish you with grievous sore."
 17 No blame is there upon the blind,
 Nor is there blame on lame to find,
 Nor on one ill. But he that goes
 Obedient to God and in rows
 To His messenger, Allah chose
 To let him in to gardens' pose
 Beneath which mighty streams arose,
 And as for the one who turns back,
 God will lay on him grief in stack.
 18 God's pleasure was upon the men
 Who believed and swore once again
 Loyalty to you by the tree.
 He knew what was in their hearts, see,
 And He sent down tranquillity
 To them. He rewarded degree
 Of fast and speedy victory.
 19 And many benefits they'll get,
 And God's exalted in might yet,
 And full of wisdom's parapet.
 20 God's promised you such benefits
 That you'll acquire, and where He sits
 He's given you these early on.
 He's kept back the hands of men drawn
 From you. So it may be a sign
 For the believers in design,
 And that He may guide you into
 A straight path *and a righteous pew*.
 21 And other benefits, which are
 Not in your power, but which in star
 God's compassed round, and God has
 power
 Over all things *and every hour*.

Like a lame duck I sit between the town
 And ski-slopes dark with fir and with
 renown,
 And rarely hear a threat or rarely find
 Destroyer on my step to put in bind.
 You must be holding hand of wicked foe,
 For they're around me as thick as can grow,
 And my invisibility will show
 Through any armour it could make to glow.
 Beloved, You hold back hands of the
 attacker
 And so protect each day Your faithful
 slacker,

Who has no friend but You, nor any
backer.
Let Your hand not fail in this time and true
To keep me safe within Your gracious
view,
And I shall praise or not Your derring-do.

22 If unbelievers come to fight
You, they'll surely turn their backs right.
They'll find protectors none nor yet
Shall they any helper have met.
23 The practice of God's already
In the past. No change will you see
In the practice of God's decree.
24 He has restrained their hands from you
And your hands from them in the crew
Of Makkah, after that in due
He gave you victory on them.
God sees all you do *in your hem*.
25 They're ones who denied revelation
And kept you from the holy station
Of the Mosque and the sacrifice
Of animals, from the place nice.
Had there been no believing men
And women whom you did not ken
That you were treading down again,
On whose account a crime would then
Have been accounted you without
Knowledge, He'd have and without doubt
Let to His mercy whom He will.
If they had been apart to spill,
We'd surely have punished in fill
The unbelievers and the swill
Among them with grief to the kill.
26 While unbelievers fill their hearts
With choler and rhetoric's parts,
The anger and words ignorant,
God sent down His peace on slant
To His messenger and to those
Who were believers and He chose
To make them stick close to the rows
Of self-restraint. And well were they
Entitled and worthy in sway.
And God knows fully all things' way.

Who now keeps the crowds of the earth
from finding
Their place at Makkah for the last
unwinding
Of Kaaba's sheath and for the sacrifice

Of boughten sheep and everything that's
nice?
I'll not name names again, but if the sandal
Fits, let them then embrace the woeful
scandal.
There was I time I too failed to regard
That journey with sufficient report card,
And thought it was an option for the way
Some people might consider Islam's pay.
Beloved, I've since learned from the day to
day
In caravan that there's no place on earth
That I can now consider of full worth
But the stones round the Kaaba of my birth.

27 God did fulfil the vision for
His messenger. You'll enter door
Of sacred mosque, if God so will,
With minds secure, heads shaved there still,
Hair cut short and without fear's bill.
For He knew what you did not know,
He granted besides speedy show
Of victory and on the go.
28 He sent His messenger to guide
And the religion of truth's side,
To proclaim it over all ways
Of faith, as witness God's to praise.
29 Muhammad is God's messenger,
And those who are with him occur
Harsh against unbelievers, yet
Compassionate among their set.
You'll see them bow prostrating there
Themselves, seeking God's grace in prayer
And His good pleasure for their share.
On their faces remain the marks,
The traces of prostration's sparks.
This is their likeness in Torah,
Their likeness in the Gospel's awe,
Like a seed which sends forth its blade,
Then grows, becomes thick and is stayed
On its own stem, for the delight
And wonder of sowers in sight.
The unbelievers filled with rage
At last come to them on rampage.
God's promised those among them who
Believe and such righteous deeds do
Forgiveness and reward in view.

The hate I find for good Muhammad round
About the Christian shambles on the
ground

Goes past my comprehension. With hair cut
And pillars stoned, and all doubt of heart
shut,

I too came to the Kaaba for relief,
And found there both the desperation's thief
And the hope of my meeting with the son
Of the fair prophet, who's journey begun
Ended in occultation once undone.
Muhammad is his name too, so I share
Delight and hope with both of them to bare
The sight of Your house, knowing they
were there.

As I look round the hills about the town,
I wonder if they mind those of renown.

Surah 49 Al-Hujraat, The Private Places

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 O you believers, do not put
Yourselves forward before the foot
Of God and His messenger, but
Bear God. For God hears and He knows
All things *upon earth as it shows*.

2 O you believers, do not raise
Your voices above the sound waves
Of the Prophet, nor speak aloud
To him in talk, as you are proud
To speak to one another's crowd,
Lest your deeds become vain and you
Do not perceive the right in cue.

3 Those who lower their voices in
The presence of God sent one, win.
Their hearts has God tested to be
In great measure of piety.
For them's forgiveness and reward.
Those who shout out to you unfloored
From without the apartments stored,
Most lack understanding *in cord*.

5 If only they had patience till
You could come out to them to still,
It would be best for them. But God
Is oft-forgiving *on the sod*,
Most merciful *to those in prod*.

6 O you believers, if a man
Of wickedness comes without ban
To you with any news, make sure
Of the truth, lest you harm the pure
Without intention. And after that
Repent of what you've done out flat.

The voice of humankind, today it seems,
Is the most sacred thing in human dreams.

Freedom of speech is the most holy rite
That wicked people ever have in sight.
The freedom to speak evil cannot be
Questioned, but those who utter righteously
Must be shut down, shut up, shut out and
put

Beneath the pall, the tax, and under foot.
Beloved, freedom of speech appears when
men

Would raise a voice above Your own in
glen

And drown the still small voice so they
may preach

In justifying wickedness of speech.
Let me not speak at all, but in that case,
Let no one come to tell me to my face.

7 Know that with you's God's messenger.

If he followed what you concur
In many issues, you would fall
Into greater misfortune's thrall.

But God has made His faith be dear
To you, and made it your hearts' cheer,
And He has made hateful to you
Unbelief, wickedness in crew,

Rebellion. Such indeed are those
Who walk in righteousness in rows,
8 A grace and favour from Allah,

And God knows well with wisdom's claw.

9 If two groups of believers fall
To fighting, make peace between all.

But if one of them still transgress
Beyond all bound and in address

Against the other, then fight all
Against the one whose acts appal

Until they comply with the call
Of God. But if they do comply,

Then make peace between them that vie
With justice and be fair. For God
Loves those who are fair *on the sod*.

10 Believers are one brotherhood.
So make peace and agreement good

Between your brothers as you should.
And fear God for mercy as could.

11 O you believers, do not let
Some men among you mock and fret

Other. It may be those they mock
Are really of the better stock.

Don't let some women laugh at others.
It may be they're the better brothers.

Do not defame or be sarcastic

To one another, or bombastic.
 Do not call each other nicknames
 Offensive, wicked are such claims,
 After one has believed from blames.
 Those who don't stop it do wrong games.
 12 O you believers, keep away
 From any suspicion in sway.
 Suspicion can be sometimes sin.
 Do not spy on each other's bin
 Behind each other's backs. Would any
 Of you like to eat for a penny
 The flesh of his dead brother's back?
 No, you'd abhor it though in lack.
 So fear God, for God is returning,
 And merciful *to what man's earning*.

You made hateful to Muhammad's heart
 three
 Things written in an awful trinity:
 Unbelief, wickedness, rebellion's stand.
 Where those exist, his hate must first
 command.
 Beloved, most Christians are sweet in their
 pew,
 And yet they think You mandate hate in
 view
 Of me and mine, of any who recite
 The Qur'an or keep its words by Your
 might.

Mandates of hate may be for prophets here,
 Of for appointed divine guides in fear,
 But I doubt that my hates strike the right
 token,
 And so I leave them out with what's still
 broken.
 Hate, my Beloved, for me and if You will
 Command my hate, and so with hate instil.

13 O humankind, We have made you
 From a single couple in pew,
 A male and female, and made you
 Nations and tribes, so you may know
 Each other. The most noble row
 Of you in God's sight is the one
 Who is most righteous once begun.
 And God knows fully and is well
 Acquainted with all things *in spell*.
 14 The Arabs say "We do believe."
 Say "You have no faith for reprieve,
 But you pretend 'We have submitted
 Ourselves to Allah and committed.'

For faith's not yet come in your hearts.
 But if you obey God and parts
 From His messenger, He will not
 Diminish of your actions aught,
 For God's forgiving and of all
 Most merciful *upon the ball*."
 15 Only those are believers who
 Have believed in God and His true
 Sent one, and have not doubted since,
 But have been struggling not to wince
 With their gear and the persons too
 In the cause of Allah in view.
 Such are the sincere ones and true.
 16 Say "What! Will you teach God about
 Your faith? But Allah knows, no doubt,
 All that's in heaven and all on earth.
 He's got full knowledge of the berth
 Of all things *naught and of full worth*.
 17 They pretend they do you a service
 To have embraced Islam to verve us.
 Say "Do not count your Islam as such
 A favour on me in your clutch.
 No, God's conferred favour on you
 That He's guided you to faith's pew,
 If you are just sincere and true.
 18 "God knows the secrets of the sky
 And of the earth, and God comes by
 To see all you do *as you try*."

Beloved, when You placed faith in the
 Qur'an
 In me, it was no service I had drawn,
 But rather a grace from You that took me
 Divided from all loving company.
 Established faiths look all askance and see
 Me in my unbelief and wickedness
 And in rebellion against their address,
 And so the Jew, the Muslim, and the good
 Christian all swear that I've become a hood.
 Beloved, I am Your hoodlum filled with
 grace,
 Reciting always here before Your face
 The wine and water of the Torah's trace,
 The Psalms, the Gospel, and Qur'anic lace.

Surah 50 Qaf

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 Qaf, by the glorious Qur'an.
 2 They wonder that there's come to dawn
 To them a warner from among
 Themselves. So unbelievers hung,

"This is a marvel, one unsung."

3 "What! When we die and become dust,
That's a return far from what must."

4 We know already how earth takes
Them in its breast and no one wakes.
With Us is a record of stakes.

5 But they deny the truth when it
Comes to them. They're confused to sit.
6 Don't they look at the sky above?
How We've made it adorned with love,
And there are no flaws in its shove?

7 And earth We've spread it out and set
The mountains on it firmly met,
And produced there of every kind
Of beautiful growing things vined,
8 To be observed and minded by
Every worshipper coming nigh.

From Qaf to Qaf, the mystic's call is made,
And I return to whirl as though unpaid.
The mountain of my brow I climb and find
The weary way a weariness of mind
As well as of the stumps. But unresigned
I take the path up to the peak betrayed.
From Qaf to Qaf, the distance I've waylaid
In arcs descending from the brow and
stayed

To bear the little journey without haste,
And without place before the butt and
paced

Of dogmas peering from behind the laced
Love of My sole Redeemer simply placed.
Beloved, from Qaf to Qaf I am one dined
To find the glories beyond the well-wined.

9 We send down the rain from the sky
Charted with blessing, and produce
By it gardens and corn unloose,
10 And tall palms with shoots of fruit-
stalks

Piled over one another's walks,
11 As nourishment for servants and
We give life by it to the land
That's parched, so will the coming be
When resurrection stands to free.

12 Before them Noah's folk denied,
Companions of the Rass deride,
Thamud too come from every side,
13 The fold of 'Ad, and Pharaoh too,
The brothers of Lot come in view,
14 Companions of the wood, and folk

Of Tubba', each one under yoke
Rejected messengers, and My
Warning was fulfilled at their cry.
15 Were We tired of the first creation,
That they should doubt so the new station?
16 It was We who created man,
And We know what dark things *in plan*
His soul makes to him, for We're near,
Much nearer to him than *his* dear
Heart vein *that pulses now in fear*.

The jugular vein is a task too hard
For humankind to keep up in the lard,
And so You must be nearer than the pard,
And greater than the inner though unbarred.
Beloved One, nearer than the life vein's
flow

That teaches me unstintingly to go,
I spy and spy again, and yet I show
No journey greater than the ring I mow.
I whirl to greater heights perhaps than those
Fair children that rise up from dancing toes,
And then see that no body rising shows.
The hopeful jump goes bump on earthly
rows.

And yet You're nearer than I might
suppose:

At the closed door You leave a golden card.

17 See two appointed to find out
Learn, one sitting without doubt
On the right and the left in rout.
18 Not one word does he speak but there
Is a watcher by him aware.
19 Unconsciousness of death will bring
Truth: "This was unfortunate thing
That you were fleeing on the wing."
20 The trumpet shall be sounded, then
The day warned about falls on den.
21 There will come out every soul then,
With each will be one to drive on,
And to bear witness at the drawn.
"You were unheeding of the right:
Now We've removed your veil from sight,
And you see clearly this day's plight."

The angels who record and guard my ways
Do not remain for thanksgiving and praise,
But only intercept the derring-do
When the soul stops and returns back to
You.

The chain and mace resound upon the
grave,
The rain comes down to soak the working
slave
Once silenced by the death that broken the
sting
Of earth and sky and middle sort of thing.
Beloved, let angels stand around me still
To write down what I do and what I will,
And if they err or not, once on the hill
I shall bear witness of the things to fill.
Let angels dance or wait, let the grave find
That if not angels, humans can be kind.

23 And his companion then with say
"Here is witness with me in sway."
24 "Cast, cast in hell rejecter play,
25 "Preventing good, transgressing all
Bounds, casting doubts and doubting's
thrall,
26 "Who set up another god for
Allah, cast him out in pain's gore."
27 His companion will say "Our Lord,
I did not make him transgress board,
But he himself was far astray."
28 He'll say "Do not dispute with each
Other in My presence or preach,
I sent you warning from the reach.
29 "The Word does not change before Me,
I do not do the injury
Unjust to My servants in fee."

Beloved, I've wasted life in the dispute
With the damned posing as Christians to
root,
But let me turn a new grief and rely
On cantillation rather in my sty.
The idols of my own hearth here suffice
Without the images others find nice.
I turn to snuggle with the woodland mice
Beneath a roof at least free of bird lice.
Let Your Word, O Beloved, descend on me
In silence and in silence let me be
The peaceful hermit of the progeny
Of prophet and imamic husbandry.
The Christ-child still looks out from the inn
door
Wide-eyed to find the world still full of
gore.

30 One day We will enquire of hell,

"Are you filled to the full to dwell?"
It will say "Are there more in spell?"
31 The garden will be brought near to
The righteous, no far thing in view.
32 "This is what was promised to you,
For every one who turned repenting,
Who kept His law and unrelenting,
33 "Who feared God Most Gracious
unseen,
And brought devoted heart serene,
34 "Enter in peace and safety too,
This day's eternal life in view."

You speak to hell and hell answers aloud,
You are Creator of words in the crowd.
No language is of human device where
The meaning and the witness fill the air.
The paradise that You bring to the eye
Of the elect and chosen in the sky
Is not beyond Orion's fateful glare,
But at the very hand upon the stair.
Beloved, the ones who keep Your law
remain
To scatter health and happiness in vain,
But heart devotion heals the grief and pain,
And brings eternal life in peace to reign,
As grace effectively ploughs up the earth
To find a deeper and more solid berth.

35 There will be for them all they wish,
And more besides from Our own dish.
36 How many generations there
Before them did We destroy share,
Better in strength than they? Then they
Wandered through the earth, was there way
Of escape for them where they stray?
37 In this is a message for him
Who has a heart and knows the trim,
Or who gives ear and earnestly
Witnesses the truth faithfully.
38 We created the sky and earth
And all between in six days' worth,
Nor did We tire in weariness.
39 Bear up with patience the address,
All that they say, and celebrate
The praises of your Lord, before
The rising of the sun from store,
Before its setting *at the door*.
40 And during a part of the night,
Celebrate His praises as right,
And after the gestures adore.

41 And listen for the day and store
 When the caller will call out from
 A place nearby to speak in sum,
 42 The day when they will hear the blast
 In truth, that will be the day cast
 Of resurrection come at last.
 43 It's We who give life and give death,
 To Us is the last goal of breath,
 44 The day when earth will be split up,
 From hurrying out like a tup,
 That will be a gathering then,
 An easy thing for Us again.
 45 We know best what they say and you
 Are not one to be awed in crew
 By force. So warn with the Qur'an
 Such as fear My warning out-drawn.

After the six days of creating power,
 The seventh day appears in holy hour,
 And gives the time of memory to play
 Upon the Scriptures for another day.
 A part of the night and a golden ray
 Throughout the day reminds the soul astray
 To come back to remembrance of Your
 name,
 And turn from the week and the weekly
 shame.

Beloved, the gauge of resurrection now
 As Sabbath turns toward the evening brow
 Is greater for the cantillated Word
 That stands upon the bleating of the herd.
 Let Torah and Qur'an feed me until
 The Sabbath light retreats from off my hill.

Surah 51 Al-Zariyat, or the Winds that Scatter

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 By the scattering, 2 and the lifting and
 The bearing away heavy hand,
 3 And those that move with ease and grace,
 4 And those that spread about the place,
 5 What you have been promised is true.
 6 Judgement and justice must come true.
 7 By the sky with its many ways,
 8 You're in a doctrinal amaze,
 9 By which you are deluded, those
 As will be deluded in pose.
 10 Woe to the sellers of falsehood,
 11 Those who are heedless in the flood
 Of a confusion. 12 They ask, "When
 Will day of judgement come again

And day of justice burst in bud?"
 13 A day when they'll be tested sore
 Over the fire and on the gore!
 14 "So taste your trial, this is what you
 Wanted to bring quickly in view!"

The three hells vaunt before each man
 alive:
 The one hell in the future and to strive,
 The other now and on the earth to be,
 The third within the human symmetry.
 Three hells to face and conquer by Your
 grace,
 I find the third more constantly in trace,
 Each day and night, one that cannot be fled
 Like the hell of society well-bred.
 Beloved, I flee to You, my fourth of hells,
 Before the tolling of ominous bells,
 And in Your love and judgement fast I burn
 Relinquishing all the great things I learn.
 I flee to You and find that a vain treat:
 You draw me willing or not to Your feet.

15 As for the righteous, they will be
 Amidst gardens and springs' degree,
 16 And taking joy in things their Lord
 Gives them for living life restored.
 17 They used to sleep little by night,
 18 And in the hour of early light
 They prayed forgiveness *in God's sight*.
 19 And in their wealth and gear the right
 Of him who asked and him in plight.
 20 On earth are signs of faith assured
 For those who found when they occurred.
 21 They're also in yourselves, just see.
 22 In the sky is the treasury
 Of nourishment, your promised fee.
 23 Then by the Lord of heaven and earth,
 This is the very truth of worth,
 As much as that you utter sound
 Understandable on your ground.
 24 Have you heard the tale of the guests
 Honoured of Abraham *for rests*?
 25 See they came in before him saying
 "Peace!" He replied "Peace" though they're
 staying
 A people marvellous and strange.
 26 Then he turned fast to his own range
 And brought a fatted calf 27 and set
 It before them. He said "Well met,
 Will you not eat the bit you get?"

28 Then he feared. They said "Do not fear."

And they gave him good news to hear
Of a son blessed with knowledge queer.

29 But his wife stepped up and aloud,
She struck her forehead and avowed,
"A barren old hag in the crowd!"

30 They said "So's spoken your Lord here.
He's full of wisdom, knowledge, fear."

Ah, my Beloved, I smite my face in grief
And offer You my barrenness in fie.
Your promises when heard in this dark
room

Of veils and mists, although they pierce the
gloom,

Seem like old tales of fortune and lost
treasure.

Can I conceive and my old lord have
pleasure?

My murmur echoes in Your heart and
mind,

Where You forgive no faith that's deaf and
blind.

Then let my faith hear with Your all-wise
knowing,

And see beyond the world of sense and
showing.

My doubt that this world can contain Your
light

Be but a step toward day and from the night
Let sound again the word that I had
doubted.

Divine voice sounds and even gods are
routed.

31 He said "And what, O you sent ones,
Is your task *now upon these runs*?

32 They said "We've been sent to a folk
In sin, 33 "to bring on them in stroke

A rain of clay stones out for broke,

34 "Marked as from your Lord for those
who

Transgress beyond the bounds in view."

35 We took out the believers fleeing
Who were there, and as We were seeing,

36 We found there no just people but
Were living in one house and shut.

37 And We left there a sign for such
As fear grief of punishment's touch.

38 And in Moses, see We sent him

To Pharaoh with clear message grim.

39 But he turned back with his court chiefs
And said "A sorcerer for griefs."

40 We took him and his armies too,
And cast them in the sea to spew,
And he was to blame for the crew.

41 In the 'Ad: See We sent on them
A wasting wind in stratagem.

42 It left nothing at all that came
Up before it, but cast the same
In ruins and decrepit claim.

43 And in the Thamud, see, 'twas told,
"Enjoy your day out of the cold!"

44 But they just arrogantly slipped
Away from their Lord's orders clipped:
The stunning sound seized them at last,
While they looked on with their eye's
glassed.

45 They could not even stand or help
Themselves *at all but only yelp*.

46 So were the folk of Noah still
Before them, for their wicked bill.

You do complain, Beloved, that peoples
turn

Away from grace and in their disgrace
burn.

But surely that's expected as we learn.
Ignorance deepens in the crowd to spurn.
You only will enlighten mind of men,
And mind exists alone in one again,
The single man before the blatant crowd.
You only speak within the heart aloud.
Of course exception's found on Sinai's
mount,

But then You had to bring to an account
The folk for worshipping the calf in gold.
A nation's righteousness is hard to hold.
Give grace, Beloved, to nations as You
give

To each soul singly with the power to live.

47 We built the firmament with skill
And power, for We create the vast
And ghastly halls of space to last.

48 And We have spread the spacious earth,
How excellent is Our task's worth!

49 All things We have made in their pairs,
So you might learn from them awares.

50 Turn quickly to God, I'm from Him
A warner to you, clear and trim.

51 Don't make another to bow down
 To in worship with God in town.
 I'm from Him a warner to you,
 Both clear and open *to your view*.
 52 No messengers came to the folk
 Before him, but like him in stroke,
 They said the same: "A sorcerer,
 Or one possessed is this new fer!"
 53 Is this the legacy they give
 Down generations without sieve?
 No, they themselves are folk transgressing
 Beyond the bounds and not confession.
 54 So do not turn away from them.
 It's not your fault or blame in hem.
 55 But teach for teaching benefits
 The one who believes *where he sits*.
 56 I've only made the jinns and men
 That they may serve Me once again.
 57 No payment do I ask of them,
 Nor portion of meals from their hem.
 58 For God gives sustenance, He's Lord
 Of power and steadfast and adored.
 59 For the wrongdoers, their portion's like
 The portion of their fellows strike,
 Let them not beg me to bring quick
 Upon them that portion and slick.
 60 Woe, then, to unbelievers when
 Day of their promise comes again.

You call in argument the vastness of
 The universe in proof of divine love.
 But surely that's all relative in glove,
 And just a matter of who's big to shove.
 If You had measured human bone to be
 In light-years, not beyond Your majesty,
 The argument would fall. You set the stage
 And call the proof, and that is what I rage
 Against as reason circular in gauge.
 Beloved, I rage and You give proof again,
 And let us see who's believed by more men.
 In my experience the weaker word
 Is what men choose as soon as they have
 heard,
 And leave the truth to mouse and bat and
 bird.

Surah 52 At-Tur, Mount Sinai

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 By the mount, 2 by decree inscribed
 3 In a scroll unfolded, imbibed,
 By the fane oft arising near,

5 By canopy raised high from fear,
 6 And by the ocean's swelling wave,
 7 The doom from your Lord that you crave
 Will come to happen to each slave.
 8 None can turn it aside, 9 the day
 When the sky will be blown away.
 10 The mountains will all fly about.
 11 Woe that day to those then who flout
 As falsehood, 12 that play round about
 In trifling shoals. 13 That day shall they
 Be thrust down to hell fire to pay.
 14 It shall be said "This is the fire,
 Denied by you, now you require.
 15 "Is this a mere invention now,
 Or do you see it anyhow?
 16 "So burn there, it's the same to you
 Whether you bear patient in rue
 Or not. You just receive reward
 Of your own deeds again restored."
 17 As for the righteous, they will be
 In gardens glad *eternally*,
 18 Enjoying what their Lord's bestowed
 On them, and their Lord shall the load
 Of their salvation from the fire
 Bring on them *for their one desire*.
 19 "Eat and drink, with profit and health,
 Because of your good deeds for wealth."
 20 They recline on thrones in ranks ranged,
 And We shall join them to estranged
 Companions with eyes big and fine.
 21 Those who believe whose families dine
 With them in faith, to them We'll join
 Their families. We'll not deprive
 Them of aught of their works' design,
 Each one's in pledge for his deeds' jive.
 22 We'll bestow on them fruit and meat,
 Anything that they want for treat.
 23 They'll there exchange one with the
 other,
 A cup of free fun not to smother,
 No taint of ill on any mother.
 24 Round them will serve them servants
 too,
 Like pearls well-guarded, *in their view*.
 25 They will advance to each to greet
 In mutual enquiry's treat.
 26 They'll say "Beforetime we were not
 Without fear for our people's lot.
 27 "But God's been good to us and taught
 Deliverance from penalty
 Of scorching wind. 28 We called on Him

From ancient time. He is not dim,
Beneficent, of mercy's trim."

The decree inscribed from that time You
came

In darkness and in cloud as well as flame
On Sinai, was not just a law of blame,
But rather proclamation of Your love
In sovereign grace to come down from
above.

You foreordained by the commandments
spent

Who should be among those that You have
bent

To keep within Your loving heart
throughout

Eternity in celestial redoubt.

No one can turn aside Your love and hate,
And none can flee from Your hand in its
rate,

But You reach out to take each soul
concerned

And put each in the vat that each has
spurned,

By choice or by flight, till salvation's
learned.

29 Proclaim then praises. By the grace
Of your Lord, you're no mage in trace
Nor one possessed *nor in disgrace*.

30 Or they say "Poet, we expect
For him calamity select
In time!" 31 Say "Wait, I too will wait
Along with you to see the rate."

32 Is it their powers to understand
That bring them to this, or a band
Of folk transgressing beyond land?

33 Or they say "He's invented it"
No, they have no faith where they sit.

34 Let them produce a recitation
Like it, if they speak truth's elation.

35 Were they created out of naught,
Or did they make themselves once taut?

36 Or did they make the heavens and earth?
No, they have no firm faith in berth.

37 Are your Lord's treasures with them, or
Are they the ones who manage score?

38 Or do they have a ladder by
Which they can listen up and try?

Let their listener produce the why.

39 Or had He only daughters while

You have sons upon which to smile?

40 Or is it that you ask reward

So they loaded with debt like sword?

41 Or that the unseen's in their hands,
And they write it down *as commands*?

42 Or do they intend there a plot?

But those who defy God in lot
Are themselves involved in a plot.

43 Have they a god other than God?

Exalted is God are from sod

Above the things they join in prod.

44 If they saw a piece of the sky

Fall, they would say, "Clouds gather by."

45 So leave them alone till they spy

That day of theirs, and theirs to keep,
When they will faint, for terror weep.

46 The day when plotting will avail

Them nothing and no help prevail.

For those who do wrong, there remains

Another punishment in chains

Besides this, but most fail to see

And understand *perversity*.

48 Now wait in patience the command

Of your Lord, for you are in band

Beneath Our eyes. And celebrate

The praises of your Lord in state

While you stand forth to *see the great*,

49 And for part of the night praise Him,

Until the sight of stars grow dim.

They said Muhammad was magician here

And poet on the earth and not to fear.

Such still remain to train the human ear

With the illusion of the things held queer.

They said Muhammad made up every rune

You sent to him under the light of noon.

But that was to deny the divine share

Of how men ought to act and everywhere.

Beloved, I say Muhammad came to be

A prophet like the others in degree,

Not better and not worse. But men are free

To set themselves in temples faithfully

Regarding one prophet and setting all

The others under a satanic pall.

Surah 53 Al-Najm, or the Star

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 By the star when the star goes down,

2 Your friend's not astray or misled,

3 Nor does he speak from his own crown

Desired. 4 It is no less than bread

Of inspiration sent on him:

5 He was taught *in the interim*
By one mighty in power, 6 endued
With wisdom before what ensued.
7 While he was in the highest part
Of the horizon from the start.
8 Then he approached and came near by,
9 And was at distance of *a sigh*
Of but two bow-lengths, closer still,
10 So He conveyed the inspired will
To His servant, and His intent.
11 The *Prophet's* heart no way was spent
To falsify the vision's *bent*.
12 Will you then dispute with him of
What he saw, *of Beloved and love?*
13 He saw him in second descent,
14 Near the lote tree where no one went,
15 Near is the garden of abode.
16 Behold, the lote tree bore the load
Of shrouded *mystery unspoken!*
17 His sight never swerved *when awoken*,
Nor did it go wrong! 18 Truly he
The signs of his great Lord did see!

The two bow-length place revelation near
And at the eye if not close to the ear.
If two lobe-length had been the word of
fear,
Then there might have been people left to
hear.
Instead, it's only seeing under bows
With eyes unready for the divine shows.
Beloved, my eyes and ears as well as heart,
As the Qur'an reports for gloried part,
Remain to see and hear and at the dart
That pierces heart with divine love to start
I rise a sacrificial spark and find
Myself above the dergah with the wined,
In staggered whirling till Your throne
recedes
Beyond the livelihoods, beyond the creeds.

19 Have you seen Lat, and Uzza, 20 and
Another, third *goddess*, Manat?
21 What! And for you the male sex, and
For Him, the female *where He's at?*
22 Behold, such division would be
Indeed most unfair *and truly!*
23 These are nothing but names which you
Have devised, you, your fathers too,
For which Allah has sent down no

Authority at all. They go
After nothing but their conjecture
And wish of their own souls' confecture!
Even though there's already come
To them Guidance from their Lord 's *sum!*
24 No, shall man have *just* anything
He hankers after? 25 Everything
Ending and beginning belongs
To Allah, *both the rights and wrongs*.
25 To God the end and start of all
Belong *in heaven and earthly ball*.
26 Though myriad angels in the skies
Intercede, it won't help the lies,
Nothing will except after God
Gives leave for whom He please by rod,
That he's acceptable in pod.

The trinity of goddesses of fame
Are like to put the poor Christian to shame.
Those who converted to Islam in claim
In the beginning thought that trinity
So well-entrenched that no one could set
free.

Beloved, Your strength is in Your jealousy.
I have one daughter, and never had three,
And one grandson who does not have
degree

Of any sort of hoped divinity.
I shall not then compete with God above,
For daughters three or any son of love.
Let me worship You only at the door
Of Kaaba that spreads out upon my floor,
And never hope for anybody more.

27 Those who don't believe in hereafter,
Name angels with female name's *laughter*.
28 But they've no knowledge of the thing.
They follow just conjecturing.
And speculation cannot stand
Against the truth in its command.
29 So shun those who turn away from
Our message and desire no sum
But the life of this world to come.
30 That's as far as knowledge will come.
Your Lord knows best those who stray
from

His path, and He knows best those who
Receive the guidance *of His crew*.

31 Indeed to God belong all things
In heaven above and earthly rings.
He rewards those who do the wrong

According to their deeds in song,
 And He reward those who do good
 With what is best in livelihood.
 32 Those who avoid great sins and deeds
 Of shame, but only small faults' speeds,
 Your Lord is quick to forgive them.
 He knows you well when He brings you
 Out of the earth, and when in due
 You're hidden in your mums' wombs too.
 So do not justify yourselves.
 He knows best who it is *on shelves*
 That guards against evil *and elves*.

The great sins are the sins of Decalogue,
 And venal ones are those no less in cog
 That do support the principles revealed
 On Sinai in ten words in justice' yield.
 Beloved, keep me from great sins is my
 prayer,
 Since You've ordained good works should
 be my ware.
 The little sins too, which cause argument,
 Let them for truth from my life too absent.
 Beloved, the hidden things in human
 hearts,
 All crowded beneath the three greater darts
 Of greed and lust and cruelty for parts,
 Destroy the soul, though in their faded
 ways
 Establish men's society of praise,
 And show the masses where to find their
 craze.

33 Do you see one who turns the back,
 34 Gives little, then harden the slack?
 35 What! Does he know of the unseen
 So that he can see *what has been?*
 36 No, he's not acquainted with what
 Is in the Books of Moses shut,
 37 And of Abraham who fulfilled
 His engagements *as though unbilled?*
 38 That is that no bearer to come
 Can bear another's burden sum.
 39 That man can have naught but what he
 Strives for. 40 That his striving will be
 Soon come to light. 41 Then will he be
 Rewarded with complete reward.
 42 That's the final goal to your Lord.
 43 He who grants laughter, yes, and tears.
 44 He who grants death and in fears.
 45 That he created them in pairs,

The male and female *in their shares*,
 46 From a seed when lodged where it
 bears.
 47 That He has promised resurrection.
 48 That He gives wealth and satisfaction.
 49 That He's the Lord of Sirius.
 50 He destroy the ancient 'Ad's fuss,
 51 And the Thamud and did not give
 Them lease eternally to live.
 52 Before them, Noah's folk, for they
 Were most unjust, arrogant stay
 Of wicked transgressors *each day*,
 53 And He destroyed the overthrown
 Cities, 54 So that *ruins unknown*
 Have covered them *from stone to stone*.
 55 Then which of the gifts of your Lord,
 Will you dispute about *and hoard?*
 56 This is a warner come *in line*
 Of ancient warners *on the vine*.
 57 The day approaching's coming near.
 58 None but Allah can lay it bare.
 59 Are you amazed and this recital?
 60 To laugh and not weep at requital,
 61 Wasting your time in vanities?
 62 Fall down prostrating on your knees
 To God and worship Him *and please*.

The recommending of the books of Moses
 To those who hear the Qur'an in their poses
 Is not an option, but required of those
 Who will avoid the hell flames that arose.
 The fact that Christians started a while back
 To criticise the Bible for its lack
 Of historicity, integrity
 Of text without a variant to see
 Hardly gives an excuse to disobey
 What the Qur'an said on another day.
 We've still got Bible texts that flourished
 then,
 And so we know what Bible for all men
 The Qur'an meant in recommending it.
 Those who reject, reject it in a fit.

Surah 54 Al-Qamar, the Moon

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 The hour is near, the moon has split.
 2 But if they see a sign that's fit,
 They turn away and so they say
 "This is just magic on the way."
 3 They are rejecting to follow
 Their lusts, but every matter slow

Has its appointed time and glow.
 4 There have already come to them
 The recitations like a gem,
 5 Old wisdom, but warning is not
 A profit welcome in their plot.
 6 So turn away from them. The day
 The caller calls them to the fray,
 7 They will come forth, their eyes of grey
 Humbled from their graves on the way
 Like locusts scattered in the may,
 8 In haste with eyes transfixed, they rush
 Towards the caller. "Hard's this day
 The unbelievers come to say.

You once predicted by holy Qur'an
 That men would in the last days come to
 fawn
 Upon the splitting of the moon and say
 The week is just a pagan sort of play.
 They'll spit on the jum'u'a and take for rest
 Of Sabbath, the day of Muhammad best,
 Not Sunday like the heathen pokers do,
 But quarters of the moon split in their view.
 Beloved, I joy to see that You reject
 Their machinations with a word undecked.
 They follow lust and magic in their way,
 And take the evolutionary pay,
 Outdated theories to reject Your word,
 To turn from heavenly nectar to eat turd.

9 Before them Noah's folk would gush
 Rejecting, they rejected Our
 Servant, and say "Here is the glower
 Of one possessed," and so they came
 To drive him away *from his claim*.
 10 Then he called on his Lord "I am
 One overcome, do help *Your lamb*."
 11 We opened up the gates of heaven,
 With water pouring out *on leaven*.
 12 We made the earth break up in springs,
 So waters rose to decreed rings.
 13 We carried him on it he made
 Of wide board pitched with the strong
 stayed
 Palm fibre. 14 It floats under Our
 Eyes, a reward to one an hour
 Who had been rejected with power.
 15 And We have left this as a sign:
 Then is there any who'll resign
 To getting admonition's tine?
 16 But how great was My penalty

And My warning's catastrophe!
 17 We have made the Qur'an easy
 To understand and to remember.
 Then is there any to get ember
 Of admonition *in degree*?

You've made the Qur'an easy to grasp here,
 Partly because so many things of cheer
 Are also found in Torah without tear:
 The rain come from the sky and the springs
 bright
 And broken from the earth in all men's
 sight.

You've made the Qur'an easy and
 surprising
 When it upsets the pictures I'm devising:
 The pitch of palm and fibre if not glass
 Is something I stop on and don't let pass
 Without a token for each lad and lass
 To say this is a thing not found in wing
 Of Torah tale of ark and everything.
 Beloved, I read the Qur'an and I rise
 To rejoice at the warnings You apprise.

18 The 'Ad rejected too, then how
 Awful was My punishment now
 And My warning upon their brow?
 19 For We sent against them a great
 Wind, on a day of raging rate,
 20 To pluck up men as by the roots
 Of palms torn up *and without boots*.
 21 Yes, how was My penalty's warning!
 22 But We've indeed made the adorning
 Of the Qur'an easy to hear
 And to remember at the ear.
 Then is there anybody here
 Who will receive warning *with fear*?

Quite frankly I find memorizing tough,
 Whether of Hebrew Torah or the rough
 Psalms of sweet David, or the glowing
 cheer
 Of the Qur'an that I am reading here.
 If You, Beloved, think it's an easy thing
 To learn by heart, then You're a dingaling.
 I've learned so many surahs in my day
 I mix them and I mix them without pay,
 And then forget them in a trice and say
 Them once more hoping that the words will
 stay.

Beloved, there may be some who learn it
fast,
But others find a chore is there to last,
And even ayatullahs fail to reach
Beyond a third of the words of its speech.

23 The Thamud too rejected warners.
24 For they said "What! A man of scorers,
A single one from among us!
Shall we follow such one with fuss?
We'd be out of our minds to buss.
25 Was the message sent to us by
Him of all people here to spy?
No, he's arrogant one to lie."
26 Ah, they will know on the next day
Who is the liar and proud in pay.
27 We'll send a she-camel by way
Of test for them. So watch them, pray,
And be so patient *and not stray*.
28 Tell them that the water's to be
Divided between them in fee.
Each one can drink in turns' decree.
29 But they called to their friend, and he
Took sword in hand, hamstrung the wee.
30 Ah, how was My penalty's warning!
31 We sent against them in the morning
A single might blast, and they
We like dry stubble used for hay
By one who feeds penned cattle's bray.
32 We have made the Qur'an easy
To hear and remember in fee,
Then is there any one to get
The admonition *in it met*?

I do remember that awful remark
That's found more than once in Qur'anic
park
Of how Thamud hamstrung a camel there
As happy and a lark and without care.
That word's easy to mark and keep in mind
Even by the dumb and the deaf and blind.
The picture rises waking and in sleep
Of bawling camel hamstrung. I could weep.
Beloved, bring down Your curses on all
men
Who shove the rights of animals again
Into the bin and take what they can take
Against the creatures that You came to
make.
Blasphemy against creature is the same
Blasphemy against Your own holy name.

33 The folk of Lot rejected warning.
34 We sent on them *before the morning*
A strong storm with showers of stones
scorning,
Except on Lot's household adorning,
Then We saved by the early morning.
35 As a grace from Us, so We do
Reward those who give their thanks *true*.
36 He warned them of Our punishment,
But they disputed what was sent.
37 They even tried to snatch away
His guests from him, but We that way
Blinded their eyes. "Now taste My wrath
And hear My warning *in the path*."
38 Early on the next day there came
Abiding punishment in flame.
39 "So taste My wrath and warning claim."
We've made the Qur'an easy here
To understand and keep in ear.
Then is there anybody near
Who'll take the admonition dear?

The case of Lot is easy too to keep
In mind while herding either goats or
sheep.
The raining down of brimstone's hard, I
say,
To forget for the howling of that day.
The blinding of the violent who came
Against the guests is something of such
fame
That it will hardly leave my mind before
I am a basket face in old folks' store.
Beloved, I taste the sulphur of Your wrath,
And seek a straighter and more righteous
path.
I look for admonition and the power
To keep Your promises another hour.
But understanding is another thing:
Keep my heart and my ear under Your
wing.

41 To the folk of Pharaoh before
Too came Warners from Allah's store.
42 The folk rejected all Our signs,
But We seized them with such designs
Of punishment that comes from One
High in might, able when He's done
To carry out His will begun.
43 Are your infidels better than

They are? Or have you missed the scan
 Of sacred books? 44 Or do they say
 "We act together in our way
 To defend ourselves from the fray?"
 45 Soon will their crowd be put to flight,
 And they will show their backs to light.
 46 No, the hour is the time declared
 To them, and that hour will be shared
 Most grievous and most bitter bared.
 47 Those in sin are the ones who stray
 In mind and in their madness play.
 48 The day they will be dragged through
 fire

On their faces, "Taste your desire,
 the touch of hell upon your pyre!"
 49 All things We have created in
 Proportion and in measured bin.
 50 And Our command is just one thing,
 The twinkling of an eye to bring.
 51 In the past We've destroyed such bands
 As you. Then are there commands
 That any will get warning stands?
 52 All that they do is noted in
 The books of *their actions of sin*.
 53 Each matter, small and great, is on
 Record. 54 As for the righteous drawn,
 They will be in the middle of
 Gardens and the rivers of *love*,
 55 In an assembly of the truth,
 In presence of a Sovereign ruth.

You've got imagination, Beloved, when
 You talk of dragging on their faces men
 Through fires of hell and coming back
 again.

Proportion in creation's a good thing,
 And measurement in punishment and sting
 Must be, if chaos does no strengthening.
 Hell is a place of vasterly inventions,
 And filled with varied sorts of fine
 dissensions

Well tailored to each punishment refined.
 But paradise invariably's resigned
 To gardens under which the rivers flow,
 The same as those of Egypt and the glow
 Of the Hijaz. Beloved, You ran out of
 Inventions when it came to show Your
 love.

Surah 55 Ar-Rahmani

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 Most Gracious, 2 He who's taught Qur'an.
 3 He has created mankind's spawn.
 4 He's taught him speech to lay mind on.
 5 Sun and moon follow the appointed
 In courses *as He has anointed*.
 6 And grass and trees alike prostrate
 Themselves in adoration's state.
 7 The skies He's raised on high, and He
 Has set up rate of justice free,
 8 So that you might not wickedly
 Go past the balance *mindlessly*.
 9 So set the weight in fairness and
 Do not cut short the balance stand.
 10 He's spread out earth for creature's stay,
 11 Thereon is fruit and the palms splay
 Producing spathes of dates each day,
 12 And grain with leaves and stalk to feed
 And hay sweet-smelling, *cattle's greed*.
 13 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?

The one who cheats in merchandise and
 sale,
 And makes the weight too light, the milk
 too pale,
 Has lost sight of how You deal with just
 men
 And the unjust who come to You again.
 Your giving's in abundance of the date
 And corn and hay and fodder in its rate.
 Be perfect like Your God, is what You say
 In Your perfection of providence sway.
 Beloved, to cheat and steal is to disdain
 The very benefits that man may gain
 From morn to night upon the earthly main.
 You don't use us a false balance when You
 give
 The air and water whereby human's live.
 You don't provide fruit running through a
 sieve.

14 He made humankind from the clay
 Sounding like pottery to play,
 15 He made the jinns a fire without
 A wisp of smoke *to show their route*.
 16 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?
 17 Lord of the two easts and the Lord
 Of the two wests, *He is adored*.
 18 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?

19 He's set free the two flowing streams
 Of water to meet each it seems.
 20 Between them is a barrier
 They do not cross although they stir.
 21 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?
 22 Out of them pearls and coral flits.
 23 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?
 24 His ships sail peacefully at sea
 Though waves like mountains there may
 be.
 25 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?

The Muslims that I know take the Qur'an
 And then they try to show its truthful
 drawn

Referring to the barrier between
 Two waters flowing as a single stream.
 They do not take in scientific proof
 The making of the jinn in warp and woof
 Of fire and not the clay without a poof.
 Selective science: argument aloof.
 Beloved, the very act of setting up
 The human thought as criterion's cup
 Will backfire, shoot them in the foot like
 tup.

It's Your Word that holds sway above all
 that

The human mind can compass of the fat
 Philosophy or empirical vat.

26 All on the earth will perish soon.
 27 But there remains Your Lord's face'
 noon,
 Full of glory, abundant boon.
 28 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?
 29 From His seeks every creature found
 In the skies and upon the ground,
 Each day in splendour shone around.
 30 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?
 31 Soon We shall settle your affairs,
 O both worlds of *the earth and airs*.
 32 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?
 33 O you congress of jinn and men,
 If you can pass the zones again
 Of heaven and earth, then pass again,

Not without leave shall you go then.
 34 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?

This verse I guess predicts the rising rocket
 To go as far as to the moon and docket,
 And that's a weight of evidence that men
 Are out to furnish power to rule again.
 Those who grew up on games of virtual
 Now think that such action was just the sal
 Of those who had control of television
 To back the politics of deep incision.
 Beloved, by Your leave men go here and
 there

Both in the mind and heart and in the air,
 To find a silver castle, golden stair,
 And I too rise to universes cold
 As I recite the Qur'an as I'm told
 Beneath the firs and pines and aspens bold.

35 On you'll be sent a flame of fire
 And smoke without defence acquire.
 36 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?
 37 When the sky's split and become red
 Like ointment about to be spread,
 38 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?
 39 On that day no question is asked
 Of man or jinn of his sin *masked*.
 40 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?
 41 The sinners will be known by those
 Marks characterizing *their throes*,
 And they'll be seized by forelocks' *woes*,
 And dragged away by feet *and toes*.
 42 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?
 43 This is the hell sinners deny
 44 In the middle of it and high
 In midst of boiling water hot
 They'll wander to find resting spot.
 45 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?

Though many have thought this word here
 reveals
 Events of the last day when judgement
 peels
 The hearts of men asunder, I propose
 To those who look for scientific prose

In the Qur'an, since it's not poetry,
 That here's prediction of the rocketry
 That burst in flame and killed with artistry
 Of awful heat the astronauts in rows.
 It's just as good as any other way
 Of reading science and prophetic sway
 Together in the words You sweetly sang
 To listening Muhammad with a twang.
 I turn from men's events and find in You
 Unchanging love and justice, and hate too.

46 But for such as fear the time when
 They'll stand before their Lord in glen,
 There will be two gardens for men.
 47 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?
 48 They contain all varieties,
 And everything that men could please.
 49 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?
 50 In them will be two springs to see
 Flowing and springing up to be.
 51 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?
 52 In them will be fruits of each kind,
 And two by two in pairs aligned.
 53 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?
 54 They will recline on carpets there
 Lined with rich brodering and fair.
 With garden fruits nearby to share.
 55 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?
 56 There will be the chaste with downcast
 Glances in modesty to last
 Whom no man or jinn before them
 Has touched, they are created gem.
 57 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?
 58 Similitude of rubies made
 And coral brightly there displayed.
 59 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?
 60 Is there reward for good beside
 Another good *that will abide*?
 61 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?

You quote the book of Revelation when
 You speak of paradise again to men.
 You show the water of life rising high,

The rivers of life pushing to the sky,
 And overcast above that flowing stream
 The tree of life seen now only in dream,
 Producing fruit in kind from time to time:
 A place where there's no sin or any crime.
 Beloved, I seek the visions from that book
 Condemned by church and council to its
 nook

Outside the sacred worship's liturgy,
 Except in Ethiopic Easter's glee,
 To read at night once every year and late,
 Before the word he's risen comes to date.

62 Besides these two there is a pair
 Of other gardens of the fair.
 63 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?
 64 Verdant in colours and in kits.
 65 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?
 66 In them will be two springs to pour
 Our water in abundant store.
 67 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?
 68 In them will be fruits and the dates
 As well as fresh pomegranates.
 69 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?
 70 In them will be companions fair,
 The good and beautiful are there.
 71 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?
 72 Companions modestly array
 Under their canopies displayed.
 73 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?
 74 Whom no man or jinn come before
 Has touched *improperly on floor*.
 75 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?
 76 Reclining on green cushions and
 Rich carpets of luxury's brand.
 77 Then which of your Lord's benefits
 Will you disparage without wits?
 78 Blessed be the name of your Lord then,
 For of both majesty by men
 And in abundant honour met,
Blessed the name of your Lord yet.

The Bible did forget a word or two
 Still needed to comfort the waiting crew,

And fill in the loose ends that Moses left
 Out of the book divine as though bereft.
 The use of the Qur'an is high and sure,
 And tells to humankind what's left of pure
 In revelation that no man had known,
 No, not even the Christ upon his throne,
 But only You, Beloved, and You alone.
 I take, Beloved, with joy the secret shown:
 In paradise of the reward to give
 To righteous saved, you have vouchsafed to
 live

The pomegranate, that fruit above all
 A secret of eternity's bright hall.

Surah 56 Al-Waqia, or The Inevitable

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 When the even inexorable
 Has happened, 2 then will no one pull
 Out falsehoods that it should not come.
 3 Some bring it low, exalt will some.
 4 When the earth's shaken to the root,
 5 And mountains there crumbled in suit,
 6 Becoming dust scattered abroad,
 7 And you'll be sorted on the sod
 Into three groups *by hand of God*.
 8 Then the fellows of the right hand,
 What will be the news in command
 Of the fellows of the right hand?
 9 And the fellows of the left hand,
 What will be the news in command
 Of the fellows of the left hand?
 10 And those foremost will be foremost.
 11 These will be nearest to the boast
 Of God, 12 in gardens of bliss host.
 13 Some folk of those of ancient time,
 14 And also of more recent clime.
 15 On thrones set with jewels in rime,
 16 Reclining there face to face climb.
 17 Around about them will young men
 Perpetually refreshed again,
 18 With goblets, pitchers, and cups filled
 From the clear-flowing fountains billed.
 19 No hangover will they get then,
 Nor will they be drunk, those fair men.
 20 And with fruits, any like they like,
 21 And flesh of chickens at the spike.
 22 Companions beautiful with eyes
 Shining and big without disguise,
 23 Like pearls well-guarded for a prize.
 24 Reward of the deeds of their past.
 25 No frivolous words will they cast,

Nor taint of any ill to last,
 26 Only to say "Peace, peace" come fast.
 27 Then the fellows of the right hand,
 What will be the news in command
 Of the fellows of the right hand?
 28 Among the Lote-trees without thorns,
 29 Tall flowered trees and without bornes,
 30 In shade across extended ways,
 31 By water flowing and always,
 32 And fruit in an abundant craze,
 33 Whose season's not in limits, nor
 Supply forbidden, locked in store,
 34 And on thrones raised high to adore.
 35 We have created to restore.
 36 And made them virgin pure and clean,
 37 Beloved and of the same age seen,
 38 For the fellows of right hand keen.
 39 A number from the ancient time,
 40 A number from more recent clime.

Though in the Gospel Jesus makes a sign
 That only two are set before the line
 Of judgement, those on left and those on
 right,

The book of Revelation takes in sight
 The third group, the foremost, and counts
 them too,

And so forever after Christian crew
 Has wondered where the hundred thousand
 true

And forty-four remain as virgins due.
 Noble Qur'an will mention them soon too
 As the third group, the foremost ones in
 view.

Beloved, set me in one of three like You
 Are set by theologians in their crew
 Of ravaged human thought's philosophy,
 And see if humankind likes to be three.

41 And the fellows of the left hand,
 What will be the news in command
 Of the fellows of the left hand?
 42 In a fierce blast of flames they'll meet
 With boiling water for their treat,
 43 And in the clouds of black smoke greet.
 44 Nothing's there to refresh or please.
 45 For they were used to be at ease
 Indulged in wealth *beneath the breeze*.
 46 Stubborn in wickedness *and ease*.
 47 They used to say "What! When we die
 And become dust and bones thereby,

Shall we then be raised up again?
 48 And our ancestors too like men?"
 Say "Yes, those of old and those too
 Of later times will come in view,
 50 "All surely will be gathered too
 For the appointed day come true.
 51 "Then you who go in the wrong way
 And treat truth as falsehood in sway,
 52 "You'll surely taste the Zaqqum tree.
 53 "You'll fill your bellies with the spree,
 54 "And drink the boiling water too,
 55 "Drink like sick camels without due
 And raging with thirst and with rue."
 56 Such will be their amusement on
 The day of reckoning at dawn.
 We have created you so why
 Don't you witness the truth thereby?
 58 Do you not see, the seed cast out
 59 Have you made it or We the stout?
 60 We have decreed death common lot,
 And none can stop Us in Our plot
 61 From changing your form once again
 To forms that you know not from men.
 62 You know now creation's first form.
 So why not celebrate the warm
 Praises of the Lord once again?
 63 Do you see the seed that you sow
 In the ground? 64 Do you make it grow,
 Or are We the cause *and not slow*?
 65 If We so wanted We could take
 And crumble it to dry grain's wake,
 And you would be left all amazed.
 66 "We're left with our debts and we're
 crazed.
 67 "Indeed we're shut out of the phased."

Most noble and most common argument
 Of the Qur'an for the judgement that's sent
 At the last day on humankind once spent
 In death and grave and dust and bones
 unrent
 Is that if You could once create mankind
 At the beginning with patent unsigned,
 Then You are able to do what's designed
 In raising up again in new creation
 Those who are still to get punishment's
 ration.
 Beloved, I do not doubt what You can do.
 I merely doubt we understand the view
 You give of future things in present pew.
 The understanding's made only when men

Experience the thing and see again.
 The new is new and will surprise us too.

68 Do you see water that you drink?
 69 Do you bring it down from the brink
 Of cloud or do We? *Come now, think.*
 70 If We so willed, We could make it
 Salty, the why not give thanks fit?
 71 Do you see the fire that you touch?
 72 Do you grow the tree that feeds much
 Wood to the fire, or is it We?
 73 We've made it a remembrance, see,
 An article of comfort and
 Convenience for dwellers on sand.
 74 So celebrate with praise the name
 Of your Lord, supreme Lord of fame.
 75 I call to witness setting stars,
 76 A mighty calling without bars
 If you just knew *how great the stars*,
 77 That this is recitations found
 Most honoured here upon the ground,
 78 In a book well-guarded and sound,
 Which none can touch but the clean found,
 80 A revelation from the Lord
 Of all the universe adored.
 81 Is it a message you'd esteem
 To hold in lightness *of your dream*?
 82 Have you made it your livelihood
 To proclaim it false *and not good*?
 83 Then why don't you stop death when it
 Reaches the throat of dying fit,
 84 While you look at him and just sit?

The water and the fire in portals set
 Are witnesses of the remembrance met
 In sema' of the recitations wild
 Of the book guarded well and sound and
 styled.
 I stand up to whirl round, why should I sit
 Among those You condemn though they
 are fit?
 There is a time when men have right to
 speak
 In speculations against the book's treat,
 And raise their pawned objections at Your
 feet,
 Their criticism historical, fleet:
 And that's the time when they can stop the
 day
 When death steps in the human house to
 pay.

The right to criticise comes with the power
To make immortal on the final hour.

85 But We're nearer to him than you,
And yet you do not see the view,
86 Then why don't you, if you're excluded
From reckoning, 87 call back exuded
Soul, if you're true in what you do?
88 So if he's one nearest to God,
89 Rest and satisfaction in pod,
And garden of delights for prod.
92 If he's a fellow of right hand,
91 "Peace be to you," from fellow's band
Gathered round unto the right hand.
92 If he's one to treat as lies,
Who goes the wrong way as he flies,
93 For him is entertainment brought
In boiling water for a drought,
94 And burning fire of hell unsought.
95 This is truth unsullied, unbought.
96 So celebrate with praise the name
Of Your Lord who's of supreme fame.

Proponents of historic criticism
Of the book studied with a witticism
Are promised in a group, though not the
fourth,
The wages of their science as it poureth.
The one who treats the book as lies will get
The boiling gate of water that was met
And overcome in sema', for his drink.
The gate of fire he'll find upon the brink
Of burning hell. So all will come to rise
In sema' of remembrance by Your eyes.
Beloved, I take the book and fail to see
The petty flaws You left in it to be,
And rather sing it than believe and wonder
What means the rising and the tolling
thunder.

Surah 57 Hadid, or Iron.

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
1 Whatever's in the sky above
And on the earth, let it lend glove
To praise and glorify Allah,
For He's high in power and in awe,
The wise. 2 To Him belongs the sway
Of heavens and earth. He gives the way
Of life and death, and holds the power
Over all things *in every hour*.
3 He's first and last, the evident

And immanent, He does prevent
Full knowledge of all things content.
4 He has created heavens and earth
In six days, and has stepped in berth
On the throne. He knows what comes in
The earth and what comes forth from bin,
And what descends from heaven and what
Ascends up to it to be shut.
And He is with you where you be,
All that you do Allah can see.
5 To Him the power of heaven and earth,
And all affairs revert in worth.
6 He merges night with day and He
Merges day into night, and He
Has full knowledge of secrets in
All hearts *whether of good or sin*.
7 Believe in God and His sent one,
And spend in alms out of the bun
Of which He's made you heirs for fun.
For those of you who believe and
Give alms, for them's great pay in hand.

My heart arises at the beauty brought
By the Qur'anic expression and thought.
Emotion is a thing not to be taught,
And never to be trusted even when sought.
And yet the rising of my heart is won
By You alone, Beloved, and for Your fun.
It is the product of Your grace to me
As You snatch me from hell's eternity.
If I believe in God, it's not because
I learned of You by human thought and
laws,
But for the way that You had mercy on
The one that You'd created once and
drawn.
Give me provisions and I'll give in alms
The help and hope as dates fall from the
palms.

8 What keeps you from belief in God?
The messenger invites by prod
You to believe in your Lord and
Has taken covenant in hand
If you are men of faith to stand.
9 He is the One who sends to His
Servant clear signs, that in a whiz
He may lead you for darkened deep
Into the light and God will keep
To you most kind and merciful.
10 What keeps you from giving alms' pull

In cause of God? For to God's full
Possession of the heavens and earth.
Not are the same among your worth
Are those who gave and fought in dearth
Before the victory. Those are
Of higher rand and brighter star
Than those who fought later in bar.
But to all God's promised the good.
And God knows well you've done as
should.

11 Who will lend to God a fine patch?
For He'll increase it like a thatch
To his credit, and have beside
Reward abundant to abide.

12 One day you'll see believing men
And women who believe again,
How their light runs out before them
And by their right hands in their hem:
"Good news for you today, for there
Are gardens beneath which streams fair
Flow, to dwell in them and to stand
In high achievement in that land."

13 One day will hypocrites of men
And women tell believers' then:
"Wait for us, let us borrow bright
For your light!" It will be said right,
"Turn back upon you to find light."
So a wall will be put in sight
Between them with a gate alight.
Within there will be mercy round,
All alongside it will be found
Wrath and punishment on the ground.
14 They'll call out, "Were we not with
you?"

The others will reply "It's true.
But you led yourselves in temptation.
You looked at it, and doubted ration,
And your desires have deceived you.
Until there comes out God's command.
The one deceiver deceived you
In regard to God and His planned.
15 "Today no ransom in command
Will be accepted of your band,
Nor of those who rejected God."
Your dwelling is in the fire's prod.
That is the proper place for you.
An evil refuge it is too."

The parable of the ten virgins waiting
For the bridegroom here the Qur'an is
stating.

The foolish virgins who did not have oil
Enough to light their lamps after the toil
Of slumber in hypocrisy, are cast
Into the burning where the fuel will last.
So their desires and lusts fulfil full-blast.
The virgins five and wise, not hypocrites,
Though slumbering on in their earthly fits,
Are wakened at the sema's call and find
Them entering the wedding hall and dined.
Beloved, cast me not where my lusts would
lead,
But make in me desires of better greed,
And bring me with the wise into Your
mead.

16 Has not the time come for believers
That their hearts humbly as receivers
Should engage in God remembrance
And of the truth revealed at glance,
And that they should not be like those
To whom was given revealings' rows
In former time, as ages passed
Over them and their hearts grew glassed?
For many among them are there
Rebellious transgressors to share.

17 You know God gives life to the earth
After its death in burning dearth,
Already have We shown the signs
Plainly to you to learn designs.

18 For those who give in charity,
Men and women, and lend in fee
To God a good loan, it shall be
Increased and so abundantly,
And they'll have yet their pay in fee.

19 And those who believe in God and
His messengers, they are at hand
Sincere, and witnesses to stand
In the eyes of their Lord in band.
They shall have their reward and light.
But those who reject in God's sight
And deny Our signs, they're in flight
Companions of hell fire and plight.

Has not the time come that believers should
Join in the sema' of remembrance good?
And yet the mass of men and womankind
Spread through the world of Muslims and
the wined

Christian and Jew, all fail to come apart
To join as one to recite from the heart

From the four books revealed. The horse
and cart
Of faithful plodding day by day are left
For rocket liturgies, and so bereft.
Beloved, I find reward and light come near
As I take on the ayni cem and hear
The echo of Your words resounding high,
The voice of Muhammad-Ali to sigh
In the night flight before Your throne and
gear.

20 You know that the life of this world
Is just play and amusement furl'd,
And pomp and boasting multiplied
Among yourselves, wealth and spawn tried.
Here is a parable to see:
How rain and growth that come to be,
Delight the husbandman freely,
Then soon it withers, you will see
A pallid dying on the lee;
Then it becomes dry, crumbles soon.
But in the hereafter to prune
A punishment severe come doon.
Forgiveness from God and His will.
And what is this world's life to fill
But goods and gear deceiving still?
21 Be best in pardon from your Lord,
And a garden and wide and floored
The width of heaven and earth implored,
Prepared for those who still believe
In God and His messengers' leave,
That is the grace of God, which He
Bestows on everyone He please.
And God's the Lord of grace to be
Abounding and coming with ease.
22 No evil can occur on earth
Or in your souls but as for worth
Recorded in decree before
We bring it into being's store.
That is easy for God *in core*.
23 So that you might not have despair
About things that come unaware,
Nor yet exult for favours brought
Upon you. For God loves none wrought
In boasting and vaingloried plot.

You work all things for good, the evil too,
According to the letters sent in view
In Bibles for the Christians before You.
The promise is repeated in the words
Of the Qur'an before the milling herds

Of Arabs waiting for grace to descend
On them and save them from things that
pretend.

Let Your fast decrees never fail to bend.
Beloved, I shall not despair, so heal me
Of faith in my own power and victory,
And let the grace that falls on my heart here
Work to the good and not to what I fear.
So whether I am cast to left or right,
All shall revert to goodness in Your sight.

24 Such persons as are covetous
And commend such to men for fuss,
And if anyone does turn back,
God is free of all need and lack,
Worthy of all praise. 25 We have sent
Beforehand our messengers lent
With clear signs and sent down with them
The book and furqan *like a gem*
To know the right from wrong by men,
That men may stand forth in the right.
We sent down iron in their sight,
In which is strength for mighty war,
As well as benefits, not gore,
That God may test mankind to see
Who will help, unseen Him freely
And His messengers. For God's full
Of might, Exalted in power's pull.

The book and furqan or criterion
That's mentioned here is before Ahmed's
done:

It refers back again, methinks, to that
Book and criterion that one time sat
On Sinai and on tables of stone writ
Were handed over to Moses, man fit.
The Torah and the Decalogue show here
In these verses sent down to lighten clear.
The Torah, Psalms and Gospels have come
near

In the verses below to give us cheer.
The furqan of Qur'an appears at last
Preparing humankind for final blast
Of judgement of the last day coming fast.
I look out with both joy and welcome fear.

26 We sent Noah and Abraham,
And set in their line prophets' cam
And revelation. Some of them
Were in right guidance. But some more
Of them became rebellious store.

27 Then after them We followed up
 With messengers of loving cup,
 We sent after them Jesus who
 Was son of Mary, and for true
 Bestowed on him the Gospel due.
 We ordained in the hearts of those
 Who followed him compassion's rows
 And mercy. But the cloistered close
 They invented for their own pose.
 We did not prescribe such for them.
 Only the seeking of God's will
 Of His good pleasure so to fill,
 But that they did not offer still.
 Yet We bestowed on those among
 Them who believed their reward sung,
 But many of them are among
 Rebellious transgressors in rung.
 28 O you who believe, fear God and
 Believe in His messenger's hand,
 And He will bestow on you twice
 In portion of His mercy's slice.
 He will provide for you a light
 By which you shall walk in the night,
 And He'll forgive you, for God is
 One oft-forgiving, mercy's whiz.
 29 That the folk of the book may know
 That they've no power at all to show
 Over the grace of God below,
 That His grace is *all* in His hand,
 To grant to those He will on land.
 For Allah is the Lord of grace
 Abounding *here in every place*.

The People of the Book may know that
 grace
 Is theirs or no, for every Christian race
 Is wholly in Your hands, Beloved. No man
 Can have monopoly on faith nor can
 A woman for that matter. Yet I'm told
 The Prophet's hearers at first were so bold
 To find a refuge in the Christian State
 Of Negus, where as legends still relate
 The persecutors all were foiled because
 It turned out then that noble Christian's
 laws
 Were none but those taught to the desert's
 son.
 In Negus' hand both power and grace were
 one.
 Unbroken line from Solomon, that power

Was turned to grace, Beloved, within the
 hour.

Surah 58 Al-Mujadila, or the Pleading On

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 God has heard the word of the wench
 Who pleads with you about the stench
 Of her man and carries complaint
 To God, and God hears every quaint
 Argument between both sides sent
 Among you. God hears and sees bent.
 2 If any men among you will
 Divorce their wives by Zihar bill,
 They cannot be mothers to fill.
 None can be their mothers but those
 Who gave them birth. They in fact chose
 Words both iniquitous, untrue.
 But Allah's the one who in view
 Blots out, forgives once then anew.
 3 But those who divorce their wives too
 By Zihar, then wish to go back
 On the words they uttered in lack,
 Then he should free a slave before
 They touch each other as before.
 So you're admonished to perform.
 And God knows well your acts *and storm*.
 4 If anyone does not have that,
 He should fast for two months out flat
 Before they touch each other then.
 But if he cannot, he should feed
 Sixty poor people in their need,
 So you may show faith in your God
 And in His messenger as prod.
 For those who reject Him they'll be
 A very grievous penalty.

The laws of divorce multiply it seems
 Since Moses had to quash unseemly
 dreams.
 And Jesus came to say such laws were
 made
 For those hard-hearted ones that go unpaid.
 But from the start the law for those whose
 hearts
 Are soft and fleshly, not of stony parts,
 The law was that one man should meet his
 mate,
 And the two in one flesh should so instate
 That no divorce should mar their happy
 rate,

Nor any plural marriage be their fate.
Beloved, bring Your folk back to the first
way,
The law of Adam and the glowing ray
Of star unsullied and the Sabbath day
Together in reciting Torah's sway.

5 Those who resist God and His sent
One will be humbled to dust's vent,
As were those before them in kind.
For We have sent down the clear signed.
And unbelievers will receive
Humiliation then to grieve.

6 The day that God raises them up
And shows them the truth *in a cup*
And what was their action *like tup*.
God has reckoned it, though they may
Have forgotten it in their sway,
For God is witness be what may.

7 Do you not see that God does know
What's in the skies, on earth to show?
There is no secret between three,
But He makes the fourth in degree,
Nor between five but He again
Appears the sixth among those men,
Nor between fewer nor the more,
But He's among them to restore.
At last He'll tell them the truth of
Their doings on the day of shove.
For God has full knowledge of all
Things *that occur upon the ball*.

When Jesus set the minyan two or three,
He did so for the danger that we see
In Roman and in Jewish company
That ruled Jerusalem above the church.
In times of the Qur'an those in the lurch
Can be a bit more free when on the perch
Of sema' in degree and so the number
Of gathered can be doubled in the slumber
Of modern rulers, who are slack to take
So small a party as rebellion's stake.
Beloved, the minyan gathered in my house
Is four, not more, unless a dog or grouse
Increase the number and the unseen
presence
Of the divine join with the other peasants.

8 Do you not look at those who got
Prohibited from secret plot,
Yet went back to forbidden lot?

And they hold secret councils still
Among themselves with wicked ill
Will and a disobeying mind
Toward the messenger to find.
And when they come to you, they greet,
Not as God does, but mangled meet,
And they say to themselves, "God's not
Here to punish for mere words sought?
Suffice it for them in hell's lot.
In it they'll burn, an evil caught.
9 O you believers, when you hold
A secret council, be not bold
To do so for iniquity
And for ill will's hostility,
And disobedience unto
The prophet. But do it on cue
For righteousness and self-restraint.
And fear God as should every saint,
To whom you'll be brought back in view.
10 Secret counsels are just brought in
By the evil one and for sin
And grief to the believers' bin.
But he cannot harm them at all,
Unless God permits in the stall,
And in God let believers trust.

The truth is Your church has in secret met
Since the day of the resurrection set
When behind closed doors for fear of the
Jews,
And later fear of Romans in their crews,
And after that fear of the Muslim caliphs
That would send out to find them with their
bailiffs.
That's why You warn of secret meetings
where
The evil lurks and plots arise to spare.
Let me lurk in the secret of Your heart
And keep my hand from every plotting part
Of human politics, Beloved, and find
The heavenly kingdom and not earth
resigned.
Let me meet with the few at home or pub
Pretending just a birthday or a hub.

11 O you believers, when you must
Make room in the assemblies, then
Make room. Room will God give you then.
And when you are told to rise up,
Rise up and God will raise the cup
To ranks, for those of you who still

Believe and have knowledge to fill.
 God knows what you do of His will.
 12 O you who believe, when you ask
 The messenger in private task,
 Spend something then in alms before
 You come in consultation's floor.
 That will be best for you, and most
 Conducive to purity's host.
 But if you don't have that to give,
 God's merciful and will forgive.
 13 Are you afraid to give in alms
 Before your private meeting's qualms?
 If so, then do not, God forgives.
 Then set daily prayer, as one lives
 Practice alms regularly and
 Obey God and His sent one's hand.
 God knows what you do by command.

If need be, You allow the wider meeting,
 With moneyed handling and no alms
 defeating.
 The private meeting still remains in store
 The way to keep the faith without the gore.
 But even if no private meeting rises,
 The lonely dervish has still some surprises,
 And may meet in the daily prayer and still
 Give secretly his alms to make the fill
 And obey God and His sent one as long
 As voice is able to lift in a song.
 Beloved, in roomy gatherings, or caught
 In private meeting of a handful sought,
 Or as a single dervish whom You've taught,
 I turn to You for ever from the wrong.

14 Do you regard those who take friends
 Among such as have on their ends
 The wrath of God? They're not of you
 And not of them, they're a false crew
 To swear so knowing what they do.
 15 God has prepared for them such pain
 For evil deeds they did in vain.
 16 They've made oaths a veil, so keep men
 From the right path of God again.
 That's why they shall have shameful pain.
 17 Of no benefit to them will
 Be their wealth and sons at the bill
 Of God. They'll be fellows of fire,
 Abiding there *and in God's ire*.
 18 One day God will raise them all up,
 Then they will swear to Him like tup
 As they swear to you. And they think

That they have something on the brink.
 No, they're just liars *in their rink*.
 19 The evil one has got control,
 So he's made them lose the good bowl
 Of the remembrance of God's toll.
 They're of the party of the foe.
 It's the foe's party that will go.
 20 Those who resist God and His sent,
 Will be among the shameful bent.
 21 God has decreed: "I and My sent
 Ones must prevail." For God is One
 Full of might, what He wills is done.
 22 You'll not find any folk who stay
 Believing in God and last day,
 Who love those who resist Allah
 And His messenger kept in awe,
 Though they were their fathers or sons,
 Or brothers or their kindred ones.
 For such He's written faith in heart,
 And strengthened them to do their part
 With a spirit from His own art.
 He will let them come in at last
 To gardens underneath which cast
 Streams flowing, to live there and last.
 God will be pleased with them, and they
 With Him. They are God's party's way.
 The party of God will indeed
 Achieve a happy end decreed.

The service of remembrance You have kept
 For those in store who joyed in You and
 wept.
 So You describe that faith that does not
 part
 From You no matter what the others start.
 That faith is based on the fact that You are
 One and One of a mighty shining star,
 Your sovereignty guides thought and word
 and deed,
 Defines theology, defines the creed,
 Defines the worship and the life until
 You bring all faces back to Your face still.
 That is the happy end that I avow
 Is coming on me and my broken brow,
 When the one dervish joins the universe
 In praise to You alone and to rehearse.

Surah 59 Al-Hashr, or The Gathering (or Banishment)

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 Whatever is in heavens and earth,

Let it declare the praises' worth
 And glory of Allah: For He's
 The exalted in Might, the Wise.
 2 He took the unbelievers out
 Among the book's people and stout
 From their homes at first gathering.
 You didn't think they would get out.
 They thought their fortresses would sting
 To keep them from God's battering.
 But God attacked from the wrong wing,
 Which they least expected to bring,
 And so cast terror in their hearts,
 So they destroyed their houses parts
 By their own hands and hands of those
 Who did believe. Take warning shows,
 Then, you who see with eyes what rose.
 3 Had it not been that God decreed
 Banishment for them in their greed,
 He would have punished them here too
 In this world. In hereafter's view
 They'll have fire's punishment on cue.
 4 That is because they resist God
 And His messenger on the sod,
 And if any one resists God,
 God is severe to pain with prod.

It seems, Beloved, I have no place at all,
 Neither in heaven nor earth, I hear Your
 call,
 But have no time nor room to join the
 praise.
 If I were in the heavens I know I'd raise
 A shout of glory to Your name, I'd sing
 The songs of angels with empurpled wing.
 If I were on the earth my voice would rise
 In Psalms of thanks up to the tuneful skies.
 But I've no place, nor time nor room to be
 A faithful witness of Your majesty.
 Within my inner chamber hidden, bare,
 I whisper here alone my humble prayer.
 And You, exalted One, in praises traced,
 Hear also silent words of one abased.

5 Whether you cut down tender palm,
 Or you leave stand roots with qualm,
 It was by leave of God, and so
 He might cover with shame the glow
 Of transgressors' rebellious show.
 6 What Allah had there to bestow
 On His messenger from them, so
 For this you made no expedition

With cavalry, camels' division,
 But God gives power to His sent ones
 Over what He pleases and stuns.
 God has power over all things tonnes.
 7 What God's bestowed on His sent ones
 From the folk of towns in their runs,
 Belongs to God, His Messenger
 And to the kin and orphans sure,
 The needy and wayfarer too.
 So it may not make circuit do
 Among the wealthy among you.
 So take what messenger gives you,
 Deny yourselves what he withholds.
 And fear God. God's punishment's molds
 Are strict and harsh *to come in view*.
 8 To the poor Muhajirs, those who
 Were thrown out from their homes in crew
 Along with their belongings too,
 While seeking grace for God and cue
 Of His good pleasure, aiding God
 And His messenger on the sod.
 Such are the sincere ones in pod.

The cutting down of palms is a great crime,
 No matter whether done in prose or rhyme,
 No matter whether on the land of those
 Who are the Sunnites or those in the throes
 Of Ali's party, the wicked who chose
 To bulldoze down the palms are wicked
 woes.

You are the source of goodness in men's
 hearts
 To leave the palms in bloom for dates in
 carts.

You are the one who allows men to break
 Down the date palms for their own sinful
 sake.

Beloved, I live beside the frozen lake
 And see no palms about me, but the birch
 With fruit too tiny for my hungry search
 And aspens shaking down no nut in lurch.

9 But those who before them had place
 And had adopted the faith's grace,
 Show their affection to such who
 Came to them for refuge from rue,
 And have no desire in their hearts
 For things given to them for their parts,
 But give them preference to themselves,
 Though poverty was on their shelves.
 And those saved from the covetous

Of their own hearts, they are the ones
 Who achieve prosperity's tonnes.
 10 And those who came after them say,
 "Our Lord, forgive us in the way,
 And our brothers who came before
 Us in the faith, and do not store
 In our hearts injury to those
 Who have believed. Our Lord, You chose
 Kindness and mercy in Your rows."

The early Muslims already knew ways
 To distinguish themselves in various praise.
 Islam added to tribal law the fate
 Of who came to the faith and who came
 late.

Sectarian in human life is here
 To stay until the judgement day appear,
 Or the Mahdi and Jesus without fear
 Go out upon a world with justice gear.
 Beloved, forgive me to as I tread the way
 That's straightened in the burning light of
 day,
 And welcome or not brothers who arrive
 With or without the injury to strive.
 Let all who do believe in You or not
 Come at last to stand ready in their lot.

11 Have you not seen the hypocrites
 Say to the misbelieving kits
 Among the people of the book?
 "If you are expelled, we will look
 To go out with you, and we'll not
 Listen to anyone who sought
 To darken your affair as taught.
 If you're attacked we'll help you out."
 But God is witness without doubt
 They are just liars *when they shout*.

12 If they're expelled, they will not go
 Out with them. And if they lie low
 Beneath attack, they'll not help them.
 And if they do help stratagem,
 They will turn their backs, so they'll not
 Get any of the help they sought.

13 Indeed you're stronger because of
 The terror in their hearts to shove
 From God. This is because they are
 Men without understanding's star.
 14 They will not fight you all of them,
 Except behind fortified hem,
 Or from behind walls. Strong is their
 Mind to quarrel among their share.

You would think them united, but
 Their hearts are divided and shut.
 That because they are a folk who
 Are devoid of wisdom in crew.
 15 Like those who came before them, they
 Have tasted the evil in sway
 Result of their actions at bay.
 For them's a penalty to pay.
 16 Like the evil one when he speaks
 To humankind, "Deny God, tweaks."
 But when he denies God he creeks,
 "I'm not responsible for you,
 I fear God Lord of the worlds too!"
 17 The end of both will be that they
 Will go into the fiery way,
 And their they will abide and stay.
 Such is the wrongdoer's last pay.

Those who pretend to faith, those who're
 well set
 In a faith of establishment or met
 In the imperial faith now or then,
 Are of the most untrustworthy of men.
 They'll make a pact and promise on a day
 To get co-operation or else pay,
 But when the wind turns round the other
 way,
 They're off in search better benefits.
 There is no way to trust men of such kits.
 Beloved, I've trusted church and mosque in
 bloom
 And always found they led me into doom.
 Only Your open heart of love is true
 And always there to hide me from their
 view
 Until the time of trial has past from gloom.

18 O you believers, fear God and
 Let every soul look to the band
 He has sent out providing for
 The morrow and in a good store.
 Fear God, for God knows well and true
 About everything that you do.
 19 And do not be like those who do
 Forget God. He made them for rue
 Forget their own souls. Such on cue
 Are the rebellious sinful crew.
 20 Not of the same value are those
 Companions of the fire they chose
 And the companions of the rows
 Of gardens, its the garden guys

Who will get gladness from the skies.

21 If We'd sent down this Qur'an on
A mountain, you'd have seen it drawn
To humble itself and split down
The middle for fear of the frown
Of God. Such are the likenesses
We propose to men for their biz.

22 God is He, above whom there's no
Other god, who know both the show
Of secret and the open glow.

He is most gracious and not slow
To mercy, *if you want to know.*

23 God is He, there's no other god,
The Sovereign, Holy One in prod,
The source of peace, of faith the guard,
Preserver of safety in ward,
The high in power, and the supreme,
The irresistible to seem:

Glory to God above those whom
They join with Him *and to their doom.*

24 He is God, the Creator and
Evolver to bestow command

Of form and colours on the land.
To Him belong the best of names,
Whatever's in the heavenly claims
And on the earth, all things declare
His praises and His glory's share.
He is high in His might, the wise,
He is high in His might, the wise.

I sit beside a mountain, if You will,
A mountain I may call it if a rill
Is called a river before it could fill
The sea with salt or gladden any hill.
I sit beside a mountain then and wait
To see it split before me in its fate
As I recite again the Qur'an's rate,
Not for the first time in its low estate.
So far it has not split, but that may be
Simply a time of waiting for the free
To gather for the sight. Beloved, decree
The splitting or the not, still I shall see
The heavenly blessings falling on the lee,
The cantillation of the robin's mate.

Surah 60 Mumtahana, or the Woman to be Examined

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 You who have faith, do not take my
Foe and your enemy to vie
As friends, giving to them affection,

Since they have denied the reflection
Of truth that has come down to you,
Driving out the Apostle too
As well as yourselves, because you
Believe in Allah, your Lord *true.*

If you have set out for the strife
In My way and seek *for your life*
My pleasure, *then do not take them*
As friends by showing your love's gem
In secret, while I know best all
That you conceal and what you scrawl,
And who among you works such wrath
Indeed has strayed off the right path.

2 If they find an excuse to go
Against you, they will be your foe,
And stretch their hands against you while
Their tongues give way to evil *smile.*

3 Your kin and children will not stay
To help you Resurrection Day.

He'll make distinctions for you then,
Allah sees all you do *as men.*

I have responsibilities I own
To kin and children here before the throne
Of earth and on the way that I must go,
The house and shop for eating here below.
But on a day that's coming I shall stand
Without a helper from another land
Before Your judgement seat and know that
You

Command and take account from me in
pew.

Beloved, upon that day, let me forget
All other tasks that I on earth have met
And know alone the cantillation fair
Of Your names glorified upon the air.
Beloved, upon that day, let me return
To You without a thing still left to earn.

4 A good example for you's found
In Abraham and those around
Him, when they said to their own folk,
"Surely we reject at a stroke
Both you and what you worship yet
Besides Allah *alone well met.*

We renounce you, and there has sprung
Between you and us hateful rung
And enmity forever strung,
Till you believe in God alone,"
Except what Abraham said to
His father, "I will plead for you

Forgiveness, though I cannot do
 Before Allah a thing for you.
 Our Lord, on You we do rely,
Repenting turn to You *our eye*,
 To You we return *when we die*.
 5 "Our Lord! Do not make us a trial
 For those who disbelieve in guile
 And forgive us, our Lord. For You
 Are mighty, wise *in what You do*."
 6 There's surely an example fine
 For you in them, who will incline
 To look to Allah and the last
 Day, and anyone who is fast
 To turn away, then Allah true
 Is sufficient, all praise is due.
 7 Perhaps Allah will bring about
 Friendship between you and the stout
 You find at enmity with you,
 Allah's Almighty, it is true,
 Forgiving, merciful to sue.

I too pray like good Abraham that I
 Shall not be a test for those by and by
 Who do not have faith in You on the sly.
 But I doubt that You will give me reply.
 When I stand for the truth, I see not many
 Who rally to the flag to give a penny.
 Instead I see the hearts go harder still
 When they are irritated by my bill.
 Beloved, I have been sent into the world,
 Not as a prophet leading an unfurled
 Flag of truth and of justice, but to be
 The one by which You harden hearts'
 degree.
 Whether You someday have mercy on me
 Or not, I stand here blessed, I stand
 uncurled.

8 Allah does not forbid you from
 Those who made no war in your sum
 Because of your religion and
 Did not drive you from home *and land*,
 But that you deal with them both kind
 And just. Allah loves the just *mind*.
 9 Allah forbids you only those
 Who made war on you *as your foes*
 Because of your religion and
 Drove you from your homes *and your land*,
 And supported your driving out,
 Not to make friends with such about,

And who makes friends with them are
 those
 Who are wrongdoers *when they chose*.

This is the era of driving from homes,
 Rather than of building of vaster domes,
 And refugees from everywhere attend
 The cleaning of the streets and so unbend
 The railways and the airports where they
 send
 More travellers on their way to oppress
 rights
 Of those who cannot get abroad their
 flights.
 The world spews out its refugees from
 flood
 And tidal wave, volcano, and the blood
 Shed by the greedy who rise from the mud
 To rule the nation and stock-markets rood.
 Beloved, let me not make friends with
 these men,
 Nor with the women that love them again,
 But keep me in my humble mountain pen.

10 O you who believe, when there come
 To you believing women from
 The cast-out ones, examine them,
 Do not sent them back to the hem
 Of disbelievers, these women
 Are not lawful for faithless men,
 Nor are those lawful to take them,
 And give them what they've spent for
 them.

You have no sin to marry them
 When you've given dowries to them.
 Do not continue marriage ties
 With faithless women *who despise*.
 Ask infidels for what you've spent,
 And let the faithless take their rent.
 This is Allah's decree and He
 Makes the judgement upon your fee.
 Allah's knowing and wise is He.
 11 And if any of your wives go
 Back to the disbelievers' show,
 And after that you have your turn
Over the infidels you spurn
 Then give to those whose wives have left
 The like of which they were bereft,
 And fear Allah for faith *to learn*.
 12 O Prophet! When there come to you
 Believing women pledging true

Not to ascribe to Allah others,
 And not to steal aught from their brothers,
 Nor commit adultery, nor kill
 Their children, nor with slander fill
 Their mouths with fabrications yet
 Nor disobey the right when met,
 Then accept of them such a pledge,
 And ask forgiveness for their hedge
 From Allah, truly Allah's now
 Forgiving, merciful *somehow*.
 13 O you who believe, do not make
 Friends with a people for whose sake
 Allah is wrathful. Of the time
 To come they're in despair of mime,
 As disbelievers in their raves
 Despair of those buried in graves.

O my Beloved, when You quote from the
 word,
 The sacred Decalogue, my soul is stirred.
 You mention sin of joining to the One
 And only God, you note when that is done
 That stealing's wrong, adultery, and true
 It is that killing children will not do.
 Falsehood and slander must not pass the
 lip.
 Do You mean then the other things can
 slip?
 Is coveting all right, and Sabbath breaking,
 Dishonour to Your name, and my awaking
 To curse my parents, are these things
 allowed?
 If so, that is good news to every crowd.
 Perhaps You meant some things are best
 rewarded
 That from the loving heart remain recorded.

Surah 61 As-Saff, or Battle Array.

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 Whatever's in the sky and earth,
 Let it declare the praise and worth
 Of Allah's glory, for He stands
 The high in power, wise *in commands*.
 2 O you believers, why do you
 Say what you do not do in view?
 3 Most hateful to God's what you say
 And fail to do along the way.
 4 God loves those who fight in His way
 In ranks as if a wall to stay
 Of metal armour not to lay.
 5 When Moses said to his folk, "O

My people, why do you pain so?
 You know that I'm a messenger
 Of God to you." But they were sure
 To go astray, as God allowed.
 God does not guide people unbowed.
 6 And when Jesus, son of Mary
 Said "O children of Israel, see.
 I am a messenger of God
 To you, confirming on the sod
 What is before you of Torah
 And bearing the glad news in awe
 Of an apostle who shall come
 After me, his name shall in sum
 Be Ahmed." And when he had come
 To them they said "This is indeed
 Apparent sorcery for greed."
 7 And who is more unjust than he
 Who invents a lie in degree
 Against God at the invitation
 To submit? And God has no ration
 To guide unjust people *for free*.
 8 Their thought's to extinguish God's light
 With the breath of their mouths for spite.
 But Allah will complete His light,
 No matter how the wicked fight.

When evening comes, I blow the candle
 out.
 So doing I join millions more, no doubt.
 We think that light goes out by blowing
 hard,
 And so we think, in all the films we've
 starred,
 That blowing words out in the wind
 suffices
 To put out Your lights too, and lower
 prices.
 The light of revelation is God-sent,
 And glistens on when candles are all spent.
 It's more like moon and stars and sun than
 lamp.
 It does not sputter when the weather's
 damp.
 For all men say, and women, too, I guess,
 Your light is burning still, not burning less.
 Within the stony chambers of my heart
 Let Your word shine, a burning lamp apart.
 9 It's He who's sent His messenger
 With guidance and the faith of Truth,
 So He may make it conquer youth

And age, above all faiths aver,
 Despite what polytheists stir.
 10 O you believers, shall I show
 You merchandise that can bestow
 On you salvation from the slow
 And painful punishment below?
 11 You should believe in God and His
 Apostle, and strive with a whiz
 In the way of God with your wealth
 And with yourselves and without stealth,
 That's better for you, if you knew.
 12 He will forgive you your sins too
 And let you into gardens' view,
 Beneath which flow streams, excellent
 Abodes in gardens ever meant,
 That is the greatest achievement.
 13 And one more thing that you will love
 And that's the help from God above,
 And victory at hand. So give
 The good news where believers live.
 14 O you believers, try to be
 Helpers of God, as Jesus wee
 Who was the son of sweet Mary,
 Said to his own disciples free:
 "Who will be my helpers for God"
 Said the disciples: "We're the prod
 To be the helpful ones for God."
 So then some of Israel's sons too
 Believed, while others in their pew
 Did not believe. So We were true
 To help believers against foes,
 And they overcame all of those.

The wealth and merchandise You offer
 now,
 Beloved, is such a thing here anyhow
 That few of humankind believe will make
 A man a better creature for Your sake.
 It's gold and precious stones and metals
 here,
 And stocks and bonds and issues that
 appear,
 That still contrive to turn the eyes away
 Of greater merchandise You have in sway.
 The great wealth of Your sovereign grace is
 true:
 It is the faith a man may have in You
 And following Your sent prophet in view.
 Beloved, give me that money-market quick
 And I shall rise a wealthy man and slick

To praise Your name with Tom, Harry, and
 Dick.

Surah 62 Al-Jumu'ah, or The Congregation

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 The glory of God makes holy
 What's in the sky and on earth free,
 The king most holy, unfailing,
 The all-wise over everything.
 2 It's He who raised among the men
 Non-readers messenger again,
 Reciting to them His signs and
 So cleansing them, and by design
 Of teaching them the book and so
 Wisdom although in times ago
 They were in straying manifest,
 3 And to the others among them
 Who've not yet joined with them in hem,
 And He's unfailing, wise and best.
 4 That is the grace of God, He gives
 It to the one He will, and lives
 The Lord of greater grace to test.

The greater grace that You give men in test
 Is of the preparation day to rest.
 The Sabbath You gave to both man and
 beast
 To bless the child, the employed, and the
 least.
 The Friday gathering You gave to men
 To feast in double blessing left again
 By manna falling still in the heart's share
 To bless the population everywhere.
 Beloved, the Sabbath day remains to guide
 The weary one always back to Your side,
 While the day when You blessed the new-
 made man
 Remains to bless again by divine plan.
 Beloved, as weeks go round in nature's path
 I turn to You from sun and moon and
 wrath.

5 The likeness of those who were set
 Under the Torah, but did yet
 Not follow it is like an ass
 That carries books and fails to pass.
 Wretched's the likeness of the folk
 Who still deny God's signs in yoke,
 And God does not come down to guide
 An unjust folk to His own side.

6 Say "O you who claim to be Jews,
 If you claim you're ones God must choose,
 Excluding other folk, then call
 Down death on yourselves for the pall
 In test of truthfulness in all."
 7 But they will never make that wish
 For what they've sent before in dish,
 And God well knows the unjust swish.
 8 Say "The death from which you now flee,
 It meets you, then you'll surely be
 Returned to Him who knows unseen
 And the seen, then He'll show it clean
 What you used to do on the scene."
 9 O you believers, when the call
 Is made for prayer on Friday's wall,
 Then hasten to God's remembrance
 And leave off trading and its prance,
 That's better for you at a glance.
 10 And when the prayer is ended then
 Disperse in the earth, and again
 Seek out the grace of God and so
 Remember God much, so the glow
 Of your success on you may go.
 11 And when they see the merchandise
 Or sport, they break away in guise
 To it and leave you standing there.
 Say "What is with God is more fair
 Than sport and merchandise, and God
 Is best sustainer on the sod."

The preparation day calls man to prayer,
 And after that the seeking everywhere
 Of Your grace and Remembrance of the
 fair,

But sport and merchandise distract the folk
 Away from Sabbath's glories that awoke,
 And so they join the donkeys at a stroke
 Who carry Judaism like a bloke.
 Beloved, give me the hearing of Your
 Word

Recited on the Sabbath, while the herd
 Runs after tinsel and flies like a bird
 Away from the feast that You rather stirred.
 The edifice of one keeps to the form
 While others flee the fire to keep them
 warm.
 I whirl alone beneath a stronger oak.

Surah 63 Munafiqun, or the Hypocrites.

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 When the hypocrites come to you,

They say, "We bear witness that you
 Are Allah's apostle indeed."
 Yea, Allah knows you are indeed
 His apostle, and Allah bears
 Witness the hypocrites beware
 Are truly liars. 2 They have made
 Their oaths a screen *for their misdeeds*:
 Thus they obstruct *men who have strayed*
 From the path in which Allah *leads*:
 Truly evil are *all* their deeds.
 3 That is because they believed, then
 They rejected the faith *for men*:
 So a seal was set on their hearts:
 Therefore they don't understand this.
 4 When you see them, you look in bliss
 At their bodies, and if they speak,
 You listen to their speech as sleek.
 They're like dolls made of wood and set
 Up in clothes, thinking each cry met
 Is against them. They are your foes,
 So be careful and on your toes.
 May God annihilate them since
 They deviate without a wince.

It's deviation that I don't accept,
 Beloved, among the religious adept.
 The deviation from the Sabbath day,
 The deviation from Your oneness' way,
 The deviation from the Scriptures' stay,
 The deviation to belief that man
 And maybe women too by divine plan
 Have souls immortal without the body,
 All these and others provided with glee
 Are simply unacceptable to me.
 Beloved, save whom You will, but I am
 sure

My education, though it is not pure,
 Suffices to show me without a doubt
 That these are innovations coming out.

5 And when it's said to them, "Come now,
 God's messenger will seek somehow
 Forgiveness for you," they turn back
 Their heads, and you see them in stack
 Turning away in a pride's pack.
 6 It doesn't matter whether you
 Seek forgiveness of them in crew
 Or seek no forgiveness for them.
 God will never forgive their hem.
 God does not guide transgressing crew.
 7 They're the ones who say "Do not spend

Anything on those who would fend
 With the apostle of God till
 They break up. And God's are the fill
 Of treasures in the skies, on earth,
 But hypocrites care for no berth."
 8 They say "If we go to Madina,
 The honoured ones will drive the meaner
 Out, "but for God's all honour and
 For His apostle in the land
 Of the believers, but the ones
 Who are the hypocrites in tonnes
 Do not know anything in band.
 9 O you believers, don't let your
 Wealth nor your offspring, children's store
 Distract your from God's remembrance,
 And whoever may join that dance,
 They are the losers *in their trance*.
 10 Spend what We have provided you,
 Before death captures from your crew,
 And then he'll say "O my Lord true,
 Why don't You give respite in view
 Of a little time left to me,
 So I may give my alms in fee,
 And among good-doers shall be."
 11 And God will never give respite
 To any soul, when in his sight
 Has come the time fixed for his plight,
 And God is all aware of what
 You do *whether open or shut*.

I'm not a hypocrite myself I deem,
 I'm more mura'i as the Arabs' team
 Suggests for those who do their prayers and
 give

Their alms for all to see and not to live.
 Beloved, I do what things of good I do
 To keep it ever in Your blessed view,
 But hope not for reward at all from You,
 Since no one else considers it is true
 And worthy of distinction. Why should
 You?

No sonnet should include a rhyme that's
 bent

On the same word, but for You I have lent
 That single best distinction, so that one
 Of us too may be thanked when I have
 done.

No one can see the both of us and shun.

Surah 64 At-Taghabun, or The Mutual Deceit

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 The glory of God sanctifies
 Whatever is in heavenly skies
 And what hides in its earthly guise.
 His is the kingdom, and to Him
 Is due praise and He stands with vim
 Over all things all-powerful.
 2 It's He created you as full,
 Then some of you do disbelieve
 And some of you believe reprieve,
 And God sees all you do *in sleeve*.
 3 He has created skies and earth
 With truth and fashioned them in worth,
 And made good your forms and to Him
 Is the final return undim.
 4 He knows whatever's in the skies
 And in the earth and what man tries
 To hide He knows, and what you show.
 And God knows all that's in the *glow*
Of human breast, the come and go.
 5 Have you not heard the tale of those
 Come before in unfaithful rows,
 Then they tasted the evil shows
 Of their own doings, as it goes.
 For them painful chastisement flows.
 6 That because their apostles came
 With clear proofs evidence of same,
 But they said "What! Men without fame,
 Shall they guide us?" So they would not
 Believe and turned away in lot,
 And God needs nothing, and God stands
 Sufficient to Himself, in lands
 Most praised *by all created bands*.
 7 Those who do not believe think they
 Will not be raised alive. Now say
 "Indeed, by my Lord, surely they
 Will be raised, then you'll be informed
 Of what you did *when you had stormed*,
 And that's easy for God *that day*.
 8 Believe in God, His messenger,
 And in the light sent down in cure,
 And God knows well what you do sure.
 9 The day He'll gather you again
 For the day of His gathering men,
 That is the day of mutual loss.
 And whoever believes a toss
 In God and does good, He will wipe
 Out from him his sins and will pipe
 Him into gardens beneath which
 Flow rivers to stay in their pitch
 For ever, that's a great end's stitch.

The argument in the Qur'an is for
 The resurrection and the night before,
 Not for the soul immortal without body
 And claiming an existence to be shoddy.
 Time and again the Qur'an answers claim
 Against the resurrection, and the same
 For the surprise the resurrected feel
 To know that many years have passed in
 heel
 While they lay down unconscious of the
 steel.

That teaching might be thought as primitive
 In early Torah writings, but we live
 With the Qur'an after the Christian sieve
 Had already accepted Greekish thought.
 There's no excuse for following what's
 taught.

10 And those who disbelieved and came
 Denying Our signs, they're to blame,
 The fellows for the fire to claim,
 And there to stay in wretched aim.

11 There's no affliction come on me
 Except by leave of God freely,
 And whoever believes in God,
 He guides his heart right with His rod,
 And God well knows all things on sod.

12 Obey God and obey the one
 That He has sent, and if you run
 Away, then on Our messenger
 Is just the clear delivery sure.

13 God, there's no god but He. And on
 God should believers stay trust run.

14 O you believers, of your wives
 And of your children by your lives
 Some are your enemy in guise.

So watch out for them, if you rise
 Forgiving, overlook and shield,
 God's oft forgiving, come to yield
 In mercy *on the earth and field*.

15 Your wealth and spawn are just a test,
 And God is the one who is best.

16 So fear God as much as you can,
 And listen, obey, and spend span,
 It's better for yourselves, and yet
 Whoever's saved from greed will get
 To be successful where he's set.

17 If you lend God a goodly loan,
 He'll double it to you when grown,
 And He'll forgive you. God is most

Appreciating and the most
 Forbearing *of all those who boast*.
 18 He's knower of seen and unseen,
 The all-prevailing, all-wise keen.

There is no god but You, Beloved, and that
 Is the confession great, and true and pat.
 Samaritan may scoff and speak about
 The one who dies in middle of the shout
 To say there is no god, but I am stout
 To claim that the confession of all men
 Who know that You are one, is good again,
 And given by the grace eternal where
 Your sovereignty becomes mercy in share.
 Beloved, I stand upon my quartzite hill
 And look about the world with things to
 fill,

And know that You are one despite the
 toss,

The multitude, appliance and the cross.
 There is no other than You: earth is bare.

Surah 65 At-Talaq, or The Divorce

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 O prophet, when you will divorce
 Your wives, divorce them as perforce
 At the time prescribed, and so count
 The timing in the right amount,
 And fear God your Lord. Don't turn them
 Out of their houses nor in hem
 Shall they go out unless they do
 Indecency among the crew.

These are the limits set by God.
 Whoever goes beyond the prod
 Of God, he does himself the wrong.

You do not know if before long
 God will bring to pass some new song.

2 And when they reach the tried set term,
 Then either keep them and be firm
 With fairness or part from them by
 A show of kindness, testify

With two men justly and set right
 The witness before God in sight.
 That's the statute set to the one
 Who does believe in God when done
 And the last day. And the one who
 Fears God, He'll make for him no rue.

3 Whoever trusts in God will get
 Provisions unexpected set,
 Sufficient is He for that one.
 God carried out His purpose done.

God's set for each due measure's run.

The fact is that most people on this earth
Have not enough to eat because of death
Of mercy and abundance of the mirth
Of greed among the heads of state and
shop.

The rest of the rich live on their bee bop.
It's not so much their trust in God that
keeps

The bread upon the table. The one weeps
Who was born in the famine's place and
heaps.

If trust in You will guarantee the bread
And water sure upon the table spread,
Then I congratulate the faithful crowd.
Until I see it so, I say aloud
This verse goes unfulfilled and so avowed.
I hope You don't feel bad for what I said.

4 Those of your women who despair
Of menstruating in their share,
If you're not sure, then set the term
At three months and of those who earn
Nothing by then. The pregnant ones
Shall have their set term in their runs
Having delivered what they had.
Whoever fears God is not sad
To have him make his case not bad.
5 This is God's order that He sent
Down to you, and whoever's bent
On fearing God, He will wipe out
From him his sins and will be stout
To increase for him his reward
As prescribed *justly by his Lord*.

6 Let them live where you live as you
Have means, and do not give them rue
Or keep them poor, and if they are
Pregnant, spend on them insofar
As they lay down their burdened car.
And if they nurse for you, then give
Them their own recompense to live.
Deal justly with each other and
If you find difficulties stand,
Then let some other woman hand
To nurse them for him contraband.

Here is an advance over early law,
And it too comes because of the sharp claw
And hardened hearts of men and women
here:

It's that the husband and father for fear
Owes payment to the wife and mother for
Her nursing of the baby at the door.
Beloved, I was not nursed at all, I know,
According to the stories on the show.
It was then popular to bottle-feed
And that had become all but some new
creed.

And yet I answer to the call and hope
For comfort on Your breast in lieu of pope
Or priest or mullah or some other dope.
Let Your laws still provide security,
But love is enough for the likes of me.

7 The one who has a lot should spend
From his abundance and not lend,
And the one who is poor, let him
Spend what God has given him trim.
God does not lay an obligation
On anyone beyond his ration.
God will soon bring ease after grim.
8 How many a town has rebelled
Against the Lord's command and quelled,
And His apostles, so We called
It to account and one appalled,
And We chastised it with a great
And heavy punishment in fate.
9 So it felt the results in kind
Of evil doing, and the find
Of such was loss among the wined.
10 God has prepared for them severe
Chastisement, and so come to fear
God, O you ones who understand
And still believe upon the land!
God's sent down to you in your hand
A good reminder in command,
11 A messenger who still recites
To you the clear signs of God's rights
So he may bring out those who will
Believe and their good deeds fulfil,
Come from the darkness to the light,
And whoever believes God right
And does good deeds, He'll bring in sight
Into the gardens beneath which
Flow rivers to abide a stitch
Eternal there. So God's bestowed
On him sustenance and abode.
12 God's the One who created all
The seven heavens and the pall
Of earth, and what is like them still,
And sent down among them the fill,

So you may know God's over all
Almighty and surrounding wall
In the knowledge of all in call.

The human heart comes in to ask its own,
The things that focus and fail to atone,
Desire for the divorce, to keep alone
The wealth that ought to go before Your throne.

But answering, Your messengers abides
Within the wondered working Your Word
hides,

And shows that the depraved heart is the
source

Of questionings about such as divorce.
He makes that matter an excuse to show
That You are God alone before the glow
Of all created thing both high and low.
Beloved, turn me from separation from
My fellowmen no matter what I hum,
To know the loving oneness where You
come.

Surah 66 Tahrim, or Holding (something) to be Forbidden.

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 O prophet, why deny yourself
What God's allowed you on your shelf?
You want to please your wives at best,
And God's forgiving to invest
In mercy, *so give God a test.*

2 Indeed, God made lawful for you
The breaking of your oaths when true,
And God's your Lord, and He knows all,
He's wise and *He is on the ball.*

3 When the prophet told one wife what
Was a secret, and then her gut
Revealed it, and God let him know,
He showed a part and did not show
The rest. So on confronting her,
She asked, "Who tattled on my fur?"
He said "The one all-knowing and
All-aware made me understand."

4 If you both turn back to Him, then
Your hearts will be inclined again,
But if you both back up each other
Against him, the God like a brother
Will be his protector, and so
Gabriel and the better show
Among believers will help too,
And angels back him in his pew.

5 It may be that his Lord will give
Him better wives than you to live,
If he divorces you, such ones
As are submissive, faithful hunts,
Obedient, repentant and
Prayerful, observers of command
To fast, widows and virgins manned.

The prophet of Islam was always met
With wives beyond the ordinary set.
They needed the divorce hanging as threat
To keep them in line and to be a pet.
The prophet was unwise to once confide
In any wife he had there at his side
After Keturah left him at her death.
The other wives were all a waste of breath,
If what we read in history is true,
And even as the Qur'an tells the view.
Beloved, let prophet's warning be not cast
Out, but remembered from now to the last
That there's a way to meet the earthly blast
By keeping from too many women's mast.

6 O you believers, save yourselves
And your families from fire that delves
The bodies of both men and stones,
Over which stand angels both stern
And strong, they do not fail to earn
Obeying God in His command
And act as they are told in band.

7 O disbelievers, do not make
Excuses on this day in stake.
You'll get the recompense that's due
For all the things you used to do.

8 O you believers, do return
Repenting to God with a turn
Of penitence sincere to earn.
It may be your Lord will wipe out
From you your sins and without doubt
Let you into the gardens where
Beneath which flow rivers as fair
On the day God will not abase
The prophet and those with a face
Of faith with him. Their light will run
Before them and on right hand stun.
They'll say "O Our Lord, now perfect
For us our light, and so reflect
For us forgiveness. Truly You
Are over all things, strong to do."

9 O prophet, strive against the ones
Who disbelieve and against guns

Of hypocrites, and be hard too.
 Their dwelling is in hellish pew
 And ill their destination's view.
 10 God sets forth a likeness to those
 Who disbelieve, in wife that chose
 Noah, and wife of Lot: they were
 Both under two of Our good fer,
 But they both were unfaithful and
 They did not help them then to stand
 Against God, and it was told them,
 "Go both of you into the fire
 Along with those gone under ire."
 11 God sets for a likeness to those
 Who do believe in the wife close
 Of Pharaoh, when she spoke loud,
 "O my Lord, build for me a proud
 House in the garden and save me
 From Pharaoh and his bigotry,
 Save from unjust humanity."
 12 And Mary daughter of Iran,
 Who guarded her chastity, and
 We breathed in her body Our spirit,
 And she bore witness to truth *near it*
 Of the words of her Lord and of
 His revelations *sent in love*,
 Was one of the devout *to stand*.

Where else but in the house of Arum's king
 Could peace be found? There was no
 heathen sting
 Of trinities, and yet the adoration
 Of Mary there stirred bright with
 supplication.
 Since son of Solomon brought back the ark
 Of covenant to hide it in the dark
 Of sacred catacomb, the faith was there
 To recognize the golden case and share
 With it the awe of God's word in its heart,
 The Decalogue cut without human art.
 So within Mary's womb the Word of God
 Was hidden like the sweet pea in the pod.
 Ark, tables, Son and mother's chastity
 Still speak, Beloved, across a timeless sea.

Surah 67 Al-Mulk, or The Kingdom

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 Blessèd is He in whose hand remains
 The kingdom and over all gains
 He is Almighty, 2 Who in pains
 Created death and life so He
 Might try you all and so to see

Which of you is best in good deeds.
 He's all prevailing, and in needs
 He's oft forgiving, 3 who has made
 The seven heavens in parade
 Each above each. You do not see
 In the creation come to be
 By the Beneficent defect
 Or inappropriate reject.
 So look again. Do you select
 Any lack there not to connect?
 4 Turn your gaze round again, again,
 Till you are wearied by the pen.
 5 We have adorned the lower sky
 With lamps and We have set them by
 As missiles to repulse the sly
 Satans, and We've prepared for them
 The punishment of flaming hem.
 6 And for those who do not believe
 In their Lord is without reprieve
 The punishment of hell, and ill
 Is the chastisement to fulfil.
 7 When they're flung into it to fill,
 They'll hear its roaring as to kill,
 The boiling up and heat to grill.
 8 As if it would burst in its rage.
 When a group is cast in its page,
 Its keepers ask them, "Did there not
 Come to you a warner in plot?"
 9 They'll say "Yes, a warner indeed
 Came to us, but we did not heed
 And we said 'God has not sent down
 A thing, but you're delusion's frown.'"
 10 And they will say "If we had just
 Listened or pondered, we needs must
 Not have been in the flaming dust."
 11 So they'll confess their sins, but far
 From mercy shall they be in car
 Of their companions' blazing bar.
 12 Those who fear their Lord secretly,
 For them shall be forgiveness free
 And a reward, one great to see.
 13 Whether you do conceal your word
 Or else declare it to the herd,
 He knows what in each breast occurred.

The test You give to humankind is not
 An issue of salvation in its plot,
 But just experiment to see which one
 Is the best in good deeds that have been
 done.

As the Creator of all things, I think

That is expected on the raging brink
 Of universe. If I created aught,
 I should like to see how the things were
 taught.
 Beloved, test me not further than I bear
 Of strength to keep Your law as You give
 share,
 And in that testing let the fruit I make
 Be worthy of the trouble that You take
 In making me upon the earthly sand
 To live here slowly in a northern land.

14 What! Does He not know what He's
 made?

He is both subtil, knowing laid.

15 It's He that made for you the earth
 Subservient, and so its girth
 Traverse, and eat provisions there.

To Him return after your share.

16 What! Do you think that you are safe
 From Him who highest heavens strafe,
 So He'll not make the earth take you
 And swallow up? See it shall spew,

17 Or do you think you're safe as well
 From Him who in high heavens dwell,
 So He'll not send now upon you
 A storm of stones violent hue,
 Then you'll know what's my warning's
 view.

18 Indeed those before them also
 Denied, and how My wrath did glow.

19 Don't they see how the birds above
 Them stretch their wings and fold in love?
 None keeps them but Beneficent,
 For truly He sees where all went.

20 Or who can be a host for you
 To nourish and aid in your rue
 Besides the Beneficent true?
 The unbelievers here abide

In the delusion where they hide.

21 Or who is that who can provide
 You with the nourishment beside
 If He should keep back His share now?
 Yet they persist there anyhow
 In their disdain, aversion's plough.

You ask the question. We are here to try
 To provide food for the world in the wry.
 It's science agriculture to apply
 In hopes that famine will not still come by,
 At least on the elite who wonder why.

If You should keep Your nourishment back
 now,
 We'd just invent a better sort of plough.
 There is no gratitude in town to waste,
 We think it is not manly to the taste
 To worship in the church or synagogue
 Or in the mosque openly or in cog,
 Admitting our dependence still on You,
 Since we have scientific ways to view.
 And yet You keep on sending rain and dew.

22 What! Is the one who grovels long
 Upon his face, better than song
 Guided or he who walks upright
 Upon the straight path in his sight?

23 Say "He it is who brought you right
 And made you ears and eyes and hearts.
 Yet how small are your grateful parts!"

24 Say "He's the one who spread you out
 In the earth and to Him no doubt
 Shall you all be gathered from rout."

25 And they say "When shall this thing be,
 And come to pass appointment's fee,
 If you are speaking truthfully?"

26 Say "Knowledge of that is alone
 With God, I'm just warner of bone."

27 But when they see it coming near,
 Their faces shall be grieved with fear,
 Those who do not believe and steer,
 And it shall be said "This is what

You've been calling down on your gut."

28 Say "Do you see? If God destroyed
 Me and those with me here employed
 Or He bestows mercy on us,
 Yet who can guard the credulous
 From painful punishment and fuss?"

29 Say "He is the Beneficent!
 We do believe in Him and vent
 Reliance on Him only here.

So you'll come to know who it is
 In the wrong way as clear as whiz."

30 Say "Do you see? If your flood went
 Down, who could bring it up unspent
 As flowing water to unvent?"

My waters sink into the earth above,
 Upon the quartzite hill I walk and love,
 And spring up from my well in quiet flow
 Along the edge of garden row by row.
 The lilacs dream above that somber place,
 Hoping for a glance in reflection's trace

Of sky above the web their branches' lace,
Till summer lends a quick and flurried pace
Of tiny trumpet blossoms raining down
To where the wise depths of the waters
drown.

Beloved, If my flood did go down between
The crevices of stone and needle keen
Left by the pines and firs, I would have
seen

Your grace and mercy everywhere I lean.

Surah 68 Al-Qalam, or The Pen

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 Nun. By the pen and what they write,

2 You by the grace of your Lord's sight
Are not mad. 3 And truly there's for
You unending rewards store.

4 Most certainly you stand firm on
Sublime morality *outdrawn*.

5 So you will see and they will see

6 Which of you's in an insane *tree*.

7 Truly your Lord, He knows the best
Of him who is astray *from nest*
Of His way, and He knows best who
Is rightly guided of the crew.

8 So don't yield to those who deny.

9 They want you to be bending nigh
So they would bend also or try.

10 And don't yield to any one who
Come grossly swearing in his view,
11 Or to defamer who goes round
With slander *falling on the ground*.

12 Vehement hinderer of good,
The uncontrolled transgressing hood,
Sunk deep in sin as far as could,

13 Of violence and cruelty,
Besides that the bastard's degree,

14 Just because he has wealth in fee
And sons, 15 when to him are recited
Our signs, he says "Stories benighted
Of ancient times *and places blighted*."

16 So We will brand him on the snout.

The fair psychology the Qur'an shows
Is proof as any for the claims it knows.
The hearer takes exception to its rows
Of miracles, not for the truth that glows
Nor for an argument of yes or no's,
But simply because wealth and family
Suffice to make him too proud to agree.
In face, I guess that's not divine to see,

As anyone who's turned an argument
Of necessary rationality
Will recognize the twisting of event.
The human mind with kin and gold is bent.
Beloved, I'm stripped of everything You've
sent,
So tell me truth I pray in Your mercy.

17 We'll try them as We tried the ones
Who owned the garden on their buns,
When they vowed they would pluck the
fruit

At morning-tide *by leaf and shoot*,

18 Not thinking to except God's boot.

19 So the presence from your Lord came
Around it while they slept in game.

20 And it became like blackened soil.

21 And they cried to each other when
The morning light reached in their den,

22 Turn early to your fields if you
Would pick the fruits you have in view.

23 And went on whispering conclave
Each with the other, they were brave,

24 Saying "No poor man shall come in
Today upon you *and with sin*."

25 At dawn they went with firm resolve.

26 But when they saw what did devolve,
They said "We've strayed and did not win.

27 "No, we're deprived of labour's bin."

28 The more reasoned of the two said
"Did I not tell you to be led

To glorify *God only spread*?"

29 They said "Sanctified by our Lord.
We have been unjust, *by the sword*!"

30 Then some of them in contradiction
Reproached the others *for the fiction*.

31 They said "Oh woe to us, we've been
As arrogant as any seen!

32 Maybe our Lord with give replacement,
A better one for our effacement,
To our Lord we turn from the scene!"

The pattern of sin is a first agreement,
And then cooperation in the freement,
And when the whole house falls without
foundation,

The fighting and recrimination's station
At last comes down upon rebellious nation.
Beloved, the gardens that I make in mind
Are hardly ever tried in soil for kind,
But stay as pictures on horizon lined.

But if I ever plant my beans to grow,
Let me plant them in righteousness to show
The yield in grateful quantities to know.
Try me or not, my vows are not distorted
To pick the unripe or the unassorted.
You are the Judge both above and below.

33 Such has been then Our punishment,
And truly the pain that is meant
To come hereafter's greater still,
If they just knew to foot the bill!
34 For righteous with their Lord remain
Gardens of bliss *instead of pain*.
35 What! Shall We them make Muslims be
In the same boat with the guilty?
36 What is the matter with you? How
Do you turn judgement anyhow?
37 Or do you have a Scripture read?
38 Is what you choose found in it spread?
39 Or have you sworn a covenant
From Us for the day of judgement,
That you'll have what you wish unspent?
40 Ask them which of them guarantees.
41 Or have they partners there to please?
Let them bring out their partners then
If they are speaking truth again.
42 On the day the shin is laid bare,
And they be called to fall in share
Of prostration and bowing down,
But they'll be able just to frown,
43 Cast down their looks, cover the face
With their abasement without grace.
They had been called before to fall
Down in prostration's faithful thrall,
While they were still whole and in stall.
44 So leave Me and the one who yet
Denies this proclamation set,
We'll lead them on in steps from where
They do not know what is their share.
45 But give the respite now for My
Invention is sure and I'll ply.
46 Or do you ask a recompense
Since they're loaded with debt in cents?
47 Or with them is knowledge of what
Is unseen to write down in glut?
48 So wait in patience for the time
Of your Lord's judgement on their crime.
Do not be like the companion
Of the fish, when he cried undone
Where he was shut in like a bun.
49 If there had not a bounty come

From his Lord to him, he'd in sum
Have been cast up nude on the shore
In full disgrace forevermore.
50 Then his Lord chose him and made him
One of the righteous ones not dim.
51 And those who disbelieve almost
Might strike you with their eyes for toast
When they hear the reminder then,
And say "He's one mad among men."
52 And it is just reminder taught
Unto the worlds and in their lot.

How many times the dhikr comes to say
Your will before the coming judgement day
As the Qur'an's recited and aloud
Before the bowing and unbowing crowd!
How many times reminder comes my way
In the words of the living light and ray,
And I hear as a new thing and unknown,
A hypocrite among the Muslims grown!
As Sabbath Eve comes on, may I return
To hear Your voice to speak and me to
learn
Obedience and faith beneath the grace
Of sovereign will and Your divinity.
The throne may hide Your form and so
Your face
Is unseen while the syllables dance free.

Surah 69 Al-Haqqah, or The Inevitable

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
1 Reality! 2 And what is that
Reality? 3 And what out flat
Do you know of Reality?
4 Thamood and 'Ad denied freely
The striking of calamity,
5 As for Thamood, they were destroyed
By terrible thunder employed.
6 And as for 'Ad, they were destroyed
By roaring, rushing blast employed.
7 He made it rage against them then
For seven nights, eight days again,
Uprooting so that you might see
The people there prostratedly
As if they were the trunks that lie
Of hollow palms *beneath the sky*.
8 Do you see any of them still
Alive *and kicking on the hill*?

Unspeakable in desolation is
The hollow trunk of palm beneath the whiz

Of stinging sand without a roof in sight.
So civilizations that fail the right
Are desolate before destruction's night.
The desolation of the heart and mind
Comes on the town before the blast that
whined

Across the heated air and beaten lined.
Beloved, let me hear once the thunder
sound

That broke Thamood and laid them on the
ground,

Let me hear once the blast that at last woke
'Ad to reality and at a stroke,
Then take the warning in both heart and
hand

Before the desolating of the land.

9 And Pharaoh came and those before,
And cities overthrown in store
With wickedness, 10 they disobeyed
The messenger of their Lord staid,
So He seized them grasping waylaid.

11 We truly when the waters rose
Above the limits and the pose,
Bore you up in the floating ark,
12 To make it a reminder stark
That sharp ears might retain the mark.

13 And when the single blast is blown
By trumpet *sounding and it's shown*,
14 And earth and mountains shall be borne
Away and crushed greatly forlorn,
15 On that day then will come to pass
The great event, judgement's impasse.
16 The sky shall split apart en masse,
On that day frail, failing as glass.
17 The angels shall stand on its sides,
And above them that day it rides
The Arsh of your Lord, a throne borne
By eight angels, *and none to scorn*.
18 On that day you shall be exposed,
No secret hidden that you posed.

The splitting of the sky no doubt is still
More evidence that the Qur'an fulfil
Criteria of scientific thought
Posed in the twentieth century wrought.
No science earlier or later can
Fulfil the criterion held by plan.
The splitting of the sky no doubt remains
A remnant of the Middle Eastern pains
To see a flat earth covered with a dome,

Belief to hold despite all facts if Rome
Had only been the ruler of Islam
To keep the faithful faithful and in calm.
Beloved, let revelation take its place
As rightful without any human trace.

19 Then the one who receives the book
In his right hand will take a look
And say "See, read here in my book!
20 I thought I'd meet my count *in hook*."

21 So he'll be in a life of bliss,
And pleased, 22 in the high garden kissed,
23 Its fruits slung low and near at hand.
24 "Eat and drink for your health and band,
For what good you have sent before
In the days past is *kept in store*.

25 But the one who receives the book
In his left hand, will say, *the crook*,
"Oh that I never took a look!

26 "And never seen my own account.
27 "I wish I'd fall under the mount.

28 "My wealth avails me naught in count.
29 "My power has left me in amount."

30 "Grab him and chain him and throw him
31 Into the blazing fire and grim.
32 "Then with a chain of cubits' length
Chain him and kept him there with
strength."

33 He did not believe God is great.
34 And he did not urge the poor rate.
35 So there's no friend for him today,
36 And no food for him save the way
Thrown from the wash of wounds' decay.

37 Such none will eat but sinners stay.
38 So I swear by the thing you see,
39 And by what you do not see wee.
40 It's the word of the messenger
Most honoured *above every fer*.

41 And it is not a poet's word.
How small's your faith in what you heard!
42 It's not word of soothsayer, see
How little you reflect wisely!

43 It's sent down from Lord of the worlds.
44 And if he had invented things
Against Us in Qur'an's sayings,
45 Truly We would have grabbed him by
The right hand and to stop the lie.

46 We'd have sliced his aorta nigh.
47 None of you could have stopped Us then
From *punishing him among men*.
48 It's truly a reminder to

The pious ones *among the crew*.
 49 We know that some of you deny.
 50 Great griefs to disbelievers lie.
 51 It is the truth and very sure.
 52 Hallow by your Lord's great name pure.

I have soon learned the Qur'an is not made
 A poet's word and merely on parade.
 The terse styles verge on comprehensible,
 And I keep struggling to keep my hands
 full.

Let me not complain, my Beloved, but
 know
 I'm no translator here below on show.
 I am a contemplator in the glow
 Of truth and sweetness, fire and awful woe.
 The hymns that fall from my lips at the
 words
 I read in the Qur'an rush out in herds
 Of bleating hopes and fastened
 compromise,
 And wanderings among maze of the wise.
 Let me thus sanctify Your name below,
 And You remain above the fields I grow.

Surah 70 Al-Ma'arij, or The Ways of Ascent

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 Demanded, a demander, pain
 Inevitable and insane,
 2 For disbelievers against it
 There is no one repelling fit,
 3 From God the Lord of the ascent.
 4 To Him the angels to prevent
 The spirit in a day appointed
 Of fifty thousand years anointed,
 5 So stand in patience excellent.
 6 They think it is to be far off,
 7 And we see it near *where they scoff*.
 8 Oh, heaven's day's like molten brass,
 9 Mountains shall be like wool on grass.
 10 No friend shall enquire of his friend,
 11 Though they are standing end to end.
 The guilty one will hope to free
 Himself of pain's iniquity
 On that day at his own spawn's fee,
 12 And wife and brother, 13 and his kin
 Who gave him shelter, store and bin,
 14 And all on earth, if they could save,
 15 But no, there's only flaming *grave*,
 16 And dragging by the scalp *of slave*,

17 To claim the one who turned his back
 And went away as though in slack
 18 To gather and to store *and pack*,
 19 Man is created a pack rat,
 20 When ill fell, he'd fret *where he sat*,
 21 When he attains good, he'll contrive
 To hide it away in his hive,
 22 Except the ones who offer prayer,
 23 Those who are constant on prayer's
stair,
 24 And those in whose wealth rights
 declare,
 25 For the one who asks and the one
 Who dares not ask *for any bun*,
 26 And those who declare truth about
 The day of judgement *with a shout*.

Beloved, You take note in the sweet Qur'an
 Of the one who begs not but needs the
 stocks
 Of giver of alms. Invisible man
 As well as those who clamour claims Your
 locks.
 My heart rejoices more than any other
 When I here recognize a fateful brother.
 I too am one invisible on earth
 And rarely seen by passer-by of worth,
 And hold out no cup nor jingle a coin.
 And yet You come back to me to enjoin
 My sustenance. Beloved, I simply sit
 To hear the sema' of the Qur'an fit,
 Remembrance of the Psalms and gloried
 word
 Of Torah and of Gospel undeterred.

27 Those who fear their Lord's punishment
 28 Their Lord's pains are not surely sent.
 29 And those who guard their private parts,
 30 Except from their wives and the arts
 Of those whom their right hands possess,
 They shall have no blame to assess.
 31 But those who seek to go past this,
 These are transgressors *without bliss*.
 32 And those who honour promised pact,
 33 And those who in witnesses act,
 34 And those who in their prayers take
 care,
 35 Shall honoured be in gardens fair.
 36 But what has fallen on those who
 Have disbelieved all around you
 37 On the right hand and on the left

And standing in their groups *bereft*?
 38 What! Do they each and every one
 Strive to enter the garden won?
 39 No, for We've made them of the dun
 And what they know *under the sun*.
 40 But no, I swear by the easts' Lord,
 And by the wests, that We're not floored,
 41 But substitute better ones than
 They, and We're above every man.
 42 So leave them in their vain discourse,
 And in their vanity's divorce,
 Until they come to face the day
 What has been promised on their way.
 43 On that day they'll rush from their
 graves
 As though called quickly to conclaves.
 44 With eyes downcast and in disgrace,
 That's the day promised to their face.

The resurrection of the just from dust
 And of the wicked who rise up too must
 Be quick and sure, in haste and in a rush
 Like fountains pushed up from the rock in
 gush.
 The resurrection is not silent growth
 Like the sprout from the earth drawn by the
 oath
 And promise of the sun and rain as both
 Kiss soil in cold and heat, in patient lust.
 Beloved, I hear the call today before
 The trumpet sounds, while earth lies in its
 gore,
 And in complacent mess the gathered store
 Of wealth and health and stealth is shown
 the more:
 I hear the whispers and the shouts and find
 A star to guide the heart to come behind.

Surah 71 Nuh, or Noah

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 We sent down Noah to his folk
 And said "Will you not take the yoke
 To warn your people before pain
 Comes on them *for their actions vain*?"
 2 He said "O you my people, I
 Am openly warning you nigh
 3 "To worship God, fear Him, obey
 The word from Him I have to say,
 4 "He will forgive you of your sin
 And give you respite from the din
 For time appointed, Allah's time,

When it arrives, no man in crime
 Can hold it back, so know the rhyme."
 5 He said "O my Lord, truly I
 Called my people by night and by
 Day. 6 "But the more I called that way,
 The more they fled from the right way.
 7 "When I called them so that You might
 Forgive them, they put fingers right
 Into their ears, covered their heads
 With their hoods and kept in their spreads
 Puffed up with pride *to meet their plight*.

Beloved, I am no prophet, yet I know
 The feeling he expresses here in show.
 The many that I've called to You in band
 Have turned away the heart and face and
 hand.
 You have appointed prophets to the race,
 You have appointed divine guides to trace
 The way the preachers ought to tell and go,
 But You've appointed the mass to be slow
 To spend obeying You before hell's glow.
 Beloved, if I have called and not been
 heard
 By sundry and the lordly, wicked spurred,
 At least let me hear the call that I stirred
 And rush before Your throne to know Your
 grace,
 Appearing saved and wound before Your
 face.

8 "Then I called to them with a shout,
 9 "I spoke as openly about
 And whispered to them secret clout,
 10 "Then I said 'Seek forgiveness brought
 From your Lord. For your Lord when
 sought
 Is most forgiving of the lot.
 11 "He'll send on you the pouring rain
 In torrents for your actions vain,
 12 "And help you with your wealth and
 spawn
 And make you gardens, rivers drawn,
 13 "What's made you not then think upon
 The greatness of God *even and dawn*?
 14 "While He created you in time
 Of stages following in climb,
 15 "Don't you see how God has created
 The seven heaven's each one instated
 Above the other *and unsated*?
 16 "And made the moon in it a light

And the sun as a lamp in sight?
 17 "And God made you grow from the
 earth
 Like a plant growing up in worth,
 18 "Then He returned you to it and
 Again will bring you forth in hand
 In a new start upon the land.
 19 "God's made for you the earth stretch
 out
 20 "So you may walk wide ways no
 doubt."

21 Then Noah said "O my Lord, they
 Hear me but they do not obey,
 But follow the one whose wealth and
 Whose children don't avail in band.
 22 "And they've plotted greatly and
 planned.
 23 "And they say to each other now
 'Do not forsake your gods in prow,
 And don't forsake Wadd or Suwa,
 Nor Yaghus, Ya'uq and the awe
 Of Nasr!' 24 "And they've led astray
 Many, and there's no increase sway
 Except error of unjust way.
 25 "For their own sins then they were
 drowned,
 And made to enter fire renowned,
 And there was no helper there found
 But God." 26 And so Noah then said
 "O my Lord, don't leave on earth's bed
 A single one of unjust dread.
 27 "If you leave them, they'll lead astray
 Your servants, and will not beget
 But ungrateful, immoral set.
 28 "O my Lord, forgive me and my
 Parents and those who come thereby
 In my abode in faith, and those
 Men who believe, women who chose
 The right and don't increase unjust
 But in perdition cast in dust."

I've wondered why all preachers on the
 earth
 Are sorry ones and preachers of no worth,
 Who do not teach Your sovereignty and
 show
 The coming punishment upon the slow.
 But now as I look on the end, I know.
 As in the days of Noah, it should be,
 And when good Noah preached to two or
 three,

There was none who repented of the spree,
 Except the seven of his family.
 There may be one good preacher in the
 land
 Who shouts Your sovereignty and stays to
 stand,
 But if there is, as in Noah's day past,
 The crowds turn back, dead in their sins to
 last,
 And he remains alone and an outcast.

Surah 72 Al-Jinn

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 Say "It has been revealed to me
 A party of the jinn freely
 Have heard the preaching and have said
 'We've heard the recitation spread,
 2 "It guides to the right way, and so
 We do believe in it, and no
 One else will we join in the show
 With our Lord. 3 "And He is so high,
 Our Lord's majestic in the sky,
 And He's not taken wife or son,
 4 "And foolish ones among us here
 Would speak against God without fear
 Atrocious things, 5 "but we had thought
 Never man or the jinn should jot
 Such lies against Allah in plot,
 6 "And so some from among the folk
 Used to seek protection in yoke
 From among the jinn so they spoke
 To increase their rebellion's croak,
 7 "And that they thought as you too think,
 Never would Allah from the brink
 Raise anyone up from death's stink,
 8 "And that we sought the sky but found
 It filled with strong guards set around
 With flaming darts, 9 "And that we sat
 On some seats for a hearing pat,
 But any who tried to hear found
 A flaming dart wait on the ground,
 10 "And that we did not understand
 Whether ill was meant on the sand
 For those on earth, or whether their
 Lord wished to guide them to right share,
 11 "And that some of us are good and
 The others of us otherwise,
 We're parties of diversant guise,
 12 "And that we knew we'll not defeat
 God's will in the earth and His seat,
 And we cannot defeat Him by

Our fleeing however we try,
 13 "And that when we heard guidance read,
 We believed in all that was said,
 And whoever believes his Lord,
 He does not fear loss or the sword,
 14 "And that some of us have submitted
 And others deviate unfitted,
 And those who submit, these pursue
 The guidance that is right and true."

The points of the true faith are mentioned
 here

As they came to the jinn in heart and ear:
 Reciting Qur'an, sovereignty of God,
 The human resurrection from the sod,
 His oneness and not wife and son for rod,
 Without sects and no deviation's prod.
 The truth is always counted out in fives
 For the man or the jinn who stays and
 strives.

Beloved, let Your will as was once decreed
 From all eternity bear the good seed
 And harvest of the earth of men and jinn
 To fill both paradise and hellish bin
 To Your own glory, till all souls shall win
 The end that You with Your own heart
 agreed.

15 And as for deviating crew,
 They shall be for hellfire fuel too,
 16 And that if they'd be steadfast true
 On the right way, We'd give them well
 Of water in abundant spell,
 17 That we may test them by it, but
 Whoever turned away from rut
 Of the remembrance of his Lord,
 He'll make him fall beneath the sword
 Of harsh chastisement *at the board*.

The institutions of faith all oppose
 The service of remembrance of Your rows,
 And that is why the church and synagogue
 Join with the mosque to lead men in the fog
 To punishment and to eternal death,
 Instead of calling on Your names with
 breath

As long as life shall last. Beloved, I take
 Upon my lips Your names and for Your
 sake

Recite the Scriptures through and then
 repeat

Your lovely names to be for me a treat
 Beside the heaps of nourishment I eat,
 The salt and sour, the bitter and the sweet.
 Beloved, let my remembrance be of You
 As week by week a come into my pew.

18 And that the places for prostration
 Are for remembered consecration
 To God, so do not call upon
 Anyone with God *eve or dawn*.

19 And that when the servant of God
 Stands praying to Him on the sod,
 They came around him in a crush
 Nearly to stifle in the rush.

20 Say "I just pray to my Lord hear,
 And I join no one to His fear."

21 Say "I do not own for you aught
 Of any evil or good wrought."

22 Say "No one can protect me here
 Against God, and I'll find none near
 Besides Him refuge from all fear.

23 "Except the revelation come
 From God and His messages' sum,
 And whoever disobeys God
 And His apostle on the sod,
 For him shall be the fire of hell,
 Where they'll stay for eternal spell."

24 Until when they see what they've been
 Promised, and then they'll know the scene
 Of who is weaker to give aid
 And fewer numbers on parade.

25 Say "I don't know whether what you
 Are promised is near or in rue
 Whether my Lord has set a time
 In distance both of days and clime.

26 "He's knower of the unseen thing,
 Nor does he show his secrets' sting
 To anyone, *servant or king*,

27 "Except to that messenger He
 Chooses, for He brings a guard free
 To march before and after spree."

28 That He may know that they indeed
 Have declared the messages' creed
 Of their Lord, and He does surround
 All that is with them on the ground,
 And takes account of each thing found.

No man knows day nor hour, so says the
 book

Where Jesus Christ spoke to the ones who
 look

For times and seasons, wars and pestilence
That signal the end of the world's days'
sense.

The prophet himself cannot speak a word
Beyond the message that His Lord
incurred,

And so he does not know if near or far,
Or long or soon to come the morning star.
Beloved, I too look on a world of care,
And wonder when the recompense that's
fair

Shall fall upon the earth and stay with men:
And just meet be meted out once again.
Beloved, I wait to see the earth gone dry
Spring up again and green beneath the sky.

Surah 73 Al-Muzzammil, or Folded in Garments

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 O you folded in garments! 2 Stand
For prayer by night, but not all night,
3 Half of it, or some less *remand*,
4 Or a little more, and recite
The Qur'an in slow, measured tone.
5 Soon shall We send down *from the*
throne

To you a weighty message *right*.
6 Truly the rising by the night
Is the most potent for the rule,
And the most suitable for *school*
In the Word. 7 True, there is for you
By day prolonged work in your pew.
8 Remember the name of your Lord.
Devote yourself to Him adored
With all your heart's devotion stored.

O my Beloved, though church and
synagogue
And every mosque and the vain voice of
frog
Of the unchurched scoff at the way I go,
Let me keep my remembrance service so
That as I walk about the woods and town
My heart and tongue sing Your name of
renown.
On Sabbath Eve I come with Scriptured
tone
To cantillate Your name before Your
throne
And leave the mullah and the priest to sit
With their imaginations of the fit.

Beloved, I trembling take Your name as
mine
And sing the syllables and line on line
Until the dawn and star rise in my heart
And I'm struck with Your love in fatal dart.

9 The Lord of the east and the west,
There is no god but He *the best*,
Take Him then as protecting *vest*.
10 And be you patient against what
They say and avoid them as shut
In seemly closeting to rest.
11 Leave Me and the denying folk,
Possessors of bounties in stoke
For the small respite of their yoke.
12 We have strong fetters, flaming fire,
13 The food that chokes and painful ire.
14 On the day when the earth and hills
Shall be thrown down and mountain frills
Turned heaps of sand run down in rills.
15 We've sent you an apostle and
A witness against all your band,
As We sent messenger into
The land of Pharaoh in his view.
16 But Pharaoh disobeyed the voice
Of the apostle sent in choice,
And so We seized him with a great
And punishing grasping in fate.
17 How then will you keep yourselves if
You disbelieve and become stiff
Against the day that shall turn small
Children grey-haired beneath the pall?

I knew a man who wrote his diary
At age of seven, a book full and free,
And he'd seen Petersburg beneath the glare
Of bloody Sunday, a small child stood
there
And saw his playmates dropping from the
trees
Where they'd climbed up to see the soldiers
wheeze,
And when the soldiers shot above the
crowd
The children dropped like apples with a
loud
Thud that reverberated in the soul
Of that small lad and turned his hair in toll
White till the day he died after the roll
Of ninety years. I heard him tell the tale.
Beloved, bless Alexander's broken wail,

And every child that sees the world unveil.

18 The sky shall be torn apart then:
His promises fulfilled again.

19 This is reminder, let him who
Will take his Lord as is his due.

20 Your Lord knows that you stand up near
Two-thirds of the night to appear,
And half of it, and oft a third,
And a band of those too who've heard
With you. And God measures out well
The night and day under His spell.
He knows that you can never take
Account of it, so turns for sake
Of you in mercy, so recite
Whatever is easy and right
Of the Qur'an. He knows that there
May be among you sick in share,
And others travelling in the earth
Seeking the grace of God in worth,
And others fighting in the way
Of God, and so recite each day
As much of it as can be done,
And set up daily prayers in run,
And pay the poor-rate, and give up
To God a goodly loan in cup.
Whatever good you send abroad
Beforehand for yourselves in prod,
You'll find it at last with your God.
That's the best and greatest reward.
So seek forgiveness from the Lord
God, God is oft-forgiving and
Most merciful *upon the land*.

Each great and popular way of faith brings
Some part of what You proscribe in Your
rings.

Here You require the sema' and the rate
Of daily prayer, the zakat to abate
The groan of the oppressed and poor in
state,

But there's no church or mosque that would
bring these
Three too You in the offering on their
knees.

Oh no, the human heart must leave of one
Or more, or then replace it with things
done.

Beloved, make me obedient at last
To every word upon the earth You've cast,
And bring my soul and body to Your way,

Though all the world should turn from You
and stay
Upon the stubble and the brazen lay.

Surah 74 Al-Muddassir, or The Covered One

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 O you covered beneath your cloak,
2 Get up and warn, 3 and at a stroke
Now magnify your Lord, 4 and poke
Your clothing in a cleansing stoke.

5 Shun every kind of thing that's ill,
Every abomination's fill.

6 And do no favours with the thought
Of profit from their doing's plot,

7 But for your Lord in patience wrought.

8 For when the trumpet blast shall sound,

9 Then shall day of distress be found,

10 To disbelievers anything

But ease shall come to them and sting.

11 Let Me alone deal with the brave
That I've created for My slave.

12 To whom I granted wealth untold.

13 And sons abiding by him bold.

14 To whom I set an easy path.

15 Yet He desires more without wrath.

16 No never! For he was a foe

To all Our signs set in a row.

17 Soon I'll make him afflicted by
A painful punishment come nigh.

18 He thought and planned and plotted too,

19 But his determination's brew
Comes but to ruin in his pew.

20 Again it's ruin that's his due.

21 He turned around and saw the view,

22 And so he frowned and scowled for rue.

23 And then he turned his back in pride,

24 And said "This is just magic side
And ancient sorcery and plied.

25 "It's just a word of human ride."

26 Soon I will throw him into hell.

The old slave songs spoke of the trumpet
blast,

And so united in one hope outcast

And in one breath the truth of Bible spoken

And the Qur'an as though freshly awoken.

The blast wakes up the dead, both in the
dust

Of earthly grave and in the hardened crust

Of those dead in their sins, and all with eye

New widened peer toward a threatened sky
And know the grand decree's eternity
Has thundered down upon humanity.
Beloved, awaken me from sinful sleep,
Complacency that my righteousness deep
Suffices to take me beyond the ride
That death blows from the sylvan side.

27 And what will make him know hell's
spell?
28 It does not let up, does not spare.
29 It shrivels human body there.
30 There are nineteen to watch in care.
31 We've not set guardians of the fire
Except the angels, and the dire
Number We've made not but as trial
For those who disbelieve the while,
So those who've been given the book
May be sure of the way they cook
And so increase those who believe
In faith, and not doubt who receive
The book and the believers' stand.
Those whose hearts are in distress and
The disbelievers say at hand,
"What does God mean by this tale fanned?"
So God lets stray the ones He wills,
And guides those He wills *as it spills*,
And none know God's hosts but Himself.
And this is just on mankind's shelf
Reminder *of duties and bills*.

Number nineteen exudes from the Qur'an
As seven and twelve ride in the Bible's
dawn,
And all guard at the pit where swim the
spawn
Of Satan once engulfed by judgement
drawn.
Number nineteen, or number twelve or
seven
Suffice not, my Beloved, to get to heaven,
But all suffice to be plunged into hell
Where time's enough to worry at the bell.
Beloved, I strike the tone and hear the
sound
Resound about my airs and on my ground,
And hope for health and wealth within my
bound
Before the judgement of all flesh is found.
No prayer nor hope suffices in the round

Of pence for pence and then of pound for
pound.

32 No, by the moon, 33 and by the night
When it retreats before the light.
34 And by the morning when it's bright.
35 It is one of the grievous woes,
36 A warning to mankind in rows.
37 To him among you who desires
To go forward or who retires.
38 Every soul for what it has earned
Is held in pledge, 39 except unspurned
The people of the right hand learned.
40 In gardens they shall be to ask
Each other 41 about guilty tasks,
42 "What's it that brought you into hell?"
43 They'll say "We did not do so well
In offering daily prayers among
Those who prayed among old and young.
44 "And we did not nourish the poor.
45 "And we spoke vanities impure
Among vain boasters without cure.
46 "And we denied the judgement day
47 "Till on us came its certain ray."
48 The mediation of those who
Intercede avail not that crew.
49 What's happened to them then to make
Them turn aside from warning stake
50 As if they were just frightened asses
51 Retreating from a lion's grasses?
52 No, all of them desire to get
The open pages spread and set.
53 No, but they do not fear the day
Of the hereafter come in sway.
54 No, but it's a reminding ray.
55 So the one who wills may take heed.
56 They'll not mind it unless God speed
Them to it. He's worthy to fear
And worthy in refuge come near.

What's this, Beloved? I see the Qur'an
make
Complaint against the Bible for Your sake.
The two are one and so they must agree,
And here I find a conflict in their fee.
It is enough to throw the good book out
And claim the Qur'an's just a fabled spout!
In every Torah word, the donkey's there
To be both good and beautiful and fair.
The one who laughs as asses laughs too
much

And ought to be obliterated crutch.
 I try to grant forgiveness for this doubt,
 This doubling of Your word against the
 stout,
 And if I so success, Beloved, then know
 The blessed Qur'an may go on with its
 show.

Surah 75 Al-Qiyamat, or The Resurrection

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 I swear by resurrection day,
 2 No, I swear by accusing way
 The self meets self. 3 What! Does man
 think
 We'll never gather his bones' stink?
 4 We can put in order complete
 Even his fingerprints and fleet.
 5 No, but man wills to do the wrong
 Before him *like a catchy song*.
 6 He asks, "When's resurrection day?"
 7 When the eye's blinded by the ray.
 8 When the moon's darkened in its way.
 9 When sun and moon shall join in sway.
 10 That day shall men cry, "Where to
 flee?"

11 There shall be no place of safety.
 12 In your Lord only's place of rest.
 13 Man shall get news on that day of
 What he's set before and to shove
 Behind. 14 No, man against himself
 Shall be a witness on the shelf.
 15 And even with excuses made.
 16 Don't put your tongue to the parade
 Too quickly. 17 Ours is gathering
 Of it as well as reciting.
 18 So when We've recited it then
 Follow in the recital's den.
 19 Again it's for Us to explain.
 20 No, but you love life's fleeting gain.
 21 And you neglect the coming pain.

In forty steps I've put my tongue too fast
 Against the spirits of a flying mast.
 Let forty years bless every soul outcast
 Before he takes the mystery to last.
 In forty steps I took, Beloved, the sign
 Too quickly for the heavenly design,
 And frightened by the lion on the way,
 Like ancient prophet, succumbed to its
 sway.

Beloved, You resurrected me to find
 Ali with the ring in the lion enshrined,
 The forties whirling on a dergah where
 No sacrifice is fallen on earth bare,
 Where glory scintillated under eye,
 And where the rushing stars came
 sweeping by.

22 Some faces on that day shall shine
 23 Toward their Lord where they resign.
 24 And other faces on that day
 Shall be chagrined before the way
 25 They think that great calamity
 Will fall upon them in degree.
 26 No, when it comes up to the throat,
 27 Then it will be said "Who's to dote?"
 28 And men see that it's parting hour.
 29 When one leg twists other in power.
 30 To your Lord on that day shall be
 The driving *toward eternity*.
 31 For he did not believe the truth,
 And did not offer prayers *in youth*,
 32 But denied truth and turned away,
 33 Went to his folk proudly to sway,
 34 Nearer to you draws on the blast
 Of your destruction, nearer cast.
 35 Again, nearer to you the pain
 And the destruction without gain.
 36 What! Does man think that he'll be left
 Without control by no hand deft?
 37 Was he not a sperm drop come out?
 38 Then he was a blood clot to spout,
 And the He created and He
 Made him well proportionately,
 39 And He made of him two distinct
 Kinds, male and female and both linked.
 40 What! Is not He well able to
 Give life again to the dead crew?

The forty steps to sanctity appear
 In every revelation and they steer
 The soul to the reward that's in Your heart,
 Beloved and Lord of heaven and earthly
 part.

The forty miracles that set the path
 In recitation of Your divine wrath
 Arise to show that death is not the end,
 But that You breathe new life and so
 defend
 Your sovereignty creating from the start

And filling heaven and earth till Judgement
Day.

Beloved, I seek to know and walk Your
way.

The faces that I see around me now
Will one day lie beneath the slicing plough,
And rise either resplendent or in grey.

Surah 76 Ad-Dahr, or Time

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 There truly came over mankind
A time when he was not maligned
Nor even mentioned as of worth.
2 We created man on the earth
From a drop of mixed life germ's girth
To test him so We gave him life
To hear and see *yet not in strife*.
3 We've guided him in the way be
He grateful or ungrateful he.
4 We've prepared disbelievers chains
And shackles and flaming fire's pains.
5 The righteous ones shall drink a cup
Sweetened by fountain camphor's sup.
6 Servants of God shall drink of it,
The fountain, they'll make flow a fit
Stream. 7 They who did fulfil their vows
And fear the day whose woe endows
Stretched out both far and wide to sit.
8 They give away food out of love
For Him to the poor and above
The orphan and captive in glove,
9 "We feed you only for God's sake,
We expect no reward in stake
From you nor even thanks to take."
10 We dread from our Lord a stern day
Of the distress men *come to pay*.
11 So God will guard them from the ill
Of that day and cause them to fill
With freshness and pleasure there still.
12 He'll recompense them for what they
Endured with patience in the way,
With gardens and with silk to stay.
13 Reclining there on couches high,
They shall not find the sun to fry
Nor any cold to freeze them by.
14 The shade will cover them nearby,
And clustered fruits bowing there nigh.
15 And vessels of silver and cups
Of crystal shall pass round their sups.
16 Bright as glass, made of silver too.
They're measured well in measure due.

17 They shall receive cups full of drink
Savored with ginger to the brink.

18 And a spring there named Salsabeel.

19 Around them to serve them a deal
Shall be boys of eternal youth.

And when you seen them you will think
Them like pearls scattered on the link.

20 And when you look about, you'll see
Bounties and a kingdom's degree.

21 On them there shall be robes of fine
Green silk and rich brocade entwine,
And they'll don silver bracelets too,
And their Lord gives them drink in brew
Pure, rich, and wholesome there in view.

22 This is to you a recompense
That your endeavour gets presents.

23 We Ourselves have sent down to you
The Qur'an in descending true.

24 Await with patience the command
Of your Lord and obey at hand
Not from among them sinning man
Or one ungrateful *in his plan*.

Mark well, Beloved, this single verse that
takes

Away from mullah, marja', imam's rakes
Authority to tell me what to do,
Despite the scoffing of a Sunnite crew,
The warnings of Usulis in their pew.
I take Your law from the hand of the true,
The sinless ones well-guided at Your
stakes,

Ali and Master of the age who wakes
The hidden ones, Jesus, Elijah and
The eldest Enoch. Incognito stand
Your guides, all sinless in a righteous band.
Beloved, let no one else pretend to know
The ruling of the right here in Your show,
And I shall cling to the good way and go.

25 Remember the name of Your Lord
At morning and evening adored,

26 And part of the night do prostrate
Yourselves in obeisance in state
To Him and His praise celebrate
Long through the night *in measured rate*.

The service of remembrance, sema's rate,
The dhikr of reciting Your names great
From Torah, Psalms, and Qur'an book
come late,

Is the foundation of all faith in state.
 Those who reject remembrance of Your
 name
 Are covered at last in eternal shame.
 Let me prostrate myself before the flame
 Of Your remembrance, and rise without
 blame.
 Remembrance in the morning light I find
 Upon my bed as waking from the blind
 Of that small sleeping death, to find in You
 Remembrance of the gloried things You do.
 Remembrance in the evening draws my eye
 Toward the darkening of peaceful sky.

27 These folk love fleeting present gain
 And neglect to mind day of pain.
 28 We Ourselves have created them
 And made them strong in every hem,
 And when We will with like of them
 We shall replace them *with a gem*.
 29 This is reminder, so who will
 May take the right path to the hill
 Of his Lord and His will fulfil.
 30 And you desire only what God
 Desires. God knows all on the sod
 And is wise above every prod.
 31 He brings into His mercy whom
 He will, and for the unjust doom
 Prepared for them in painful gloom.

Three miracles of verses sent down to
 Muhammad to reveal the truth in view
 Show that Your Sovereign Grace alone is
 true.

I turn from man's work and the way he
 proves
 With all the feelings and the hymns he
 grooves,
 And find eternal decree at Your hand
 Proves faithfully that You will always
 stand
 Behind Your promises and behind all
 The threats You make against the sinful
 ball.
 Beloved, Your mercy is worth every faint
 Excuse and blame poured on the chosen
 saint.
 You're vindicated by Your own word and
 The greatness of Your grace upon the land.
 I bow with only praise and no complaint.

Surah 77 Al-Mursalat, or Those Sent Forth

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 By those who sent forth their good
 ranging,
 2 Who then rage in their rage unchanging,
 3 And by those spreading far and wide,
 4 And by those that from each divide,
 5 Then by those that give the reminder,
 6 To justify or warn the finder,
 7 What has been promised you will come.
 8 So when the stars shall cease in sum,
 9 And when the sky be rent apart,
 10 And when the mountains there shall
 start

Away like dust, 11 When messengers
 Reach the appointment time prefers,
 12 To what day is appointment made?
 13 To the day of decision paid.
 14 And what will make you know what be
 The day of the decision free?
 15 Woe on the day to the deniers.
 16 What! Did We not destroy desires
 Of former people? 17 Then did We
 Make later folk follow in fee,
 18 So We deal with the guilty ones.
 19 Woe on the day to liars' sons.
 20 Did We not make you from a stain
 Of flowing jism of disdain?
 21 Then We set it in a safe place
 22 Till term appointed to birth's grace.
 23 So We planned then how excellent
 We are as planners in extent.
 24 Woe on the day to the deniers.
 25 Have We not made the earth in spires
 Container of all in desires?
 26 For living and for dead on biers.
 27 And We made mountains in it high,
 And gave you sweet water to try?
 28 Woe on the day, those who deny.
 29 Away now to the thing you try
 In ignorance then to deny.
 30 Away to the shadow of smoke
 Rising in three columns in stroke.
 31 It's without shade against flames' yoke.
 32 It sends up sparks like palace fair,
 33 As if of tawny camels there.
 34 Woe on the day, those who deny.
 35 This is the day when they shall sigh
 And speak no word or even try,
 36 And they'll have no leave then to try

To make excuse or justify,
 37 Woe on the day, those who deny.
 38 This is day of decision, We
 Will gather you and former spree,
 39 Or you've got a device in fee,
 Try that device now utterly.
 40 Woe on the day, those who deny.
 41 The pious will midst shades and springs,
 42 And fruits and such desired things,
 43 "Eat and drink in health and delight,
 As reward for your former plight.
 44 So We'll reward doers of good.
 45 Woe on the day deniers should.
 46 Eat and enjoy yourselves a bit,
 For you are guilty and unfit.
 47 Woe on the day, those who deny.
 48 And when it's said to them thereby,
 "Bow down!" they do not even try.
 49 Woe on that day, those who deny.
 50 Then what message is in reprieve
 After that will they come believe?

Beloved, I prostrate toward the house of
 God,
 As I have done for many years. The rod
 That Moses held before the people bowed
 Still speaks to me. Elijah's solemn crowd
 Heard words that touch my soul as well and
 so

Like them I too make forehead bowing low
 Acknowledge none but You as worthy of
 My worship, dedication, and my love.
 The words of John and Jesus reaffirm
 Those messages are true beyond their term.
 Muhammad, peace on him, at last recites
 The golden words that perfume days and
 nights.

Ah woe, that day! Unless this water still
 Tastes fresh of truth, Qur'an fail not to
 thrill.

Surah 78 An-Naba', or The Great News

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 What do they ask each other then?
 2 Of the great news come down to men,
 3 Of which they differ in the hearing.
 4 They shall soon come to know with
 fearing.
 5 Then they shall truly come to know.
 6 What! Did We not make earth to show
 In broad expanses here below?

7 And the mountains in bolts and stairs
 8 And We created you in pairs,
 9 And make your sleep a rest in shares,
 10 And left the night to cover good,
 11 And made day for your livelihood,
 12 And We've stretched out above you the
 guns
 Of the seven strong mighty ones,
 13 And We made there a burning lamp,
 14 And send down torrents from clouds
 damp,
 15 So We might produce corn and herbs,
 16 And garden thick with foliage curbs.
 17 Day of decision's a set time,
 18 Day when the trumpet blast shall climb
 And you come forth in groups from night
 19 With heaven's gates opened in light.
 20 And mountains set to move and sway
 As though mere vapour before day.
 21 Hell shall be waiting to betray
 22 Transgressors from the goal and stay,
 23 To dwell therein time without ray.
 24 They'll not taste there the cool nor drink,
 25 But only boiling water, stink
 Of running pus, 26 fit recompense.
 27 They did not foresee with good sense
 Their reckoning, 28 and so denied
 Our signs in their pernicious pride.

My burning and my learning whirl aside
 To recognize my earning at the ride
 Of urning for the resurrection's glide.
 The water boiling that I drank to feel
 The self slip out of awful head and heel
 Ran pus indeed worse than what Gabirol
 Had on the days of his uncleanness' toll.
 I did not foresee with good sense the right,
 And so was surprised when it came in
 sight,
 And snatched up from the purgatory's
 might

My soul and whirled me further out of
 light.
 Beloved, I too deny Your signs till now,
 And writhe and complain of mercy
 somehow,
 And here before Your throne still come to
 bow.

29 And everything here We have writ
 Recorded in a book as fit,

30 So taste, and We'll never increase
 For you anything there to lease
 But punishment never to cease.
 31 For pious folk great waking up,
 32 Walled gardens and the vineyards' cup,
 33 And mates and maidens beautiful.
 34 And a cup overflowing full,
 35 They'll not hear vain words there nor yet
 Any falsehood among the set.
 36 A recompense from your Lord and
 Reward according to the stand,
 37 The Lord of the heaven and the earth
 And what's between the two of worth,
 Beneficent God, they'll not get
 From Him the right of address met,
 38 On the day when the spirit and
 The angels in array shall stand,
 They shall not speak except the one
 To whom the blessing God's begun
 To hive leave, who spoke the truth done.
 39 That is the certain day, so who
 Desires may take the refuge due
 In his Lord. 40 We have warned you too
 Of punishment come near at hand,
 The day when man shall see to stand
 What both his hands have sent before,
 And when the disbeliever sore
 Shall say "If I were dust, not more."

Again I take the forty rounds to make
 The ladder of St David and the stake
 Of Jacob at his pillows rocky wake.
 The seven skies whirled round me as I
 stepped
 Out on the clouds after the days I'd slept,
 And all the mountains underneath my feet
 Split crumbling and in their prostration
 meet
 Bowed before You and before the Qur'an
 Recited in its forties on the dawn.
 Beloved, I stood upon a higher place
 And reveled in the glory of Your face,
 Until my whirling lifted me apace
 And set my feet upon the earth with grace,
 Where love and all awareness fade from
 trace.

Surah 79 An-Nazi'aat, or The Draggers

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 Those who drag forth with violence
 2 And those who untie fast and dense,

3 And those who move on through the
 fence,
 4 And those who go ahead with speed,
 5 And those who manage without greed.
 6 On the day when quaking shall come
 7 Shall follow it the quaking's sum.
 8 Hearts shall run fearfully that day,
 9 Their eyes shall be cast down to pay.
 10 They'll say then, "What! Shall we
 indeed
 Be restored as first from the seed?
 11 What! When we're rotten bones and
 bead?"
 12 They said "Then that shall be in vain
 Return." 13 A single blast in train,
 14 When see, they'll be wakened the lain.
 15 Have you not heard of Moses' story?
 16 When his Lord called him up in glory
 From holy valley Tuva', 17 Saying
 "Go to Pharaoh, and don't be staying,
 He crossed the bounds! 18 "And say 'Will
 you
 Cleanse yourself of the things you do?
 19 "And I'll guide you back to your Lord,
 So you may fear Him who'se adored."
 20 And he showed him the greatest sign,
 21 But he denied and by design
 He disobeyed commanded line.
 22 Then he turned his back hastily.
 23 He gathered the folk and proclaimed,
 24 And said "I am your lord in fee,
 The most high and not to be shamed."
 25 So God seized him with punishment
 In the hereafter, and life spent.
 26 In this there's a lesson to him
 Who fears *to fail the right and trim.*

A single blast in train suffices when
 You wish to resurrect bodies of men
 And recreate in them a living soul
 After the death of night's unconscious
 scroll.
 The fate of Pharaoh was sealed from the
 start,
 And You had hardened Pharaoh's weeding
 heart.
 So why send Moses to make such appeal
 That he should heed repentance at the heel?
 Beloved, You send out preachers of the
 word

To give them harder hearts that are
unstirred,
And so provide the justified reply
To their rebellion, when You let them die
Beneath the flood of the Red Sea's desire,
The cruelty, lust, greed of their hell fire.

27 Are you harder to be created
Or the sky that He once instated?
28 He raised its heights and set it up,
29 He darkened its night like a cup,
And brought forth its noon light *above*.
30 And earth afterward He *in love*
Stretched forth and spread it *like a glove*.
31 He brought from it its waters *sure*
And pastures *green and cool and pure*.
32 And mountains He set them to stand,
33 Provision for you and your band.
34 When comes the great calamity,
35 The day when man shall mind in fee
What he strove for *in life to be*,
36 And hell shall be displayed to him
Who sees the sight and sees it grim.
37 Then as for him who's crossed the
bounds,
38 And preferred this world's life and
sounds,
39 Then truly hell shall be his place.
40 And as for him who feared the face
Of his Lord, and forbids himself
From his desires *upon the shelf*,
41 Indeed the garden will be there
His place of dwelling, a place fair.
42 They ask you of the hour to bring
To port and anchorage to sing.
43 In what are you of that thinking?
44 To your Lord is its end sinking.
45 You are only a warner here
To him as has once learned to fear.
46 It will seem to them on the day
When they perceive it as though they
Had not waited in the graves' stay
But for an evening or dawn's sway.

Your argument that bringing back to life
The bodies that have rotted after strife
Is easier than the creation of
The universe of stars that's lit above,
Is argument enough to convince me,
But then I am not so tough in the spree
Of scientific hopefulness' degree.

The resurrection is a hope and not
A conflict with the scientific plot
As is the immortal soul vainly sought
In test-tube and in forests unbegot.
Those who hope not for body's
resurrection,
Believing in immortal soul's reflection,
Are hard put before science's inspection.

Surah 80 Abasa, or He Frowned

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
1 He frowned and so he turned away,
2 Because a blind man came his way,
3 And what makes you know that he'd stay
To cleanse himself, 4 or warned and so
Made profit of the warning's glow?
5 As for the one who thinks he's got
In wealth an independent lot,
6 To him you do attend in plot,
7 It shall be no blame on you if
He does not cleanse himself a stiff.
8 But as for the one who comes to
You striving in earnest to do,
9 And fears sincerely at the view,
10 From him you'll be indifferent too,
11 No! But it is a minding view.
12 So let who wills then mind it too.
13 In the books greatly honoured writ,
14 Exalted high and cleansed and fit,
15 In the hands of the angels sent,
16 Noble, and virtuous they went.
17 Cursed be man! How ungrateful bent!
18 Of what thing did He create him?
19 Of a drop of semen in vim,
He created him, then He fixed
Its measure *in a cup unmixed*.
20 The way He made easy transfixed,
21 Then He caused him to die and got
Him buried in the graveyard's plot,
22 Then when He wills, He will again
Raise him to life among his men.
23 No! He's not fulfilled what He cried.
24 Then let man look at his food tried,
25 That it was We who poured down then
Water in abundance on men,
26 Then We split the earth with a split,
27 And We caused grain to grow there fit,
28 And grapes and vegetation too,
29 The olive and the palm in view,
30 Walled gardens thick with trees as due,
31 And fruits and herbage, *thyme and rue*,

32 Provision for you and your herd.
 33 But when there comes once to be heard
 The deafening trumpet blast blurred,
 34 That day man will flee from his own
 Brother, 35 and from his mother's bone
 And from his father, 36 and from wife
 And even from his children rife.
 37 For every man of them that day
 Will have concern about his way
 Enough to make him look away.
 38 There shall be faces on that day
 In radiance, 39 laughing, in joy's sway.
 40 And faces on that day on them
 That shall be dust upon the hem,
 41 And darkness shall cover them then.
 42 These are disbelievers again,
 The wicked ones from among men.

O my Beloved, not one but all men frown
 At me as I come to sit in Your town,
 Turn my blind eye toward Your mammoth
 throne,
 And seek the pleasure Your presence alone
 Can give the heart of the outcast in stone.
 O my Beloved, the frowns I do not see,
 But I know certainly they fall on me.
 I turn my sightless eyes away from men,
 And from their hopes and glories drowned
 again,
 And seek the sight of Your face, though I'm
 blind,
 I know that You see me, so I'm resigned
 To ignorance of all that's true and great.
 I quietly assume my humble state.
 Your turning to my seat is never late.

Surah 81 Al-Takwir, or the Folding Up

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 And when the sun is folded down,
 2 When the stars fall, losing their crown,
 3 When the mountains vanish away,
 4 When she camels, ten months in way
 Are left untended, 5 when wild beast
 Is herded in *where humans ceased*,
 6 When oceans boil over with swell,
 7 When the souls are sorted out well,
 8 When the girl child, buried alive,
 Is questioned 9 for what crime she'd strive,
 10 When the scrolls are laid open, *bare*,
 11 When the world on high's unveiled
 there,

12 When blazing fire's kindled to heat,
 13 And when the garden's brought near
 sweet,
 14 Each soul shall know its claim and feat.
 15 So truly I call to witness
 The planets that receding *bless*,
 16 Go straight, or hide, 17 and the night as
 It dissipates 18 in what dawn has,
 Breathed away of the darkness till
 19 The word of honoured runner fill,
 20 Endued with power, with rank before
 The Lord of the throne, 21 power in store,
 Faithful to his trust, 22 and your friend
 Is not one possessed *by the fiend*,
 23 Without doubt he saw him on clear
 Horizon, 24 neither does he fear
 To give knowledge of the unseen,
 25 Nor word of evil spirit keen
 Accursed, accursed. 26 Where do you go?
 27 Truly this Message is to show
 To *all* the worlds, 28 to all who will
 Go in the straight *path*, but you still
 Cannot, except as Allah wills,
 Allah, Lord *who all* the worlds *fills*.

The message to the universe is this,
 The holy Qur'an recited in bliss,
 And without electronic device,
 The service of remembrance still works
 nice

To broadcast to the universe displayed
 The single voice of the one here who's
 prayed.

The rising of the voice in recitation
 Of the four books for a heart's fast elation
 Fills all the hooks and crannies of creation
 With the message of Your oneness and fair,
 And oneness of humanity's repair.
 Beloved, I too lift my voice on occasion,
 As though in holy office of persuasion,
 To join the quires of angels unaware.

Surah 82 Al-Infitar, or The Cleaving

In name of God most gracious, merciful.
 1 And when the heavens split apart,
 2 And when the stars fall from their start,
 3 And when the seas are mingled art,
 4 And when the graves open their heart,
 5 Then every soul shall know what it
 Has sent abroad and left unfit.
 6 O man, what has beguiled you from

Your Lord, most gracious One to come,
 7 Who has created you and made
 You in proportion on parade,
 8 In the form that He willed to cast?
 9 But you deny accounting last,
 10 While watchers are appointed you,
 11 Recorder noble of the view,
 12 So know that whatever you do,
 13 The righteous in abundant bliss,
 14 The wicked flaming fire not miss,
 15 They'll be sentenced on Judgement Day.
 16 They'll not be absent from that sway.
 17 And what makes you to know what will
 Be the day of judgement's fulfil?
 18 What makes you know what it will be
 The day of judgement in its fee?
 19 The day when one shall own nothing
 For other souls, and commanding
 Of all things that day shall return
 To God *alone while others burn*.

I'm waiting for the heavens to split apart
 And spill out from celestial grocery cart.
 I reckon that the stars will fall like coins
 Of gold and silver, and the crowd that joins
 In chasing them across the polished floor
 Of earth's bank central will shut up the door
 With lock and bolt and key thrown to the
 dust
 Of those who are militant and unjust.
 Beloved, let the sky split above my head
 And let me hear at last just what You said
 In Your eternal will decreed instead
 Of time and temporal where I've been fed.
 The cabbages my daughter planted well
 Have all been eaten in the night light's
 spell.

Surah 83 At-Tatfif, or the Deceivers in Measure

In name of God most gracious, merciful.
 1 Woe to defrauders in their measure,
 2 Who, when they take of the folk's
 treasure,
 Demand the full, 3 but when they bring
 The measure to them, or they sling
 The weight, they then diminish it.
 4 What! Don't they consider a bit
 That they'll be raised up as is fit
 5 For a day of power, 6 on the day
 When humankind shall stand their way

Before the Lord of universe?
 7 No, then the record of perverse
 Has been preserved in the Sajjin,
 8 And what will make known the Sajjin?
 9 It is a book that's written keen,
 10 Woe on that day to the deniers,
 11 Those who deny judgement day's fliers,
 12 And none deny it but the sinner,
 And the transgressor that's no winner,
 13 When Our signs are recited him,
 He says "These are vain tales and dim."
 14 No! Rather their hearts rust with vim
 Of what they used to do and skim.
 15 No! That day they'll be shut away
 From their Lord's mercy now in sway.
 16 They'll be thrown in the flaming fire.
 17 It shall be said "This is the *dire*
 Thing you denied *and now desire*."
 18 No! The righteous ones' record stands
 In the Illiyyun *without bands*.
 19 What makes you know Illiyyun's hands?
 20 A written book, 21 they see it who
 Are the ones near to God in crew,
 22 The righteous in abundant bliss,
 23 On couches high so they'll not miss
 The view celestial. 24 You will know
 Their faces blissful joys to show.
 25 They'll be provided with the drink
 Of purity, sealed from the brink.
 26 The seal of musk, for which aspire
 All those who lovely things desire.
 27 Mixed with it water of Tasnim,
 28 Spring from which drink the near to
 Him.
 29 While guilty ones are they who laughed
 At the believers come and quaffed.
 30 When they pass by them, then they wink
 At one another *where they drink*.
 31 When they go back to their folk, they
 Laugh and joke all along the way.
 32 And when they see them, then they say
 "These are the ones who've gone astray."
 33 While they are not set over them
 To be the watchers *in their hem*.
 34 On this day those who have believed
 Shall scoff at those now unreprieved,
 35 On couches lifted up to see,
 36 Shall not the disbelievers be
 Recompensed for iniquity?

The fashion in the sofas I see here

Is mostly low, and when I did appear
 To buy a bigger one, one of more height,
 My daughter came through for the winning
 fight
 And vetoed polish, style and carved delight
 For comfort in the evening and the night.
 Beloved, the couches of the righteous saved
 Are higher than my own, and stand on
 paved
 Squares of the gems and gold of paradise.
 And still I think my lower couches nice.
 If there's a time to leave the humble store
 Of softness that's accumulated more
 In house and cold, then let it be for those
 Sofas set higher than the ones I chose.

Surah 84 Al-Inshiqaq, or The Rending Asunder

In name God, Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 When the skies shall rend them asunder,
 2 Obeying their Lord *by the thunder*,
 3 And when the earth shall be stretched out,
 4 And cast up till empty of doubt,
 5 It shall obey its Lord, not flout.
 6 O human being, the truth's you
 Are in strife to your Lord in view
 Of struggling, and so you'll meet Him!
 7 And he who's given his book in right
 Hand, 8 soon shall be accounted in sight,
 9 He'll go to his folk with delight.
 10 And he who's given his writ from
 Behind his back, 11 he'll find in sum
 Destruction, 12 and fall in the flame
 Of fire. 13 He joyed among his claim
 Of people. 14 He thought he should not
 Return *into the evil lot*.
 15 Indeed his Lord watch him with care.
 16 By the glow of sunset I swear,
 17 And by the night and its shroud wear,
 18 And by the moon at full repair,
 19 That you'll go through states to your
 share.
 20 But what's befallen those who did
 Not believe? 21 And reciting's bid
 From the Qur'an falls, they do not
 Prostrate themselves in worship's lot?

I do prostrate, Beloved, my body here,
 And sometimes even soul that I hold dear,
 And on occasion, when the sky is clear,

I stop my rushing thoughts to find Your
 near
 And bare my heart to the eternal fear.
 The glow of sunset and the night and moon,
 The day and all things late and coming
 soon,
 Call me to prayer, to comfort and to boon.
 Beloved, what have I here to do with this
 Reward of streams eternal in their bliss?
 My human heart goes down to the abyss.
 Meet me their in my punishment and gloom
 And let Your grace give me the heavenly
 room
 Before the fading flowers, before the
 bloom.

22 No, those who disbelieve deny.
 23 And so God knows the best on high
 Of what the keep in secret's ply.
 24 Proclaim to them the news that they
 Will come in painful reward's sway.
 25 Except those who believe and do
 Good deeds, for them shall be in view
 Eternal recompense from rue.

Belief and good deeds are no easy thing
 To the heart that takes to the wicked wing
 Of scoffing in the world of stand and sting.
 Belief and good deeds all come from Your
 hand,
 And where they are, there You are in the
 land,
 Though there may be few here who
 understand.
 Proclaim what news You will to human
 hearts,
 We all have our own arsenal of darts,
 And all the shroud and bier and waiting
 carts.
 Beloved, I lie inert before Your grace,
 And if it falls upon my heart and place,
 I shall stand up renewed before Your face.
 If not, I'll meet You in the dust's disgrace,
 The tomb, the riding winds, the silent lace.

Surah 85 Al Buruj, or The Celestial Stations

In the name of God, Most Gracious, Ever
 Merciful.
 1 And by the heaven full of stars!
 2 And by the day promised in bars!

3 And by the witness and its cars!
 4 The fellows of the ditch fell down,
 5 They felt the fire as fuel on crown,
 6 They sat before its raging *frown*,
 7 To see what they did to *the town*
Of the believers as to drown.
 8 They had tormented them for naught,
 But that they did believe *the plot*
Of God prevailing and most praised,
 9 He to whom belongs kingdom raised
 To the sky and the earth. And God
 Is over all witness *in prod.*
 10 They persecute believer men
 And women also come again,
 And yet do not repent their deed,
 For them shall be hell's painful greed
 And for them burning torture's lead.
 11 Those who believe and do good things,
 For them shall be the gardens' rings
 Beneath which flow the streams in toll
 Of a great reward come in goal.
 12 The grip of your Lord's terrible.
 13 It's He who starts all things in full
 And brings them back to final goal.
 14 He's oft-forgiving, loving One,
 15 Lord of the throne in glory done,
 16 The mighty doer of His will.
 17 Have you not hear the story still
 Of hosts, 18 Of Pharaoh and Thamood?
 19 No, those who disbelieve deny.
 20 While God surrounds them ever nigh.
 21 No, it's the Qur'an glorious,
 In the kept tablets above us.

The tablets are first known in Jubilees,
 That fair book kept in Ethiopic breeze
 While all the world turned back to softened
 sleeze
 To find a pagan way in Christian frieze.
 Beloved, I seek the tablets of the sky
 Where the Qur'an was sealed to meet the
 try
 Of heresy in every Christian church.
 I seek and You don't leave me in the lurch,
 But there I find a noble, sounding perch.
 The faith that ignores Jubilees must smirch
 The soul and stain the heart. I turn again
 And read its gloried strains along the den
 Of desert wanderings, and Isaac's heart,
 And Jacob's bosom, where Abraham's start.

Surah 86 At-Tariq, or the Nightly Visitant

In name of God, Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 By the sky and the nightly call,
 2 What will show you visitant's wall?
 3 The star of piercing radiance,
 4 There's not a soul that's set to dance
 As watcher, 5 so let man reflect
 Of what he is made and select,
 6 Created a drop to eject,
 7 Come from between backbone and ribs.
 8 He's well able to bring back cribs
 In resurrection, 9 on the day
 When all things hidden shall give way
 To judgement, 10 then for him shall not
 Be any power or help in lot.
 11 By the skies turning round and round,
 12 And by the earthly splitting sound,
 13 It is a word deciding ground,
 14 And not a joke *some men have found.*
 15 They plot a plot, 16 and so do I
 Scheme on a scheme to make them try,
 16 So let the disbelievers rest,
 Let them lie a moment at best.

The mystery of darkness all around
 I find a cloak of comfort from the sound
 Of plotting and of planning against You,
 And against every good thing that You do.
 The dark may hide the evil and its crew,
 But also come protecting good from view.
 The mastered word of the Qur'an will crash
 Among complacent sitter with a slash
 Of lightning to illuminate the brash.
 But still the mystery of darkness gains
 Against the light of artificial swains,
 To show the pleasures and the awful pains.
 Beloved, creation lies before Your eye,
 But no one else has ever been so sly.

Surah 87 Al-A'la, or The Most High

In name of God, Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 Hallow name of your Lord most high,
 2 He who creates, fashions thereby,
 3 And He who planned and guided them,
 4 Who brings for the green things like gem,
 5 And then brings it to stubble dust.
 6 We make you read so that you must
 Not forget, 7 except what God will.
 He knows the stated and the still
 Secret. 8 We'll make ease for your ease,

9 So keep reminding, profits please
 From the reminding. 10 He who fears
 Will mind the warning, and with tears,
 11 He will avoid it, even such
 As are most reprobate to clutch,
 12 Who shall be thrown into the fire,
 13 To die and not live in desire.
 14 He succeeds who makes himself pure,
 15 Remembering the name to endure
 Of his Lord and stands up in prayer.
 16 No, you prefer the life and share
 Of this world, 17 although world to come
 Is better and more lasting sum.
 18 This is found in earlier writ,
 19 Of Abraham and Moses fit.

The barzakh and the grave are silent and
 The burning of hell also comes to stand
 In silence when body and soul remand
 In dissolution and cease to exist,
 In death annihilated, all thought missed,
 All feeling, hope and torture long forgot,
 The end of every deed and every thought.
 Beloved, I read the Torah and Qur'an,
 And see that they agree within Your plan,
 And eschatology remains aloft
 Semitic and not Greek all the hat doffed.
 Beloved, let grave and hell pass by in still
 Retreat and finally beneath the hill
 Be nothing except You and what You fill.

Remembrance is the service that I seek,
 Reciting of the Scripture week by week,
 And day by day, and hour by hour until
 My life is just Your Word, Your Word to
 fill.

There is no way to purify the heart,
 The hand, the way, any of human art,
 But by Your Word alone, as David sang
 In the Psalm longest in the book that rang
 Out clear and sheer and lovely on the air
 I breathed this morning from the pine in
 share

And firs that solemnly met me as I
 Climbed up the hill to find a piece of sky.
 Remembrance is the service that I find
 To purify the hand and heart and mind.

Surah 88 Al-Ghashiyah, or The Overwhelming Event

In name of God, Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 Has not the news of the great thing
 Come to you and to bless your wing?
 2 Some faces on that day will frown,
 3 Toiling and weary, 4 entering down
 Into the fire ablaze, where they
 Are made to drink from boiling spray.
 6 For them there'll be no nourishment
 But bitter, thorny fruit that's sent
 From the Zaree, 7 which does not give
 Fat or relief from hunger's sieve.
 8 Other faces on that day bright
 Shall be with happiness and light,
 9 Their efforts past, pleasure in sight,
 10 In a grand garden, 11 they shall hear
 No vain talk babbling in the ear.
 12 There is a spring flowing and dear.
 13 There are couches set up on high.
 14 And goblets placed and set nearby.
 15 And cushions ranged all in array.
 16 And carpets spread out there to stay.
 17 What! Don't the see how camels stand
 Created to be in the land?
 18 And up to heaven, how it is raised
 19 And to the mountains high and glazed?
 20 And to the earth, how it's spread out?
 21 So keep reminding as with shout.
 You're only a reminder here.
 22 You're not set over them for fear
 To make them obey with a tear,
 23 But the one who turns back to be
 A doubter disbelieving, see,
 24 Then God will punish him in spree
 Of greatest punishment to be.
 25 To Us is their return in fee.
 26 We'll reckon with them faithfully.

The goblets are what I most wonder for
 Placed as they are upon the heavenly floor.
 The word's unknown in the fair Arabic
 I've heard about me in the bin and brick.
 Perhaps the ancient Persian understands
 The gardening best in celestial lands.
 The goblets. Let them been of a green
 stone,

An alabaster rare, not the thin bone
 Of porcelain. Let them contain the treat
 Dealt out to all you pray behind the feet
 Of Ali son of Abu Talib sweet.

Beloved, I wait the goblets, I wait long,
 Although all time on earth is just a song,

And everywhere I turn, there's right and wrong.

Surah 89 Al-Fajr, or The Daybreak

In name of God, Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 By the dawn 2 and by the ten nights,

3 And by the even and odd flights,

4 And by the night that passes on,

5 There's here an oath for those who've drawn

On understanding *in their lights*.

6 Have you not seen how your Lord dealt With the people of 'Ad *with welf*?

7 Iram with many columns' belt,

8 The like of which were never made

In any other town's parade,

9 And Thamud who carved from the rocks

In the valley *hold, house, and stocks*,

10 And Pharaoh owner of the stakes

11 Who all transgressed in cities' wakes,

12 And multiplied wickedness there,

13 So your Lord let fall on their share

The whip chastizing then and there,

14 Your Lord keeps watch on all with care.

15 As for man, when his Lord tries him,

And honours with abundant trim,

Then he says "My Lord's honoured me!"

17 No, rather you give no note to

The orphan, 18 nor urge each in due

To feed the poor around in view.

19 And you consume the heritage,

Devouring greedily in stage,

20 And love wealth as with a strong rage.

21 No, when the earth shall be ground in

To powder, 22 and your Lord in din

Come with the angels ranked arrayed,

23 And Hell made manifest displayed

That day, that day shall man awake,

By what help shall be for his sake?

24 He'll say "Oh, that I'd sent before

Me the provisions for my score!"

25 For on that day none shall chastise

Like His chastisement in disguise.

26 And none shall bind as in His wise.

27 O soul pacified and at rest!

28 Return then to your Lord the best,

Well-pleased and He well-pleased with you.

29 So enter in My servants' crew,

30 And enter in the garden too.

I contemplate the ten nights of the time
Illuminating earth above the grime
Of soiled hopes and their expectations'
rhyme

To find the perfect rest of pilgrimage
Writ softly to invest my moving page.

I've tasted of Your paradise when I
Came down from fair Madina once to spy
The lovely shadowed miqwes where in
dress

Of glowing white all souls came to confess
Their coming back to You, Beloved, to
know

The pleasure only pilgrims have in stow.
Beloved, in dream and in my waking
thought

I oft return to find that lovely spot
Where gardens of the heart are fully
wrought.

Surah 90 Al-Balad, or The City

In name of God, Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 I call to witness this city,

2 And you are its free citizen,

3 And parent and child *all to see*,

4 Truly We have created men

To toil and struggle. 5 Then thinks he

That none has power over him?

6 He may *rise* saying *boastfully*
"I've squandered wealth abundantly!"

7 He thinks that no one beholds him.

8 Have We not made him pair of eyes,

9 And tongue, and lips *and by surprise*,

10 And shown to him the two highways?

11 But he's not hurried *where he stays*

To enter on the path that's steep.

12 And what will show you the path steep?

13 Freeing the slave, 14 or giving food

In the day of a famine's *brood*,

15 To the orphan with ties of love,

16 Or to the poor man in the dust.

17 Then he will be of those *above*

Who believe, and enjoin to trust

With constancy, and enjoin deeds

Of kindness and compassion's *seeds*.

18 Such are right-hand associates.

19 But those who reject Our signs *rates*,

They are left-hand associates.

20 Over them will be burning grates.

Beloved, each man has two feet and two hands,
 One to work out sinful highway's commands
 And one to flee to You and work Your will.
 Beloved, each man has two eyes and two ears,
 One to see and hear wicked ways and fears,
 And one to see and hear Your way and will.
 Beloved, no man has more than one mind and
 One heart and tongue, and so must choose to stand
 In one way or the other. Let me go
 In the steep path, Beloved, and let me know
 The freeing of the slave, the feeding of
 The hungry, and the poor and orphan's love.
 For none escape the flaming grate of fire,
 But let it be Your burning love's desire.

Surah 91 Ash-Shams, or The Sun

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 By the sun and its glorious rays,
 2 By the moon following in praise,
 3 By the day unfolding in light,
 4 By the enshrouding lay of night,
 5 By the sky in its edifice,
 6 By the earth expanded in bliss,
 7 By the soul that perfections kiss,
 8 Inspiring it of vice and right,
 9 Succeeds the one who cleanses white,
 10 And fails he who pollutes the sight.
 11 Thamud denied it to incite
Impiety against the fight.
 12 When the worst wretch among them
 rose,
 13 Then God's messenger said to those,
 "It's God's she-camel, let her drink!"
 14 But they denied him, came to slink
 And hamstring her, that's why the Lord
 Crushed them for their sins by the sword,
 And leveled them upon the ground.
 15 He is not afraid of the sound.

Beloved, I'm glad that You came down one time
 To punish men for their works and their crime
 Against a beast of burden, and a beast

Who could not recite prayers to You at least
 To raise Your arm against tormenting men.
 I wish that You would do so once again.
 The rights of animals may well be found
 In Torah or in Psalms, or Gospel's ground,
 But if not there, at least I see Your care
 Revealed in the Qur'an with beasts to share.
 Beloved, let me remember that the voice
 Of swallow and of blackbird to rejoice
 Is as pleasing to You as nightingale
 Set in the concert hall and under sail.

Surah 92 Al-Lail, or The Night

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 By the night when it spreads its ill,
 2 By the day when sun shines to fill,
 3 By Him who made male and female,
 4 Your striving's to diverse avail!
 5 As for one who gives charity
 And guards against iniquity,
 6 And has faith in the best of faiths,
 7 We'll make smooth the path without
 wraiths
 To the place of blissful degree.
 8 As for the stingy man who thinks
 He stands safe away from the brinks,
 9 And denies the truth of the best,
 10 We'll smoothen the paths that invest
Affliction in a place that stinks.
 11 His wealth will never help him when
 He perishes in that low den.
 12 We only can guidance impart,
 13 Ours is the end and Ours the start.
 14 I warn you of the fire that flames,
 15 None shall be thrown there but for
 blames

Of the most wretched kind in claims,
 16 Who denies truth and turns his back.
 17 Far moved from it and from its rack
 Shall be the one who guards the most,
 18 Who shares of his wealth without boast,
 To purify himself for lack.
 19 No one's done Him a favour to
 Be recompensed in heavenly crew,
 20 But seeking the pleasure alone
 Of his Lord, the Most High on throne,
 21 And soon he shall receive the mind
 Of great contentment and resigned.

There is no man on earth who's done for
 You
 Such a great thing that You're indebted to,
 And ought to give to him heavenly reward
 Instead of send to hell beneath the sword.
 The life eternal that You offer some
 Is by Your grace alone, not right of bum.
 That's why I praise You for Your mercy
 here,
 And for Your grace, both to laughter and
 tear.
 Beloved, I have no argument to bring
 To You to make You wonder and to sing,
 And yet I myself wonder at Your ways
 And stop anon to sing to You Your praise
 Though tongue is thoughtless of the better
 tune
 And You may hope more for my silence
 soon.

Surah 93 Dhuha, or The Brightness

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 By the glorious morning light,
 2 And when it is still, by the night,
 3 Your guardian Lord has not forsaken
 You, nor has He displeasure taken.
 4 And truly the hereafter will
 Be better for you than what's still.
 5 And soon your guardian Lord will give
 You what will make you pleased *to live*.
 6 Did He not find you orphaned and
 Give you shelter, *care from His hand*?
 7 And He found you wandering, and He
 Gave you *His guidance and freely*.
 8 And He found you in need, and made
 You independent. 9 Therefore, *stayed*,
 Don't treat the orphan with harshness,
 10 Nor repulse beggar, *instead bless*,
 11 Rehearsing and proclaiming *still*
 The bounty of your *good Lord's will*!

Indeed, Beloved, I am an orphan found,
 Rejected by Jew, Muslim, Christian pound,
 Despised by even saints Samaritan,
 By Buddhist, Hindu, Zoroastrian.
 But I am orphaned because I delight
 To follow You alone, and in the right
 Of Your commandments I shed every rung
 That is extolled by pagan-Christian tongue.
 And wandering in my need among the
 books

Of sacred messages, I found Your looks
 And finally divine Guides You provide
 To sincere hearts and all the souls who hide
 From priest-craft and its evil clerics who
 Give heathen dance but do not guide to
 You.

Surah 94 Al-Inshirah, The Expansion

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 What! Did We not expand your breast?
 2 We took your burdens that infest,
 3 Which weighed down your back with the
 rest,
 4 And made your fame among the best.
 5 With every hardship comes reprieve,
 6 Each trouble finds ways to releave,
 7 And when you've finished your task here,
 Then you'll establish it, no fear.
 8 Then to your Lord go back again
 With fervour *leaving earth and men*.

Beloved, I need no breast implants or such
 Breast augments that so many here now
 touch,
 Not only of the ladies but with crutch
 Also the gentlemen left in the clutch
 Of hope to change their bodies to make
 right
 The correspondence with their souls in
 light.
 Never before have such solutions come
 To solve the troubles of the human sum.
 The prophecy that You sent down in cheer
 Is now reality, with or not fear.
 Beloved, I may or not bear trouble now
 To write, as did Muhammad, anyhow,
 But when I've done, I pray I shall return
 To You and not the other place to burn.

Surah 95 At-Tin, The Fig

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 By the fig and the olive too!
 2 And by Mount Sinai come in view!
 3 And by the city sanctified!
 4 We have created edified
 Mankind, 5 and sent him down again
 To be the lowest in the den,
 6 Except the ones who did believe
 And do good deeds for their reprieve.
 7 What can after this make you doubt
 The final judgement with a shout?

8 What! Is not Allah above all
Judge of the judges *great and small*?

The witness of the fig and olive may
Indeed be better than humankind's way.
I've watered both in Wadi-Natrun's sway
To find the fossil water without pay
By root extended deep beneath the sand.
Beloved, You choose the best in witness
band.

After the generation that was born
Before me fell asleep, as though in scorn
The olives and the figs grandfathers set
Still bear their witness beneath skies unwet.
Beloved, though desert seems to be my lot,
Let me drink from the hidden streams in
plot

And live to be a witness that You stand
Both sovereign and the merciful on land.

Surah 96 Iqraa, or Read! or Proclaim! or Alaq, or The Clot of Congealed Blood

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 Then cantillate in your Lord's name,
Who has created *every claim*,
2 Created man, out of a clot
Of congealed blood (he's still a dot),
3 Proclaim! Your Lord's most bountiful,
4 He who taught the pen *what's useful*,
5 Taught man that which he did not know.
6 No, but men transgress where they go,
7 In that he looks upon himself
As self-sufficient *as blue delf*.
8 Truly, to your Lord is return.
9 Do you see one of those who spurn
10 To give a gift when he would pray?
11 See if he is on Guidance' way,
12 Or enjoins Righteousness *to sway*?
13 See if he denies, turns away?
14 Does he not know that Allah sees?
15 Let him beware! Unless he freeze,
We will drag him by the forelock,
16 A lying, sinful forelock *mock!*
17 Then, let him call to his council:
18 We'll call on the angels of ill!
19 No, do not heed him: But bow down
In worship, come close *to the crown!*

I cantillate Your name, Beloved, and know
By intellection what reason can show

And revelation impart to the heart.

I raise my voice at morning and proclaim
The grace and mercy, judgement of Your
name,

And pray that wondering heart of mine
might not

Depart from contemplation of the taught
In Your path daily, that the wandering foot
Might keep still in the Guidance You have
put

Within the Book. Though I see nothing but
The dark, drag out the sinful forelock shut
Against Your will, and leave me righteous
still,

If righteousness is following Your will.
Be so not in word only from the start.

Who gives the alms in charity in prayer
Is marked out as the divine proof and there
Is safety in the following of such
Whose actions are embodiment of book
Of revelation. One need only touch.
May Ali's grave reminder then that shook
The heart of beggar to the root shake mine
As well this day to confirmed will resign
In his obedience. My love shows not
In ripe emotions for the finely bought,
But in the humble following today
Of what was shown in alms along the way.
Beloved, I find reflected in the face
The guidance of the heart to Your own
place.

Surah 97 Al-Qadr, or The Night of Power (or Honour)

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 We have indeed revealed this *thing*
In the night of *Our* power to sing.
2 And what will show you what the night
Of power is? 3 Better's the night
Of power than a thousand months' *nights*.
4 Therein come down angels of *lights*
And the Spirit by Allah's rights,
On every errand: 5 "Peace!" *they say*
Until the rise of morning's *day!*

Even the sacred blessing of the night
Of power is made an argument in sight
To show which sect is and is never right.
Even the angels coming down in light,
The spirit flying where it will for spite,

Divide the human train once to requite.
Beloved, I seek in every night I live
The broader blessings that You come to
give.

If my time of vocation is allowed
Within or without the last praying crowd,
I shall appear before the flaming shroud
Sure of the peace that morning at its dawn
Reveals when the first prayer is fully
drawn,
The visions of the night at last are gone.

Surah 98 Al-Bayyinah, or The Clear Evidence

In the name of God, Most Gracious, Most
Merciful

1 Those who are faithless from the folk
Of the book and from those who cloak
With idols could not take their stand
Apart until clear signs command
Appeared to them *on every hand*,
2 The messenger come to recite
To them the Scriptures recondite,
3 Wherein are the decrees of might.
4 Division rose among those who
Had the Book only at the view
Of evidence clear not to skew.
5 But nothing was laid upon them,
But they, they should by stratagem
Worship Allah sincerely true,
In judgement to just Him in view,
And offer prayer and give in alms,
And that is the strong faith *in balms*.
6 Truly the ones who disbelieved
Among the folk of the Book's guide
And the idolators received,
Shall be in hell fire to abide,
The worst of creation beside.
7 Truly those who believe and do
Good works, they are the best in view
Of all creation, *it is true*.
8 Their reward from their Lord shall be
Gardens eternal under the which
Flow rivers and streams in the ditch,
To live in them eternally.
Allah's well pleased with them and they
Are satisfied with Him in sway:
This for him who fears his Lord's way.

No, the division was before the time

Of prophet come to save them from the
crime
Of Jew denying Christ come to the world
And Christian making him a god unfurled.
And yet it's true, no doubt, the Scripture
sound
Recited on the air and on the ground
Inspires the saved elect to heaven bound
By the decrees eternal, while the wail
Of Scripture in the ear of those who sail
Alone in their depravity makes sure
That their destruction is fit for impure.
Beloved, destroy me by the sweetness
heard

In the reciting of Qur'anic word,
And I shall die a happy man and stirred.

Surah 99 Al-Zilzal, or The Convulsion

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 When the earth is shaken to her
Utmost convulsion. 2 And throws her
Burdens up *from within*, 3 And man
Cries *loud in his distress*, 'What can
Be the matter with her?' 4 On that
Day she will declare her news flat.
5 For your Lord will have given her
The inspiration. 6 On that day
Will men proceed in groups that stay
To be shown the deeds that they's done.
7 Then anyone who's done a bit,
An atom's weight of good, sees it.
8 And anyone who's done a slight,
An atom's evil weight, shall sight.

I have not done an atom's worth of good
Though I have sometimes done just what I
should.

But You, Beloved, take evil done by men
And demons and turn wrongs to right and
then

Make good the short and straight the
crooked thing.

An atom's worth is all even a king
Can do of good or bad, yet even that
Must come to judgement where all men fall
flat,
And where You are shown right and just in
all.

I hasten toward the judgement at Your call,
And listen to the sema' of Your name
That echoes of Your lovely face and fame.

Each moment I see atoms brought to light,
Each breath I find I'm judged before Your
sight.

Surah 100 Al-Adiyat, or The Stallions

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 By *steeds* that run with panting *breath*,
2 And strike fiery sparks, 3 push *like death*
The charge at morn, 4 and raise the dust
In clouds the while, 5 then turn the first
To penetrate forthwith into
The midst of *foe* in mass *not few*:
6 Truly man to his Lord's ungrateful,
7 And to that *by his deeds* he's waitful
To bear his witness. 8 Violent
Is he in love of wealth *unspent*.
9 Does he not know, when that which is
In the graves abroad scattered is,
10 And that which is in *human* breast
Appears and is made manifest,
11 That their Lord had been well-
acquainted
With them, that day, *though they're*
unsainted?

Though You, Beloved, are unknown to my
sight

And I have no part nor place in Your right,
I have seen horses racing toward the night,
And gleaming in the rays of the last light.
Though You, Beloved, invisible may be
To me, I see the things You've made in
spree,

The fiery sparks of morn beneath the hoof
Of horses starting out from sleeping roof.
I too am violent in love of wealth,
I too am ready to tear out in stealth,
But more than this I'm violent to see
Return to Your face and eternity,
The hope of morning in the reddened glow,
The quest of evening in the doomsday
show.

Surah 101 Al-Qari'ah, the Calamity

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 Calamity! 2 And what's to see
With striking of calamity?
3 What makes you know of the degree
Of the striking calamity?
4 The day when folk shall come to be
Like moths dispersed *in wind's decree*,

5 And mountains furrowed like the wool
Carded *and torn beneath the pull*,

6 Then as for him whose scales weigh
much,

7 He shall be in life pleased to touch;
8 And as for him whose scales are light,
9 His home shall be a burning fright.
10 What makes you know that burning
well?
11 It is a raging fire *in spell*.

Beloved, my scales are overturned and
spilled

Beneath the places where the swine have
swilled.

My empty balances reflect the light
Of hopes now lost and all the ghastly sight
Of loss before the ruins of my plight.
Before the day of judgement and my loss,
Before the rendering of crown and cross,
Come secretly with mercy and then toss
It on my balances. Sustain my hope,
Since I have turned from every priest and
pope.

I seek no help from human hand, not mine
Or any other of the faded vine.
You are my only helper in the need:
Fill up my balances with Your own greed.

Surah 102 Al-Takathur, or Piling Up

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 The mutual rivalry for
Piling up *the good things in store*
Diverts you *from truth*, 2 until you
Visit the graves. 3 But no, for you
Shall soon know *truly*: 4 And again,
You shall soon know! 5 No, *being men*
Were you to know with certainty
Of mind, 6 you'll surely come to see
Hellfire! 7 Again, you shall see *light*
With the certainty of *your* sight!
8 Then, shall you be questioned that day
About abundances *that sway!*

The three abundances for which all are
Questioned upon the day of sun and star
Are merely these: What have I done with
You,

Beloved, knowing You unity is true,
And there is only One God and Almighty?
The second abundance is not less flighty,

But is: What have I done with those ones
sent
To give in Scripture what Your word has
meant?
So many accept one God yet fail to
Accept Your prophets and what things they
do.
The third abundance is a harder yet
To swallow for the man who'll take a bet.
It is: What have I done with divine guides
Whose worth is the whole world and all
besides?

Surah 103 Asr, or Time through the Ages

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
1 By *the token of time through ages*,
2 Truly man's in loss, 3 except *sages*
Who have faith, and do righteous deeds,
Joining in Truth each one that heeds,
In patience and in constancy
As long as time on earth shall be.

Beloved, I squeal beneath the squeeze of
Time,
And cry to You in silence, prose and
rhyme.

The loss if loss is never Yours, but mine
As long as I think floating is just fine.
I float indeed on time squeezed out since I
Float in assurance not remote but nigh,
And my faith is rewarded by the deeds
That You produce in Your name and my
needs.

Those portals of love and obedience
Lead to time squeezed beyond both life and
sense.

I step from the squeeze out in Truth whose
breeze
Is gusty on that hilltop after squeeze.
Give Me, Beloved, the patience to float on
That single Truth until the break of dawn.

Surah 104 Al-Humaza, or the Scandal Monger

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
1 Woe then to every scandal monger
And backbiter, 2 who piles up *longer*
Wealth and lays it by, 3 thinking that
His wealth makes him last *where he sat*.
4 By no means! He is sure to be

Thrown into grinding company.
5 And what shows you and makes you see
What is that grinding company?
6 The fire of Allah kindled *bright*,
7 Which mounts *lighting* the hearts of
night,
8 Made into a vault over them,
9 In columns outstretched *with bright gem*.

The mullah says say nothing bad about
Another or I shall bear the sin out
To judgement day, unless the wronged
reprieve.

The mullah is the one out to deceive.
He will not have the people say a word
Against his own deeds. He'd be reassured.
Backbiting is the evil speech that takes
A wicked profit for the rich men's sakes.
Let me, Beloved, be brave to tell the score
Of wickedness gone public, behind door,
By great or small, and always publicize
Oppression of the innocent by lies,
Expose the priest and president as thieves
Whose wicked actions cause the word that
grieves.

Surah 105 Al-Fil, or The Elephant

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
1 Do you not see how your Lord dealt
With companions of elephant?
2 Did He not make their plan to melt
They made in treachery? 3 He sent
Against them flocks of birds, 4 to strike
Them with stones of baked clay *alike*.
5 He made them like an empty field
Of stalks and straw and consumed yield.

Abraha came with elephants to move
The holy city off the earth or prove
The empire of Cush on two continents.
The Red Sea was a divide making sense.
The Christian kingdom met its master in
The birds that dropped clay stones from
stores and bins,
Until the armies were defeated and
Turned back at last and fled to their own
land.

Yet in the land of Abraha lay hidden
The tables of the law come forth unbidden,
Until Ali went there with the exile
And stood before a new king for awhile,

And brought back with him the signs of the
pact
That made his mission and his power a fact.

Surah 106 The Quraish, (Custodians of the Kaba)

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
1 Because of the treaties enjoyed
By the Quraish, *secure employed*,
2 Treaties for journeys in the winter
And in the summer *without splinter*,
3 Let them adore this house's Lord
4 Who gives them food against the void,
Security from fear of sword.

Let me, Beloved, secure, adore this house,
With summer swallow and the winter
grouse,

Lord of the date and pea and peace for
sword,

Let me, Beloved, adore this house's Lord.
The summer quickly bends its golden
streak

Across the spring green disappearing peek.
The autumn turns again the wheel of hope
Into the desolation of white scope
Across the islands, forests, all the land.
The round only obeys Your own command.
Let me, Beloved, secure against the ice,
Sleep contentedly unconscious of mice,
And wake to see the rosy dawn of light
That for a moment pierces winter's night.

Surah 107 Al-Maun, or the plate

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
1 Do you see him deny the day
Of judgement *coming in the way*?
2 Such is repulsing orphans *coldly*
3 Neglecting feeding poor ones *boldly*.
4 So woe to worshippers 5 who are
Neglectful of their prayers, 6 who star
In all the parts to be *best* seen
7 But still leave a poor man's plate clean.

Though I have mother and father I know
The orphan's plaint who has seen orphan's
show.

And though I have a well-filled plate I feel
The hunger of the poor who know no weal.
As I share my bread with the hungry
tongue,

I know beyond bread there's another rung,
And well-filled belly has its hidden clue,
And beringed hand abides the secret cue.
The veil of meat and silver hides the face
Of You, Beloved, in every dwelling place.
And so I make my father's honour due
A stepping stone of orphan up to You,
And take the bread my mother holds in
hand
As empty plate to bear to Your command.

Surah 108 Al-Kauthar, or Abundance

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
1 To you We grant fount of abundance.
2 So to your Lord *without redundancy*
Return in prayer and sacrifice.
3 For him who hates you, he shall slice
Off *from future hope in a trice*.

The Prophet, in his sorrow for the lost
Sons all who died so young and at such
cost

Of ridicule, heard promises of sweet
Waters to quaff, an ecstasy and treat.
He heard the punishment that You will
mete

Out on the ones who hated him and cried
Their scoffing flags on him from every
side.

What comfort is in hearing that somehow
The future holds reward for him, the slough
For enemy? I think the heart still longs
For children gone, although for no one's
wrongs.

Beloved, Your sight is on eternal now,
While I brave moments passing through the
sieve.

In Your name I brave sorrows, and I live.

Surah 109 Al-Kafirun, or Those who reject Faith

In the name of God Most Gracious,
Merciful.

Proclaim: O you who disbelieve!
I worship not what you receive,
What I know you do not believe,
I'll not worship when you deceive,
You'll not worship to what I cleave,
To you your doom, to me reprieve.

Beloved, You seem to tell Your prophet
 how
 To put them in their place who break the
 plough.
 The pious Muslim will pretend this text
 Expresses tolerance. I'm still perplexed.
 Reprieve and doom are both "deen" in the
 word,
 And here You use the tongue David
 preferred.
 The sweet Christian reads only David's
 speech
 That has no curse for enemies to teach.
 Illusion only teaches confrontation
 While there's no I but You in state and
 nation.
 Let Your judgement destroy the separation
 In me that works evil recrimination,
 Till there is no reprieve but for You only,
 The Self You give to find and not be
 lonely.

Surah 110 Al-Nasr, or Help

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 When comes Allah's awaited aid,
 And Victory, 2 you see *unpaid*
 The people enter in by crowd
 Allah's religion, 3 Celebrate
 The praises of your Lord *aloud*,
 And pray for His forgiveness *late*:
 For He is oft-returning *here*
When grace and mercy shall appear.

For centuries the crowds have entered in
 Your faith, for centuries remained in sin.
 There is no faith to put in fickle crowd,
 A better thing might be were none allowed
 To come to faith than that the victory
 And help be turned to greed and cruelty.
 In Your name crowds of faithful come to
 spend
 Their wealth in stocks and bombs without
 an end.
 Their prayers and pilgrimage suffice they
 think
 To make atonement for oppression's stink.
 For this I celebrate Your praise alone
 Who am unworthy of the creeds in stone.
 Let others enter in, I stand apart
 And seek not faith but love, and from the
 heart.

Surah 111 Al-Lahab, or the Father of Flame

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.
 1 Perish hands of Father of Flame!
 Perish he! 2 No profit to claim
 From all his wealth, and all his gain!
 3 Burnt soon will he be in a Fire
 Of blazing Flame! 4 His wife, *the bane*,
 Shall bear the *crackling* wood's *desire*
 As fuel! 5 And so a twisted rope
 Of palm leaf fibre *without hope*
 Around her *own* neck *for her blame*!

I see her walking on the street, along
 The river, waiting at stop-lights and then,
 The thorns protruding from her parisienne,
 I see her laughing at the right and wrong.
 Her artificial shoes cost one year's wage.
 She changes them by dozens in their
 season.
 She does not know her sweet life is a
 treason

Against herself, writ on an angel's page.
 She carries thorns and twigs to fuel the fire
 Of scandal and oppression that buy meats
 And dainty pastries that her husband eats.
 Her only goal is trample and acquire.
 She represents this town's majority
 And shows democracy's a fallacy.

Let my soul carry crackling wood as fuel
 And I shall join the fray in frightful duel,
 And perish both my hands that seek to do
 The right or wrong and be instead of You!
 Let there be nothing in my wealth or gain
 To vie with You, Beloved, I seek the rain
 Of fire and brimstone on my naked heart,
 A blazing, burning fire to do its part,
 A flaming furnace where the twisted rope
 Of palm leaf fibre round my neck for hope
 Disintegrates in heat of hell, turns dark
 And frees my soul from self and saving ark.
 I flee to burning love in You, I flee
 And join in One beyond plurality.

Surah 112 Al-Ikhlās, or Purity (of Faith)

In the name of God Most Gracious,
 Merciful.
 1 Proclaim alone He God is one.
 2 God without need of anyone.

3 He is not born, He sires no son,
4 There is none like him, no, not one.

Truly, my Beloved, there is none like You!
The One and Only, Allah Allah Huu!
Eternal, Absolute, in need of none,
Truly, my Beloved, You alone are One!
For You give birth to nothing I may know,
In You there is no change, no come and go,
You have no birth, You have no source at
all,

Time, place, inside or out the earthly ball.
Creation is an idol if by it
I might attempt to give You space or fit.
No weight or colour, sequence, sour or
sweet

Can touch Your essence, trace Your hands
and feet.

Invisible to eye and mind above,
I cannot know You, I can only love.

Surah 113 Al-Falaq, or The Dawn

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 Say: I flee to the Lord of dawn,
2 From mischief of created things,
3 From darkness' mischief coming on,
4 From mischief of the blowers on
The knots, who practice secret arts,
5 From mischief of the envious *kings*
Or slaves, whenever envy starts.

Love, let me practice envy in the dawn,
I envy red-bright clouds You have stepped
on,

I envy earth caught in Your sleeted tears,
I envy sky bared to You when rain clears,
I envy trees leaf-brushed by both Your
hands,

I envy hills where Your lost image stands,
I envy ground grass-kissed by both Your
lips,

I envy Psalms where You live drunk in
sips,

I envy temple, mosque and synagogue
Where Your Name hides in sunlight or in
fog.

I envy sun, moon, stars behind Your train,
I envy taut day and damp night in vain,
Though You escape both times and all
compare,

I envy my own self to find You there.

Surah 114 Al-Nas, or Mankind

In name of God Most Gracious, Merciful.

1 Say: I seek refuge with the Lord
And Cherisher of humankind,
2 The King *or Ruler without sword*
Of humankind, 3 Allah *not blind*
But still the Judge of humankind,
4 From the mischief of him who whispers
Evil in stealth and then withdraws,
5 *The one* who whispers *among lispers*
Into men's hearts *with fatal claws*,
6 *Who slinks away, comes back again*
Among the jinns and among men.

O my Beloved, Most Gracious, Merciful,
My Lord and Cherisher, my Judge and
King,

I seek my refuge from the wonderful
And good as well as from the evil thing.
I flee to You from every whispering word,
I flee to You from everything that's heard,
And from the silences I meet within,
And from my good deeds as I flee from sin.
As I turn from all things in flight to You,
I find all things turn from the dark to true.
And what was slinking whisper in the ear
And arrows through the soul when heard
from here,

Becomes Your voice of love within my
heart,
Both voice of jinn and every human part.

O my Beloved, take me out of this world!
I've read the words attributed to You,
I've joined the temples where in prayer I
whirled

Only to find in every chart and pew
Mankind's hatred both for my word and for
My silences. Give me another shore.
I do not seek Your paradise reward,
I only seek relief from angels' sword.
Let me fall in the punishments of hell
Rather than meet the faces that repel
The divine spark within my heart. It burns.
Extinguish me, now, my Beloved